

THE REVELATION IN THE WILDERNESS

*(Dealing with the revelation of the meaning of
the symbolism contained in the traditions of old in
the wilderness of the mind and of the modern world)*

AN EXPOSITION OF TRADITIONAL PSYCHOLOGY



N. KLUWER • DEVENTER

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VOLUME I

THE BOOK OF SIGNS

BY G. H. MEES

M A (Cantab), LL D (Leyden)



N KLUWER • DEVENTER

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*Note: This Volume is accompanied by a separate folder,
the Supplement,
containing diagrams, notes and recognitions.*

PROFOUND SALUTATION TO THE MASTERS OF OLD,
MOST PROFOUND SALUTATION AND DEDICATION
TO THE SUPREME MASTER, OUR SON OF GOD,
MOST PROFOUND SALUTATION AND DEDICATION
TO THE HOLY SPIRIT OF THE TRADITION, OUR MOTHER,
ADORATION OF THE DIVINE REALITY,
OUR FATHER

"I beheld the earth, and lo, it was waste and void, and the heavens, and they had no light I beheld, and lo, the fruitful place was a wilderness "

(JEREMIAH, 4, 23, 26)

"I testify unto every man that heareth the words of the prophecy of this book, If any man shall add unto these things, God shall add unto him the plagues that are written in this book And if any man shall take away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part out of the book of life, and out of the holy city, and from the things which are written in this book He who testifieth these things saith, Surely I come quickly "

(ST JOHN THE DIVINE in the Revelation, 22, 18-20)

"For there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed, neither hid, that shall not be made known "

(ST LUKE, 12, 2)

"Thus there begins their living and their growing wise, For every birth of flesh ensouled and of the fruit of seed, and every handiwork, though it decay shall of necessity renew itself, both by the renovation of the Gods and by the turning-round of Nature's rhythmic wheel "

(HERMES TRISMEGISTUS, The Sacred Sermon, 4)

"Behold a very fair and most resemblant image — a husbandman casting the seed into the ground, here wheat, here barley, and there (again) some other of the seeds!

Behold one and the selfsame man planting the vine, the apple, and (all) other trees!

In just the selfsame way doth God sow Immortality in Heaven, and Change on Earth, and Life and Motion in the Universe "

(HERMES TRISMEGISTUS, Letter to Asclepius, 10)

"Therefore speak I to them in parables: because they seeing see not; and hearing they hear not, neither do they understand. . . . For this people's heart is waxed gross, and their ears are dull of hearing, and their eyes they have closed. . . . But blessed are your eyes, for they see; and your ears, for they hear. For verily I say unto you, that many prophets and righteous men have desired to see those things which ye see, and have not seen them, and to hear those things which ye hear, and have not heard them." (ST. MATTHEW, 13; 13, 15, 16-17)

"The voice of him that crieth in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make straight in the desert a highway for our God." (ISAIAH, 40; 3)

"O Lord of the Universe, O Universal Form . . . O God! in Thy body I see all the Gods, as well as multitudes of all kinds of beings . . . In Thy vast Form the Universe is spread . . . O All, boundless in power, immeasurable in strength. Thou holdest all, therefore Thou art All."

(ARJUNA in the Bhagavad Gitā, 11; 15, 38, 40)

"Would it be possible for thee to get wings, and soar into the Air, and, poised midway 'tween Earth and Heaven, behold the Earth's solidity, the Sea's fluidity (the flowings of its streams), the spaciousness of Air, Fire's swiftness, (and) the coursing of the Stars, the swiftness of Heavens' circuit round them (all)!"

(HERMES TRISMEGISTUS to his son Tat,
Though unmanifest God is most manifest, 5)

"In search of flowers wherewith to worship Thee, O Lord, misguided people are seen to go into thick forests, climb to the summits of high hills, or venture forth into deep lakes, and yet fail to attain the bliss supreme, which they could quickly have got by offering unto Thee the single, stainless, flower of their heart."

(VISHNU MAHIMNA STOTRAM)

"To have attained to the human form must always be a source of joy. And then, to undergo countless transformations, with only the infinite to look forward to, — what incomparable bliss is that!" (CHUANG TZE, 6)

"We speak the wisdom of God in a mystery, the hidden wisdom, which God ordained before the world unto our glory."

(ST. PAUL to the Corinthians, I ; 2 : 7)

"To the impure eyes of them Thou seekest to liberate, Thou manifestest Thyself in a variety of shapes; but to those of Thy followers who have been purified, Thou, Lord, appearest as a Perfected Being; obeissance to Thee."

(The Tibetan Yogi JETSON MILAREPA to his Guru)

"For to the Good there is no other shore; It hath no bounds; It is without an end; and for itself It is without beginning, too, though unto us it seemeth to have one — the Gnosis."

Therefore to It Gnosis is no beginning; rather is it (that Gnosis doth afford) to us the first beginning of Its being known."

Let us lay hold, therefore, of the beginning, and quickly speed through all (we have to pass)

'T is very hard, to leave the things we have grown used to, which meet our gaze on every side, and turn ourselves back to the Old Old (Path)."

(HERMES TRISMEGISTUS to Tat,
The Cup or Monad, 8-9)

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„	1b	Periods connected with the Path through the Zodiac.
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„	3	The Fourteen Worlds, and various groups of fourteen symbols.

INTRODUCTION

1. THE PRESENT WORLD

Peace and War. The tower of modern civilization, built on the foundations of "the enlightenment" and "the industrial revolution", is tottering. The edifices of human construction have been crashing down literally and metaphorically. They had ceased to be constructions for human edification. The word "Aedis", from which "edification" is derived, means "temple". Modern life has become almost wholly profane. "Profanus" means "outside the temple". Even religion has become profane, for it has lost meaning and life.

The world is full of ruins — material, emotional, rational and spiritual. The ruins are haunted by souls like ghosts that cannot find peace. After the mad riot of well thought-out and organized theft and destruction of the second world-war, a semblance of peace has come here and there. There may or there may not be war on the physical plane, but whatever be the case, it continues in the emotional and mental worlds. If peace has come, it is only on the surface. Below that surface, within the soul, remains a hunting ground of desires, passions and delusions. Peace in the psyche, crowned by the Peace of God, is known by very few.

What is "peace"? The Latin "pax", from which "peace" is derived, means "a compact, a bargain". "Pact" is a related word.

True inner peace does not depend on pacts between men and nations. It cannot come as long as men have a pact with the devil — their ego. The Sanskrit word "pāśa", etymologically related to "peace", means bondage. It is used to denote the pact of the soul with "the things of this world", and implies the bondage of selfishness and sinfulness. True Peace, on the other hand, comes with the Covenant between man and God, between the lower and the higher man. It is "a state of heart", a pact with the Divine Higher Self, demanding obedience to the *spirit* of the sacred traditions of old. The condition of the pact is man's mastery over self and its world.

The masses of this age are only interested in the peace depending on man-made pacts. They do not understand the only true way to peace of heart by the fulfilment of the Divine Covenant.

For as long as there is no change of heart, a happier world cannot be expected. War is raging within the psyche. Here and there it is of such chronic nature, that people know no better and have accepted it as a matter of course, not realizing in the least that another, happier, state is at all possible. Many battles are taking place within the soul of modern man. Those he sees with his conscious mind may not cause too much trouble. But many he cannot see, very often because he refuses to see them. These may have, and do have at times, most unhappy, and even catastrophic, results.

The Robot has risen against the Spirit and obtained the upper hand in the lower realms. The Spirit has all but fled away. Which of the two will win the last round? The very exterior of man has taken on a Robot's characteristics: nearly all humanity is in "uniform", military, civil, political, professional, and nearly all humanity in modern states is in the bondage of an indefinitely extended network of laws, regulations and stereotyped forms. Unlike the Rules or Commandments of sacred tradition, which never change, their profane substitutes are in continuous revolution, tending thereby to ever greater complication, confusion and dissension. While the former aim at Liberation, the latter make for bondage.

Man has become progressively focussed in consciousness and egotism on the material plane and the substances and energies of matter have become the predominating factors in his life. The higher faculties of intuition, reason and feeling have become subservient to the ends of "materialism". At the present time the powers released by man have begun to threaten his physical existence. There seems to be nothing but death before him, in spite of his clever efforts to preserve and lengthen life. Now he is engaged in unharnessing the very powers of Creation which are latent in the atoms of the Earth Element, the material plane. In nuclear fission he has released the dormant power of the heaviest and hence the most earthly of the physical elements. "Chemistry, the invention of the Titans" (Syncellus) is beginning to reach its zenith. The modern Promêtheus is stealing the Fire from Heaven in a far more serious form than the Promêtheus of old.

Man has been learning to control matter. There would be no harm in this, if he were capable of controlling himself. But he has not learned that. On the contrary, he has lost much of the control he exercised over himself in the days of old. The discipline he applies is Titanic in nature.

Amidst the modern mechanical and regimented forms of life the human soul is suffering agonies of spiritual imprisonment and starvation. In spite of his achievements modern man is a bored and lonely creature. For the Spirit is the greatest friend and most lively companion, the source of inspiration and joy, the guide on supreme adventures. But modern man has

lost all acquaintance with the Spirit. He runs everywhere in search of other company and in quest of adventure, not knowing that he need not go anywhere to find happiness, for the Spirit is ever where he happens to be himself — if he would but hear and see it.

Nothing but a change of heart, an awakening from sleep, a rebirth from death (to use the traditional terms) can save humanity from expiring in its psychical prison, from dying in its spiritual sleep, from falling into deeper gloom and doom.

The power of thought. This is the age of reason. Even now the world's leaders are engaged in thinking and working out solutions of the problems of reconstruction in the same way in which they thought and worked out the problems of destruction. Without realizing it, they are preparing the ground for other worldwars. For thought by itself can never save the world. It is indeed the excessive emphasis on "thinking" that provokes most of the problems of the present day. There is no lack of cleverness but not all the clever put together can transform the world.

Here and there faith in higher matters is found but a faith groping and uncertain, even if it is pure and genuine. It is a faith knocking at the Gate, not a faith that has been admitted to the inside of things.

On the whole neither the leaders nor the led put much faith in anything except the very powers which contributed to the catastrophes of this age, namely, the powers of reason, and the powers derived from their application in mechanics and regimentation — including the power of money and paper.

Of all the powers used in dissociation from the remaining human faculties, those of reason have proved themselves the least "reasonable". Of this the contemporary world presents one vast illustration.

The earth has become too narrow and too small for many. There are no more unknown continents, lands or peoples to be discovered that are of any importance to modern man. People dream of greater conquests, they want to be shot in rockets to other continents and into space. Actually they want to escape from the world they have created for themselves. They run after more and more science and mechanics, which all the time bring greater and greater complications, leading to more, and more problems.

All the while people do not realize that they are escaping from their own soul, and that there are great worlds to be discovered, or rather, re-discovered, within their own selves. They do not know of the great adventures to be experienced during that quest and do not dream that they hold the greatest treasure within their own heart.

Philosophy. The greater part of philosophy — that is, rational and natural philosophy — nourishes and appeals to the rational function alone. It serves a *part*, only, of the human psyche and is not concerned with the complete, integrated personality, the whole man. Thus it is useless from the point of view of the fullness of life. The effect is to overstimulate and overfeed the rational function and ignore, neglect and starve the remainder and thus leads to unbalance and disintegration of the whole psyche.

Only that which feeds all inner organs of man in such a harmonious way that he is not aware that he has different organs in his body at all, is "wholesome" food. The fruit of the Tree of Life alone feeds his inner faculties in that manner. Whatever overfeeds some parts of his being and starves others should be left alone or discarded. Modern man is possessed by his thinking faculty. "Grey is all theory, green grows the Tree of Life alone", as Goethe wrote. Many types of modern leaders are bloodless and dry like books of paper, while the led are shedding their lifeblood like sacrificial animals and their sweat like slaves.

It is not necessary to devote space to the forms of materialistic philosophy.

Warning voices have been heard of people who very well realize what is taking place within the human psyche and consequently in the world of social relations. Side by side with them are found the mere-critics, always ready, sometimes with the best of motives, to criticise other people and institutions. They do not improve the world, for they do not offer anything constructive in the place of what they condemn. Many people do not know that the only way to improve the world is by improving oneself. Others are sincerely desirous of improving themselves, but do not know how, and lack inspiration and guidance.

Religion In all parts of the world established religion is the religion of "the letter of the Law". That "letter" is upheld at the expense of its "spirit". Perhaps it is more correct to say that the letter of the Law is upheld at the expense of the spiritual life of man, for the spirit of the Tradition, that is, the language of symbols, has been forgotten long ago. It has become deeply hidden in the unconscious.

Many people in all walks of life and belonging to various traditions in the East and in the West have realized that religion in its present forms fails to satisfy the aspirations and the intelligence of the men and women of the time, many of whom consequently turn to cheap substitutes or to some form of pseudo religion or atheism.

Modern religions have lost organic contact with actual life and so too

their power to inspire and convince. Their creeds and dogmas have ceased to be of real interest. Many old traditions and customs are condemned or even damned as forms of superstition.

The outer man is out of joint with the inner man. The result is disease: of the soul, of the nerves, of the body, of human relationships in every field and on every plane of existence, and of society.

If the average man of this day accepts or believes in a Divinity at all, his God is a glorified version of his own mentality — a super-professor of physics and mathematics and super-mechanic in one, who has invented a super-machine run by transcendent super-wireless. His God is not to be associated with any form of "humanity", for that would be anthropomorphism, nor "personality", for that would be unworthy of the achievements of this enlightened age. He is an "abstract" God.

Modern forms of religion are hardly compatible with modern intelligence. Because they are so unintelligible they have ceased to command the interest of the thinking man. Modern theologians have, consciously or unconsciously, to engage constantly in acrobatic adjustments. Their creeds are doomed to pass away, unless they can be infused with new life through renewal of the original and true meaning. For man is at heart too great to be satisfied with a letter from which the meaning has gone.

Within and without "established religion" and its creeds and forms, the religion of the heart, which is private and individual, blossoms here and there. For it is timeless, ever ancient and ever modern.

Because the older forms of religion did not satisfy many people, various new cults have sprung into existence, many of which are systems of mystery-mongering. Their leaders have hunted at mysterious secrets, to be learned only by those who join their ranks and contribute tangible power to the movements or their leaders. They have played with symbols, but not given an interpretation of their meaning. Nothing tickles the mind more than secret knowledge and its (imagined) possession, withheld from others like a trade monopoly. Books on "occult" knowledge and secret places and beings have been published in large numbers and eagerly read by the many who are attracted by this forbidden canned fruit. Some imagine that by indulging in pitiful superstitions they are reaching back to ancient traditions. There are masses of people who have a vulgar desire for various mental and psychic powers. Many forms of thought and "religion" openly or disguisedly aim at strengthening that from which true religion liberates the soul: egotism and selfishness.

Comparative religion has so far been little more than a rationalistic academic subject. It has been studied in the same spirit as that in which a

merchant studies the laws and regulations of trade, in order that he may outwit his competitors

Questions that arise. The ideals of former periods were full of commonplaces, phrases and bloodless abstractions. Endless repetition has made them completely meaningless. What will take the

place of the clichés and the bankrupt ideas? What can heal the boredom of spirit? What can hold back the recklessness of sense which results from an all-round exhaustion of the human faculties? What food will be available for the starving soul? What will take the place of the patriotic ideals of wartime? What forms of struggle will replace the fight against the aggression, greed and tyranny of other nations? What will be able to shatter the faith of people in the fiery rationalistic powers which have been running amok?

Whence shall come new life, new faith, new ideals? Where can inspiration, peace, and joy in life be found? How can modern man regain his self-respect? What service can he attempt to do in the world that may bear fruit not for the day alone, but for all time?

Where should one search for God? In scriptures? In a church or a temple? In the self-forgetfulness of service? In the woods and plains or in the expanse of the waters? In the words of a preacher? In one's own heart? In the face of a friend or a parent? In a flower? In a machine? In heaven or hell? Is it necessary to search for God at all? Is there a God?

Such separate questions arise in periods when the integrity of life has been lost, because the meaning of life has been forgotten. Their solution comes with the re-discovery of the meaning and the re-establishment of the integrity of life at its hand. In order to bring this about it is necessary to turn to the traditional science which embraces, unifies and synthesizes all aspects of life, and which connects the actual everyday-life of the world with the most exalted things. That science is the Tradition of old — a system of psychology and theology in one.

"What shall it profit a man if he gain the whole world, and lose his own soul?" That is what modern man has been engaged in doing. How much will it profit a man to lose all worldliness and gain his own soul!

2. TRADITIONAL PSYCHOLOGY

Tradition. For the solution of his problems man should turn to his spiritual heritage, contained in the traditions of the ancients and to some extent also in their offshoots which have subsisted till the present day. Certain records in stone and paper have been preserved or handed down from past generations.

Humanity has a treasure-house with many rooms, full of monuments, images and scriptures, containing teachings in the language of symbols, and further rituals, ceremonies and customs, and orally transmitted traditions, to draw upon.

For the *meaning* of what he finds he should search in another treasure-house, not found in the outer world, but in his own soul. For the *meaning* of even the fundamentals of symbolism has been lost to the conscious mind. To discover it he must turn within and call to aid some of the higher psychical functions for letting it arise out of the unconscious. Though the sacred traditions of the ancients were in their original form entirely rational (even if more than that), the rational mind of modern students has been unable to find its way through them. This is only natural, for the old traditions did not aim at presenting a picture of a rational universe or a rational man. It will be shown that they were forms of a psychological science which dealt with the interrelation and correlation of *all* the psychological functions and the creative power from which these spring: consciousness.

The reason why the rational mind has not succeeded in finding the key to the traditions of old is that it always searches for a one-word-one-meaning interpretation — as is correct for a modern textbook of an exact science. But such an interpretation serves no purpose with symbols, for reasons which will be apparent later. Furthermore, the key is symbolical and to be found and successfully applied only by the functions which are higher than the rational, in co-operation with the rational and emotional functions.

The modern mind always searches for a rational meaning. This is correct with regard to purely rational matters. But psychology deals with a field of life in which the rational mind is only one of the active factors. Therefore the teachings of traditional psychology should be approached by all the psychical functions: perception, feeling, rational thought, intuition, and faith. Psychological problems arise from disharmony and discord between the various psychological functions. Therefore their solution should be attempted by them all, and not merely by the rational function.

The function of thought considers itself to be so objective that it deems the character of the thinker to be of no importance with regard to its efficiency. It is true that the exercise of the function of thought, as distinct from the direction and objects of its preoccupation, is not much influenced by character. Blackguards can have very efficient minds. But we do not speak of clever saints, and it is clear that in a saint the function of thought is well controlled by other functions. The traditional teachings tell us (as we shall see later) that these higher functions only begin to play a part in life after a person's character has become sufficiently purified. It is also for this

reason that the search for the meaning of ancient traditions has so far not yielded any fruit.

In the present very gloomy period of time various technical circumstances have made it possible, for the first time on a big scale since history (as reckoned by the people of this age) began, to place the traditions of all nations and cultures, ancient and modern, religious and otherwise, side by side. If this modern age had not had a few saving features, humanity could never have lived through it at all.

When the study of comparative religion, mythology and culture ceases to be an exclusive concern of the rational mind and a pastime for sectarians, and is followed on a truly sincere and unbiassed basis, and not pursued in an abstract way, but continually referred to the psychological and sociological actualities of life — first of all those of the students themselves — it is hardly possible to foresee the vastness of its consequences for the future of humanity. For it will be a study of traditional *psychology*.

Dreams. Psychologists have recognized the intimate relationship between the symbolic material of the dreams of sleep and that of the traditions of olden times. How intimate this relationship is will be realized by anyone who begins to study this subject at the hand of the meaning of the traditional material that is dealt with in this book. It lies beyond the scope of this work to adduce evidence for it, which can easily be collected by individual researchers from their own dreams and those of others. Modern man has lost the faculty and the key to enter into the meaning of myths, and he has only just begun again to interpret dreams. Myths have dropped out of this life, leaving him in a state of spiritual poverty, and his dreams are only very rarely „great dreams”, mostly consisting, as they do, of images of a superficial nature, relating to the superficial atmosphere of modern life.

Psychological etymology. The science of etymology is of very great value in the search for the meaning of symbols. But apart from purely philological factors, there are certain pseudo-etymological factors of great value to psychology, that should also receive attention. Between (pure) etymology and what is called “popular etymology” is a great field which — for lack of a better name — may be termed “psychological etymology”. This field has so far hardly received recognition, since etymologists refuse, from their point of view rightly, to consider anything which is regarded by them as “popular etymology”.

As an example of “psychological etymology” one may cite the association

between the words "bliss" and "blessing", which are not related in their origin. The first originally meant joy and is related to "blithe"; and the second indicated a wound and is related to "blood". Since both were connected with religious sacrifices, an association was formed in the mind. Such a connection is based on sound-similarity and association of origin, end, aim, meaning, function, or cause-and-effect.

Another example is provided by the words "good" and "God". At first words may be merely connected together in some symbolic association or other. To give an example. Somewhere the words "symbol" and "sample" were spontaneously joined together, in spite of the fact that they are not etymologically related at all. This is the first stage. When the association is repeated and taken over by others, it is on the way, if it is important enough, to become a tradition. The field of life to which they apply and the subtlety and usefulness of such a marriage between words will decide whether it will produce a sample of popular etymology or a symbol of psychological etymology. The history of the great traditions is full of examples of the process, which has been promoted by the influence of syncretism. Some associations, in which there is no element of bloodrelationship, have become more intimate through marriage than many that arise only from bloodrelationship.

Wrong etymological conclusions of past generations have similarly become traditions. They should be accepted as forms of "psychological etymology" and part and parcel of the psychological treasure-trove of man. It must also be remarked that it is sometimes difficult to say where etymological conclusions go wrong, for, as will be pointed out later, all roots ultimately lead to one root of roots.

The contrast The modern outlook is concerned with "definite" things, that is, "finite", delimited, things. It likes the outlook of "definitions" or devices to delimit things. However traditional psychology and the modern outlook. if they are employed outside their proper domain for the purpose of imprisoning truths (as a definition of God) and expressions of life. The modern outlook is also much concerned with abstractions and generalizations.

The working material of traditional psychology consists of symbols. These are in contrast with the definitions or one-word-one-meaning terms that are used in the place of definitions. Symbols represent psychological situations in connection with particular stages in a time-cycle. It is evident,

therefore, that there is nothing vague and indetermined about them. Their meaning should be deduced from their context, as is the case with words in a sentence. They may, and should, be rationally clarified and explained, so long as it is realized that this process deals with only one aspect of their nature. The other aspects are clarified at the hand of supplementing and analogous symbols.

The modern outlook is bound up with self-realization in material comfort and emotional pleasure. The reality it is concerned with is that of "this world". The outlook of traditional science is bound up with the striving for self-knowledge and the realization of the Self or God, bringing the comfort of a peaceful mind and the pleasure of ecstatic rapture. The reality it is interested in is absolute Reality and its highest aim is to realize That in the world, thereby unifying the great opposites and harmonizing life.

The modern outlook is much concerned with the situation on "the morrow", whereas the traditional outlook stresses the value of the moment itself. In this the traditional outlook is more realistic.

The modern outlook stresses the ideal of human equality, the traditional outlook is aware of the fact of spiritual and moral inequality in the world. Here, again, the outlook of tradition is the more realistic.

The modern tendency is to equalize life in the world, the traditional outlook is that man is at heart (respectively, *was* and *will be*) the likeness of God.

In its better aspects the modern outlook demands moral reconstruction. The traditional outlook stresses the need of spiritual renaissance. There are many people of great moral integrity who are spiritually bored, starving and unhappy. The spiritual functions are suppressed and repressed to a greater extent than one would consider possible, and — as quite a few people have realized — this fact is at the root of a great many of the problems of our age, if not of all.

In the modern outlook "a myth" is synonymous with the "unintelligible" or even the "non-existent". The expression "a mere myth" is intended to denote what is baseless and imaginary. In traditional psychology a myth is a story containing at one and the same time the highest and the most practical wisdom.

The outlooks of science and the sacred psychological traditions of old are opposed to each other as form to life. In practice they can never be entirely distinct, for form and life are actually related. Tradition shows us that the worlds of the Titans and the Gods are also related.

Science starts from uncertainties and doubts and works with speculations and working hypotheses. It begins, as it were, at the bottom. It starts from an ever changing world. The sacred psychological traditions of old, on the

other hand, started from the top, from an experienced Reality, from Being and a changeless Certainty. It reflects Truth and teaches in terms of "thus it is". This science can never do. For it is based upon the relative.

Modern man has come to a great extent to identify Consciousness and thought, the Logos and logic, Pure Reason and common sense. His methods of thought have led to label-thinking. His mind is like a box full of labels, while the mind of a man open to the sacred traditions of old is like a sky with moving clouds.

Sacred tradition contains, in so far it deals with realms beyond reason, and beyond the reach of reason, much that is unreasoned, and perhaps unreasonable. But it is not irrational. If rationalism is to be condemned, this applies only to rationalism-for-rationalism's sake and rationalism-for-materialism's sake. The rational function cannot be condemned and should not be restrained if it works harmoniously with the other functions.

Modern thought is analytical, ever productive of new cupboards full of new labels. This leads by more and more specialization to the collective schizophrenia of modern humanity, with the separation of the psyche in water-tight compartments. The outlook of traditional psychology is synthetic, it makes for unity and harmony in the soul and between men. The modern mind seeks differences, while the mind open to tradition seeks what unites.

The modern outlook is one of identification with the physical body, the emotions and the faculty of thought, while the outlook of traditional psychology is associated with theokrasia, that is, the practice leading to the union of the soul with God or Being, and the realization of its true identity.

In theological and philosophical matters the modern man is sectarian and intolerant and holds that he has a special revelation or truth all of his own. The outlook of sacred psychology is tolerant and spiritually syncretic. It strives for the rediscovery of parallelisms between the symbolic teachings belonging to different traditions, for the purpose of obtaining more knowledge, greater inspiration and a clearer insight. Syncretism should not be superficial and artificial (in which sense some have interpreted and hence condemned it) but be based on the original living relationship between traditions.

From the point of view of traditional psychology, modern forms of theology are literalistic and pseudo-rationalistic interpretations of sacred tradition. Traditional psychology is not traditionalism, in the sense of the striving for the preservation of traditional *forms* which, having lost their *meaning* represent a degeneration of older and purer teachings. It aims at truth and clarification and discards superstition wherever it is found.

Philosophy came into existence a few centuries before the Christian era and became the basis of modern philosophy. But early philosophy was linked with the world of symbols and myths — as Eastern philosophy still is to a very great extent. It is significant that Jesus did not bring a new philosophy. He spoke in symbols and his life has been recorded in the form of a myth. The Christian Mystery represented the resurrection and fulfilment of older Mysteries. Philosophy, divorced from the teachings of traditional psychology, is a product of times of progressive “schizophrenia” and decay. The perennial philosophy is contained in the teachings of traditional psychology and theology.

Most of the terms of Eastern schools of philosophy cannot be defined, like the terms of Western philosophy. They are symbolical and do not indicate particular concepts. Words such as *Âtmâ*, *Buddhi*, *Dharma*, *Karma*, etc., have meaning according to the context in which and the occasion and the time at which they are used or occur. *Âtmâ*, for instance, may mean many things ranging from the Supreme Self via the soul (whatever it means) to the body, the lowest form of the “self”. *Buddhi* is used in an number of different meanings: intuition, discrimination between the One and the multiple, discrimination between the Real and the unreal, discrimination between Spirit and form, discrimination between “the letter of the Law” and its meaning, perception of symbolic meaning, secondary direct perception of truth (the primary being *Âtman* by *Âtman*), etc. A glossary of terms or a dictionary is not of much use for understanding the meaning of a term in a particular context. What is needed before all else is a steady focussing in the function of *Buddhi*, after that faculty has been progressively developed. The traditional aid in understanding is given by myths in which the function of *Buddhi* or spiritual discrimination is shown in interplay with the other psychical functions, in tackling the problems of life.

The spirit and the meaning of teachings of traditional psychology cannot be obtained by perception (of their letter), feeling, and logic, though all these functions are of assistance. “The key is not transmitted with scriptures, but infused in the spirit by means of the spirit” (Agrippa, *Epist. III*, 56).

Modern teachings appeal only to the faculty of thought, traditional teachings make an appeal to *all* the inner functions. Symbols should be interpreted rationally only in so far as the rational enters in as a subsidiary function along with the other functions. The main function for dealing with them and for appraising them is the intuition, the faculty of spiritual understanding which in Hinduism is called the *Buddhi*. According to the teachings, *Buddhi* involves the lower functions harmoniously, if it is “pure”. In that case it is also linked to the functions beyond it. The three lower

functions are the perception and apprehension of the tangible aspect of a symbol, the emotional function, and the rational function. If Buddhi is not "pure", one or other of the lower functions predominates. When the co-ordination of the lower functions has been achieved in life, and Buddhi "purified", life becomes "like an open book", insight is won, and the highest peace, happiness and rapture obtained.

The symbols of traditional psychology and many of the terms of Oriental philosophy are hints and cannot be equated with the terms of Western philosophy. Eastern and Western philosophy, traditional psychology and the modern outlook, cannot meet, unless the modern thinker finds his way back to the wisdom which is hidden in his unconscious and contains the wide world of ancient, but perennial, traditions.

The modern mind has a high opinion of itself and a poor opinion of the ancients. It will become evident by and by that the ancients were vastly more cultured and intellectual than is now held.

Rationalism is unrealistic, for rational man does not know anything, whatever it be, for certain — as also the leading scientists of the present time have now realized. The man of great faith and insight into the quintessence of things, the mystic, is a realist, for he knows that GOD, who is the substratum of all, IS, whereas everything else is perpetually changing. Mystics and seers in all ages have declared that GOD stands out as Reality. This realization has given many the faith and the power to face persecution, martyrdom and death. Traditional psychology holds that God is both Reality and the Self. The average man holds that reality and his self are inherent in his physical body. In him — according to the traditional point of view — Reality and the Self have been concealed within the self-created structure of psychical delusion. The human mind veils itself, closes itself, delimits itself, binds itself, and, after having done so, either sits in self-glory on its self-made throne, lighted by artificial lamps which sooner or later fail, or plucks the fruits of its self-caused exile, blaming God or chance for the imperfections, troubles, sufferings and catastrophes of life, for which nothing but its own attitude and action should be blamed.

The modern mind is interested in personal theories and philosophies of life. These last a few decennia or for the most a few hundred years. The Tradition is universal and everlasting. Its material has been the agelong guide of humanity in the solution of its problems and the attainment of happiness. It is not the private possession of anyone, but belongs to all. From the point of view of traditional psychology the problems of modern man spring from the fact that he has ignored the ancient science of his forefathers, dealing with the path, at one end of which is psychical chaos, emptiness and

darkness, and at the other peace and the rapture of a mind that sees the unity of the highest and the most ordinary things in life, knows the grace connected with a pure consciousness, and has the fixity of purpose resulting from the realization of That which IS

The meaning of the Tradition is revealed ever again to the soul for its liberation from bondage due to ignorance of its true nature, and for salvation from its pains and sorrows. Modern life and science, if not psychically adjusted and made subservient to the Tradition, produce bondage and its painful problems.

A few hints always manage to penetrate to the consciousness of people, however rationalistically, sentimentally or materialistically coloured it is — for in their unconscious is a great store of ancient wisdom. Truths are continually conveyed in a symbolic form to their perception. But there are powers in the psyche that see to it that the hints are not understood. For understanding would destroy these factors — and they do not want annihilation. From self-protection they will ignore symbolic hints, or else suppress them with "common sense" or ridicule.

The modern outlook is specialist and partial. Traditional psychology aims at "healthiness", "wholesomeness", "baleness" and "holiness" — all etymologically related terms, implying harmony between all the psychological functions and balance between the introvert and extrovert tendencies.

When insight in traditional psychology is gained then the universal realization and proclamation of the traditional methods are seen to be of the greatest world importance. These methods of symbolism are clearly more practical (with reference to physical functions and life in the world), satisfying (applying to the emotional function), scientific (applying to the rational function), inspiring and wise (with reference to the spiritual and intuitive functions), and wholesome and profound (applying to the aim and quintessence of life) — than the modern ways of teaching in the form of ethics or moral science (which is philosophy and does not make anyone better), philosophy, dogmatic theology and rationalistic psychology.

3 METHOD AND FRAMEWORK OF THE BOOK

Method and framework.

The subjects dealt with in this book are so closely interwoven that it is not possible to separate them — which would also not be in accordance with the underlying principles of traditional psychology, which stress the interrelation of things.

In view of the nature of the subjects dealt with it is impossible to produce

all the evidence in one place. For some subjects it will appear little by little.

If the reader initially finds some of the subjects difficult to understand, he could well defer their study until their detailed amplification and connection with the other subjects makes them clear.

The right understanding of traditional truths requires an emotional and intellectual re-orientation, and a spiritual turning about, which cannot but evoke in some cases an inner resistance, for the mind is conservatively inclined, if that suits its purposes.

Each section of the book is to some extent an introduction to the next and likewise each Book to the following one.

The beginning of the first Book includes observations, statements and notes which introduce the subjects to follow. Before the meaning of traditions can unfold, the keys to the meaning must be given. The keys by themselves have only the potential value of promises. They obtain their true value only when they are used for the opening up of the symbolic meaning. Therefore the subject matter will only begin to live, penetrate and inspire to its full measure when the introductory generalizations give place to detailed exposition.

Form of expression. The work has been written in the vein of "thus it is", because it reflects the outlook and teachings of the psychological traditions of humanity, and not any personal theory.

The assertion that "it is thus" does not imply that the statements made or the symbols referred to express absolute truths. There is only *one* Absolute Truth, and that lies beyond the reach of words. The "thus it is" should be taken in the sense of "thus it is according to the fundamental traditions of man" and "thus it becomes understandable and realizable". The great traditions of old aimed at liberating men from their limitations and should never be taken to be, and made to degenerate into, systems for narrowing the mind to make it fit into a scheme from which there is no escape. For escape from limitations is the very aim of Tradition.

The subject is not particularly difficult. It may give a first impression that an unusual share of intelligence is needed for understanding the work. This is not at all the case. The material has as simple an expression as the subject permits and technical terms have

been avoided as much as possible. Furthermore the reader can take courage from the fact that if he studies a modern textbook, he must *acquire* and *learn* a large amount of what he reads, because it is new to him, but if he studies

traditional psychology, he need but *re-learn* or *remember*, what is actually in its basic form in his own possession —for traditional psychology is hidden within his own unconscious, as he will presently discover for himself. Traditional psychology is meant for everyone and only ordinary intelligence is required for profiting from its more fundamental teachings. Needed are intuition and common sense, which many people have who are not well read and have not received much instruction.

Supplement It will be necessary to refer regularly to the Diagrams and Diagrams. contained in a separate folder, the Supplement Diagrams 1, 1a, 1b, 2 and 3 are dealt with in Volume I, Diagrams 3, 4a, 4b, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9a, 9b, 9c and 10 in Volume II and Diagrams 11, 12, 13 and 14 in Volume III. Some of the Diagrams are referred to continually, sometimes even before they are dealt with and also after.

A note on how the work came to be written, recognitions and a list of literature are added. Ancient sources are mentioned in brackets in the text. Recognitions of recent sources have been avoided in the text, first of all to keep modern and personal associations out of the mind while reading, and secondly for simplicity's sake and not to break the train of thoughts by reference to foot-notes. The use (and misuse!) of foot-notes is a practice that started fairly recently. The quoting of references in foot-notes, moreover, is no guarantee for the strict scientific treatment of material.

The Supplement contains a note on etymology, transliteration, and the pronunciation of Sanskrit words. An Index is added at the end of Volume III.

THE BOOK OF SIGNS

“God said, Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days, and years ”
(Genesis 1; 14)

“What think ye? If this *Book* be from God and ye believe it not, who will have gone further astray than he who is in wide separation?
We will show them our signs upon the horizons and within themselves, until it become plain to them that it is the truth ”
(Korân, Sûra The Made Plain 52-53)

THE BOOK OF SIGNS

1. FUNDAMENTAL SYMBOLISM.

PEACE!

PEACE!

PEACE!

The language of symbolism. The language of symbolism is contained in the myths, religious teachings and rites, and other traditional possessions of the world, and applies to psychical processes and phases which every man individually, groups of people and humanity collectively are undergoing and passing through. The meaning of symbols as forming part of a language has been forgotten long ago and is unknown while this is written, even though implications of some symbols have been preserved. Knowledge of a few words, however, does not give understanding and command of a language. As words used in a particular context, that is, as a rule, in association with other words in a sentence, symbols obtain or reveal power and meaning only in a particular context or situation, in combination with and relation to other symbols.

Words themselves were originally symbols and many are so even now. Others have become more like labels. A study of words, with reference to their etymology and psychological etymology, in connection with the sacred traditions of old, amply repays the trouble by opening up great vistas. The words of modern languages have become shallow, narrow and exact. These languages have become rich only in numbers of words. But *plurality is not true wealth. It may appear to be the same whether one possesses a banknote of a thousand dollars or a thousand notes of one dollar.* A thousand „chips” are useful for small purposes, but the big note can be used for a big purpose. Narrowness and exactness of meaning are actually smallness. Modern words are suited for rationalistic and materialistic purposes of specialization. Ancient words are like broad and deep hints with a world of meaning, applying to high things. We shall see later that there is a symbolic meaning in the dimensions.

Mirror-symbolism.

When dealing with symbols, one must remember that a thing cannot be described and clarified in terms of itself, but only with reference to something else in the

universe The substance and form of a symbol may very well be derived from something which is the opposite of that which the symbol means or intends to convey

The field from which the substance and the form of symbols are taken is nature There is no other field from which to derive them Nature takes the two aspects of "human nature" and the nature of the surroundings of man Man's "animal nature" is symbolic of a particular aspect of human nature, derived from the nature of animals in man's surroundings

Substance and form of symbols belong to external nature The meaning applies to the internal nature Nature is the mirror of consciousness and the pictures in the mirror reflect the dynamism of consciousness

The ancestors of the human race looked in "the mirror of Venus", and beheld in it the waters, the wind, heaven and earth, mountains and meadows, trees and animals, and a whole world of animate and inanimate objects They watched the functions of eating, breathing, walking, procreation and other actions, and wondered at sleep and death They experienced the struggle for existence and studied life and death around themselves The pictures they saw became the symbols for the inner experiences they had to pass through — experiences which could be expressed on the physical plane in such a manner that others could understand them, in no other way than by means of imagery derived from that plane

In the course of time the meaning of symbols has become more or less separated from their form Symbolic forms have come down to us in the scriptures, monuments, rituals and other traditional things which we possess Their meanings have survived within the psychic of every human being and make up the essential material of his inner life, but they have more or less vanished from the conscious into the unconscious realm From the point of view of consciousness (in the sense of modern psychology — corresponding to "the waking consciousness" of the traditional teachings) the meanings are largely "lost" or "hidden" ("occult")

"The mirror of Venus" is not a symbol of a woman's vanity, as some interpreters would actually make us believe And yet, in the conception of 'vanity' in looking into the mirror lies a profound significance, overlooked by those who hold the view that the Gods are mere caricatures of humans and "have all their vices and more" "Vanity" really means emptiness, that which is vain, useless, empty The deeper meaning is recalled in "vanity of vanities, all is vanity" (Eccles 1, 2) What is "vain", from the angle of vision of the spiritual man, is the delusions and embroilments of the mund-world Life is really empty and unsatisfactory without the breath of the Spirit

The Moon is the mirror that reflects the light of the Sun. In the highest connection the Sun symbolizes Being and Reality and God, and the Moon Consciousness and its creative power.

Because Light is reflected on matter belonging to ever less subtle and more material planes — the realms of the various psychical functions — there may be mention of several mirrors. The mirror of Venus then represents the emotional plane. The Moon-mirror symbolizes the sphere of Consciousness. The mirror of Mother Earth is material nature.

The creative power of consciousness on its own plane is generally symbolized in the form of a Goddess and particularly as Moon-Goddess.

People who use the expression "the reflective faculty of the mind" generally do not realize that it is connected with mirror symbolism.

The creative power of Consciousness is called in Hindu tradition Śakti or "Power", conceived in some contexts as a Goddess. In the Kāmakalāvīlāsa Tantra (V; 4) Śakti is described as "the Pure Mirror in which Śiva reflects Himself". Śiva here represents Reality and Being, the static aspect of God, and corresponds to "the Father" of Christian tradition. Śakti, his Consort, represents the dynamic aspect of God in the Manifested Universe (of which the material universe is only the condition of the greatest density). She is the Great Mother, the Creatrix.

For intimately connected moral and spiritual reasons the mirror of the mind must be purified. And concerning advanced stages of meditation the teachers of sacred tradition in the East warn against mental pictures which form an obstruction to pure mystical contemplation, integration of personality, and Self-realization. According to Taoism, when the action of the mind comes to rest, when the attention is fixed and the mind empty of forms (realizing "all is vanity"), it is then the Pure Mirror in which is reflected the ineffable and unnamable Essence of Tao itself. A mirror is found in every Japanese Shinto shrine. According to the tradition, it should be compared with the human heart. If the heart is perfectly pure, the Divine is reflected in it. In every tradition and clime the path of the spiritual aspirant involves the systematic purification "of the heart", which means of the feelings, thoughts and aspirations. In Hindu tradition the process of discipline is called Chittaśuddhi, "mind-purification". Yoga, the various Mārgas or Paths to God-realization, the rituals of all religions, the moral rules of all the world, have no other object but purification, which is intimately connected with renunciation, sacrifice, good works, service of God, and a noble, fruitful and enjoyable life in the world. Richard of St. Victor said: "Let him that thirst to see God cleanse his mirror".

Symbols are nothing but pictures in various mirrors. They are psycholog-

ical signposts and spiritual guides — the only possible ones — on the path to harmony and happiness. It cannot be claimed for any of them that they are absolute in themselves, as is done for theological dogmas, philosophical maxims and laws of science. Yet there is an element of universality about them that comes very near to absoluteness.

Signposts are usually ugly features on the roadside of nature. But symbols, the signposts of the sacred traditions of old, that serve to guide one on the right path and help one to reach the goal, are not ugly, for they consist of the animate and inanimate things of nature itself.

Light and darkness.

Symbols should not be defined in a generalizing manner.

The danger hereof becomes clear with reference to the symbolism of light and darkness. Light is generally a symbol of spiritual insight and realization, and Darkness of ignorance, sin, and a state of disharmony within the psyche and in life. In some contexts the Sun as Lord of Light is a symbol of God, and the Moon, the Ruler of the Night, is a symbol of the World of Creation, or else of "the world", the world of worldliness and sensuality. But in another context the relation of Light and Darkness is the reverse. Darkness is then a symbol of the Unmanifest, Supreme, Impersonal Deity, and Light of the Manifest, the Universe, the Personal Deity. Darkness is further sometimes symbolic of the "Virgin" state of the soul which gives birth to "the Light". In some connections "day" is a synonym for the world and its hustle and bustle, and "night" is associated with silence, prayer and meditation. Hence the verse in the Bhagavad-Gîtâ (II; 69):

"The waking of the beings
Is Night for the silent Seer,
But the night of the beings
Is Waking for the Self-restrained."

Night and day here, of course, need not actually indicate the time-periods of night and day, but rather symbolize moods or states of consciousness. In this connection see also Diagram 1b. Furthermore light and darkness often symbolize the conscious and the unconscious.

Fundamental symbolism.

The most fundamental symbolism is that of the Four Elements of Manifestation, which correspond to the four lowest of the Seven Spheres. These Four Elements are conceived as based on, or springing from, a fifth, the "Quintessence" or "fifth Element", the Ether, which corresponds to the Sphere of Light. Be-

yond these are the Spheres of the Moon and the Sun. The Element Earth symbolizes the physical body and the material world, the Element Water the plane of feeling, the Element Fire the lower mind, the Element Air the sphere of the spiritual functions, including the intuition, the Element Ether the sphere of the essential function, that is faith and insight — faith being unconscious insight, and "insight" conscious faith. The Moon-Sphere is the domain of Consciousness and its creative power. The Sun, in its highest symbolic aspect, represents the Inexpressible, which, through the glasses of the lower Spheres, is denoted by the names of God, Reality, Being, the Unmanifest, the Self, and by symbols.

Hermes Trismegistus called the fifth Element also Cosmos: "That, then, from which the whole Cosmos is formed, consisteth of Four Elements—Fire, Water, Earth, and Air; Cosmos (itself is) one, (its) Soul (is) one, and God is one." (The Perfect Sermon, III; 1.)

The fundamental symbolism is mentioned in Diagram 1. The groups of symbols that are contained in it, are dealt with systematically in suitable order and connections.

The traditions of the Four Elements and Seven Spheres are universal. They are conceived as ruled by emanations, aspects and powers of GOD, who are variously termed Gods or Angels or given some other title. People who are prejudiced, because they do not see the deeper meaning of teachings, often object to the term "Gods". It is clear that the exact term is not important. It is the meaning that counts.

These Elements play an unequal part in the life of people. While in the perfect man they are in balance and harmony, in the life of the imperfect, one or more predominate. A man for whom the Element Earth predominates unduly is a materialist. For him a symbol is only a form which should be taken at its face value. He looks for its utilitarian value, for instance as an ornament. He worships matter for its substance and form, and its usefulness. His Gods are the Machine, Mammon and Comfort, and his "worship" is idol-worship. He believes in the letter of the Law.

One in whose life the Element Water predominates will have an emotional attitude to symbols, and one in whom the Element Fire predominates will be inclined to take them for mental images with a figurative or allegoric value. Science has dealt with Gods as personifications of natural phenomena.

A man in whose life the Element Air predominates will experience the inspiring influence of symbols and will note that often they move him to the depth of his being, stirring "the very elements" of his soul. He may experience symbols as containing more life and meaning than the everyday occurrences of life. He will come to realize that symbols represent the very

forces which move the world — and his world — “up” or “down” His intuition will convey to him their meaning

When his *Buddhi*, the spiritual-discriminative function, becomes “pure” and the Elements within his being are harmonized, he will have the Four Winds, representing the Four Elements in a spiritualized form, in his bag and at his command, to blow him whithersoever his spirit desires to fly And if he chooses to direct the four currents inwards, back to the Cave whence they sprang, he will come to know the Quintessence, in which symbols dissolve like salt dolls immersed in the ocean

Since all traditions are intimately interrelated, some will be explained first from one point of view and in one context, and later in others As the great scheme of Tradition unfolds, the more profound things dealt with later on will be found easier to understand than the simpler things taken as an introduction For insight comes when the interrelationship of things is seen

Animal Symbolism. Man has always felt that he has a double nature He has sensed that in his deepest being he is divine, and that his “lower nature” is “animal” Therefore animal symbolism is connected with the lower mind A man has always been apt to call his brother a pig, a monkey, an ass or a viper, in the need of his soul to relieve himself of his own unworthiness He tries to do this by projecting it upon others

Each animal represents a particular sensual or mental tendency or appetite — for good or for ill The domestic and the wild animals therefore serve their own purposes in symbolism, and appear in sacred traditions and fairy-tales in favourable aspects, as friends, or in unfavourable aspects, as enemies It is a most unfavourable sign if a domestic animal becomes wild and dangerous, and it is symbolic of the highest spiritual achievement if wild animals become tame, and if a man can live in friendship with the beasts of the wilderness

The symbolic animals are shadows of man, because they live and move in his shadow The entire psychical story of man, as applying to the world of manifestation, can be told — and has been told in all traditions — in terms of animals And human nature is ever fond of recreating the animal with human traits, representing the human with animal traits

The Zodiac While the “higher” or spiritual levels of psychology are represented by Gods or Angels, the “lower” or worldly levels are represented by animals In the traditions of the Zodiac

the two are combined. The divisions of the Zodiac are in the main represented by symbolic animals, for which reason it is called "the Animal Belt". This Zodiacal scheme is divided in twelve Signs, that is, symbols. Eight of these symbols are animals. Of the twelve Signs of the Zodiac three are Earth-Signs, three Water-Signs, three Fire-Signs and three Air-Signs. (See Diagram 1a). It is significant that the Air-Signs, the spiritual symbols, show a human form, while the Earth, Water and Fire-Signs are represented by animal forms. (The Earth-Sign of Virgo is the only exception to this rule, surely because it is ruled by Mercury, the God of the Element Air, the spiritual sphere).

Besides the animals which are found in the Signs of the Zodiac, all other animals that are encountered in traditional contexts, have their place in one or more Signs of that Animal Belt. The same applies to the Gods and Angels of the various religions. These are the emanations, powers, aspects, attributes, names, servants and forms of GOD, in accordance with the characteristics of the Seven Spheres, and are conceived as the Rulers of the Signs and of the animals of the Signs.

The Zodiac is the starry path through the heavens which is, as it appears, taken by the sun, the moon and the planets on their wanderings. These are the exterior representatives of part-aspects of the human soul, in the material world, from which the material for symbolism is largely taken. The Zodiac is the animal picture-book of the Spiritual Path, on which all the episodes of spiritual life take place and the Battle of Life is fought. The word "Zodiac" is derived from the Greek "Zôdiakos", which is commonly said to be derived from the Greek "Zôdion", the diminutive of "Zôon", meaning animal. The Greek word "Zôdiakos" is also said to come from an ancient Oriental root "Sôdi", meaning a way. The Sanskrit word "sôdaya" is connected with the rise of the heavenly bodies and also implies succession in time and on a path.

Animal vehicles. In the Vedas the Gods were called Diva-narâh, "heavenly men", or simply Narâh, men, and they were described as Nripesah, which means the same as anthropomorphic.

In Hinduism every God is represented as having a vehicle, which is either an animal or a car drawn by one or more animals. The word for vehicle is "Vâhana", etymologically related to it. The root of these words means to carry. The Animal-vehicle "carries" the God in the manifested world, symbolically represented by, because externalized to the ultimate extent in, the starry heavens, through which leads the spiritual path through the Signs of the Zodiac. The entire Universe is the Vehicle of GOD. As we shall

forces which move the world — and his world — “up” or “down” His intuition will convey to him their meaning

When his Buddhi, the spiritual discriminative function, becomes “pure” and the Elements within his being are harmonized, he will have the Four Winds, representing the Four Elements in a spiritualized form, in his bag and at his command, to blow him whithersoever his spirit desires to fly And if he chooses to direct the four currents inwards, back to the Cave whence they sprang, he will come to know the Quintessence, in which symbols dissolve like salt dolls immersed in the ocean

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	himself of his own unworthiness He tries to do this by
	others

see later, this is taught especially by the symbolism of the Wain, which is conceived as carrying the Pole Star, symbol of the Immovable Centre of the ALL — GOD The Wain is in several traditions of the World especially associated with Jupiter, the God of the function of faith and insight In Hindu tradition the seven stars of the Wain (the Great Bear) are called the Seven Rishis, aspects of Guru or Jupiter, and in central Europe they were called Irmin's Wain, Irmin being the same as Jupiter or Guru

Among Hindu Gods Śiva has his Bull to ride on, the Goddess Durgā her Lion, Vishnu his Eagle, and Nirriti his Man Ezekiel had his well-known vision of the four Living Creatures, which had the heads of a Bull, a Lion, an Eagle and a Man It will be seen later that these represent the same spiritual stages on the Path through "the heavens", that is the Zodiac The symbols of Lamb, fishes and Lion, that occur in the Christian tradition, represent the Zodiacal Signs of Aries, Pisces and Leo

Composite beings. The Śakti or "Power" of a God represents the God in his creative aspect, and is generally conceived mythologically as the God's Consort In some cases the Animal of a God is partially identified with his Śakti Sometimes even the higher and the lower man grow into one in particular psychological contexts, and then we encounter beings that are partially Animal and partially God or man There are some that have an animal body and a human head Such forms have grown and come into being on account of specific developments in the human psyche, and represent psychological realities Such beings have not been concocted by the reasoning mind of priests, as has often been assumed But there is no doubt that the symbolizing faculty in the psyche works in close co-operation with the reasoning faculty

Well-known examples of composite symbolic creatures are the Sphinx, the lion with the head of a woman, who represents Leo, or Aquarius, in case she is winged, further the Mermaid, the woman with the tail of a fish, which as a rule represents Scorpio, and the Centaur, the horse with the torso and head of a man, representing Sagittarius All traditions know such beings, and some are found in several traditions or have their parallels in other traditions They all have a world of meaning to convey

Sometimes Gods appear in shapes not consisting of animal bodies with human heads, but with human bodies with animal heads Such forms represent very profound aspects of Divinity In them the "lower nature", symbolized by the body, is represented as human, that is to say, as "an image of God", and the higher nature, the head, is represented by an animal symbol symbolizing some particular moral or intellectual power or attribute

Commonly known Deities of this type are the Jackal or Dog headed Egyptian God Anubis, later identified with Hermes-Thoth as Hermanubis, and in living Hindu tradition the Elephant-headed God Ganapati and the Monkey-headed Hanumân. What divine aspects these Gods represent will be made clear later.

Apart from these, there is, however, also a class of animal headed forms which represent degraded human faculties. These occur in old pictures of Hell, both of Eastern and Western traditions, and in the Egyptian and Tibetan Books of the Dead. They can also be recognized to be the particular psychical realities they symbolize. Psychologists know them from people's dreams.

Rational thought, which has been dealing with sacred scriptures and traditions, after their symbolical meaning had been forgotten, has dealt with little more than their surface. Hence it has been so sterile in its bearing on the "deeper" and "higher" processes of life, and so helpless in its efforts to influence those for the better. It can grasp only one thing at the time in its pure form-aspect, that is, in its "Titanic" aspect. It "grasps" that thing and pins it down, hurting and crucifying it in immovable impotency, as a collector pins a butterfly in a glass prison. It is no wonder that this function has traditionally been associated more than any other function with "the Fall", as will be shown later.

The power of symbols In spite of the power of rational thought and common sense, symbols have very often a strange, mysterious and overpowering appeal even on the most matter of fact minds. This is the case because they work in and from the unconscious, and often manifest themselves with greater power or activity, where they are not understood by the conscious mind. They bear witness to the psychical process towards the re-establishment of equilibrium between the psychical functions and between introvert and extrovert tendencies. Symbols of the type implied, which are understood in what is, from the traditional point of view, a rather simplistic manner, are the political, national and international symbols of recent times — nearly all derived from the sacred traditions of old. The people of the present age are, in spite of their enlightened minds — enlightened by the Fire stolen from Heaven — blind instruments in the hands of inner psychical powers. They live, but are hardly aware of that fact, for what they consider their life, is only a state of symbolic death from the point of view of the old Tradition (see Genesis 2, 17). People know much, and know the distinction between good and evil, but they do not know anything about themselves. Their knowledge concerns only

(what tradition has called) 'Titanic power. But even that they do not properly know. And hence they are contributing constantly to their own ruin.

In a way everything in life is the outcome or the reflection of "something within". Dreams, whether for good or for evil, have changed the face of the earth more thoroughly than anything else. Many things have erupted out of the "subterranean fires" of the unconscious, with which reason and feeling cannot cope. Where the spiritual function does not inspire and give the lead, symbols, if not understood or if misunderstood, if played with or abused, may work dangerous reactions in human society. The deliberate use of symbols for secular and political, that is, for personal, egoistic, purposes, is a misuse which is bound to entail serious consequences. Religious symbols either form part of a living tradition, or spring spontaneously from the psyche — the unconscious, in the terminology of modern psychology. They should not be "instituted" for profane ends, that is to say, all ends which are not of universal ethical and spiritual nature. They are not just rational pictures, but represent living psychical forces from all levels of the psyche. Misuse of the forms of such powers is "playing with fire" and "tempting the Lord". Stealing Fire from Heaven — which the people of this Age have been increasingly engaged in — can only result in the psychical condition traditionally called "Hellfire".

The Svastika. An example of a symbol which has been misunderstood and grievously misused in recent times for personal purposes, is found in the Svastika. This is a symbol of the Great Wheel, representing the cycle of time of the Tradition. Therefore it is a symbol of creative activity — auspicious if moving along the way of the Tradition. The Great Wheel is the Zodiac.

The North-European, thick-branched, Svastika, was associated with creative activity, and consisted of crossed representations of the Fire-Hammer of Thor. Its form became known as the *fyfot cross*. The Greek Svastika was called Gammadion, and consisted of four capital gammas. The letter gamma has the numerical value of three. Four times three make the twelve Signs of the Zodiac. Related to the Svastika is the Hermetic figure with the right hand to Heaven and the left to Earth, a posture also of many forms of Hindu deities. This symbolism holds a world of meaning, illustrated in the maxim "as Above, so Below", and representing the union, in being and action, in the Divine Person, of Heaven and Earth. This union is accomplished only through the Tradition. The Hindu Svastika is a symbol of auspicious creative action along the lines of Veda — the Tradition. The word is Sanskrit. "Su" may imply good, auspicious, sacrifice, and begetting.

The Tradition is good and auspicious, requires sacrifice and begets the perfect Man. "Astika" may imply being and abode.

This great symbol, which, of course, never had anything to do with anti-Semitism, was placed in Germany solidly in black on a red field. Black is in Manifestation a colour symbolizing Earth, darkness, death and negation. Red represents Fire. The symbol was, moreover, wrongly placed like an X. In that form it became more or less identical with what various traditions have called "the Wheel of Samsâra" (meaning erring in bondage), "the Rack", "the Wheel of Ixion", and "the Cross of the Passion":

Wheel- The Svastika is only one of numerous forms of the
symbolism. Great Wheel, popularly called "the Sun-wheel". It is the aim of the Tradition to replace the Wheel of Bondage by the Wheel of the Tradition. The Wheel of Samsâra should "turn into" the Wheel of the Law, the Buddhist form of the Tradition, the Dhamma, the very symbol of which it is. The human soul is bound and crucified and turned round and round on the Wheel of Bondage. But when the soul attains true Manhood, it becomes itself the Chakravartin or "Turner of the Wheel", and one with its immovable Centre. The first Wheel is that of the Fall, the second of the Redemption. The Wheel will be dealt with in many contexts and in many traditional forms.

The Great Wheel is not only a Sun-wheel but also a wheel of the Moon and the five Planets, connected with the Five Elements. Thus the Great Wheel has seven aspects or forms. These are reflected in "the body" of man in the Chakras or wheels of the Yogic tradition.

On the Great Wheel everything moves and changes and passes on. There is no rest and no refuge, except in its centre, representing the Ever-Present-Changeless-Motionless Being of God. To the pilgrim that may seem terribly remote and hard to reach, but, as the Arabic mystic says, "even to the camel comes a dawn without a burden for its wounded back."

The attributes In traditional contexts the symbols or attributes con-
of Gods. nected with or held by a God or Angel are amplifications of the God himself. It is easy to understand how this led to the very common cases in which the symbols of a God represent other Gods, subsidiary to him in that particular aspect and context. The most common example is Jupiter and his Thunderbolt. Jupiter is the God of the Sphere of Light and Enlightenment, the Ether, and his Thunderbolt represents the Element Fire. More about that later. Sometimes the Six Great Gods are all recapitulated as symbols of the Seventh God. On other

occasions a God has five attributes representing the functions connected with the Five Elements or their ruling Intelligences. An example of this may be given

The five symbols of Vishnu — The five symbols that are commonly held by Vishnu represent the powers of the five Planetary Gods, called in Hindu Astrology the Five Tara Grahas. The symbols are the Kaustubha-mani, the Gadâ, the Chakra, the Śankha and the Padma. The Kaustubha is a gem of great lustre and represents Venus, the Ruler of the emotional life. The Gada is a heavy club or mace, and represents the power of Saturn, the Ruler of the Element Earth. It is called Kaumodaki, meaning 'bliss-giver to the earth', and is a symbol of Enlightenment and Earth-rulership. Saturn gives enduring enlightenment after first causing trouble and sorrow, in astrological tradition. In Hindu Astrology Sani, that is, Saturn, is represented and often worshipped in the form of an iron sword. This corresponds to the scythe of Saturn, with which, as Lord of Time and Death, he cuts off the cycle of Manifestation, and also the state of not-knowing God and Reality — thereby giving Enlightenment. As "Holder of the Gadâ", Vishnu is often called Gadadhara. He holds the Gada in one, and the three symbols to follow in his three other hands.

The Chakra is the Fiery Wheel of Manifestation, with two crossed triangles. It will be dealt with at length later on. It here represents Mars, the Lord of Manifestation, the God of the Element Fire and the lower mind. It is the Sudarśana, the Fiery Weapon of Vishnu, which, in the myths dealing with his Incarnations, he uses for the purpose of "protecting the good and punishing the wicked". He protects the good by means of the Wheel of the Tradition, and punishes the wicked on the Fiery Rack of Suffering (which from the mental point of view is a fiery hell and, from the emotional, "a lake of fire and brimstone").

The Śankha is the Conch shell. The word "conch" is derived from a Latin word, and related to "Śankha". The conch shell was also a symbol of the Greek and Roman mythology. It represents Budha, the Mercury of Hindu Astrology, the God of the functions connected with the Element Air, because it reflects sound, symbolically expressive of Air or Spirit.

The Padma is the Lotus and represents Guru, that is, Jupiter, the Ruler of the Element Ether. In Indian tradition it is customary to speak of "the lotus feet of the Guru". Sometimes Mount Meru, the Mountain of the Gods, is symbolically equated to the Lotus. All the symbols of Vishnu will be dealt with in more detail and in connection with their parallels in other religions.

The five symbols represent the five Planets or Gods of the Five Elements. Vishnu himself represents the Sun and Lakshmi, his Consort, the Moon, and thereby the group of seven is complete. In Incarnation Vishnu represents Love, and in that connection he himself represents Venus, the Power of Love, while the Kaustubha-mani symbolizes the Sun. The Sun is the Power of the higher Love, the Charis or Grace of God.

The nature of the Gods. People have believed that the Gods were, originally natural powers or phenomena of nature, endowed by primitive men with an anthropomorphic nature and a human personality. The truth is the reverse, as will be shown below. The Gods can be experienced in various ways, because they are the ruling principles and functions in the psyche. They are psychological realities, each representing a particular aspect of Reality. Their existence can be felt and understood, and their presence inspire and be seen with the eye of insight, for they do not live in some remote heaven, but within every human being, as traditional psychology teaches.

If one may speak of "degrees of reality", it would be justifiable to say that the Gods are more real than man himself. Man clings to form and to the world of form around him, but ever loses it, because his world is ever changing. How then can this world of form be real? It is the reality of a house, that can be enlarged and beautified, but also burned and plundered. The Gods stand above this change, and in the course of thousands of years their symbols have remained the same. They are the dwellers in the house. In accordance with psychological contexts they are shape-changers. But in reality they are immortal, for they form the very essence and essential principles of the life of man. By realizing their presence people become immortal, because the Gods or Angels are aspects of Immortality and lead them to the Reality of God. This has been the experience of worshippers, prophets and seers in all ages and belonging to all religions. They have "talked with Angels" and "seen God face to face", they have "heard the voice of God", and "tasted of his sweetness". These expressions do not denote psychic phenomena, but spiritual experiences. They are dressed in symbols with a precision no less exacting for their refusal to be confined within the specialism of an "exact science".

Even if the Gods cannot be experienced as realities, they can still be admitted by the intellect and in that sense can figure as principles of an intelligently ordered plan — in modern terms, a working hypothesis.

For the tradition, which gave the Gods their forms and symbols, is the very creation of consciousness and the supreme among the sciences.

In a purely rational study particular things can be singled out for systematic treatment, but this method is not quite adequate for the study of symbols, for these are largely chosen in the unconscious. Sometimes they appear in the conscious mind like unexpected and uninvited guests — as every psychiatrist knows — and occasionally they come with a flash and a bang, and no one can say what they will do to him or how they will leave him — or, for that matter, the world. Once they have thus appeared, the rational mind should deal with them to the best of its ability, but ever suffering them to convey their transcendent message, and never seeking to impose itself upon them at their expense.

The symbolism of time. Time is symbolic in several ways. First of all the divisions of time — years, months, days, hours, minutes and seconds — are symbolically indicative of the Seven Spheres in particular cases. This will become clear when we deal with the myths concerned (See Diagram 1)

Secondly the stages in the great time-scheme of the Zodiac are symbolically connected with the stages of the Fall of Man and the Spiritual Path. This is the case with the divisions of the year, the day, the week, and the Great Year (See all the Diagrams except 1 and 4b)

Time-indication in symbols. Many symbols are connected with special divisions of time. Generally the symbols with which a God or Angel appears, give a clue to the particular division of time on the Spiritual Path represented by him.

To take for example two aspects of Vishnu, the beginning-stage of the Zodiac, centred in Aquarius, is traditionally the stage of the Womb (see Diagrams 1b and 7). Vishnu in the aspect of Nârâyana is that under which he was first worshipped. Nara is parallel to Adam, and Nârâyana means something like "the son of man". Nârâyana further means the "ayana" that is, abode, or place of motion, of "nara", the waters. This form of Vishnu is generally represented in its first form, as a baby-boy, lying on a leaf of the sacred banyan tree, floating on the waters. The banyan is symbolically connected with the Element Air, as will be shown later. The aspect of Nârâyana represents the stage of the Air-Sign of Aquarius, the hieroglyphic symbol of which is , representing "the Waters". The Biblical parallel to the (symbolic) Womb-aspect of Vishnu, in the form of Nârâyana, is, as we shall see later, "And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters" (Genesis 1, 2).

Another aspect of Vishnu — Padmanabha — applies to the same stage of

Aquarius, but with reference to other matters. Padmanâbha means "the Lotus navel One". In this form Vishnu lies at full length on the coiled-up World-Serpent Âdiśesha, "the Primary Serpent", also called Ananta, "the Endless". Aquarius is the centre of the stage of rest in the Zodiac, called Pralaya in Hindu tradition. The Divine has withdrawn from activity in the world and is immersed in its own state of realization and bliss. This is again the Womb state. Âdiśesha is generally represented as floating on the waters. But in the Womb of Time the coming cycle is prepared and foreshadowed. From the navel of the Resting Lord a lotus is seen to come forth. It is the Lotus of the Guru, Jupiter. In it the world to be born is present in its germ state. From the Lotus issues a tiny form of Brahmâ, the Creator. The Navel represents the Centre of the All from the point of view of Creation. The child-form of the Creator is the embryo of the world to be born. — It will later be clear that this symbolism has no reference to the creation of the material universe, but to the genesis of man, in the symbolical sense.

Some of the most important Gods of various traditions have twelve aspects, representing them in forms applying to the stages of the Spiritual Path, marked by the Signs of the Zodiac.

Astrology. Astrology, in both its Western and Eastern forms, has preserved many of the elements and symbols of traditional psychology, in a rather dogmatic form, because insight into the meaning of the older traditions has been lost. Modern astrology embodies on the whole little more than a method of making predictions regarding the profane life of people, though sometimes, especially in Hinduism, it serves an aid to psychology or religion. The original Astrology is a grand science, which is inseparable from traditional psychology. It will be shown that all religions are based upon it. In "The Key to the First Chapter of Genesis" and "Evolution, Paradise, and the Fall" it has been explained that it forms the fundamental tradition of the Bible. This will also be shown in the present book, and numerous teachings in both the Old and the New Testaments, which are based upon Genesis, will be dealt with, side by side with parallel teachings in other religions.

For the understanding of the true Astrology, constituting the symbolic time-scheme of traditional psychology, aspects of which are dealt with in this book, a technical knowledge of modern astrology and the casting of a horoscope is not required. Horoscopes are not referred to at all. Some of the basic symbols of astrology — though not those which necessitate reference to astrological books — are used. The terms "Signs" and "Houses" are used practically as synonyms, keeping in view that "Signs" are symbols

and "Houses" psychological stages or abodes on the Path. The technical distinction made by astrology between "Signs" and "Houses" is not adhered to. The difference implied in this astrological distinction is explained where it is necessary. The Great Year is called "a Round" or its meaning is explained.

The main traditions which astrology has preserved are those of the three times four Elements of the Signs of the Zodiac and the Rulers of the Signs (see Diagram 1a).

Heaven and Hell "The heavens above" are symbolically connected with "the heavens within". The sky above our head, with its sun, moon, planets and stars, symbolically represents the dynamic World of the Manifested Godhead, with its Seven Spheres. The Zodiac is the Path through the starry heavens, which are conceived as the Vehicle, Chariot or Throne of the Static, Immovable, Eternal and Unchanging God-Reality. Further it is the Great Wheel of Creation and Dissolution, and of the Fall and the Genesis of Man, which ever turns around the Fixed Centre of God-Reality, the symbol of which is the pole star.

In the Fall these grand truths are gradually hidden. Both God-Reality and the Tradition which forms the guide to it, become concealed. When ultimately they are fully eclipsed and hidden by the influence of psychical darkness, the heavens are by then turned into so many hells. The original meaning is still present in the Dutch word "helen", meaning to "conceal stolen goods". Etymologically the word "hell" means conceal. Hell is not a remote abode that is attained in a here-after, but symbolizes a state of mind psychologically very real because experienced in the very here and now of life.

What is "the Fall" and how was it caused? The next section will introduce the underlying traditional conceptions.

2 THE SYMBOLISM OF DESIRE AND THE FALL OF MAN

The two Paths In order to find the Path to the peace and happiness of God-Reality it is necessary to understand the Path which originally led away from that God-Reality to the state of psychical disintegration, darkness, and emptiness of culture, which forms the condition of "hell", experienced by so many people. In order to know the whither one must know the whence, for, as the old traditions proclaim, we return whence

we came, for the origin and the goal are one: the state of non-distinction from God-Reality. In order to know the "light", we must also know the "darkness".

"The Fall" is, primarily, a change in consciousness, or, in traditional terms, the "veiling" and "hiding" of Consciousness. The third Chapter of Genesis deals with this aspect of the Fall (see "Evolution, Paradise and the Fall"). Other teachings on this subject will be dealt with in this book.

In well-preserved myths and frequently in fairy-tales the subject-matter refers to the adventures in consciousness on the two Paths of the Fall and the Return. The symbolical adventures are related to the stages marked on "the clock of the Zodiac", and are connected with its Twelve Signs and Gates of Initiation (into other states of consciousness). It will be shown later that this symbolism is intimately connected with that of Evolution and Manifestation, which follows the same scheme.

Traditionally the Two Paths begin in the stage of Capricorn, in which "the choice at the Cross-roads" must be made. The Path of the Fall is called "the left-hand Path" and "the Path of Darkness". For this reason the English word "sinister" obtained its meaning of malignant, evil, gloomy, of evil omen. The Latin "sinistrum" means left, and the word "sinister" is used in heraldry in the same sense. This Path is further called "the Path of the Ancestors". The Path of the Return is called "the right-hand Path", because it is the right Path, and also the Path of Redemption, the Spiritual Path, the Path of the Gods, and the Path of Light. These terms will be dealt with in the proper connections.

In some traditions the Two Paths are conceived as going "right" and "left" and in others as leading forward and backward. The first separate at "the Cross-roads" and the second at the Gate, which is, according to the context, the Gate of Hell or the Gate of Heaven. We shall see that this Gate is connected with the winter equinox.

The meaning of sin. What is the real meaning of "sin"? Modern conceptions of sin have wandered far from the original. The fundamental Christian conception, based on Genesis 39; 9 and Psalm 51; 4, is the correct one. It is that every sin is primarily against God: *Omne peccatum in Deum committitur*. Every transgression of the Tradition is rebellion against God. It shows that the soul has separated itself from God, and begun to strive for something apart from God, for itself as apart from God. For this reason the word "sin" has been associated by psychological etymology with "to sunder", meaning to separate. Sin is really separation from God or Reality, implying loss of wholeness, haleness

and holiness To be "whole" is to be united in God-Reality and to be entirely non-separate in Being

The Primal Offence is the existence of a separate "I", which has begun to operate in its own way, against the interests of the Self, or, in religious terms, against the Will of God That "I" becomes reduced to an extremely small focus in world-externals — an imagined "reality" — and thereby forgets its identity with the reality of the Divine Self It thus becomes an "ego" or an "it" and assumes a certain independence which is really illusory Thus is "disobedience", this is "sin"

The fundamental conceptions of sin have been formulated in a simple and beautiful form in the "*Theologia Germanica*", a mystical work which was written about 1300 A D There we read "The Word, the Faith and the Truth affirm that sin is nought else but the turning away of the creature from the unchangeable Good to the changeable from that which is Perfect to that which is in part, and most often to itself" "All disobedience is contrary to God, and nothing else In truth, no Thing is contrary to God nor anything we can name is displeasing to Him, but only disobedience" "He who is in disobedience is in sin, and sin can never be atoned for or healed but by returning to God, and this is brought to pass by humble obedience"

"Obedience" means obedience of the Tradition, which is, as we shall see later, the Voice of God

The writer of the *Theologia Germanica* affirms that when there is perfect obedience, the highest goal of the mystic is attained "It is possible to every man to approach so near thereunto as to be rightly called God-like, and a partaker of the divine nature" The supreme truth is "Ye should learn that eternal blessedness lieth in one thing only, and in nought else Moreover, it needeth not to enter into the soul, for it is there already, only it is unperceived"

The ego-factor. Disobedience is due to the activity of the separate I "Nothing is forbidden and nothing is contrary to God but one thing only that is, self will, or to will otherwise than as the Eternal Will would have it" The work also stresses the psychological nature of "Hell" "Nothing burneth in hell but self-will Put off thine own will, and there will be no hell"

"The Will of God" is expressed by "the Voice of God" and symbolizes the Spirit of the Tradition, — and not its letter, nor an organization representing the letter Only obedience to the Spirit of the Tradition is a *true* obedience

The "I" that is an "it" and causes all the trouble in the psyche and the world of social relations, grows into egoism, egotism, selfishness and other related manifestations. In this work that "I-factor" is called by its Hindu name, Ahankâra, because that term is both deeper and more embracing than the available English terms, each of which denotes only a particular aspect of it. Ahankâra means literally "I-factor". It modifies its meaning according to the context. It has not always an "evil" connotation, for its origin is in the spiritual, and not in the moral sphere. The subject will receive further explanation later on.

Desire. The motive in life connected with the cause and the precipitation of the Fall is desire. This and certain other words will be written with a capital letter, in the case of symbolical use or of a meaning more fundamental than the usual. In Eastern thought, will is considered to be a manifestation of desire.

The traditions teach the relation between Ahankâra and Desire under (symbolic) form of myths. They do not attempt to explain rationally what lies beyond the reach of reason. For both Ahankâra and Desire spring from regions in the psyche where rational thought cannot penetrate by itself alone. It can "enter in" only in close co-operation with the other functions. Mythology here lends a helping hand by appeal to feeling, inspiration and intuition, and the essential function of faith and insight.

Desire, though it is bound up with the Fall, is not "evil", for on the Spiritual Path, as desire for liberation from ignorance and sin, and as desire for the peace and happiness of God-Reality, it is as much the motive factor as it is on the Path of the Fall. The two forms might be called "earth-bound" and "heaven-bound desire".

Desire has brought about everything: Creation, Manifestation, evolution and the phenomena of life, Ahankâra or ego-hood, and involvement in mental darkness and sin.

Furthermore it is also Desire which dissolves these things and leads the way back to God-Reality, when mental darkness has been destroyed.

By the destruction of earth-bound desire, all sorrows and pains that result from "sin", wither away. Hence the great traditions invariably advocate the systematic substitution of nobler desires for coarser ones, and ultimately the complete destruction of desire, in all its forms from the grossest to the subtlest. Perfect freedom from earth-bound desire means freedom from selfhood and unhappiness. Eventually even heaven-bound desires should be renounced, for these, as is taught, also represent forms of

bondage which prevent the soul from experiencing the supreme experience God-Reality

Renunciation of desire does not imply, as is often imagined, the end of life. On the contrary it implies living with greater riches and interest. The Sage Vasiṣṭha enjoined his young pupil, Prince Râma, the hero of the Râmâyana Epic (in the Yoga-Vâsiṣṭha, Upaśānti Prakaraṇa, the Story of Puṇya and Pâvana) "Steady in the state of Fullness which shines when all desires (dheya — vâsanâs) are given up, and peaceful in the state of freedom in life, act playfully in the world, O Râghava! Inwardly free from all desires, dispassionate and detached, but outwardly active in all directions, act playfully in the world, O Raghava! Outwardly full of zeal in action but free from any zeal at heart, active in appearance but inwardly peaceful, work playfully in the world, O Râghava! Free from Ahankâra with mind detached as in sleep, pure like the Ether, ever untainted, act playfully in the world, O Râghava! Conducting yourself nobly and with kindly tenderness, outwardly conforming to conventions but inwardly renouncing all, act playfully in the world, O Râghava! Quite unattached at heart, but for all appearance acting as if with attachment, inwardly cool but outwardly full of fervour, act playfully in the world, O Raghava!" These verses contain some symbolic material — the Fullness, sleep, the Ether — which will be clarified later.

The Path of the Fall led from the Self to self-will, or, to express it in Hindu terms, from the Aham or "I" to the Ahankâra. The Path of Return consists of a retracing of the way, till the Self is all-in-all, and the soul experiences, in the words of St. Catherine, "My I is God, I do not want any other I than this my God."

Desire is one of the Triad of the Nyâya school of Hindu philosophy. Jñâna-Ichchhâ-Kriyâ. Ichchhâ is Desire. The word is related to the English "to ask" and the Dutch "eisen." This involves will. Jñâna means spiritual realization and is related to "gnosis" and "knowledge." Kriyâ is activity and is related to "Creation", meaning action.

From myths much more than from philosophy we learn about the nature of Desire and its relation to other psychical factors. In the myths, Desire is represented by Gods, e.g. Erôs, Kâma, and other forms of the God of Love and Desire. These have two quite different aspects, representing worldly desire — not necessarily earth-bound — on the one hand, and heavenly desire on the other. Worldly desire is represented by Erôs, the son of Venus, and Kâma, the son of Lakshmi. The Primordial or Primal Erôs or Kâma has quite different mythological antecedents. The Rig-veda describes him as "the first movement that arose in the One, after it had come

into life through the power of fervour or disengagement". This is Desire as the power at the back of evolution. On other occasions Desire is the Parent of all the Gods — in which cases he stands at the beginning of the Spiritual Path. In his supernal aspect the God of Love and Desire will be encountered "in the beginning" and "at the end". In his lower, well-known, aspect, he will be met all the time, for he is the great upholder of the world, and Manifestation would come to an end, if he did not continually manifest himself in action. In one myth Kâma is said to be a son of Brahmâ, the Creator.

The symbolism The lower forms of desire are often symbolically of sensual and expressive of the higher forms. First of all, sexual desire sexual desire. is often symbolic of Desire, in a general and basic form.

Further sensual desire often symbolizes desire for "heavenly things". Finally sexual desire is used symbolically for the desire for God, and its satisfaction for the bliss of at-onement of "God-the-Father" and "God-the-Mother", that is, Being and Consciousness, or the Unchanging Reality and the changing World of Creation, — within the psyche.

. If the *symbolism* making use of the imagery of sex is not clearly distinguished from teachings which deal with the *subject* of sex, it gives rise to the regrettable trivialities and vulgarities which are found in many books. The only connection between the two fields is that they lie at the two extreme ends of a scale of transmutation, as will be shown later.

Sexual symbolism exists widely in the ancient traditions. We read in Genesis, the basic tradition of the Bible (2; 24): "A man. . . shall cleave unto his wife: and they shall be one flesh." It has been shown in "Evolution, Paradise and the Fall", that this symbolizes "the mystic marriage".

The Linga of Śiva, standing in the Ark of Śakti, representing the Yoni, symbolizes the Beginning and the End of spirituality or life, the state of Rest or Peace. In that state Static and Dynamic Godhead — Father and Mother — are One, and the soul is completely merged in God-Reality. The symbolism of the Linga, fixed immovably in the Receptacle, also implies that — in spite of the show of the apparent universe — God is perpetually in contact and at One with his Power, the World of Creation. The word "Linga" means etheric or subtle. The Linga is also the Axis of the Universe of the soul, its base represents the Earth and its head, Heaven.

The Śiva-linga is worshipped by communities and people of high spiritual integrity. These have been occasionally accused of "sex-worship" by ignorant or mentally impure adherents of other religions, who have happened to come across some semi-pornographic work about "sex-worship through the ages" (no particular book is meant), or "enlightening" statements of

adherents of some modern school of psychology. Actually the Linga represents primarily the Spiritual Axis of the World of the soul. Its higher end symbolizes the Spiritual Pole, and its lower end the Pole of Manifestation. Therefore the lower end symbolizes *among other things* the power of sex.

The Linga symbol, which has survived to the present day practically only in the form of the Śiva-linga of Hinduism, was known and revered almost universally in the ancient world. When Jacob poured oil over the stone on which his head had rested during his sleep experiences, after putting it up right as a pillar (Genesis 28, 18), he performed the same rite which is done in Śaiva temples to-day. The rite does not imply "sex-worship", but, as will be shown later, its opposite, namely, transmutation of sex. The stone pillar was found everywhere in Syria and is mentioned in the Bible in the sacred Massebah (see, for instance, Judges 9, 6).

Sexual desire, as a form of desire on the lowest levels, forms a symbol of desire in subtler forms, on higher planes. *Ultimately*, that is, in order to reach the high End of humanity, sex must be transmuted and controlled, for as long as sexual desire predominates, the subtler forms of desire are certain to predominate also. Only after the former has been overcome is it possible to overcome the latter. Later the important teachings of Hinduism and the half or wholly forgotten teachings of Christianity and other religions will be dealt with.

Sexual symbolism has entered even Christianity — the religion the adherents of which became most prejudiced against "sex", because it came into existence in a period when in the surrounding religions sexual symbolism had fully lost its meaning and was understood and taken literally, with all the unfortunate moral consequences.

There was a ritual in the early Church, in which a procession, headed by a priest carrying a burning candle, went down into the crypt of the church. The burning candle was dipped into the well which was found under almost every ancient church, as also in the temples of a good many ancient faiths. The well represents the Womb of the Mother and the light the Light of the Father. It was a symbolic fertilization rite: the Divine Mother, represented by the Church, was fructified in order that she might bear and bring forth the Son of God in the hearts of the sons and daughters of the Church, and that thereby the community of saints might be increased. The baptismal font, called the "uterus ecclesiae", "the womb of the Church", was similarly fertilized in the night of the seventh day. The implications and the profundity of this symbolism will be clearer when other traditions have been dealt with.

When considering erotic and sexual symbolism one should remember

that it originated in ages when humanity had not yet fallen to its present level and become involved in the present-day problems of the emotional and physical planes.

Apart from its use in traditional teachings, sensual and sexual symbolism has also been made use of more individualistically. For the men of old the most perfect language for describing the mystical union with God or Divine Nature, was that describing the blissful experience of emotional and physical intercourse. To the pure everything is pure, naturally and unselfconsciously so. If people object to the use of sexual symbolism it means that they do not understand what it teaches and that their mind is not a clean mirror, because they have not properly solved the problem of Desire in their personal life. The avoidance of the subject in an ignorant environment is quite another matter.

Mystics of all traditions have expressed themselves in intimate terms of sensual love. The Song of Solomon in the Bible is well-known. St. John of the Cross and other Christian mystics were inspired by it in their writings. The poems of Muslim Sufis and the traditions of the Krishna cult of Hinduism are examples in the East.

Teachings referring to sex.	We should clearly distinguish the teachings referring to the <i>subject</i> of sex from sexual <i>symbolism</i> . The teachings applying to sex proper fall into two classes, pictorial and symbolical.
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On some ancient Hindu temples erotic and sexual representations are found, — a fact much emphasized by puritans belonging to other religions. These representations formed part of an all-inclusive body of teachings. In Hindu tradition sex has been deemed a part of life which should be considered side by side with the other parts. Hence, on such temples as the Sun-temple at Konarak, known as "the Black Pagoda", sexual representations are found only in one of the many layers of sculpture and in none of the others. The Temple represents the entire world of the psyche, from the physical body to the Divine Reality in its inmost shrine. That particular layer — a low one — is meant to represent "the level" of sex. It shows a part of human life which is as legitimate and sacred as any other. If Western moralists of a past period had given legitimate attention to "sex" and harmonized it with the other functions and aspects of human life, instead of hushhushing it with morbid shame and damning it as something evil, it would surely have remained a more simple and natural subject and not have hatched so many difficult problems. Tradition should not overlook any of the aspects or functions of life, and isolation and occultation is worse than neglect.

Sculptural representations of the type mentioned represent only a particular period of Hindu tradition. Much more ancient and universal is another class of teachings which followed another method, equally difficult to understand for a person accustomed to modern ways of thinking, though perhaps easier to appreciate. The sculptural representations on the *outside* of temples represent exoteric teachings, meant for the greater mass of the people. The esoteric teachings, meant for people of higher culture, aspiring to understand the *inner* side of things, used a method which contrasts strikingly with that of the reliefs. It is concerned with symbols only. If, for instance, the male organ had to be referred to, it was, in its relation to other things in the human scheme, not mentioned by its own name, but symbolized by a plough, a snake, a little lizard, an iron rod, or something else. This applies not only to Hinduism, but to all other ancient traditions as well. The rational mind, if acting in isolation, always desperately tries to call a spade a spade. Perhaps in some contexts there is no harm in the method, — in others there surely is. Anyway, it does not really explain anything. For the purposes of morphology tangible and visible representations in stone or paper are eminently suited. But psychology requires a more refined method of teaching.

The paragraph "Teachings referring to sex" has been included for the purpose of distinguishing this subject from sexual symbolism, and has no direct reference to "The symbolism of Desire and the Fall of Man."

3 THE SYMBOLISM OF THE VIRGIN BIRTH AND THE BEGINNING OF THE SPIRITUAL PATH

The Virgin Birth

The Fall was caused by the influence of Desire. In the Return or Redemption the factor of Desire is absent.

This is expressed in the myths of the "immaculate conception" and the "virgin birth" of Gods, heroes and redeemers, all representing aspects or forms of the saving function in the human soul.

The old traditions present a variety of forms of the Virgin Birth. The Goddess Athênê is *born from the head* of Zeus. She is the Virgin Goddess of Wisdom, presiding over the War between the powers of life and death within the psyche. That is, she represents the Tradition, the Voice that issues from the Head. The version of the "virgin birth" from the head of Zeus has its parallel in Hindu tradition in the Birth of beings from "the mind of Brahmâ." These are called "the mind-born sons" of the Creator.

When Kronos mutilated his father Uranus, he threw the organ into the Ocean. This symbolizes the isolation and dissolution of Desire. Out of the

foam thus caused on the surface of the Ocean, the Goddess Venus Urania, "the Heavenly Venus", was born. Begotten "without passion", she represents the higher Love which contributes to the salvation of the soul from Desire and its consequences in the Fall.

The Mexican Quetzalcoatl was born of a Virgin Perseus was born of the Virgin Danae, after Zeus showered on her in the form of gold. The substitution of a Divine Father for a human father is a common element in myths pertaining to the Birth of a "hero", symbolizing the spiritual function, which comes to perform heroic deeds in life. Zeus or Jupiter was said to be the Father of many heroes, as, for instance, Perseus and Hercules. He corresponds to the Hindu "Guru" and is the Enlightener, presiding over the essential function of faith and insight, who leads his son and disciple back to "obedience" and the enjoyment of true Manhood. During his trials and deeds, representing the stages of the Spiritual Path, the spiritual hero learns the lessons and obtains mastership over himself on the various planes of his soul, one by one, till ultimately he comes to enjoy the peace and bliss of Heaven and becomes divine.

In Buddhist tradition the Virgin Birth is called "the birth from a lotus-blossom in the Tushita Heaven". It implies the divine birth, without reference to a womb, this being considered impure. The Tushita Heaven represents the Moon-Sphere.

The Birth of Kârttikeya. The myth of the Virgin Birth of the Hindu God Kârttikeya gives some very significant details. According to tradition, Śiva, the Lord of Yogis, was at one time immersed in blissful contemplation on Mount Kailâsa, the sacred Abode of the Gods. He corresponds in this aspect to Uranus, the Heavenly Father. The Devas, wishing that Śiva should generate progeny to aid in the scheme of Genesis, sent Kâma, the God of Desire, to him in order to excite him to approach his wife, the Goddess Umâ or Pârvatî, the All-Mother. Pârvatî had had to undergo severe spiritual practices for the purpose of winning him for her husband at all. When the God of Desire came near, Śiva refused to stir from his meditation and leave his state of Bliss. Like Uranus, he refused to generate progeny. After a while, irritated by Kâma's behaviour, he opened his Third Eye, the frontal Eye of Illumination. By the Power of this Eye the God Kâma was burned to ashes, for Illumination dissolves earth-bound desire. But even Enlightenment must work its way and be worked out in the world of Manifestation, or, in other words, must "be born in this world". Therefore the myth continues. Later the Devas sent Agni, the God of Fire, to Śiva. It will be seen later, that he represents an

aspect of Mars Ruler of the first Sign of Manifestation in the Zodiac, Aries Agni visited Śiva and obtained "a germ" of Śiva in the form of a six-fold spark of Fire from his Third Eye. As he was bringing it away, it fell out of his hold into the Heavenly River Ganges, from where it passed into the Himalayan Lake Saravana. The Heavenly Ganges, into which the germ of Śiva fell, corresponds to the Ocean, into which fell the generating power of Uranus. The Heavenly Ganges represents in the Zodiac Aquarius and Pisces. It comes into Manifestation as the first of the Ten Rivers in Aries, as will be shown later (see Diagram 7). Agni's Sign is also Aries (see Diagram 7), and the issuing of Fire from Śiva's Eye is traditionally also connected with Aries.

After the Child had been "virgin-born" out of the Water, beautiful as the Moon and bright as the Sun, six daughters of Kings, married to six of the Seven Rishis, offered him their breast. One myth teaches that he developed six mouths so that he could suckle each of them. Another tradition runs that the six sparks at first were each a babe, and that the six babes became one on being fondly clasped by Umā, the Consort of Śiva, who became the Child's Mother. The six Mothers who suckled him are found in the Heavens in the form of the six Krittikās or Pleiades. Their constellation is situated in Taurus, the Sign following on Aries. The name "Kārttikeya" is derived from "Krittikās". The six foster mothers symbolize the creative aspects of the six Spheres of Moon, Ether, Air, Fire, Water and Earth, and also the six stages of the Path, represented by the Six Days of Genesis.

Kārttikeya has often been called "the Hindu Mars", an identification which may easily lead to crude misconceptions. It will be seen later that Mars is not just "God of war", but that he is the God presiding over the Battle of Life and the Resurrection. The same applies to Kārttikeya. He is the Solar Hero in the human soul. The six stages of the Battle of Life on his Path will be dealt with later. It is a version of the ultimate Battle between the powers of Wholeness or Holiness and the powers of Ahankāra, which comes at the end of the long War that rages within every soul.

The Vahana or riding animal of Kārttikeya is the Peacock, which as *bird* represents the intelligence of the Element Air, the peacock's tail symbolizes the starry heavens that are spread out in beauty. Kārttikeya's twelve hands represent the twelve Signs of the Zodiac. He is worshipped in South India under the Sanskrit names of Subrahmanian and Kumāra or under the Tamil name of Murugan. In the South he is generally represented as an immortal youth, in a simple human form, naked but for the small cloth worn by ascetics. He holds a staff in his hand, which is the same as the lance of the

fierce Kārttikeya. According to tradition, it is a symbol of Viveka. Viveka is a synonym of Buddhi and means discrimination between the Real and "the unreal", that is, the apparent reality of the world. He further holds an ascetic's waterpot in his hand, symbolizing the Grace of the Water of Life. It is a mighty achievement if the psychical function belonging to the Element Fire becomes "ascetic". Subrahmanian is the Patron of many who seek God-Reality or Self-realization. The symbols of Kārttikeya will later be considered at greater length in connection with his Battle with the Titans. His main festivals in South India are celebrated in the periods of Aries, the Sign of Sunrise which is ruled by Mars, and Taurus, the Sign of "the Mothers", represented by the Pleiades, which is ruled by Venus. His Victory over the Ahankāric powers is celebrated in the period of Libra.

The Virgin Birth of Christ. The most recent, and for the present time most appropriate, instance of the Virgin Birth is that of Christ. No Eros approached the Holy Virgin (St. Luke 1; 34). The Angel of the Annunciation, announcing the Immaculate Conception, was Gabriel, the Voice of God. He is the Angel of the Moon-Sphere (see Diagram 1). It is by the Moon-Sphere that the Ether-Sphere comes into existence. The Voice gives birth to the Word, as we shall see presently. The Ether is the realm of Light and Enlightenment, ruled by the Guru, the Enlightener. The Holy Virgin, like Isis, Venus Urania, Athênê and the virgin Diana, represents the Moon-Goddess, that is, the Power of Consciousness in its aspect of the Tradition, ever virgin and ever young, and ever giving birth to the power of faith and insight into the mystery of life. The Holy Virgin is "Queen of Heaven", "Queen of the Stars" and to give her an ancient title — "Mother of the Aeons". Much of the ancient symbolism of the Moon-Goddess, Queen of the Night, has become associated with the Holy Virgin. In early times the seers knew well whom she represented. The Virgin's Mother, Anna, has also been identified with the Primal Mother. An Ethiopian manuscript of the early Abyssinian Church contains a prayer to Anna: "Hanna, thou who art the Morning . . . brilliant pearl, wherefrom went forth Mary the Virgin, who gave birth to the Flame . . . She shall bring forth the blessed Moon (who shall give birth to the Sun). Praise, salutation, and homage to Hanna, the mother of the mother of Adonâi, who made rise a second Sun . . . my Lady Hanna, thou bride of the Heavenly Father . . . thou saviour of Adam." Adonâi is the Lord.

Since early times Christian thought has not made a clear distinction between the symbolism of the Christ Myth and the Facts of the life of the historical Jesus. In the myth the Virgin Mary represents the "Moon-

Goddess" who gives birth to the Son of God in human hearts all over the world. The mother of Jesus was a woman like other women, except that she was spiritually highly advanced. In spite of her advanced spiritual development, however, she served occasionally as a symbol of "the world" (as, for instance, St Matthew 12, 47-50 and St John 2, 4). The Virgin Mother of Christ is the Moon-Goddess, Queen of Heaven — the most exalted form of Deity, for as regards the Father, no one can speak of "form". The Mother is traditionally "the form" and "the power" of the Father. In the Apocryphal "Gospel according to the Hebrews" Jesus spoke about "My Mother the Holy Spirit"

"The Son of man". The dogma that Joseph was not the father of Jesus takes away one of the most significant elements in the Gospel teachings. It implies the denial that Jesus was an ordinary human being, however spiritually matured, and hence the denial of the attainment of God-realization from a basis in the human condition. This forms a very great element of hope and promise. If we know of an Angel or God who is liberated from sin and sorrow and has attained Salvation, it is not of much use to us. But if we see *a man* who has attained this, it gives us hope and comfort, for it assures us that we may attain it ourselves. It may biologically, under special circumstances, be possible for a woman to bring forth a child by herself, without impregnation, but such an abnormal phenomenon would be an unnatural one, unsuited for a great Saviour, whose importance for humanity lies in the fact that he is one of them and one like them in every way, and that, in spite of this, he achieves the state of Being and Consciousness in which he can proclaim "I and the Father are One."

The title "Son of man" means son of Joseph, and the title "Son of God", implying the Virgin Birth, is symbolical. Jesus was "made of the seed of David according to the flesh" (Romans 1, 3). The historian Josephus and the Church-historian Hegesippus have referred to the brothers of the Lord, especially James the Just, to "Symeon, the son of the Lord's uncle, Clopas", and to other relatives. James the Just, or, the Righteous, was the first Bishop of the Church and Symeon the second.

Tradition carefully stressed the fatherhood of Joseph by giving the ancestors of Jesus from Abraham and David downward, in St Matthew 1, 1-16. The last verse is "And Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ." Because the mythological material referring to the Virgin Birth was inserted immediately after these verses, the words "the husband of Mary" were also inserted in the 16th

verse. It is hard to understand why all the trouble should have been taken to record the ancestry of Jesus if Joseph were not his father. And actually, it has been proved from the so-called Sinai-Palimpsest, discovered in 1892 that the original text had "Joseph begat Jesus", instead of "Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus".

The tradition of the Virgin Birth was derived from other than the common Jewish sources.

But though "the Son of man" should be taken to mean "son of Joseph", it has also symbolical implications. For, as we shall see later, "ancestors" should also be understood in a symbolical sense. Furthermore "man" has reference to the stage of the Path in which Manhood is attained, while "*Son of man*" applies to the stage following on that. (This will at once be clear to readers of "The Key to the First Chapter of Genesis". It will also be explained in this book).

Those who hold to a literalistic interpretation of Scripture and fail to recognize the existence of symbolism, cannot benefit from the rich details of the traditional teachings.

The devout among Christians can only object to the mention of "the Christ Myth" as long as they use that word in the modern, contemptuous, sense. One who understands what *a myth* really is, cannot but regard it as a most valuable, beautiful, intellectual, inspiring, enlightening and sacred traditional treasure.

From the little material that has been adduced, it is already evident that the Virgin Birth is the symbolic or spiritual birth or renewal and has no reference at all to the subject of conception and sex. This "birth" exactly opposes and follows from the state of symbolic or spiritual "death" of the Fall (see Genesis 2;17). There is, as we shall see later, a different meaning in the Virgin Birth of Men and of Virgins themselves.

The winter solstice.	The spiritual and symbolic birth is traditionally associated with the time of the winter solstice, because from that time onward the light of the sun becomes stronger and the sun seems to return on its course. This "return" marks the beginning of the Spiritual Path or Path of Return. It constitutes the "conversion", literally, the turning about, of the soul.
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The darkness of the time of the year is a symbol of the state of soul of the Fallen Man. From that time on, the darkness is dispelled by light. Therefore older traditions celebrated the Birth of Dionysos and Mithras on December 25th and the Birth of Osiris on December 27th, and therefore, also, the Birth of Christ is celebrated on December 25th. The Lord of

Light is, moreover, conceived to be born at midnight. There is a symbolic correspondence between the stages of the year-cycle and the stages of the day-cycle, and herein midnight corresponds to the winter-solstice (see Diagram 1a)

The sacred teachings of old are universal and all-embracing. The Light is born in the heart-cave of every human being, Christian or otherwise, when the time for its conversion on the Path of Ahankâra has come. It matters very little what name is associated with it. When the Light is born in the soul, the Ahankâra, "the old Adam" passes away.

The meaning of the symbols and myths of old, whether of the East or of the West, has been long forgotten. We shall see that it is taught in the myths and scriptures of several faiths that their meaning will once more be revealed and understood. The Lord has long remained hidden in the tombs of dogmatic theologies and in the sepulchres of numerous sects. Tradition teaches us about his Re-birth and Resurrection. That implies the renewal of *insight* into the *meaning* of the teachings of the Tradition and of life itself, at the hand of these teachings.

The winter solstice is when the sun moves from Sagittarius to Capricorn. The old cycle ends in Sagittarius and the new begins in Capricorn. In those connections in which the old cycle is conceived as one of psychical and cultural disorder, darkness and emptiness (all three important symbolical conceptions, as we shall see later), the end of the cycle is presided over by a Divine Judge, who holds his Court and weighs the deeds or the heart of man in the Balance. The different traditions have given him many names and titles — the Angel of Life and Death, Saturn, Yama, Dharma-Raja, Osiris, Forsete, Christ. According as one side or the other of the Balance falls, it is determined whether the "here-after" will take the form of a heaven or a hell. The here-after implied does not refer in the first instance to the stage to follow after the death of the physical body, but to the state following on the symbolic or spiritual death of the Fall — during the life-time of man. For the heaven and hell of man's making are in "this world".

The Titans. The myths of Genesis of various faiths do not contain meaningless explanations of the creation of the material universe and man, or a theatrical allegory to explain natural phenomena. Their object is spiritual enlightenment and they deal with that very subject. They discuss the stages of the Spiritual Path and form the basis of all the more detailed, later, teachings.

In Greek tradition the first Gods are the Titans. The Titans and Gods are the Daemons — a word originally meaning Angels or Gods. Diotima,

the prophetess of Mantinea, taught Socrates that Eros is "the intermediate being between mortals and immortals, a great Daemon, dear Socrates, for everything demoniac is just the intermediate link between God and man". It is Desire that leads to the Fall, and it is also Desire that leads the way back to God-Reality. Therefore Desire has a special place in Capricorn, the stage in which the cycles meet.

The Twelve Primordial Titans came forth from Uranus, the Heavenly Father, who is apprehended or approached in the Zodiac in the stage of Capricorn and Aquarius. They symbolize the first order arising out of Khaos - which does not represent a state of the material universe, but symbolizes the state of disorder in the soul of a man at the depth of the Fall: "And the earth was without form and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep" (Genesis 1; 2). It should be noted that the order of the Twelve Titans is the same as that of the Twelve Signs of the Zodiac in the direction of the Spiritual Path (see Diagram 1b). The last of these Primordial Titans, called Kronos or Time by the Greeks and Saturnus by the Romans, was the first of the Gods. Saturn is the God of the Element Earth, the physical plane. He is the Ruler of Capricorn and Aquarius, and is, therefore, watching over the beginning and end of both the Fall and the Return.

The Titans represent the world of *form* and the Gods which follow them, the world of *life*. The Titanic and the Divine are never entirely distinct, for form and life are never fully separated.

The outlooks of science and the sacred psychological traditions of old are opposed to each other and related as form to life. In practice they can never be entirely distinct. The Gods must rule the Titans — science must be subservient to the Tradition.

Before the light of insight can come in the life of a man, to guide him on the Spiritual Path, a certain orderliness regarding the form-aspect of things, should arise in his mind. The Titans represent this orderliness. They further represent the powers of evolution — without reference to a spiritual path, implying the retracing of a downward path.

By itself the creation and evolution of form is pure and right, but through the interference of the Ahankâra, the Ego-factor, they become impure, "sinister" and ultimately devilish. The Titans, at first the great creators, manifesters and upholders of form, become within the psyche of the Fallen Man, ruled by Ahankâra, adversaries of the higher functions, and demons.

Originally Titan and Titânius were names of the Sun-God and a son or brother of the Sun. His or their descendants, the Titans, rose against the Gods and were precipitated into the Underworld, that is, the world of the Fall. This myth illustrates how the creators and evolvers of form, or, in other

words, the "elemental powers" of the mind, became involved in the Fall. The parallel traditions in Genesis (6, 4-5) and other religions will be dealt with later.

The Titans, called in Hindu tradition by the name of Daityas or Asuras, are not in any way "evil" by themselves. The creative powers of the mind only become "evil" when they become servants of the Ahankâra and cease to be obedient to the higher functions of the soul. When that is the case, the War between the Gods and the Titans begins, with either of the two groups having predominance, according as the soul chooses one or the other of the Two Paths. At the greatest *depth* of the Fall the Titans are condemned to live in the *Underworld*, where they suffer the consequences of their deeds of disobedience. That state is Tartaros, the Deep (Genesis 1, 2) and Hell.

The Spiritual Path begins there. The first glimpse of light from above penetrates into the darkness of the Abyss. At the end of the Spiritual Path the fallen powers are liberated from their bondage. Thereby the mental powers of orderliness can again perform their creative task in obedience to the higher functions of the psyche.

"Liberation" is ever a freeing from earthly bondage, and is traditionally associated with Capricorn and Aquarius. The Ruler of these two stages of the Zodiac is Saturn, the Liberator.

A Greek myth taught that after Ouranos or Uranus had brought forth the Twelve Titans, he decided to put an end to generation. This decision comes at the end of the Cycle. Ouranos buried his children "in the earth." The last Titan, Kronos or Saturnus, escaped this fate, however. He represents the Power of the Earth-Element itself, and his first House, Capricorn, is an Earth-House. Saturn agreed with his mother, Gaea, the Earth-Mother, that he should mutilate his Father, and carry on the work of generation in a new manner. He liberated his eleven brothers and sisters, and asked them to assist him in this task. The eldest brother, Okeanos, representing the Saturn Sign of Aquarius — which is that of his Father, Ouranos — refused to aid in the act of mutilating the Father. It is significant, that, after the act of mutilation, Kronos-Saturn threw the organ *into the Ocean*. The Titan Okeanos and the Ocean both represent Aquarius, the Abode of "the Heavenly Ocean" or "the Waters" in many traditions.

This myth deals with the difficult problem of the force of Desire. Followers of Attis, a God-Man whose Birth was celebrated in Capricorn, and of other traditions, castrated themselves "for the Kingdom of Heaven's sake", and so this symbolism found its way into Christianity. One need hardly say that there is question here of symbolism only, and not of injunctions which

should be taken literally. The organ that is a symbol of Desire, is cut off with "the sickle of Saturn". The symbolism of the Linga is also specially connected with Capricorn and Aquarius. The fuller implications of the symbolism will appear little by little, for the moment it is only possible to mention a few traditional data in an introductory manner. It has already been stated that as a result of the mutilation of Ouranos. Aphroditē Ourania or Venus Urania was born in an immaculate manner.

Kronos or Saturn. Saturn was the liberator of his eleven brothers and sisters, representing all the Signs of the Zodiac except Capricorn. The Liberator is, as we shall see later in connection with many other traditions, connected with Capricorn.

Kronos or Saturnus is the Ruler of Capricorn. The word "Kronos" means "Time". He opens and closes the Cycle of Time. His sand-glass is a time-symbol and suggests the energy spent during a Cycle. The sand in it represents the dust of the Earth — the Element he is Lord of. His scythe, symbol of mortality and spiritual death as well as of the reaping of the spiritual harvest, cuts off the Cycle. As a Titan he represents finitude in Time and Space. At the end of the Cycle all life must pass by him, as it passed by him at the beginning. He watches over both the Fall and the Redemption and is in many traditions the Lord of the cross-roads, the juncture on man's Path. In his House, Capricorn, the Two Paths begin, or, to put it in another way, the one Path ends and the other begins. He is the Lord of "this world", the Element Earth, and also the Liberator and Initiator, and eventually the Ruler of the high spiritual state, known as "the Golden Age of Saturn". Kronos also sleeps on an island in the Ocean — representing the Spiritual Pole in Aquarius (see Diagram 1a). Sleep is his real element and time does not exist for him. In the day-cycle the period from midnight to 4 a.m. (see Diagram 1b) is the time of sleep. Sleep, as we shall see later, is symbolically associated with spiritual life. For him one year is one hour. The time-division of one year symbolically indicates the material world, where as one hour indicates the experience of spirit (see Diagram 1).

Saturn is both Titan and God, both God of Death and God of Life. Though all Gods and Titans have a dual aspect, this is most pronounced in Saturn. For he is the last of the Primordial Titans and the first of the Gods. He forms the link between Earth and Heaven.

As Ruler on the Night-throne of Capricorn he has an aspect of tempter and trouble-maker. As Ruler on the Day-throne of Aquarius, he is the Father of the Gods.

Saturn is the God of Seeds. The word "Saturn" is derived from a word

for seeds Saturn is the guardian of the seeds which are stored up in the period of rest for the next Cycle. The seeds symbolize the fruits of actions of the past Cycle, to serve for the Cycle to come, they are psychological tendencies and complexes. The word Saturn is further derived from "satur", implying fullness, "satiation". Saturn represents the fullness of time and things, which also the seed contains. "Satur" moreover means rich. Saturn is the Guardian of the Treasure, Lord of the *Golden Age*. Satur also means fertile. All these symbolic implications will be dealt with in their suitable contexts. In all traditions Aquarius represents the stage of full spiritual, all inclusive, "satisfaction" — a related word — and "saturation", when the soul becomes "sated" with the Bread and the Water of Life.

In theological language Christ is "the satisfaction" for our sins, the satisfaction meaning the atonement made by Christ. This "atonement" is the at-onement of the ultimate stage.

The dual aspect of Saturn is reflected in the dual aspect of all the most profound symbols, applying to the ultimate stage, which also forms the stage of a new beginning. The symbols of "good" and "evil" are intimately related and seem to be interchangeable, when they are taken out of their context.

From the point of view of full Manifestation, the stages of Aquarius and Pisces are symbolically "pre-natal", and ultimately "after-death" states. They form the Womb, out of which all life arises, and into which it finally passes — to arise once more. In that Womb, the seeds of life are preserved. They are sometimes identified with the fishes of Pisces. The seeds of Saturn are carried over for the next Cycle of Manifestation, to be sown in the stage of Taurus, as we shall see later. They form the basic material for "culture".

In Diagram 1b Aquarius and Pisces are mentioned as "pre-genetic" Signs at the top and as "here after" Signs at the bottom. Of the two Signs Aquarius represents more specifically the here-after and Pisces the preliminaries of Manifestation. In many contexts Capricorn is included in the Womb stage of the Path. In as many accounts as the stage of the perfection of Manifestation. Herein we have another example of the curious dual nature of the Sign.

Manifestation is traditionally conceived to begin in the Sign of Aries, the Ram, when "the Sun rises". With the Re-birth of Resurrection of life the Womb-stage has come to an end.

When considering the Diagrams representing the great scheme of the Tradition, it should be remembered that it does not consist of watertight compartments. The Rivers both of Life and of Death run through it. Their Waters pass through peaceful lotus-lakes or stagnant pools, as the case may be, and they shoot down in rapids or leap down in cascades.

To return to Saturn. His scythe has been preserved to this day in the scythe held by the allegorical "Father Time" and "Death".

Saturn is, as we have seen, God of Seeds. That is, he is the presiding Intelligence over the fruits of actions, or, to use a Hindu term, Lord of Karma. As such, he is the God of Death as the Great Judge, who recapitulates all life at the end of a Cycle. In various traditions the God of Death holds symbols like the sword or the scythe and the balance with which "good" and "evil" actions are weighed. It will be evident later, that the accompanying symbols recapitulate the previous stages on the Path: the God of Death representing Saturn, the Ruler of Capricorn, the judgment is that of Jupiter, the Guru, the Ruler of Sagittarius, the sword belongs to Mars, the Ruler of Scorpio, and the balance to Venus, the Ruler of Libra. The clerk or recorder of the God of Death, by whatever name he is called by in Hindu, Buddhist, Egyptian or other tradition, is an aspect of Mercury, the Ruler of Virgo.

Before the Spiritual Path can be entered or re-entered, the soul must pass through the Judgment — which is really a self-judgment, for the drama is enacted within the psyche, and the actors are the psychical functions and factors. The Judge is an aspect of God and the defendant or accused is the Ahankâra.

The God Pan. Intimately related to Saturn in his lower aspect is Faunus, considered to be his descendant, and like him a field and seed God. The "field" is the plane of "culture". The Latin Faunus was identified with the Greek God Pan, who also significantly indicates the dual aspect of Saturn.

In his higher, transcendent, aspect, Pan represents The All. For the Stoics and Orphics he was Universal Life.

As such he represents the Ruler of Aquarius. The Lupercalia, the Festival of Pan in Rome, were celebrated on February 15th. The star which he wore on his breast represents the Pole Star. Pan was worshipped with great solemnity in ancient Egypt. There he ranked as one of the eight Greatest Gods. His statues represented him in the symbol of a goat. His horns represent the rays of the Supernal Sun.

In his lower aspect Pan is the Nature-God, represented with horns and goatlegs by the Greeks and Romans. He is the cause of "panics", or, more correctly, panic fears. Capricorn is the stage of terror on the Path. His task is to inspire "the fear of God". The Capricornian Pan was "capricious", that is, literally, "goat-like". There is an incalculable element in the psychical developments in the stage of Capricorn. The word "Capricornus" means

"the goat-horned" The lower aspect of Pan was not considered to be immortal, as he was in his higher aspect, as the Great All

As we shall see later, Pan is also connected with the stage of Taurus, in which the "seeds" are sown in "the field" and the process of "culture" begins In that constructive aspect Pan is the friend of shepherds and cowherds In this capacity Pan resided chiefly in Arcadia in Greece He was the inventor of the Syrinx or pipe with seven reeds.

In Capricorn the Two Paths begin The Spiritual Path is presided over by the Lord of Light and the Path of the Fall by his Adversary, the Power of Darkness It is easy to see how Satan, literally "the Adversary" or "the Enemy", obtained his goat-legs and goat-horns, and how his name became associated with "Satyr" and "Saturn", though there is no etymological relationship But all are connected with the same stage of the Path

Ganapati.

The Deity that watches over the beginning of the Spiritual Path in Hindu tradition is the Elephant-headed God

Ganapati His Jayanthi or "victory-day of birth", symbolizing the spiritual birth, is celebrated in the period of Capricorn The word "Ganapati" means "Lord of hosts" or "Lord of quantities" These quantities form the parallel of the "Sands of time" in the Sand-clock, which is a symbol of Saturn Pan is also Lord of Quantities While unity or oneness belongs to the Divine, multiplicity pertains to the Titanic world Titanic multiplicity and Divine oneness can only meet in an Intelligence or Power who is at one and the same time Titan and God We have seen that that is Saturn

Ganapati or Ganesa, "the God of Ganas", is like Saturn a Sower One Ganapati scripture has a verse "Innumerable Universes were born from his belly, of this there is no doubt" Ganapati is worshipped at the beginning of every religious rite, and at the beginning of every important enterprise, by the devout Hindu For he watches over the beginning of the Path The belief is, that no obstacles can be overcome, and no progress made, on the Spiritual Path, without the guidance, help and blessings of this God, who stands ever at the cross-roads of human choice He is the Lord of Karmic causes-and-effects, hence he is the "Bringer and Remover of Obstacles" Capricorn, the stage he represents, is the "crucial" stage on the Path The time comes when the Titanic multiple fragments, numerous as the particles of sand or the dust of the Earth, should be reunited to Divine Union The time comes when a soul should choose the Return Path to GOD, that is, Reality Hercules, at the beginning of his heroic career, had to make the choice at the Cross-roads That choice lies before one and all The opportunity traditionally suited for it comes in the time when the Cycles meet,

marked by the winter solstice. Gaṇapati is called "the Lord of the Two Paths" which are the Pitri-yāna or "Path of the Ancestors", and the Deva-yāna or "Path of the Gods". The "Ancestors" are the symbols of the forces of Karma, as we shall see later. The Two Paths begin from the winter solstice, leading in opposite directions. In some contexts they are associated with both the winter and the summer solstices. When we compare the situations in the heavens of the first points of Capricorn and Cancer, with which the two solstices are connected, the one, the Path of Heaven, is high above, from the point of view of a beholder on earth, while the other, the Path of Hell, is deep underneath, in the opposite direction.

Gaṇapati shares some of his Saturnian characteristics with Śiva, his Father, and some with Yama, the God of Death. All three Gods are Initiators into a higher, spiritual, mode of life.

Occasionally Gaṇapati is represented with five heads: one in each of the four directions and one crowning them. These symbolize, like the four angles of a pyramid, with the fifth at the top, the Four Elements Earth, Water, Fire and Air, sprung from the Fifth, the Quintessence, Ether. For the meaning of this symbolism refer to Diagram 1.

Images of Gaṇapati are found, usually in small shrines, at cross-roads and in the doorways of countless houses.

Janus. The name of the Roman God Janus is etymologically related to the Sanskrit word "Yāna", meaning Path. Janus was said to be the Guardian of doors and gates. These are symbols of initiation, of entrance to other worlds. The festivals of Janus in Rome were celebrated at the time of the two solstices. These are his two Doors, for Janus, "Passage", was the Lord of the Two Paths, like Gaṇapati. Janus was represented with two faces, one looking forward and the other backward. He was invoked in Rome at the *beginning* of important matters and functions of the state or the community. The month of January, *the first month* (of one form of the year-cycle), which was sacred to him, owes its name to him.

In the Christian religion which came into the place of the old Roman religion, the two festivals of Janus, at the two solstices, became the festivals of St. John the Divine and St. John the Baptist, each in their way Doors admitting to Christ. "John" was associated by psychological etymology with "Janus".

It is ever remarkable and inspiring to watch how the different traditions run parallel and are linked and associated with one another.

4 THE SYMBOLISM OF THE DILACERATION OF MAN

Fragmentation and The Fall is characterized by an ever increasing fragmentation and dissension

dissension. Adherents of the various religions of the world (with the exception of Hinduism) now imagine that theirs is the only true religion, and followers of the various sects within one religion imagine the same Individuals forming new philosophies, theologies or political creeds labour under the same delusion Christianity in particular has shown this separative tendency to an excessive degree

Not only have the religious traditions of the world become separated one from another, but the separative tendency has also been at work within the very bosom of each tradition In ancient times religion science, medicine, astrology, psychology, and other traditional branch-sciences, all functioned in harmony with one another in the organism of the whole In the course of time they have lost touch with one another, begun to contradict one another, and become scattered in fragments and imprisoned in watertight compartments It would not have mattered very much if the process had not taken place within the human soul The process is an outcome of the Fall

The cutting up of life into multiple fragments has been going on in the human soul the process has divided one tradition from another, has divided art(s) and science(s) from one another, has divided humanity into groups and smaller groups, and has divided the individual into so many parts at war within himself The inner life of modern man is a field of battle between assertions, theories, tenets, — of art, science and religion, to mention only the more important claimants for power There are a host more, as everybody knows And generally it is the suppressed or repressed "minorities" that cause the greatest trouble The tendency towards watertight compartments, with all its resultant problems, has reached its high tide in the collective "schizophrenia" of present day humanity

Fragments of the sacred, universal, Tradition have been preserved by different groups of men But fragments, like fragments of an organic body, no longer contain true life Life is connected with wholeness, in which is a harmonious relationship between the organs

The lost interrelation Traditional psychology deals with the interrelation of the functions and factors of the soul — including the body, for that forms one of the functions of the soul, and the material world As the meaning of the fundamental symbolism of the

Tradition gets lost more and more, the interrelation of branches of tradition is lost sight of more and more, and they drift further and further away from each other.

In India it is no longer realized that there is an intimate relationship between the symbolism of Śani or Saturn, Śiva, the Destroyer of Desire, who takes also the forms of Linga and Kāla, Time and further Yama, the God of Death, Ganapati, the Initiator, and other Gods in as much as they represent the Capricornian stage of the Path and can in some contexts even be identified.

The process of separative forgetfulness of the meaning of traditions has advanced even further in Western countries, since generally in the West people have lost touch more completely with their traditional roots. It is due to this process that, for instance, nowadays no more connection is seen between the astronomical winter solstice on the 22nd of December, the Birth of the Light, the Son of God, and the first of January, the beginning of the new Year-cycle. It is an outcome of this same process, that religious bigots, when speaking of heaven, mechanically roll their eyes upwards, as if the sky were indeed their heaven. This forms a custom handed down to them by their elders. Since the meaning has been lost, it has become a form of superstition. The emptiness of the gesture has made atheists and sceptics, who are often people gifted with a little more intuition, ask them whether their God is sitting on the cloud that just happens to sail by. Vision has been exiled and superstition has usurped its place. Once upon a time the gesture had a deep symbolic meaning and was done spontaneously. For formerly the heaven above was the living symbol of the heaven within. Then air and ether were living symbols of the Spirit and the Light of God. Then Winged Beings were the messengers from on High, in the shape of Dove, or Swan, or Garuda, or Hermès, or Angel. — Now, however, man has become a Gnome, digging in the galleries of the Earth-Element, for tangible forms of power. He is no more interested in the heavens, except to scale them with the help of artificial wings, to display his Titanic power or to shower destruction and ruin upon the earth. He has become a worshipper of Mammon and the Machine. When will he grow wings again? When will he lift eyes and arms heavenwards again, in full knowledge of what that means, invoking grace and insight, praying to the One beyond all, responding enraptured to the call echoing within his inmost being? When will he begin to gather the fragments of his soul?

It is written in the Gnostic Gospel of Eve: "In all am I scattered. And whencesoever thou wilt, thou gatherest Me; and gathering Me, thou gatherest thyself." That is why the appeal is uttered in the Pistis Sophia:

"Come unto us, for we are thy Fellow-Limbs We are all one with thee"

The dilaceration The symbolism of the dilaceration and the scattering of Dionûsos. of the fragments was much more ancient than the Gnostic tradition The Egyptian God Osiris, born on the 27th of December, was cut into parts by his Adversaries Similar myths, related to the Crucifixion myth, were found all around the Eastern Mediterranean The best known example is that of the Greek God Dionûsos

The traditions of the Mysteries of Eleusis and of the Orphics taught that Dionûsos was the son of a virgin-mother, the mortal Sêmelê His father was said to be Zeus, the Father of the Gods He was born, as Mitra and Christ, on the 25th of December At a very tender age Zeus-Jupiter entrusted to him the Rulership over the World His earliest dwelling place was a Cave, and in his earliest age he was associated with a Ram The Cave is the Womb-stage of the Path and the Ram is Aries

Once, while playing, Dionusos looked at himself in a mirror and became captivated by his own image The mirror is the Moon-mirror The episode symbolizes the loss of All-consciousness and the entering into a state of Duality discrimination between Being and its reflection, the self, implying the birth of the Ahankâra, the I-factor, and, in another sense, the shifting of the attention from Reality to its reflections, in the mind and in the world The symbolism refers to the Fall, and hence it is no wonder that worse is to come When engaged in beholding his image in the Mirror, the Titans, incited by the Goddess Hêra, approached him in a disguise, and tried to overwhelm him Hêra represents the veiling power of Consciousness, traditionally associated with the Moon-Sphere To use a convenient Hindu term — she represents Mâyâ Her main symbol is a veil Mâyâ is the Power that disguises Reality and creates the apparent "realities" of "the world", which are fleeting and transient The disguise of the Titans belongs to the power of Mâyâ

In this connection it should be noted that in the modern world the Titans are also well disguised, in order that the soul may be deceived

Dionusos tried to escape from the Titans by changing his shape In the power of adaption lies the last protection of the spiritual man when he is hard pressed by the world But form belongs to the sphere of the Titans, and there are limitations to the process of adaptation Finally Dionûsos was overpowered and slain, when he had taken the form of a Bull The Titans then dismembered him, boiled the flesh and consumed it

The encounter with the Titans has reference to three stages of the Fall We have seen that the Fall is traditionally conceived as moving backwards

from the first point of Capricorn, connected with the winter solstice. The reason is the following.

The Great Year Traditionally a Round of the Fall is symbolically and the Fall. connected with the Great Year, that is, one cycle of the precession of the equinoxes.

This will be substantiated at length in other sections of this work. For the moment a short explanation will suffice. The movements of the (planet) earth are responsible for the existence of the Great Year. Symbolically connected with the Fall of Man, the self-willed movements of the Earth-and-Moon-Dragon are the cause of the Fall. This Dragon, Demon or Devil represents "self-will", the desire connected with Ahankâra or ego-centricity.

The precession of the equinoxes has traditionally no reference to the Path of Return. For though on the Path of the Fall there is an ever-changing Pole of Existence, on the Path of Return the Pole is eternally fixed, and the time-scheme ever remains the same. The Path of Return to God-Reality follows in the myths of all the world the identical time-scheme of the Zodiac, based on an unchangeable, ever-fixed, Spiritual Pole of Being. On the Spiritual Path the action of the Earth-and-Moon-Dragon, who eclipses Truth, should be taken due note of, and the delusion of his universe of appearances should be broken, so that the Eternal and Unchanging World of the Tradition can stand out revealed. The Paths of the Fall and the Return should ever be carefully distinguished.

The Slaying of the Bull and the Lamb. The symbolism of "the slaying of the Bull" is akin to that of "the slaying of the Lamb". Students of recent times have sought a connection between the Zodiacal Animals figuring in the myths of ancient traditions and their respective periods in history in relation to the precession of the equinoxes during the Great Year. Such a connection exists with regard to *some* contexts in which the Animals appear in myths and scriptures — but not in all. In some symbolic contexts the slain Bull refers to the Age of Taurus and the slain Lamb to the Age of Aries.

The slaying of the Animal begins on the Path of the Fall — as also the battle of Dionûsos with the Titans — in the stage of Scorpio. The second stage is connected with Leo, and the third stage has reference to Taurus (see Diagram 1a). The first stage has reference to mental and moral matters, relating to the Element Fire, the second to emotional matters, connected with the Element Water, while the last applies to physical matters, relating to the Element Earth. The Fall progresses (actually, regresses) downwards

from Element to Element, in conformity with the specific Element-symbolism that is connected with the various stages of the Zodiac

Towards the end of the Fall the Element Earth begins to be all-important. The physical killing of the Spiritual Man has always been commemorated in the stage of Taurus and Aries. Good Friday also falls in that stage.

But in the symbolic traditions, referring to the Path of Return, the slaying of the Bull and the Lamb is connected in the great traditions of the world with the end of the Cycle — Scorpio and Sagittarius — because the end of the Path of Return covers the same ground as the beginning of the Path of the Fall, which runs in the direction inverse to that of the Return. Hence the slaying of Bull and Lamb is commemorated in the various traditions in the stage of Scorpio and Sagittarius. The slaying of the Bull of Mithras, the slaying of the Minotaur by Theseus, the slaying of the Buffalo-Demon by the Goddess Durgâ, and other such killing, all have reference to this critical and "crucial" stage on the Path. The slaying and dismembering of Osiris was enacted at Abydos and commemorated all over Egypt at the time when the period of Scorpio began. The slaying of the Lamb in the form of the Crucifixion of Christ is traditionally connected with the stage of Scorpio and Sagittarius, as we shall see later. For that stage is represented by the *Friday* in the week-cycle, in a tradition that is based on Genesis. In that stage the symbolic death of the Fall begins, and therefore in that stage it is overcome on the Spiritual Path.

The nature of Man is, in a manner of speaking derived from sacred tradition, half Solar, half Lunar. In his Solar nature, derived from the Father, Man is immortal. In his Lunar nature, implying "a mortal mother", or, in other words, descent from Eve or Sêmelê, on the Path of the Fall, or actual birth on the physical plane, he is exposed to danger, immolation and crucifixion. But it is also his Lunar nature, by means of the Virgin Birth, that destroys the Mâyâvic mortality, allowing Immortality to shine forth. It also brings him Resurrection.

The killing of the Light The theme of "the killing of the Light", which is intimately connected with the slaying of the symbolic Animals, occurs in myths all over the world. It does not form a dramatization of the approach of winter, but it uses natural phenomena for the purpose of teaching about the Fall and the Return, that is, the subject of specific changes in the consciousness and actions of man. The theme often takes the form of the death of the Sun-God. In this context the Sun does not represent the Supernal Sun or Father, God-Reality — which is

immortal and can, of course, not be slain — but “the incarnate Sun”, the Bearer of Light, within the soul of man.

The Solar Hero or Son of God eventually regains true life and immortality at the end of the Spiritual Path. For at the same stage he had originally lost it in the beginning of the Fall. The “death” of the Sun-God or God-Man, representing the function of insight and faith, in the soul, with its consequences for the moral man, has been connected by various traditions with the end of the Cycle. Scorpio, as shown in Diagram 1 b, is the Sign of the “sunset”. On the Path of Return the “sunset” implies the approaching return of the soul to the Father’s House, in Aquarius, in Peace and Love. But on the Path of the Fall the stage of “sunset” represents the death-involving tragedy of the Fall. Later the meaning of the symbolism under consideration will be made clear. Meanwhile one point may be made to stand out clearly: the symbolic “death” of the Fall, and the death of that death on the Path of Return, both occur in the same region of the Path through the Zodiac. The death or neutralization of the symbolic or spiritual death is followed by the spiritual birth.

Moral and spiritual suffering cannot be undergone without an element of guilt. This pertains to the Fall. On the Path of Return to God-Reality the various stages of the Fall from God-Reality are re-traced one by one. What was done on the Path of the Fall should be undone on the Path of Return, and what was left undone on the Path of the Fall has to be done on the Path of Return. The Crucifixion constitutes the recapitulation of the basic elements, and the re-enactment of the first and decisive stage, of the Fall. The “slaying” is the killing of the Light on the Path of the Fall, which must be compensated by the killing of “the lower nature”, often symbolized by an Animal, on the Path of Return. In order that the soul may be redeemed from the state of the Fall, the Ahankâra must suffer and die. That death leads to the Re-birth and Resurrection of the soul. When the lower or animal man dies, the Son of man is born as Son of God, and his function of insight into the mystery of life — symbolized by Light — tells him: “I and the Father are One.”

The dilaceration Some other myths, forming special elaborations of the of the Son of same theme, are connected with the myth of Dionûsos. God. There is the story of Pentheus, a relative of Dionûsos who refused to recognize him as a God. His fate was to, be torn to pieces by the followers of the God, the Bacchantes, among whom was his own mother, who did not recognize him in her state of “ecstasy”. His “mother”, who did not recognize the truth of his identity, represents

his own veiled consciousness, the power of Mâyâ within his own soul, which engendered his actions in the world of the psyche. That factor worked his own undoing. It is dangerous not to recognize Divinity — so intimately related to us — especially if we are given an opportunity at close quarters. The factors or motives at the back of the incapacity or unwillingness to recognize Him will precipitate the soul into a (new) Fall.

The divine singer Orpheus, considered to be an incarnation of Dionûsos-Apollo, was also torn to pieces. Osiris was cut into fourteen parts, representing, as we shall see later, fourteen stages of the Path of the Fall.

Orpheus was identified with Dionûsos, and Dionûsos with Bakkhos. In Crete Dionûsos was identified with the Cretan Zeus. Herodotus (II, 114) identified Dionûsos-Bakkhos with the Egyptian God Osiris. He was further identified with the God Zagreus, representing the Underworld-Sun or the Sun in the Womb-stage of the Path, and with Apollo, the God of Light, representing the Sun in the opposite stage of the Path, centred in Leo. His "tomb" was shown in the inner sanctuary of Apollo's temple at Delphi. These wide identifications, extending even to Tammuz of Babylon, Attis of Phrygia, Mithra of the Medes, Eshmun of the Phoenicians, Adonai of Kanaan, Adonis of Greece, and God-Men of other traditions, show that the process of dilaceration, that is, fragmentation and separation, had at that time not yet advanced to the extent that it has in modern times, in which Christians, Muslims, Buddhists and others decry one another's beliefs. In the times when these God-Men were worshipped, people belonging to one tradition would travel far and wide in order to be initiated into the Mysteries of other religions. Wherever they went, they would find the Universal Tradition in a form suitable for the people of the country, and they would learn by comparing other traditions with their own, and so compliment them by filling up the missing links of understanding and obtaining the needed clues for insight.

The symbolism of the dilaceration of the Fallen Man is referred to in the parable of the good and the evil servant in St. Luke (12, 46). It is the fate of "the evil servant", the Fallen Man, to be cut in sunder. This is the fate of modern humanity even more than of the humanity of former ages.

The Resurrection of Dionûsos While the Titans were engaged in immolating and consuming the God Dionûsos in the form of a Bull, the Goddess Pallas Athênê appeared on the scene. This "virgin-born" and virgin Goddess represents the higher aspect of the Moon-Goddess which counterbalances the power of Mâyâ. Athênê succeeded in saving the heart of Dionûsos. The heart is the symbol

of the spiritual "core", which is immortal. The heart, representing the essential and spiritual being within the psyche, is, of course, beyond the reach of the Titans, who represent a lower plane. Athênê, Goddess of Wisdom, that is, of the Tradition, represents the power or faculty of Consciousness that pierces and knows Mâyâ, because it is "virgin" or desireless.

Athênê brought the heart to Zeus-Jupiter. Zeus became excited to anger and began a Battle with the Titans. He threw his Martian Thunderbolt at them and reduced them to ashes. The Battle between the Enlightener or Guru with the Ahankâric powers of the lower mind ultimately results in the victory of the Guru, representing the Intelligence of the function of faith and insight. The Thunderbolt gives "the flash of illumination" and destroys ignorance and sin.

After this follows Rebirth and Resurrection. Zeus swallowed the heart, and had the remains of Dionûsos carefully interred. Zeus is God of the Element Ether, the Sphere of Light; interment has reference to the Element Earth and to the Womb-stage of the Path. Interment in the Element Earth implies the period between physical death and re-incarnation, part of which is passed in (literally) a womb. It is evident that the symbolism of interment and resurrection applies both to physical matters, connected with re-incarnation, and to spiritual matters, symbolized by Resurrection.

Dionûsos was restored to his former life and glory-spiritually as Son of God, physically as Son of man. Another myth recounts that Zeus gave the heart of Dionûsos to his mother Sêmelê to eat, after which she gave birth to him for the second time. Dionûsos was also said to be a son of the Goddess Dêmêter, the Culture-Mother.

A tradition also teaches that from the ashes and fumes of the Titans' burned bodies Mankind was brought forth. Indeed, true Manhood is ever the end-product of the great Drama of Life. The end of the Battle between the Divine and the Titanic powers in the psyche brings the attainment of Manhood.

In the state of true Manhood the fragments of the soul—for a school of Gnostics the fragments of the Body of the Cosmic Christ—have been gathered and re-united in harmony, and thereby wholeness, haleness and holiness have been re-established.

5 THE SYMBOLISM OF WAR AND BATTLE

The great struggle in the psyche. On account of the fragmentation of the soul, symbolized by the dilaceration of Man, the psyche is the scene, not only of a struggle between the Gods and the Titans, representing the functions of spiritual life and the factors of form, but also between the human and the animal factors of the soul, representing aspects of the higher and the lower man

Mythology presents us numerous examples and aspects of struggle — as numerous as the psychological problems with which man has to grapple

The Monsters with which the spiritual hero has to fight, represent excessively Ahankaric developments of his "animal functions", connected with the lower mind, symbolized by the Element Fire. Sometimes Titans and Animals are welded into composite Monsters. These are not products of fiction, but psychological realities.

Basically the struggle is between the Divine Principle and the Ahankara, the "I-factor", creating separateness, egotism, egoism and sin. With the preponderance of Ahankâra a soul is bound on the Path of the Fall, and with the preponderance of the Divine Principle it walks the Return Path to God-Reality.

In Hindu tradition the struggle between the Gods or Angels and the Titans or Demons and Monsters is regarded from two angles of vision. From the point of view of sorrow and suffering, life is regarded as a bondage on the Wheel of Samsâra or as a struggling in the waves of the Sea of Samsâra. Samsâra, literally "erring, roaming", means the world of worldliness and "error". From the higher angle of vision of the sage, who sees "the illusion of things", that is, "the vanity of life", the struggle is *Lila* — a Divine Play.

The Great War that mythology gives us so many versions of, is a fight for supremacy. Visioned by the seers and prophets of all religions and traditions, described in so many mythological versions and sacred scriptures, dealt with in fairy-tales of all the world, it rages within the psyche of every man and woman, with the exception of those who have won victory and found peace.

According to psychological contexts and temperaments, the great struggle has many aspects and takes many forms. Sometimes it is a fight between Good and Evil or between God and Devil, sometimes between Creator and his Creation, God and Nature, sometimes between Knowledge of God-Reality and ignorance, sometimes between virtue or merit and sin.

or demerit; sometimes between heaven and hell; sometimes between Harmony and disharmony; sometimes between wholeness, holiness and health, and "partiality" and disease; sometimes between Oneness, Communion, and multiplicity, apartness; sometimes between Love and hate; sometimes between the Aham of God, the Self, and the Ahankâra; sometimes between Divine Will and self-will, between Law or Tradition, and lawlessness and disobedience; sometimes between Bliss and sorrow; sometimes between Dharma, that is, righteousness and duty, and Adharma, unrighteousness and selfish action; sometimes between faith and "the senses"; sometimes between a particular virtue and its corresponding sin; sometimes between Life and Death; sometimes between Light and Darkness; and so on.

The scene lies within and reflects without. Says a Śaiva Tantra: "That which appears without only so appears because it exists within." Plotinus said: "All that is Yonder is also Here." In the Zohar, a Cabalistic work, we read: "The inferior world has been created in the similitude of the superior", and "it appears here below like the reflection of an image."

If there is war in the outer world, it only results from the excessive struggle within the collective psyche of humanity. The traditional and scientific way to control war and restlessness in the world of social relations, is by strengthening the powers of the higher man and controlling "the raging passions" of the lower man — which everyone should do for himself.

The inseparable The Divine Play on the Merry-go-round of Life and relationships Death, consisting of the Great Wheel of the Zodiac with in the psyche. its twelve spokes, involves the mutual generation of

Gods and Titans and the bringing forth of parents by their children. Both these curious data are encountered in the mythical traditions. The psychological implications of these seemingly unreasonable data are clear. In human life "good" is invariable born out of "evil", and the reverse. The balance always tends to swing from one extreme to the other. Children giving birth to their parents has reference to the Path of Return to God-Reality. This can even be put into Christian terminology: Christ, the Universal Parent, must be born in the hearts of all.

Though the Gods and their Adversaries form two groups and though the second group forms the inverse reflection of the first, it is not possible to separate them with reference to the practical application of the scheme of the Zodiac. There they form part of an inseparable whole. When considering them, the spiritual function of the intuition, the Buddhi, should be continually used, for one must shift one's point of view from moment to moment, of from period to period (which is much the same) continually

to and fro between the inner and the outer, the higher and the lower, as the practical need requires

Buddhi has sometimes been rendered by "intellect" Because this word is generally used for the rational function, or for the rational plus the intuitive function, it has not been used for Buddhi in this work

It is the faculty of Buddhi or spiritual, intuitive, perception, which makes the soul aware of the intimate interrelationship of all things

The Seven Great Gods or Angels are not really separate Powers, each living their own life They are as intimately related as organs in a physical body, and, as will be shown later, these are indeed connected with them As in a physical organism, which is regaining health after an illness, the various organs return little by little to a harmonious co-operation of functions, so in the organism of the soul, which is regaining health and holiness on the Path of Return to God-Reality, the various Powers contribute little by little towards the state of Wholeness

In the Battle of Kurukshetra, the scene of the Bhagavad-Gitâ, the warriors fighting on both sides were, like the Titans and the Gods, intimately related, both by worldly ties of blood and spiritual ties of guru-and-discipleship

The struggle between the Titans and the Gods is reflected even in the field of religion, in the contention that goes on in degenerate traditions between priests, representing the form side of religion (in dogmas, creeds, rituals, organization, laws, conventions, customs, etc) and mystics and prophets, representing the life-aspect (in experience, mystical contemplation and insight, instrumentality of and obedience to the Spirit of the Tradition, and spontaneity of expression)

In the soul of the sages or mystics who have found the Peace of God-Reality, the form-side and the life-aspect of tradition are harmoniously at one For, in the words of Jesus (St Matthew 5, 17), they do not "come to destroy the law, or the prophets", but, on the contrary, "to fulfil" them The Tradition needs the vehicle of form — the letter — for the revelation and manifestation of its life - its meaning and its Spirit

In the early days of Christianity the Church recognized prophets, side by side with bishops and elders The bishops or ordained priests represented the form-side, the prophets, who were not ordained, the life-aspect, of the Church Originally a "prophêtês" was not a predictor of profane occurrences The word means, literally, "forth-teller" Prophets were originally, and should be at all times, the inspired spokesmen of the Tradition, representing its Word and Spirit

The absence of the propbetic element is co-existent with a dilacerated state of life

The individual and the mass-man In the traditional teachings there is a striking antithesis between the downward trend of humanity during the Fall, and the upward trend of the individual on the Path of Return. It is the pioneer-individual who uplifts, guides and ultimately redeems the dilacerated mass-man, within the psyche and in society. As there was no Fall without the agency of individualism, so there is no progress on the Spiritual Path leading to God-Reality and harmonious relations in society but for the agency of individuals. The individual is the bearer of culture and tradition. He alone is capable of sacrifice, renunciation and service. Ultimately it is he alone who redeems the mass-man. The paradox that the mass man is the individualist, and that the pioneer-individual on the Path of Return is the universalist, should be kept in mind.

The struggle between the spiritual individual and the mass man is going on continuously, in the soul and in the world, with crises occurring periodically. Experiences in time and space do not take place in an imperceptible steady progression. Psychical processes take place by leaps — as science has lately discovered with regard to material processes. Every adventure in consciousness has to undergo, as it were, the experiences of conception, growth in darkness, birth, growth in light, and death, again followed by another conception, birth or resurrection, and so on. Every happening forms a minor revolution, intimately connected with various time-cycles. The leaps take place in accordance with a complicated interrelationship of cyclic elements. The clock is the Zodiac, and its hands are the Sun, the Moon, and the Planets, representing the Intelligences and Powers of the psychical Universe.

The direction of the Path of Return of the individual factor is the opposite of the direction of the Fall of the mass factor (see Diagrams 1b and 9a). Every man is born on the Path and gets a chance to live in accordance with the sacred traditions of old. If he does not take the chance, he will contribute to the burden of humanity in the Fall. If he takes the chance, he will learn the lessons of the Return one by one and ultimately become a Redeemer — of the world of the psyche, within himself, inextricably connected with the collective psyche.

A look on the Diagrams shows us that the individual is conceived and born in the stage of the mass-man, that is, the Womb stage of the Path, extending over Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces. He begins with sharing the problems and troubles of his time, till he can face them as an individual and begin to liberate himself from them. The development of the individual proceeds from the Element Earth through Water and Fire to Air and Ether.

First comes the stages of physical growth, and next the emotional, intellectual and moral, and spiritual, stages. The traditional periods of the life-cycle, that run parallel to the periods of the year-cycle, the day-cycle, and the great cycle of the soul through many lives, are shown in Diagram 1b, from three aspects connected with three starting points. The four Āśramas or traditional stages and modes of life, of Hinduism, are the periods of youth, of the householder, of introversion, prayer, and moral battle, and of final renunciation of "worldliness", that is, Ahankāra.

The four stages correspond, in inverse order, to the stages of the Fall of Man, the Four Ages.

Bondage and self-control. The Solar Hero, on his Path, learns to control the rebellious factors of life. He unloosens the bonds of his bondage to them, and binds them with the bonds of faith and insight. King Solomon was said to have vanquished "the rebellious genii" and to have shut them up in the Pit or in metal vessels, sealing the exit with his Seal of God, which has the same form as the Chakra of Vishnu — a six-pointed star, consisting of two triangles (see Diagram 13). It will be shown later that the Pit, the metal vessel and the sixpointed star of Jewish and Hindu traditions are centred in Aquarius. The Pit or Deep is the Hell, and the Chakra or Seal of God symbolizes the Heaven of that stage — the former representing traditional and cultural bounds and bondage, the latter the expanse of the Tradition and the freedom it gives.

The Evil Genius of the Norse tradition, Loki, was bound in the same stage of Aquarius. The Fenris-Wolf was bound by the Gods, with very great trouble. The Giant Tiphôn, who revolted against the Gods, was bound in the Underworld-flames of Mount Etna. They represent different aspects of the Ahankāra. Rebellion against the Voice of God, the Tradition, leads to bondage, crucifixion, immolation, and suffering in "hell-fire".

Ultimately the soul suffers inexpressible woes in the Hell fire of its own making — the Fire it has stolen from Heaven. Its desires, delusions, passions and follies, aspects of the Seven Sins (see Diagram 4b), form the devils that torment it in the hell of "this world". The Wheel of the Zodiac then becomes the Wheel of Ixion, the Rack, the Mill of Fate, and the Cross. Vishnu flings his Martian Chakra and Jupiter his Martian Thunderbolt at the unrighteous, the deluded, the wicked, the forgetters of the "righteousness" of God-Reality. The tormenting flames of Hell belong to the Element Fire, the Lord of which is Mars. Their function is to bring man "to his reason". The Element Fire is the lower mind, the tendencies and passions of which should be controlled, instead of being allowed Ahankāric

free play. It is — as we shall see — the primal sphere of disobedience to the Voice of God, the Tradition, that manifests itself in that realm as “the voice of conscience”.

Peaceful and wrathful aspects of God. Towards the end of the Path the Gods reveal themselves to be more and more what they fundamentally are — Powers of Consciousness. In accordance with the

situation they assume peaceful or wrathful aspects. They put trials and tests of an awful nature before the pilgrim aspiring to the Heights, before they grant him their favour, their love, their insight, their power and their blessings. The most formidable of the Gods is the Moon-Goddess, for she represents the very dynamism of Consciousness itself. In the myths of Héraklès, Aeneas and others, the Moon, who rules the world of form and division, created by Consciousness, is represented by the Goddess Hêra, the Power of Máyâ, who puts endless difficulties in the way of the heroes.

The next most formidable of the Gods, in Ahankâric contexts, is Jupiter, the Lord of the Element Ether, the Sphere of Light. The Old Testament is full of references to his wrath, in the form of Jehovah.

The Great Battle. After the higher and the lower faculties within the psyche have become involved in the War of Life and Death, the struggle continues, with alternating success, till the bitter end. The only true peace is the Peace of God at the end of the Holy War within the soul.

The last Battle is traditionally conceived at the end of the Spiritual Path, in the stage of Scorpio and Sagittarius. It is then that a battle royal takes place between armies of virtues and sins, and it is also then, that the Solar Hero kills the Demon of the Deep, in the form of Horus killing the Crocodile, Sî Râma Râvana, Thêseus the Minotaur and Siegfried and the legendary St. George their Dragon.

The weapons used — the lance of spiritual discrimination, the sword of moral power, etc. — give a clue to the particular meaning of the myth under consideration, for each myth deals with a special psychological problem.

At the time of victory the hero on the battlefield within the psyche of every man kills the adversary that brought him worry and suffering. If, at the spiritual stage, represented by the winter solstice, he has not been successful in his spiritual and moral endeavours, he will again fall into the hands of the Adversary, known by many names in the traditions of the world — Satan, Mâra, the Tempter, the Devil — and representing Ahankâra.

6 THE SYMBOLISM OF SILENCE, VOICE AND WORD

Zeus-Jupiter-Indra-Guru. The struggle in the soul is presided over by the God, who is variously called Zeus, Jupiter, Indra, Tyr, Jehovah or Guru. His realm is the Element Ether, the Quintessence, the Sphere of Light, and he rules over faith and insight into the mystery of life.

The Mountain-top is universally connected with the Ether. The Mountain represents the World of Manifestation, and its Top, reaching beyond the clouds — symbolically connected with the Element Air, the Spirit — is the place from which Manifestation is surveyed and ruled. The top of Olympus was the abode of Zeus. Paradise is always conceived on a mountain top.

Indra, the Jupiter of the old Hindu religion, is the Lord of the Paradise of Hinduism, the Âkâśa or Ether, representing Heaven. He is represented as four-armed, signifying that the Four Elements are under his control. He is the Ruler of "the senses", which are called "Indriyas" — a word derived from his name. It is shown in Diagram 1, how the senses are symbolically connected with the Elements and the functions.

The name "Zeus" is related to "Jupiter" for "Djupiter", the nominative form of which is "Diespiter". These words are also related to the name of Zyaus Pitâ or Dyauh Pitâ, the "Heavenly Father" of the Vedas. From the root, meaning "luminous heaven", came the word "diês", meaning day. The English word "day" is not related to "dies", but comes from a root for "to burn", also existing in Sanskrit.

The word "Guru" means "heavy". The quality of weight, which is connected with the volume and the dimensions (see Diagram 1) is symbolically associated with the Ether-Sphere and hence with the Guru. Weight often determines value. "Weightiness" denotes importance and authoritativeness. The climb to the mountain-top is the "heaviest" of efforts and the task to attain the Guru's state is the most heavy (lit. intense) of endeavours. "Guru" is further said to mean "dispeller of darkness". In other words, Guru is Enlightener. Insight is enlightenment.

The Guru or Enlightener. The heavenly or inner Guru is represented in the world in the form of men who are Gurus to their disciples. Their function is to enlighten their disciples, till the Guru within their own soul shines forth. The relation of the function of faith and insight in the soul to the lower functions is that of a Guru to his disciples.

The very conception of "the Guru" is often misunderstood in our time,

because Gurus who are truly enlightened and have subjected the lower functions within themselves, are unfortunately very rare. Nowadays, a Guru is generally supposed to be, and generally is, in fact, nothing more than an instructor of philosophy and (what is deemed to be) "Yoga". There is no harm in this if the teacher is a man of pure and humble character. But if he has not purified himself of Ahankâra, he may do more harm than good to his follower. There may be serious consequences, if the so-called or self-styled "Guru" is a man who is out for "power", or who likes to dabble in secret rites and occult practices that increase egotism. There are also "Gurus" who impose upon others dogmas, beliefs, actions, and — worst of all — themselves. The law of supply and demand works on all planes. People obtain the type of leader or master they desire and deserve. For those who have pure spiritual aspirations, the traditional saying, "the Guru appears when the disciple is ready", applies.

The other traditional saying, "the Guru is God", can be understood from the fact that Guru is Zeus-Jupiter-Jehovah, the Enlightener.

The inner or divine Guru is projected in the outer world on a suitable person — for the purpose of the enlightenment of a disciple. Enlightenment is evoked in the disciple by the "participation mystique" of Guru and disciple.

It may not be out of place to remark that the emotional and intellectual links between Guru and disciple are secondary and form only reflections of the spiritual link. The purity of the Guru, that is, the lack of Ahankâric factors in his life, purifies the lives of those who live with him. The disciple who surrenders and annihilates his Ahankâra at the Guru's feet (to use the traditional expression), finds insight or enlightenment through the Guru's grace, which is the Grace of God. It is evident that faith in the Guru is of the highest importance, for it is faith that brings insight into the mystery of life, and the bliss of harmonization.

The Guru or Enlightener is the embodied Word, born from the Voice, representing the Tradition.

The Jupiter had the name of Tonans, the Thunderer. On
Thunderbolt. account of the Thunderbolt being his main symbol in
many traditions, he has often been confused with Mars

But the fact is that the Thunderbolt in the hand of Jupiter represents the
power of Mars. The Thunderbolt has numerous aspects, of which one is
important. The bolt or lightning represents the Martian Element Fire
a destructive or punitive aspect, or in the aspect of giving "the flash of
mination". The bolt or lightning is often conceived as the stroke of a hammer

whip For that reason the whip forms a parallel symbol The Archangel Jehudiel, who corresponds to Jupiter-Guru, holds a whip in his hand The thunder forms the second aspect to be noted It represents the reverberation of the Element Air Its threatening sound symbolizes the warning voice of the Spirit

The Element Air is the Sphere in which "the harmonies of the spheres" are heard If harmony is lacking, discordant sounds are produced Air and sound had been related by the seers of old ages before science discovered that sound was transmitted by air-vibration Both the musical "air" and the Element "Air" are derived from the same Latin and Greek word "Aer"

The Sound is indispensable for the expression of the Word The Speaker is God-Father, the Voice the Virgin-Mother, the Tradition, the Word the embodied Intelligence of the Ether-Sphere, and the Sound the Spirit, the Intelligence of the Element Air The Element Fire provides the intelligent articulation of the Word, the Element Water its emotional accentuation, and the Element Earth its incarnation

Jupiter, the Lord of the Ether-Sphere, is the Overlord of the Elements Air and Fire In the Thunderbolt the properties of these Elements are embodied

Jupiter had the title of "Pater omnipotens Aether". The Latins called the Aether "ignifer", that is, "fire-bearing"

The Thunderbolt is one of those symbols that exist in most traditions Occasionally it is replaced by the Whip or the Fire-Hammer Lei Kung, the Duke of Thunder of Chinese tradition, and Thor, the God of the Element Fire of the Norse tradition, wielded a Fire-Hammer In the last case it should be noted that Thor does not correspond to Jupiter, but forms the Intelligence of the symbol itself — he corresponds to Mars

Thor's Fire-Hammer is sometimes represented by the Svastika We have seen that this symbolizes an aspect of the Great Wheel of the Tradition, the Zodiac In this way it is related to one of the forms of the Thunderbolt in classical tradition, in which it is described as having twelve points — three of hail, three of rain, three of fire, and three of storm In them we recognize the Four Elements, from Earth to Air, and the three Signs of each of these Elements in the Zodiac

On a Chalkidian water-vessel of the middle of the 6th century B C, on which the battle of Zeus with Tiphôn is depicted, the Thunderbolt takes a form which closely resembles that of the Indian and Tibetan traditions Its two ends have the shape of an open lotus, while the two ends of the Eastern Thunderbolt have the shape of a closed lotus It is a scepter, a

symbol of Overlordship. It has already been noted that the Lotus is one of the symbols of the Divine Guru, the Lord of Heaven. The flower form of the Sceptre indicates that at the back of God's Almighty lies his Sweetness and at the back of his Justice his Mercy. In Hindu tradition the Thunderbolt is the Vajra or Mahâbâhu in the hand of Indra. In Tibetan-Buddhist tradition it is the Vajra or Dorje in the hand of the God who is called in Sanskrit Vajra-Dhâra and in Tibetan Dorje-Chang, "the Holder of the Thunderbolt". He is the Divine Guru.

There is an etymological relationship between the Latin "tono", to thunder, "thunder", "Thor" and "Donar", the Germanic name of Thor, the Sanskrit "tan", meaning to extend, to stretch out, and the word "tone", meaning note.

The Creative Word. The symbolism of the creative Word can be understood at the hand of Zodiacal traditions. Jupiter and Mars rule adjoining Signs of the Zodiac: first Pisces and Aries, and at the end, in inverse order, Scorpio and Sagittarius. In the beginning of the Path they are "creatively" engaged, and towards the end "destructively". Jupiter, watching over creation, presides over "the senses" in the pre-natal House of Pisces. He is the Law-giver at the Gate of Manifestation, marked by the vernal equinox. That is, he teaches by the Word of the Tradition. At the end of the Path he presides over the Great Battle, and teaches not by Word, but by Silence.

"Creative" has reference to the genesis of true manhood, the state of an integrated and harmonized personality, the spiritual and essential elements of which predominate over the lower elements. It does not apply to the creation of the material universe, except in so far the physical world forms the lowest "element" that is created.

The birth of the manifested world is traditionally conceived as coming with the sunrise. When the sun rises, consciousness takes the place of unconsciousness, and the world suddenly becomes visible. Symbolically that time is the time of Resurrection and Revelation. In this connection the parallel symbolism of dawn in the day-cycle and spring in the year-cycle should be studied (see Diagram 1b).

In all traditions the Resurrection and Revelation of the Word of the Tradition is connected with the time of the vernal equinox. What is this Word? It is not the mere, meaningless, combination of letters and sounds. It does not represent "the letter of the Law". The Word is *the meaning* of the Tradition, entering Manifestation. The word "Logos" or Word means "Meaning". The symbolism of the Word is associated with the symbolism

of vision, insight and enlightenment, and their practical consequences in the World

Since the conception of the Word has lost its meaning, which is Meaning itself, that is, the meaning of the symbolism of the Tradition, dealing with the meaning of life, all human traditions have lost their meaning, and therefore their bearing on practical life in the world — for insight into the meaning of things is the most potent factor for changing life for the better

Let us consider a few traditional conceptions The Vedic God Rudra sprang from the forehead of Brahmâ, the Creator, in a virgin form of birth, according to the Vishnu Purâna He then divided his nature into male and female, and next multiplied each of these into eleven persons With the original form these represent the Twelve Signs of the Zodiac Rudra is sometimes identical with the God of Fire This means, that he belongs to the Fire-House of Aries, ruled by Mars Originally he was both a destructive Deity who brought diseases and a beneficent Deity who had healing powers The Word of the Tradition works destructively on the Path of the Fall, and heals the soul on the Spiritual Path

In another myth the mother of Rudra was Ushas, the Goddess of Dawn, who also represents Aries In yet another tradition, found in the Vishnu Purâns, it is said that Brahmâ desired a son and that Rudra came into existence as a youth He cried and asked for a name Brahmâ gave him the name of "Rudra" This word is from the root "rud", meaning to cry, to roar It forms an aspect of the Word The asking for a name signifies the asking for the rational meaning of the mystery of self After the youth had been named Rudra, he cried seven times more and so obtained seven other names These apply to different stages of the Path

Creation, that is, activity, conceived in connection with consciousness on the Spiritual Path, is indicated in the root "Cr" or "Kr" The Latin "creo" means to produce, make, bring forth, beget, create "Crescent" means growing, "increasing" The Crescent Moon is a universal symbol of Creation, that is, of the dynamic power of Consciousness The crescent Moon is traditionally connected with the stage of Pisces and Aries, as we shall see later The name of the Titan of Aries is "Krios", the Ram (see Diagram 1b) "Kronos", Time, is the Titan at the very beginning of the Path of Creation or Genesis The Sanskrit "Kṛiyā" indicates the dynamic aspect of Consciousness, "Krama" means proceeding, course, series, regular and uninterrupted succession and order (compare with "Kronos"), and "Karma" signifies action, and the action, including reaction, that is a result of that action Other words, fundamentally representing aspects of the creative power or process of Consciousness on the Spiritual Path, or,

in other words, relating to the Tradition, might be added to the list.

The creative Word has sound and meaning, that is, spirit and meaning. In the first Chapter of Genesis we read repeatedly "God said" and "God saw". The Hindu conception is Śabdārtha, which is composed of Śabda, meaning sound, and Artha, implying thought-meaning. The Śabdārtha or "Sound-Meaning" manifests as the Nāma-rūpa or "Name-form". This applies to the world-of-name-and-form of the intellectual function. The Śabdārtha corresponds to the Logos (Word), which has been said to be inseparable thought-word-meaning.

We shall see later that the Word of the Tradition is always revealed at the time of the vernal equinox, between Pisces and Aries. This revelation is its resurrection. The symbolism of the trumpet, calling the soul to resurrection from death, also pertains to Aries. The Hebrew "yobel" meant ram. It was the ramshorn trumpet which was blown at the New Year's festival of the Jews, celebrating the renewal of the Universe as well as of the human soul. (That this festival is celebrated at another period of the year is another matter.)

The Logos has been identified with the secret name of Zeus, which should not be uttered (Heracl. Eph. Rell. LXV). According to Plutarch, it was the secret name of the First God in Egypt, namely Amen. Amen was Zeus-Jupiter. Jupiter is the Ruler of Pisces. Sacred to him was the Ram, the animal of Aries, ruled by Mars. The flame-coloured Ba-en-Ded was an Egyptian form of the Ram. This Ram was considered to be the source of creative energy for Gods and men. We can understand this from the fact that it symbolized the meaning of the Tradition, the risen Word. It will be shown later that the search for the Golden Fleece symbolized the search for the lost meaning of the Tradition — like Rudra asking for his name.

The symbolism of the Ram of the Rising Sun is more ancient than the Egyptian tradition in the forms which are now known. It has been discovered in prehistoric rock pictures in North Africa, as on Djebel Bes Saba in Kabyl country, where a man is depicted, standing in the attitude of prayer with uplifted arms before a Ram with the Sun above its head. The present-day Kabyl still knows that the Ram "taught the proper time to sow", and is "the articulator of the Year". We shall see later, that "sowing the seeds" is traditionally done in Taurus and that therewith the process of "culture" on the Spiritual Path begins. As is always the case, the symbolism is derived from the natural processes that take place in the material world.

The same Ram is connected with the Jupiter-Ammon of the Oasis Siwa. Ammon is a corruption of Amen. Jupiter-Ammon represents the combination of the symbolic propensities of Pisces and Aries, the Signs, respectively,

of Jupiter, the *hidden*, and Mars, the *articulated*, Word. The word "Amen" became also united to the name of the Sun-God Ra in the word "Amen-Ra". The Sun rises in Aries. The Egyptian Amen, "the Hidden One", is related to the Amen of Hebrew tradition, from which the Christian Amen came. Amen meant "the true, the certain, the faithful" in Hebrew. It is evident that this can only apply to the Word of the Tradition, revealed on the Spiritual Path, and resurrected within the soul. Amen becomes in Manifestation the "So be it" of the Tradition, and the faith arising out of the depths of Being. The symbolism of the sacred Word of the Hindu tradition, OM (written AUM), will be dealt with later.

The symbolism of the Creative Word, having reference to the embodied spirit and meaning of the Tradition, that is, insight into the symbolism of the Tradition, and the resultant insight into the problems of life, is inextricably connected with the Intelligence and Power of the Ether-Sphere, known as Zeus, Jupiter, Jehovah, Jehudiel or Guru.

In this connection we can understand that at the beginning of the Path, Jupiter manifests himself as Law-giver — instances of which will be given later — and at the end of the Path as Guru, teaching by means of "silence".

Word and Silence.

The uttering of the Word at the beginning of the Path, in Aries, is followed by a steady increase of the power of the Word, till it reaches its full strength in summer. After that its strength begins to decrease, till ultimately it vanishes in Silence. Jupiter, as Ruler of Sagittarius, is the Guru giving the Silence-initiation. It is the Silence of the Speaker of the Word — the Supreme — about Whom or Which nought can be said or should be said. It is the Silence of God Reality.

The Word is born in the negative silence of a complete absence of insight into the mystery of life, and ultimately passes away in the positive Silence of perfect Self-realization. Both, opposite, forms of "silence" pertain to the same region of the Zodiac, in which both the beginning and the end of the Spiritual Path are conceived.

In the beginning of the Path the Word implies "So be it" in the sense of "fiat", meaning "be it done", and at the end of the Path the Silence of the Word directs to the "So be it" in the sense of the return to Being or God Reality. According to various traditions the sacred Word should be whispered into the ear of a disciple by his Guru. In other words, the Guru conveys "the voice of the silence" rather than instruction. This symbolism has been generally interpreted as implying mere secrecy. In Jewish tradition the utterance of the four-lettered Name of God, YHVH, that is,

Jehovah, is prohibited. Its pronunciation has been said to be blasphemy. On the Day of Atonement alone the Name of God was spoken by the High Priest in the Temple. Actually, perfect pronunciation of the Word means representing the Word and being the Word — something which only a perfect Man, a Son of God, could embody. Wrong pronunciation, that is, wrong interpretation, of the Word, would be blasphemy.

The Name which is given in the beginning, representing the moral and thought-aspect of the Word, is ultimately given up. At the beginning of the Spiritual Path names are very important, later they cease to count, and finally they are renounced altogether. Definitions and literal interpretations make place for symbols and these to ever profounder symbols, till ultimately all merge and vanish in Silence.

In India, the highest form of "initiation" a Guru can give, is Mouna-diksha or "Silence-initiation". It passes straight from soul to soul, without intermediary of word or touch or rite. Mantra-diksha or initiation by word, and other forms of initiation, have reference to the lower psychical functions. Silence-initiation is the highest. Mouna or Silence is the Essence of the Word. The essential meaning cannot be conveyed by means of word.

The syllables of the Word. In the Hebrew book, Sepher Yezirah, it is written that God created the world by means of the letters of his Name, YHVH, that is, Jehovah or Jahveh. This applies to the world of the psyche, including the physical world, of a person on the Spiritual Path, the Path of the Genesis of true Manhood. The parallel traditions in other religions will be dealt with later.

The words Amen, OM, Allāh and YHVH are composed of syllables or letters, symbolizing the states of consciousness, connected with the various Elements and periods of time connected with regions of space. Though the Names or Words are different, the basic tradition dealing with the symbolic meaning of their component parts, is the same, as will be shown later.

The Speaker and the Voice are ever the same, but Word varies in accordance with the characteristics of time and place. From time to time "a new name" arises and "a new song" bursts forth.

Word and Name should not be confused. The Name forms the rational aspect of the Word. The Sound is the spiritual aspect of the Word. The Word itself represents the harmonious combination of "all elements" of the soul — the Elements Earth, Water, Fire and Air, presided over by the Element Ether, which the Word represents par excellence.

Speaker, Voice and Word. Furthermore Word and Voice should not be confused and Word. The Voice is the Mother and the Word the Son

Speaker, Voice and Word are mentioned in the following sentence of Philo of Alexandria "He who drives the chariot of the Powers is the Logos (Word) and He who is borne in the chariot is He who speaks, giving commandment to the Driver for the right driving of the Universe" He-who-speaks is the Father, also symbolized by the title of Supernal Sun, representing God-Reality, the Self The voice giving Commandment is the Mother, representing pure, unveiled Consciousness giving the Tradition for the guidance of the soul She is the Moon-Goddess The Driver is the Word, the Intelligence of the Ether-Sphere, Zeus-Jupiter-Guru, ruling the lower Elements The Chariot represents the World of Manifestation, consisting of the four lower Elements Its four wheels symbolize the courses of the four Rulers, Mercury, Mars, Venus and Saturn, through the Path of the Zodiac The Universe is not the material cosmos but the entire World consisting of Seven Spheres All the data will be substantiated later

The Voice and the other elements of symbolism were each called a *Dunamis*, meaning a "Moving Power" This word corresponds to the Hindu "Śakti" Only the Speaker is no *Dunamis* The Voice, the Word, etc., are Moving Powers of the Speaker

The Voice was called *Phônê* — It is significant of the one-sided mentality of the present age, how words as *Phônê*, *Dunamis*, *Phusis*, etc., are used exclusively in the domain of rational thought and mechanics, and have survived in physics, telephone, phonetics, dynamics, logic, etc *Phusis* is Nature The physical world, material nature, is only the outermost of her manifestations

In the *Kôrê Kôsmôn*, a Hermetic scripture, we read "The God laughed and said "Let *Phusis* come into being!" And the Female, the primevally powerful Beauty, came out of his Voice, and when the Gods saw her, they were enraptured with astonishment and admiration" When Nature is seen in the light of Consciousness, at the hand of the symbolism of the Tradition, it becomes a source of wonder and admiration to all the faculties of the soul

To return to the above-quoted sentence of Philo — it is clear that his sentence has reference to the Sun-God and his chariot

In some traditions the Sun-God has a charioteer, representing the Logos In the old Hindu religion, *Sûrya*, the Sun-God, has a driver called *Aruna* This word means "the red, the ruddy light" *Aruna* is the Dawn — that is, the Dawn of Light, in Aries Aries is a Fire-Sign, ruled by Mars, the Intelligence of the Element Fire

The symbolism of the Chariot, the Car and the Wain will be referred to later, in many contexts. When dealing with it, we should always remember that the physical body is the vehicle of the soul, and that the soul is the vehicle of the Self, God-Reality.

In the sentence of Philo, the Driver of the Chariot is the Christ, "the light of men", because he is the Light of the Sun, the Quintessence.

Zeno called the Word "the Mind of Jupiter". Jupiter is the Intelligence of the Ether-Sphere, the Enlightener. The Word is the Light.

The Voice. In most traditions the Voice of God is represented by
Vâch. Aditi. a Goddess. The Word, however, is "male". The Voice speaks the Word, the Moon-Goddess, as Virgin Mother, gives birth to the Son of God.

In the Rig-veda the Voice appears in the form of the Goddess Vâch. This word, meaning voice and eloquence, is etymologically related to the Latin "vox" and the English "voice". She is called "Queen of the Gods" and it is said that she "entered into the Rishis" and that she makes the man she loves great and intelligent, a priest and a Rishi. A Rishi is a Sage, a Son of God. It is evident that she represents the Intelligence of the Tradition. This is also clear from the reference in the Taittiriya Brâhmana in which she is called "the Mother of the Vedas", for the Vedas embody the Tradition of the Vedic Indians.

She was "generated by the Gods" (Rig-veda). The Tradition belongs to the Spiritual Path.

The Rig-veda also describes her as "the melodious cow who milked forth sustenance and water", "who yields us nourishment and sustenance." There is a tradition, in which the Voice is parallel to the Water of Life, and the Word to the Bread of Life. Instances from several religions will be given later. The tradition is the Water of Life and *produces* the Bread of Life.

The Taittiriya Brâhmana also says that Vâch is "the wife of Indra, who contains within herself all worlds." We have seen that Indra is Jupiter, the Overlord of the Five Elements. In many traditions there is a marriage-relationship between the Intelligences of the Moon-Sphere and the Ether-Sphere.

The Brâhmanas mention that Vâch is associated with Prajâpati, "the Progenitor", in the work of creation. The Progenitor is the Intelligence of the Process of Genesis, that is, the genesis of true Manhood on the Spiritual Path. Prajâpati is a form of Brahmâ, the Creator.

The Mahâbhârata also calls Vâch "the Mother of the Vedas", and says, "A Voice derived from Brahmâ entered into the ears of them all; the

celestial Sarasvatî was then *produced from the heavens*" The sense of hearing is the sense symbolizing the spiritual function (see Diagram 1) Sarasvatî, one with Vâch, is now generally called Vâgîśvarî, "the Voice-Goddess" She is the Consort of Brabmâ, and has a number of names — Sâvitri Brâhmanî, Gâyatri, and others, each representing a particular aspect of the Śakti of the Tradition The places of Brahmâ and Sarasvatî are in Cancer and Leo, the Houses in which Voice and Word are at their mightiest Cancer is ruled by the Moon and Leo by the Sun Sun and Moon represent the Duality of the Moon-Sphere, as we shall see later Sarasvatî is worshipped as the Goddess of Wisdom — the wisdom of the Tradition which is the great constructive factor in the genesis of Manhood on the Spiritual Path

The Goddess Vâch is identified with the important Goddess Aditi, in the Rig-veda "Aditi" signifies "the indivisible, the infinite, liberation" She is described as follows in the Rig-veda (Samhitâ I, 6, V) "Aditi is the Heaven, Aditi is the Antarksha (the inner region, the mid-region), Aditi is Mother, Father, Son, Aditi is the Viśvadevas (All-Gods, Universe Gods) and the Pañcha-Janâ (the Five Kins), Aditi is Generation and Birth" This verse describes all the fields of influence of the Tradition, liberating men from bondage and moulding them into true Men The Five Kins form, as we shall see later, the aspects of life in the Five Elements

In the Rig-veda Aditi is also called Deva-mâtri, "the Mother of the Gods", and she is invoked for blessings, for protection, and for forgiveness She was a Deity of the greatest importance Terracotta images of her are among the most ancient images found in India In her rested the power to redeem men from sin and suffering Only the Intelligence of the Tradition, the Queen of Heaven, can do this

Aditi was the Mother of Âditya, the Solar Logos of the Veda, who has six or seven forms, as applying to the Six or Seven Spheres, or twelve forms, referring to the stages of the Spiritual Path connected with the Twelve Signs of the Zodiac They are dealt with in the Book of Stars

The antithesis of the Goddess Aditi is Diti, "finiteness, bondage", who is also mentioned in the Rig-veda, and is the mother of the Daityas or Titans also called Asuras

The Voice of the Tradition is always countered by the Anti-Traditional Voice The two Voices are contrasted beautifully in the Proverbs of Solomon Chapters 2—10 "The Lord giveth wisdom out of his mouth cometh knowledge and understanding" (2, 6) This is the Voice of the Spiritual Path "Does not wisdom cry? and understanding put forth her voice? Unto you, O men, I call, and my voice is to the sons of men" (8, 1, 4) The Voice of the Path of the Fall is that of "the strange woman" with the

attire of a harlot . . . With her much fair speech she caused him to yield, with the flattering of her lips she forced him." (7; 5,10,21).

The world of the Fall is symbolized by "the wilderness". "The voice of one crying in the wilderness" represents the Voice of the Tradition, announcing the Word. St. John the Baptist represented that Voice, when he announced the Christ, in the Wilderness of the world in his time. The sentence, derived from Isaiah, occurs at the beginning of the Gospel of St. Mark, which is traditionally related to the stage of the Zodiac of Leo. The voice of the Baptist reflects the roar of the Lion — standing for rulership over "the animal nature" — in the wilderness of Ahankâra.

7. THE VISION OF THE UNIVERSE-FORM

The Fullness and the Voidness. We have seen that the Voice is at its mightiest in the stage of Cancer and Leo, and that the opposite stage of the Universe, Capricorn and Aquarius, forms the stage of Silence. In a parallel manner the first stage is expressive of the Fullness of Life, and the second of the Voidness. As "silence", according to the context, is either negative or favourable, even so is "voidness". It can be either fully negative, as in "the earth was . . . void" (Genesis 1; 2), or positive, as the Nirvâna of Hindu and Buddhist traditions, defined as "Śunya" or "Emptiness", symbolizing the supreme Peace of the ultimate stage, corresponding to the Rest of the seventh Day of Genesis. This Peace or Rest forms the opposite of the stage of full activity, of Cancer and Leo, forming the summer-period. In the winter-period the world is at rest.

On the Spiritual Path the stage of the Silence and Voidness and Rest is the stage of the Mystery and of the Depth. The opposite stage, of the full power of the Voice and the greatest activity of Life is symbolically the stage of the Height of Manifestation. These data will be substantiated continually in the material which follows.

"Vision" is insight into the meaning of the Tradition and into the meaning of life at the hand of the Tradition. In Leo vision is insight into the World-Form, in Capricorn it is insight into "the vanity of things" and the fundamental mystery of life. "Vision" is symbolically associated with the Ether-Sphere. This Sphere is associated with Leo and Capricorn in a particular context which will appear later (see Diagrams 2 and 5).

Vision of the Universe-Form. Vision of the great Scheme of Life and Death, of the Tradition, is reached in the intellectual and moral stage of the Path — represented in a man's life by his "summer period", between his 21st and 42nd years (see Diagram 1b)

How small a man feels when he looks through a powerful telescope at the immensity of the *material* universe The emotional reaction of feeling the vastness of the Universe *of the psyche* may be overwhelming Rational insight into the Scheme of the Tradition, dealing with the world of the psyche, including the material universe, and including the science of symbolism, may at first be overpowering Spiritual understanding of the symbolic implications may at first be almost more than a person is able to bear

The disciple Arjuna, whose experience of the Viśvarūpa, the Universe Form of the Tradition, has been laid down in the Eleventh Chapter of the Bhagavad Gita, cries out in utmost terror "My inmost self is quaking Have mercy, O Lord of the Gods!" The World-Form is shown to him by his Guru, Krishna, who (as every Guru or Enlightener), represents Jupiter, the Intelligence of the function of insight, and is "the Lord of the Gods"

The narrator says "If the effulgence of a thousand suns were to shine at once in the sky, that might resemble the splendour of that Great Being Then the son of Pandu saw the entire Universe resting in one, with its manifold divisions, in the body of the God of Gods, . . . Arjuna said 'O God! in Thy body I see all the Gods, as well as multitude of all kinds of beings, the Lord Brahma, seated on the lotus-throne, all the Sages and all the Celestial Serpents O Lord of the Universe, O Universal Form, I see Thee with manifold arms, trunks, mouths and eyes, boundless on every side, neither do I see Thy beginning, nor middle, nor end The heavens and the earth and all the regions in between are filled by Thee alone At the sight of this, Thy marvellous and awful Form, O Great-souled One, all the Three Worlds are panic struck Having seen Thy mighty Form

the worlds are terrified, and so am I, O Vishnu! My inmost self is quaking at seeing Thee reaching the Firmament Have mercy, O Lord of the Devas, O Abode of the Universe On every side, all-swallowing, fiery-mouthed, thou lickest up the worlds Thy blazing rays, O Vishnu, are burning the Universe with radiance Reveal Thyself! What terrible Form hast Thou? To Thee, Supreme of Devas, salutation! Have mercy! Thine inner Being I desire to know, for indeed Thy purpose I do not understand" The Element Fire symbolizes the creative, intellectual function Its manifestation easily evokes terror Brahmā represents the creative power of the Tradition, and gets special mention Arjuna stresses

that he desires to know the *inner* Being. The purpose of the World of Form he does not yet clearly understand.

The Blessed Lord replies to his query: "I am the mighty World-Destroyer Time, made manifest for the purpose of unfolding worlds." In other words, the Scheme of the Zodiac, made manifest for the purpose of unfolding worlds as stages on the Spiritual Path, and of destroying the mental darkness of the Fall — *Mâyâ*.

Arjuna continues: "O Lord of the Senses, it is right that the world delights and rejoices in Thy praise. The Demons fly with fear and the hosts of the Perfect Ones bow down to Thee in adoration. . . . O Boundless Form, Thou art the Primal Deity, the Ancient Man, Thou art the Supreme Refuge of the Universe; Thou art the Knower, the One to be known and the Supreme Abode. By Thee alone this Universe is pervaded . . . Prostration to Thee before, behind and on every side, again and again, O All! Thou, infinite in power, immeasurable in strength, pervadest all, therefore Thou art All. . . . Overjoyed am I to have seen what I have never seen before, yet my mind is distracted with terror. Show me, O God, O Lord of Devas, Thine familiar Form. Have mercy, O Refuge of the Universe." The mind of Arjuna, overwhelmed by the vastness and complication of life and of the Tradition, yearns for the simplicity of the familiar, and for the simplicity that lies at the core of all complication.

Finally the Lord reveals that "Neither by (study of) the Vedas, not by austerities, nor by sacrifice, can I be seen as thou hast seen Me; But by single-hearted devotion alone can I be known in this Form, O Arjuna, and perceived in Essence and also entered into." Knowledge of scripture spiritual and practices and rituals do not give insight into the vast world of the psyche and the Tradition dealing with that world. The Christian equivalent of the needed "Single-hearted devotion" is the Immortal Virtue of Faith in continuous watchfulness. It is faith that leads to insight or vision (see Diagram 1). The study of the symbols, which have been omitted here, is enlightening.

The disciples Peter, James and John saw the Cosmic form of Jesus on the mountain-top. It is described in St. Matthew 17; 1—8, St. Mark 9; 2—8 and St. Luke 9; 28—36. "They fell on their face and were sore afraid." For a heavenly Voice made itself heard, affirming the Sonship of Jesus in the light of the traditions of old, represented by Moses and Elias. The transfiguration of the Lord is celebrated on August sixth, which is exactly in the middle of the Leo-period, ruled by the Sun. Jesus was "transfigured before them: and his face did shine as the sun." (St. Matthew 17; 2). August sixth is the date of the climax of the year and of the Pole of Manifestation

(see Diagrams 1b and 8) The "high mountain apart" (17, 1) is a typical symbol of this Pole, as we shall see later. The "vision" connected with the Leo period (17, 9) is mentioned, for instance, in Diagram 5.

Another aspect of the Cosmic Man is expressed by Origen: "As our body while consisting of human members is yet held together by one soul, so the Universe is to be thought of as an immense living being which is held together by one soul, the power of the Logos, God." "The Universe" is not the material world, with its countless stars and solar systems, but the all-inclusive world of the psyche.

Egyptians, Greeks, Apocalyptics, Gnostics, Cabalists and representatives of other traditions have described their vision of the Universal Form or Being in their own grand symbols, the purer and truer where it was less affected by material conceptions.

Vision of the World-Form implies insight into the basic unity and linking of the great traditions of the world. All the various schools of traditional psychology and theology — Vedic, Zoroastrian, Jewish, Hindu, Taoist, Buddhist, Christian, Muslim and others — are members of the One Tradition-Body of the Lord.

In the course of time the vision of the Universal Form has been lost and its conceptions have become vague and partial.

But, as many traditions teach, from age to age the vision is recaptured.

Spiritual vision and psychic visions	The Great Wheel ever turns, and life moves on. Psychical fixation is against the law of movement. The aspirant for a greater and truer life is always warned not to remain attached to institutions, beliefs and habits, dogmas and rites, after they have served their purpose. There is a Hindu saying: "It is good to be born in a sect, but it is bad to die in it." Symbols live and change into others or are succeeded by others. Even the forms of the Gods change. Proclus wrote (Ennead I, 6, 9): "The Gods assume many forms and change from one to another, now they are manifested in the emission of shapeless light, now they are of human shape, and anon appear in other and different forms." The reason is that even the <i>form</i> of the Gods is Titanic or Ahankâric in character. Also for this reason the Gods reveal themselves as shape-changers. The rational function clings to form, because forms are easier to "grasp" than light. It is the experience of those who have a spiritual vision of a divine Being, that if curiosity prompts them to try and see some detail of form, their vision immediately comes to an end. Psychic experiences on the other hand are usually visions of Titanic or Ahankâric factors that are clear-cut in their details of form and lend themselves willingly for
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inspection. Spiritual visions of Gods or Angels consist of "light" and life and inexpressible elements. Hence the spiritual and psychological Teachers of all ages and religions have warned their disciples against visions, because a highly purified mind and intuition are needed for their correct interpretation. Furthermore even the greatest visions convey their message only for the time when they come. Ultimately, when true Vision or contemplation of the Self, begins, all visions come to an end. For ultimately all Gods or Angels with their symbols merge into one Ocean of Light. Hence the great Râja-Yogî Patañjali — like so many others — warned against "overtures of divine beings" which might entrap and fix the aspirant and prevent his ultimate attainment of true contemplation. The Demchog Tantra gives the warning: "Gods are but symbols representing the various things which occur on the Path, such as the helpful impulses and the stages attained by their means." This sentence was written for the soul well grounded in faith and experience, and not for the rationalistic mind shut out from the light of spiritual experience and apt to exclaim: "You see, the Gods are not real, they are 'only symbols'!"

Sometimes inner experiences or desires imprint themselves in the consciousness of a lower function, causing "day-visions" associated with the physical eyes, or "dream-visions" by means of "astral" eyes. Such "visions" have generally little value, being mainly Ahankâric in nature. They may easily be misunderstood by the experiencer, which may have undesirable effects. Hence the traditional teachings warn against "visions" of such a kind, which are but psychic phenomena. Very often they are but twisted reports from the inner Battlefield, which have eluded the censorship of the Spirit. They may be of use only to the psychiatrist or the priest as a clue to the mental and emotional problems of the persons concerned.

The All both a The Gods or Angels are emanations, aspects and attributes of GOD, and should be regarded and worshipped as a substratum. in this light. Śrî Krishna said in the Bhagavad Gîtâ:

"He who worships the Gods goes to the Gods, but he who worships Me, comes to Me." Jehovah said: "Thou shalt have no other Gods before me." Many myths deal with the subject of over-attachment to some particular God to the exclusion of others, signifying fixation in a particular psychical function. In such a case the Gods representing the higher functions stand out in myths by their "jealousy", as occurs with Hêra, Jehovah and Śiva. The ideal to be strived for is the harmonious relationship of all functions, under the rulership of the higher. All Gods should be given their due, in their own way, relating to the functions they preside over. On

the Spiritual Path the process of harmonization and integration of personality is gradually accomplished. At its end the Nameless GOD is worshipped in Silence and Peace. It has been indicated as God-Reality and the Self.

In Christian theology the distinction is made between *Latreia*, worship due to God alone, and *Dulia*, worship of (images of) Christ and the Virgin, Saints and Angels. The latter is called *Proskunêsis* in Greek. The worship of the qualified kind leads to the worship of the unqualified God. Gods or Angels represent aspects or powers of God on the stages of the Path leading to God-Reality. One goes to the Father through the Son, and to the Son through the Mother.

Ultimately the One, which is the whole, is re-attained, after its fragments have been re-collected. In the first place It is that which is prior to parts. It is Reality, Parabrahman, the Absolute. Not only is It prior to parts, but It also subsists in the parts. In the *Gîtâ* the Lord is "the beginning, the middle and the end". In the Revelation of St. John He is "the Alpha and Omega", "which is and which was and which is to come". It subsists in the parts in Its Fullness. It is the "Infinity in a grain of sand" of Blake. It is *Âtmâ*, the Self of all beings, dwelling in "the Heart". "smaller than the small, greater than the great, is the *Âtma* dwelling in the hidden cave" (*Kathopanishad* II, 20). The One is found in the Whole after the parts have been collected, harmonized and synthesized. In the highest Sphere the Whole is One, the Substratum, on the lowest plane it is a sum-total.

Insight into the sum-total of psychical contents is traditionally centred in the stage of Leo, and insight into the substratum of life in the stage of Aquarius. These are the stages of the Fullness and the Voidness. In the Hindu tradition "the Self" is the substratum of the psyche. In the conceptions of the Zurich school of analytical psychology, on the other hand, "the Self" indicates a sum-total of contents.

There are many stages on the way to the "discovery" or uncovering of the One — Eternal, Immovable, Unchanging — and the experience of the mystery of God-Reality, when the soul reaches the state of realizing that "I and the Father are One", which the Hindus call the attainment of *Advaita* or "Non-dualism". During these stages the seekers and aspirants on the Path of Return have to learn — and to unlearn — many things. This learning and unlearning can be accomplished successfully only by those people who realize that they do not apply to objective matters of knowledge, but to the very elements of their own personality. They will read the Signs on the horizons of their life and gather the fragments of themselves. They will engage courageously in the Holy War against the *Ahankara*.

Ultimately the Light of the Tradition will help them to attain Victory. Then they will know and enjoy Peace.

8. MISCELLANEOUS SYMBOLISM BASED ON THE FIVE ELEMENTS

The Elementals. In the former sections a few of the most important conceptions of traditional psychology have been mentioned and the great Scheme of the Tradition has been indicated in general outlines. Now, somewhat as an anti-climax to "the vision of the World-Form", let us begin to consider numerous details of symbolism. Only after sufficient traditional details have been dealt with, can the more important mythological teachings be studied successfully.

The main task before everyone is that of learning to control the elements of life. The traditional expression is that one must learn to control the Elements and the Elementals. The Elementals are the "nature spirits", "genii" or "fairies", connected with the Elements Earth, Water, Fire and Air, and represent particular part-aspects of the human soul. In the Western world they are called the Kobolts or Gnomes, representing the Element Earth, the Nymphs or Undines, representing the Element Water, the Salamanders, representing Fire, and the Sylphs, representing the Air. The names are known from the fairy-tales of our childhood, many of which, if the proper key is applied to them, reveal psychological hints of great significance. They appeal to the child, whose rational faculty has not yet begun to obsess and possess his soul to the detriment of the other functions.

The Gods of the Four Elements have each again four aspects, according to the Four Elements. The Gods of the Seven Spheres, including the Four Elements, have each seven aspects. Hence one comes across the numbers 16 and 49, which will receive consideration later. Subsidiary to the Gods are the Elementals, the Titanic Powers. They are either the multiplied elaborations and powers of the Gods or of the Adversaries. In traditional contexts the Elementals are hence said to be well-disposed or inimical to humanity. Some are malignant in character, according to the Ahankâric elements in the psyche.

The Five Elements. The forms and symbols of these "hosts of the spheres" vary according to the tradition and change with the needs of time and occasion. A comparative study of them reveals relatively small variations and changes in form, covering a basic similarity. Their Rulers are but aspects of the Gods of the Elements and

Spheres Hindu tradition calls the Elements the Bhûtas or Mahâbhutas. Apart from "Element", the word Bhûta means furthermore "elemental, nature-spirit, ghost," and is also applied to "any creature". It also means "material substance". All these things are indeed implied in the real meaning of "Elemental". The Hindu Bhûta-yajña or "sacrifice to Bhûtas" is traditionally said to include Gods (Devas), ancestors (Pitris), animals, birds, worms and other creatures. The Five Elements, from Earth to Ether, are called in the Gîtâ (VII, 4) Bhumi, Ap, Anala, Vâyu and Kha. But generally they are called Prithvî, Âp, Agni, Vâyu and Âkâśa. Sometimes Seven Elements are mentioned instead of five, in order to include the Lunar and Solar Spheres. In that case Âkâśa is subdivided into three spheres, the highest of which, called Âtmâkâśa, Jñânâkâśa or Mahâkâśa, or respectively the "Ether of the Self," the "Ether of Realization" and the "Great Ether", is no "sphere" at all, because it refers to the state beyond Manifestation, the abode of the Supernal Sun.

For the moment it will be enough to be concerned with the Five Elements, four of which form the arms, and the fifth the centre, of the Cross. The Alchemists called that Fifth Element the Quintessence. It was identified with the Christ in the middle of the Cross. It was the mystic Rose in the centre of the cross of the Rosicrucians. That Centre is the Source and the Goal.

The traditional teaching regarding the four psychological temperaments, as used by Hippocrates and Galen, is based on the Four Elements. The terms of this ancient tradition must, after centuries of misunderstanding and misinterpretation, of course not be taken in their modern sense. This traditional psychological teaching has been revived in the system of Analytical Psychology in which the four functions of perception, feeling, thinking and intuition refer to the Four Elements. By way of introduction, some traditional data, clues and correspondences will be given without much comment.

Air-Elementals. The Elementals of Air are the Sylphs. They are the spirits of the Air, winged like birds, Angel-like. They represent Buddha intuition, spiritual discrimination, the flight of the soul. People focussed on this plane were considered to be in the system of Hippocrates and Galen of "Sanguine" temperament. The symbolism of blood will be dealt with later. The magic symbol of the Sylphs, which is used in their "control", is the Pentacle . The function of the Element Air is to lead to and reveal the Fifth Element or Quintessence, which it alone is capable of doing. In the traditional Tarot cards the Element Air is represented by the Pentacles, the symbol of which is . In ancient packs these were

also called "deniers", a word derived from the small coin denarius, and referring, by association, to the spirit of denial and renunciation which has to be attained in this plane. This spirit of renunciation has been symbolized in various traditions by a small coin. The dakshina or money-offering at a Hindu rite was once meant to represent it. Also in Hindu tradition a coin, if possible a gold one, should be put into the mouth of a corpse, before cremation. In Greek tradition an "obolus" accompanied the corpse, to be given to the ferryman of the dead for taking them "to the other shore". The prayed-for "other shore" is really the Sphere of Ether.

In the ordinary suit of playing cards the symbol of Air is found in the Diamonds. For ordinary playing cards also contain the Elements, engaged in the Play of Life. The spirit of Air, the Buddhi, has indeed the crystal clarity and also the value of the diamond. The four corners of the symbol also refer to the Four Elements, of which Air is the highest.

In the Zodiac the Air is represented particularly by the fixed Sign of Aquarius. In the Sign of Aquarius, the House leading to Liberation, man becomes more than man. He becomes one with his Father. Aquarius and the Element Air are represented in the Revelation of St. John (4; 7) by the Beast like a flying Eagle, corresponding to the face of an Eagle of the Living Creatures of Ezekiel (1; 10). It refers to Mercury. Aquarius is an Air-House. Traditionally the Gospel of St. John has been related to it. The Royal Star of Fomalhout is found near Aquarius.

Fire-Elementals. The Elementals of Fire are the Salamanders. They are the denizens of the lower mental plane, the Sphere ruled by Mars. Out of the four psychological temperaments the "Choleric" refers to Fire. The symbolism of bile and liver will be dealt with later. The magic symbol of the Salamanders, which is to be used in their control, is traditionally drawn thus: . It is the thunderbolt of Jupiter, representing Mars. It is also the Martian trident of Neptune, who is an aspect of Jupiter in Pisces, and of Siva. It symbolizes among other things the masterhood of the Third Element Fire over the three lower Elements of Earth, Water and Fire. In the Zodiac Fire is particularly represented by the fixed Sign of Leo, the Fire-Sign, ruled by the Sun. It is represented by the Beast like a Lion in the Revelation of St. John, and the face of a Lion of the Living Creatures of Ezekiel. Traditionally the Gospel of St. Mark has been related to it. In Leo is the Royal Star of Regulus, "the little Ruler".

Among the Tarot cards the Salamanders or Fire-Elementals are represented by the suit of Wands. The Wands are also called "sceptres". The sceptre is a form of the symbol of power of Jupiter: the Thunderbolt, representing

Mars The Wands are represented by branches like small trees from which small green shoots are coming forth The Wand is a form of the Tree of Knowledge The little green shoots springing from them point to the fact that the Element Fire leads to the higher Element Air, the Sphere of the Spirit, in which the Tree of Knowledge will become the Tree of Life In the pack of ordinary playing cards Fire is represented by the suit of clubs The triple club is related to the Trident The club is that of Thor, the North-European aspect of Mars The triple club and trident are a different symbol from the one-pointed lance or sword, which represents the Buddha and which kills the Ahankara in some symbolic shape

One of the main symbols connected with the Plane of Fire, particularly in its embroilment with the Plane of Water, is the Blood It is a symbol of suffering — suffering on the Cross of the Four Elements The blood is found to play an important part in the trials of the Solar Hero on the Four Planes He experiences suffering on all planes the Blood of the Man on the Cross flows from the wounds made by the four nails And when the Ahankara, the man-of-separation-and-sin, is killed, blood flows from the wound made by the lance of Buddha The lance deals the death-blow to the lower nature and conveys Liberation from Mâyâvic selfhood The lance of Subrahmanian, bringing this very Liberation, the lance in the side of Jesus on the Cross, the lance in the side of the Grail-King, and in other myths, hint at the same truth It generally does not pass into the physical heart on the left side of the body, but into the liver, on the right side As noted before, the liver is connected with the "choleric" temperament The blood, of course, is connected with the "sanguine" temperament In as far as it traditionally represents the "life-force", it is a spiritual symbol

It is the lance, or the more Martian sword, which kills the Beast, the Devil of selfhood-and-separateness It is wielded by Krishna, Perseus, St George, Horus, Siegfried, and many forms of the Solar Hero The penetration by the lance is the One-pointed Experience, in which sin-and-separation is destroyed and its form dissolved in the Fullness In Hindu myths the Monster which is killed by a God or Hero is after his death liberated and united to his Vanquisher This is generally stressed There is never any question of annihilation, in the usual sense of the word In this symbolism is also contained the answer to the question, again and again asked by those who advance on the Path to God "Does the attainment of God-Realization, Union, Nirvâna, imply the total extinction of the soul, or does something remain?" It is only symbol or paradox that can give the answer In other words only Experience

Tapas. The unsuccessful marriage of Fire and Water, resulting in the spilling or losing of Blood or "fiery water", must be successfully consummated. In the terms of the tradition of Alchemy this is expressed by: "Boil the Water over the Fire." This is an important part of the Great Work of the Philosophers. When water boils the resultant is steam, which, in its perfect state, is invisible. It is Air. The perfect coordination and harmony of Water and Fire, of emotions and lower mind, prepare the ground for the revelation of Spirit. Herein lies also the clue to the meaning of the Hindu practice of Tapas. This word has been variously rendered and interpreted as "spiritual practice", "heating-up process", "burning", "asceticism, with all that implies", "spiritual striving". It means all these things and much more. The word "tepid", derived from the Latin tepidus, warm, is related to tapas. The purpose of Tapasyâ, the life of tapas, is the coordination of the three lower planes of existence: Earth, Water and Fire, under the presidency of the Fire. Tapas has been traditionally defined as being triple: 1. Śârîraka, that is, bodily; 2. Vâchika, that is, voiced; and 3. Mânasa, that is, mental. "Voiced" implies the emotional benefits of reciting scriptures and chanting hymns. Tapasyâ is the coordination and purification of thought, word and deed.

Tapasyâ also implies something deeper. The Fire of Mars should be transmuted into the Solar Fire. The Śârîraka, or bodily aspect of it, then refers to the three Śârîras of bodies, consisting of the five kośas or "sheaths" which relate to the five Elements. The Vâchika then refers to Vâch, "the Voice", and the Mânasa to the Mahat, "the Great One". In this sense Tapas includes the entire spiritual Path till the final "Enlightenment". Ultimately the Blood of Suffering changes into the Wine of Rapture.

The fiery experiences of highly spiritual people, especially in the chest and in the head, have often been noted. The inner experiences often impress themselves on the matter of the physical body.

Water-Elementals. The Elementals of Water are the Nymphs or Undines. They belong to the emotional plane. Undines are literally "the spirits of the waves". It was believed that by marrying a mortal and bearing a child they could receive a soul. The "marrying of a mortal" implies "the coming down to Earth", with the resultant expansion of personality. The "child" is the spiritual child, the Christ-child, which, when born in the heart, lifts life out of mortality to immortality. We shall return to this subject. The symbol of the Water-spirits in magic is a Cup. Theirs is the "phlegmatic" among the four psychological temperaments. Phlegm is a watery substance in the body. The word also

suggests coolness. Indeed water is a cool element, in spite of its liquidity and attribute of motion, found in "emotion." The type has also been called the "sentimental" temperament, which word, like the others, should not be taken in the modern sense. The fiery influence from the Element Fire may heat the water and turn it into Blood. By itself it is pure. It is left to the Ahankāra which shadows Man on his long tour to turn the Elements into hells. On the other hand the intensity of his Tapas can turn them back into so many heavens. Very often they are a mixture of both, or show alternating aspects. Man decides his dwelling place amidst the mansions in his Father's house by his own actions.

In the Tarot, the Element of Water is represented by the suit of Cups, and in the ordinary playing cards by the Hearts. In the Zodiac it is particularly represented by the fixed Sign of Scorpio, a Water-Sign. It is represented by the Beast with the face of a Man in the Revelation, and the face of a Man of the Living Creatures of Ezekiel. In Scorpio is found the Royal Star Antares. Scorpio is ruled by Ares or Mars on the night-throne. Traditionally the Gospel of St. Matthew has been related to it.

Earth- Elementals

The Elementals of Earth are the Gnomes or Kobolds also known as dwarfs, urchins, brownies, goblins, and so on. Every country has or had its hierarchies of sprites, fairies and gnomes, relating either to the Four Elements or to the four subdivisions of these Elements on the same basis. Their work mostly consists of guarding, supervising and guiding life in the Four Kingdoms of Nature: the mineral, the vegetable, the animal and the spiritual, which symbolize again the Four Elements (see Diagram 1). The mineral kingdom represents the physical plane. The vegetable kingdom refers to the emotional plane. Green is the colour of the Element Water and of Venus. The animal kingdom refers to the lower mental plane, and the spiritual kingdom refers to the plane of Buddha. And on every plane there are again subdivisions. In the vegetable kingdom there is the subdivision of stem and branches for the physical plane, flowers for the emotional plane, fruits for the lower mental plane, and leaves for the spiritual mind. Then there are further subdivisions, as for instance with regard to flowers. With "an eye for such things" the details of Symbolism can be found in a number of traditions, throwing interesting light on many old fairy-tales. The details, as always, vary in accordance with climate and country. But the fundamental scheme is everywhere the same. The alternative tradition based on the Seven Spheres is also found everywhere. Colours, musical notes, tastes, smells,

and a large number of other things will be found to have each their particular place in the old teachings.

Among the four temperaments as used by Hippocrates and Galen, the "melancholy" refers to Earth. In the Tarot the Earth Elementals are represented by the suit of Swords, and in the ordinary cards by Spades. The spade is as appropriate as the sword. Both are of iron, and both are used to wound physical matter. The Spade is used "to dig for Treasure", and the sword "to kill the Adversary". The meaning of "treasure", the Gold of Saturn, will be considered later. The spade, however, is also used to dig the grave, and the sword easily becomes an implement of murder on earth. They are also sexual symbols and their implications will be made clear by and by.

In the Zodiac, Earth is particularly represented by the fixed Sign of Taurus. The Royal Star Aldebaran is found in it. It is represented by the Beast like a Calf in the Revelation of St. John, corresponding to the face of an Ox in Ezekiel's vision. Traditionally the Gospel of St. Luke had been connected with it.

The Earth Elementals are always represented as being extremely industrious. The physical plane is the field of fourfold activity: productive, concerned with Earth; distributive, concerned with Water; ruling and regulating, concerned with Fire; and educational and spiritual, concerned with Air. This fourfold division is reflected in the theoretical Four Varnas or "natural classes" (not castes) of traditional Hinduism.

With the Gnomes or Earth-elementals we reach the "most material" of the Elements. Earth represents the lowest field and the culmination of the Titanic creative efforts. The God of the Earth is Saturn, Ruler of the Earth-House of Capricorn, the House of both Christ, the Son of Man, and of Satan. Saturn is also Ruler of Aquarius, which he rules on the day-throne, whereas he rules Capricorn on the night-throne. In Aquarius Saturn represents the mythical King of the Golden Age in the country of the Hyperboreans — a country which, according to traditions of Greece and Rome as well as of Asia, is ever existing, in spite of the succession of the Four Ages. It is said to be "far North", "beyond". The "North" refers to the Pole in Aquarius. "Beyond" means beyond the end of the Path through the Zodiac. To find that Golden Age there is no need to travel to mysterious far-off countries, or to reach to other World-Ages. For it is found in the Heart, and it may be found there, as many traditions teach us, here and now.

The two aspects of Saturn in Capricorn, as the Tempter and as the God presiding over the Divine Birth, are reflected in his servants, the Gnomes, or, as they were called by an older tradition, the Kobolds. The word Gnome

comes from the Greek words *gênomos*, meaning "dwelling in the Earth", and "law of the Earth", and *gnômê*, "truth" The latter word is related to *gnôsis*, spiritual realization, the same as the related Hindu *jñānam* The word "know" is also etymologically connected

The Treasure and its guardians The Gnomes have indeed a double nature They tempt with the treasures of the earth, they are malignant to "materialists", increasing and fulfilling their desires to some extent, and enslaving them But they are also "knowers" like their great Master, Saturn They know what the Treasure is and they guard it carefully It is not the treasure which the miner is seeking in the form of coal, or iron, or gold The Treasure is not, as the Alchemists put it, the "vulgar gold" of this world, but "the Gold of the Philosophers" It is the Gold of the Golden Age It symbolizes the Enlightenment of the Zodiacal stage of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces, which is a stage of Ether as well as of Earth The Treasure is the Spiritual Pole The attainment of Divine Reality has been symbolized in many traditions as "the finding of the Treasure" Countless myths and fairy-tales deal with the theme The Treasure is guarded, true to its Capricorn and Aquarius-symbolism, either by Earth-spirits or by a Dragon On the Path of the Fall the Dragon or Serpent is the Tempter, on the Path of Return he is the Liberator, embodiment of Wisdom In all its forms the Serpent or Dragon is a symbol of Śakti or Creative Power In the stage of Aquarius the Serpent is coiled up in Rest In Hinduism it is, in the form of a Nāga, often represented as coiled around the Śiva-Linga, with its head high above it The Linga is a form of the Treasure, and the symbolic representation implies the perfect transmutation of Desire as well as of Power Such representations are generally found under a tree, the *Ficus Religiosa*, the most sacred tree of Hindu and Buddhist tradition It represents the Tree of Life, which is the Tree of the Ether-Sphere We shall see later that in the Zodiac the Tree of Life is also found in the stage of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces Such images are sometimes worshipped in a fertility rite Before this was conceived in a literalistic sense, it had a symbolic meaning The *spiritual fertilization* is called in another tradition "the immaculate conception" It leads to the spiritual Birth .

The Serpent Power. The Serpent-Power is called in the Yoga-tradition Kundalīnī, after the Kundalī Chakra, that is, the Solar plexus Centre, which is "the Animal Centre" in man (see Diagram 1) The Serpent is an Animal, and symbolizes the creative

consciousness of the lower mind. Kundalinî, called "the fiery Power", is said to "sleep in the Mûlâdhâra", "the Root-Support". This is the lowest of the Seven Centres (see Diagram 1). It is the Centre of Earth, and is said to be ruled by Ganapati, who, as we have seen, represents an aspect of Saturn. It is one of the objects of Yoga to "awaken" the sleeping Kundalinî, to make it "ascend", and to cause it to unite, in the highest of the Centres, with its Lord, the Supernal Śiva. This transmutation process of the Yoga-tradition is an uplifting of consciousness and a transfiguration of its creative power, from Earth, step by step, to Heaven. This is either conceived as taking a full Cycle of the Path through the Zodiac, or as proceeding from Capricorn to Aquarius.

The first "sleep" of Kundalinî, is a negative state. Its final "rest" is positive. We read in Genesis (2; 2), that on the Seventh Day, representing the End of the Path, in Capricorn and Aquarius, God "rested". Śrī Padmanâbha, a form of Vishnu that represents Aquarius, lies in Supernal Rest, with his Śakti by his side, on the coiled up, resting, form of Ādiśeṣha, the "Primal Serpent", also called Ananta, "the Endless".

The ultimate Rest, symbolizing complete inner peace, is the real Treasure. It is evident that it can be obtained only after great exertion and struggle.

The Dragon is dangerous on account of Ahankâra and harmless when Ahankâra is absent. In that case it is a symbol of Wisdom. The Dragon or Serpent in myths and fairy-tales yields the Treasure only to the hero who has passed all the tests and temptations successfully. Sometimes the hero must kill the Dragon of Ahankâra, before he can take the Treasure.

In India there is a widespread belief that treasures are guarded by Nâgas or fairy-serpents. These are often identified with cobras. — Symbolism is largely based on natural circumstances.

The Nâga is often represented as five-hooded, which refers to the Five Elements, in which the Serpent-Power manifests, or as seven-hooded, which refers to the Seven Spheres. At the end of the Path the Elements and Spheres are harmoniously united in the form of the Dragon of Wisdom, Guardian of the Tradition.

The Earth in Hermetic symbolism. In Indian traditions the idea has been expressed that even Divine Beings must be born as men, in order to attain Salvation and Liberation. The implication is that the experiences of the physical plane, the Element Earth, have to be gone through. Spiritual escapism will not do. The Earth is the testing place of the Spirit. The hardest lessons are learnt on it, and its trials should be faced as well as the trials of existence on the other planes.

No stage on the Path can be skipped, and least of all the last stage. The Hermetists stressed the importance of life on Earth. Jacob Boehme wrote (in *Signatura Rerum* X, 50) "The grain of corn does not give a sprout, if it is not buried in the Earth." The symbol of the sprouting corn, apart from referring to re-incarnation, applied to the spiritual and "cultural" Resurrection. It was employed in the Mysteries of Greece and Egypt, and used by Jesus and his Apostles. In Hindu tradition many scriptures refer to the great boon of having obtained a suitable physical body, as the medium to attain Self-realization. The gathering of the fragments and their ultimate synthesis are achieved on Earth, for the Earth forms the last fragment. The Treasure is found by "digging in the Earth." This we can understand at the hand of the symbolism of the dimension of "depth" (see Diagram 1). Another of the great symbols of the Earth, referring to the End-stage, is that of the Philosophers' Stone. Stone is a symbol of Earth. By the help of that magic Stone the "lower metals" of a person's being become transmuted into Gold. Hence it may be understood why the Stone of the Philosophers was symbolically identified with the Quintessence, "the fifth Element", namely, Ether, and that with the Christ. This symbolism again refers to the transmutation from Earth to Ether. The Making of the Gold, the Obtaining of the Treasure, Rebirth, and much other symbolism that will be encountered later, all refer to the culmination of spiritual attainment at the end of the Path, in synthesis and union.

Till the last moment, however, there is the possibility that "something may go wrong" on the Path of Return, or in the Great Work of the Alchemist, or in the process of Spiritual Birth. In that case the Achievement will be postponed till some future cycle. The Tempter may manage to intervene, and stimulate, through his servants, the desire for possession of the elements of the earth: coal, iron, petrol, gold, material things including physical bodies. People jealously guard the "vulgar gold" of "the world" in underground caves. Therefore symbolically the Treasure of Self-Realization is carefully guarded by Gnomes, lest it fall into the hands of those who do not deserve it, who have no right to it. Both the treasure of the world and the Treasure of Light are found in the same stage of the Zodiac. The Gnomes are both the servants of Mammon and the guardians of the Treasure. The aspect they take depends on the context in which they appear, or, in other words, on the character of the person concerned, that is to say, on the degree to which he is in the bondage of Ahankâra, the principle of Ego-ism, personified in the Devil, Satan or Mâra.

Part-personalities. On the planes to which the Elementals belong, men and women in the world *are* Gnomes, Nymphs, Salamanders and Sylphs. These, like the Gods and Titans, live within the human soul. This statement is easily liable to be misunderstood. For the "within" is often conceived with reference to the *ego* or the *body*. Traditionally it is taught that every man creates his own universe from within. Many philosophical schools teach the same. On the innermost plane everything is One. The more "superficial" the plane, the greater the diversity, division and multiplicity. As the physically embodied individual has contact with other individuals on the physical plane, his emotional counterpart has contact with others on the emotional plane, and so on. Everyone knows the large variety in contact he has with other persons. In his life some persons exist, as it were, only physically, others only emotionally, others only intellectually. A great deal of unhappiness, in marriage partnership, in family and other relationships is due to this.

Spiritual experience. What occurs "outside" is the response to the "within". In the world people are almost entirely focussed in their consciousness on the lower planes, experience of which they have gained through the senses. But when in the course of the purification and coordination of the personality the tendency of their consciousness is to strive "upward" or "inward", they contact a life which is not dependent on the experience gained by the senses. Where previously Form dominated over Life, now Life begins to dominate over Form. The experience is startling, revolutionary. When the first glimpses of Life occur — in "great dreams", flashes of "cosmic consciousness", visions of unknown Beings, great symbols, — it seems to the experiencer that "the ground is taken away from underneath his feet", or that an earthquake is occurring. If a man has always thought that a God or the Devil or belongs to old superstitions, and that GOD is some theoretical abstraction beyond experience, it shakes him to his very depths if one day he experiences something of the Life of the inner planes, and moreover experiences it as being of "greater reality" than the "things of every day" which he has known all his life. He is astonished at the "newness" of the experience. He is likely to exclaim: "One would never have dreamt of such a thing!" He knows that his thinking mind could never have worked it out. And he experiences it within, but as coming from without. He then feels that it is not correct to make God into a psychological principle, along the lines of some schools of thought. Such a thing stands out as a sacrilege, unless the terms of reason are re-transmuted into spiritual terms and used symbolically. Then God truly is the Principle

of the psyche, and the Gods or Angels are in their turn His Principles. Instead of Principle, one may say Prince. Both words, originally meaning "the first taken", are derived from the Latin "principium", meaning "beginning".

In all "experiences" the Ahankâra or I-factor is present, though in the more exalted ones it is in the background. The Ahankâra in its manifold forms cowers before the Life which reveals itself before the soul. It knows the "fear of God". For it, and in as far as people identify themselves with it, GOD and His Powers always "come from without" and are never within. — In the ultimate, Full Experience, the Ahankâra dies its own death, the death it has always represented. And then the distinction of "within and without" ceases to exist.

The four types of men. In connection with the existence of Four Elements there are certain sociological distinctions. The four Varnas or "natural classes" of Hindu tradition have been mentioned before. These have to be distinguished from the numerous castes or hereditary groups which evolved when the true tradition became forgotten. These four natural classes are, of course, not only Hindu; they are universal. They can be found everywhere. The focussing of consciousness and activity on any of the Planes of Earth, Water, Fire and Air determines whether any man anywhere on earth is, to use the Hindu terms, a Śûdra, a Vaiśya, a Kshatriya or a Brâhmana. It has been stressed in the Gîta as well as in other scriptures that people's status is determined by their Svadharma, that is, their personal, individual, vocation, life-activity, duty and contribution to humanity. If a man's interest and activities are focussed on the physical plane, he is a materialist, no matter what his parents were. If his interest and activities are focussed on the Plane of Buddhi, the Element Air or Spirit, he is, to use the Hindu term, a Brâhmana or "knower of Truth", no matter what his ancestry. Actually, of course, the focus of attention and activity shifts to some extent from Plane to Plane, and various combinations exist, forming different psychological types. The ideal is full coordination and harmony. In connection with this it is traditionally stated that in the Golden Age there is only one Varna or class. People who are focussed in the higher spiritual states, live in the Golden Age here and now. They have found and established the Kingdom of Heaven.

The coordination and harmonization of the human fragments scattered in the Four Elements can only be achieved under the Fifth — the Quintes-

sense, the Christ, the Light, Immanuel or "the Inner God", the Antaryâmin or "Inner Ruler", the Guru.

The Fool. When the harmonization and coordination of the personality has achieved full integration, the traditional end of perfection or sainthood has been attained. From the point of view of "the world", a saint or perfected man is often looked upon as a fool. The Fool has an important place in the traditions of East and West. He is found among the Tarot cards — about which later — and is reflected in the joker of the ordinary playing cards. The symbolism of the Fool is interwoven with that of the "Play of Life". The Fool, like his card in the pack, has no definite place in the Scheme. He may be everywhere and nowhere. He is both inside and outside. He borrows his name from the fool who is deeply enmeshed by and involved in the Veils of Mâyâ. He is the Divine Fool, liberated from all foolishness, One with his Father. His nature is always paradoxical. He fits beautifully and yet does not fit at all into the World-scheme and its reflection in the world of man. He "has no place to lay his head", he owns nothing, he has nothing, he is nothing, because he is and has the Whole. The beauty of it is that such men actually exist. They are not theoretical possibilities and fancies, or found only in stories, but they walk on the roads of the earth. It is not always easy to recognize one. Because such a man is a Fool, fools will consider him a fool and laugh at him and leave him alone, which, if he wants anything at all, is all he desires.

Fourfold symbolism. A number of traditional subdivisions of four are based on the Four Elements. They are, to express it systematically, to be taken notice of, to be felt, to be cogitated upon, to be the subject of meditation, finally to be experienced in essence.

The Four are represented in the Four Angels presiding over the "corners of the world". This tradition has found expression in state ceremonies in many parts of the world. The King of Babylon was "Lord of the four directions". Peru was the "Land of the four directions". The King of Hungary, at the crowning ceremony, pointed his sword at the four directions. The Emperor of China had to ascend the four Yao-hills. Ireland had a similar tradition. The four Angels were reflected in the four arch-officers of the Holy Roman Empire. Similar traditions were and are found practically everywhere. — The State is the reflection without of the state within.

The Four are found in the Four Streams issuing from Eden, symbol of the Ether-Sphere. This is symbolism in terms of Water. The Four are also found in the Four Winds, symbolism in terms of Air. The Four Seasons

and the Four Life-Periods have their Symbolical implications for stages on the Two Paths. They are found in Diagram 1b. In relation to Time in connection with Creation, Manifestation, Dissolution and Rest, the Four are found in the Four Phases of the Moon, Lord of Creation. This will be dealt with later.

The four stages of life. Hindu tradition abounds with teachings based on the Four Elements. The Four Yugas were considered before. The Four Āśramas, or stages and ways of life are based on the Elements. They are Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha and Sannyāsa. The first applies to the period of growth and education. The second is the period of life as householder, as pater-and materfamilias. It is the emotional stage. The third period is that which pertains to the Element Fire, the mental plane. The Vānaprastha has traditionally to "live in the forest" and "to nourish the sacrificial fires." The forest is a symbol of the mental plane. It is "the wilderness." The Fire has ultimately to become "the sacrificial fire." The last stage, Sannyāsa, that of renunciation, is the spiritual stage of Air. In traditional teachings, there is an intimate relationship between the symbolism, the rites, and the recommended way of life. The mental plane is symbolically "the wilderness", where "the wild beasts" of the urges and tendencies of the "animal-man" roam about. And it is actually true that the best environment for the subjugation of those "wild beasts" is in the retreat of a forest, away from "the world", where the mind is sweetened and harmonized by consorting with actual wild animals. In the Tēvyja Sutta the Buddha characterizes the philosophizing of some learned Brahmins as a "waterless desert" and a "pathless jungle." The terms are not used merely as vivid "figures of speech" but constitute very exact symbols as the context signifies.

The four ends of life. The ends of life are also fourfold. The Four Puruṣhārthas or "Human Ends" are Artha, Kāma, Dharma and Moksha. Artha is the ordering of one's material affairs so as to conduce to wealth and health. "Wealth" and "health" are the physical plane correlatives of commonweal, wholeness and holiness. Artha pertains to the Element Earth. Kāma is the perfection of the emotional life and of the desires of love, in coordination with the physical, mental and spiritual planes. It pertains to the Element of Water. Dharma signifies perfection in the discharge of a person's function in the organism of human society as rationally conceived. Social ethics and morality pertain to the Element Fire. Moksha is the perfection of the spiritual element in man, which ulti-

mately brings him Salvation and Liberation. It pertains to the Element Air or Spirit. The average man is, of course, far removed from the attainment of these "ends"; for him they are ideals to guide him on his Path. The perfect alignment and coordination of the Four Ends under the presidency of the Spiritual End leads to Moksha, which is the ever-existent Fifth State, of Ether, Paradise, Heaven. For that is the "quintessence" of Manifestation.

The four Yogas. To regain that lost state, that Golden Age, man's birth-right, various Hindu traditions teach about the Four Yogas, or Ways of Union; the Four Mārgas or Ways; and the Four Padas or Paths. These words have a meaning much wider and deeper than the English terms given. Each of these Four Paths is suited to the temperament of people in accordance with the focus of consciousness and activity on any of the Four Planes.

"Yoga" may be interpreted as both union with the Self, Reality, God, and as union and synthesis of the Four into One. The word Yoga is related to Yuga, period. Both imply a "joining" and "yoking" together; these are related words. Yoga is generally rendered by Union.

Yoga is fourfold, in accordance with the four temperaments. It is impossible to make a clear-cut division between the four Yogas, because every one of them is found in the other three forms. Even if one of the Elements predominates in a person's life, he has also to deal with the other three. The four Yogas, from the point of view of the path of pilgrimage, as represented in "one lifetime" as well as in the greater life through the eyes, succeed one another in stages.

The Yoga for the physical plane, consisting of postures and exercises for the body and its members and organs, is called Hatha Yoga. The Yoga for the emotional plane is Bhakti Yoga. It comprises purification of the emotional life and love urge, leading to devotion and love of God, and communion with the God of Love. The Yoga for the mental plane, the Element Fire, is Rāja Yoga or "the Kingly Yoga", comprising the purification of the mind and the development and training of its powers in coordination with the other functions. The Yoga for the plane of Buddhi, the Element Air, is Jñāna Yoga, the Way of Union based on Realization, the Science, Gnosis.

Very often Karma Yoga is given as the first of the Four Yogas. In that case it applies to actions in the physical world. Karma or action is not really a separate Yoga, for action has to take place on all the planes of existence. It is unavoidable. Sometimes the term Karma Yoga implies a spiritual life in the world in contradistinction to a spiritual life in the retreat

of a monastery or hermitage, or a life of roaming⁴ about without even these ties Karma Yoga implies that a person is "extravert", in contradistinction to the introversion of a person who has devoted himself to a religious life. The distinction between extraversion and introversion is, however, only a superficial one, relating to appearances, since the ideal of co-ordination, harmony, synthesis and union also implies balance between introversion and extraversion. In the ultimate Experience the outer and the inner fuse into one. The Jñāna Yogî is as much a man of action as a man who contributes his energies to society as a dock-labourer. The action lies on a different plane. The activities on the higher planes are of a more lasting order than those on the physical plane. The "Yogî in the Cave" may move the world of men, the dock-labourer moves a number of bales or crates a day for the material good of the world. Karma Yoga has yet another meaning. Karma is also ritual, as a means of communion with the divine. As such again all the planes, including the physical, are involved.

The four Paths.

The word Mārga means the Path or the Pursuit, from the root "mrg" meaning "to hunt", to follow, "to follow to the source". The Mārgas of Śaivism with the corresponding Padas are here given for those who are specially interested, in their order as referring to the Elements from Earth to Air. 1 Dāsamārga and Charyapada, 2 Satputramārga and Kriyāpada, 3 Sahāmārga and Yogapada, and 4 Sanmārga or Jñānapada. Both Dāsa and Charya mean service. A Satputra is a son of Truth, Harmony or Purity. Kriyā generally means creative activity. In that sense (of the Nyāya tradition) it is used in this book. But in the Sāṅkhya tradition it means desire. Sahas is the power of the mind. Yoga, without further qualification, denotes Rāja Yoga. Sanmārga means the Path of Purity, Reality, Truth. Perhaps it is better to say that these Ways and Paths lead to the qualities the names of which they bear, as was the case with the ends of life. Jñānam implies the perfection of the Fourth Plane.

The five Sheaths

The Five Elements form the "material" of the Five Kośas or "Sheaths" of Hindu tradition. These form the bodies or veils of man on the various planes. The grossest is the Annamayakośa or "sheath made of or by Anna" which means both Food and Earth. The second is Prāṇamayakośa. Prāṇa here indicates the flowing, fluidic, liquid Element, Water. The third sheath is the Manomayakośa, "the sheath made of or by the lower mind". The fourth is the Vijnānamayakośa, "the sheath made of Buddhi", for Vijnāna

and Buddhi are synonyms. The fifth sheath is the *Ānandamayakośa*, "the sheath made of Bliss". The Bliss is the experience of the Sphere of Ether. It is the Pure Joy of Paradise, the Kingdom of Heaven.

The four states The Four States of Consciousness of the earlier Hindu of philosophical traditions refer to consciousness on the Consciousness. Five Planes. The word "consciousness" in Eastern traditions refers to "super-consciousness" veiled to a greater or lesser degree in the matter of the various Spheres. It is quite distinct from "consciousness" in the Western sense, which implies awakeness and awareness, and is one of a duality: the conscious — the unconscious. In Hindu tradition the first state of consciousness is known as *Jâgrat*, or "the waking state". It is traditionally called "the state of experience of gross objects", hence "objective state". It refers to consciousness on the physical plane and is associated with *Vaikhari Śabda* or "Sound manifested in spoken words".

The second state of consciousness is *Svapna* or "the dreaming state". It is also known as "the subjective state" because denoting the state of experience of "subtle objects". This is the consciousness of the emotional and mental planes together. It is the state of *Madhyamâ Śabda*, the "middle or intermediate Sound". The word "*Svapna*" is related to the Latin "*sopor*", sleep, and the Anglo-Saxon "*swefen*", a dream.

The third state of consciousness is *Sushupti* or "the state of deep sleep". The words *sushupti* and sleep are also etymologically related. It is the state of *Paraśabda* or "Supernal Sound". It has been noted before that the Element Air is the Element of Sound. The hierarchy of Voice — Word — Sound has thus been retraced from external physical manifestation to inward spiritual principle. The State of Deep Sleep is called "the state in which there is neither the subjective nor the objective". It is the state in which Buddhi, the intuitive, discriminative spiritual faculty functions. "Sleep" is symbolical, though the literal is not excluded. The function of Buddhi is like sleep to the rational mind which inevitably falls short of its superior realm. But also from the viewpoint of the Sphere of Ether, the Sphere of Air and Buddhi is like sleep. For Air is the Plane on which the soul *falls* asleep, like Snow-white and the Sleeping Beauty in the fairy-tales. Sleep is moreover an appropriate term, for while the rational faculty can be followed in its activities, the faculty of Buddhi works in flashes of its own nature, without allowing itself to be watched at work. It is, indeed, "neither subjective, nor objective". The symbolic nature of the "sleep" of the *Sushupti* state appears in statements like that made by the Rishi Vasishta (in the

Mumukshu-Prakarana of Yoga-Vâsishta) "I shall ever be in the Sushupti state, and thus be able to overstep the limits of the painful mind, though engaged in the daily actions of the world " The Yoga-Vâsishta also mentions that it is the highest of the Ajñâna states or "states of non realization (of Reality) Interesting is another sentence in Yoga-Vâsishta (Utpattî Prakarana, the Story of Ākaśaja) Those who are liberated in life are in that undisturbed state of mental equilibrium when they enjoy the Jagrata (Waking) state in Sushupti (Sleep) or the Sushupti in Jagrata, devoid of all desire-tendencies (Vasanas)"

The fourth state of consciousness is Turiya or "that beyond deep sleep Yoga-Vâsishta says that it is the state of those "liberated during life Jivanmuktas or those "living freed" It is the state of Ether, of Heaven on Earth Tradition speaks of yet another state, beyond Turiya It is the Tur yatita state, belonging to the Videhamuktas or "freed souls without bodies Turyatita means "gone beyond Turiya" It is the state of unveiled pure Consciousness of the Moon-Sphere It should be mentioned that in the Tantric doctrine of the Śaiva Siddhanta, which is a fairly late School the five states of consciousness are explained in a manner which is opposed to the doctrine given above and below

The meaning of the Word OM The Mândūkya-Upanishad explains the relationship of the states of consciousness to the Word, OM, which is elsewhere shown to be related to Amen and Ammon

OM is actually written as AUM Every letter is called a pāda The Upanishad says "All, indeed, is AUM, even all that is beyond the triple conception of time" It is then equated with Brahman and Ātman and said to have four padas "The first pāda is Vaiśvānara whose sphere is the state of waking, who is cognizant of the objective, and whose fruition consists of the gross" Vaiśvānara is derived from Viśva, the world or universe, and is rendered as "the fire of life" It is the fire of the sun of manifestation It relates to the physical plane the Element Earth

"The second pada is Taijasa whose region is dream, who is cognizant only of the subjective, and whose fruition consists of the subtle' It refers to the Elements of Water and Fire The next refers to Air, the Sphere of Buddha "This is the state of deep sleep wherein the sleeper does not imagine anything, and does not see any dream The third pada therefore is the Prajñā whose sphere is deep sleep, in whom all melts into one, who is a mass all sentiency, who is all bliss, whose fruition is of bliss, and who is the way of sentiency " Prajñā is the consciousness of the sphere of Buddha.

It is rendered as "understanding, insight, wisdom, knowledge", and is much the same as Buddhi.

The following refers to Ether: "This is the Lord of all, this is all-knowing, this is the Inner Ruler (Antaryāmin), this is the source of all, the origin and final resort of all beings. The fourth pāda is not that which is conscious of the subjective, nor that which is conscious of the objective nor that which is conscious of both, nor that which is simple consciousness, nor that which is a mass all sentiency nor that which is all darkness. It is unseen, transcendent, unapprehensible, uninferable, unthinkable, indescribable, the sole essence of the consciousness of self, the negative of all illusion, the ever peaceful, all bliss, the One Unit; this indeed is the Self (Ātman), as it should be known. This is that Ātman even with regard to the letters (of the word AUM), it is the Word (Omkāra) with its parts. The pādas are the parts, and the parts the pādas, those being A, U, M." It is next said that the first part A is Vaiśvānara, the second U Taijasa "on account of being in the middle". It corresponds to Madhyamā, and to Antariksha, the interior state or Mid-region, both considered earlier. The third part M is Prājña. And finally, as concerning the Ether, the Quintessence; "That which has no parts is the Fourth State, indescribable, free from the illusion of experiences, all bliss, one without a second. This is the Word (Omkāra). He who realizes the Self (Ātman) in himself, loses himself in the Self (Ātman)."

The Name Allah. In Islāmic tradition the Five Elements are represented in the Name of Allah. According to one tradition the A implies the physical state and the waking state. The L implies the subtle state and the dream state. The La implies the unformed state, the deep-sleep state. The final H implies the non-manifest, the unconditioned state. So far there is a parallel with the tradition of the Māndūkya Upanishad. Allah Himself is the entire Name, in One. According to another tradition the A represents the body (jism), the LL the soul (nafs), the A the spirit (rūh) and H the Fullness of Allah. Then the two Ls represent Water and Fire. Sometimes the first L is said to mean "Life", the second L, "Intelligence", and the H, "Truth". One sees that these traditions correspond perfectly to the Hindu ones given above.

The Rose-Cross and the pyramid. The symbolism of the cross has been considered before. The Ether-centre of the Cross, the Quintessence, the Christ, Hermes the Thrice Great, was symbolized by the Rosicrucians of the seventeenth century as the Rose in the centre of the Rose-Cross. The Rose corresponds to the Lotus of

Hindu and the Golden Flower of Chinese tradition The letters I N R I above the crucified Jesus, the first letters of the words of the "historical" sentence (St Matthew 27, 37), have been referred to as representing the Four Elements in Hebrew Iam is Water, Nur is Fire, Ruach is Air, and Iabeshah is Earth The pyramid is also a symbol referring primarily to the Five Elements The Four angles of the base represent Earth, Water, Fire and Air, and the upper angle Ether In Islâmic tradition the corners or angles are called "rukn" This word has also the sense of "secret", "mysterious" The plural of "rukn", "Al-Arkân", represent the Four Elements in the tradition of Muslim Alchemy Those "mysterious ones", the Arkân, have by psychological etymology been assimilated with the Latin Arcanum, "the secret, hidden, mysterious" The knowledge of the Elements indeed reveals many secrets and provides the key to many scriptures, myths and fairy-tales, not forgetting the "ordinary life", to which all the traditions refer. The top of the pyramid, representing the Ether, is called in Islâmic tradition Al-Athir, a word derived from the Greek word Aether

The Stûpa In Buddhist tradition the Five Elements are represented in the sacred structure called Stûpa or Dâgaba The Square base of this sacred monument represents Earth Its shape hints, among other things, at the four dimensions of the physical plane On the half cubic base rests a big round structure, which represents Water Its shape suggests the roundness of a drop of water It is called the Anda or egg The half cube is repeated on its upper portion On that rests a cone pointed like a flame, which represents Fire On its top is a small horizontal moon-crescent, representing Air This is crowned by a small golden ball and spire representing Ether It represents the Jyotih or "Light" of the Buddha, the Guru of Buddhism Sometimes the top portion is called the triple umbrella In the interior of the Stûpa a treasure is enclosed in a small crypt After the building of the sacred monument has been completed, admittance to the crypt is not possible The treasure consists of a relic of Buddha or of a saint, or, since such relics are practically no longer available, of images of Buddha or symbols in gold or precious materials This treasure in the crypt of the Stûpa represents the Treasure at the bottom of the Earth It is the Treasure within the Cave of the Heart

In Chinese tradition the Five Elements are found in a variety of symbolic groups From Ether to Earth they are implied in the Five Colours blue, yellow, red, white, black; in the Five Tastes, sweet, sour, bitter, pungent, salt, and in other connections The same applies to other traditions

The Pentathlon. The Five Elements were implied in the Pentathlon or "fivefold contest" of the Olympic Games. These Games, held every *four* years in Olympia were sacred to Zeus-Jupiter, the Ruler of Mount Olympus, the God of Ether, Guru. Traditionally the games were not, of course, a mere physical contest for display of muscles and skill. There was a deep meaning in them. Their object for the participant was not to become a popular hero in the modern sense of the word, but to qualify on the physical plane for the exalted spiritual initiations of the Solar Hero. The Planes of Ether, Air, Fire, Water and Earth were represented by the games of pitching the quoit or disk, running, leaping, wrestling and javelin-hurling. The diskos or quoit corresponds to the chakra of Hinduism. Its symbolism has been dealt with elsewhere. The celebrated diskobolos or disk-thrower of Myron does not represent a man of mere perfect physique, but one who has harmonized within himself the powers of the Five Planes of Being, the man who has become the Solar Hero, the Son of the Sun his Father, the ideal man, a god indeed. The Olympic games were the first Mysteries, intended for the first stage in a man's life; that of the development of the physical body, not as mere muscle training, but as a religious training in which the further planes with their mysteries were already foreshadowed in advance. Hindu tradition offers a parallel in Hatha Yoga.

The five trees. Hindu tradition recommends the practice of certain forms of meditation under five trees which have been planted together with that view. The "Panchavati", under which Śrī Rāmakrishna used to meditate in the garden of Dakshineśvar, has become well-known. As the branches and leaves of the trees intermingle and grow together, so the elements of a man's being have to fuse into one under the presidency of the Quintessence. The five trees are generally the same. Sometimes one or two may be different trees on account of local factors of soil and climate. The trees are (1) Amalaka, *Phyllanthus Emblica*, the Nelli or Gooseberry tree, representing Earth; (2) Udumbara, *Ficus Glomerata*, a species of fig tree, representing Water; (3) Margosa, *Azadirachta Indica*, the Neem tree, representing Fire; (4) Vata, *Ficus Benghalensis*, the Banyan tree, representing Air; and (5) Aśvattha, *Ficus Religiosa*, the Bodhi tree, representing Ether. The second, fourth and fifth trees are of the fig species. The sacred Sycamore found in the Egyptian Book of the Dead was also a fig tree. The Aśvattha, Bodhi tree or *Ficus Religiosa*, representing the Ākāśa or Ether, will be dealt with at length in other connections. The Banyan tree is a sacred tree well-known for its air-roots and its tendency to grow out into a forest by itself. It represents the Element Air.

It is the *Ficus Benghalensis* or Waringin, called "vata" in Sanskrit "Vâta" is a garden The word "Banyan" is derived from "Vana" "Vana" means forest

The roots "vata" and 'vana' have undoubtedly been associated through psychological etymology with other roots "vata" and "vana", because both sets of roots and their derivatives express symbolism connected with the Element Air "Vâta", meaning Air, is a name of "Vâyû", the God of the Element Air "Vana" means the vain, the empty, the void, and is related to the Latin "vanus" and "ventus", meaning wind, and to the English "void, vain, vanish, wind, weather", and the Dutch "waaien", to blow, and to many words in other languages

"Nirvâna" signifies that which lies beyond the Element Air, or, in other words, the Ether It implies a cessation of breathing and also means 'that which has been blown out' It is also called "Nirvâtam", a term which corresponds to the "Avâtam" of the Rig-Veda (X, 129, 2) "That, the One, breathes without respiration" Quite in keeping with this, the Nirvana-tree is the Bodhi-tree or *Ficus Religiosa*, representing the Element Ether

The Margosa or Neem tree has very bitter leaves The bitter taste has been associated with the Element Fire in a number of traditions It is the case in Chinese and in Biblical tradition The bitter herbs which should be served with the Jewish Easter-lamb also represent Fire On the other hand the leaves of the Udumbara tree, sacred to Venus, are often mixed in curries to improve the taste The fruits of the Nelli tree, which resemble European gooseberries, have also very good qualities and are said to be good for health When chewed the taste is actually at first bitter, then sour, and finally sweet, showing symbolically that in and through "the world" one can experience the qualities of higher planes

All the trees mentioned exert influences on men, ranging from the physical via the intermediate to the highest Their main qualities are strengthening, purifying, healing and inspiring The relationship between their "material" properties and their symbolism bears witness to the intimate relationship between the various planes of existence There is also a group of five trees which are inauspicious, because they represent the reverse aspects of the Elements

There is another tradition that certain trees should be planted on certain sides of a tapovanam or place where people engage in spiritual practices The trees may be the same as the ones mentioned above, but are generally the following To the East of the Âśrama or spiritual centre is planted an Aśvattha or Bodhi tree, to the West a Banyan tree, to the North a Bel tree, Aegle Marmelos or Bilva, to the South a Nelli tree, and to the South-East

an Aśoka tree, *Saraca Indica*. In addition to the trees mentioned there are many other trees which are sacred to particular Gods.

Groups of four and five limbs.

The four Elements are represented in the Four arms of most representations of Hindu deities, and in the four heads of Brahmā, the Creator. In some traditions the five limbs of the body represent the Elements. The same

applies to the five fingers of a hand. The thumb represents the Ether. The mudrās or finger and hand postures of Hindu as well as of Buddhist traditions and the finger movements of the rituals of Northern Buddhism are, in so far as they do not imitate animals and natural functions, based on the Five Elements represented by the fingers. These postures are found in representations of Gods and Sages, they are an aid in meditation practices, and form part of the symbolic language of classical dancing. Finger postures are also found in Christianity, and, indeed, in all traditions, in connection with Magic, that is, as we shall see presently, the science of the knowledge and control of Māyā. The aim and end of life has been traditionally expressed as Self-Knowledge which further implies self-control. The means to this end is Magic, that is not the contemporary acceptance of the term in the sense of sympathetic magic or the forms of idolatrous superstition, but the Science of Māyā embracing full knowledge of traditional symbolism. The knowledge of the symbolic meaning of the Elements belongs to the Kindergarten of this Science.

The fingers in their threefold division also show the $3 \times 4 = 12$ Houses of the Zodiac, the thumb reflecting the Primal Duality. The thumb-top represents Śakti, the Creative Power of the Universe. In popular belief the thumb is still said to represent the will. This forms but one of many remnants of ancient traditions, only one out of so many scattered fragments to be collected for the resurrection of the body of Tradition. The moon-crescent of Śakti is found in the nail of the thumb as well as in ever diminishing size in the nails of the other fingers, from Air to Earth. In India there is a popular belief that a handprint drives away evil spirits. Hence handprints are imposed with sandal-paste on the door of a new house at the "house-warming ceremony". The meaning of this rite implies the blessings of harmony, synthesis and unity of the Five Elements. The hand represents the Hand of God on the house. It is bound to drive away the evil spirits of separateness and egotism, which endeavour to disturb harmony. The door of the house symbolizes the connection between the Macrocosm and the Microcosm: the Greater World, and the Smaller World of the individual.

The three
Magi.

The Five Elements are implied also in the symbol of the
Pentacle, , representing the human being in his

fivefold wholeness, the limbs and head corresponding to the five points of the star, the Ether as head at the top. An inverted or irregular pentacle represents the Devil, the Ahankara, or a person in the state of disharmony, "disobedience" or sin. The Star which guided the Three Magi to the newborn Christ has been traditionally represented as a Pentacle. The Three Magi or Wise Men represent the Divinity in the Elements Air, Fire and Water, come to pay homage to the Divinity of the Element Ether, the Guru, incarnated in the Element Earth. In the Zodiac they represent the three stages which lead to the fourth, that of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces.

Melchior, sometimes said to be King of Arabia, brought as offering to the Christ-child gold. He represents the stage on the Path of the return of light — "Melchior" means "King of Light". This stage is focussed in the Earth-Sign of Taurus, ruled by Venus. This is the Sign of the "Golden Calf". The Venusian nature also comes out in his name, as associated with the Latin "melliculus", meaning "honey-sweet". "Melculus" was a term of endearment applied to a man. Melchior was said to be very old and to have a venerable white beard.

Caspar, sometimes said to be King of Ethiopia, brought as his offering to the Christ-child incense, symbolizing the homage of the mind to the Spirit. The airy product of the fire of the mind rises majestically on high. This Magus represents the stage of the Zodiac focussed in Leo, the Fire-House ruled by the Sun. His name means "Governor of the Castle", in keeping with his Sun-rulership. He was tall, youthful and ruddy like the Sun-God. Some traditions picture him as deeply sun-burnt, others as white. Both versions are significant.

King Balthasar, sometimes said to be King of Chaldea, brought as his offering sweet-smelling bitter-tasting myrrh. The sense of taste symbolizes the emotional plane of Water and the sense of smell the mental plane of Fire (See Diagram 1). But with reference to sweetness and bitterness the symbolism is just the reverse. This Magus represents the stage in the Zodiac focussed in Scorpio, the Water Sign, ruled on the Night-throne by Mars, Lord of Fire. The implications of this symbolism will appear later. Balthasar, from the Biblical Belsazar, means "Protected by Bel". The name has been associated with the Latin "balteus", meaning a sword belt. Mars, the Ruler of Scorpio, is the wielder of the Sword and Scorpio is the crucial stage of the Battle. "Balteus" may also merely mean a girdle-belt. The symbolism of the belt occurs at this stage of the Path, as we shall see later. Balthasar

was strong and dark and had a shaggy beard. It is significant that myrrh was used to embalm corpses and therefore symbolizes the incorruptibility of eternal life.

The five precepts. In Hindu tradition one of the titles which is given to the Ruler of the Ether-Sphere, the Guru, is Hrishikeśa, meaning "God of the Senses". The Senses symbolize the faculties in the Elements. Control over the Senses implies perfection of the personality. The word "perfection" means "made whole". To achieve wholeness, haleness, holiness, it is necessary to follow the Five Rules. The Five Precepts of Buddhist tradition are: not to kill, not to be unchaste, not to steal, not to lie and not to take intoxicants. These Precepts, which on the surface are moral ones, contain in their symbolical implications a deep meaning for those people who have purified themselves morally sufficiently to understand more than the exoteric meaning. The Five Precepts refer to the Five Planes from Earth to Ether. The details of the symbolism will be dealt with at length in other connections. For the moment it is enough to say that "stealing" refers to the stealing of the Fire from Heaven, "lying" to the perversion of the truth of the Element Air, and "the taking of intoxicants" to the getting involved in the bondage of the Four Elements by "eating the forbidden fruit".

The five fires. Hindu tradition knows the spiritual practice of Pañchāgni Tāpa. It consists of sitting between four fires with the blazing sun as the fifth overhead. The true ascetic is not he who carries this practice out to the letter, but he who controls the fires of the five senses, pertaining to the Element Fire, and, in a still deeper sense, he who controls the powers of all Five Elements. The Five Fires are also found in the Five Sacrificial (or "holy-making") Rites to be performed by the Hindu householder. These will be dealt with later. The "fifth fire overhead" is the Light of the Sun, the Highest Guru and Father of the seeker. He is the Ruler of all the Directions of Space, and of the Elements.

The directions of space. The symbolism of the Directions of Space must be understood with reference to the relation between the Sun and the spiritual seeker on earth. The "movement of the Sun" has great symbolical implications. It will later be seen that Hindu and Greek traditions run parallel to each other. The main conceptions in the Hindu tradition are the following.

Indra, the Hindu Jupiter, the Ruler of the Ākāśa or Ether, is the Regent

of the East The sun rises in the East Man's origin is the Paradise, the Kingdom of Heaven of the Ether Sphere After the sun has completed his course, he goes down in the West The Regent of the West is Varuna He represents the goal of the Air-House of Aquarius, the House of the heavenly Waters The origin is Pisces, the goal is Aquarius Aquarius is "the Western Ocean" of Greek tradition

The meanings Crossing the line from East to West is another line, of "death". from North to South or South to North According to

the season the sun "travels Northward or Southward"

The Regent of the South is Yama, the God of Death In Hindu parlance dying is often called "going South", and the South is considered to be an inauspicious direction "Dying", however, may imply a variety of things firstly, physical death, secondly, the indrawing of the Powers of Manifestation for the Night of Rest, thirdly, the spiritual death in the Fall, which may occur again and again on a re-entering of the Downward Path, and fourthly, the "dying to the world" with its consummation in the death of the "old Adam", the Ahankâra, the man-of-self The last form of "death" leads to Life and Resurrection The process of "dying", in all of its aspects, takes place, of course, all through the time-scheme of the Zodiac But in the symbolism of the Two Paths as conceived in terms of the Zodiac "death" is found specially referred to in connection with Scorpio, Capricorn and Aries, for each House in different contexts The choice which will lead the soul away from Death to Life is made especially under the auspices of Agni and Yama, aspects of the Rulers of these Houses These two Gods are related in various ways In the Vedas they are even sometimes identified

In accordance with the particular context and meaning of "death", Yama, the God of Death, assumes the aspect of a grim Judge and punisher of the wicked, or that of a wise and benevolent Teacher and Guide In the latter form he appears in the Katha Upanishad If in his exalted form he is not able to grant liberation to those who appear before him, he sends them in his grim form on to "the Hell Fires" of Manifestation in the next Cycle, to begin again in Aries, the House of Agni or Mars If Death has been able to liberate a soul from selfishness and sinfulness and lead it to Resurrection, Aries, the first House of Manifestation, becomes very "Heaven" Then Mars, the Ruler of Aries, takes the aspect of God of Spring Later this subject will be dealt with in various contexts

The two paths. It has been seen before that Ganapati and Janus, the two-headed God, supervise the Two Paths and the choice to tread them. These are called by various names. The Downward Path, that of the Fall, is called Pitri-Yâna, "the Path of the Ancestors", or Bhokti-Mârga, "the Path of Pleasure (literally 'eating')", or the Path of the Moon, or the Path of Death. The Return Path to God has been called the Deva-Yâna, "the Path of the Gods", or Mukti-Mârga, "the Path of Liberation", or the Path of the Sun, or the Path of Life. At every moment anew — for every moment is a new beginning — the choice of Path must be made — till the Goal is reached. In crude words, the choice must be made between materialism, selfishness and sin on the one hand, and spirituality, unselfishness and virtue (meaning true manhood) on the other.

In connection with the apparent movement of the sun the Two Paths have been called the Northward and the Southward Paths. The Spiritual Path then starts with the commencement of winter, when the sun begins to move Northwards. It is the Birth of Christ, Mitra, the Son of Man, in Capricorn. Capricorn is the House of Yama, the God of Death, who is also Lord of Life. It is in this sense that tradition teaches the spiritual striver "to go North". Just as the South may have a meaning varying with the meaning of "dying" in the context in which it occurs, the North also may imply different and opposite things.

Kubera, the Lord of the Treasure. The Gods of Death and Life were seen to be Yama and Agni. The function of God of Death and Life seems to shift continually between Saturn, Ruler of Capricorn and Mars, Ruler of Aries. Their counter-pole is the Regent of the North, Kubera. Kubera is the God of Wealth. He is, like Yama, an aspect of Saturn, but he represents Saturn as Ruler of Aquarius. He is the King of the Yakshas, the Kobolds of Hinduism. In early times and in early Buddhist tradition Kubera occupied a very important place, but in later Hinduism he has not at all been held in esteem. He is not worshipped and he is looked upon with disdain as a materialist, fat man as he is, clasping a money-bag in his hand. In this case, as in so many others, men who had lost insight into the depth and meaning of their tradition, projected their own superficiality upon a divinity. For the higher nature of Kubera is a powerful and exalted one. He is the Lord of Treasure. Kubera is continually engaged in shifting the Treasure from Aquarius, the House of the Supernal Midnight Sun, to Leo, the House of the Sun of Manifestation and the fullness of Life, and back again to Aquarius. In this capacity he will receive more consideration later. His Treasure in Leo is the Fullness

of Solar Power, Light and Life, and in Aquarius the Treasure hidden deep in the Darkness of the Night. In the cycle of a lifetime every man and woman is shifting a little of Kubera's Treasure, first up, and later down. But his greatest and ultimate Treasure is Divine Realization.

Saturn, King of the Earth and of the Gnomes, guards the twofold Treasure of Power and of God-Realization. He teaches that it is found by facing the battle of life in the world. Not by introversion alone, not by running away from the earth can the hidden Gold of the Spirit be found in the Cave of the Heart. He gives a new meaning to "introversion", making it one with "extraversion". He teaches that we must not only be born on earth, but also live on earth, and there find Life Eternal.

In a certain context the twofold Treasure of Kubera is the treasure of worldly power and dominion on the one hand and the treasure of spirituality on the other. The spiritual striver has to choose between them, again and again. Jesus and Buddha were tempted by the Evil One, the Ahankara, with "empire", as the traditions recount. But worldly power is not compatible with Christhood and Buddhahood. Their Kingdom "is not of this world", in the sense of Underworld.

The North Pole is the magnetic factor in life which man cannot escape. In all traditions the North Pole is the pivot for the merry-go-round of life, so too the pole star is the centre for the rotation of the starry heavens. Moreover, the iron needle of the compass points to the North, compelled by an irresistible force. The Pole Star is a symbol of the Immovable Centre of the Wheel of Sansara. In its immovability it is Beyond, beyond Manifestation, beyond the Wheel. In Hinduism the Pole Star is called Dhruva, which means "the Eternal".

Agni, the God of Fire, and his Ram Agni, the God of Fire, is sometimes represented as two-headed, as is the case in Chudambaram. In his two heads are recognized those of Janus (corresponding to Ganapati) Lord of the Two Paths, but here with reference to Manifestation. The Two-tongued Flame of Agni consumes the impure and liberates the pure. It is reflected in the Double Torch of Mithraism and of the Order of the Templars. It is the "sharp two-edged sword" that comes out of the mouth of the one like unto the Son of Man in the Revelation of St John (1, 16). It represents Mars, who, as was seen before, is the thunderbolt in the hand of Indra-Jupiter, and whose task it is both to punish and destroy, or else, as Lord of Spring, to supply the power and energy of life.

The vehicle of Agni is a Ram. Aries, the Ram, is ruled by Mars. Life,

entering Manifestation at the Sunrise in Aries, is both "the Lamb as it had been slain" (Revelation 5; 6) and the Agnus Dei, the Lamb of God. And, indeed, there is an intimate relationship, in etymology as well as in symbolical implications, between Agni and Agnus. Agni is moreover related to the Latin ignis, the Greek aglaos, and the Lithuanian ugnis, all meaning "fire".

There is an alternative representation of Agni with three flaming heads and seven arms. The three flaming heads are the Triple Flame which burns in the Three Worlds and which is mentioned in the Katha Upanishad, in connection with Yama. The seven arms indicate that Mars, though one of the Seven Gods, in his highest aspect combines the Seven and represents the One Overlord. St. John writes in his Revelation (5; 6): "a Lamb as it had been slain, having seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven Spirits of God sent forth into all the earth". Agni, in his highest aspect, is indeed the Sun himself. The Chariot of the Sun is drawn by seven horses. According to an Apocryphal scripture, Jesus said: "He that is near me is near the Fire. He that is far from me is far from the Kingdom."

Every one of the Great Seven or of the Twelve Gods of the Houses of the Zodiac emerges from the One Supernal God, in or beyond Aquarius; and into Him again they are ultimately re-absorbed. In their highest form they are aspects of Him and represent Him. They hold the powers of the other Gods, in their symbols and attributes. This will be shown again in many contexts.

Fire is connected with the lower mind and the Element predominantly involved in the Fall. It is in the mind that the choice is made between "Good" and "Evil", between the right-hand and the left-hand Paths. Its realm is the intermediate one between Spirit and the material world.

In a myth which has been referred to before, the birth of the Solar Hero Kārttikeya is shown to be due to the agency of the God of Fire, Agni. On account of another myth Kārttikeya is sometimes actually called "the son of Agni". The Śakti and Consort of Agni is called Svāhā. This word means "offering" and "heavenly". It will be shown later that the House of Aries represents Svah or Svarloka, that is, "heaven". "Svāhā" is derived from "Svah". Tradition runs that Svāhā visited Agni on six consecutive nights disguised as the wife of one of six of the seven Rishis consecutively. In this myth the six wives of the Rishis are more than stepmothers, though one can hardly call them mothers, since the guise refers only to Māyāvic appearances. The six wives represent alternatively, in Space, the Six Spheres from the Moon-Sphere to the Element Earth, and in Time, the six stages in the Zodiac found in the Six Days of Creation. The seventh symbolizes

that which is of the Solar Sphere and hence beyond both Space and Time Therefore the Seventh Rishi's wife was not involved The fact that the six stepmothers are Śaktis of Rishis or Sages stresses the wisdom-aspect of the Birth of the Solar Hero Kārttikeya, which in the earlier-mentioned myth is a "virgin birth" pure and simple In the myth now related, which does not stress the Divine antecedents of Kārttikeya but the Titanic aspect of Manifestation, the birth is hardly "virgin"

The sixfold birth may be considered from different angles From the "material" or evolutionary or Titanic point of view it represents the sixfold involvement in the material of the Six Spheres, the last being the physical birth From the spiritual or involutionary point of view, or that referring to the Return to the Oneness of God, the six "births" are so many initiations on the Path, each relating to one of the Six Spheres In this connection they are so many aspects or stages of the "virgin birth" According to a Hindu tradition the six heads of Kārttikeya symbolize the Five Mahābhūtas or Elements plus Śakti Śakti is the power of the Moon-Sphere The Solar Hero, while progressing on the Path, harmonizes and synthesizes the powers and faculties of the Six Spheres

Creative or destructive Fire. In all traditions the Element Fire represents the mental plane Fire is always either creative or destructive It is creative if it produces food and warmth and useful energy If it gets out of hand, it becomes destructive It is one of the main symbols of the creative (and destructively) intellect Symbolically "creative" implies freedom from Ahankāra or selfishness, and "destructive" Ahankāric damage In the Maitrī Upanishad (6, 34) one reads "The Manas (mind) is said to be twofold, impure by contact with desire and pure when free from it Manas is indeed the cause of bondage and of liberation for men, of bondage when attached to objects, of freedom when un-attached"

The Ahankāric Fire is found in the symbolism of "hell-fire" and in the punishment of the wicked and sinful by means of the "thunderbolt" in the hands of Jupiter-Guru This Ahankāric Fire burns on all planes On the physical plane it consists of liquid fire, bombs, mines and other mind-created implements of destruction On the emotional plane, in the Element Water, it is found in symbols like the "lake of fire and brimstone" of the Revelation of St John

Fire-rites. Hell-Fire, engendered by the Ahankāra, the one and only Devil, who, however, can manifest himself in innumerable forms — for he works through division and multiplicity — is

ultimately self-destructive. It burns up the lower nature and liberates the soul. The process is continually taking place within the psyche. In order to aid and further it, various traditions have recommended rites of sacrifice, in which various offerings, representing the attachments of the Five Senses, are burned in the sacrificial fire, purifying the elements of the Five Planes, and liberating the soul from impure, that is to say, Ahankâric or selfish, hankerings and attachments. Examples of such rites, as for instance the Hindu Homa rite, will be given elsewhere. The fire ceremonies connected with the Hindu Holy festival originally had also this meaning. The festival falls in early spring. According to tradition the God of Desire, Kâma, was burnt to ashes on that day by Śiva, whom he troubled. Spring is symbolic of the Springtime of the Spirit. Resurrection has to be preceded by the burning up of impurities. Aries is a Fire-House which is ruled by Mars or Agni, the God of the Element Fire. It is the House of the yearly Sunrise. The Light of the Dawn burns up Desire. Desire as associated with Darkness, Ignorance and Sin is destroyed by the Light of a New Day. In various parts of Europe Easter-fires are lit on hill-tops and in prominent places. These are fires of joy, expressive of joy in the Victory of the Sun over the Powers of Darkness, joy in the Resurrection.

Fire-rites are spiritually successful according to the "spirit" that is infused into them and the "inspiration" involved. A fire burns brightly and well if much air is blown into it. There is a popular Hindu belief that if a sacrificial fire burns well it is most auspicious. Some priests predict the future from the way in which it burns. It is, of course, most inauspicious if it goes out.

The Five Kins. The most important teachings are based on the symbolism of the Five Elements. Examples will be given, beginning with some of the simpler ones. The Pañchajanâ or "Five Kins" of Hindu tradition represent the various aspects of human life in the Five Elements, from Earth to Heaven. Their names are mentioned in the Aitareya Brâhmana, the Brihad Devatâ and other scriptures. The first kin is called either Sarpâ, "Serpents", or Uruga-Râkshasa, or Yaksha-Râkshasa. Urugas are Serpent-beings, Yakshas are Gnomes. Rakshas, from which the word Râkshasas has been derived, is the Spirit of Illusion, generally taking the form of a monstrous serpent. This first Kin belongs to Earth. It will be met more often later on. The word Râkshasas is generally rendered by "demons"; but in the myths fierce and terrible looking Râkshasas were sometimes pious in nature. The Elements, which are pure by themselves, become impure through the trifling and rapine of the Ahankâra, the man-of-self-

and-sin The Five Kins are spoken of in the Rîg-veda (X, 53) as the *Daivya-Janâ*, "the heavenly kin" They are said to have a superior understanding, in contrast to "those here" whose understanding is profane It is the separative and grabbing nature of the lower self which breaks harmony and destroys communion and understanding, bringing about all that is evil The Five Kins are said to be *yajñiyâsah*, which signifies "proper to be sacrificially worshipped" Even Illusion, the characteristic of the physical plane, is a harmless quality in the hands of a pure and childlike soul That even the Kin of Earth is fit to be worshipped is another way of saying that the physical body by itself is in no way evil, contrary to religious teachings which confuse "evil" with one of its possible fields of activity, the body

The second Kin is called *Pitara*, meaning "Fathers" or "Ancestors". The link with the members of the family, alive and dead, is predominantly an emotional one The *Pitaras* belong to the Element Water It has been mentioned before that the "dream-state" of consciousness is connected with the Element Water The actors in dreams are generally people with whom the dreamer has emotional contacts Relatives predominate That the dream-actors largely symbolize aspects of the dreamer himself and are thus "Elementals" or even Gods or Angels and their adversaries in forms pertaining to the emotional plane, is also true Physical existence is determined on the plane above the physical, namely the "astral" plane of emotion and desire Eastern traditions teach that a soul chooses its parents previous to incarnation in the womb The choice is ultimately an emotional one In this connection there is an element of truth in the modern idea that a son is in love with his mother and a daughter with her father

The third Kin is called *Manushyâ*, "Men", and occasionally *Asurâ*, "Not-Angels" (The word *Asurâ* has also other etymological antecedents) These terms, belonging to a Vedic tradition, developed a different meaning in subsequent Hindu tradition A *Manushyan* was originally a mental being, a thinker, a denizen of the Element Fire Now it means a man, a human being In the East as well as in the West, "man" derived his name from the "mind"

The fourth Kin is called *Devâ*, Gods, "heavenly beings", Angels They belong to the Element Air or Spirit They are sensed by the Buddha the faculty of spiritual discrimination

The fifth Kin is called *Gandharvâ* To a modern Hindu it may seem strange that *Gandharvas* rank higher than *Devas* for now *Gandharvas* are taken to be no more than heavenly singers and musicians in Indra's heaven Yet even in this conception something of the original meaning has been preserved, for Indra's heaven is the Ether He is Lord of the *Âkāśa*.

The original meaning of Gandharva is a most exalted one. In the Vedas the Gandharva was a glorious being, a "measurer of space". He is the Higher Self, the Son of God, the Lord of Ether, the Quintessence, the Lord of Light. In the Rig-veda (X) we read: "Erect, to Heaven hath the Gandharva mounted, pointing at us his many coloured weapons; clad in sweet raiment, beautiful to look on, for he, as light, produceth forms to please us." "High to heaven's vault hath the Gandharva risen, beholding all his varied forms and figures. His ray hath gone abroad with gleaming splendour: pure he hath lighted up both the worlds, the Parents". Light is a symbol of Ether, as physical light is connected with the ether of space. The conception of Gandharvas as heavenly singers and musicians is derived from the symbolism of the Word, voiced in the Ether, in the words of the Veda "producing forms to please us" in the manifested world of the Four Elements. The "harmonies of the spheres" are produced by the Gandharva. The original meaning of Gandharva has also persisted to some extent in that the term is used for the soul after death and previous to rebirth. The Four Elements are spheres of temporary incarnation. The Ether, however, is an aeviternal abode. It is the abode of the soul before the Fall and after the Return to Sonship. The Fall makes the soul "blind" and "deaf" for its glories and harmonies.

Later the connection between the Five Kins and the Five Sacrifices will be noted. There is also a connection between the Kins and the stages of the Zodiac.

Symbolism of the dimensions. The four dimensions are symbolically connected with the Four Elements (see Diagram 1).

The dimension of height and length is one which pertains to the rational faculty. The mind thinks in terms of "higher" and "lower". In the Element Fire the vertical view predominates. A flame strives upwards. The denizens of the Element Fire often take the form of giants.

The horizontal view predominates in the Element Water. Symbolical for it is the dimension of breadth. Outstretched arms are an emotional symbol. The function of feeling places people and things side by side, and measures their "broadness" or "narrowness".

The dimension of thickness is symbolically connected with the Element Earth, and also the "depth" to the distance, which is the same dimension. In natural art, therefore, portraying the physical plane, perspective plays an important part. In traditional art, in which generally only the emotional, mental and spiritual elements are of importance, perspective is generally

lacking In natural art it is often the horizon which provides the spiritual note, and the path to the horizon then symbolizes the spiritual Path

It is clear that "depth" should be qualified "Depth" to the bottom is a kind of inverted height and relates to the Underworld, the Deep "Depth" to the distance concerns the physical dimension "Depth" to the centre concerns the spiritual element It symbolizes the distance from the circumference, the outer, the physical, to the centre, the inner, the spiritual The centre symbolizes the innermost Divinity To the Element Air pertains the concentric and the centrical view and all symbols which have a centre are symbols referring to spiritual matters From the point of view of the more "superficial" psychical functions, man should, to find the Spirit, "go inward" or "go deeper", in order to arrive ultimately at the Core, the Central Sun, Divinity, symbolized by a point (generally represented by a small circle) This relates to the Sun-Sphere To the Moon-Sphere pertains the structure, including time And weight is symbolically connected with the Ether-Sphere Weight is considered to be the quintessence of the dimensions This will be dealt with in other contents The symbolism of the dimensions will be often mentioned

Words like "world", "plane", "sphere", "field", though now used rather loosely, were once used preferably in connection with one or other of the Elements The emotional or astral "plane" is a "field" The word "world" has been derived from a word for "man" and means literally "man's age" It is an intellectual and moral term "Sphere" is a term of Air, "Essence" a term of Ether, "Element" a term of Earth Yet all these terms denote the same states of existence, seen, as it were, through so many coloured glasses, or from so many "points of view"

In the symbolic language of Earth, man must "dig for the Treasure", "sow the corn in the earth", "find the Philosopher's Stone", "seek the Cave of the Heart", "make the Gold in the Great Work", and so on The Element Water is the astral or emotional plane The word "planet" meant originally "wanderer" In the language of this plane man has to "cross the Ocean of Samsâra", "cross the River of Death", "walk the Path", "water the garden of life", and so on In the language of Fire he must "climb the ladder" which Jacob saw, and which is found in the seven chakras or centres of Râja Yoga, "the kingly way of union", and Laya or Kundalini Yoga, the way of union by means of the Creative Fire These are suited for the mental plane Or he must "climb the Mountain" Anyway he must "go up step by step", a procedure which typifies the function of the reasoning mind, in contradistinction to the function of Buddhi, pertaining to Air For the Air requires flight In the symbols of Air the spiritual centre appears,

in the Cross or in the Pentacle, in the Svastika, literally "the good" or "the fortunate" sign, or in the Hexagram , all symbols to be understood by Jñāna Yoga, by the help of the function of Buddhi. The Centre in these symbols symbolizes Divinity or the Spiritual Pole.

Elemental Symbolism. In connection with the above, Activity, "creative" and "destructive", has been represented in symbolism borrowed from all Five Elements. The Lord of Activity, GOD, has been symbolized in terms of all the Spheres.

Material objects of Earth have become symbols of God, as for instance the Śiva-Linga, the Metæ of ancient Rome, the Bethel of Jacob, the Philosophers' Stone, and, in a way, material images of Gods and Saviours. Moreover, the entire universe of "heavenly bodies" has become the material for the expression of the most exalted spiritual symbolism. Since it is indeed the most material of the Six Materials or "mother-stuffs" of Spirit, there is nothing strange in this.

The Great Mother is the "Moon", ruler of the Night and of the Stars, symbols of Karma or fate and destiny. Where the Light of the Sun shines by itself alone and obliterates all other lights, the Moon rules a multiplicity of starry lights. She receives her Light from the Sun and reflects it on the Earth. There she is represented by Mother Earth. The Great Goddess, whose symbol is the moon, is the Creatrix. She is Mâyā. She is Existence. She is the World-Mother.

The Moon-Goddess is the Ruler of the Waters above the Firmament or the Supernal Ocean as well as of the Milky Way or Milk Ocean of Manifestation. She is reflected "below" in the Element Water, the Ocean of Samsāra, the Waters below the Firmament. There she is represented by Venus. Her Light manifests below in the Element Fire, and her Spirit in the Element Air.

"As Above, so Below". Therefore it is that the mystics can express their inner life in terms of the language of the Elements, and of the senses which symbolically correspond to them, while knowing that for the greatest mystical experience, that of the Reality-Light-Bliss of Sonship in Ether, the Four Elements have to be surpassed. St. Augustine wrote in his Confessions (X; 27): "Thou calledst and criedst unto me, Thou didst burst open my deafness. Thou didst flash and shine unto me, and didst scatter my blindness. Thou didst most fragrantly blow upon me, and I drew in breath and panted for Thee. I tasted Thee, and I did hunger and thirst after Thee. Thou didst touch me, and I burned for Thy peace." Yet he writes (IX; 10): "If to any man the tumults of the flesh be hushed, if the

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images of the earth and waters and air be hushed also, if the poles of heaven be hushed also, yea, if the very soul be hushed to herself, and by not thinking upon self surmount self, if all dreams and imaginary revelations be hushed, every tongue and every sign, and whatsoever is transient, since if any could hear, all these say 'We made not ourselves, but He made us that abideth for ever' — If then having uttered this, they too should be hushed, having roused only our ears to Him who made them and He alone speak, not by them, but by Himself, that we may hear His Word, not through any tongue of flesh, nor Angel's voice, nor sound of thunder, nor in the dark riddle of a similitude, but might hear Whom in all these things we love, might hear His Very Self without these, could this exaltation of spirit be continued, and other visions of a kind far unlike be withdrawn, and this alone ravish us and swallow us up, and wrap up the beholder amid these inward joys, so that life might be for ever like that very moment of understanding which we now sighed after, were not this as much as 'Enter into thy Master's joy'?" — Meanwhile, however, he has to continue living, expressing himself, and teaching in the material of the Four Elements

On the Plane of Water, Creation has been described in various traditions in a number of ways, as for instance the issuing of the Seven Rivers from the Supernal Ocean, or the issuing of the Seven Rivers or Streams from the central well or Source, or the flowing of the Four Rivers from the Mountain-top, or the dividing of the Waters above from those below the Firmament, and so on

Water symbolism is found in the rituals of all traditions, from the simple ablutions of Islâm to the Abhisheka-rites of Hinduism and Buddhism, and the sacrament of Baptism and the holy water of Christianity Their object is to contribute to the regaining of "the original purity" and harmony by the purification of the emotional life Water in the form of "the Water of Life" represents "the stream of Consciousness" and the Tradition

Rites of exorcism. The ravages of the *Ahankâra* — selfishness and egotism — are capable of bringing about a serious disharmony between the elements of a human personality, causingt confusion and displacements in the soul Some subsidiary par, may go to the extent of taking possession of other parts Hallucinations, crimes of passion, forms of mania and madness, "obsessions", "possessions", are so many different examples Psycho-analysis is a rationalist attempt at bringing order into the psyche The religious rites of exorcism are based on a deeper traditional insight The following is a translation of the end of an invocation to be uttered when a

person "is tormented by spirits from the Elemental Kingdoms". It belongs to a mixed Cabalistic and Hermetic tradition. "That Water returneth to Water, that Fire burneth, that Air revolveth, that Earth falleth to Earth, by the power of the Pentagram which is the morning star, and in the name of the Tetragram which is written in the centre of the Cross of the Light. Amen." The Tetragram is the name of four letters: JHVH or Jehovah, who is the Lord of the Ether, and corresponds to Jupiter and Guru. His name is, of course, "written in the centre of the cross of Light." In the accompanying rite, the Earth is adjured with a sword, the Water with holy water, the Fire with fire, and the Air with the breath.

Fairy-tales of the traditional type are often full of symbolism relating to Ahankâric possession. Everybody remembers from his childhood the stories of "princes" or "princesses" who were turned by magic (or Mâyâ) into a stone, a tree or an animal, either because they had committed some sin, or because they had offended some fairy or genic — which is the same thing from another point of view. The "prince" represented at first the ideal, all-round, harmonious man. The "stone" indicated the Fall into materialism, including the physical involvements of sex. The "tree" indicated a Fall into weaknesses of the emotional plane, including sex and sense. The "animal" indicated a Fall into mental or moral weaknesses such as undue curiosity, desire for unnecessary or "forbidden" knowledge, conceit, greed or anger, each of which is represented by a particular animal. The "world" is full indeed of "werewolves", meaning man-wolves, and other man-animals. The fairy-tale rite is usually — for instance, in the Arabian Nights — that water, after having been prepared with certain ingredients (again relating to the different Planes) and generally after having been boiled over a fire, is thrown over the bewitched person.

At the same time words like the following are pronounced: "If thou wast created by the Sovereign Master of the world as thou appearest at this time, continue in this form, but if thou be a man and art changed into this shape by enchantment, return to thy natural shape." The "natural state" to which the "bewitched" person has to return is the Original State of Purity of the Element Ether. By the purificatory influence of the Water of Life the temporary "animal nature", brought about by the Fall, is transmuted into its original nature of purity and obedience. The fairy-tale rite is nothing but a form of baptism. Every man is in need of it, in order to return to his "natural" state. There is no need to stress the point, that this "natural state" is not the same as, but rather the opposite of the natural state of most naturalists. That the changes, which myths and folk-lore hint at, actually take place, that men are "possessed by their animal nature" and can return to true manhood,

priests and psychiatrist have known in all ages Man's "animal nature" indeed causes much trouble and provokes many tears, which have to be redeemed by the Dewdrops of Heaven

Harmony implies order and a state in which everything is in its own place, and behaves according to its own natural laws The definition of dirt as "matter in the wrong place" could very well be applied in psychology It is the Ahankâric desires and tendencies which cause breach of harmony and bring confusion they cause psychic dirt The bewitchment of the Ahankâra, the sinner-and-grabber, has to be undone on every plane, thereby re-establishing purity of thought, word and deed One reads how Christ exorcised seven devils from Mary Magdalene

The Baptism of Jesus. The Baptism of Jesus is more than a purification of the Element Water within the soul It is also more than a

spiritual reviviscence through the Water of Life It denotes the harmonization and reunion of the Elements of the Soul and the consequent attainment of Sonship in the Quintessence, the Ether, the Kingdom of Heaven St John the Baptist proclaimed that "I indeed baptize you with water unto repentance" (St Matthew 3, 11), referring to the ordinary purification in Water He went on to hint that Jesus would do much more and would bring full and perfect harmonization and synthesis "He shall baptize you with the Holy Spirit, and with Fire "The Holy Spirit is the Intelligence of the Moon-Sphere, manifesting through the Intelligence of the Element Air St John next referred to the Elements Air, Earth and Fire "Whose fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly purge his floor, and gather his wheat into the garner, but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire " And then came Jesus to be baptized An Apocryphal tradition states that, when Jesus was in the water of the Jordan, fire appeared over the river "And, lo, the heavens were opened unto him, and he saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove, and lighting upon him And lo a voice from heaven, saying, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased " (St Matthew 3, 16-17) The Dove is a form of the Bird of the Element Air and represents the Spirit It will be considered more in detail on another occasion The "voice from heaven" expresses the Word and names the Son The Voice is the Mother, the Speaker is the Father and the Word is the Son In the "Gospel according to the Hebrews" Jesus speaks of "My Mother the Holy Spirit"

The sixteen divisions Every one of the Four Elements has four sub-divisions on the same basis, each of which represents an Element within the field of an Element Four times four makes

sixteen. The number 16 is found in various forms in different traditions. The 16 Court Cards of the Tarot as well as the 16 faces of the Four Living Creatures of Ezekiel refer to "the 16 Elements". The Hindu Shodasopachara Pûjâ, "the worship with 16 offerings", was originally a reference to them. In one form of the Dîpa, the rite of "waving of lights" before the Deity, a lamp is used which is shaped like a stiff Christmas tree, and on which 16 lights are burning. A Tântrik tradition holds that the 16 offerings apply to the 16 Kalâs, and the stages of spiritual development. Kalâ (not to be confused with Kâla, Time; Kâlî, the Goddess; and Kali, the spirit of the Kali Yuga) is one of the Kanchukas, which are particular forms or sheaths of Mâyâ. Kalâ implies limitations of space, sections of existence, digits of the Moon (of which there are 16). Kalâ is said to be that which makes man a "little doer", in contradistinction to the Almightiness of the Supreme. There are five Kanchukas, one for each of the Five Elements. Kalâ refers to the material or elemental aspect of things, as expressed particularly in Earth. The other four need not concern us here.

Aqua In a seventeenth century Rosicrucian work the "Philosophorum. sophical Labour" was laid down in terms of Water in the following 16 lines. The heading is Aqua Philosophorum, "the Water of the Philosophers", with the sub-heading Mercurius Primaterialis (Prima-Materialis) Catholicus. Mercury is the fluid metal, the Elixer of Life, which is intermediary in transmuting the lower metals into Gold, or, in other words, the lower elements of the soul into Spirit. The Mercury of the Alchemists was the Quintessence. He or It is, of course, "catholic", that is to say, universal, all-embracing. To the 16 verses is added the remark: "Four times Four make 16 verses, so many are also the Elements", which provides the key to their interpretation.

1. "Water is water and remains Water,
2. Water rains down from the Heaven of the Sages;
3. The Philosophers' Stone weeps Water of tears,
4. Yet the world takes no notice of such Water.
5. Its Fire burns in Water
6. And lives in Water.
7. Make Water from Fire,
8. And boil the Fire in Water;
9. Thus comes a fiery Water
10. Like a sharply salted Ocean-Water.
11. It is to children a living Water.
12. Because it dissolves body and soul into Water.

- 13 It begins to stink, becomes green, tainted, blue, like Heaven-Water
 14 Digest, calcify, solve and putrefy the Water,
 15 Seek the fourfold abiding Water of the Philosophers,
 16 And when it has been done perfectly, the Art (itself) becomes Water
 Aqua Q E Secreta "

Taken in a literal sense, these lines embody pure nonsense. But with the key to their symbolism they reveal a treasure of advice on the Path. Their order is from Earth to Air, one by one, and again in groups of four. The first four verses refer to the physical plane. The first line is the only one which should be taken literally, both in the material and in the spiritual sense. The fourth line expresses the fact that the manifestation of the Spirit remains unnoticed by "the world". Verses 5-7 refer to the relation of the emotional life with the moral and intellectual life, and verse 8 to their tempering by spiritual emotion. Verses 9-12 refer to the intellectual and moral plane. To "children" even dry reason is a function of Life. "Children", besides indicating new-born souls, may also represent actions in the form of "thoughts, words and deeds". The synthesis of the verses 9-11 leads to, and is conditioned by, the dissolution, in the 12th verse, by the influence of Spirit. The last four verses, which require a more detailed knowledge of Alchemic symbolism, refer to the spiritual stage. The influence of the Spirit is directed on to the lower Elements or their functions. In the 16th line the aim or goal is achieved: the Art, that is, the Great Labour of the Philosopher or Alchemist, becomes itself identical with the Water of Life, the Elixir of Immortality — but, of course, only if the requirements of the previous stages have been met perfectly!

Ignis If this symbolism was focussed more particularly in the **Philosophorum**, emotional Element, the same work presents the Great Labour also in terms of Fire, with the same reference to the 16 Elements. The heading is here "Ignis Philosophorum", with the sub-heading 'invisibilis & secretissima occultatum'

- 1 "Strive for the Fire,
- 2 Seek the Fire
- 3 Thus findest thou Fire,
- 4 Light a Fire,
- 5 Add Fire to Fire,
- 6 Boil Fire in Fire,
- 7 Throw body, soul, intellect into the Fire
- 8 Thus hast thou dead and living Fire,

9. Out of that comes black, yellow, white and red Fire,
10. Bear thy children in Fire,
11. Give them food and drink and nourish them in Fire:
12. Then they live and die in Fire,
13. And are Fire and remain in the Fire.
14. Their silver and gold all becomes Fire.
15. Heaven and earth pass away in Fire,
16. And finally comes a fourfold Philosophical Fire.

Ignis Q. E. Coelest."

The first four lines refer to the inquiry into the nature and application of Fire with respect to the physical plane. The second set of four lines refers to the emotional plane. In verse 7 the physical, emotional and intellectual are synthesized and purified. The distinction between death and life comes out in verse 8. Verses 9-12 refer to the Element Fire itself. In verse 9 the four Elements appear in colours. The "children" in verse 10 refer to actions: thoughts, words and deeds, on the mental, emotional and physical planes. Food, drink and nourishment in verse 11 again refer to Earth, Water and Fire. This symbolism will become clear later in other connections. In verse 12 stress is again laid on life and death. Here life comes first, but eventually all "children" must die in Fire, and by that death, in verse 13, they become immortal. In verses 14 and 15 duality dissolves in its various aspects into One. The aim or goal is the Solar Fire, One but manifesting in the Four Elements. It is "the Fire which is heavenly, the Ignis of the Philosophers, the light of the Ether-Sphere, which is "invisible" and "hidden", unlike the fire of the physical plane.

On account of the fact that the sixteen phases refer to the four times four Elements in their proper order, they should pertain to the spiritual path through the Zodiac and, therefore, to the year and the day. This is indeed the case. We read, for instance, in the *Bṛihadāraṇyaka Upanishad* (I; 15,14): "Prajāpati is the year, it has sixteen divisions." Prajāpati is literally "the Lord of Genesis". In parts of Europe the day was divided in sixteen parts or great-hours, before the time of Charlemagne, and even now in Bavaria the farmers use the great-hour of $1\frac{1}{2}$ hours. The Dutch word "etmaal" for the day is a witness of its original eightfold division. The compass with its sixteen main divisions is also based on ancient tradition. The number sixteen in old Norse and Germanic traditions will be further mentioned in the *Book of Stars*.

To return to the Element Fire — it is pre-eminently the Element and symbol of creation and manifestation. In *Rāja Yoga*, the Way of Union

pertaining to the Plane of Fire, the creative Fire is symbolized as Kundalini. This is the Mother-Power, which by a systematic procedure, has to be re-united with the Supernal Father, Śiva, her Lord. Creation and Manifestation are primarily the outcome of activity in the Cosmic Mind. The Moon and the Martian Mind. Kundalini is the Serpent-Power. The Element Fire is that of the Serpents or Salamanders.

Sulphur-symbolism The Divine Fire purifies the Ahankâric "hell-fire" of the mind. This is the Fire-baptism. The Divine Fire — the same as the Light of the Supernal Sun, the Father — was symbolized by the Alchemists in Sulphur. The Triad Sulphur-Mercury-Salt represented in Sulphur God the Father, The Creative Spirit, in Salt God the Mother, the Created world, and in Mercury the Son Mercury, or Hermes the thrice Great, combines in his symbol  the symbols of Sun, Moon and Cross. The Mercury of this Hermetic Triad represents the Quintessence and is identified with the Christ. He is not the same as the Mercury who is one of the Great Seven, Lord of Air of other traditions. Sulphur, Mercury and Salt are the three "ingredients" in the Great Work of the Alchemist. With their aid the Great Work must be accomplished: the discovery of the Philosophers' Stone, the making of the Gold, the distillation of the Elixir of Life. In crude modern words: the achievement of God-Realization. The divine Sulphur-Fire implies torment for the Ahankâra, it is the "lake of fire and brimstone" or sulphur, of the Revelation of St. John. A great number of symbolic terms have entered into popular beliefs, without being in the least understood.

The fire of the hearth Fire lends itself as easily for purposes of creation and manifestation as for those of purification and destruction. The most ancient symbolism of creative and sustaining fire is that of the hearth. Out of it grew the symbolism of the "boiling of Water" which was worked out into an entire science by the Alchemists. Of more importance has been the universal symbolism of creation and sustenance in the preparation of food by the help of that fire, and in particular the symbolism of the baking of bread.

Cremation-rites. Many Hindu rituals imply the purification of the personality by Fire. One of them, aiming at the ultimate and perfect purification, is the rite of Sannyâsa or "renunciation of the world." He who renounces worldliness burns up the impurities caused by the Ahankâra, the sinful one, on the lower planes, those of Earth,

Water and Fire. This idea has been preserved in substance to this day⁷ for a man taking Sannyâsa is supposed to light his own funeral pyre and cremate himself. He must become "dead to the world". He burns his Vâsanâs or attachments and tendencies and the very root of Ahankâra or "Ego-action". He ceases to be separate and is consumed by God. At least that is what the ritual aims at.

The cremation of the bodies of the dead has to be considered in the same light. The bodies of Indian Saints and Sages are generally not cremated, but buried. With regard to them there is no need for the last Fire, since the Fire-purification has already been achieved during their lifetime.

Brick- The colour of Fire is reflected in the red ochre cloths
symbolism. worn by the Sannyâsi or wandering monk. The true Sannyâsi is "the burnt red brick". Brick-symbolism is deeply suggestive. A brick consists of earth. The earth is mixed with water, and then it is baked over a fire, into which air is blown. When it has been hardened and is perfect in shape, it is used in the construction of the house. The house is a symbol for the body. Actually it is — or should be — a temple. The body is the temple of God. The ideal "body of men", human society, is the Temple of God.

A brick is used for the creative purpose of building. But it may also be used in dissolution-symbolism. As such it occurs in the ceremony — an example of a fragment of a forgotten tradition — which is generally observed by high-caste Hindus on (or before) the 16th day after the decease of a person. Incidentally the number 16, may be noted. The dead person is invoked by a priest into a burnt brick. Afterwards the brick is thrown into a river. The river represents the Supernal Water of the Sign of Aquarius at the end of the Cycle of Manifestation, following on the Sign of Death, Capricorn. It symbolizes the dissolution in the "Waters above the Firmament" of Varuna or Uranus. The river also symbolizes the Element Water, which, as will be noted elsewhere, is the Element connected with the Pitris or Ancestors. The Element Water follows the Element Earth, from which the deceased has passed away. In the Śaiva Siddhânta community the rite is performed with one brick. In the Brâhman community the deceased is generally invoked into three bricks, one for every one of the lower planes, or for the "three worlds". Stones may be taken if bricks are not at hand, a fact which demonstrates forgetfulness of the meaning. The bricks are said to represent Yama, Kâla and Chanda. Yama is the God of Death, the other two are his servants. In accordance with the same spiritual aim the ashes of the deceased are generally immersed in the water of a sacred river,

preferably the Ganges Gangâ, the river Ganges, is the Heavenly River of Aquarius. It comes into Manifestation in Aries, the House of the beginning of life, as will be shown later. The rite thus aims at resurrection as well as at liberation.

The meaning of Sannyâsa. Sannyâsa has been considered in its negative aspect, as implying the renunciation of worldliness and the crea-

tion of the lower man. The positive and higher aspect of Sannyâsa is found in the word itself, actually sam-nyâsa, meaning "conjoined and complete dedication to the Divine". It indeed implies the harmonization, synthesis and unification of all the part-personalities of the human soul. It refers to the very last stage of the Path, involving utter dedication to God-Reality. Nyâsa is a rite of dedication which forms part of every major religious rite. Hindu tradition teaches what one finds expressed in the Cabalistic work the Zohar (I, 272b) where it is said that "all the members and parts of the human body" correspond with "sacred forms". During the Nyasa rite the tips of the fingers and the palm of the right hand are put on various parts of the body, in order that they may be filled with the divine life, Chit-Śakti, "Dynamic Consciousness" or "the Consciring Power", according to the Tântrik explanation. The rite is at the same time a systematic dedication of the body in its parts to God in His Gods, and a sanctification of the body in its parts by identification with the Intelligences which created them. The word "Nyâsa" is derived from a word for to "place". When Nyâsa becomes perfect, in other words, when dedication and sanctification has been fully achieved, a man is a Sannyâsi — and not until then. In modern times the Sannyâsi way of life has unfortunately fallen into much discredit. Some people adopt it as a way of escape from the world for negative instead of for positive reasons. Others take it prematurely, and disgrace it by exhibitions of all kinds of Ahankâric weaknesses, the subtlest of which is spiritual pride. And many who are complete frauds put on the sacred fire-coloured cloth of Sannyâsa, if not to indulge in vices, then to obtain food and money at the expense of those who still uphold the venerable tradition that the Sannyâsi is the Man of God, who has to be shown hospitality like God himself. As a consequence it is found that often true Sannyâsins refrain from putting on the ochre cloth, in order to stress the fact that Sannyasa is a state of the soul and that externals do not matter.

The five sacrifices of Hinduism. The Five Sacrifices of Hinduism also refer to the Five Elements. The word "sacrifice", by forgetfulness of its original meaning, has assumed the sense of painful, almost compulsory, dutiful, renunciation of attachments, whatever they are. Originally and philologically it meant "holy-making". Such is indeed the true intention of a sacrifice. The Latin "Sacrum" included all things dedicated to the Light-Gods. A sacrifice was an offering symbolical of some aspect of human nature. Consecratio was the rite of dedication with the laying of the obligation on the God concerned to protect and watch over the person or object involved. The Hindu word for sacrifice is Yajña, or Yājanam, both words from the root Yaj, meaning primarily to offer and hence to shine, to worship, to combine, to dedicate. In Yajña this is combined with jña, the root of realization. In Hindu philosophy the word Yajña may also indicate the relation between God and his World. In this light the "sacrifice" of Christ may be understood. Life itself, in the highest sense, is sacrifice. In the Gītā (IV; 23) it is said that "When a man's attachment is gone, when he is harmonized and his mind is well-established in wisdom and he works for yajña (sacrifice) alone, his whole karma melts away." The same Chapter of the Gītā enumerates a vast number of forms of sacrifice, referring to different temperaments according to the focus of consciousness on one or other of the Planes.

When considering the Five Sacrifices, it is clear that each of them implies each of the Five Planes. They do not stress the importance of any one plane, but concern them all equally. Their purpose is to synthesize the five into a harmonious whole, taking into account the spiritual level of people. Though all five are prescribed for all people, it is inevitable that for each person some will be more attractive than others according to temperament.

The sacrifice applying to Earth. The first Sacrifice is Bhūta-yajña. It is an offering supposed to be performed for the benefit of animals, by feeding and tending them. Another opinion is that offerings have to be made to Gods, ancestors, animals, birds, worms, and other creatures. It has been noted before that the word Bhūta has a wide meaning, including elements, elementals, nature spirits, ghosts, animals and all creatures. Hence different popular interpretations are only to be expected. The sacrifice refers to the Element Earth, and secondarily to its sub-divisions according to the Elements. It is the first and easiest. It increases unselfish love of creation. It serves a moral purpose, at the same time benefiting the animal world. And it lends to lift up the mind towards the planes of which the particular "bhūtas" are the symbols.

The sacrifice applying to Water. The second Sacrifice is Pitri-yajña Pitris are Ancestors They correspond to the Pitaras, the second of the Five Kins In the Pitri-yajña or Tarpana rite the main ingredients are water and gingely (sesame) The sacrifice concerns the Element Water, the emotional plane Sesame, as will be seen later, is a symbol of great significance The rite is said to be a family rite, involving family honour The most intimate life of a man and a woman is that of the family The most intimately known plane, on the whole, is the astral or emotional plane The ancestors also represent family-tradition In the conception of honour and family-honour the emotional and erotic factors predominate over other factors In the Element Water are decided matters of love and chastity Previously other remarks have been made with regard to the Pitaras, the second Kin In birth and death the Element Water is that from which a soul comes into incarnation and into which it disappears "He it is who hath created man of Water, then made him capable of the ties of kindred and affinity and potent is thy Lord "(Korān, Sūra Al Furkân 56)

The most intimate contacts between human beings, by their nature exclusive and selective (unlike spiritual contacts which are all-inclusive) are in the Element Water No element but the liquid lends itself so easily for the fusion of likes Water may also serve as a mirror "As in water face answereth to face, so the heart of man to man " (Proverbs of Solomon 27, 19)

The Ancestors and what they symbolize. The sacrifice to the Ancestors has to be performed in a very simple form every day A similar rite is performed on the days of the anniversary of the death of parents and grandparents It is a very grand rite and is called the Śraddha ceremony It is performed for the spiritual benefit of "seven ancestors" These are the father and the mother and the two pairs of grandparents The seventh is the primordial progenitor, the founder of the family or clan According to tradition a man cannot be liberated if he has no son or grandson to perform this ceremony for him This seemingly rather senseless condition provides the key to the deeper meaning of the Śraddha ceremony, which, it should be stressed, in no way takes away the more apparent intention of the rite The "seven ancestors" represent the Powers of Creation Six of them represent the Six Planes, from the Moon-Sphere to the Element Earth The seventh, the "primordial progenitor" represents the Sun, the All-Father The Great Seven in their Titanic aspect have created the Microcosm, that is to say, the individual human being, as well as the Macrocosm, the Universe They have become involved

within the soul in a struggle against the bondage of Ahankāra. Liberation therefore implies the liberation of these divine Essences or intelligences from the bondage of ignorance, disharmony and fragmentation, as caused by the Fall. Liberation further means the birth of the divine Child in the Cave of the Heart. Without that spiritual birth there cannot be salvation. Hence "there must be a son." One of the fundamental traditions of the Freemasons is contained in the sentence "Thou livest in thy son!" He who gives birth to the Divine Child liberates the parents who created him, literally and anagogically. He becomes their Saviour. They are in him as well as without him. The final synthesis and harmonization of the elements of the psyche, leading to Birth, gives salvation to our ancestors in the sense of the karmic factors which brought about our existence. The "physical plane" ancestors are the externalization of the ancestors in the deeper sense of the word. The psyche including its physical sheath, is nothing but a complex of karmas seen and unseen actions and their results, springing from *vr̥ttis* and *vāsanās* psychical modifications and tendencies. Taking into account the nature of the world of appearance it may be said that a man *is* his karma, and that everything around a man, including the entire Universe, is part of his karma. Thus he forms also part of the karmas of others around him, and in the first place of his parents! It is surely a great blessing and a source of great happiness and satisfaction to a father and mother if a child of theirs attains to that state of being which is the noblest that human emotions can aspire to. In that case their own child becomes like Bālarama, Bālakrishna or Bālasubramanya the Divine Child is born to them! It should be remembered that the emotional element predominates in this connection. And with regard to deceased parents, the Śrāddha ceremony as well as any form of prayer for the dead, is certain to help them "to cross over to the other shore." Whatever be the particular aspect considered at the moment, the very intimate relationship of all things in life becomes most easily apparent with regard to the emotional plane, the Element Water.

The mythological curiosity of a child giving birth to its parent may also be considered in connection with what has just been explained.

The Gods and their Adversaries are represented by, and use the people with whom a man comes into contact. Modern psychologists have expressed this truth to some extent by saying that a man "projects" his inner life, as embodied in his failings as well as in his good qualities, on to the people he has to deal with in the world around him. This is true in the sense that everything is projected without from within. The outer world is an externalization of the inner world, cosmically and individually. Yet it is equally true that the outer world stretches out its hands towards the inner world.

that a man on earth stretches out his hands towards the heavens, whether he realizes it or not

Furthermore the Gods and their Adversaries appear in the dreams of the average man, disguised in the forms of parents, relatives, friends, employers, priests, public personalities, in fact, of anybody, according to the psychological trend and need of the moment. They show themselves more "as they are", in subtler, more exalted, more heavenly and less earthly forms, to those whose sense of vision has become more "spiritualized" or even "etherealized". In the myths and fairy-tales the Gods and their Adversaries often put on a disguise when they move among men. In the myths they generally show their true form only to great devotees.

Traditionally priests and mystics, saints and sages, are the instruments of the Divine, and the mediators between God and man, like their Master, the Holy Spirit, the Lord of the Element Air. And for those who have become true "aspirants", breathing ever more freely the pure air of the Spirit, God comes in the form of the Guru.

The Element Water, the astral or emotional plane, to which the Śraddha ceremony particularly refers, is also the plane of the quality of Śraddhā, a related word, meaning piety and faith, in the sense of a spiritually purified emotion focussed on an aspect of God: faith in and love of God like that of a child in and of its father or mother.

The sacrifice applying to Fire. The third Sacrifice is Nir-yajña. It is the offering of food and hospitality to guests. We have seen before that the third Kṛm is that of Manushyā or "Men". This "sacrifice" has reference to the Element Fire. Agni, the

God of Fire, is called in Vedic tradition "the Guest of Man" or "the Guest in the Sacred Jar". The "guest" is the creative mind. The Sacred Jar consists of the psyche, including the physical body. It is composed of the Five Elements. Its symbolism is parallel to that of "the temple of God" or "the house of God". This last symbolism is based on the existing conditions in a human dwelling, in which fire is "the guest of the hearth", providing light, warmth and food. It has been traditionally externalized in church and temple, in which the Eternal Light of God is represented by an everburning flame.

The lower mind and the stomach. The higher Mind is represented in Manifestation "below" by the fiery creative power of the lower mind. The Divine Mind is Consciousness in its Solar and Lunar forms. It is heavily veiled in the psyche of the worldly-

minded who are hardly or not at all aware of Consciousness and who know only the modified and tainted "consciousness" of the moral and mental plane with its (so often) unruly flames. The Centre of Fire in "the body", "below", is called in Yoga the Manipûra. This word means "full of rays". The Śakti or Dynamic Power of this Centre is said to be full of lustre. In the West it is called the Solar plexus Centre. Hindu tradition gives it a red colour, like Fire, its Element. It is also called Kundali Chakra. According to tradition a triangular shaped Agnimandalam — that is to say, a symbolic picture of Agni or Fire and its God — is within it. That region absorbs the Light from the Chandramandalam — the symbolic picture of the Moon — in the highest of the Chakras or Centres in the head. It is said that in the Manipûra or Solar plexus Centre the Yogî pierces the "Knot of Vishnu", that is, he understands and thereby masters the secret of the Light or Power of Sustenance. This Centre is situated in the region of the stomach. The stomach is the organ of the "gastric fire". It digests the food, which creates and maintains the body. In Hindu tradition there is further mention of Ahura and Antaragni. Ahura is "the fire in the stomach". Antaragni, literally "the interior Fire", is the digestive force. In the Rig-veda Agni, the Lord of Fire, is called Bhuj, "the eater, the enjoyer". The symbolism of stomach and food will be considered at length at other occasions. One remark may be made now. It may seem strange to a modern man, who is so proud of his intellect, that "the mind" is placed in the traditional scheme in the stomach region. But it ceases to be strange when he comes to realize that "intellect" in the modern sense deals hardly at all with Consciousness and its unveiling, but is in the Fallen Man almost entirely in the service of the quest for the food of this world. He thinks primarily and often almost exclusively from the point of view of his belly.

The guest. Nir-yajña is said to be the offering of food and hospitality to guests. Some of the more Titanic implications of this tradition have just been noted. There are also highly spiritual implications. The Guest is a symbol of the Divine Mind. Hospitality to guests is a venerable social tradition which has a number of aspects. Fairy-tales, myths and sacred scriptures abound with stories of Angels and Gods suddenly knocking at the doors of the houses of men, and being entertained — or sent away! Generally their identity is only revealed at or after their departure. Many have "entertained Angels unawares". Is it not one of the major shortcomings of the average man that he is unaware of the Intelligences within himself? He does not know them, and often, if he is given a chance, he does not bid them welcome.

The guest who knocks at the door is the representative of the Guest within. By giving him of his best, a man does himself the greatest good. Moral and spiritual factors go hand in hand. The guest is the stranger who suddenly turns up out of an unknown outer world into the familiar circle of relatives and intimate friends of which every-day life is composed. He brings new points of view, wider angles of vision, new clues to the puzzling problems of life, and other aspects of knowledge, breaking in upon the narrowness of the circle within which life moves. In a way, he breaks in upon the conscious out of the unconscious. This is the intellectual factor. It is closely interwoven with the moral and spiritual factors. The guest may be the messenger of God. In ancient conceptions the guest was the representative of God. Blessed is any country, any family, where the ancient tradition of hospitality is still followed. For hospitality confers many sided blessings on the hosts.

The symbolism The "guest in the hearth", the fire of the fireplace, is of food and bread intermediary in the creation of food. Food is the elemental, material, substantial building stuff, not only of the physical plane, but of all planes. A man does not only need food to eat. His emotional life must not be starved. It must be given food, as well as his mind. And before all he needs spiritual food the "bread of life". In all traditions food has ranked among the highest forms of offering to the Deity. For food is a synthetic product. It is composed of the raw material, representing Earth, it is mixed with water and prepared with fire, with the help of air. The same symbolism is found at the heart of food rites in Hinduism, in Jewish tradition, in Christianity. Food is dedicated and sanctified. Afterwards it is eaten by the worshippers. In Hindu tradition it is called *Prasādam*. This is a word meaning "peace". In Christian tradition it is called the Sacred Host, and is said to be the "*body of Christ*". Christ is the Son of God, Lord of the Element Ether. The Lord is the Bread of Life. His "*body*" is composed of the Four Elements. Bread is a symbol of the Ether, as other, "less synthetic" types of food, represent other Elements. "Give us day by day our daily bread" does not refer in the first place to the bread of "this world"! In the Bhagavad Gītā (XV, 14), Śrī Krishna, the Lord of the Ether, the Guru, says "Dwelling in the body of living beings I digest four kinds of food". In the Sacrament of Communion the Bread of Life is given to the hungry Communicant. The Life indwelling in the Four Elements of the Bread passes into the worshipper by "communion". Communion with other people makes them into "com-

panions", literally "those with whom bread is eaten". The Lord is the Keeper of the Bread. The word "Lord" is a suitable word, since it comes from the Anglo-Saxon word "hlafard", a "loaf-ward" or protector of the bread.

There is a traditional saying which has been handed down in Hinduism: "Man is the food of the Gods." Indeed, the more material planes from the body and the food of the Creator. In order to realize God and obtain the power of the Creator, man eats ritually the body of the victim on the lower planes. The victim is himself in the bondage of the Ahankâra on the Cross of the Four Elements. The meaning of the word "host", from Latin "hostia", is victim. In ancient traditions people ate the flesh of the sacrificial bull or of the sacrificial lamb. Modern tribes in various parts of the world eat their totem animal, their God, on special ritual occasions. Jesus was identified with the Lamb.

It is essential for every man to realize his position and to avail himself of opportunities of spiritual enlightenment. Otherwise he remains a victim, a mere morsel of flesh to be consumed by the Titanic mouth of Existence. At the realization of the position, Arjuna cries out in the Gîtâ (XI; 30): "On every side, all-swallowing, fiery-mouthed, thou lickest up the worlds." The enlightened one, however, expresses the relation of the Son of God and Creation, of Spirit and Matter, of Essence and Substance, in words like the verse found in the Chhândogya Upanishad and Taittirîya Upanishad (Bhṛigu Valli Ch X): "Having what food he wills, this Sâma (veda) song he singing sits: 'O wonder, wonder, wonder! Food I, food I, food I! Food-eater I, Food-eater I, Food-eater I!'" It was with a view to teach his disciples the right relationship between "food" and "the food-eater", that at the Last Supper Jesus "took bread, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to the disciples, and said, 'Take, eat; this is my body' (St. Matthew 26; 26). Every meal taken by a Christian should be eaten in this spirit. Theological tenets and conceptions about transubstantiation are beside the point if its Mystery is experienced. The exoteric, or in other words literalistic, sentimental and rationalistic, explanations of the Mysteries hardly make sense.

The sacrifice Before continuing the examination of "food", the two applying to the last Sacrifices should be dealt with. The Sacrifice which spiritual plane. refers to Air, the fourth, is Deva-yajña. The Fourth Kin is that of Devas. Devas are the Angels or Gods. The sacrifice has to be performed by Homa, a Fire-rite. The Homa rite

is performed by the burning of wood and the pouring of molten butter into the flames. Wood and liquid butter represent Earth and Water. Air is represented by incense. By the purification of the three lower Planes, the Deva-world of Air or Spirit is attained.

Burnt offerings The "burnt offerings" performed in earlier times, and described, for instance, in the books of Moses, refer to the Elements Fire and Air. The sacrificer aimed at destroying "his animal nature", consisting of his animal "appetites", by means of this ritual. Modern people, who think nothing of the scientific slaughter in abattoirs, often recoil with horror at the mention of animal sacrifices. Indeed, it is better to adhere to the rule of harmlessness and non-killing, and be a vegetarian. But if the eating of meat is an unavoidable factor, it may well serve a symbolic purpose rather than be committed in a spirit of utter materialism. In the deed of offering to God lies further an element of shame. Modern slaughter is utterly shameless and "cold-blooded".

'What one eats, that one becomes' is an old word. It is an indisputable fact that the eating of meat stimulates "the animal passions" in man. Moral, psychic, and purely physical factors work hand in hand in this process. If "animal food" is avoided, "animal sacrifice" is not required, physically and meta-physically.

The sacrifice The fifth Sacrifice is Brahma-yajña. It refers to Ether applying to the It is the sacrifice which leads to Brahman Reality, Quintessence. Truth, GOD. This sacrifice is not a rite. It has, according to tradition, to be performed "by knowledge and wisdom", and to be offered to the Rishes or Sages, that is to say, the Liberated Ones, who are, in terms of another tradition, "one with the Father". The living Rishi is the Son of God. According to Hindu tradition, the presence of a Rishi is the greatest saving factor in the life of a spiritual aspirant. The Nārada Bhakti Sūtra says that the Love of God is attained "principally through the compassion of the great, or by a spark of Divine Mercy. The company of the great is hard to get, hard to reach, and never in vain. It is obtained through the Grace of God."

That this highest of the Five Sacrifices is not a rite, but is achieved by Divine Grace, working either immediately or through the medium of a Son of God, is in accordance with the Christian dogma that Salvation is attained not by rites and works — the Hindu would say by karmas — but by the Saving Grace of God, either immediately or through the mediatorship of Christ. In the terms of Hindu tradition, "knowledge and wisdom"

are necessary. The first stages of religion fall indeed "under the Law." The ultimate stage is one in which "the Law" is superseded by the Lord's Grace. But quite apart from that, the mind eventually itself questions "the Law" from its own approach to understanding, as is expressed, for instance, in the Hindu Parapûjâ hymns: "How give a seat to One who is himself the support of the world? — How sing hymns of One whom even the Vedas cannot sufficiently know? — Why burn camphor before One who is self-effulgent? — How make circumambulation round One who is limitless? — Why bow to One who is without a second?" It is necessary to stress, that "the Law" must not be given up too early. This can be done only by those who have true "knowledge and wisdom" and are abstaining from "the food of this world." The exoteric form of "the Law" can be given up only by those who have discovered its esoteric meaning and are living in accordance with that. It will bar the way to further progress on the Path, or cause great inner confusion, if the Ahankâra sees its way to prompt a premature discarding of traditions.

Communion by food The "eating of food" implies identification with the place or Plane where it occurs. There are many fairy-tales and legends in which human beings visit fairies and "men of another order." They are always free to return to their own kind unless they have partaken of the food of the fairies. In that case they are obliged to remain. Very often the eating of the fairies' food makes them forget their own people altogether. This tradition is a universal and deeply rooted one. It is also found to some extent in the prohibition of "interdining" with people belonging to other castes among Hindus.

Well known is the Greek myth of Persêphonê, called in Latin Proserpina. She was the daughter of Zeus and Dêmeter, called by the Romans Jupiter and Ceres. While gathering flowers, Persephone was kidnapped by Hâdês, the God of the Underworld, called Pluto by the Romans. Her mother, the Goddess of Fertility, wandered round to find her. After she had stricken the earth with sterility, Zeus sent Hermês to the Lord of the Underworld. Persêphonê was allowed to return to the world of Light on the condition that she had taken no food during her captivity. Unfortunately she had eaten a few seeds of a pomegranate. Hence she became obliged to pass four months of the year in the Underworld, whilst for the rest of the year she could be in the world of light. This myth is not a mere dramatization of the fact of nature that in a temperate or cold climate the land is for part of the year in the sterile grip of winter, whilst the rest of the year is the time of fertility. What purpose would it have served to personify material nature in such a

way? Upholders of the personification theory have little common sense and less sense of humour. The real drama takes place within the soul. It is reflected without, and the scene without serves to illustrate allegorically the drama within.

The apple of the Tree of Knowledge, eaten by Eve and Adam, is also a kind of food. Its symbolism will be considered on another occasion. It is further a kind of fruit or seed. Fruits or seeds signify either the fruits or seeds of worldly actions, or those of spiritual practices and longings — according to the context in which they appear. Fruits and seeds appear in the Cycle of the Zodiac at the beginning, when they are sown, and at the end, when they are harvested. They are stored away in Aquarius, and are carried over to the new Cycle in the Fishes. Pisces is a Water-House, and fishes represent the spiritual germs or seeds that are to sprout and blossom in the new Cycle of Manifestation. It will be seen later, that in some traditional contexts Pisces is called the Womb. In connection with this in some traditions and in folklore the eating of fish has symbolical implications, connected with the spiritual gift of looking into the future. In certain traditional connections the eating of fish gives clairvoyant and prophetic powers. These are particularly associated with the Sign of the Fishes. This subject will be dealt with at more length in connection with Oracles.

In Celtic tradition is found the "Fish of Wisdom" or "Salmon of Wisdom" which "burns the hands", but, when "put into the mouth," gives fullness of wisdom. In the tradition of the Holy Grail the Grail has the virtue of miraculously nourishing with food. It will be seen later that the Grail is a form of the Moon-Vessel in its Crescent shape  in Pisces. In the Grand Graal it is said that all those who are not nourished by the Grail are nourished by a fish caught by Sir Alain, for which this knight is called "the rich fisher". The title is transmitted to the dynasty of the Holy Grail.

The miraculous Jesus was called "the fisher of men". The story of the feeding, miraculous feeding of the multitude, found in the

14th Chapter of St. Matthew and the 6th Chapter of St. Mark, in which there is reference to both the Bread of Life and the Fishes, is symbolically of the deepest significance, as also the story contained in the 6th Chapter of St. Mark, in which the symbolism of number is especially stressed (8, 19-21). In the symbolic aspect of the story the multitude of aspirants on the Path to God — represented in the story by the disciples of St. John the Baptist, who had just lost their leader — is not hungry after the food of the physical plane but hungry for the Bread of Life.

The food of the physical plane serves for the need of the day, but the Bread of Life serves for "all time". In the days when loudspeakers, radios and printing presses were not available, the disciples of World-teachers must often have been desperate about the vastness of the task for a few men to "feed the multitude", whether assembled in one place or disseminated all over the desert of this world. They wanted to send the people away. But Jesus ordered them to give them to eat. And they answered: "We have here but five loaves, and two fishes." Jesus took them, blessed and brake and gave the loaves to his disciples, and the disciples passed them on to the multitude. The five loaves refer to the food of the Five Elements. Only the Son of God, in whom the Five have been harmonized and synthesized into One, can give spiritual food in which all the Five Planes are harmoniously and proportionately represented. Other teachers, who have not yet realized Divinity, give messages of a rational philosophy, or of an emotional appeal, or of a misty mysticism, or of a purely utilitarian nature. Jesus gave the Bread of Life to his disciples, each of whom represents a certain aspect of the Divine Dispensation, corresponding to one of the Twelve Signs of the Zodiac. They were intermediaries between Christ and the multitude of followers in the world. In this story as told by St. Matthew Jesus does not even preach. It is only said that he "healed their sick" before he sent them the Bread of Life through his disciples. And when all had eaten and were filled, there remained twelve baskets full. The Divine Food never runs short, and cannot possibly be entirely consumed. There is always plenty for all — in contradistinction to the food of the physical plane, of which, due to the tricks of the Ahankâra, the Devil, there is never enough for all.

The temptations of Jesus. The twelve baskets which remain — one for each House of the Zodiac — further signify the reserve for the next Cycle. There is always something left over. There is never a clean finish. Either there is a shortage, or there is too much. The shortage is a debt which is left over. What remains is what Hindu tradition calls Sanchita karma: the karmic causes of the past, which do not bear fruit now, but are reserved to have their effects in a future cycle. These are both the unfavourable Ahankâric "failures", and the Spiritual Hope and Promise, and refer to both humanity and the individual. In the Christ-drama the Abankâric failure is found in Judas, the betrayer of the Lord, and the Spiritual Hope and Promise Centre in the Christ, "who will return with clouds". Salvation and Liberation are never quite complete. There is an element which is incapable of responding to the Word of God, and "falls" anew, in Capricorn. The "mass-man" in humanity goes down,

again and again, throughout the cycles, impelled by Ahankara, the separator and grabber. At regular times he comes with his temptations, always after the soul has made an advance towards the Light and has climbed to a higher stage on the Path of Return to God. When that has happened, the Ahankara first sends a subtle suggestion of satisfaction and security, and when the soul has responded to that, he comes with more substantial temptations. Till the bitter end he will continue to pursue the weary disciple, sometimes able to win a certain amount of success, but ultimately bound to fail. At the very last moment he will try to drag a soul back from the Father's bosom. When Buddha was about to enter the State of Nirvana, seated under the Bodhi tree, Mara, the Tempter, approached him, with his Ten Sins, to hold him back, — to no avail. After Jesus had passed through the purification and integration of the Baptism he was immediately assailed by the Devil. Forty days he was tempted. But he fasted; he did not take any food identifying him with this world. And he ate neither apple nor pomegranate. The three temptations of Christ are described in the 4th Chapter of St. Matthew and the 4th Chapter of St. Luke, and are referred to in the 1st Chapter of St. Mark. These three Gospels have been traditionally related to the three fixed Signs of the Zodiac of respectively Taurus, Scorpio and Leo, Houses of Earth, Water and Fire. It will be seen that there is a correspondence between the Three Temptations and the first three stages of the Zodiac, shown in Diagram 1b. These consist each of three Signs, the middle one of which is a "fixed Sign". In the fourth stage, that of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces, temptation is not manifest. In the Gospel of St. John, relating to Aquarius, the House of Air, the Temptation of Christ is not mentioned at all. The Three Temptations are temptations with which all humanity is struggling, whether consciously or without knowing it. The realization of their meaning is of the greatest importance to all. The Three Temptations are found in forms suitable to the level on which people live and move. Especially the first is of the highest importance to the greater mass of humanity, since it is a temptation to which it is the main characteristic of modern civilization to succumb.

The first temptation.	The first Temptation refers to the group of three Houses with the fixed Earth-Sign of Taurus in the centre. The devil said "If thou be the Son of God, command that these stones be made bread." But Jesus, though hungry from fasting, or rather, because he was hungry in the deeper sense of the word, answered "It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God" (St. Matthew 4, 4). The Tempter
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wanted Jesus to turn stones into bread. But Jesus declined the bread of this world, because life depends on the Word of God: the Life and Light and Bliss of the Ether-Sphere. The modern world has been feverishly engaged in trying to turn stones into bread; in trying to improve material conditions, and, starting from the world and its powers, in trying to transmute it into a materialistic Utopia — something which, of course, can never be accomplished, for the very reason that “man shall not live by bread alone”, as “it is written”, in other words, as is universal tradition. At the present time there is no end to utilitarian, technocratic, economic, industrial and political doctrines and activities, all born of reason and applied to the physical world. They have absorbed human energy on an unprecedented scale, and have consequently caused unprecedented world-catastrophes. The transmutation factor in life has to come “from within”, by the Word of God. That Word alone is able to uplift the world, including the physical plane, and bring the Kingdom of Heaven to Earth.

The second temptation. The second Temptation of Christ refers to the group of three with the fixed Fire-Sign of Leo. It applies to a higher level and is a temptation for the mind. “The devil taketh him up into the holy city, and setteth him on a pinnacle of the temple, and saith unto him, ‘If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down: for it is written, ‘He shall give his angels charge concerning thee: and in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone.’ Jesus said unto him, ‘It is written again, ‘Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.’ ” The temptation applies to a mind set above others, a ruler and guide in its own dominion, small or great. On the highest level it is the temptation of “psychic powers”, Siddhis, as they are called in Hinduism, implying pride of authority and achievement above others. The devil quoted scripture, and used the very tradition for his purposes. It is the temptation of the priest, of the spiritual aspirant, and the error of those who belong to secret brotherhoods and so-called “esoteric schools”. On a lower level it is the temptation — found in many books specially written for the purpose — of “power”: to become rich, to get a good position, to influence one’s fellowmen, to develop a magnetic personality, and so forth. Jesus said: “Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.” Let Earth be Earth, let Water be Water, let Fire be Fire, let Air be Air! Spiritual powers should not be used by the Ahankâra to interfere in the laws of the other Planes.

The third temptation. The Third Temptation of Christ refers to the group with the fixed Water-Sign of Scorpio. It applies to a soul far advanced on the Return Path to GOD. In the Cycle of

the Zodiac the first Temptation refers to "young souls" on the beginning of the Path, the second to "middle-aged souls" at the height of Manifestation, and the third to "old souls", on the verge of God-realization. The Three Temptations will be more fully elucidated in connection with other Gospel teachings. The Third Temptation is the most dangerous one, pertaining to more advanced spiritual stages. One reads "The devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain and sheweth him all the kingdoms of the world, and the glory of them, and saith unto him, 'All these things will I give thee, if thou wilt fall down and worship me'" (St. Matthew 4, 8-9). St. Luke gives the version "And the devil said unto him, 'All this power will I give thee, and the glory of them: for that is delivered unto me, and to whomsoever I will I give it. If thou therefore wilt worship me, all shall be thine'" (4, 6-7). "And Jesus answered and said unto him, 'Get thee behind me, Satan: for it is written, 'Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve'" (4, 8). And "then the devil leaveth him, and behold, angels came and ministered unto him" (St. Matthew 4, 11). In this temptation the devil takes the guise of the Power of Desire, called Kâma or Ichchhâ in Hindu tradition and Will in Western thought. Just as Kâma has to vanish in the Absoluteness of Brahman, Truth or Reality, so the will of a person has first to be subjected to the "Will of God" and finally to be entirely merged in it. The Will of God is the Pure Desire of God which is the counter-pole of the Ahankâric will, that of the devil. "May Thy Will be done" is a necessary stage on the Path. Ultimately, when the Will of God has been fulfilled by the annihilation of the will of the Ahankâra, there is no "will" of any kind left. GOD has, of course, no Will, as He Is. Will is one of his Powers in Manifestation. Jesus declined to worship the Duality of Ahankâric Will and God, and he declined the Multiplicity of "all the kingdoms of the world", pertaining to the world of Mâyâ, retorting that one must serve *only* God. He ordered Satan to "get behind" him, implying that the *cycle of past karmas had come to an end. Not Satan, but Christ alone ultimately rules the Earth House of Capricorn.*

Idoltrous literalists have been engaged for many centuries in stultifying the symbolism of the Old and the New Testaments, unaware that already in the third century A.D. Origen warned against literalism. He pointed out that often passages contradicted each other when taken literally, and he wrote (in *De Principiis* IV, 16) regarding the Creation tradition "What intelligent person would fancy, for instance, that a first, second, and third day, evening and morning, took place without sun, moon, and stars, and the first, as we call it, without even a heaven?" "Even the Gospels are full of sayings of the same class, as when the devil takes Jesus up into a high

mountain, to show him from thence the kingdoms of the world and the glory of them. Who but a careless reader of such words would fail to condemn those who think that by the eye of the flesh, which needs a height to bring into view what lies far down beneath, the kingdoms of Persians, and Scythians, and Indians, and Parthians, were seen, and the glory men give to their rulers?"

In connection with the Temptation of Jesus in the desert, two sayings of Jesus from the Apocrypha are of interest. The first is: "If ye fast not from the world, ye shall not find the Kingdom of God." The other is: "No man that is not tempted shall obtain the Kingdom of heaven."

The meaning of temptation. GOD, as He Is, is, of course, beyond all conceptions and activities. As He has no Will, He does not tempt. God's Will is one of the emanations or attributes of GOD in Manifestation, or, in other words, one of the Angels or Gods. These do tempt.

Hence there are two forms of temptation which are mentioned in the scriptures. The Divine temptations are for the good of the spiritual aspirant. They are called "tentationes probationis" and occur on those stages of the Path of Return where on the Path of the Fall the soul succumbed to the temptations of the Fall. These are called "tentationes seductionis".

The soul, on the Return Path to God-Reality, has to "cover the same ground" as it trod on its Fall. When Satan tempted Jesus, it was a tentatio probationis. Often, for the sake of the temptation, the nature of the Tempter is hidden. In this connection, as we shall see later, it is often left open whether the Devil appears to be, or is in fact, a Servant of God.

The word "tempt" means to try, to test, to handle, to allure, 'to be disposed to, to tend to. Derived from it by abbreviation in the Latin is "to tend" and "tendency", allied to Latin "tenêre", to hold, to grasp. These words all relate to processes of the lower mind, the Element Fire, which is the sphere predominating in the Temptation and the Fall. Mental tendencies and temptations are what Hindu tradition calls "vâsanâs".

The root "tem", inclining towards "ten", is interesting. A number of words are derived from it, all connected with the fall from light into darkness, from peace to disturbance, from being to having, from freedom to bondage. "Tem" implies several, distinct, ideas, which are traditionally related in their implications. It means dark, cut off, separate. The Latin "temere" meant in the dark, later it got the sense of rashly, from which the English "temerity" was derived. It also assumed the sense of thoughtlessly, indiscreetly. Related to it is the Latin "tenebrae", darkness, and the Sanskrit "tamas", meaning darkness, ignorance of truth, gloom, materiality. The function of

Tamas is traditionally said to be "the veiling of consciousness". "Tem", in the sense of cut off, is found in the Latin "tempus", time. A number of words are derived from it, which all deserve study from the point of view of their meaning in sacred tradition. "temporal", meaning worldly, "tempest", a disturbance in the atmosphere, the sphere of Air, "tempestuous", used almost exclusively symbolically, and further "a temper", "temperance" and "temperament".

"Tem" is further represented in the traditions of the Path of Return in "temple". This word, from Latin "templum", is related to Greek "temenos", meaning a sacred enclosure and symbolizing the "inner life". Just as the Fall was a "cutting off" from the purity, harmony and simplicity of that state, so, for the purposes of the Return the temple is, inversely, a sphere "cut off" from the outer, profane, world of the Fall. It is the sacred enclosure, in which the soul, as in a "magic circle", is safe from the Ahankâric influences from outside. It is the sanctuary and the place to seek sanctuary.

The five Command- ments.

In order to temper man's inner life and to teach him Temperance, various traditions propound five Rules or Commandments, relating to the Five Elements. In the Yoga-tradition, the preliminaries to Yoga or Union

are the Yamas. Their Buddhist equivalents have already been mentioned. The five Yamas — "restraints" or "commandments" — are the following:

- 1 Ahimsa, meaning inoffensiveness, non-harming of other creatures (including non-killing). This applies to the Element Earth.
- 2 Brahmacharya, generally translated by continence, but referring to all-round purity of the emotional life. It applies to the Element Water.
- 3 Asteya, generally translated as non-stealing, or as temperance. It applies to the Element Fire.
- 4 Ârjava, translated as sincerity, straight-forwardness, truthfulness. It refers to the Element Air, the Spirit.
- 5 Abhidyâ (or Aparigraha). It is generally translated as non-coveting, not thinking of vain thoughts, or something like that. It is Abhi-dhyâ. Abhi means towards, into, longing for. Dhyâ is knowledge of the Undifferentiated. Dhyana is mystical contemplation. In Buddhist tradition the Abhijñâ, a closely related word, is the blissful state attained by Buddha under the Bodhi tree, said to imply insight into all and mastery over all. It is non-coveting alone which can undo the coveting which led to the Fall. The Ether is the Sphere of freedom from bondage, implying Mastery over all. Aparigraha means "non-including, renouncing, non-acceptance".

It has been noted before, how these "restraints", apart from referring in a literal sense to the physical plane, in which sense they are meant for

the very beginners on the Path, or even for those who are not even yet beginners, contain anagogical implications. The non-coveting, for instance, refers to the basic Temptation leading to the Fall, from the Ether or Paradise, into the Mâyâvic involvement in the Four Elements. The coveting of the forbidden fruit or of the Fire of Heaven, was the cause of the Fall of Adam or of the bondage and suffering of Promêtheus. "Coveting" leads to "stealing" as soon as "openness" has been closed in, and "truthfulness" "darkened." The next stage is incontinence and lasciviousness on the emotional plane, followed by expression on the physical plane. Ultimately, at the greatest remove from the inner and subjective life, the predominance of materialism leads to indifference to all other life, seen as separate and distinct from one's own and from this manifests the actual wounding and taking of life.

Reform.

Those who have seriously chosen to reform the world in the only right way — as taught by all traditions, — in other words, those who have set to work sincerely on reforming themselves, begin by purifying their life expressions in the Four Elements. They begin to trace their Ahankara to its source, to harmonize "the elements" of their life, and to worship God as manifesting himself through the Elements.

Isolated moralistic self-improvement, such as has been practised in the West for a long time, leads only to more grievous Ahankâric delusions. It gives not inner peace, gladness and integration, but increases the burdens of the world. True self-improvement results from self-recognition at the hand of the teachings of traditional psychology and further from the practice of the presence of God-Reality, meditation and contemplation. Prayer, self-surrender, praise of God's Powers in Manifestation, ritual, service, art, and many other things, find their place in the process, if these words and conceptions are understood and followed in the spirit of traditional psychology. Many people are much prejudiced against words and conceptions like "God", "prayer", "Grace", "mysticism", etc., *because they have no idea at all what these words really mean*. They are prejudiced against them because they have taken notice only of their modern use or misuse, by people who profess to be "religious", or "mystics", but are actually deluded moralists, sentimentalists and pseudo-rationalists. Their prejudice is based on a dash of intuition and would be excusable if it were not so negative. It should be overcome because it prevents their benefiting from the true conception which only these words can express. A fresh perspective is needed, one which restores insight into real problems. The most hackneyed Scriptures resume their splendour, when they are saved from the stony deserts of

literalism, the stagnant pools of sentimentality, and the pitfalls in the jungle of moralism. The transformation reveals their everlasting youth and the actuality of their bearing on each situation in the psyche and in the world.

An invocation of Elemental Spirits. Fragments of traditional teachings have come down to us in the present time which are valued, but little understood, by the few into whose hands they have come. The following, replete with significance and power, is an example of such a fragment. It belongs to a mixed Cabalistic, Hermetic and Christian tradition. It represents "an invocation of the Elemental Spirits of Fire, Water, Air and Earth." The prayers of the spirits of the Elements i.e., of the denizens of these Four Planes of Manifestation in the Zodiac, called "the rolling chariot", are to the Supreme Lord. He is addressed in the form of His Powers, in terms of Fire, Water, Air and Earth. The purpose of the ritual is the harmonization of the elements of the human soul and Divine Realization.

Ritual involving the Spirits of Fire. The ritual begins with the Element Fire. "The Spirits of Fire or Salamanders are invoked by throwing on the fire salt, incense, white resin, camphor and sulphur, and in pronouncing three times the names of the Genu of Fire: Michael, King of the Sun and of the Lightning, Samael, King of the Underworld Fires, and Anael, Prince of the Astral Light." Into the "sacrificial" fire are thrown salt, representing Earth, white resin, representing Water, sulphur for Fire, incense for Air, and camphor for Ether. Michael, as will be seen later on consideration of the Seven Great Angels, is the Sun, Samael is Mars and Anael is Venus, the Morning Star, Ruler of the astral plane.

"Then one pronounces the Prayer of the Salamanders" to GOD: "*Inexpressible, Eternal, Immortal and Uncreated Father of all things, who art borne on the rolling chariot, beyond the doubts of the worlds which are revolving, Ruler of the immeasurable ethereal regions, where the throne of Thy Power is elevated, of the heights from where Thy terrible eyes discover all things and Thy glorious and holy ears hear all sounds, — hear Thy children whom Thou hast loved since the birth of the ages. Because Thy Golden and Eternal Majesty shines above the world and the starry heavens, Thou art exalted above them, O sparkling Fire! There Thou ignitest Thyself and maintainest Thyself through Thine own lustre, and there emanate from Thee inestimable currents of light which feed Thine Infinite Spirit. This Infinite Spirit feeds all things and keeps this treasure, which is*

inexhaustible of substance, always in readiness for the generation which it causes, and brings forth the forms, which Thou hast devised from the beginning. From this Spirit are also drawn the Most Holy Kings who are ranged around Thy Throne and constitute Thy Court, O Universal Father! O Only One! O Father of the blessed, of mortals and immortals. Before all hast Thou created Thy Powers, which are visibly one with Thine Eternal Thought and with Thine Adorable Spirit. Thou hast placed them higher than the Angels which proclaim to the world Thy Holy Will. Finally Thou hast created us in the third rank in our Elemental Kingdom. There it is our everlasting practice to praise Thee, and to worship Thy Will; there we are incessantly burning of desire and sighing to possess Thee. O Father! O Mother! Most tender of all mothers! O Archetype, adorable in Thy motherhood and pure love. O Son! Flower of all sons! O Form of all forms, soul, spirit, harmony and number of all things, be blessed eternally and everlastingly. Amen."

This prayer is addressed to GOD successively and recurringly as Father, Mother and Son, or Sun, Moon and Guru, Ruler of Ether. The beginning is to the Father, "Who is borne on the rolling chariot". The chariot is Manifestation, the Mother. "Ruler of the immeasurable ethereal regions" and what follows, refers to Jupiter-Jehovah, corresponding to the Pythagorean "Harmony of the Spheres". The following is built up on the same succession. The "Infinite Spirit" which causes generation and feeds all things is the Mother, the Moon-Power. After that follows a reference to the Hierarchies: the Most Holy Kings are the "Seven Spirits before the Throne" of the Revelation, the Seven Gods or Seven Archangels. They belong to the Heavenly Spheres. The Angels, messengers and intermediaries of Jehovah's Will, belong to the intermediate world, that of the Spirit. The Elementals belong to the Titanic world. As has been noted before, the "vertical" or hierarchic principle is typical of the Element Fire. In this prayer the Element Fire is seen to be the creation of the Solar Fire of God, just as in the next part the Element Water is seen to be the reflection of the "Living Waters" "above the Firmament".

Ritual involving the Spirits of Water.

The second part of the ritual concerns the Element Water: "The Water" used in the ritual "is consecrated by the imposition of hands, by the breath and by the word, by adding to it the consecrated salt with a little of the ashes remaining in the fire of the (burnt) perfumes.

The holy-water-sprinkler is made of twigs of vervain, periwinkle, sage, mint, valerian, ash-tree and mullain, bound with a hemp-thread from the spinning-wheel of a virgin, with handpiece of a hazel-nut tree which has not yet

borne fruit and on which one engraves with a consecrated knife the characters of the Seven Spirits" The five-fold consecration relates to the Five Elements The imposition of hands concerns the Element of Water itself The fluidic magnetism belongs especially to that Element The breath represents the Element Air or Spirit The word represents the Word of the Element Ether, issuing from "the throat centre" The salt represents Earth, and the ashes of the sacrificial fire, Fire The Element Water is particularly symbolized by the Vegetable Kingdom, as the Element Earth by the Mineral, Fire by the Animal, and Air by the Heavenly Kingdoms The twigs of the seven plants and trees (resp. *Verbena officinalis* L., *Vinca minor* L., *Salvia officinalis* L., *Mentha*, *Valeriana officinalis* L., *Fraxinus excelsior* L., and *Ocimum basilicum* L.), synthesized in the holy-water-sprinkler, represent the Seven Spheres, beginning with the Earth The "hemp thread of a virgin" is a symbol which will be dealt with at length on another occasion It is the girdle of Venus, Brunhilde, Hippolyte, and of the "twice born" of Hindu tradition It symbolizes control on the emotional and erotic plane The "virgin" is a reflection of the Virgin Mother giving birth to the Son, in "the higher birth" Virginity is also reflected in the "hazel-nut tree (*Corylus avellana* L.) which has not yet borne fruit"

Old spells and rituals of this class clearly do not belong to "black magic", as was often supposed by the orthodox, anymore than they do to "sympathetic magic" or "mere superstition", as is supposed nowadays by the so-called "enlightened"

The text continues, that one must bless the salt and consecrate it with the ashes, and gives a Latin invocation to be recited at that time These Latin Formulas are impressive by their power This one runs, translated "In this salt let there be wisdom and may it preserve our minds and bodies from all corruption through Chokmael and in virtue of Ruach Chokmael, may the phantasms of Hylac withdraw from it, that it may be the heavenly salt, the salt of the earth and the land of the sun, that the triturating bull may be nitrated and may add to our hope the horns of the flying bull Amen"

Ruach is Breath, wind, Spirit The "phantasms of Hylac" are the delusions of Maya The Greek *Hulê* is matter Chokmael is the Venusian God of Wisdom The formula refers to the world of Manifestation Next one should pronounce over the ashes the following adjuration "Let the ash be returned to the fount of Living Waters and let the earth be fruitful and let it produce the Tree of Life through the three names, which are Netzah, Hod and Yesod, in the beginning and the ending, through Alpha and Omega which are in the spirit of Azoth Amen" Chokmah, Netzah, Hod, and Yesod are four of the Ten Sephiroth of the Cabala (see Diagram 6) When

the Sephiroth are dealt with, the present symbolism will become clear. It refers to the perfection of Manifestation. The "earth becomes fruitful" in Capricorn and Aquarius, the Houses where the roots of the Tree of Life are and in which the Tree is seen to grow. In Aquarius is also "the beginning and the end." The Living Waters spring or flow down from it. "Azoth" is a word which has been compounded out of the first and last letters of the Hebrew, Greek and Latin languages.

Finally, when mixing salt, water and ashes, one should say: "In the salt of eternal wisdom and in the water of rebirth and in ash producing a new world, let everything be made through Elohim, Gabriel, Raphael, Uriel, for ages and aeons. Amen." The Elohim — as will be shown later — refer to the House of Scorpio, ruled by Mars. Gabriel is the Great Angel representing the Moon, Raphael the Great Angel representing Mercury, Uriel the Great Angel representing Mars.

Then the Nymphs of Undines, the Spirits of the Element Water, are adjured with another Latin formula: "Let there be a firmament in the midst of the waters and let it separate the waters which are above from the waters which are below, and those which are below from those which are above, and let the wonders be performed of the one thing, of which the Sun is the Father and the Moon the Mother; the Wind bore it in its womb, it ascended from earth to heaven and again descended from heaven to earth. I adjure thee, creature Water, that thou be to me a mirror of the Living God in his works, a fount of life, a washing away of sins. Amen." The division of the Waters refers to Genesis I; 6-7. The separation is that of the "Ocean of Samsāra" in the Ten Houses of Manifestation, from the Water of Life of Aquarius; and also that of the Element Water of Venus, the lower astral plane, from the Living Water of Venus-Urania, the Moon, ruling the true Astral Plane. The former should be "a pure mirror" of the latter.

Then the Prayer of the Spirits of Water, or Nymphs, to God, is recited: "Terrible King of the Ocean, Thou who holdest the keys of the vast waterfalls of heaven and who enclovest the subterranean waters in the hollows of the earth, King of the floods and the rains of spring, Thou who openest the sources of the streams and fountains, Thou who rulest humidity, which is as the blood of the earth to become the sap of plants, we worship Thee and call Thee, we, Thy moving and changing creatures; speak to us in the mighty rolling of the sea and we shall tremble before Thee; speak to us also in the rippling of the clear waters and we shall long for Thy love. O Infinity, in which will be lost all currents of existence which are ever born in Thee! O Ocean of infinite perfections! Thou who art the Height mirroring Thyself in the Depth, Depth which Thou liftest up on high,

lead us to the true life by wisdom and love Lead us to immortality by sacrifice, in order that on a certain day we may be deemed worthy to offer the Water to Thee, the blood and the tears by the forgiveness of errors Amen " It is the heart's call of beings struggling in the "Sea of existence", to the Supernal Ocean of Grace The "King of the Ocean who holds the keys" refers to the Ruler of Pisces Neptune Every sentence has a number of symbolical implications

Ritual in- Next follows an adjuration of the Elemental Spirits of
 • volving the Air, the Sylphs One should breathe out in each of the
 Spirits of Air. four cardinal directions in turn and recite a Latin formula,
 of which the translation is "The Spirit of God was carried
 over the Waters and commanded the breath of life into the face of man May
 Michael be my God and Sabtacl my servant in light and through light Let
 the Word be my breath and by the command of the Spirits of the Air I will
 hold the horses of the Sun hy the will of my heart and the thought of my
 mind and the wink of my right eye Therefore I adjure thee, creature of Air,
 by the Pentagrammaton and in the name of the Tetragrammaton, in which
 there are firm Will and Faith Amen Selah So be it!" All the planes are
 referred to in this symbolism, and especially Ether, the Realm of Jehovah

• After this invocation the text directs one to draw the symbol of the Sylphs
 in the air with the feather of an eagle, and to recite their prayer "Spirit of
 Light, Spirit of Wisdom, the Breath of whom gives form to every thing and
 takes it away again, Thou for whom the life of beings is a shadow which
 changes and a smoke which passes, Thou who raisest Thyself in the clouds
 and proceedest on the wings of the wind, Thou who ever breathed out in
 the spaces, populating them, and makest return to Thee all things which
 come from Tbee, Movement without end in the Eternal Immutable, be
 everlastingly hlestl We praise Thee and bless Thee in the changing realm
 of the created light, of the darknesses, of the reflections and of the images,
 and we unceasingly sigh to Thine Immovable and Imperishable Lustre
 Let the ray of Thine Intelligence and the warmth of Thy Love penetrate to
 us, then that which was moving will become fixed, the shadow will become
 a body, the spirit of the Air will become a living soul, the dream will be a
 thought And we shall no longer be carried hy the storm, but we shall
 hold the reins of the winged horses of the morning and we shall direct the
 course of the evening winds, to fly up to Thee O Spirit of the spirits,
 O Eternal Soul of the souls, O Imperishable Breath of Life, O Creating
 Sigh, O Mouth which breathest out and in the existence of all beings in
 the flood-tide and ebb-tide of Thine Eternal Word which is the Ocean of

Thy divine Word and of the movement and of the Truth. Amen." All the planes are again mentioned; for instance "the changing realm" of the Manifest World has the "created light" of Air, the "darknesses" of Fire, the "reflections" of Water, and the "images" of Earth. In another context the images are of Fire and the darknesses of Earth. Many traditional opposites are represented, such as Movement and the Immovable; the downward path and the return path; out- and in-breathing; ebb and flow. The "fixing" of the moving, the shadow becoming a body and the dream becoming a thought refer to the Ultimate Experience, in which "the dream of Mâyâ" becomes one with Reality Itself.

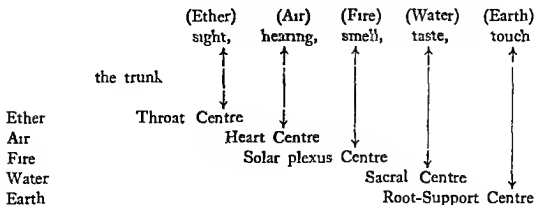
Ritual in- After this follows the adjuration of the Spirits of Earth,
volving the the Gnomes. "The Earth is adjured by sprinkling of
Spirits of water, by the breath, and by fire with the perfumes suitable
Earth. for the day of the week. Then one should read the prayer:

Invisible King, Thou who hast taken the earth as support
and who hollowest out its abysses to fill them with Thine Omnipotence,
Thou whose very name makes tremble the vaults of the world, Thou who
makest flow the seven metals in the breath of the Stone, Monarch of the
Seven Lights, Rewarder of the labourers of the underworld, lead us to the
longed-for Air and to the Kingdom of the Light. We watch and work un-
ceasingly, we search and hope, by the Twelve Stones of the Holy City;
by the talismans which are buried; by the magnet which runs through the
centre of the world. Lord! Lord! Lord have compassion on those who
suffer, widen our breasts, open and raise our heads, enlarge us, O Fixed
One and Moving One! O Day developed by the Night! O veiled Darkness
of Light! O Master who never keepest back the reward of his labourers!
O Silver Fairness! O Golden Splendour! O Crown of living and melodious
diamonds! Thou who wearest heaven on Thy hand as a ring of sapphires!
Thou who hidest the wonderful seed of the stars in the earth in the realm
of the Stones! Mayest Thou live, rule and eternally be the divider of the
treasures of which Thou hast made us the guardians. Amen."

With this prayer the ritual comes to an end. The symbolism is largely
Saturnian in nature, referring to the God of the Earth as the giver of Treas-
ure and as the guide to the heavenly realm of Light. Saturn, Ruler of Capri-
corn, leads to Saturn the All-Father, Ruler of Aquarius. Saturn's "ring"
is the ring round the planet and the ring of stars in the expanse around
the earth. It is a symbol of the Everlastingness of Time, and of the fact
that beginning and end join hands and that every end is a new beginning.
But it is also a symbol of bondage. The wonderful Saturnian symbol of

The Moon-Sphere the head

the five senses



The scheme of correspondences, here given, represents the Aindriya division of Hindu philosophy, relating to "the senses" A somewhat different scheme of correspondences is given by the Tamasa division, relating to the material aspect of the world That scheme, belonging to the Sankhya

will be referred to later The above diagram though derived from of universal application

the Philosophers' Stone of the Hermetists is referred to The "seven metals" represent the Seven Gods in their Saturnian aspects In his highest aspect he is "Monarch of the Seven Lights" The "Twelve Stones of the Holy City" refer to the Heavenly Jerusalem, which is not a worldly Utopia but represents the purified world of a Son, One with his Father, in symbols referring to the Zodiacal Scheme The "talismans which are buried" are the spiritual treasures of the traditions which are unknown, that is to say, hidden, to those who have not "the eyes to see" The "magnet which runs through the centre of the world" is the irresistible power of attraction of God As will be seen later, it extends between Leo and Aquarius, the Houses of the Pole of Manifestation and the Spiritual Pole (See Diagram 1a) The "Fixed One" is the Immovable Axis of the Wheel of Time, which is the "Moving One" The first is the Supernal Sun, the second His Power in Manifestation The "Silver Fairness" is of the Moon, and the "Golden Splendour" of the Sun, alternatively the two aspects of the Creator, or the two aspects of Creatrix and Supernal Sun, attaining their greatest "height" and "depth" in Leo and Aquarius respectively The "crown" is that of spiritual perfection in Manifestation It is the crown which appears in Aries, after having been won in Scorpio as a crown of thorns Most of these symbols will be dealt with later in other connections When we consider the tradition of the World-Ages, we shall see that this prayer of 'the Spirits of the Earth' has an especial significance for the people of the present time The symbolism of "the veiling of light", referring to the sheathing and the consequent darkening of Consciousness, is very common in Hinduism The "developing of the Day" of Manifestation out of the Night of Rest is universal symbolism It is significant that the Element Earth, though apparently the lowest of the Elements, is dealt with last in the ritual In the Earth the Treasure of God Reality is found

The five senses

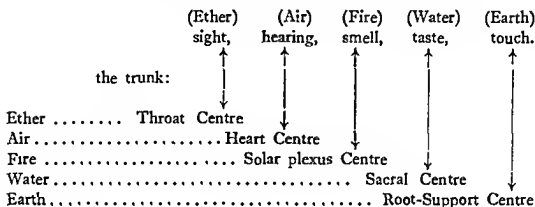
The five senses symbolize five forms of the perceiving activity of Consciousness, relating to the Five Elements (see Diagram 1) Touch is symbolic of conscious percep-

tion on the physical plane, taste on the emotional, smell on the mental and moral, hearing on the spiritual, and sight on the essential, planes "The sixth sense" is the higher mind, the Sphere of Consciousness proper, symbolized by the Moon Sphere

The relation between "the senses" and "the World of Manifestation" is illustrated in the following diagram

The Moon-Sphere: the head:

the five senses:



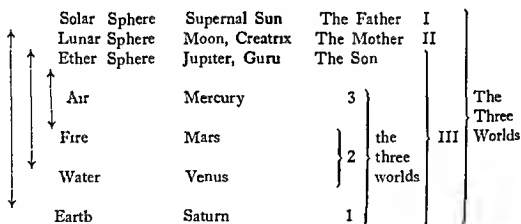
The scheme of correspondences, here given, represents the Aindriya division of Hindu philosophy, relating to "the senses". A somewhat different scheme of correspondences is given by the Tamasa division, relating to the material aspect of the world. That scheme, belonging to the Sāṅkhya school, will be referred to later. The above diagram, though derived from Hinduism, is of universal application.

The arrows point to the relation between the five senses and the five Centres of action in the five Elements. There is a relation between "insight" and the Word, issuing from the Throat Centre, the Centre of Ether. Spiritual "hearing" of the Voice, the Word and the Sound of the Tradition is connected with the Heart Centre, the Centre of Air, which is called in Hinduism the Centre of "Unstruck Sound" (Anāhata). Smell stimulates appetite for "the food of life", the creative substance of the Element Fire, in the Solar plexus Centre. "Taste" has emotional implications, either in tasting the Love of God, or in tasting the pleasures of the world and of human love. It is connected with the Sacral Centre, the Water Centre. "Touch" means possession or control of material objects and bodies, energies and substances. It implies perception in the Element Earth. Its Centre, the "Root-Support", is situated in the body in the place where, in a sitting position, it touches the earth. The task which lies before everyone is that of harmonizing the various "senses" with "the organs of action" (see Diagram 1) and "the Centres", and to establish a harmonious relation between "the Above" and "the Below", Consciousness and World, Head and Body. The fruition of his endeavours will bring "atonement", literally "at-one-ment". Then, in the words of the Mystery of Osiris, he will experience that "Heaven unites with the Earth, on the Earth prevails the Joy of Heaven." It will be seen later that the Christian rite of Holy Unction is a rite that sanctifies

the atonement of "the senses" in "the sixth sense", the higher mind. This rite has reference to the final perfection in the stage of Aquarius of what has been achieved during the previous stages of the Path through the other Signs of the Zodiac with regard to "the senses"

The implications of this diagram will be clarified little by little

The same applies to the following diagram, in which some other relations are given. It shows how the Air forms the intermediary Sphere between God and World, or the higher and the lower Spheres, and why Mercury, its God, is the messenger between the higher and the lower Spheres, and between the Divine World and the world of men on earth. In this tradition the Five Elements form so many veils or sheaths created by the Power of Consciousness, the Creatrix, for the purpose both of veiling and of revealing Consciousness. "The Three Worlds" symbolize either the Solar Sphere, of the Father, the Lunar Sphere, of the Mother, and the Five Elements, of the Son, or, alternatively, with relation to the World of Manifestation, the states of Waking, Dreaming and Deep-Sleep Consciousness (1, 2 and 3)



Mâyâ and magic.

The old traditional science to control "the elements of our being" and "the elementals of our life" is Magic

What is the real meaning of Magic? Does it belong to the realm of "mere myth"? No. Magic is the science of (the control of) Mâyâ. That means it is the science of the creative power of consciousness, manifesting through the Tattvas and Bhûtas, that is, the Principles and their constituent Elements

In many hymns of the Rig-veda Mâyâ is praised as a World-sustaining Power, in others it is the magical Power attributed to the Gods, and among these especially to Indra, Mitra and Varuna. In the Gîtâ we read of the Yoga-Mâyâ of Śrî Krishna. The word Mâyâ takes on an unfavourable sense

when it is the power wielded by the Asuras, the Titans that are the enemies of the Devas or Gods. In the *Praśna Upanishad* *Mâyâ* is used almost in the sense of illusion. This means that the word is employed both in a favourable and in an unfavourable sense. Historically the use of the word in an unfavourable sense is later. In this work the term will be used in both senses, according to the context. This is customary at the present time.

Mâyâ is the building power of Consciousness. It creates duality, multiplicity, substance, form, dimensions, time, and so forth. It is the creative power which involves all life in the bondage of its threads and forms, but which ultimately reveals the truth regarding itself, thereby granting liberation and salvation. The Tradition, which is a form of *Mâyâ*, is the instrument of liberation and salvation. This subject will be pursued later.

The word "magic" is derived from Latin and Greek words, which are etymologically related to "Magus", originally denoting a Chaldean Sage. This word "Magus" is remotely related to "*Mâyâ*". The true Magus or Sage is he who controls the creative power of his consciousness in "the elements of his being". The true magician is the man who exercises self-control.

We have seen that the Three Magi of Christian tradition represent "self-control" on three stages of the Spiritual Path. They come to pay homage to the Christ, as the fourth Magus, representing self-control in the fourth and final stage of the Path.

Command of the Elements. Jesus, "the fourth Magus", had full command "over the elements". In the eighth Chapter of St. Matthew, after "tests of faith", involving the healing of the sick and the infirm, Jesus first commanded his disciples to follow him "and let the dead bury their dead". This means that when the spirit calls, materialism should be left to look after its own interests. Next Jesus "rebuked the winds and the sea", for there is a great tempest. This applies to the emotional life stirred up by the spirit. "The winds and the sea obey him", and "there was a great calm". Next, "there met him two possessed with devils, coming out of the tombs, exceeding fierce." This refers to the mental life of the Fallen Man when it is shaken by the spirit. "They cried out, saying, What have we to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of God? art thou come hither to torment us before the time?" The devils of *Ahankâra* know the fear of God, and cling to their life with the utmost attachment, for "when the time comes" they are faced with nothing else but annihilation. But the time had not yet come, and they went into a herd of swine, which "ran down a steep place into the sea, and perished in the waters." The swine symbolize an

aspect of "the animal man" Their precipitation into the sea is a form of illustrating the Fall from the Element Fire to the Element Water The reaction to an untimely overdose of spirit is a flight to the familiar pleasures of the world After the swine have disappeared, "behold, the whole city came out to meet Jesus and when they saw him, they besought him that he would depart out of their coasts" The Ahankâra trembles "in the fear of God" when it is put face to face with "the quintessence" of things It represents self-will as opposed to "the Will of God", the power of command over the elements of the psyche, born from insight In mythology that power is wielded by Jupiter-Indra, the Lord of the Ether or Quintessence Indra is the Lord of the "Indriyas" or "senses" Christ is the Quintessence, the Enlightener, the Guru, bringing insight into the conditions within the psyche, and through that, command over its elements

Fear comes from lack of insight and faith and from lack of command over the Elements Fear, the "fear of God", proves the existence of inner life It is a power haunting the Path of the Fall "Stone-dead" are those who never experience "the fear of God", but can only feel indifference towards the activities of the higher functions of the soul Fearlessness is often only a negative attribute of sleep and death A sleeping man, a corpse and a stone are fearless Distinct from this negative fearlessness is the fearlessness which is the ideal and end of life That implies freedom from the great fears of life, from the hidden fears of the mind and from the chronic fears of neurosis This fearlessness results from insight into the nature of the psyche and command over its Elements

9 MODERN AND TRADITIONAL KNOWLEDGE

The modern outlook and the traditional outlook.

The reader of this book may put the question whether it is necessary to master the ancient science it deals with The answer is an emphatic affirmative The material at hand has been the age-long guide of humanity in the solution of its problems, the vanquishing of its fears and the realization of its joys If modern man is full of fears, lacks peace of mind and has not the remotest notion of spiritual bliss, it is due to his having forgotten the heritage of his forefathers The degree of his expectation of greater happiness and luck in a "here-after" is the measure of his loss of insight into the truth that supreme happiness may be experienced here and now His supposed happiness is, on the whole, mere physical comfort It comes whimsically and goes catastrophically

Sacred ancient tradition and profane modern erudition are indeed strictly antithetical. What to the Tradition were merely by-processes or sub-sciences i.e., the application of its principles within the material sphere itself, corresponds more or less to "science" in the modern accepted sense. Most of its representatives pour scorn on the traditional teachings. They reject them as irrational and superstitions, because of their own unsuccessful attempts to explain their symbolic language in a literalistic or "scientific" manner.

It is the analysis of the phenomena of the lower mental, emotional and material spheres which, though carried out for different purposes, constitutes the link between "modern science" and the traditional "sub-sciences" just referred to. But whereas "modern science" carries out its analytical investigations in reckless and overweening disregard of the integrity of those governing considerations which give it whatever title it has, the traditional sub-sciences were discreetly delimited in their scope by what was of concrete importance and of immediate practical necessity. This was in keeping with a point of view which embraced life in its integrity and honoured a just balance of its constitutive elements. The spontaneous effect was to curb any unduly analytical investigations.

The phenomena of nature were accepted as they appeared to the senses in all their freshness and beauty. On that basis they became the very symbols which could make an integral appeal to imagination, intellect and spirit. The traditional sciences, properly speaking, then availed themselves of the vast possibilities of symbolical application that lay to hand.

It is hardly necessary to add that analytical science in its modern form, so reduces the integrity of the elements that a modern education tends to obstruct the inner and higher faculties and damage the health of psyche and body.

Ancient traditional teachings were promulgated by men who had realized the Mystery of Divine Reality, who were true psychologists and aimed at guiding others to what they knew by personal experience to be the highest good. This highest good was and remains the synthesis of man in God, in very God.

By contrast modern science attempts to give modern man, just as he is, a Titanic mechanical control over the whole of the surrounding material world, and this in proportionate disregard of the faculties which alone can govern such a concentration.

In reality the two developments are incompatible, for the single-mindedness required for the excessive development of possibilities inherent in the material plane can only be at the expense of the other psychical faculties

— faculties which correspond to the planes left undeveloped. Indeed the profusion of gadgets and mechanical contrivances, to which modern science gives rise, by their very multitude and complexity bewilder the intelligence and stifle the spirit. This in turn unbalances the sentiments which sway between overstimulation and apathy. Finally the body in utter deprivation of all governing principles, seeks to impose the hell of its own anarchy on all around. But the damage goes even further, for the artificialities that surround modern man on every side, effectively thwart his contacts with the organic world of nature and, therefore, with the hierarchy of elements, the symbolic basis of his soul's edification and return to God.

This does not mean that all mechanics are to be eschewed, but that introduction of automatic and standardization factors is wrong *in principle*. What is decisive is that man should set the pace of his work by his own heart beat and not become the passive piston of so-called labour saving devices. Work, furthermore, should never degenerate into the dead and purely quantitative reproduction of the same article. The quality of every moment is different, so is the work of every moment. Herein lies the difference between the passivity of slavery and the creative activity of art. Quality must ever govern quantity.

For the time being, humanity is entirely in the bands — or rather, in the claws — of the dragon of the Age. The dragon is getting ever more unruly and tyrannical. His hand — his claw — is felt in every field of life. The dragon's three thousand claws must be clipped and bound and cut off, not in the "outer world", but within the soul. Once the task has been begun, the dragon will be found to behave himself much better in the outer world. The modern way would be to make numerous enactments and regulations for clipping and binding and cutting, and appoint an executive committee for carrying them out systematically and vigorously, hoping for good results — and then to be sincerely surprised when the dragon became more and more unruly and unmanageable, and finally broke loose entirely and caused the greatest havoc. This is exactly what has happened in the world. For the numerous enactments and regulations and committees and boards are only so many of the claws of the dragon themselves. The dragon can only be mastered by getting at his heart. The three-thousand-clawed dragon is modern life. Every man and woman must deal with it within his or her own soul.

The ancestors of this modern dragon are found in the ancient traditions and symbols. There is nothing new in him, except perhaps his size and the number of his claws. At all times it took a great hero to master him. Sometimes he grows numerous heads, sometimes he has more pointed teeth

or a more virulent poison, sometimes he may look more like this or that animal. But he is always of the same fiery-mouthed breed.

New teachings and traditional teachings. There is nothing new in the world of tradition, though its expression in form changes with the character of the times. There is no need for "new teachings." The heritage of the past is capable of solving the problems of the man of the present day as well as it solved those of his ancestors, it awaits his use if he will only invoke it. Sincere spiritual aspirants should look with suspicion on teachers who claim to have originated or worked out a new doctrine. For "there is nothing new under the Sun." The only newness there is, is the astonishing freshness and wonder-waking youthfulness of a new revelation of Tradition in a human being. Newness is found only in re-awakening, rebirth, resurrection. Revelation brings the liberation and expansion of consciousness which is the only true form of rejuvenation. It is significant that all these words begin with "re." For Tradition aims to guide man on his Path of Re-turn, in order that he may re-attain his Natural State, as Son of God, resurrected from the death of the Fall, re-born in glory.

The great traditions of the world were all based on older traditions and claimed no novelty. In the first book of the Bible are many signs of the linking of Judaism to an earlier, non-Jewish, tradition. In many of the more important episodes in the life of Jesus and in the Christ-drama, as found in the Gospels, there is a reference to the older tradition in the words "It is written." In Islâm are found traditions of Jews, Christians, Iranians, and the people of Mecca, concentrating in the Kaaba. The Jain tradition, though its disseminator Vardhamana was born about six hundred years before Christ, claimed to be already age-old at that time. The tradition of the Buddhists was founded as an off-shoot of Hinduism, and modern Hinduism has Buddhist elements in its amalgam. The great Chinese philosophers always referred to "the Sages of old." Japanese tradition goes back to China and India. The same law applies to every true tradition.

Fragments of traditions are preserved everywhere, even in times of "darkness" (meaning etymologically "hiding" of Light), "decadence" (meaning "fallen away" from Tradition), and "corruption" (meaning "broken away" from Tradition). At a time of new Revelation they enter in usefully into its Body. It is impossible to make a new religion or a new doctrine out of fragments. Nobody can be constructed by stitching all the necessary organs together. They must receive synthesis in a principle higher than themselves. Revelation comes from a sphere deeper than that of reason. It comes by the

Grace of God By its life and power the fragments combine and unite Out of darkness and the corruption of "death", rises the ancient teaching in a glorious new body

Re-establishment of the Tradition.

"Whenever unrighteousness prevails and Righteousness declines, I manifest Myself in a human form to re-establish the Righteous and to destroy the unrighteous," says the Lord Krishna in the Bhagavad Gītā

(IV, 7-8) The word "Dharma", here rendered, as is generally done, by "Righteousness", could also have been rendered by "the Tradition" For that is the deeper meaning of this word, much misused by Hindu conservatives and sectarians It comes from the root "Dhr", meaning to support, to uphold, to maintain The Tradition is the support, the only support, of humanity It upholds and maintains humanity, which, losing it, sinks to the level of beasts, plants and stones This is what, according to Hindu tradition, has happened during the progressive "decadence" or "Fall away" from man's natural state of communion with God It is written in the Purāṇas that Dharma originally went in the shape of a cow on four legs, in the second age on three, in the third on two, and in the fourth only on one

Buddha's Revelation is called the Dhamma (Pāli for dharma) It is the æviterual Wheel of the Doctrine, the Tradition that is proclaimed by Buddhas in all ages The Revelation of Jesus is called the Gospel, i.e. the "glad tidings" The Revelation of Moses is known as the Law All these terms are interchangeable But at the time of a new Revelation the new is generally contrasted with the old, as life is contrasted with death The new Buddhist Dharma was at first the living opposite of the conservative caste-Dharma of the Hindus The Gospel of Jesus was at first the living opposite of the Law of Moses

The word "tradition" must be used with some care, since it is sometimes employed rather for the spirit of conservatism of customs and beliefs than for the reality from which this is a partial degeneration Mere "traditionalism", in the unfavourable sense of the word, is in opposition to the spirit of true traditionalism, in the "deeper", "broader", "higher", and "inner" sense

Fragments of traditions are scattered all over the world Libraries contain treasures In all fields of life there are fragments Some are hidden — sometimes in places that are so open, that nobody thinks of looking for them there They are like the air which penetrates everywhere, upon which life depends, and which is yet unseen Examples hereof are the seven days of the week, the twelve Signs of the Zodiac, and the names of the months

Nobody has ever had the bright idea of changing the order of the days of the week. The traditional order was safe, because there was no motive for changing it.

10. MEDOUSA, THE SPIRIT OF MATERIALISM

Perseus and the Gorgo Medousa. When "a change of heart" has come to a person, when he has made the choice at the Cross-roads and chosen the Right Path, when he has been "converted" — not to a new religion, but to "his own" — the converted one, that is, literally, he who has "turned about", begins his endeavours to live a new life by gathering the fragments of his soul. This he must do with the help of whatever fragments of traditions he can find. Very illuminating is the myth of Perseus, who went out into the world with the aim of killing the Gorgo Medousa, a terrible female monster, with hair consisting of serpents and with the power to turn everyone who looked her in the face, into stone. She symbolizes "materialism", in its most extreme aspects. Stone represents Earth. Serpents are Animals belonging to the Element Earth. One must not look the spirit of materialism "in the face". Looking eye-in-eye means identification. One must not fight materialism with materialism. To see is to be. We are what we see, and we see what we are. Sometimes it makes us uncomfortable to "look people in the eye" with whom we cannot identify ourselves, whether they are "better" or "worse" than ourselves. There is therefore also a relation between the eye and conscience. We cannot always endure the calm eye of a Sage, and we do not always bear the eye of a criminal, whether he be a criminal in material or physical matters, in the emotional field or in the moral realm. The eye is a very mysterious opening in our being. Through it we look inward and see the truth. A Sage confers blessings and "initiation" upon a disciple through his opening of Truth. Looking into the eye of the Guru, the disciple sees Treasure within and through the ensuing identity he sees the identical Treasure within himself. The seeker still looks on the world without him with the eye of distinction, but the Sage "looks equally on a Brâhmana, a pariah and a dog," in the words of the Gîtâ. For him there are no distinctions, for he looks through the veils of form and sees the living God within. There are sayings to the effect that "the sun shines equally upon sinners and saints". That "looking into the eye" means identification, is known to every man and woman, in reference to the lower planes. That a woman should not look any other man than her husband in the eye, is a time-honoured and still widely followed tradition in the East. Modesty does not allow "identifi-

cation" A woman is, however, allowed to look upon a saint, and tradition even encourages this, as a rule The saint makes no demands, he has only to give — the blessings of his presence

Perseus had been told not to look Medousa in the eyes He used his brightly polished shield as a mirror While looking into that he cut off the Gorgo's head Instead of using the subjective mirror of his own eye, he used the mirror of divine Consciousness, that became the mirror of the Tradition, to shield him against the power of Medousa That shield belonged to Zeus, the Enlightener, and was often used by Pallas Athene, the virgin-born and virgin Goddess of Wisdom Eventually the head of Medousa was used as an emblem in the middle of that shield

But it is well to consider the quest of Perseus from its beginning He did not know how to accomplish his aim and where to find Medousa He must find the way and obtain the means to kill her To that end he was directed to the Three Grey Sisters who lived in an icy waste-land in the extreme North This symbolism refers to the winter-aspect of the beginning of the Path in Capricorn-Aquarius, ruled by Saturn, the God of the Element Earth Perseus took leave of the warm world of human habitation and travelled North, across terrible waste lands and lonely deserts — symbolic of spiritual loneliness in the first stages of the Path, which are still coloured by materialism The world of materialism may be full of glamour for those who are trying to find happiness there, but "when the eyes begin to open", it is realized to be a wilderness Perseus saw it as such After a long journey he arrived at the dark cavern near the entrance to Tartaros (i.e. Capricorn) where the Three Grey Sisters lived These ancient spinsters shared between them only one eye and one tooth, which they used in turn When Perseus asked them for the way, they refused to oblige him But he got hold of the eye and the tooth when one Sister passed them on to another And when he threatened to throw them into the ocean, the Sisters, afraid to lose the precious organs, agreed to show him the way They directed him to the Hesperides, the Nymphs of the West

**The Three
Grey Sisters**

The Three Grey Sisters represent the ancient forgotten traditions, divorced from life, in the three worlds Instead of each having two eyes — the eye of the Sun or Spirit and the eye of the Moon or Form — they had only one eye between them, capable of seeing form alone They represent the state of soul in which the different parts have lost contact with one another The eye of Spirit can see life and reality at one glance, the eye of Form can see only unconnected details, numberless

and of endless variety. The Three Grey Sisters are spinsters, symbolic not of virginity, but of sterility. They represent the inner life of people shut up in the coldness and sterility of materialism and rationalism, with a soul consisting of watertight compartments and obsessed by fears. The Three Grey Sisters are ever buried in the semi-darkness, wilderness and emptiness of the Northern realm (compare Genesis 1; 2), ever using their eye and their tooth in turn, engaged in the limited activities permitted by the two organs. Their eye is an instrument of analysis and deals only with fragments. It is the eye which peers over the books in the dark libraries of the world, feeding on all forms of unconnected knowledge. It sees ever greater diversity and creates ever more numerous departments. Their tooth is their instrument of mastication, quite unsuited to get the material well digested. It can also deal with only one thing at a time and does not serve to combine all material into unity.

In spite of this, Perseus received his first directions on his way from the Three Grey Sisters. They represent the state at the beginning of the Spiritual Path. Though it is a state of extreme extroversion and focussing in form and materiality, it is not without its sign-posts to Truth. Once the aspirant for a nobler life begins to tackle in its lair the spirit of excessive extroversion and materialism, he has set his feet on the Path. He finds his first light from the dead books, hidden in the dark libraries. Though they contain endless fragments, the beginning of the quest lies in them. The seeker who, in the darkness and sorrow of the world, at last "turns within", gets his first dim glimpse of light from books or words. The word "Graeae" or "Grey Ones" suggests the fog which lies on the mind of a man before he starts on his spiritual quest. Their names are suggestive of the fears of the unconscious: Deino, Pephredo and Enyo, meaning respectively "Alarm", "Dread" and "Horror".

The spiritual aspirant gets his first light from the Three Grey Sisters, representing the beginning of the Path, in Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces. Gradually, as the Sun moves onwards on its Northern Path, the light will get stronger and stronger, till no darkness is left on earth at all, and ultimately the Midnight Sun of the Polar Summer will fully enlighten the entire world in beauty and glory. Then the very world of the Three Grey Sisters will be revealed as the Paradise, the Kingdom on Earth. "Samsāra and Nirvāna are one!" a Zen-Buddhist exclaimed triumphantly at the moment of Illumination. In the Zodiac the end-stage of the Spiritual Path is the same as the beginning-stage (see Diagram 1a) and the stage of Ether is the same as the stage of Earth (see Diagram 1b). The last stage consists of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces. The "fearful" Three Grey Sisters, the sterile spinsters

of the Element Earth, represent these three Signs. Their opposites, symbolizing the spiritual aspects of these Signs, are the Three Charites of the Greek, the Three Graces of the Roman, tradition. In connection with other matters the three Signs are represented by another set of three Goddesses, the Greek Moerae and the Roman Parcae, forming the Three Fatal Sisters. In Egyptian tradition they were called Shai, Renenutet and Meschent.

The eye and tooth represent the function of the intellect, prying helplessly and impotently into the mystery of life and trying inefficiently and hopelessly to masticate the knowledge gained. The beginning of the Path springs from the relative blindness, sterility and toothlessness of the life of the Fallen Man. It is significant that the Three Grey Sisters were not entirely bereft of light. They were the only ones who knew where Medousa, the spirit of Materialism, lived.

The threat of Perseus to throw the eye and the tooth into the Ocean (the Waters of Aquarius), the great dissolver of things, if their possessors did not show him the way, implies objectively the decision of every sincere aspirant for light, to do away with everything of the old order which has ceased to have significance. This is not a revolt against true tradition but a revolt against mere conservatism of form or empty formalism. It is the true "ultimatum" which sooner or later everyone must put to the old order within himself. From another, more subjective point of view, the threat represents the ultimatum of another land which a soul puts to "the Gods" or Life, when in the hours of the deepest suffering the temptation of suicide comes to it. The eye, after all, is the last remnant of life and hope.

The Hesperides	The Three Grey Sisters showed Perseus the way to the Hesperides. It will be shown later, in connection with one of the Labours of Hercules, that the Hesperides or Nymphs of the West represent the spiritual aspect of Aquarius. This Sign is an Air-Sign. The Nymphs stand for the spiritual qualities of the final stage. They gave to Perseus winged sandals, with which he could fly where he wanted, and a cap made of dog skin, with which he could see what he desired, remaining invisible himself. Further Perseus received a bag from them. Whatever he put into that, became invisible, in consistence with the nature of bags. Invisibility is an attribute of Air. When a man is focussed entirely in Spirit, nothing of the material world can lay hold on him. Materialism will not be able to see his spiritual nature, either. The wings of the sandals are also symbols of Air. In another tradition Perseus received the invisible-making helmet from Hâdês or Pluto, the Lord of the Underworld. The cap or helmet hides the head, representing consciousness, and symbolises
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the unconscious state. The unconscious is invisible to consciousness. The helmet has a parallel in the invisible-making "Tarn-Kappe", not so much a cap as a cape, which Siegfried took from Alberich, a personage also representing the Underworld. Its possession gave great physical and material power. In one version of the myth Perseus also got the winged sandals from Hermès himself. Hermès or Mercury is the Intelligence of the Element Air. From him Perseus also received the famous shield of Zeus, the Aegis, which had been made by Hephaestus, the Greek aspect of Vulcan, who, as we shall see later, represents the Element Fire in the service of the Element Ether. Hermès also gave Perseus a metal sickle. This is an emblem of Saturn, the Lord of the Element Earth.

The killing of Medousa. The objects Perseus received from the Hesperides and Gods symbolize the virtues connected with the various Elements. The sickle is a symbol of the Element Earth; the bag, as all containers like cups, chalices, cauldrons, etc., of the Element Water; the helmet, made of dog-skin, of the Element Fire, the plane of "the animal man"; the winged sandals, of the Element Air; the shield, of the "fire-bearing" Element Ether. Furthermore the mirror into which Perseus looked when killing Medousa, represents the Moon-Sphere. It is said that the Goddess of Wisdom, Athênê, guided his hand when Perseus cut off the Gorgo's head with the sickle, used as a sword. To overcome Materialism, the weapon symbolizing the virtue of the Element Earth is needed.

Medousa lived in a cave. It will be shown later that the stage of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces represents the Cave-stage of the Path. The Cave is allied to the Womb. Medousa symbolizes the state of Consciousness as it has fallen to Earth. Her *head* — the organ of consciousness — has snakes instead of hair. Serpents are Animals that represent life on Earth. It is evident that they do not belong to the Moon-Sphere, the realm of Consciousness. Medousa represents the stage of Capricorn. Hêraklès, as we shall see later, also meets the shade of Medousa in the Labour applying to Capricorn.

The killing of Medousa consisted in her beheading. This is a clean separation of head and body, that is, consciousness and Manifestation. Materialism can only be overcome by separating consciousness and matter and realizing that these belong to two entirely distinct spheres. The materialist has the notion that the two are one and that consciousness is a product or function of the physical body.

Perseus During his further adventures — for the overcoming
and Atlas. of the spirit of materialism is only the first of the major
 tasks before the spiritual aspirant for peace and joy of
life — Perseus had several occasions to use the Medousa-head by showing
it to others, thereby turning them into stone. These occasions, if they are
studied with attention, are obviously cases of letting "Earth return to
Earth", to stop it obsessing, and interfering in the functions of, the other
Elements. But on one occasion, the first, the use of the head of Medousa
had a different implication. It relates to his encounter with Atlas.

After Perseus had killed Medousa, he hid her head in the magic bag which
he had received from the Nymphs. We have seen that it symbolizes proper-
ties of the Element Water. After materialism has been overcome in the waking
consciousness, its power hides in the dream-consciousness of the emotional
life. By the predominance of the spiritual function it becomes invisible.

After Perseus had killed Medousa, he was pursued by her terrible sisters,
but the helmet of invisibility stood him in good stead. He turned away
from the place in the same way as he had come — with his back turned
towards them. "Get thee behind me, Satan!"

When he flew over the Ocean, some drops of blood fell from the bag
into the sea. Out of these Neptune created the winged Horse Pegasus.
Other drops trickled into the sand of the desert of Libya and turned into
spotted poisonous snakes. These two incidents symbolize creative activity
on the opposite Paths of the Redemption and the Fall. The winged Horse
Pegasus represents the spiritualized mind, as we shall see presently. Neptune
is one of the Rulers of the Water-House of Pisces. The constellation
"Pegasus" is in the neighbourhood of Pisces and Aquarius. The spotted
snakes, born in the sand of the desert, represent mental traits expressing
themselves in the stage of the Earth-House of Capricorn in the Fall. The
desert is "the earth without form, and void" of the last stage of the Fall, and
Pegasus arising out of the Ocean has implications somewhat parallel to
that of "the Spirit of God moving upon the face of the waters"
(Genesis 1, 2). In this symbolism the propensities of the Paths of the Fall
and the Return are contrasted.

Continuing his flight Westwards, Perseus came to the realm of Atlas.
Atlas was a Titan who was made to bear the Heavens as a punishment for
having taken part in the revolt against the Gods. Aeschylus wrote "And on
his shoulders he bore the heavy column of Earth and Heaven, a burden hardly
to be borne". The column is "the Spiritual Pole" in Aquarius. The meaning
of this symbol, which is depicted in Diagrams 1a and 8, will be explained
later. Earth and Heaven, the two extremes, are both beheld in the beginning-

and-end stage of Aquarius. They are also mentioned in Genesis 1; 1. What is the meaning of "bearing the burden of Heaven"? Atlas had disobeyed the Gods, that is, he had acted against the Tradition. Therefore he was punished by having to bear the Scheme of the Tradition. For the Heavens, with their Stars, represent the Scheme of the Tradition. There is no greater burden to the Fallen Man than having to live in exact obedience to the Commandments and to be the unwilling supporter of the Law.

We shall see later that the bearing of the burden of Heaven is symbolically allied to the bearing of the burden of the Cross. For the Cross is also a symbol of the structure of the Tradition (see Diagrams 1a and 8) and its burden a way of redemption from the actions on the Path of the Fall. Apart from having the same underlying motif, the two traditions have somewhat different implications.

When Atlas saw Perseus, he asked him to be allowed to look at the head of Medousa, to be turned into stone and freed from the heavy yoke of the Heavens. Perseus agreed and the Titan was changed into stone.

This incident illustrates that the Tradition, in the course of the Ages of the Fall of humanity, becomes crystallized in the form in which it is known on the physical plane. Its life has retreated to the higher Spheres, the inner realms of the psyche. Ultimately the Tradition has a solidified, dead, body, on *Earth*. And its outer forms are preserved unchanged. The stone Atlas surely can bear the burden of the Heavens much more efficiently than a living Atlas. He has carried the outer form of the Tradition to this day — *quite unconscious of the fact*.

This unconsciousness has been caused by the Medousa-head of "materialism".

11. THE BONDAGE OF CONSCIOUSNESS

The symbolism Medousa represents an aspect of the bondage of Consciousness. Bondage is a limitation of consciousness.

"Narrow-mindedness", "hide-bound conservatism" and "a cramped character" are forms of bondage of consciousness. In its worst form the bondage of the higher mind manifests itself at the gate between the waking state of consciousness and the unconscious as "the Terror on the Threshold". Traditionally this Terror is depicted in a female form, because the dynamism of Consciousness — the Moon-power — is conceived in a female form. This subject will be pursued later.

Bondage is always connected with the Titanic factors in life. For the Titans represent the form-side of things. In Greek tradition the Titans are

more particularly the enemies of Apollo, and the Cyclops the enemies of Zeus. The Cyclops have only one eye — like the Three Grey Sisters — which is “the eye of the world” that is interested in and capable of seeing only fragments and details. Zeus, on the other hand, has “the all-seeing eye” that sees the interrelationship of all things. Indra, the Zeus of Hinduism, is represented with a thousand eyes.

The two eyes of man are symbols of the Sun and the Moon, Spirit and Form, Father and Mother, Reality and Mâyâ or World-magic, introversion and extroversion. The two eyes express the dual nature of Consciousness, as dealing with Life and Form.

Between the two eyes the Tradition has conceived a third eye. It is taught that man had originally three eyes. The third eye is the Âjñâ Centre of the Yoga-tradition, representing the Centre of the Moon-Sphere, the realm of Consciousness. In the old traditions of medieval Europe it was called the Forehead Centre. It is evident that in the Fall man lost that third eye, the symbol of an enlightened mind and a pure, unfettered, consciousness.

In China, India and elsewhere there are traditions of snakes with jewels in their forehead. In India there are many people who claim to have seen cobras with a luminous gem on their head, in the darkness of the night. Some species of snake originally had three eyes and the third eye is present in a rudimentary form. The Tuatara or Sphenodon is the only survivor of this extinct group. It has the vestige of a third eye in the top of the head — “the pineal eye”, for time has changed this eye into the pineal body. The Serpents of mythology have the third eye or the jewel that symbolizes the same.

According to tradition there was originally a precious stone on the forehead of the Angel Lucifer, the Light-bearer. When he revolted against God, it fell to earth. It is very significant that there is another tradition that tells us that the Holy Grail was made from it, for the Grail represents the Vessel of the Tradition. Both the third eye and the Holy Grail represent the Intelligence of the Moon-Sphere. The Tradition became needed on earth on account of the Fall, and the loss of the power of the “third eye”.

Hinduism has the tradition of the Third Eye of Śiva. When that Eye opens, the World-delusion of separateness and duality is destroyed, and Kama or Eros, the power of Desire, is burned up. Also Ganapati, the Initiator at the beginning of the Path, who watches over the birth of Light, has the third eye. In Buddhist tradition the third eye, the Urnâ, is a symbol of Bodhi, the highest enlightenment and realization.

In the Vedic tradition the “third eye” is the sacred Fire that is born between the two firesticks of the Sun and the Moon. This is represented in the Tripundram, the sacred forehead-mark, of Vaishnavas.

The meaning of Sun and Moon. Sun and Moon, as a Duality, represent the Life and Form-aspect of Consciousness, and are both connected with the Moon-Sphere. The Sun of this Duality rules (in Astrology) the Sign of Leo, and the Moon the Sign of Cancer. These two Signs constitute "the Height of Manifestation".

Sun and Moon, *as opposites*, represent Being and Consciousness. The Supernal Sun is the God-Reality of the Solar Sphere, and is traditionally connected with the Depth, centred in Aquarius. Its opposite, the Power of Manifestation, the dual Sun-Moon of the Moon-Sphere, is traditionally connected with the Height of Manifestation, centred in Leo.

In some contexts also the Sun is associated especially with Leo, and the Moon with Aquarius.

In every case, when there is question of Sun and Moon, it must be established first, into which category they fall. This will appear from the context. In each category the symbolic implications are different.

Further the stages of the Moon should be taken into consideration, not so much with reference to moon-periods, but rather to the sun-periods, for sun and moon-symbolism are closely associated. Capricorn, for instance, is traditionally the Sign of the New Moon, and the opposite Sign, Cancer, the Sign of the Full Moon. Aries is the Sign of the first quarter of the Moon, and Libra of the last quarter. The Moon-crescent represents the beginning of "creation", and the Moon-sickle its end. These data will be substantiated by and by.

From the above it is evident that the Sun may symbolize two very different things. These are both indicated in Diagram 1.

The Sun and the Moon are symbolized in the two petals of the *Ājñā Padma*, the Forehead Lotus or Centre of the Yoga-tradition. This is the sixth Centre, starting from the lowest (see Diagram 1). The seventh Centre, the *Sahasrāra*, over the top of the head, represents the blossoming of the sixth Centre. It is "thousand-petalled" and its radiance is said to be equal to the light of a crore of suns. It corresponds to the aureole, halo or nimbus around or above the head of Christian and Buddhist saints, and the *Sūrya-Bimbam* or Sun-nimbus of Hinduism. In the Tantras, however, the *Sahasrāra*, the Centre over the head, is called the *Chandra Mandala*, that is, "Moon-circle", whereas the *Hridaya* or "Heart" (not to be confused with the *Anāhata* of Yoga) is called the *Sūrya Mandala* or "Sun-circle". It is clear that the word "Sūrya" or Sun is used in these traditions in two different senses. It denotes (1) the Sun of Manifestation and (2) the Supernal Sun. The Heart is the *Ātma-sthāna*, that is, "the abode, basis, or pole, of the Self", and the Head is the *Śakti-sthāna*, "the abode, basis, or pole, of

Creative Power" In accordance with this tradition, a tradition of Jñānis or Knowers, the Heart is the symbolic Centre of God-Reality, and the Head the symbolic Centre of Creative Consciousness In this way, the Heart is fundamental and the Head secondary

In the Yoga-tradition the Ajñā or Forehead Centre has two petals, and the Sahasrāra two Spheres, in one of which, called Chandra loka or "Moon-world", God and Goddess live in beatific union in their aspects as Sat or Reality and Chit or Consciousness The "beatific union" is Ānanda or Bliss The Triad Sat-Chit-Ānanda, or Being Consciousness-Bliss, corresponds to the Three Persons of the Christian Trinity Father-Holy Spirit (Mother)-Son, in as much as they symbolize the same Spheres

In connection with That which is beyond Duality or Trinity — the Supernal, Parabrahman, Paramaśiva, God-Reality — it should be stressed that it is taught that there is no Fall from It, nor any Return to It For It IS It can be "expressed" only by Silence

The doctrine of reflection of consciousness Sun and Moon give Light, the Source of which is the Sun only The Light represents the Ether Sphere It is reflected in the Four Elements of Manifestation The white Light is broken in the coloured rays of the Elements and reflected in their material The attributes of the Moon-Sphere have varying aspects according to the coloured glasses of the Spheres from which they are considered To get the correct vision of Light, the rays of the Spheres should be integrated The achievement of this synthesis implies perfect insight into life

There is an ancient definition of Man "Man is the reflection of God" It is written in Genesis that Man was made in the image of God An "image" is a "reflection" The Hermetic maxim is "As above, so below" The doctrine of the reflection of Consciousness has been preserved in a pure form in the teachings concerning Chidābhāsa of the Sāṅkhya and Māyāvāda Vedānta traditions of Hinduism It is the false, reflected, "consciousness" of the individual soul that experiences pleasure and pain The reflection is that of Puruṣa, "the Man", in Prakṛti, "Nature", in the terms of Sāṅkhya, or of Ātmā, "the Self", in Māyā, in Māyāvāda terminology Pure Consciousness, that is, consciousness on its own plane and level, or consciousness-as-it-is, is ever-free It can never be in bondage

The Channels of Sun and Moon in Yoga. Traditionally the body forms an inverse reflection of the head. In this connection it is interesting that the right side of the physical brain controls the left side of the body, and vice versa. Furthermore the nerves of the physical organs of vision, the eyes, cross each other.

In Yoga, Sun and Moon are represented in the body in the Idâ and Pingalâ "channels", of respectively the Moon and the Sun, running on either side of (or, in another tradition, around) the Sushumnâ, the central "channel" which is symbolically identical with the spine. Idâ and Pingalâ form a knot at the Mûlâdhâra, the "Root-Support" Centre at the bottom of the body, and another knot at the Âjñâ, the Forehead Centre. The Lower knot is called the Yuktatrivenî or "Union-entwining of three braids", and the upper knot Muktatrivenî or "Liberation-entwining of three braids". At the Forehead Centre the Sun and Moon channels cross each other and go to the nostrils opposite to the sides from which they came. They end in the openings of breath, because their currents are entirely "spiritual", connected, as they are, with Air or Spirit. The combination of the three "channels" of Yoga, with the knots as described, form the Caduceus or Wand of Mercury. This has long been recognized, if not the reason why. The details of its symbolism will be dealt with later. In the Rosicrucian symbolism of the 16th century the "channels" of the Sun and the Moon were called respectively "Spiraculum Vitae" or "breathing-channel of life" and "Spiraculum Mortis" or "breathing-channel of death". The first was associated with Lumen or Light and the second with Tenebrae or Darkness.

The cutting-power of the Moon. The Moon has a "secreting" power. It secretes, that is to say, *conceals* GOD-REALITY. For it is Mâyâ. It secretes, that is further, "separates" God into multiple parts. The word "secret" comes from the Latin "sêcrêtus" meaning "secret, set apart". It is the past participle of sêcernere, meaning "to separate, to sunder". The Primal Fall is that of the sundering and separation from God and of God's Body, the World. The Titans, instigated by Hêra, cut Dionûsos in fragments. The same fate overcame Osiris and other God-men.

The Moon-Power is the Cutting Power, it brings about "sections" in the Divine Body. It "vivisects" the All. It creates "sectors". These words have all been derived from the Latin root for "to cut": "sec, sect". By psychological etymology to "sectarianism", originally from a root for "following", is only a small step. Etymologically related are, however, the words "secular" and "sickle". The Latin "saeculum" implied "worldliness", "races and

breeds, and their earthly lifetime", "the spirit of the age", and "the shades of the infernal regions" It is Saturnian in character The Latin "secula" is the "sickle", the Karma-symbol of Saturn, with which he cuts off time and life, when the seeds are ripe The Moon-Crescent, as representing the Moon-Power in its "last quarter", takes the form of the Sickle of Saturn It causes the cutting and sundering implied by the words derived from the roots "sec" and "tem" Secular is worldly, temporal Temporal is that which falls within the domain of time, and what belongs to the world Saturn is the God of Time, with the Moon-Power in his service, as the Sickle denotes

The Moon's cutting-power may extend to causing "lunacy", a word derived from the Latin name for the Moon, Luna "Lunacy" means either insanity or "true" madness, a state in which the personality has been inverted and its parts entirely cut off from each other in one way or another, or the so-called normal state of mind in which the soul demonstrates the lunacy or foolishness accompanying the bondage of Mâyâ It is well-known how "real" lunacy is intermittent or accentuated with the changing phases of the Moon

Aspect of the Moon. On the Path of Return the Gods take away what they brought and undo what they caused, in proportion to the diminishing influence of the Ahankâra Hence it is that the Moon-Power ultimately shows itself in its highest aspect, which is beyond time and change, as Pure Consciousness, Chit-Rupinî, or "Consciousness-formed", the Holy Spirit, the Virgin Mother, the Voice of the Tradition, granting by her Grace the draught of the Elixir of Life, giving Immortality She, the Great Goddess, is both the Most Terrible and the Most Gracious of the Gods, according to the exploits or the absence of Ahankâra

12 TEACHINGS AND TEACHERS

Secret and forbidden knowledge. The Moon-influence also works in the secrecy which is associated with "occultism" The occult is the hidden It is ruled by the Moon, Queen of the Night Occultism is on the Path of the Fall a cult of mystery-mongering Except in man's selfimposed, that is, Ahankâric, sundering and separation from God and His Tradition, there is no secret knowledge regarding the Truth What is forgotten can hardly be called secret On the path of Return the secret is only that which, even when told, remains above the understanding The Sun and the Moon, like the sun and the moon in the physical

universe, are ever shining upon every human being. If he does not want to see their light, it is his own fault. If he tries to secrete their light for his own Ahankâric purposes, it is a great "sin". The Buddha said: "Three things, O disciples, secrecy is characteristic of: love-affairs, priestly wisdom, and all aberrations from the path of truth. Priests who claim to be in possession of special revelations, O disciples, seek secrecy and shun publicity and all those who stray from the path of truth, O disciples, seek secrecy and shun publicity. Three things, O disciples, shine before the world and cannot be hidden. What are the three? The Moon, O disciples, illumines the world and cannot be hidden, the Sun, O disciples, illumines the world and cannot be hidden, and the Truth proclaimed by the Tathâgatha illumines the world and cannot be hidden. There is no secrecy about them." The three things which illumine the world are the Light of the Father, of the Mother, and of the Son.

The same lesson is also taught by Jesus (in St. Luke 8; 16-17): "No man, when he hath lighted a candle, covereth it with a vessel, or putteth it under a bed; but setteth it on a candlestick, that they which enter in may see the light. For nothing is secret, that shall not be made manifest; neither any thing hid, that shall not be known and come abroad." The secret things which are here referred to, are those of the Ahankâra, the Devil.

There is, however, a knowledge which should be kept "secret". It is not liberating knowledge, but knowledge which leads deeper into bondage. It is the knowledge of the Titans. It involves man in a progressive entanglement in the snares of "the world", a progressive bondage on the wheel of Samsâra or the profane outlook, as turned by the Titans. That this knowledge should remain hidden is expressed in God's forbidding Adam to eat of the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge. The "eating of the fruit" is the cause of the Fall — and the greater the amount that is eaten, the greater the Fall — as the history of humanity, cyclically culminating in catastrophe, has abundantly demonstrated.

This "forbidden knowledge" includes a good deal of what is called "science" and "mechanics" in the present age.

A particular form of "forbidden knowledge", knowledge which should be kept secret, is that which applies to the development of so-called "supra-normal" or psychic powers. In India these are called Siddhis, literally "achievements". The word is generally translated by "powers", in accordance with the spirit of the age. The Siddhis mentioned by Patañjali in the Yoga Sûtras indicate successive experiences or achievements on the Path of the disciple. They are the psychic qualities and properties of the Spheres and their Gods. Therefore they may form "temptations" which,

if not resisted, become traps and snares and may lead the disciple on to dangerous by-paths. The Titans may again overpower him, since all by-paths lead to their realm. The disciple should not halt by the way any longer than is necessary to view the landscape and learn its message. He should "make straight the Way of the Lord", and not try side-paths out of curiosity to know where they lead to.

In some circles there is much whispered reference to mysterious occult or esoteric knowledge. If the leaders encourage or tolerate such whispering, it can only indicate that they have not "heard the Voice" and "seen the Light."

Very often in such cases there is question only of metapsychological or psychic experiences, which are mistaken for spiritual ones, and very often the people in question do not know what true secrets consist of or why they should be kept secret. In such cases the Ahankâra is very much in evidence. In an age when the profane overshadows sacred traditions even in the field of religion, the Mysteries have been superseded by mystery-mongering.

The truly occult is "so occult" that it is impossible to convey it by word of mouth to other people at all. It concerns the private relationship of the soul and God, in which a perfect Guru alone can be the silent mediator. In the Apocrypha is related how "Bartholomew came unto the Lord and questioned him, saying 'Lord, reveal unto me the mysteries of the heavens'." Jesus answered: "If I put not off the body of flesh, I shall not be able to tell them unto thee!"

Realization, Understanding and Knowledge. What has been explained above applies to the realm of the Ether and the Light. Below that is the realm of the Spirit, and of Sound. In that Sphere the Word is "heard." The esoteric Mystery-teachings of this Sphere can only be understood by one who with the faculty of Buddhi is able to read the meaning of the symbols used. Below this Sphere is that of the mind, of the "Naming" of matters and things. It is the Sphere of exoteric knowledge. Mystery-teachings may become known in this Sphere without being understood. In the Spirit they may be understood without being entirely followed up, mastered, and realized. The latter belongs again to the domain of the Guru, for if this is accomplished perfectly, it implies Attainment.

On the Path of the Sun, trodden by the spiritual seeker on his return-journey to the Father, Divine Reality, all is Light, whether of the Sun, of the Moon or of the Stars, and everything lies open to everything else. Secrecy is delimitation. The progressive note of the Path of Return is openness and expansion, like the soul of a child. The Way of the Lord is straight and goes

in a clear sweep through the Heavens. There is nothing which concerns that Path which the Pilgrim may not be told — if it can be told. If he is told correctly, there is no harm if he is told more than he can understand. When the time for understanding comes, his memory will stand him in good stead and help him to realize and master the teachings. The teachings must be consecutively perceived, felt, thought about, intuited or understood, mastered and their essence finally identified with oneself. This sequence, corresponding to the various Planes, can be profitably followed in meditation on divine symbols and archetypes, as has been recommended in various traditions. In actual life the functions rarely work in their order. Ideally they should work together harmoniously and synthetically. In practice, they are generally at loggerheads with one another. A vague intuitive insight alone, not harmoniously joined to thought and feeling, is of as little use as a means to mastery as any of the other functions in the same position. Mastery alone, implying synthesis and harmony, within and without, makes the Guru, the true Master or Teacher.

The spiritual aspirant must be on his guard not only against mystery-mongering, but also against partial knowledge, which is knowledge of the parts and not knowledge of the interrelationship of the parts in the whole, and thus not true knowledge at all. There is disadvantage and even danger in following teachings which hold forth fragments of Truth proclaiming them to be the Whole Truth, and which claim to be universal and catholic, or, in other words, claim to represent the whole of Revealed Tradition. That which calls itself universal or catholic is often no more than something particular and exclusive. Exotericism represents one form of partial teachings. It has no reference to the realms which lie beyond the mental and moral one, except in the limited terminology of that realm. The following of a creed, and the knowledge of doctrines, do not make a man into a Teacher, a Guru. It is significant that the word "dogma" comes from a Greek word meaning "seem". It implies a truth as it *appears* to the mind. A Guru or enlightened teacher can also not be formed by men, representing an organized or established religion or sect. A Church cannot make a Saint, a School cannot make a Sage. Saint or Sage, representing the true Guru, are made by the Grace of God.

The authority to be a spiritual teacher. The authority to teach and minister may be given by men and organizations of men, but such authority can, by the very nature of things, only refer to the first stages of the Path. There is no harm if the teachers realize this in a spirit of humility, in accordance with some degree of "insight" and

"inspiration", but if they take their stand on doctrine alone, proclaiming that to represent the absolute truth, and lacking divine authority to teach, then their teaching and ministering can be but a very pale, uninspiring and broken reflection of what it should be, and will do more harm than good. It may even drive people further off, instead of helping them to approach and conform. Broken teachings are found in literalism, form-conservatism, bigotry, devotee-ism, sectarianism, moralism, rationalism and a host of other "isms" in religion — so many forms of superstition or pseudo-tradition. In the Gospel of St. Thomas it is reported that Jesus took to task a teacher called Zacchaeus: "Thou that knowest not the Alpha according to its nature, how canst thou teach others the Beta? Thou hypocrite! First, if thou knowest it, teach the Alpha, and then we will believe thee concerning the Beta." How many Christian teachers, or, for that matter, teachers of other religions, know the Alpha? Jesus warned repeatedly against teachers "outwardly like sheep" but "inwardly like ravening wolves" — the wolf being a symbol of the Ahankâra — and against teachers "coming in my name." The Church of God, truly Universal or Catholic, the community of the Saints, is in the higher sense one and identical with the Brotherhood of Saints and Sages of other traditions, presided over by the Perfect Man, by whatever name or form he may be called or known. Adonâi, the Lord of Light, Melki-Tsedeq, Hermes Trismegistua, the Christ or Messiah, the Son of God, Vishnu's most perfect Avatâra, Amida-Buddha, Supreme Guru or Master, World-Teacher, Saviour, or by whatever other name or title. He may be called. He belongs to the Eternal Tradition, hidden deep in the soul of every man and woman in the world. He is not the especial property of any race, religion or sect. Christians delimit and insult Christ by thinking that he "works" only in and through their Church, and Buddhists who believe that Buddhas can only be Buddhists, make them into images of their own narrow mentality, instead of proclaiming their exalted nature. From the Glory of Illumination and the Bliss of Communion exclude themselves all those who are sectarians, fanatics and converters to "their own" (Ahankâric) form of religion.

A person can become a master, in the deeper sense of the word, only when he has purified, co-ordinated, synthesized and harmonized the "elements of his being", under the rulership of the Divinity of the Sphere of Ether, the Kingdom of Heaven, Paradise. While engaged in this spiritual endeavour, he will pass on to others what he receives himself of the Bread of Life. As long as he knows "where he stands", there is no harm done, if he teaches others. On the contrary. Harm is done only, if he is deluded about "his own" spiritual attainments, and makes claims for "himself." He should

know that he stands between the Master in his inmost heart, and the world of humanity. Whatever pieces of the Bread of Life his Master gives unto him, he should pass on to "the multitude". There is nothing which one should keep for oneself, spiritual possessions even less than material ones, treasures even less than common things. The Ahankâra is ever eager to reserve things for himself, and to store up a secret hoard, even of heavenly joys. But if Manna is preserved, it breeds worms. When the Ahankâra becomes unable to fulfil his nature with the things of this world, he begins with the things of the spirit. When he quotes Scripture, he becomes truly dangerous. Therefore teachers should know themselves and be on their guard against themselves, for there is no more treacherous enemy than the adversary within their own soul.

In view of this, the Teachers of the East have laid great stress on the necessity of spiritually "helping oneself first" before attempting to help others. This is not, as has been said in the West, a subtle form of egoism. The truth is that no one is really able to help another in the things which matter until he has purified, co-ordinated and harmonized the elements of his own soul. He is then not only qualified to help others but by his very nature he cannot fail to do so. He helps them rather by what he is than by what he does, because his every act, whether he wills or no, is instinct with the power of his spiritual attainment and the higher the attainment, the less of Ahankâra to obstruct. Anything else is but presumption and delusion. The teaching does not derogate from service, but condemns the Ahankâric stress which is so often laid on it. The self-conscious thought "I do good" or "I serve", often coupled either with the expectation of a payment in the form of heavenly goods, or with subtle forms of pride, does much more harm than good.

The theology of service. The theology of service has been expounded in an accomplished way by the Chassids, the followers of the 18th century Jewish saint and sage Rabbi Israel ben Eliezer, Baalshem. In the words of one of its greatest modern expounders: "To help another is not a task but the self-evident reality on which Chassidism is based. To help is not a virtue, but a pulse of its existence." "To help, not out of pity which arises from a sharp quick pain which one wishes to exorcise, but out of love." "He who thus lives with others, in his own action realizes the truth that all souls are one, for each is a part of the universal soul, and the whole of the universal soul is in each of these souls. Mixing with all, and unmoved by all, devoted to the multitude, and collected in his own individuality, ful-

filling on the rocky heights of solitude the bond with the eternal, and in the valleys of life the bond with the earthly, blossoming out in profound dedication, and withdrawn from all self-desire, he knows that all is in God, and meets his messages as trusted friends"

The remembering of God By uniting the fragments in his own life and soul to a Living Body, a person unites the fragments of the world around him and transforms them into the Heavenly City Engaged in that one-pointed end, he will lose more and more of his self-consciousness and become ever more loving and serviceable to others, not like a machine turning out a manufactured article, but like a flower opening up its heart to the light of the sun

The Divine Body, the True State, including the Tradition, in the form of Dionūsos, Osiris, the Cosmic Man of the Gnostics, was dismembered by the Titans. It is the task of the spiritual aspirant to re-member it. This re-membering is indeed the re-uniting of the members of fragments of his being into the Divine Whole. But it is also remembering in the current sense of the word, the remembering of the True State, the Kingdom of Heaven, the Satya-loka, the Paradise within the Heart-Self, the Source and Origin of all life. The two kinds of "remembering" form the two sides of one coin. In fact, the one cannot be there without the other. Instead of "re-member" one may also say "re-collect". The two meanings of remember are not related etymologically. The word "member" comes from the Latin "membrum" which is related to the Sanskrit "mamsa", "flesh". It means also "apartment". "Remembering" comes from the Latin "memor", meaning "mindful, remembering", from a root "mer" which is related to the Sanskrit root "smṛ". From this root are derived "smarati", "he remembers", and "smṛti", "memory". Smṛti is also used for one of the four classes of Hindu scriptures. Scriptures are forms of and aids in remembering the Divine Life. The language of everyday life contains very valuable fragments. But people have ears and do not hear.

In Islāmic tradition the term Dhikr is used for all different ways and means of reminding man of his Original State. Every Dhikr is a symbol intended to bring about its remembrance. It recalls man to God.

The great adventure. The "remembering" of GOD is the greatest adventure in the world. The word adventure has been used in modern times for all kinds of unusual and "sensational" experiences. Detective stories, the modern substitute for the sacred myths, legends and the popular fairy-tales of old, are full of adventures. In spite of

the fact that detective stories resemble myths and legends as night resembles day, there are yet certain correspondences. Even detective stories are based on a traditional pattern and supply a psychological demand. Both the sacred prototype and the modern productions show an ultimate "happy end", in which the villain is caught and wrongs are righted. That "the villain" really represents a part of the soul of the reader — the Ahankâra-devil — is suspected but by a few psychologists. The satisfaction and relief which is felt when the book-villain is caught, is symptomatic, not of the "rightness" of modern man, but of the fact that he tends to project the evil within him on to the outer world around him. He is always ready to right the world: in others and in organizations and institutions. Whereas those who live in accordance with sacred tradition know that they must right themselves before all, and that "the world", which refuses to conform to the law which is laid down for it, will follow of its own accord the life which shines from within the soul.

"Adventure" means "that which comes". It refers to the evening of the cycle, the time of the greatest spiritual adventures—see Diagram 1b. The Great Event — a related word — is the Advent, the coming of the Light. The Divine Birth, in the hour of darkness, is the Great Adventure. It is the Manifestation of Divinity in the Earth-House of Capricorn.

The killing of the teachers. Before the Great Adventure takes place, many minor adventures have to be faced by the spiritual aspirant. In sacred myths and traditions these take the form of the killing of various monsters or enemies — aspects of the Ahankâra — and of the killing of the teachers. The theme of the killing of teachers recurs again and again in myths. It is well-known that Hercules killed several of his teachers during the performance of his deeds and labours. Arjuna finds some of his old teachers in the opposing camp before the battle of Kurukshetra, and is told by his Guru, Śrī Krishna, that it is his duty to kill them. The symbolic meaning of this is that a man must leave all teachers and what they stand for in the way of part-knowledge, dogmas, maxims, creeds, etc., when they have given the little they had to give and when he has taken the firm resolve to follow the Guru alone. The Guru, if he is a true Guru, stands for the highest alone: Divine Realization. He alone is able to point the way — which leads ever onwards till the Goal is realized. The kind of teacher who should be "killed" is the one who does not point the way onwards, but who points unendingly to a set of texts, dogmas, rituals, beliefs and conventions, forming a creed and sometimes ranged around a personality, possibly even that of himself — and who thus binds the spiritual aspirant instead of show-

ing him the way to Liberation. Such teachers are necessary and helpful to a point. But when they have done their work, they should be left behind. The "killing" implies a severance of connections in the mind and in life. Spiritual aspirants should not become permanently attached to any "teacher", whether in the form of a person, an "established religion", a set of dogmas, or a sect that claims to have all truth for its own — not to mention social and political teachers. It is clear that present-day man will have to "kill" many of his teachers — if not all — before the Guru can reveal the Tradition. Only a "Death" can close a cycle.

The theme of "the killing of the teachers" is akin to that of "the killing of the doctors", found in fairy-tales. A good example is contained in the Tale of Kameralzaman and Princess Budur in the Book of the Thousand and One Nights, in which much deeply significant symbolism is hidden. The tale has an episode in which the King of China "called together all the learned men of his kingdom, all the doctors, astrologers, chemists, and those versed in the books of old" in order to cure his daughter, who was supposed to be very ill, but actually was only love-sick due to separation from her lover. The king promised the hand of the princess and the succession to the throne after his death to anyone who would succeed in healing his daughter. But the condition was that the healer-suitor would be beheaded if he failed. Forty came and tried and "lost their heads". The "learned men" of the story are now represented in the scientists, physicians, psychiatrists, philosophers, politicians, astrologers, sectarian theologians and so on, who are the specialists trying to heal the illnesses of man, caused by the Fall. They should be "killed", if they claim to be able to heal the *ultimate or basic ill*. We have already considered the beheading of Medousa by Perseus. In that myth the "beheading" symbolized the cutting of the knot of earth-bound consciousness and had reference to the first great Battle on the Path. In the episode under consideration the bride-the-soul seeks to be reunited to her Lord. The learned men therefore represent the hierarchy of earth-bound powers and sciences. They especially represent the faculties of the head in dissociation from the Heart. The Heart is the "one thing necessary", so they are impotent to restore psychical health. Their execution is the mind's recognition of this very state of affairs. They are beheaded for the "heartlessness" of their pretensions.

Eventually the princess was cured when prince Kameralzaman, her lover, arrived. He had clothed himself in the traditional habit of an astrologer, in order to be admitted into her presence. This symbolizes that the special traditional sciences cannot be dispensed with, but must be borrowed and used. It also hints that the higher Astrology is the most important of these

sciences. The princess was immediately cured and her happy marriage with her lover followed on the same day. The Mystic Marriage is equally the state of Grace and Love's consummation. In it is realized the unity of Being and Consciring. Abnormalities, psychical and otherwise, arise when the Normal (which is the Natural State) and its Norm (or the Tradition) have been lost. They are cured by means of the Panacea of Love or Grace, because in the Fall self-love was their cause.

Types of teachers. When choosing a new teacher, in the hope that he will be more of an Inspirer or a Guru, a spiritual aspirant should beware of teachers who choose *him*. A teacher who is anxious for personal reasons to get disciples cannot be a true Prophet or a true Guru, for these are beyond desire.

In spite of being desireless, or from a deeper point of view, because of it, true Prophets and Gurus change the spirit of their time and influence the destiny of humanity. They are remembered for their reflection in the world, of the immortality they have won. This perpetuates them as aspects of Divinity or as images of the Divine emanations. The teachers who are not fully purified and harmonized and who have not realized God-Reality and the teachers who give a new creed or a new philosophy of life, scratch only the surface of the world in which they live, however violently they may affect it, as some do. If they are not forgotten, they are remembered as spiritual frauds and as examples and symbols of "how it should not be done". Some are remembered with abhorrence and hate, but even then not for very long.

Though all true Masters have a great influence on the inner (and hence on the outer) life of humanity, they do not all necessarily acquire "name and fame". For though some may go into the fullness of the life of the world, others may "retire into a mountain cave" either literally or metaphorically. In the latter case only one or two disciples will know him as Master and pass on his spiritual light. Whether a Guru "goes into the world" or "retires into a mountain-cave" depends on the particular needs of humanity or of his race at the time. The tradition that "when the disciple is ready, the Guru will appear" applies to general humanity as well as to individual man. The law of supply and demand operates in all spheres.

In Hindu tradition the renowned Sage living in society and the little-known one living on the hill-top or in the forest are not differentiated in their spiritual efficacy. Neither is attached to the façade, the fads, the fame and the fuss of the world. But any remnants of self-will will prompt them to shun "the world" like a poison. "Take away this cup from me: nevertheless not what

I will, but what thou wilt "The field of life of a Sage is determined by the Will of God alone "The Will of God" is Jupiter-Jehovah, the Guru, the Lord of the Ether-Sphere The Guru on earth is His embodiment As the Lord surveys the world from the pinnacle of Heaven, so the Sage surveys human society from his Earth mountain-top The needs and possibilities of the time determine whether a Guru will remain on it and receive there the few who are able to climb to his etherial heights But he may well decide to go down into the world and refresh its atmosphere, with something of his own spirit Whatever he does, his actions pertain only to externals, for his Self remains serene and unaffected As the Self, GOD has no Will and does not act

Retreat Modern critics have judged contemplatives living in retreat as being anxious only for "their own enlightenment" and therefore as shirkers of duty or escapists Such a judgment arises from a moralism cut off from the spirit and itself carries the stigma of escapism — escape from spiritual issues In reality, the expression "one's own enlightenment" is a contradiction in terms Enlightenment is strictly conditional on the extirpation of all notions of "I" and "mine", of "aham" and "mamatvam", as the Hindus put it

In order to accomplish the spiritual end, periodic retreats — whether lasting an hour a day, a period of seven years, or a life-time, are essential For the soul should occasionally be away from an Ahankâric atmosphere

Since the Ahankâra uses all things for its own purposes, it sometimes happens that people go into retreat not for the purpose of seeking inspiration and light, but to escape from the responsibilities of the world

Before the spiritual function in man can "play the music of the Spheres" and thereby inspire heal and gladden the worlds of thought, word and deed, it must first hear the Word of the Tradition and the Voice of the Silence

Monotheism and Kathenotheism. Modernism in religion tends to atheism The God-abstraction of today and the God conception of old are poles apart The appetite for the Bread of Life is not satisfied by abstractions, so how can it accept a "depersonalization" of its God? In the Tradition, God is found through His emanations, aspects, qualities, attributes, persons and forms — applying to the Six Spheres — in Gods or Angels These represent various stages on the Spiritual Path Only through "the Son" can one know "the Father", and the Intermediary to "the Son" is "the Mother" The rationalistic conception of God is useless for all purposes of inspiration, integration and

enlightenment, and doubly so for the spirit of intellectual presumption which adheres to it.

The so-called monotheist religions have not been nearly as monotheistic as is commonly supposed. The very first sentence in the Bible — "In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth" — has been wrongly translated. The word translated as "God" is "Elohim", which is a plural term. In the Bible, God is called by many names and titles and appears in a number of aspects — as Adonâi, translated by many Jews as "the Eternal" and by Christians as "The Lord"; as El Elion, "the Most High God"; as El Shaddai, "the Most Mighty God"; as El Ruach, "the Spirit"; and as Jehovah, "the Living God". Further, many Angels and "Men of God" appear in the scriptures, taking the place of the manifold aspects and attributes of God. The ALHIM (Elohim) of the Cabalistic tradition is the sum total of the aspects of the Great Mother, through whom can be realized the Father or First Principle, Ab. The Angels appear in a group of seven, corresponding to the seven Gods of other religions, and in a group of twelve and in whole hierarchies, pertaining to the divisions of the Zodiac.

Christianity, with its Trinity and hierarchy of Angels, is also not as "monotheistic" as it is claimed to be. The same applies to Islâm. Allâh is given a number of wonderful attributes and titles: the First, the Last, the One, the One-without-Oneness, the Alone, the One-without-Aloneness, the Subduer, the Gracious, the Merciful, the Great, the Outer, the Hidden or the Inner, and others. These names correspond to the names of the Gods in other faiths.

Every true tradition, that is, every religion which forms a branch of the Tradition of old, is monotheistic in essence and kathenotheistic in practice.

Kathenotheism is the encounter and worship of one God at a time, whose being is real and whose form is symbolic, and who is an emanation, aspect, person, attribute, quality and form (in accordance with the Six Spheres in their order from the Moon-Sphere to Earth) of the Supreme Being, in agreement with the psychological situation at a particular moment, or in accordance with a particular stage of the Path.

It is clear, therefore, that kathenotheism is both scientific and practical, and forms the link between traditional psychology and theology.

Monotheism results from the *knowledge* that God is One, because the innermost and true man has his being in God-Reality. For the practical purposes of life kathenotheism cannot be dispensed with.

The rational function should not presume to approach and consider GOD. Thought can work on its own plane, which is a world of names and distinctions, on a vertical basis. It can "name" the rungs of the ladder which reach

from Earth to Heaven, but it cannot climb higher than the rung it itself represents. Only the "higher" functions of man can climb higher. Jacob (in Genesis 28, 12) "dreamed, and behold a ladder set up on the earth, and the top of it reached to heaven, and behold the angels of God ascending and descending on it."

Impression and expression. The greater spiritual experiences, not to speak of Divine realization, cannot be expressed in rational language. When such experiences come, all rationalistic conceptions and dogmatic beliefs dissolve like shadows of the night in the light of the rising sun. Such realizations cannot even be expressed in symbols, because the blaze of light dissolves even the forms of the symbols. It would be like describing the light of the sun in terms of candles or electric bulbs. In the same order of ideas, that which is of the nature of impression is insusceptible of expression.

Expression is the bringing down of an experience — to use the vertical symbolism of the rational function. The word means "pressing out" and should therefore be considered in connection with the concentric symbolism of the spiritual function. What is "pressed out" or "brought down" is, of course, not the experience itself, but only a pale reflection or imperfect image of it in the material of the rational, emotional and physical planes.

In connection with spiritual truths, impression and expression are both forms of revelation. Revelation is both an unveiling of spiritual truth and a veiling of the experience in matter of the lower or outer planes.

There is even a sense in which whatever is "expressed" is the "ex-creta" — lit "that which is sifted out" — of the plane, centre or sphere in question. Excretion is associated with the organic action of the material plane (see Diagram 1) and the material sub-division of each of the others. This illustrates with much vividness what the lower worlds are basically like from the point of view of the higher ones. In the same order of ideas the "discharge of responsibilities" is the basic organic function with reference to the Element Fire. The "response" is spiritual.

13 THE SYMBOLISM OF LIFE AND DEATH

The two movements Life consists of an eternal recurrence of impression and expression, of looking within and looking without, of breathing in and out, of going up and going down. The two processes occur naturally and involuntarily during the day-cycle. In another way they happen during the year-cycle. In a third way they occur

during the life-cycle. The two poles are consciousness and unconsciousness, or waking and sleep or death hiding and revealing a superior waking. The task before the spiritual aspirant is "to make day into night and night into day", and, in various senses, to make the state of death into one of life, and to kill what is considered to be life. There is a Hermetic saying: "Kill the living". For, as Euripides said: "Who knows but life may after all be death, and death be life." Before the aspirant lies the work of effecting a change of consciousness, not starting from the premise of a worldly consciousness which has to be turned into a spiritual one (though this has to be achieved), but from that of a Divine Consciousness which is the only real one, a super-waking state of Consciousness, which has to be freed from the darkened Ahankâric veils of the various lower planes. At the hand of what happens to every being in the day, in the year, and in the life-cycle, the spiritual aspirant has to attain self-knowledge and Self-Realization by means of his spiritual practices, whatever they are.

Life is in every way an alternation of contrary movements, not only in the sense referred to. Every action is followed by a reaction, every urge is countered by another urge. Great things have an anti-climax in small things. Small things suddenly assume vast proportions. — Hence, in these pages also, the great and the small, the high and the low, the inner and the outer, continually follow one another.

The two processes are actually one.

The spiritual aspirant should not allow himself to get confused by the seemingly twofold direction of the current, for, as the Hermetist Artefius wrote (178): "The solution of the Body and the coagulation of the Spirit are performed by one single and selfsame action." He should be concerned only with the process which the Hermetists Nicolas Flamel, Arnauld de Villeneuve, Rosinus and Basilius Valentinus described as: "Render manifest the occult and hide the manifest." "Form the invisible with the visible, and form the visible with the invisible." And, as Olimpiodorus said, "If the corporeal substances are not rendered incorporeal and if the incorporeal substances are not rendered corporeal, none of the expected result will occur."

For, as the Book of Compassion, an Arab Alchemic treatise, expresses it: "Body and Spirit are of One Nature, which is the Elixir and the Path followed by the prophets, the saints and the sages all."

Fundamental simplicity.

No one should allow himself to get dejected by the seemingly complicated nature of life and of the Tradition dealing with life. For he should realize that most of the

complications are due to the complicity of the Ahankâra, playing its tricks in and in between the Elements. The seeker will discover that the nearer he approaches to Truth and God-Reality, the simpler everything becomes. Truth or God-Reality is the "simplest" of all things. The Latin "simplex" is related to the Sanskrit "sama", meaning junction, equality, sameness, and to the English "sameness". The root is also in the Latin "semper", meaning always. Divine Reality is sempiternal and has simplicity and sameness at all times.

The complicated patterns of the stars in the heavens are symbolically connected with the complications of life. When the sun rises, the stars are obliterated. With the ascendancy of God in a person's life, the complications of Mâya disappear.

The higher the flight of the spirit, the simpler life becomes. There is ever less "to grasp" — faculty of the lower mind — and everything becomes ever more transparent — attribute of the higher mind.

High numbers impress the beginners on the spiritual path, for great numbers belong to the Earth as well as to worldliness. When rising higher the Thousand-headed Snake Ananta, "the Endless", is seen to have only Seven Heads, the Thousand-petalled Lotus, the Sahasrâra, reveals itself as a Six-pointed Star, with the centre as Seventh, the thousand nights of tradition are seen to be in reality only one night, the Sahasranama or "Thousand Names" of God pass away in the name of Silence. Everything which impresses by size and complexity is Titanic in nature. On high the endless confusion of sounds in the world below give way to a divine harmony. The manifold sounds are heard to consist of only seven notes, the manifold hues of nature are seen to consist of only seven colours. Looking down from on high, the seer beholds only five continents, the Five Elements, and only seven seas, the Seven Spheres. The innumerable Gods and their aspects, attributes and qualities, reveal themselves to be only Seven.

Desire for ever more and more detailed knowledge pertains to the lower mind. On the spiritual path it implies eating of the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge. The spiritual aspirant should strive to be "as simple as a child" — not the sophisticated type of modern child which is too grown up and not simple at all. From learned books he should turn to fairy-tales. From guessing who the detective-story villain is, he should turn to find the unknown villain within his own soul. From collecting scientific data and objects of this world, he should turn to collecting the fragments of his own self. From knowledge of the physical universe he should turn to knowledge of his own inner world. From the pleasures of the senses he should turn to the bliss of Heaven. From seeking for the source of suffering in the selfish behaviour of other indivi-

duals, other classes and other nations, he should turn to enquiring for the source of suffering within his own heart. From text books he should turn to sacred traditions. — For such is the ancient way of his forefathers, the only way leading from sickness to salvation, from sorrow to liberation, from death to life, from decay to immortality.

Death and immortality. From the point of view of those who know the true life, the state of worldliness into which the greater mass of mankind has fallen, is symbolized as a state of sleep, trance or death. The Orphics called the state of worldliness and the physical body of the people steeped in it, "the tomb". Hermetists called it "the tomb of Osiris". The same symbolism is found in the Gospels. The idea is also inherent in Hinduism, as in the Subala Upanishad: "Who, moving in the interior of *mṛtyu*, to whom *mṛtyu* is body, . . .". *Mṛtyu* is death. The word is related to the Latin "*mors*" and to "mortality". The symbolism of the Resurrection from the Tomb, on the Last Day, should be understood in the light of the symbolism of the Tomb. On the last day of the period of ignorance and *Ahankāra* that began with the Fall, the trumpet-call of the Angel of the Moon, Gabriel, calls "the dead man" forth to life in "the original and natural state". The trumpet produces the Sound of the Spirit. The Moon-Angel represents the Voice of the Tradition. Gabriel's title is *Nuncius*.

From the root "*mṛt*" is derived, besides "*mṛtyu*," also "*amṛita*". The word is related to the "*Ambrosia*" of the Greeks, and to "immortality". *Amṛita* is the mythical Elixir of Immortality.

The *Amṛita* is the Solar Elixir and is symbolically connected with the Ether-Sphere. It is closely related to the *Soma*, the Lunar Elixir, which is symbolically connected with the Moon-Sphere, the Sphere of Consciousness and the Tradition.

Soma was said to be born "between the two sacred stones that were used to press it out", symbolism referring to the union of Father and Mother, or God and his Creative Power, resulting in Enlightenment, and reflected in the preparation of the unfermented wine that was used in rituals. It is the *Jñānavari*, "the Water of Gnosis" of the Hindu tradition dealing with Knowledge. It is the Elixir of Life, the production of which was the aim and end of the Great Work of the Alchemist. It is further the *Rasa* of the Hindu tradition dealing with Bliss. In the *Rig-veda* (IX; 63; 13; 65; 15) the *Rasa* is the juice of the *Soma*-plant. The *Rasa* is the blissful essence of life. In the *Taittirīya Upanishad* (11; 7; 1) and the *Maitri Upanishad* (V; 2) it is self-luminous consciousness, ecstasy, and the perfect taste or realization of life.

According to tradition it is obtained by "smṛiti", meaning memory, recollection, and the scriptures that aid in the process of remembering and recollecting

The symbolic death is mentioned already in the second Chapter of the Bible, in connection with the forbidden fruit "In the day thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die"

Apple and throat.

The trance-like state of spiritual death is mentioned in many traditions and is the subject of many fairy-tales. The sleeping beauty in the woods represents the soul entranced by the power of "the wilderness of the world" Snow-white is the soul, as pursued by the Witch-queen, representing the obnoxious aspect of Mâyâ. As long as she is in the presence of the seven dwarfs, representing the Intelligences of the Seven Spheres, she is comparatively safe. But one day, while they are absent, the Witch, well disguised, tempts her with a poisoned apple. Disguises are the veils of Mâyâ. The poisoned apple is "the forbidden fruit" which tempted Eve. Snow-white falls in a death-like trance and not all the cares of the seven dwarfs can bring her back to life again. She sleeps in a glass coffin — for her state is transparent to the knowers of life and death — till the prince comes who brings her back to life. In this state of death-like trance many people in the world are immersed — a state quite apparent to those who look through the façade and beyond the surface — and the Angels, however eager, are unable to help till the Prince of the Spirit manifests himself and gives the call to Resurrection. Those who have not fallen into the trance or are awakening from it, should realize, and adhere to, the presence of the Gods, to guard themselves against falling a prey to the temptations of this world. The name "Snow-white" betokens that the essence of the soul, in spite of the spiritual sleep and the defilements of the lower worlds, is ever pure and untainted. The title of "sleeping beauty" indicates the same. It is as Blake said "The soul of sweet delight can never be defiled." For the essence of the soul is unadulterated Divine Reality. "All else" is but a dream. Indeed, from the point of view of the consciousness that transcends "this world", the world of Ahankâra, life is but a dream in a dream, in spite of great inventions, war, economic problems, political excitement and tax papers, or rather, on account of them.

The fruit mentioned in Genesis 2 and 3 was taken to be an apple in later times. The "forbidden fruit" in various traditions is as a rule either an apple or a pomegranate or "seed apple". The poisoned apple of the Witch-queen has a prototype in many old myths. Proserpina ate a part of a pomegranate

and so became involved in the Underworld-life. The Underworld is nothing but an aspect of "this" world — which men by their attitude and actions make into either a hell or a heaven. Greek mythology has further the story of the "apple of discord" which Eris, the spirit of discord, threw at the assembled guests at the marriage of Peleus and Thetis. This act was the primal cause of the Trojan War, a Greek version of the Battle of Life, which is dealt with by all religions in their own particular way and which is raging in the modern world in no uncertain form.

Because the "forbidden fruit" is being continually consumed, it was one of the main injunctions of Śrī Krishna to Arjuna before the Battle, that he should renounce "the fruits" of action.

The Fall is conceived as being from the Ether-Sphere to the Four Elements of Manifestation. In the body the Ether is represented in the Throat Centre. In connection with the Fall of Adam from Paradise we can understand the symbolism of the "Adam's apple" in the throat. The piece of the poisoned apple which the Witch gave to Snow-white also got stuck in her throat. She remained in a state of "suspended animation", that is, in other words, suspension of spiritual activity, till it came out again at the coming of the prince. Later it will be shown how the throat of Śiva is blue on account of the World-poison he swallowed and kept there.

14 THE TRADITION AND ITS AXIS

The return to the roots of tradition. The Path of Return, which has been seen to be a Path of recollection and remembering, leads back to the Root, the Source, the Origin. For That is the Goal also. There all traditions meet in the universal Tradition. At their beginning and "in their end" all traditions are One.

The Return to the Root is assisted by a study of the first period and origin of a religion. Then can be studied the earlier traditions of which that religion was the heir. The Bible contains several stages of tradition or consecutive traditions. In the Book of Genesis the Son of God of an early period is represented by the mighty figure of Melchisedec. The word "Melkisedeq" means "King of Justice". He was said to be King of Salem, which word means "Peace". Jesus was "made an high priest for ever after the order of Melchisedec" (Hebrews 6, 20), which links Christianity to the earlier tradition, before the Mosaic tradition. Jesus was not a mere re-former, but an in-spirer and re-vealer (of the Tradition). He proclaimed that he had not come to destroy, but to fulfil the Law. This statement has always been narrowly interpreted as referring only to the Law of Moses. It must have

been true in the historical sense. In the deeper sense, which rises above the limitations of time and space, the Law is the universal Tradition that lies at the heart of all the sacred traditions of all peoples and governs the unconscious life of their soul.

Genesis 1, 2 and 3 contains the root-tradition of the Bible and the teachings Jews and Christians should return to.

Christianity is furthermore the heir to numerous other traditions: Greek and Roman, Mithraic, Egyptian, Celtic of manifold variety, Norse, Germanic and others, not to forget the Buddhist influences from the East. In Europe the ancient heritage of myths, sagas and folklore has also to be drawn upon for fresh inspiration, for they represent a living treasure. The ancient Gods live and move within the soul, as is beheld by those "whose eyes have been healed", and who have risen from the tomb of modern death. The same applies to the people of the East — where many have been infected by the modern malady. Islâm has much to return to in its history, in its foundation by the Prophet Mohammed, in its heritage of more ancient traditions, Semitic and otherwise. The Prophet and a great many Muslim "Sufis" have borne witness to the true catholicity of the Spirit of Islam. For Mohammed Islâm — a word meaning surrender, peace, refuge, salvation — was not a new truth and law, but the resurrection of the primal and universal tradition of the world. If "Islâm" is taken in its true sense, the proverb "All children are born in Islâm" conveys a great truth, sensed by Goethe, when he wrote "If this is Islâm, are we not all Muslims?" Unfortunately this insight and realization has been lost by a good many of those who call themselves Muslim ("submitted") — as it has been lost by the followers of other religions. The only way to regain it is by a Return to the Root in the deeper sense of the phrase, and perhaps in other senses as well.

The four Vedas.

In Hinduism the Return to the Root is the return to Veda. In study and meditation the path leads back through the ritualistic and philosophical periods to Purânîc Hinduism, and from that to the Upanishads. From the Upanishads the path returns to the Root in the Vedas. According to a tradition the Four Vedas relate to the Four Ends of Life, the Yajur-veda to Artha — which refers to the Element Earth, the Sâma-veda to Kâma — which refers to the Element Water, the Atharva-veda to Dharma — which refers to the Element Fire, and the Rig-veda to Moksha — which refers to Air, the Spirit. The Yajur-veda, the hymns of which have to be muttered, is said to have for its objects men. It refers to the physical plane. The Sâma-veda, the hymns of which have to be sung, is said to have for its objects

the Pitris or "ancestors". It has been considered before how the Pitris refer to the Element Water. In IV; 124 the Sâma-veda is described as having special reference to the Pitris. It contains manuals for chanting. Singing has emotional implications. The objects of the Atharvā-veda are powers. The idea that "supernatural powers" can be attained by the practice of austerities — *tapas* — is very common in it. *Tapas* means "heat". It will be dealt with at length elsewhere. The Atharva-veda refers to the Element Fire, the mental plane. Atharva has been derived from "athar" meaning "fire". The hymns of this Veda are called Angiras, a word used for "descendants of Agni". Agni is Fire and its God. The Rig-veda, the hymns of which have to be recited, is said to have for its objects the Gods. Many references to the Solar Light are found in it. The Gâyatrî mantra, which is dealt with elsewhere, is given in it. The Sanskrit "Rig" is derived from the root "rich" or "arch", meaning shine or praise. Closely connected is "arka" meaning especially ray, sun, praise and song in praise of a deity.

From a point of view which takes into account the mythological stages of the Fall, Rig-veda, Yajur-veda and Sâma-veda have been associated with the Satya, Tretâ and Dvâpara Yugas, and the Atharva-veda, said to form a summary of the other three, with Kali Yuga.

In another context the Vedas have been traditionally classified as regards their contents into five headings: 1: vidhi or injunctions, 2: mantras or verses to be recited, 3: nâmadheya or names, 4: nisheda or prohibitions, and 5: arthavâda or that part which deals with things, acts and historical facts. These five headings refer to the Five Elements, from Ether to Earth.

The Four Vedas and all they imply are represented in the four main strings of the Indian musical instrument called *Vinâ*. The *Vinâ* forms the main symbol of the Goddess *Sarasvatî*, the Consort of *Brahmâ*, the Creator. It has been previously considered how Creation is associated with Sound. *Śrî Śankara* addressed his *Prapañchāsara* to her as the *Devî Śārada*: "May *Devî Śārada* whose limbs divine are garlanded with the eternal, seven-hued primal letters, commencing with A and ending with Ksha, who is the Sole Mistress of all Creation, Who is everlasting and who is the Sole Reality behind Manifestation, elevate and exalt my soul!" *Śārada* is Goddess of *Mâyâ* in her pure unveiled form, Goddess of Wisdom, One with her Lord, *Chitrû-pinî* or "Consciousness-formed". She plays "the Harmony of the Spheres" on her instrument — which is the Universe — and sings the Song of Life.

The Vedas are said to be the whole of Manifestation, come forth from the Word, the OM. They are said to be eternal and perfect — truths which become clear in the light of what has been said before regarding the Word and the hierarchy of Speaker, Voice, Word, consisting of Sound, Name, and

Articulation Later they will become clearer in the light of the Garland of Letters of the Goddess Kālī. The Word is the Quintessence of the Four "OM is the essence of the four Vedas", according to the Śiva-Jñānamṭa Upanishad. It is interesting to consider that the Four Vedas and the Four Gospels are both traditionally related to the Four Elements.

Veda.

The Four Vedas are not the Root. The Root is Veda Veda, freed from its literalistic and divisional implications, is the Tradition, Truth. The root of the word veda is "vid", found also in other Sanskrit and Indo-European words. Vid is to know, and also to be. The object of spiritual practice is said to be the identification of Vedaka, the knower, Vidyā, the knowing, and Vedyā, the known. Related words are the English "to wit" and "witness" and the Dutch "weten", to know. Veda is Pure Knowledge, Reality. Also related is "wisdom". The Tradition is the highest wisdom.

It is not surprising that the sacredness of Veda was transferred to written scriptures of that name, their reflection on Earth. The same has happened to the Scriptures written in Hebrew and Arabic, to the sacred Book of the Sikhs, and to scriptures in other languages. The influence of literalism, however, occults the spiritual meaning.

So deeply is the sanctity of "Veda" ingrained in the Indian mind, that Indian Christians have come to call the Bible "Veda-pustakam", "the Book of Veda". Indeed, the Root of the Old Testament as well as of the New is Veda, if the word is taken in its most profound and universal sense. The word "testament" is derived from the Latin testis, witness. The Old Covenant between God and the people of a particular tradition, and again the New Covenant, bear Witness to the Truth. But people who have no wit mistake the witness for the Truth that is borne witness of. They wot not that, in the words of St. Paul (II Corinthians 3, 6), who had personal experience of the matter, "the letter killeth, but the spirit giveth life." Why the letter "kills", is clear from what has already been stated above. The activity of Creation and Manifestation is one which moves downwards into denser and denser forms of Materia, the activity of "Dissolution", "Salvation" and "Liberation", however, moves upwards from denser to subtler realms, from the preponderance of the "material" to the preponderance of the "spiritual". Both movements take place on the ladder with the seven rungs. The Bible on the physical plane is only paper, as even the word "Bible" itself tells us, for "biblos" meant papyrus bark. The reader of Scripture should look upwards, and be a minister "not of the letter, but of the spirit." As regards the evils of "literalism", these have been dealt with elsewhere.

The fixed pole and the changing pole. The Root, Truth, God-Reality, the Source, is the Fixed Pole of Being. In the Universe of Manifestation nothing whatsoever is or remains fixed. Everything moves and changes: everything is on a path. Even the fixed pole of the universe moves, and is, as will be explained elsewhere, the Mâyâvic spiritual pole created by the Ahankâra in its form as the Earth-Dragon. In spite of that, the changing pole of the heavens bears witness to the True Pole, the Immovable, the Sthânu or "the Stable, the Established". The forms of all symbols belong to the changing realm of Manifestation, and pertain, however subtle their nature may be, to Expression, Creation. Yet they point the way and bear witness to the Truth of the Impression of Divine Reality. The Sun of Manifestation bears witness to the Sun Supernal. Existence testifies to "sistence", i.e. "the standing of the standing", namely Being. Creation bears witness to the Beyond, the Mortal to the Immortal, Death to Life. The different scriptures bear witness to the same truth, traditions to Tradition. Traditions may die but The Tradition is immortal.

The two Poles of Tradition. The Fixed Pole of God-Reality is reflected in the two Poles of Creation, symbolically corresponding to the Sun and Moon of Creation, which are as intimately related as the two sides of one coin and the two poles of one magnet. They are the two most exalted aspects of God. The two Poles of Creation are symbolised by sacred poles and pillars. Among these is the stone pillar which has remained sacred to this day in the form of the Śiva Linga, the upper end of which points to the Heavens, and the lower end of which sinks into Materia. It is found in all ancient traditions, and is known to Christians as the Pillar of Jacob. It is the Axis of the Universe. It has survived in a number of forms; the one best known to the West is the May-pole. The steeples of churches, minarets have, like the towers of temples, the same symbolism. As will be seen later, the Axis is also reflected in the upright tree of the Cross. Generally the material of which a cult-object is made, gives a clue to the Element which preponderates in the spiritual intention. Stone refers to Earth, wood to Water, metal to Fire, precious materials to higher Planes. The Axis is also found in emblems held by Gods: the iron rod held by Yama, the God of Death, the thyrsus in the hand of Bakkhos, the caduceus held by Hermès. It is further represented in the magic wand of fairy-tales.

The magic wand, the wand of Mercury-Hermès, the God of Air, the Messenger of the Gods, the Wanderer between the Spheres, the Lord of the function of inspiration and intuition, changes by its touch the aspect

of things. It is an instrument of God's Grace. When it touches a person, his world is transformed into a more joyful realm, and he becomes full of spirit. Or, may be, he sees his old world for the first time in its true light — an experience which at first is far from enjoyable.

The next section will be devoted to the God of Spirit and his magic Wand, and to the symbolism connected with the Element Air.

15 THE SPIRIT THE SYMBOLISM OF THE GODS, ANIMALS, PROPHETS AND POWERS OF THE ELEMENT AIR

The wings of the Spirit When progress is made in the "purification" of the Buddhi, the intuitive, discriminative, spiritual faculty, the inspired soul learns to use its wings to cross the precipices of the Earth and to fly over the floods of the Waters. Her wings help her to escape from being scorched by Fire. The wings of the Air, then, safeguard the soul from the hollows and traps of materialism, from the floods of sensual emotion and the flames of thought. When, in due time, the Gods call the soul to go to the Home of the Father, the wings carry her on high to the pure Sphere of the Ether, where she sees the Light of Heaven.

Without the wings of the Spirit no one can rise high. On high is heard the music of the spheres and the song of the swan, the Voice of the Silence.

The wings are those of Hermès-Mercury, who is represented with a winged head and feet. The winged feet lift the Earth up to Heaven, and the winged head brings Heaven down to Earth. For Hermès-Mercury is the Intermediary between the Spheres and the Messenger of the Gods. He brings the Grace of God from on high. Not only his sandals and helmet have wings, but also his wand, the Caduceus. That symbolizes the connection between head and feet.

Wind "The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth: so is everyone that is born of the Spirit" (St. John 3, 8). This is old, old, symbolism. To Job the Lord spoke "out of the whirlwind." Wind symbolizes the active aspect of the Spirit. In unfavourable contexts it may grow into a tempest, a spiritual storm.

The words „wanderer" and „wand" are both related to „wind." The German „sich wandeln" means to change in a deeply inward way. The transubstantiation in the Mass is called in German „die Wandlung."

The God of the Element Air is called Vāyu in Hindu tradition. His „wand"

is a flagpole with a streamer. The root "vâ" means to blow, to move, to kill. Derived from it are the Sanskrit "Nirvâna", and "Vâna", which means the vain, the empty, the void. Related words are the Latin "vanus" and the English "vanish", "vanity" and "vain". When the spirit blows one learns that "all is vanity" and the grossness of the world vanishes. "Nirvâna" does not symbolize "the absolute nothing", but, on the contrary, the "not-empty, not-vain", or, in other words, that which is beyond the "it is all vanity" of the Preacher (1; 2 and 12; 8). "Nirvâna" further means literally "not-breathed", and so refers to the Sphere, which is beyond the Element Air, namely, the Ether. Actually it is a word denoting the Essential State.

Related to the above-mentioned words is the Dutch "waaïen", the blowing of the wind. The following are also related words, that should be noted for their symbolical implications in connection with the influence of Spirit: "weather" (weather-cock), "wand" "wind", "window" (originally "wind-eye"), "winnow", "fan", "fane", "vane", "vent", "ventilate", "pervade", "vapour", and others.

Vâyu and Hanumân. The God Vâyu was also called Vâta in the Vedas, and is now also known as Pavana, implying purity. Sometimes he is represented as sitting on an antelope or deer, and as having four arms. The deer is a symbol of Jñânam or wisdom and realization. The four arms indicate rulership over the four lower planes. Sometimes he is represented as sitting on a lotus-seat and holding his son Hanumân, the so-called Monkey-God, on his lap, embracing him with his right hand. Hanumân represents the human soul in "the intermediate world", that of the Elements Fire and Water, as born from the Element Air, the Spirit, and completely at its service. Hanumân's devotion to his Master, Śrî Râma, and his cleverness, are both proverbial. Monkeys are animals that live in trees — representing the Element Fire — "in the air". They are great leapers, jumping to and fro between "heaven and earth". "Leaping" is also associated with the Element Fire. In the Râmâyana Hanumân manifests himself as a great jumper, and he shows his tail to represent Fire, and in particular the Kundalinî Fire. The "mind" is well-known for its jumping propensities. The "mind" is also well-known for its monkey-tricks. True Manhood, as represented in Śrî Râma, is attained by the Spirit. The mind should be the servant of the Spirit, as Hanumân is the servant of Râma. Only when the mind is the devoted and efficient servant and instrument of the Spirit, does it become fit to be admired and worshipped, like Hanumân, son of Vâyu, the God of Air. Hanumân represents the ideally spiritualized lower mind.

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man, stretching his arms to heaven. The initial H in words with spiritual implications is worth studying. Here only a few words of this class may be mentioned: heaven, heart, the Sanskrit Hamsa and Hu, and the Arabic Haq, truth. The Hamsa, a symbolic Bird, will be dealt with later. "Hamsa" is the word for breath. The Sanskrit root "hu" means to worship. It is inclined to "gh" towards the West, and hence the word "God" is also derived from the same root.

In the Zend-Avesta the Sphere of the Spirit was called Garo-de-mana, which became in Persian Garotman. It has been translated as "house of hymns". In the Element Air "the harmonies of the spheres" are heard. Garotman has been associated with the Vedic word Garutman or Garutmat, said to be the name of a heavenly Bird of great glory. The Sanskrit "garut" means the wing of a bird. Garuda is the great Bird which is the Vâhana of Vishnu. He is said to be a brother of Aruna, the Dawn, and, like him, full of lustre.

The Siddhis or Achievements of Yoga. Few aspects of Hindu tradition have caused more mystification, either innocent or intentional, than the teachings regarding the Ashtasiddhi or "eight achievements" of Yoga, and few teachings have caused so much misunderstanding, often with serious consequences, as these. The Siddhis, that is, literally, "achievements, perfections, satisfactions", are often called "the abnormal" Yogic Powers". Actually, of course, there is nothing "abnormal" in them. Like everything else, these "powers" become abnormal only by misunderstanding and misuse. It is the Fall which transforms the heavens, to which these spiritual achievements pertain, into so many hells. When the word "abnormal" occurs, there should be an inquiry into Ahankâric complicity. What is normal for Spirit is often abnormal for "the world", and vice versa. The Siddhis indicate Mastery over the Seven Spheres, from the Earth to the Sun-Sphere. It is the task of the spiritual aspirant on the Path of Return to God-Reality to acquire the Siddhis; he should strive to be initiated into them.

Acquirement is the activity from below upwards, initiation is the activity from on high downwards. This seemingly twofold activity is, however, only one. "The solution of the Body and the coagulation of the Spirit are performed by one single and selfsame action", as Artefius wrote.

The Eight Siddhis or Achievements of Yoga are the following. After each Sanskrit name the current, often most contradictory, renderings or interpretations are given between inverted commas. From these traditional fragments the truth shines forth. The Siddhis are:

Names and aspects of the Spirit.

In the aspects considered so far, the God of Air is represented as the gracious Lord of Spirit, liberator from the involvements of the lower planes. But he is also known in another aspect that of the Fall, the breaking off from Unity and the rebellion against God. In this more Martian aspect he is known by the name of Marut. The origin of Marut is related in the Rāmāyana. Diti, the Mother of Finiteness, sorrowing after the death of her children, the Asuras (Titans), at the hands of the Devas (Gods), asked her husband Kāśyapa, an aspect of the Creator, for a boon by which she could beget a child who should destroy Indra, the Lord of the Ether. Indra, coming to know of it, cut the foetus with his Vajra or "Thunderbolt" into 49 pieces. These became the 49 Maruts. As we noted before, the "thunderbolt" represents Mars. The Maruts are the Storms, the Martian aspects of Spirit. The 49 pieces indicate the seven times seven elemental divisions. In an older account the number is given as 27, that is to say, the number of Houses or Asterisms of the Moon-Zodiac. The division is a form of the theme of the dismemberment — which takes place on the Plane of the Buddha or Spirit. And so the reuniting of the fragments must also be achieved on this Plane, under the guidance of the God of Air in his peaceful and gracious aspect. To Hindu Astrology he is known as Budha, a word which is etymologically related to the name Budu, denoting the Sumerian God of Spirit, and to Wodan, the name of Hermès-Mercury in North-Western Europe. Budha is worshipped in the form of a golden bow. It will be seen later that the bow, and its special variety the rainbow, are also symbols of Air or Spirit. Budha-Wodan corresponds to Votan and Quetzalcohuatl of the Central American traditions, in which he was represented as a Bird-serpent, indicating his mastery over Fire. In Egypt he was Thoth, the Ibis-headed God. The Ibis, and its parallel in India, the Garuda, are mortal enemies of the snake. Both are Serpent-destroyers in the myths. The Element of Fire, the mental plane, can be subdued and mastered only by Air or Spirit. The word Buddha comes from the root Budha, as also the words Buddha, Bôdhi and Bôdha, all indicating various aspects of Enlightenment. All these are well-known facts, as also that the word Spirit means breath and a breeze, and that the Greek word for Spirit, Pneuma, means air and wind. The same applied to the Arabic word for soul—whatever the word implies—nafs. Nafasa is to breathe. The Greek Psukhe means breath. The Sanskrit word for the Essence or Self is Âtman, originally also meaning breath. The German word for breath, "Atem", is related to it. The Atmosphere is "the sphere of air and vapour". The air and wind-sounds in speech, primarily H, and further S, Y, F, etc., are called "spiritus". The letter H evolved from the picture of a praying

man, stretching his arms to heaven. The initial H in words with spiritual implications is worth studying. Here only a few words of this class may be mentioned: heaven, heart, the Sanskrit Hamsa and Hu, and the Arabic Haq, truth. The Hamsa, a symbolic Bird, will be dealt with later. "Hamsa" is the word for breath. The Sanskrit root "hu" means to worship. It is inclined to "gh" towards the West, and hence the word "God" is also derived from the same root.

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1. *Animā*: "the power to identify oneself with the smallest atom", "the power to project oneself into the smallest atom". It is the mastery over the Element Earth. In it the Creative Power is projected and broken up to the utmost. It is the power of analysis, which has special application in material science. Ani is the point of a needle, Anu means atomic, and is also a name of Śiva, in his aspect of God of the Earth.

2. *Prākāmya*: "the capacity to derive enjoyment from everything heard or seen", "the power to exercise an irresistible will upon the minds of others", "the power to obtain more than one expects", "the property to enter into the body of another", "the power to maintain a youthful appearance for an unusual length of time". It is the mastery over the Element Water, the emotional or astral plane. Kāma is Eros. The traditional renderings all refer to different aspects of the Element Water, which is also the plane of the emotional aspect of sex. Will or desire in various forms, youth, enjoyment, are characteristics of this plane. "The property to enter into the body of another" is not in the least a miraculous power. Great love and full sympathy with a person imply that power, which, for once, may even be taken almost literally. Physical birth is determined on the emotional or astral plane in two different ways.

3. *Mahimā*: "the power to expand one's consciousness to the largest atom or form", "power, might, glory". It is the power of "greatness", referring to the Element Fire, the mental plane. It is the mastery over thought, over the lower mind, over the creative urges of that mind. The attainment of this mastery truly implies "greatness". It has been seen before, how height is the dimension which symbolizes this plane. It also requires greatness to overcome the adversaries on this plane, which in myths and fairy-tales take the form of giants, and which are known to modern psychology as forms of inflation.

4. *Laghimā*. "the power of 'evitation'", "the power to transcend the body, light at will". This achievement is the mastery over the Element Air, the plane of Buddhi or spiritual discrimination. The soul, by rising up into the Air, obtains a "bird's-eye view" of the lower planes. The mastery over Air may also take another form. Tradition gives alternatively another Siddhi, called *Garimā*. The Yoga-Vāsishtha (VIa; 81; 45) describes it as follows: "If by the practice of Pūraka (filling up with air, that is to say, inbreathing) one can succeed in filling up the Kundalinī-nāḍī with Prāna, and letting it remain there without any outflow, one's body will become as heavy as a mountain, in addition to becoming vast". The details of this symbolism will be dealt with presently. It refers to the fact that the true greatness of

the mind, bringing expansion of personality and influence, is due to the Spirit. Garimâ further means "dignity, venerableness".

5. *Prâpti*: "the power to give indefinite extension to the subtle body or its members", "the power to obtain any desired objective anywhere", "the connection of a being with his organs as their presiding deity, known as attainment", "success in obtaining all desired objects and powers", "arrival at the goal, deliverance, discovery, good fortune, joyful attaining". In all these various traditional interpretations a fragment of the meaning has been preserved for this as well as for the other Siddhis. This particular achievement refers to Mastery, or rulership of the Ether-Sphere. The presiding deity is Indra or Jupiter, the Lord of the indriyas or organs. A person's essential nature in the Ether Sphere should rule his functions on the lower planes. This power of Mastery implies the discovery of Heaven, the attainment of joy and deliverance.

6. *Īśatva* or *Īśitâ*: "rulership", "the power to control and create". It is the power of and over Mâyâ, granted by the Goddess of Mâyâ. It is a power either for creation, multiplication, manifestation, or for simplification and dissolution by purification and unveiling of Consciousness. The word means "God-hood". It refers to Śakti, Creative Power, the Great Goddess, the Moon-Sphere.

7. *Vasitva* or *Vasitâ*: "the power of command and control, resulting from non-attachment to objects", "self-control", "self-restraint and power over the elements". Indeed, it is the Power which controls Mâyâ, and the Achievement of that Power. It controls and restrains the All contained in the self, and the self contained in the All. It refers to Śiva, the Lord of Mâyâ, the Sun.

8. *Kāmāvasāyitâ*: "consummation of any and every desire", "the power of suppressing desire". It is the Achievement of the fulfilment of the Heart's supreme desire, which is the liberation from bondage and the salvation from suffering by the annihilation of all desire. It is God-Realization. It is the Power which subdues the Primordial Kâma or Desire, the Primal cause of Existence, and the Achievement of the Return unto GOD, Parabrahman, the Beyond, about Which or Whom man can only stammer "neti, neti", that is "not this, not this". It is Nirvâna.

It is obvious that these Achievements or Powers, except the highest, can be misused. In fact, they are being gravely misused all the time, in as far as they are not yet truly achievements or perfections. In other words, their partial acquirement constitutes misuse, for perfection rules out the possibility of misuse. Yet, from another point of view, every one of these achievements is capable of being misused, as long as the next higher achievement has not

yet been attained. The fact is, of course, that there cannot really be seven or eight, or even two or three perfections. There can be only Perfection, the perfection of a truly harmonized and aligned state of being which is symbolized as Sonship. Every one of the seven or eight Achievements by itself is only a partial achievement, from the point of view of the ideal to be attained. Hence the scriptures stress that the Goal is Siddhi, in the singular. The first three Powers, pertaining to the elements Earth, Water and Fire, the physical, the pleasure, and the mental planes, are being seriously misused especially at the present time, and the misuse has brought world catastrophes of an unprecedented kind. Mankind is today hypnotized by the physical plane. Man thinks he has mastered it but he is more than ever before its abject slave. As a man thinks so he becomes. The first condition of mastery over anything is the direction of the attention to what lies above it.

Abnormal psychic powers

The Seven Achievements, beginning from the first, and passing by way of the others to the highest, should be mastered by all spiritual aspirants so far as their natures permit. They are normal and natural powers which should be the end of all in so far as they manifest in their own planes. They become abnormal when they manifest on planes which are not their own. It has been noted before how it sometimes occurs that powers of one Element interfere in the domain of other Elements, and how rites of exorcism aim at restoring equilibrium by "making Earth fall to Earth, Water return to Water, Fire burn, and Air revolve". When these Powers, by Ahankâric interference, manifest in the wrong way on the wrong planes, they become the "psychic powers" against which the Masters always warn their disciples. When spiritual "levitation" becomes levitation on the physical plane, when spiritual vision becomes mere astral clairvoyance, when the spiritual hearing of the Word becomes the mere "clairaudient" hearing of voices through the ears, and similar phenomena, the norm has been left for the abnormal. Hence the teachers of true tradition always give warning against desiring such powers or phenomena — because this stimulates Ahankâra, which is the very thing a spiritual aspirant should avoid — or they warn one against paying undue attention to them, when they manifest themselves of their own accord, since this might keep the aspirant from advancing to his spiritual Goal. Many saints, innocently and without wishing it, display unusual phenomena. Their sainthood consists of the purity, right alightment and holiness of their personality, and not of the wonders and signs they may possibly manifest. It is a well-known fact that "ordinary", unspiritual people sometimes show unusual powers — which should be left alone as abnormal. People who have

only the vaguest spiritual inclinations often hanker for the abnormal, in the form of psychic sensations and miracles. Jesus said (St. Luke 11; 29) to "the masses": "This is an evil generation: they seek a sign: and there shall no sign be given it, but the sign of Jonas the prophet." This word is of special application at the present time.

The greatest miracles, sensational but not spectacular, are worked by the Spirit, by virtue of the law of supply and demand in the domain of faith, where hindrances of Ahankâra are absent.

The two meanings of "Spirit". "Spirit" in Manifestation is the Element Air, ruled by Mercury. In a higher sense "Spirit" is the highest aspect of the Moon-Sphere. This distinction applies to all traditions. In Genesis (1; 2), "The Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters". In the Apocryphal Gospel to the Hebrews Jesus speaks of "My Mother, the Holy Ghost". In the early Church the Agia Pneuma or Holy Spirit was conceived as a "female". Budha, the Mercury of Hindu Astrology, is the son of Soma, the Moon. The Mother-Spirit and the Air-Spirit are intimately related in symbology. The latter is the Messenger of the former. In ancient Mediterranean traditions doves were found with the Mother Goddess, in her various aspects. In Christianity the Dove is the symbol connected with the Holy Spirit. Elsewhere more instances will be noted.

Prâna. An aspect of Spirit in Hindu tradition is Prâna. The teachings about Prâna have mystified many generations, because the word may mean a great variety of things. The particular meaning in any given context has to be gauged from the number attached to it: whether Prâna is One, or whether there is question of two, five, seven, or more Prânas. From the Supreme Spirit down to animal magnetism and the air that is breathed, the whole Cosmos is pervaded by Prâna. The entire process of Creation and Dissolution, apart from that of Maintenance, has been expressed in the symbolism of Prâna in the in- and out-breathing of God.

For mention of the Prâna, as the One Life and Spirit, one should go back to early traditions. In the Aitareya Âranyaka (II; 2,1) it is stated that "The Prâna shines upon the world in the form of a Person." In the Yoga-Vâsishta (VIa; 24,28) it is said that "the general name of the vital air in the Hridaya is Prâna." The Hridaya is the Heart of Hearts. The Prâna in the form of a person is the "Cosmic Man".

The Two Life-breaths. Out of that Centre, and back into it again, flows the Life-breath, thus manifesting as the Two Life-breaths. They correspond to some extent to the Two Paths which have been mentioned earlier the *Pitri Yāna* or "Path of the Ancestors", also called the Southern Path of the Moon, leading to involvement in the world, and consequently to bondage and suffering, and secondly the *Deva Yāna* or "Path of the Gods", also called the Northern Path or Path of the Sun. The first is the Path of *Pravṛtti* or involvement, and the second the Path of *Nivṛtti* or renunciation.

The correspondence between the Two Paths and the Two Life-breaths is only partial, of course. They have their own symbolical implications. The scriptures and traditions of all religions are full of references to the Breath of God. Generally the Breath of man moves in the inverse direction. The Outward-going Breath of God is the Inward-going Breath of man, and the reverse, as will be seen from the references that follow.

Prānāyāma. The symbolism of the Two Life-breaths is at the root of the Yogic doctrine of *Prānāyāma*, which, in modern times is generally considered to be merely "breath-control" in a literalist sense. This superficial view is not new, however, since already Śaṅkarācārya wrote in *Aparokṣhānubhūti* (119-120) "The negation of the phenomenal world is known as *Rechaka* ("breathing out"), the idea 'I am verily Brahman', is called *Pūraka* ("breathing in"), and the steadiness of that idea thereafter is called *Kumbhaka* ("restraint of breath"). This is the real course of *Prānāyāma* for the enlightened, whereas fools only torture their nose." The last remark refers to the Yogic practice of alternatively closing the right and left nostrils, by people who have no inkling of the symbolical meaning of *Prānāyāma* or "Life-Breath control". There is no doubt, however, that a physical breath-regulation is helpful in the attainment of emotional and mental poise and balance, if it is done in the proper way. The deeper meaning is brought out clearly in the *Tejobīndupanishad*: "Man's *karmas* come to an end when he realizes that everything he has a conception of, is but the manifestation of Brahman. This state is called *Rechaka* (exhaling). The subsequent contemplation that 'I am that Brahman' is *Pūraka* (inhaling). To continue that contemplation without interruption is *Kumbhaka* (steady inkeeping of *Prāna*). Such is the nature of the *Prānāyāma* meant for the wise. To the ignorant it simply means regulation of the breath."

The Mantra Hamsa. The symbolism of the Two Life-breaths also lies at the root of the mantra, that is to say, "magic" and symbolical formula, "*Hamsa*". The word "*hamsa*" means

breath. The Hamsa is the Swan, an aspect of the Bird of the Element Air or Spirit. To the word Hamsa is related the word "gans" in West-European languages, in English "goose". An Egyptian form of this bird is shown in the frontispiece. The two syllables of the word Hamsa are the two wings of the Bird, representing the Two Life-breaths. In one Indian tradition they represent Brahmâ the Creator, also called Kâlahamsa or "Swan of Time", and his Consort, Sarasvatî, Goddess of Wisdom. At the beginning of every cycle the Kâla-hamsa or Swan of Time, lays an egg, from which the world springs forth.

In Śaivite tradition the two syllables of Hamsa represent Śiva and Śakti, the mantra of Śiva being Ha or Ham and that of Śakti, the "Power" and Consort of Śiva, Sa. In Śāktism the entire mantra Hamsa represents the Goddess, the Manifested God. If the word is repeated quickly in "japa" or rhythmic repetition, it becomes Saham, which means "She I am". By meditation on the identity of the soul with the Goddess of Manifestation, the deeper meaning of the mantra opens up.

The Swan. In Yogic tradition the Ruler of the Heart Centre, the Anâhata chakra or "Sound-wheel", is Vâyu, the Lord of Air. The presiding deity of this centre is represented as sitting on the Hamsa. The Element Air is that of Sound. The sense of hearing pertains to it. The Swan, Bird of so many traditions, is an aspect of Mercury, God of Air. The word "swan" is related to the Sanskrit word "svan", meaning "to resound, sound, sing". "Svana" is "sound", and is related also to the Latin "sonus". A dim memory of the mystic meaning of the swan, the "royal bird", has been preserved in the idea "swan-song". The Swan-Song is the last spiritual blissful experience at Dissolution, as it was the first at Creation, before it became coagulated into the articulate sounds of Manifestation. The "Song of the Swan" is furthermore the "Voice of the Silence" as heard on the Plane of Buddhi or Spirit. It is the Harmony of the Spheres, the Song of Freedom of the winged Soul. It is significant that "Anâhata" means "*unstruck* sound", as distinguished from sound on the physical plane which is produced by mechanical means.

The forbidden question. In order to soar beyond dualities and opposites to the Primal Unchangeable State, the Swan should be used as Vehicle. And once the Soul has soared to the Beyond all questionings and speculations come to an end. After Experience has come, the lower man should not interfere, with reasonings and sentiments. When the Soul returns from its flight, the question should not be asked 'Whence

comest thou?' Such questioning betrays weakness of faith and over-eagerness of mind. Curiosity is a form of the eating of the forbidden fruit. The Spirit should be followed with a wholehearted surrender and an unquestioning faith. In a good many myths and tales a Saviour comes, and stays only on the expressly stated condition that the question whence he hails should not be asked. The knight of the Swan, Lohengrin, a son of the King of the Castle of the Holy Grail, came to the succour of Lady Elsa of Brabant, on the express condition that she should never ask him whence he came. For a time all went well, but then curiosity overcame her and she asked him the fateful question. Then, sorrowfully, he took his leave, after revealing to her his origin. A memory, a tradition, was all that was left. A memory or a tradition is always the only thing that is left when the Light has been veiled, when the Paradise has been lost, when the Presence is no more heard. It remains as the spirit of Hope, in a small but immortal star, that will eventually guide to a new revelation of Light.

There is an ancient Oriental tradition that an unknown guest should not be questioned as to his name and place of origin. The guest should reveal them first, if he wishes to do so. In another context we have considered how the guest may be an Angel or a God. The sacred presence of Divinity should not be enquired into with a questioning, analysing, dismembering mind. It has been lost by it, and it is lost again and again by it, and it will never be regained by it.

The trumpet-call.

The Plane of Buddha and Air is that on which the tradition is heard and on which the Word of God becomes audible, after a certain amount of instruction on the

Plane of Fire has prepared the ground. "The hour is coming, and now is, when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God and they that hear shall live" (St. John 5, 25). The resurrection of the dead is nothing but the opening up of the inner world of Truth and the awakening from the trance-like state of consciousness in the bondage of Ahankara on the lower planes. The trumpet-call of the Angel calling "the dead" to Resurrection is heard on the Plane of Buddha.

In Hindu ritual the blowing of the sacred conch as well as the ringing of bells symbolize the Air-Sound of the Sacred Word, OM. These sounds are produced at the culmination of the ritual. It has been seen before how the Conch represents Budha or Mercury, the Lord of Air in Hindu Astrology. The Sound is the Anâhata-nâda of Yogic tradition.

The five Prânas. The Prâna or Spirit subdivides itself in Manifestation. In the Prasna Upanishad (II) we read: "The Supreme Prâna declared: Do not be deluded. I alone, dividing myself into five parts, hold this body and support it". The "five parts" of Prâna relate to the Five Elements. They are known as Prânâdi. In the Yogic tradition of Patañjali their names are given as follows: Prâna, Apâna, Udâna, Vyâna and Samâna. The mastery of these Five Prânas gives extraordinary powers. In this respect applies what has already been said about the Seven Siddhis or Achievements of Yoga. The references to the Five Prânas are partly "physiological" statements of which the symbolic nature is overlooked by literalists. These references are, however, not entirely symbolical. The Prânas refer to the interrelationship of Spirit and its sheaths, including the physical body. The word Prâna is generally translated by "vital air", "vital energy", or "magnetism".

The Five Prânas are the following. The fifth is called *Apâna* and is considered to be "the seizer of food", and "the vital energy that works throughout the alimentary canal and the digestive organs." Apa means "down, out". It is located in the sphere of the anus, or the digestive system. It is the Prâna of the Element Earth, that is to say, of the physical body.

The fourth Prâna, called *Vyâna*, is considered to be "the energy working through the nervous system and in the blood-circulation." It is said to be "the father of Apâna". Vyâna means "to breathe in different directions", „to distribute breath over the whole body". It is "not located anywhere in particular but pervades the whole body". It is the Prâna of the emotional plane, the Element Water.

The third Prâna, called *Samâna*, is considered to be "the Prâna which controls assimilation and distributes the food, etc., equally to all parts." Patañjali (III;40) says: "By mastery of Samâna comes light-radiance." Samâna is located "between the heart and the navel". The meaning of "food" has been considered previously. The solar plexus or Fire-centre is situated between the heart and the navel. It is one which produces "light-radiance" when it and the other Centres work in perfect co-ordination. The "digestive fire" may cause great trouble until the time when it truly becomes the Solar Fire which gives the name to the Solar plexus. Samâna also means "virtuous, middling, possessing honour, uniform". It is the Prâna of the moral sphere of the lower mind.

The second Prâna, called *Prâna*, relates to the Plane of Air or Spirit. It is Prâna in the sense most commonly used in the scriptures. The Gheranda Samhitâ says (V; 61) "It moves always in the heart." For its Centre is the Anâhata Chakra, the Heart Centre.

The first Prâna is called *Udâna* Patañjali (III, 39) describes it as follows "By mastery of the *Udâna*, the Yogî does not sink in water, or in swamps he can walk on thorns and he gains the power of ascension " Since it applies to mastery of the Plane of Ether, it is clear that sinking in the waters of the emotional life and in the swamps of the lower mind is no more possible, and that the thorns of the earth cannot hurt his feet The power of ascension pertains to Air or Spirit *Udâna* is also considered to be "the Prâna that carries the soul after death to the different states according to its actions " The Four Elements are within the domain of death, the Ether, however, is an æviteral state In the after-death and pre-natal state, the future pre-arranges itself out of the past in the Ether *Udana* is said to "pervade the whole system" Or, alternatively, it "rules the region of the body above the throat", or, in other words, the head It is also said to "control the *Sûkshma Śarîra*" or "subtle body", which again confirms what has been said previously

According to tradition, each of the Five Prânas is subdivided into Five Prânas on the same basis Here $5 \times 5 = 25$ comes into the place of the $4 \times 4 = 16$, which has been considered previously

Patañjali writes clearly and unmistakably (III, 44) "Mastery over the Elements is acquired by concentrated meditation on the fivefold forms in the manifested universe," and then enumerates their properties as respectively 1 "grossness", 2 "quality or character", 3 "subtlety", 4 "susceptibility to distinction as to sattva (purity, harmony), rajas (activity, passion) and tamas (inertia, darkness, materiality), and 5 "usefulness or proficiency" In the 45th verse he continues "From the acquirement of such mastery over the Elements there result to the Yogî various Siddhis" or Achievements, which he then enumerates They have already been considered

In the *Gîtâ* the connection between the two forms of Prâna or Spirit as Prâna and *Udâna* is referred to thus (IX, 6) "As the mighty Air, ever moving everywhere, is rooted in the Ether, so all beings remain rooted in Me, thus know thou " And, indeed, as the *Taittiriya Upanishad* (III, 1) proclaims "Those who worship Prâna as Brahman assuredly attain the fullness of life "

The Nâdis of Yoga According to Yogic tradition, Prâna moves through Nâdis The word "nâdi", translated by some, who stress the physiological aspect of Yoga, as "nerve", really means "tube or hollow pipe" The word is derived from "nadi", reed The root "nad" means to resound The most important Nâdi is the *Sushumnâ*, placed within the spine, which is the Polar Channel, the Axis of the Microcosm It is the Pole, the Pillar, the Wand, and is represented in the Caduceus of

Mercury, the Lord of Air. The next two important Nâdis are the Idâ or Moon-channel, and the Pingalâ or Sun-channel. They are found in the two snakes at the side of the Caduceus, as has already been noted in another connection. Their lowest meeting place is the Mûlâdhâra or "Root-support" Centre at the base of the spine. That Centre is ruled by Gaṇapati, who is the Lord of the Two Paths, as is Janus of the Romans. The Two Air Channels of Sun and Moon are those of the Outward and Ingoing Breaths, previously considered. In Yogic tradition the two nostrils are connected with them.

The two "Channels" have been known by other traditions than that of Yoga. In "Secret symbols of the Rosicrucians of the 16th and 17th century", a manuscript printed in 1785, the Philosophers' Stone, which is a symbolic representation of the Macrocosm and Microcosm, is described as having two sides. The right side is called "Lumen et Spiraculum Vitae" or "Light and the Breathing-passage of Life" and the left side "Tenebrae et Spiraculum Mortis" or "The Shadows and the Breathing-passage of Death".

The "twofold airtube" is also described in the Popul Vuh, the scripture of the Zuni Indians of America. The "Airtube" corresponds to the Susumṇâ nâdī. To Kundalinī, the Dynamic Fire of Creation and Manifestation, corresponds Hurakan, the God of Lightning. His name has been preserved in the word "hurricane", and moreover, by an irony of fate, in the "hurricane-lamp". And yet something of the meaning has been preserved, for no storm, however strong, is supposed to be able to blow out the light of a hurricane-lamp. It is, as it were, the lamp of the sage of old, who goes out in the darkness of a world of materialism, to look for a righteous man.

The names of Gods. In ages of materialism the Gods are forgotten. Their names become by-words of human characteristics or shortcomings. In the present time Mars is found in "martial law", Venus in "Venerial disease", and "aphrodisiacs", Eros in "erotic disposition", Saturn in a "saturnine" and Jupiter in a "jovial temperament", Luna, the Moon, in "lunatics", and Hermes in "hermetically sealed". The degeneration of words illustrates the Fall of man! The forgetfulness of meanings is also not indicative of progress. Who would connect "sunny laughter" or a "sunny disposition" with the Sun-God, or "veneration" and "venerableness" with Venus?

The Comforter and Healer. In times when sacred tradition has been forgotten and when words have degenerated, the Spirit manifests itself by the revelation of meanings and the renewal of ancient traditions. After it had been given "a new name", the soul can sing

"a new song" The new song is none but the age-old Hymn of the human soul, but it resounds with the astonishing freshness of immortal youth, lifting away heavy burdens of sickness and sorrow. The bringer of the new name, the inspirer of the new song, is the Youth Mercury. He is the Messenger of Heaven, the Healer, the Comforter, the Saviour from corruption and Giver of Immortality. In the *Rasēśvara Darśana*, a Hindu Alchemic work, one reads "Mercury and Air save from all sickness. Mercury and Air maintain life. Is there anything better than an incorruptible body? It is Mercury who makes the body immortal. He saves from transmigrations of soul, he liberates from reincarnations." Modern man requires the Comforter and Healer very badly. The Joy of the Winged Angel will drive away his sorrows, after the Great Medicine, the Elixir of Life, has healed his sicknesses. Then his endless transmigrations or searchings "in all the world" and his reincarnations in ego-ism will come to an end, and he will remain transfixed in Spirit, here and now and for ever.

**Indra and
the Indriyas.**

Before the Comforter, the Spirit, can sound his note in the soul, the bondage to the senses must be shaken off.

The freeing of the soul from the enslavement to the senses is a great labour. Instead of obeying the *Ahankāra*, the senses should be trained to obey the Lord their God. Their Master and Ruler is the Divine Ruler of the Sphere of Ether. The senses are called *Indriyas* in Hinduism. This word has been derived from the name of the Jupiter of Hinduism, Indra, the God of the Ether, the realm of Paradise. By means of the senses the Inner Ruler in the soul is in contact with "the outer world." The five senses have each an organ on the physical plane. But only one of them refers particularly to the Element Earth. For each of them symbolically represents one of the Five Elements. In order to understand and to control himself, the spiritual aspirant should consider the traditional relationships and correspondences, found in all the great traditions, but preserved almost intact till this day only in Hinduism. They will be dealt with in detail below, in other connections. For the Ten Commandments of the Semitic religions, the ten *Yamas* and *Niyamas* of Hinduism, or indeed, the rules of any moral code, are based upon them. Hindu tradition distinguishes Five *Jñānendriyas* or *Buddhindriyas*, that is, "Organs of Knowledge" or perception, and Five *Karmendriyas* or "Organs of action." Their relationship and correspondences are as follows.

<i>Organs of Knowledge</i>		<i>Element</i>	<i>Ruler</i>	<i>Organs of Action</i>	
2 eyes	seeing	Ether	Jupiter	2 hands	Giving (Altern controlling)
2 ears	hearing	Air	Mercury	2 feet	moving
nose	smelling	Fire	Mars	mouth	speech
tongue	tasting	Water	Venus	organ of sex	procreating
skin	touching	Earth	Saturn	anus	excreting

In the dual number of the two highest organs the duality of Sun and Moon are represented. Of the three lower organs, the ones of knowledge are those of taking possession, and the ones of action are eliminating ones. The body provides a perfect language for the expression of psychological verities, by virtue of the maxim "As Above, so Below". The body was formed by a series of reflections of Spirit onto or into ever grosser matter. For the purpose of understanding, discipline and self-control, these reflections should be followed back from the gross to the subtle.

In other traditional connections the organs of Mars and Jupiter should be interchanged. In that case the mouth is the Jupiterian organ giving utterance to "the word" and the Martian hands are the creative or destructive organs which give or take (and steal) (see Diagram 1).

One accustomed to think in terms of modern science may perhaps wonder at the seeming inconsistency of Fire in the scheme of the Elements. Yet Fire fits in perfectly. It represents a creative or destructive combination of either solid or liquid matter with oxygen, the "life-essence" of the air, which can unite with them. The ancients knew more about "science" than is commonly presumed. Even the most ignorant "scientist" in early times must have known that a fire goes out in a place where there is either no air, or no material to burn. The material processes are, in the eyes of a Seer, perfect symbols in the language of the Soul. Even water is the result of a burning process. The order of Creation of the Elements is Ether, Air, Fire, Water, Earth.

The organs and functions of the Five Senses should be considered in connection with the Five Paths and Yogas and the other five-fold divisions previously mentioned. By doing this in relation to his own life, a spiritual aspirant obtains much insight into his own problems and shortcomings. The knowledge gained will aid him in proceeding on his Path.

Ritual offerings.

By a little meditation on these matters insight is gained into the rituals of the various traditions. These aim at leading consciousness from the gross projections in the

material world, through the subtler projections in the intermediate realms of feeling and thought to the subtlest in the sphere of spirit. They are all forms of "magic" psychological devices for the control of Mâyâ, that is to say, means of dealing with and neutralizing the powers of darkness within the soul by enlightenment. The rituals aim inwards and upwards, and back again.

The offerings made in different forms of divine worship and the various elements which enter into rituals all relate to the Five Elements, Planes, Worlds, Spheres or Essences. They are all forms of renunciation and purification, and all aim at sound and light-revelation and initiation. They apply to the Five Planes and also to the five sub-divisions of those Planes. Some offerings are renunciations, particularly referring to Earth. Some are water and fire purifications, particularly referring to Water and Fire. Some offerings, like the burning of incense, are forms of worship, particularly referring to Air. Light, especially in the form of an everburning light or flame, refers to the Ether-Sphere.

- Rituals applying to Earth** Renunciation, though of course applying to all planes is particularly stressed on Earth. "It is easier for a camel to go through a needle's eye, than for a rich man to enter the Kingdom of God." In Hindu rituals the offering of a small silver coin is to be made. This "dakshina" is not — or rather was not — in the first place a payment to the officiating priest, but a symbolic act of renunciation of wealth. One of the Three Magi, representing Earth, offered gold at the cradle of the new-born Christ-child. In Hindu rites the Alankatu, or offerings of jewels and decorations to the Deity, is symbolic of the renunciation of earthly possessions to God, thereby sublimating them to real treasures in the form of divine qualities and perfections. It is not a common offering, as it is applicable only to "the rich."

- Rituals applying to Water.** Forms of water-purification, found in all religions, refer particularly to the emotional plane. The water-rituals baptisms, ablutions, abhishekams, aim at purifying the realm of the lower Venus and lifting the soul up to the realm of the Venus-Urania, the Heavenly Venus of the Moon-Sphere, who grants the Water of Life. Water refers to faith, devotion, love. In Hindu traditions baths in sacred rivers are encouraged for purification from sinfulness, because a Bath in the Heavenly River cleanses from all sin and heals all separation. No Hindu rite should be performed without a preliminary bath. During the rite water is sprinkled repeatedly over everything that comes

into play, the place, the ritual vessels as well as the organs and body of the worshipper. Images of Gods are bathed with liquids symbolizing the Five Elements, because they form links between the worshipper and GOD. Even the preliminaries of taking a meal consist for a Hindu in the sprinkling of water over the meal. Practically every aspect of life has in Hinduism a traditional significance in connection with the revelation of Spirit. At the present time the traditional meaning is being quickly forgotten, as it has been almost entirely forgotten in other traditions. The modern fashion of condemning old practices and customs as "mere superstition" is responsible for the abandonment of much that has value. It is true that a mechanical repetition of rites and customs, without an understanding of their meaning, is much the same as superstition. But a people that gives up its traditions loses its soul. Even if rituals and customs are performed mechanically — something to be expected in the Mechanical Age — without an insight into their psychological meaning, they have a certain influence on the inner man, the "unconscious mind", and they continue to have psychological effects of various kinds.

Offerings of flowers, the children of water, also apply to the plane of emotional love. Flowers are sexual organs of plants. They are fertilized not by copulation, but with the help of humble but beautiful denizens of the air or even by the wind alone. They attract and enrapture one by their beauty, sweetness and virginity. They are fit symbols of tender feelings of love and faith, touched by Spirit. The lily is the flower of the Annunciation of the Virgin.

Scent and smell refer to the lower mind and the Element Fire. Scented water and scented oil are symbols of a purified and harmonized personality on the Planes of Water and Fire. "Then took Mary a pound of ointment of spikenard, very costly, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair, and the house was filled with the odour of the ointment." (St. John 12; 3). In Muslim tradition the offering of scented oil is one of love and respect. The offering of sweet-smelling myrrh, made by the second of the Three Magi to the Christ-child, symbolizes the homage of "the intermediate world" of the personality to the Son of God. The Kalaśa Pûjâ of Hinduism is the worship of a vessel filled with water scented by sandal-paste. The Gandha or sandal-paste is a symbol of the purified mind.

The highest form of the Water is the Water of Life, the Water above the Firmament, the Sacrificial Wine, the Amrita or Soma of Hinduism, the Haoma of Iranic tradition, the Nectar of Greek tradition, the Elixir of Immortality, the Oil in the Ever-burning Lamp. All five Elements are represented in the Hindu offering of Pañchâmrita or "Five Nectars". The

mixture consists of sugar, representing Earth, honey, representing Water, ghî or clarified butter, representing Fire, curds, representing Air, and milk, representing Ether. Curds of milk and the clouds of the âir are intimately related symbols. Sacrificial fires are "fed" with ghî.

**Rituals
applying
to Fire.**

The use of fire in ritual is very common. Fire has already been considered in many connections. The Hindu Homa rite comprises all the Elements, represented by wood, ghî or liquid butter, and incense. The impurities of the personality are burned up. After a certain form of Hindu worship, ashes are rubbed on the forehead and sometimes also on other parts of the body, symbolizing the Indestructible, which always remains. To "put on sack cloth and ashes" refers to renunciation and purification of the mind, and implies repentance and humility.

The Hindu rite of "waving of light" or Âratî refers to the Element Fire, though sometimes it may also refer to Ether. The Dîpa or offering of light is done by means of a lamp in which are three wicks. The three flames represent the three worlds. The impurities of the three lower worlds are burned up and the glories of the Three higher Worlds are revealed. What burns up is the Ahankâra, and what is revealed is the Âtmâ or Pure Spirit. A particular form of light-offering or worship is the Mangala Nirâñjana or Mangalâratî, wherein five lights burning simultaneously are waved before the Deity, symbolic of the enlightening and harmonization of all the Five Worlds. "Mangala" is a name of Mars and also means blessing or bliss. In this rite the higher aspect of Mars stands revealed. Sometimes seven lights are waved, representing all Seven Spheres.

**Rituals
applying
to Air.**

The burning of incense — Dhûpa — denotes the homage of the mind to the Spirit. The smoke of the incense rises quietly and majestically in the air. The third of the Three Magi offered frankincense to the Christ child. The modern shadowy counterpart of the offering of incense is the smoking of tobacco, ganja and opium. It is the outcome of an unconscious desire for pacification of mind and nerves. Where the mind is not naturally pacified by alignment to Spirit, artificial means of pacification are employed. Where sacred means are lacking, profane means are used. Where the Joy of Spirit is not naturally experienced, substitute pleasures are looked for. Smoking is a gratification of "self" and a nuisance to others. Spiritually "it poisons the atmosphere."

**Rituals
applying
to Ether.**

The Hindu rite of burning of camphor — Karpûrâratî — refers to Ether. When camphor burns up there is no residue. Nothing is left. The pure Light of Ether burns up the last traces of sinfulness and selfishness. It is the Light of the Guru. As said before, sometimes a light burning in oil takes the place of the light of camphor. In some temples, during the rite of waving of light, a mirror is held in bright sunlight, throwing the reflection of the sun on the image of the Deity. To use terms belonging to other traditions: the sun is the symbol of God the Father, the mirror of the Moon, the Mother, and what is enlightened is the Son of Man. The "image" of a God is the image, that is to say, likeness or picture, of both God and worshipper.

**Attitudes
of prayer.**

The traditional attitudes of prayer are, of course, not arbitrary. In ancient Mediterranean cultures the traditional attitude was with arms stretched up into the air. It will be noted later that the knees are connected with Mercury, the Spiritual Messenger. The folding of the hands symbolizes the union of the Primal Duality, Śiva and Śakti, Father and Mother, Divinity and World. It further symbolizes the harmonious interrelationship of the Five Organs of Perception and the Five Organs of Action, considered above. In the terminology of psychology it may be said to refer to the balance between introvert and extravert tendencies. With the achievement of that balance, the distinction between "inner" and "outer" ceases to obtrude itself.

The Hindu Pañchagam Namaskâram or "Salutation with five members" is symbolic of the bowing down of the fivefold man before God. The earth, representing the Mother, the Manifested God, is touched by the head, the two hands and the two knees.

Idolatry.

The offering of food has been dealt with before. The Hindu Naivedya has its correspondences in other traditions. Traditionally all food should be eaten only after having been dedicated to God, to the Indwelling Spirit. The material food is a symbol of the Five Elements, harmonized and synthesized into a wholesome ambrosia. The Lord said in the Gîtâ: (IX; 27): "Whatever thou doest, whatever thou eatest, whatever thou givest and the spiritual practice thou performest, O Kaunteya, do that as an offering to Me". And he condemns those who "dress food for their own sake", implying the Ahankâric identification with "impure food" on the different levels of existence. Symbolically man should eat the Bread of Life, the true Prasâdam, alone. That belongs to all, and unites humanity into a

true Brotherhood, from which egoism is absent. The various brotherhoods on earth are pale reflections of that Great Brotherhood. If in the Old and the New Testaments the injunction is found that no food should be eaten that has been offered to idols, the implication is, that materialism and literalism are to be avoided and condemned. An *Idolon* is a form or shape. If an image cannot be experienced as a symbol or "likeness" of God or an aspect of God, and if its sacredness depends on its material substance, its worship becomes idolatry. Images should be of help to a worshipper in his striving to have communion with God. If they do not serve that purpose, they become, as in the Bible, symbols of materialism as regards the Element Earth, and of "fornications" as regards the Element Water, in so far as they stimulate sentimentality, emotionalism, or "religious erotism." A typical example of the latter is found in the worship and the naked dancing and singing before the golden calf, described in the 32nd Chapter of Exodus. The golden calf represents more particularly the Sign of Taurus, and Earth Sign, ruled on the Night-throne by Venus. This episode represents the antithesis to the Revelation, which was in those very days being received by Moses, and illustrates the "Zeitgeist", which had to undergo a revolution. The forms of tradition periodically degenerate when its life no longer shines forth. Tradition often uses more ancient and purer forms for its revelation. The *Devadâsis* or "Servants of God" of Hindu tradition were originally virgins dedicated to a pure spiritual life. At the present time they form a caste given to prostitution. The worship of the "golden calf" was once upon a time a pure form of adoration.

Hindu temples. The devotion before an image of God may degenerate into idol-worship when the meaning of the temple symbolism is forgotten. Idolatry being in essence the worship of the symbol instead of the thing symbolized, the understanding of the meaning of the symbolism is at once the best antidote and safeguard. Hindu temples have generally five gates between the outer world and the sanctum sanctorum. The space outside the temple represents "the world as well as the physical body, the sanctum sanctorum the "innermost shrine of the Heart" harbouring the Divinity "within." The five doors admit from one Element or Sphere to another. Sometimes there are seven. In smaller temples there are three. A bigger and more important temple implies, of course, a more elaborate symbolism. Shoes or sandals should be left at the outer gate, implying that the contact with the profane impurities of the Earth Element is broken. In the outer court of the temple, if it is an important one, is a tank, where the worshipper is supposed to bathe before

entering the next court. If he does not bathe, he should at least wash his feet and face. After this Water-purification he enters the next court of the temple, where either a pillared hall is found, or the temple-building itself is entered or both occur together. Often the hall is called the dancing-hall, as this is the place, where once the sacred dances before the deity took place. In this part of the temple we find the tall vertical pillar and the animal *vâhana* or vehicle of the particular God or Goddess. As will become evident from symbolism explained elsewhere, these refer to the mental plane; the Element Fire. In this part of the temple little oil lights will be seen for the first time. Passing the next gate, the worshipper enters into an inner room, from which he can see the God or Goddess in the innermost shrine. This is the space representing *Buddhi*, spiritual discrimination. There he watches the rites before the Deity. The officiating priest brings the burning camphor to be touched by him, after it has been waved before the Image, and gives him the *prasâdam*. The word *prasâdam* has a wide and deep meaning, as will be clear from references in the *Gîtâ* (II; 64, 65, etc.). Its main implication is Peace of Spirit. In the innermost shrine, in which the God is found, generally only the officiating priests are admitted. Originally the priests were "initiates". At the present time they are professional performers of rites, generally without an inkling of their meaning. In Hinduism appears a wealth of variations from the general plan. Every temple has its special symbolical traditions in connection with local and inter-local traditions. The same applies to temples of other religions. The divisions and construction of the Temple at Jerusalem were entirely symbolical.

Symbolism of The passing through the five doors of the temple implies
clothes and the piercing of the Veils of Spirit, from the grossest in
nakedness. the physical plane to the subtlest in the "inner spheres".
 The veils are those of *Mâyâ*, or *Isis*. Who would worship
 the Veil of *Mâyâ*, the dark mist which hides Reality? And yet this is what is
 being done at the present day. The modern world stares at the Veil of In-
 tellect in fascination, taking it for the Truth. It does not realize that there
 is something beyond. Veil-worship, in another sense, has even entered Hindu
 temples. Hindu tradition knows an offering of clothes to the Deity — *Vas-
 tropavastram*. Cloths or clothes are symbols of *Mâyâ*, they represent *Mâyâ*'s
 Veils. In the ancient Mysteries the aspirant for the highest initiation
 had to shed his clothes and go forward naked. This nakedness has also
 played an important part in various Indian traditions. Starting from the
 physical plane, into which a man enters naked, nakedness is found next on
 the Plane of Water. But in connection with Water it is not an entire naked-

ness, for the "Venus girdle", which will be dealt with later at length is worn, in some form or another. It is reflected on the physical plane in the bathing-slips or kaupinam with which a bath is taken, though, as will be seen later, the symbolism of the Venus-girdle implies very much more than a mere hiding of private or Ahankâric things. In the Element Air, the Spirit nakedness becomes complete and symbolizes purity in the sense of "rising above sex" and liberation from the entanglement of Mayâ. In the Apocryphal Gospel of the Egyptians we read that Salome inquired of Jesus "How long shall death prevail?" The Lord answered "Until you have trampled on the garment of shame and the two become one, and the male with the female is neither male nor female." In one place his disciples say unto him "When wilt thou be manifest unto us and when shall we see thee?" The Lord said "When ye have put off your raiment and are not ashamed." The "garment of shame" is the Veil of Mayâ. Significant is also the expression "the bare truth." The tradition of complete nakedness as symbolizing perfect "purity" in the sense of enlightenment of spirit, is found in Jain and Hindu traditions. The Jain Tirthankaras — which are parallel with the Buddhas of Buddhism — are represented as completely naked. Perfected beings in a naked state are called Digambaras or "clothed in the directions of space." Naked Hindu ascetics of various Hindu traditions are called Avadhûtas, "those who have shaken or washed off", and Nâgâ swâmîs. The latter word has been derived from the Sanskrit nagna, meaning naked. The words are related. A very exalted Hindu aspect of God, not much known in popular hinduism, but worshipped by contemplatives is Dattatreya, an Incarnation of the Trimurti, the Triad Brahma-Vishnu Sîva. He is represented as naked.

The tradition of nakedness is preserved to a modified extent in the general orthodox custom found especially in South India, that a man should enter a sacred place only with a bare upper body. In many temples men are not admitted unless they take off their shirts, and even if shirts are tolerated at least the "upper cloth" has to be taken from the shoulders and wound round the hips. This custom illustrates how the meaning of things was lost little by little. Such a loss of insight is demonstrated very significantly by the fact that images of deities in modern Hinduism are generally covered by cloths or clothes. The rite of Vastropavastram or renunciation of the Veils of Maya has been falsely interpreted as having the meaning that the Gods want clothes. Instead of offering the Veils of Ignorance and laying them at the feet of the Deity, they are projected on to the image. By doing this the priest or worshipper veils the God with his own Mayâ. This procedure is symbolic of the spirit of the age. Even the Gods have become veiled in Maya,

since sacred tradition has been forgotten. The Gods have to be "revealed" once more. By that revelation their symbols and attributes will again shine with meaning. Sometimes the images are hidden by a profusion of garlands of flowers, symbolic of the fact that in the present age (in all religions) the Spirit is often smothered by an excess of sticky sentiment or devotion.

Mere stripping and nudism do not make a man pure, though the modern urge in Western countries for stripping and sun-bathing is on the whole not an unhealthy sign. It is symptomatic of a semi-conscious desire for a more natural life, "purer air" and "light". Clothes represent in particular the outer world, of which humanity in its heart of hearts is very tired and which it fain would change for a better one. Clothes are the outer form of the persona.

In the tropic East, on the other hand, there is, under modern influences, an increasing tendency to put on more and more clothes, particularly of Western patterns. This shows how modern-Western forms of Mâyâ are conquering the East. The change of clothes but follows a mental change. In East and West men will again have to experience that, in the words of Plotinus, "Those who ascend the grades of the sacred Mysteries, purify themselves and take off the vestments in which they were clothed, and advance naked" (Enn. I; VI, 7).

The Western custom of uncovering the head, and to some extent, the Eastern custom of taking off the shoes, when entering a hallowed place, were also originally forms of "unveiling".

The mystic Marriage.

The physical plane forms the outermost Veil of Mâyâ, the grossest form of Materia. The principle of "separateness" manifests itself to its very limit on that plane.

Going inwards, the merging of separates to union begins on the emotional plane, the Element Water. The higher Elements are successively ever more suited for communion and union, and oneness becomes ever more clearly their dominant note. The highest represents oneness. The merging of the final duality into that Oneness is the "mystic marriage". It has been commonly believed among Christians that the conception or symbol of the "mystic marriage" was derived from the earthly marriage. Though the word "marriage" was used anagogically, the marriage Sacrament was derived from symbolism of the Mystic Marriage. The Gnostic Master Marcos, as is known from the writings of his adversary Irenaeus of Lyon, celebrated the Mystic Marriage of his disciples in the Sacrament of the Bridal Chamber, teaching that the rite symbolized the spiritual marriage in accordance with the Mystical Marriage in Plêrôma, the Sphere of "Whole-

ness", between Sophia, the last suffering Aeon, and the Saviour The Plerôma, the Fullness, corresponds to the Sanskrit Pûma Sophia is the Mayâ-Śakti of the Soul, conceived as a Goddess She represents Mayâ both in the sense of Self-forgetfulness, entailing involvement in the world, with its consequent suffering, and in the sense of Knowledge and Consciousness, as implied by the name Sophia The Foundress of marriage in the Roman tradition was not Venus, but Juno, the Mother of Heaven, an aspect of the Moon-Sphere Divinity

The Mystic Marriage implies the Divine Birth, the birth of the Son of God as son of man, and of the son of man as Son of God

Christian mystics have written about the marriage between the Bride the-Soul and the Bridegroom Christ This Mystic Marriage is also found in the dedication of nuns, as it was in that of the Vestal Virgins of ancient Rome, the Devadasis of ancient Hinduism, and virgins of other traditions

The worldly marriage is a reflection of the Mystic Marriage If so many marriages in the world are unhappy, it is due to the fact that the Mystic Marriage has never even been visioned as a remote ideal within the hearts of the marriage partners The Mystic Marriage is the Divine Play of God, Mâyâ transformed into Lîlâ, "Divine Play" Sages experience the Universe as Lîlâ There is a Hindu tradition which teaches that the wife should be looked upon by the husband as an "incarnation" of the Divine Mother, Śakti, and that the husband should represent the All-father The Divine Father and Mother have to be worshipped in the form of the marriage partner The human form is the image of God

In the Mystic Marriage there is a complete Unveiling of Reality Oneness stands revealed In it "the highest" and "the lowest" commune, unite and are at-oned

If in some traditions the conception of marriage contained suggestions of a bondage or exclusiveness to be overcome, marriage-symbolism is replaced by that of "free love" The freeness of love becomes a symbol of Liberation from bondage In this class falls the Hindu tradition of the Love of Râdhâ and Krishna and also the Love of Sufis

Rites of Element- purification

When sacred tradition is lost and forgotten in externalization, and when religion becomes a profession, the noblest possessions of humanity serve as instruments for bondage The devil, in the form of the Ahankara, likes to assume holy and respectable airs He is at his best when he can quote scripture for his Mâyâvic purposes Nothing is safe from him, in the world of Mâyâ All rites and sacraments have the one aim of purifying the

soul from his influence. By trying to take a hand in them, he is often able to turn them to his benefit. The best safe-guard is knowledge of their meaning and implications, on the part of those who perform them. Knowledge leads to realization and experience. The second-best safe-guard is complete ignorance, for imperfect knowledge holds dangers. The performance of many rites, even before understanding has come, prepares the ground in the "unconscious" and has a purifying effect on the personality. In Hindu tradition there is a rite called *Bhûtaśuddhi*, "purification of the Elements", in which the worshipper "imagines" that each of the Elements within him is purified and absorbed in the next higher Element, until they are all merged in the Quintessence. As soon as this is no more a matter of aspiration and creative imagining on the lower planes, but has actually been experienced as the result of inspiration, or an action of grace from Above, there is no more need for the rite to be performed. The same applies, of course, to one and every ritual. For every rite is essentially a form of *Bhûtaśuddhi* or Element-purification. Till the last initiation has been passed through in fullness of experience and realization, taking the place of mere knowledge, the traditional rites should be "observed". The giving up of sacred ceremonies as the result of merely mental enlightenment, in obedience to the fashion of the age, or in a spirit of over-estimation of self and a "superior attitude", does more harm than good. The *Gitâ* says (VI; 1): "He who performs his Karma without depending on the fruits of action, he is a *Sannyâsi* and a *Yogi*, not he who is without sacrificial fire or without rites." The word "Karma" significantly includes duties and actions of every kind, as well as, or rather, comprising, religious rites.

Bird-symbolism.

It is clear that the most important element on the spiritual path of the aspirant is inspiration. It comes as the divine response to his aspiration. Inspiration, spiritual discrimination and intuition, the joy of the heart, are so many aspects of the life of the Element Air, the Sphere of the Spirit. The most inspiring symbolism is found in connection with the Air.

Siegfried, the Solar Hero of North and West European tradition, after killing the Dragon-Salamander, representing egotism on the mental plane, and after receiving the Fire baptism by bathing in the Blood of the Dragon, and, in another myth, roasting and eating the *heart* of the Dragon, obtains the power to understand the language of the birds. Feathered and winged creatures are the denizens of the air. The song of song-birds represents the Music of the Spheres. "He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith". The colours and habits of birds have ever been symbols of the various

Elements There are land-birds and swimming birds, beautiful and ugly birds, humble and pretentious ones, sweet and martial ones. There are entire hierarchies of birds, traditionally representing the Seven Spheres, and more particularly their Mercurian or spiritual aspect. They are the living symbols of the Winged Angels, which in their turn are aspects, emanations and servants of the Great Seven. Birds are the "heavenly messengers." Though the Sphere of Air is their particular Element, and though they soar high up into the heavens, they also come down to earth to enrapture the spirit of man. The Air is all-pervading. It does not burn in one place, like Fire, nor does it run away like Water, nor is it massive like Earth. The Air is the intermediary between God and man. It penetrates in caves and passages, where there are gnomes, snakes and worms. It does not penetrate Earth proper or Water. But it embraces them.

Hermès-Mercury is winged on head and feet. Wodan or Odinn, the Mercury of Western and Northern Europe, wears a helmet with two white eagle-wings, and two black ravens accompany him, called Hugin and Munin. The Dutch words "heugen" and "meenen", to remember and to believe, are related to their names. He is the traditional inventor of the Runes, the symbolic letters and graphs, and of all "sciences", just as the Egyptian Hermès, Thoth, represented very often with the head of an ibis or white crane, was the originator of the alphabet, numbers, and "sciences." Science, in this sense of the word, is traditional, sacred or spiritual science. Quetzalcoatl, the Mexican God, was winged. Winged is Erôs, winged are Hypnos, the God of sleep, and Thanatos, the God of Death, both aspects of the Spirit. Winged are all the hierarchies of Angels of Semitic as well as of other traditions. In Egyptian tradition the Soul, that is to say, the spiritual man, the Ba, was represented as a Bird, with human face and hands.

There are certain universal traits in bird-symbolism, modified in the different traditions of the world by particular circumstances. Various birds will be encountered at other occasions. Here some aspects of bird-symbolism of universal interest may be mentioned. Raven, crow and vulture represent the Spirit in connection with Saturn and in the Element Earth. Parrot, swan, hen and sparrow represent the Spirit in connection with various aspects of Venus and in the Element Water. Cock and vulture represent the Spirit in connection with Mars and in the Element Fire. Various song-birds, dove, swan, pelican and crane represent the Spirit in connection with the Element Air. The eagle, the falcon and the hawk, forms of the King of the Birds, represent Jupiter and the high spheres of the Ether. Whilst swans and cranes are migratory birds that fly far and wide over the world, the kingly birds fly higher than others.

Owl and peacock represent the Moon-Sphere. The Sun is represented by the White Bird, which may be either Swan or Crane. It has to be noted that birds are generally sacred to the God of another Sphere than the one they represent. Thus the raven, representing the Earth, is found to be sacred to Apollo, the Sun-God. In this combination "the highest and the lowest" are found together. Dove and sparrow were sacred to Venus. The cock is sacred to the Sun, because at Sun-rise it announces the beginning of Manifestation. This is the case in traditions as far apart as those of Western Europe and Japan. The etymology of the word "swan" has already been noted. The word "Sun" is furthermore related to it. The swan was sacred to Apollo, the Sun-God.

Dove, raven and swan. Even the colours of birds are symbolical. The birds of Saturn and Earth are generally black or dark brown;

those of Mars have plenty of red, like the "flame" on the head of the cock; Venus's birds have blue and green predominating. In popular tradition blue birds are remembered as symbols of happiness. The White Bird represents supreme felicity. Among American Indians the White Bird is known as the Bird in the Primordial Waters. It is the Hamsa of Hindu tradition, floating upon the Primordial Ocean, the "Waters above the firmament". The goose was sacred to Juno, the Mother of Heaven. White goose, white swan and white dove were sacred to the Great Goddess of Ireland. The white dove was sacred to Astarte and to the Mycenaean Goddess. The image of a Dove was worshipped by the Samaritans on their sacred mountain Gerizim. The Law of Moses held the dove to be "a pure animal". It was sacred to the Virgin. After the Deluge, Noah first sent a raven from the Ark, and afterwards a dove. The Raven represents the Air-House of Aquarius, ruled by Saturn, God of the Earth. The Dove, going out for the first time, "found no rest for the sole of her foot, and returned" (Genesis 8:9). This represents the Air-House of Gemini, ruled by Mercury, God of the Air. Later Noah sent the Dove for the second time, "and lo, in her mouth was an olive leaf plucked off; so Noah knew that the waters were abated from off the earth." This refers to Libra, the Air-House ruled by Venus. In Libra the balance between Spirit and "deluge-water" is attained. But Noah did not yet go forth. After another equal period he sent forth the Dove again. But it did not return. This again refers to Aquarius, when "Noah removed the covering of the Ark, and looked, and behold, the face of the ground was dry". The symbolism of "looking" refers to Ether; it is "higher" than that of Air. Two months later Noah and his charge left the Ark. This is in Aries, the first House of Manifestation. This sym-

bolism will become clearer when subsequent pictures unfold themselves. The Dove was pre-eminently the "bearer of good tidings", the messenger of "peace", the announcer of a new Cycle of Life. It is the Dove of the Holy Ghost. It comes to man to inspire him with the Life of God and to lead him back to the Father. That is the task of the White Bird. The symbolism varies in its particulars with the species of Bird. The Swan brought Lohengrin "to earth" and took him ultimately back whence he had come. It is the mystic Hamsa. The Valkyries of European traditions accompanied the heroes who had fallen in the battle of life to Valhalla, Heaven. They changed into Swans. They are the spiritual selves or guardian angels of the 'Solar Heroes' who have brought the Battle of Life to a victorious conclusion.

Crane and
stork.

The Egyptian Hermès, the White Crane, Thoth, was called 'the Intelligence'. The White Falcon was Horus, the Son. Thoth ruled the Element Air, Horus the Element Ether. In Europe the crane was also a sacred bird. The Gaulish God Grannos, "the Crane", represented a spiritual aspect of the power of life, the Sun. The Crane brings new life, re-birth. This is remembered in the charming European piece of folk-lore that babies are brought from heaven by a stork. The stork, a European form of the crane, symbolizes the spiritual power aiding in the process of rebirth or resurrection and revelation. In Northern Europe he is represented by the God Hoenir. The migratory flight of the stork covers vast distances, from one continent to another. It is an international bird, for the Spirit is international, or rather inter-traditional.

The Raven is the Bird of the Earth. With the Raven the Great Work of the Hermetists begins. It is the first and "lowest" Bird to be encountered. Elijah was fed in the desert by the Ravens. In St. Luke, the Gospel that refers especially to the Element Earth, one reads (12, 24) that Jesus said: "Consider the ravens: for they neither sow nor reap, which neither have storehouse nor barn, and God feedeth them: how much more are ye better than the fowls?"

The Bible is full of bird-symbolism. Jehovah, the Jupiter of the Jews (as will be shown later), said unto Moses (Exodus 19, 4): "Ye have seen how I bare you on eagle's wings, and brought you unto myself." In the fifty-seventh Psalm are the beautiful words: "In the shadow of thy wings will I make my refuge."

There is an Egyptian representation in which the Falcon is shown bringing back the last piece of the dismembered Osiris, as yet stretched

dead on the ground. The Son is the Resurrected One. He brings Life, and He is one with the Life He brings.

Five Birds The Hermetic tradition knew a group of five birds, representing the Five Elements. The Earth was represented by the Raven or Crow, Water by the Swan. Fire was represented by the Phoenix, mythical Bird, symbolizing Manifestation, ultimately consumed by its own Fire, but arising again out of its own ashes. This symbolism refers to the three Fire-Houses of Leo, Sagittarius and Aries. The prototype of the Phoenix, also etymologically, was the Egyptian Bennu, symbol of Resurrection. The Element Air was represented by the Pelican. It was said to feed its young with its own lifeblood. On account of this symbolism of sacrifice the Pelican became a symbol of Christ. The representation of the Pelican feeding its young is found on old forms of the monstrance. The word pelican is derived from the Greek *pelekus*, meaning an axe. The axe symbol, as will be noted later, is an Air-symbol. The Greek *pelekus* is etymologically related to the Sanskrit *paraśu*, an axe.

In this Hermitic group of five birds, the Ether is represented by the mythical Basilisk. It means "the royal" bird. The Ether is the realm of the King of the Gods, of the Son. The Basilisk was serpent-like and had a crown on its head. In it the Serpent of the Earth has become the Serpent of Wisdom.

In Sufi mysticism the Simurg is the King of the Birds, comprising within himself all Birds. The Simurg is a symbol for Divine Oneness, embracing the many.

Air-Elementals are winged like birds. They are found in the forms of Sylphs, Elves, Fairies, Indian Kinnaris, Suparnas, Gandharvas, and other beings. Their highest aspect is that of Angels.

Birds as avengers. Birds also symbolize the "watchfulness" of the Spirit. The Spirits of the Air do not always come with divine messages and blessings. Sometimes their function is that of avengers or punishers. Prometheus and Tityos were punished by birds of prey picking their liver. The Harpies also punished for greed by methods of greed. "Wheresoever the carcase is, there will the eagles be gathered together" (St. Matthew 24; 28). Ahankâric Dragons are often winged. Medousa was winged. The Lilith of Jewish tradition, the "first wife of Adam", is represented on potsherds from Nippur as a woman with wings and the tail of a serpent. She became later identical with the horrible Lamia, the Night-Owl, described by Philostratus as a kind of female vampire. The latter is

mentioned in Isaiah (34, 14-15) together with the vulture, again, as in the words of Jesus mentioned above, in connection with the catastrophic end of a Cycle "Come near, ye nations, to hear, and hearken, ye people For the indignation of the Lord is upon all nations, and fury upon their armies he has utterly destroyed them, he hath delivered them to the slaughter' (34, 1-2) Thus it is, ever again

Insect-symbolism. Apart from Birds, there are humbler winged creatures which represent Elemental Messengers The Koran says "Verily God disdaineth not to cite as symbol a gnat as well as something nobler" (Sûra of the Cow, 24) The Earth is often represented by Beetles, that is to say, "biting ones" They generally come out of the earth They are covered by hard scales, and are clumsy fliers They prefer to walk, and then their wings are hidden They are Saturnian insects The dung-chafer, which is occupied in rolling balls of dung for winter provision, is typical of the Element Earth The ball is the treasure of the Earth But it is also The Treasure, the Supernal Sun of Realization, in the case of the sacred Egyptian Sun-chafer, represented with the Sun-Disk. The English word chafer is allied to the ancient Egyptian word Kheperu

Butterflies represent the Venusian Element, Water The Element of Mars is represented in various aspects by ants, wasps, locusts and scorpions Some of these creatures will be more fully dealt with later The Element Air is universally represented by the buzzing bee As will be explained later, there is a world of symbolism in the activities of the bee Its unpleasant counterpart is the fly The Element Ether is represented by the fire fly and the dragon-fly Though the spider is not winged, it may not be out of place to mention that it is a universal symbol of the Mâyâ-aspect of the Moon-Creatrix Though not winged, it lives "high up" at the beginning of the Day of Manifestation, and weaves the Web of Mâyâ, the World, in which it catches the souls that are "unaware" of it At the end of the Day it takes back the Web into itself Many kinds of spiders eat their consorts after these have satisfied their desires—horrible symbolism Another wingless creature is the earth-worm, closely related symbolically to the snake In German the word Lindwurm means a dragon The Earth-dragon lives in a cave The worm burrows its passages in the Earth and is blind to higher things It is, among other things, a symbol of the male organ It is intent but on burrowing and satisfying its hunger and it likes water, without which it cannot live Man, in his lowest aspect, is a mere worm, as compared with the Divine Man

Plagues sent by God to erring races are often represented as winged insects

Creatures of Hell of various traditions are mainly represented as half human and half insect. Such entities escaped from the Box of Pandora.

When the descendants of Pandora or Eve become desperate on account of the worries and pains caused by these creatures of the Ahankâra, the Spirit sends one or two of its messengers to give relief. One is winged Hope, sweet but solemn, pointing afar. The other is winged Laughter or Humour, immediate and spontaneous in its manifestation.

Humour and laughter. Humour and laughter provide a medicine for pain, a release from sorrow and tension, a liberation from the drama enacted on the three lower planes. But it has no lasting influence to speak of, it is only a release by a safety valve in case the internal fires drive up the steam pressure too much. The experience of Spirit is one of Liberation and Peace. But long before experience comes, gusts of wind from the Sphere of Spirit penetrate to the lower worlds. One form of such manifestations is laughter. The inner man of Spirit cannot help being amused at the distorted picture of Life on the lower planes since Spirit is aware of the Divine Play, Lîlâ. When distortion and tension become too great, when life in the outer world becomes difficult or even unbearable, he sends his releasing flash from within. Humour is at heart a divine quality, though, like all things, it can be distorted by the Ahankara. From the angle of vision of the Spirit, the entire lower distorted world of human manifestation is a subject of fun.

Tears, too, form a liberating release of Spirit. In their highest form they are the "heavenly water" that purifies and fertilizes the lower world. They are "the tears of Isis" forming the source of the Nile. The meaning of tears and laughter, their releasing, purifying, emotional, creative and other implications, are understood better in connection with the symbolism of mouth, eyes and sound.

A lack of a sense of humour is a very great handicap on the spiritual Path. A person who always wears a "long faced" mask cannot experience the spiritual joy of the heart. He must learn to value the "broad" smile. The vertical and horizontal arms of the cross must be evenly balanced.

True humour and joy are spontaneous and natural, because they are spiritual. They can never be mastered and commanded. People dimly sense their spiritual nature, and, in their urge to escape from their everyday life, get drunk with the desire for laughter. Often the true is lost for semblances or reflections in coarser and more Mâyâvic matter. Reactions will come in the form of depressions or periods of utter boredom. Some supposed humorists become mere bores and objects of humour themselves.

Forms of laughter.

True laughter is a reflection of the Pure Joy of Spirit, which is a reflection of the Bliss of Heaven, the Ânanda of the Ether Sphere. Joy is reflected on the mental plane as happiness, on the emotional as enjoyment and on the physical as pleasure. The words are often interchanged. The "ego" is capable of appropriating and obscuring, and consequently distorting any of them. Even the essence of happiness, Bliss, the "ego" will try to appropriate. Laughter is an expression of mirth, happiness and enjoyment. The Ahankâra distorts the wise Saturnian smile to a saturnine, sardonic, or even satanic laughter, the loving smile of Venus may become an irritating erotic giggle or a jealous sneer, or turn into an uncontrolled fit of hysteria. The victorious self-laughter of Mars may become a mere guffaw, a spiteful laugh or a vulgar demonstration of ego triumph over other egos. The spontaneous pure sense of humour of Hermès, God of intercourse, may turn into a mere conventional grimace or the grin of the bore. The "jovial" laughter of Jupiter may turn into the scornful roar or the frightening grimace of the dictator, and the smile of Realization and wisdom of the Moon-Goddess into the mad howling of a lunatic. The sunny laughter of the Sun-God, found in children and those who have become children, alone is beyond the reach of the Ahankâra. How trying is the laughter of uncontrolled hilarity, how damaging the smile of superiority, how unsympathetic the laughter of the isolated and inflated lower mind of the man who laughs about others, whether he be an uneducated boor or a scholar who laughs about the theories of his colleagues. And how surprising is the laughter of the man whose inner life is not understandable and who is considered to be a fool by the world. Possibly he is a fool, possibly he is the Divine Fool, with the unconcerned sunny laughter of Liberty, amused at the Play of Ignorance and God-forgetfulness, smiling at the Beauty of Life, inexpressible in any other way than in signs of joy.

The long-drawn faces so often associated with bigots, only demonstrate that the laughter of the Sphere of Air cannot penetrate through the crust of convention on the soul. The importance given to laughter should, however, not be taken to imply a depreciation of seriousness. Those who have the true laughter in their hearts, will also be found to be the truly serious.

How often has not laughter, the divine release, saved people from destruction. How often has not humour made people see their own lower selves distorted by the uneven magic mirror of the Ahankâra, in a truer light. The tears of the Sea of Samsara or worldliness must give way to the sunny laughter of the man who in his heart of hearts, where the Lord dwells in Spirit knows that "all is well!"

The inner man, in every human being, knows in his inmost heart, in the

deep-sleep-state of Consciousness, that the Essence is Bliss, whatever the appearance may be. Therefore "the man in the street" is unconsciously seeking happiness, of which laughter is only an expression. But he seeks happiness in part-things, where it can really be obtained only in the Whole and he seeks happiness in particular places, though it can be had in equal measure in every place. Modern man has gone to the extreme of identifying happiness with cinemas, cars, radios, and such matters, and has forgotten the words of Jesus: "How will it profit a man if he gain the whole world and lose his own soul!" For the soul contributes happiness to the world, but the world takes away happiness from the soul.

If a man takes pleasure in teasing or worrying others, or if he ridicules others, it means that he betrays his own weaknesses by projecting them on to others, in an unconscious effort to externalize them and free himself from them. Such is the humour of life, that those who steal pleasure at the expense of others, betray themselves.

Till the pure, true laughter of the Gods is experienced, elation will be followed by depression, and depression by elation.

Risus, the Roman God of Mirth, is the root of the "ridiculus" and "risible". "Comic" and "comedy" come from the name of the God of "good-fellows", Comus.

The seven Gods of happiness of Japan. The Japanese worship their Seven Gods. The Sun is represented by Hotei, "the happy Chinaman", with his sunny smile and his linen sack.

He was originally a Zen Master and became the Santa Claus of Japan, and especially a God of children. He is represented with a bald shining head and a big fat body, and radiates joy and well-being, the natural outcome of his blissful state of Illumination. His sack, like that of Santa Claus, contains all the good things of the world, meant to enrapture the children of men. The child lives in the heart of all. What is the secret of the good things of the world? It is Charity, that is to say, Love or Grace.

The Moon is represented by the God Fukurokujin. He is shown as having a very long head and very long legs. Originally he was a Taoist Chinese philosopher who was said to "live on the mists of heaven and the dews of earth." This symbolism belongs to the Moon. He has the gift of prophecy and can work miracles for the good of mankind. The Moon is the great miracle-worker, being the Creator, and the Ruler of Form and Number. We shall see later that Pisces, the House of the Crescent Moon, is the House of prophecy. Fukurokujin is accompanied by a white crane and holds a roll

of records We shall see in the Book of Stars that the Crane is particularly connected with Pisces The records are the "Records of the Moon" or "Astral Records", which appear in many traditions Later they will be discussed at length Mystically the roll represents the Tradition Popularly the roll is the record of human age Fukurokujin is the God of a long, happy and prosperous life

Jupiter is represented in the group by the God Bishamon, who was originally an Indian soldier, Vishravana, standing on guard when Buddha preached He carries a long spear in his left hand The symbolism of spear and lance will be considered later In his right hand he holds a small pagoda Both symbols point to Jupiter as Guru Furthermore the Indian tradition was in a way "the Guru" of Buddhism The best of Hindu tradition stood "at attention" and on guard when Buddhism was born The two symbols well typify the two aspects of Jupiter Popularly Bishamon is said to be the God of War The same applies to Jupiter in other traditions The War is the spiritual struggle going on within the soul It is Jupiter who presides over it It is the "Holy War"

Mercury is represented by the God Jurojin, a venerable old Chinese with a snow-white beard, carrying a sacred staff, to which is tied a scroll containing the wisdom of the spirit He is accompanied by a crane, a stag or a tortoise The stag is an animal which always represents the function of Buddha, spiritual discrimination The Indian deer symbolizes Jñanam or Realization The animals are dealt with elsewhere The staff or wand and the scroll are typically Mercurian Jurojin is the God of the happiness of old age He represents Confucianism within the group

Mars is represented by the God Ebisu He has an amiable laughing face, for as God of Happiness he is not in any way "Martial" As will be seen later, Mars was "originally" God of Spring Ebisu is a fisherman and is represented as holding a fishing-rod in his right and a tai-fish in his left hand It might be said (even though Japanese tradition calls "Pisces" by another name) that Mars the Creator, Ruler of Aries, the first House of Manifestation in the Zodiac, as God of the Happiness of Resurrection, controls the "fishes" of the previous House, the Water-House of Pisces And Mars the Ruler of Fire, controls the denizens of the Element Water, below him. Scorpio, ruled by Mars, is a Water-House Ebisu is a hard worker, quite in accordance with his creative task He became the God of opportunity, chance and luck, and also the deity of fishermen and tradesmen by popular misinterpretation of the symbolism, just as the Roman Mercury became the deity of tradesmen and thieves

Venus is represented by the Goddess Benten, a virgin who is the ideal

of womanly beauty and accomplishment. She is the Goddess of art, literature, music and eloquence, plays on the biwa, and is shown with a sea-serpent, a typical Venusian symbol, as will be seen later.

Saturn is represented by the God Daikoku. He is God of wealth, and is to be compared to the Hindu Kubera, dealt with elsewhere. Originally he was a God of Love. He became the God of Wealth. Both aspects are clear if one considers that Saturn in his exalted aspect is Ruler of the Zodiacal House of Aquarius, the House of the Great Treasure of God-Realization, owned at the beginning and at the end of the Path. Daikoku is represented as sitting on two decorated rice-bales. Rats are nibbling at them, but his wealth is so vast that he does not mind. In Far-Eastern tradition Aquarius is called the House of the Rat. Rats and mice will be met again before long, in connection with other traditions. The "lucky hammer" of Daikoku, from which he can shake anything that may be desired, looks like a combination of the sickle of Saturn, the hammer of Mars and the sun-orb. On his shoulder he holds a sack full of treasure. The rice he sits on represents the treasure of the spiritual harvest, stored in Aquarius for the "winter-night". This symbolism will by and by become clear.

The originator of this happy group also wanted to symbolize the origins of Japanese culture in the antecedents of those Seven Gods. The Gods of Happiness representing the Sun, the Moon and Mercury were Chinese. The Sun-God was a Zen Master. Zen Buddhism represents the profoundest aspect of life in Japan. The Moon-God was a Taoist, and the Air-God a Confucian. Jupiter, or Guru, was Hindu, and the Gods representing the three lower planes of Manifestation are purely Japanese, as might be expected. Daikoku represents Shintoism within the group. Saturn is "the Lord of this world". Daikoku is the guardian of national tradition. He was originally a great Japanese hero, a man of great character and beauty. His treasures, from this point of view, are the sacred Japanese traditions as found in Shintoism, and other specifically Japanese traditions, in their form aspect in rites, ceremonies and customs. His treasure is the reflection of the treasure found in the sack of the Zen-Buddhist Master Hotei, who represents the Sun in the group. It has been said that "Zen Buddhism is the Vehicle of the Buddha Hridaya, the brilliancy of enlightenment", and that it "is the highest as well as the most essential (part) among all other Oriental teachings." Hridaya is the "Heart" of Hindu tradition: the Centre and Core of Being, the "seventh" Sphere, that of the Supernal Sun.

Buddha and the lotus. The happy laughter and serene joviality of the Seven Gods of Happiness, who are especially worshipped at the New Year, ultimately dissolve in the smile of Realization in Liberation. According to Japanese tradition Zen Buddhism came into being, as the ultimate essence of Buddha's Message to the world, in the following way. One day Buddha took a lotus in his hand. He looked at it for a while and smiled, keeping silence. None of the disciples understood the esoteric significance of the Master's behaviour, except one favourite disciple, who returned the smile of the Master. He had realized the greatest of all Teachings in Silence. In Hindu tradition Mouna-diksha or "Silence initiation" is the ultimate Grace passed on between Guru and disciple. It implies Liberation. In as much as Liberation comprises the destruction of the Ahankâra, it can be understood that in the North-European tradition it is the God of Silence, Vidar, the son of Odinn and Frigg, who kills the Fenris-Wolf at the 'Twilight of the Gods'. The God of Silence is an aspect of the Guru, Ruler of Sagittarius.

The God of Air and Wind. Mercury or Hermès, the Lord of Air, is the Traveller on the Path, the Guide of souls struggling with the difficulties of the three lower planes. He represents also the spiritual aspect of the soul as listening to the Guru and obeying his injunctions and is the especial messenger of Jupiter. He is reflected in man as the erring wanderer in the labyrinth of the world, in the aspiring disciple who grows out of the wanderer, and in the pilgrim on the Path of Illumination. In the scheme of the Gods of the Nordic races he was considered to be the father and head of the Gods in the form of Odinn or Wodan.

In Greek tradition the God of Wind was called Aeolus. Aeolus was the Lord of the Four Winds, each representing one of the Elements, as will be seen later. He was the God of the Aeolian tradition, and became the favourite of the Gods of Olympus. The Aeolus-harp plays the "music of the Spheres". The Vedic Aryans addressed the God of Wind as follows (Rig-veda X, 168): "I celebrate Vâta's great chariot: it comes, rending the Air, with the noise of thunder. It touches the sky as it goes and makes it ruddy, whirling up the dust of the earth. The flying gusts rush after it, as maidens to a festival. As he flies along on airy paths, Vâta never rests on any day... In what place was he born? And from whence came he, the vital breath of Gods, the world's great offspring? The God moves wherever he will at his pleasure, his rushing sound we hear, his form was never seen." This hymn has been compared with the words in St John (3, 8)

"The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but canst not tell whence it cometh and whither it goeth."

Hermês or Mercurius. Hermês or Mercury is the son of Maïa, the eldest and most beautiful of the Pleiades. These form a group of six stars which is found in Taurus, the Earth-House ruled by Venus, the House of the Mothers. As we have seen before, they nursed Kârttikeya. They also nursed Bakkhos. Hermês was born at the time of sun-rise. In the evening of the same day he stole fifty head of cattle from his brother Apollo, the Sun-God, and hid them in a cave. On account of this incident, he became in popular tradition the "God of thieves". Apollo discovered the theft and took the little thief to Zeus-Jupiter, who ordered the cattle to be returned. But Hermês so much delighted Apollo by his playing on the lyre which he had meanwhile invented, that Apollo allowed him to keep the cattle in exchange for the lyre.

Therefore Mercury became in popular tradition the "god of commerce". In the exchange of lyre and cattle lies a deeper meaning, however. The Latin name of Hermês, "Mercurius", is derived from "mercor", to trade and to traffic, and is related to words from which "immersing" and "merging" are derived. The trading and trafficking refers to the travelling and linking functions of Mercury, about which more will be said presently. "Mercy", originally meaning "reward", also falls within the domain of the Spirit. The cave in which Hermês hid the cattle at the end of the first day of his appearance is in one connection the Cave of the Heart and in another the Cave-stage between Sagittarius and Aries.

Apollo was so delighted with the lyre and its inventor, Mercury, that he became his closest friend. It is to be noted that the Planet Mercury is the nearest to the Sun, and that the Anâhata chakra or "Sound wheel", the Heart Centre, which is the Centre of the Element Air, is "in the body" the nearest to the Hridaya or "Heart", the Centre of the Supernal Sun. As soon as at the beginning of the Spiritual Path the Spirit has been born, the Sun gives the tokens of his friendship. Apollo presented Hermês with the Golden Wand and with the gift of prophecy. For that gift is exercised by the Spirit. The Greek Karukion or Herald's Wand was shaped in this manner.  It is easy to see how its lines suggested two interwoven snakes and led to the more familiar form of the Caduceus, which will be considered presently.

The fifty head of cattle appropriated by Hermês are the creative powers issuing from Taurus, the Bull. The first urge of the new-born Spirit is to obtain Lordship over the World of Manifestation. The Spirit does not

recognize at once that which is higher than itself. But it realizes it fairly soon and is then immediately ready to obey the higher Powers, the service of which is its very function, and to act as "go-between" among the Gods and their Spheres, or, in other words, between Godhead and World. The number 50 represents the 7×7 sub-planes or stages plus the One. These are also found in the 49 Maruts of Hindu tradition plus Marut, their Origin and Lord, who is a "storm" aspect, creative and destructive, of Vāyu or Pāvana, the God of Air. The numbers 49 and 50 will be dealt with at greater length later.

The caduceus in the light of Yoga Having shown his attitude, first vis à vis the lower world and next vis à vis the higher world, Mercury reveals that he has established a harmonious relationship between them on the subtle basis of Sound. He invents the lyre, the seven strings of which represent the Seven Spheres, and he plays on it the Harmony of the Spheres. Apollo is delighted with this and becomes his closest friend, presenting to him the Golden Wand, the Caduceus, a many-sided and most profound symbol, in which the entire spiritual Path on which Hermès is the guide, is represented. The Wand corresponds to the Sushumnâ Nâdi of Yogic tradition and the two snakes on either side correspond to the Sun and Moon-channels and the Two Lifebreaths. In another context the two snakes are aspects of the Agathodaimôn, the Good Spirit, the Serpent of Wisdom, and the Kakodaimôn, the Evil Spirit, the Serpent of Delusion. In this context the two snakes are connected with the Two Paths. It is clear that with regard to the Fall, the Two Lifebreaths become associated with the Two Paths.

The snakes cross at three places, which correspond to the three Granthi or "Knots" of Yoga. The Brahmâ Granthi or "Knot of the Creator" is at the Mulâdhâra or "Root-Support" Centre, the Vishnu Granthi at the Manipura or Solar plexus Centre, and the Rudra Granthi at the Âjñâ or Forehead Centre.

The meeting place of the three at the lower beginning (or end) of the Wand is called in Yoga the Yuktatrivenî or "union braid of three". It is the "Cross-roads" that are watched over by Ganapati and Janus. When the "Knot of the Creator" — who is the Lord of the Tradition — is pierced or unravelled, the Path is entered, leading past the "Knot of the Preserver" to the "Knot of the Destroyer" (of Mâyâ). The higher meeting place of the three is the Muktatrivenî or "liberation braid of three". The three rivers are, in Yoga, sometimes called Gangâ (Ganges), Yamunâ and Sarasvatî, Ganga representing Idâ, the Moon-current, Yamunâ Pingalâ, the

Sun-current, and Sarasvatî the Sushumnâ or Middle current. These three rivers are also encountered in other symbolical contexts, as will be shown later.

It is the function of the Spirit to establish and keep the balance between the opposites which are symbolized in the scheme.

The Guide of the Dead.	The Wand is winged at the top, like the head of Mercury. The two wings are moreover the two petals of the Âjñâ Centre and the wings of the Hamsa, the Swan and the two breaths.
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When the God of Light has presented the wand to Hermês-Mercury, Zeus-Jupiter appoints the latter as his herald and messenger and as the guide of the dead to Hâdês, the Underworld. For Hermês is not only the Guide of spiritual aspirants, he is also the Guide of the dead. The Spirit watches over the dissolution of the sheaths or veils of materia after the death of a person, and also over the choice of new sheaths and the clothing with new veils. He watches over death and rebirth. There is, however, also a deeper meaning in "death" and "rebirth". The dead are, anagogically, the unenlightened people of the world, involved in their Ahankâric materialistic, sensual and rationalistic pursuits. Rebirth is the "Resurrection from the dead". It is the spiritual rebirth. With the trumpet-blast of the Angel of the Resurrection, a form of the Sound of Spirit, the soul arises out of "the Tomb". Hermês accompanies the dead, the people of "this world", which is the Underworld, even though they see him not, hear him not, feel him not and touch him not. But when they begin to aspire for Life, the life of Spirit, they bring nearer the time when he will touch them with his magic Wand, when they will feel or taste the Love of God, scent God's Reality and know the Spirit, hear the Music of the Spheres, and see and be the Son of God.

Hermês is the Psukhopompos, "the Guide of souls". In this capacity he brings sleep with his wand moistened with the waters of the rivers Lethe (forgetfulness) and Styx in the Underworld. We have seen before that sleep is symbolically associated with the spiritual life. Hermês accompanies the dead and goes down into the Underworld, that is to say, the world of worldliness, with a view to bring back the souls to Life. In Greek mythology there are a number of myths in which Zeus, the Father and Lord of the Gods, gives him the task to go down into Hâdês, the Underworld, to bring back a soul. Zeus is the Guru. It is only when the Guru decides that a soul is capable of living and deserves to live, that the gate of the Underworld can open and that the darkness and blindness of the existence of delusion can

be driven away by light and vision. In one or two myths a condition was attached to the return: in Hâdês the soul was not allowed "to speak", "to eat" or "to look back". Failure to fulfil the condition implied "falling to a temptation", and then the return, being untimely, had to be postponed. The element of finality in the fate of the soul in case of failure, which we encounter in the myths, comes from the tendency, found in very advanced teachings, to stress the uniqueness and "Einmaligkeit" of every spiritual test and situation. If a person knows that he can take an examination once again, or any number of times, in case of failure, he will not exert himself half as much as if he knows that he may attempt it only once. Furthermore strictly speaking, every situation and test is unique and einmalig, as a Jewish mystic said: "God does not do the same thing twice."

The "dead" are also the fragments of the dismembered Man which have to be fitted together and re-united for the Resurrection. The fragments of dead Osiris were thus re-united by Isis and Horus. Christ descends into Hell to save sinners.

In Greek tradition Hermês is the Lyrist in the Astral World, the Sphere of Moon and Stars. He is also the Source of invention and the Patron of inventors. No invention of any importance can be made without the help of intuition.

Elijah and Al-Khadîr.

The Mercurian hero, prophet or saint occupies an important place in the traditions of the world. One of his early forms is the Prophet Elijah or Elias, called the "Ruler of the Air". In Jewish tradition Elijah is a Prophet or Angel whose life on earth is apparitional. Also in the New Testament references to this tradition are found. In the Old Testament Elijah is shown to be good at hiding and appearing. He finally disappeared in a chariot of fire and "went up by a whirlwind into heavens" (II Kings 2, 11). In the next verse he is called the "Chariot of Israel". The Chariot is the vehicle of the Sun-God. Its four wheels are the Four Elements. It is the Mystic Merkabah described in the first Chapter of Ezekiel.

Later it will be dealt with at greater length. The word Elijah means "Yah is my God". "Yah" is the first part of YHVH or Yahve, the Jupiter of the Jewish tradition. In the Haggadah Elijah is called "the Bird of Heaven", because, as it is said, he appears down below like a bird at times when God wants to change the course of events. The Bird is a form of the Spirit applying to the mental and moral plane. In the Jewish Encyclopaedia it is stated that Elijah will restore the Ark of the Covenant. This has reference

to the function of the Spirit as prophet of the Tradition. Elijah also "raises the dead" and prepares the way for the Messiah, in Jewish tradition.

In Islâmic tradition he appears in the form of Seyidna Idris, who has been identified with Henoch (Enoch) and Hermès. In Christian tradition he is found in the mythical St. George, who should not be confused with the historical Bishop of Alexandria of that name. Lohengrin, the Knight of the Swan, who has been mentioned previously, was called Elias in the earliest form of the legend. The disciple of Elias, Elisha, is preserved in the name of the Lady Elsa to whose succour Lohengrin came, and who represents the soul, involved in the world of problems, as disciple. "Elsa" is etymologically the same as "Elisha". The name "Lohengrin" can be explained by references to Eastern traditions. In Arabic tradition there is a saint and prophet designated Seyidna Al-Khidr. In North India he is known as Khwâjâ Khizr or Khadir and is the object of a cult of both Muslims and Hindus. He is always represented in a green robe and sometimes it is called a robe of light. Loherangrain or Lohengrin means both "the wanderer in the green wood" and "the light-wanderer". Moreover "grin" was associated with "green". In the Christian tradition green is the colour of the Holy Spirit. In Hinduism the green emerald is the stone of Mercury. Green is the colour of the spiritual aspect of Venus and also the spiritual colour of the Vegetable Kingdom — leaves being green (see Diagram 1). In the Hermetic tradition it is the spiritual colour of the Element Water. The lustrous, green-robed, Al-Khadir is intimately linked to the prophet Elias, with whom he has often been identified. Al-Khadir is represented with a fish as Vâhana or Vehicle. On this account he has been identified with the Ruler of Pisces, in the form of the aspects of Neptune in the Greek Glaukos and the Babylonian Ea. But he stands for a later stage. The fish is a symbol of Venus, the Ruler of Taurus, Goddess of the emotional Element, Water. The festival of St. George in Greece, and of Elias and Al-Khidr in Persia, Turkey and elsewhere, falls on April 24th, during the time when Venus rules Taurus. He represents the Spirit, Messenger of Jupiter and Lord of Venus. He visits the Earth.

The Spirit as traveller and bridge.

The links between the various traditions are often truly bewildering in nature. This is particularly the case with regard to Hermès-Mercury, the Lord of Spirit.

The Mercurian travelling and linking tendency can be traced back to very early times. The etymological relationship between the Indian Budhan and the West European Wodan or Wotan has been mentioned already. These words are also related to the Latin uâtes, meaning

an inspired singer and travelling bard As will be noted later, the East European God Perkins is related to the Indian Vedic God Parjanya The name Hermès has related forms in Indian tradition The historical tendency can be understood if one remembers that it is a function of the Spirit to bring about the linking of traditions The Spirit is the true Pontifex Maximus "the great bridge-builder", not only between higher and lower planes but also between the traditions and nations of the world Hermès is the Lord of pilgrims on the roads of tradition Hermès, Al-Khadir, Odinn or Wodan, and St George, are all aspects of "the Patron of travellers" In the Roman tradition, statues of Mercury, Patron of travellers, were placed all along the main country roads Dead or alive, willing or unwilling, man is a traveller He is led by Hermès, though he knows it not For if he has no eyes to see and no ears to hear, the Divine Youth is invisible and inaudible to him Sooner or later he must recognize his Guide, in one or more of the innumerable forms the Spirit takes The traveller's staff is a form of the Wand of Mercury It is his "support" In case of need, it turns into the lance to kill the Ahankâric Dragon

Speaking with tongues The linking and uniting tendency of the Spirit is expressed also in the "speaking with tongues" described in the second Chapter of the Acts of the Apostles "And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance" The Spirit does not need one of the languages of this world for linking people of different nations and traditions It speaks the language of the heart, by means of sound, facial expression and gestures When it uses words belonging to a language of the world it does not speak the language of the Ahankâra that divides people, whether in the field of thought and dogma, the field of the emotions, or the field of material concerns The language of the heart unites all beings in a loving brotherhood The "heart" is the Heart Centre, the Anâhata or Centre of "Unstruck Sound" of Yoga, the Element of which is Air When language is merely rational, emotional and materialistic, and divorced from the Spirit and its Tradition, it serves for creating differences of opinion, differences of mood and differences of interest

The Tower of Babel. Communion of language, in the sense of international and intertraditional communion, is also mentioned in the eleventh Chapter of Genesis But there the teaching does not refer to the regaining of that communion, but to its loss It describes a stage of the Fall "And the whole earth was of one language, and of one speech" In

Hebrew the word for "language" is "lip". Lips are symbols of love and communion. The Hebrew for "speech" is "words". In those days there existed spiritual and rational unity of all traditions in the Universal Tradition. But the people said: "Let us build us a city and a tower, whose top may reach unto heaven; and let us make us a name." Every aspect of this symbolism refers to ambitious schemes of the rational mind. "Name", in various senses of the word, refers to the mind. The "naming" has been referred to before. "And the Lord said, Behold, the people is one, and they have all one language; and this they begin to do: and now nothing will be restrained from them, which they have imagined to do." And the Lord confounded their language. They could no longer understand one another's speech, and they were scattered abroad upon the face of all the earth. Here we have the theme of the scattering of the fragments of the dilacerated Man. The name of the City was Babel, that is, "Confusion". The meaning of this myth will be further explained later in connection with its particular place in the symbolism of the Zodiac, which is the stage where "the word" comes fully to expression. — Modern man is again building the tower of Babel, full of ambitious schemes and imaginings, lacking the love of brotherhood, failing to live in accordance with sacred tradition, and unable to understand the speech of his neighbour. He has brought about utter confusion in his soul and in the world. The fragments are "scattered abroad" — the fragments of Osiris, the fragments of the dismembered soul, the poor fragments of humanity on the war-swept surface of the earth. "If ye transgress, I will scatter you abroad among the nations: But if ye turn unto me, and keep my commandments, and do them; though there were of you cast out unto the uttermost part of heaven, yet will I gather them from thence, and will bring them unto the place that I have chosen to set my name there" (Nehemiah I; 8-9).

The Spirit as the Revealer of the Tradition. The Spirit, as embodied in Thoth, Hermês, Wodan, Agastya, Quetzalcobuatl, etc., is traditionally the Teacher of the sacred "Sciences" and the originator of the alphabet in the form of Runes or Hieroglyphs, that is, sacred picture-symbols. This concerns the aspect of the Spirit as the revealer of the Tradition. That is the prophetic aspect.

The Spirit is the intermediary between the letter and the meaning of the Tradition, as it is the intermediary between actual life and the meaning of life. The Spirit, presiding over the function of inspiration and intuition, is the intermediary between the higher worlds of the Tradition and the Guru

— that is, the Moon-Sphere and the Ether-Sphere — and the worlds of reason, feeling and action — the Elements Fire, Water and Earth

The Guru embodies the Word, the Spirit as Prophet interprets the Word to the rational and emotional functions and the world of action. The Guru initiates by Silence, the Spirit initiates by means of the interpretation of the Tradition. In this connection we can understand one of the implications of the words spoken by Jesus, the Guru of Christianity (St John 16, 7 and 13-14) "It is expedient for you that I go away for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you, but if I depart, I will send him to you" "When he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth, for he shall not speak of himself, but whatever he shall hear he shall speak, and he will show you things to come. He shall glorify me for he shall receive of mine, and shall show it unto you" In these words the spiritual functions of "hearing" and "forth-speaking" are mentioned in connection with the intermediary position of the Spirit between Guru or Enlightener and world, between Heaven and Earth.

The Comforter is the Parakletos. This word means the one "called to one's aid". It is an advocate, an intermediary. Paraklêtos is simply an appropriate name or title of the Spirit, the great Intermediary. He knows the Law and makes it known to the soul. This has reference to the benefit of the soul. The Advocate does not plead for the Ahankâra, neither does he plead to God for the forgiveness of the sins of the soul. Such beliefs betray superstition, not intuition and insight into the meaning of Tradition. The Paraklêtos pleads for the right understanding of the Law and for action in accordance with the Law.

The comforter comes in human form whenever a human being becomes a pure instrument of the Tradition. He works through prophets, saintly teachers and comforters, and inspired leaders of the human race. It is clear that the Comforter cannot be monopolized by any one tradition, whether it be Judaism, Christianity, Islâm, or any other. Of all the Gods or Angels, the Spirit is the most universal and all-embracing, intertraditional and supertraditional. The Spirit is the Intermediary, vertically as well as horizontally, or, in other words, between God and man, and between man and man.

We have noted the distinction between the Holy Spirit of the Moon-Sphere and the Spirit of the Element Air, and the relation of the two. The first is symbolized by Silver and the second by Mercury or Quicksilver, meaning "Living Silver". The Messenger is sent down by the Mother in the form of a Dove or of some other Bird, or manifests himself as "a rushing mighty wind".

In Islâmic tradition the Paraclete or Comforter is called Rûh al-Haqq, "the Spirit of Truth". Rûh, the word for Spirit, is etymologically related to the word Rih, meaning wind. Rûh is also sometimes identified with the Angel Gabriel, the Angel of the Moon, and with Mitatrûn, the Angel corresponding to the Metatrone of the Cabala, who also represents the Moon-Sphere. Metatrone, the Angel who, literally, is "with the Throne" of God, represents the Sun of the Moon-Sphere Duality. The Moon of that Duality is the Shekinab, the "Presence of God", "the Queen", representing Pure Consciousness and the Tradition. The Shekinah is identified with Ruach, the Hebrew equivalent of Rûh. In Jewish tradition She is the complementary form of Metatrone. Metatrone was, according to the Cabala, the Voice of God speaking on Mount Sinai. The Angel of the Annunciation, that is, the Voice of God "announcing" the Birth of the Son to the mother of Jesus, reflection on earth of the Mother of Heaven, was according to tradition the Archangel Gabriel, the "Nuncius". In Jewish tradition this Archangel is called Khôl, meaning "the Voice".

The spirit of man hears the Word spoken by the Voice. It hears what has to be passed on for the benefit of the Fallen Man, involved in Ahankâric bondage on the lower planes and striving for liberation. It reveals the Tradition.

16. THE SYMBOLISM OF THE HORSE AND THE SOLAR PLEXUS CENTRE

The Throne and Chariot of God. "Metatrone" does not only mean "with the Throne", but also "the changing Throne". The *changing* Throne is the Chariot of God, the Merkabah, Vehicle of the Spirit. It is the Chariot of Manifestation, which is ever moving and changing. The word "throne" comes from the same root as the Sanskrit "Dharma", meaning sacred tradition and the duty to fulfil it. The root of both words means support, maintenance, upholding. The Chariot of the Stars is the supporting and upholding Vehicle of the Tradition, upholding God-Reality.

In Egyptian tradition the symbol depicting the Goddess Isis (actually "Auset"), the sister and consort of Osiris (actually "Ausar") is a throne, and her name has that meaning.

In the body the "throne" is found in the "trunk". The two words are remotely related. The body is in symbolical terms the Trunk of the Tree of Life of the microcosm. It is the Vehicle or Chariot of God-Reality.

The power that moves the Chariot is traditionally the Power of the Ele-

ment Fire In this connection we should study the symbolism of the Animal that represents the dynamism of the lower mind — the horse — and of the Solar plexus Centre in the body

The symbolism We have seen that the Spirit descends from on high in of the horse. the shape of a Bird From the point of view of the personality which is focussed on the mental plane and aspires to purify and spiritualize itself, it takes the form of a winged horse or of another winged animal

The horse is the Animal which represents Mars, the Creator and Manifest It is the "support" of the Solar Hero It symbolizes movement, activity and dynamism in the World All Four or Seven Powers, in their aspect of Manifesters in the Great Round, are symbolised in the form of the Four or Seven Horses which draw the Chariot of the Sun God in various traditions Horse symbolism has even been preserved in modern days in the "horse-power" of mechanics The Lord of the Horse, Mars is Jupiter The Horse is sacred to Jupiter, in various traditions It is also sacred to Neptune As will be seen later, Neptune, the Ruler of the Seas, is an aspect of Jupiter, Ruler on the Night throne of the Water-House of Pisces, House representing the Womb and Pre-natal stage of Manifestation The Water-Horse, in various myths, is born out of that Sea In the first House of Manifestation, Aries, a Fire-House ruled by Mars on the Day-throne, the Horse plays a prominent part In the House of Gemini, ruled by Mercury, the Horse appears as his vehicle, or as a Winged Horse Further the Horse is found in the Fire-House of Leo, ruled by the Sun Leo marks the climax of the Fiery Powers of Manifestation In the Far-Eastern Zodiac Leo is called the House of the Horse Finally the Horse is encountered in the Centaur depicted in the Fire-House of Sagittarius Sagittarius is ruled by Jupiter, the Guru, on the Day-throne The Centaur has the form of a horse with the upper body of a man As will be noted later, Scorpio and Sagittarius form the stage where man attains "Manhood" The Centaur is an aspect of Guru, the Lord of Ether, the Quintessence of life The word "centaur" has been derived from the Latin Centaurus and the Greek Kentauros These words are etymologically related to the Sanskrit Gandharva The Gandharvâ are the Fifth Kin of Hindu tradition, representing the Element Ether ruled by the Guru The Centaur Cheiron lived in a cave on the sacred Mount Pelion — a form of the Mountain — with a number of Greek Heroes around him, whose Guru he was Most of the famous Heroes of Greek tradition were his disciples They represented the various Houses of the Zodiac, like the disciples of Christ and the Knights

of the Round Table. Centaurs have also been found depicted in Buddha Gaya. They represent the mind ruled by its Master, Jupiter the Guru.

The Horse is thus found in the three Fire-Houses in the Zodiac. It is horn as a Water-Horse. Then it manifests as a Fire-Horse. Next it flies in the Air. And finally it becomes the Ether-Horse.

The Horse was all-important in Vedic tradition. In later Hinduism its meaning, and hence its importance, was all but lost. As a winged horse it is found in Vedic tradition in the Horse Tarkshya, and as Dadhikravana. The latter is the great Winged Stallion bounding along the Path. The symbolism of this Horse becomes clear from the Brihadâranyaka Upanishad (1; 1): "Verily the Dawn is the head of the Sacrificial Horse, the Sun his eye, the Air its life-breath, the Universe Fire its open Mouth, the great Time-Cycle its body. The heavens are its back, the intermediate world its belly, the earth its hoofs, the cardinal points its sides and the intermediate quarters its ribs, the seasons its limbs, the months and fortnights its joints, the days and nights its feet, the stars its bones, the clouds its flesh The Great Golden Vessel which appeared in front of the Horse is the Day. Its Source is the Eastern Ocean. The Great Silver Vessel which appeared behind the Horse is the Night, its Source is the Western Ocean. These two arose on the two sides of the Horse, as the two sacrificial Vessels. The Ocean is indeed its Kinsman, the Ocean its Source." The Great Golden Vessel, the source of which is the Eastern Ocean, is the Sun, which arises out of the Water. House of Pisces. The Great Silver Vessel, the source of which is the Western Ocean, is the Moon, arising out of Aquarius. The further statements recapitulate the symbolism of the Elements and time and space. Stress is laid on the dynamic nature of the World of Manifestation and therefore it is symbolised as a Horse. Distinct from it are only the Power of Life, symbolized by the Golden Vessel, and the Tradition, represented by the Silver Vessel.

The Ásvamedha This symbolism enables one to understand the meaning or horse-sacrifice. of the ancient "horse-sacrifice", the Ásvamedha, the implications of which have been much misunderstood by modern scholars. The Sanskrit word Áśva means horse. The intention of the Ásvamedha or "horse-sacrifice" was to confirm "world-rulership". "Kingship" refers in the first place to the Element Fire, and in a higher sense to Air and Ether. Jupiter is the King of the Gods. The Son of God is the King of the Kingdom. This symbolic sacrifice represented the ultimate sacrifice of a disciple, which made him into a Ruler, namely a ruler over self and the Self. The performer became a "world-conqueror",

in the spiritual and symbolic sense Śrī Rāma in the Tretā Yuga and Yuddhisthira in the Dvāpara Yuga performed it. In the Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa (XIII, I, 6, 3) one reads "A King governs his people justly and righteously. This is called Aśvamedha." And further "A man of Knowledge gives a free gift of Knowledge to the people. This is also called Aśvamedha." The sacrifice concerns the Element Fire. It implies control of the lower mind, and attainment of knowledge. This control, achieved with the help of the Spirit, confers Kingship. The King is the protector of the Dharma, in the sense of sacred tradition and social duty. As seen before, Dharma is the "End of Life" referring to the Element Fire.

Sometimes the scriptures contain warnings meant for an early breed of literalists, incapable of perceiving the symbolic nature of the mythical traditions. We find it stated in the Rig-Veda (IV, 36, 1) that the Steeds of the Chariot of the Sun are "not born of horses", and also (I, 20, 2) that they are "fashioned by the mind (manas)".

Aśva and ash The very first House of the Moon Zodiac, which covers with its 27 Houses the 12 Houses of the Sun-Zodiac, is in Hindu tradition Aśvini. The constellation consists of the stars Alpha, Beta and Gamma of Aries and is said to resemble a horse's head. The Aśvins are two Horsemen. They are the Gods of Succour. Tradition runs that they have a wife in common, a daughter of the Sun, and that they are the owners of an Indian Pegasus, on which they fly through the sky.

Apart from "horse", the word Aśva also means "seven". The Tree of Life of Hindu tradition is called the Aśvattha Tree, a word derived from Aśva, "horse" and "seven". This is why it is mentioned in the Taittiriya Upanishad (III, VIII, 12, 2) that Agni, the God of Fire, hid in this Tree in the form of a horse. In the Roman tradition the horse was associated with Mars, the Lord of Manifestation. The Tree of Life of the Norse tradition is called Yggdrasill, meaning "the steed of Odinn". The Tree of Life of the Egyptians, as well as that of the Assyrians, was represented with seven branches. The Tree of Life is found also in the form of the "seven branched candlestick of Jewish tradition. In each branch burns one of the seven Flames of Creation.

Related to "Aśva" is the word "ash". The Universe-Tree of Scandinavian mythology, Yggdrasill, was an Asb. According to the tradition the Ases, the Gods of the Nordic faith, created the first man and the first woman out of two Ash trees. They were called Ask or Asker and Embla and became the progenitors of the human race. Their place, like that of the Aśvins, is in Aries, the first House of Manifestation, ruled by Mars.

Mythological horses. The Horse is further found in Hindu tradition in the form of the white Horse Uchchaiśravas which arose out of the Milk Ocean when it was churned by the Gods and the Titans — the Devas and the Asuras. It was taken into possession by Indra, the Lord of the Ākāśa, Jupiter. In Greek tradition a number of horses arose out of the Ocean. They were sacred to Poseidōn, the Neptune of Roman tradition. Their Master is Lord of the "Ocean of Samsāra".

In the Norse and the Germanic traditions the Horse took the form of Sleipnir, the Stormwind, the vehicle of Wodan or Odinn. This Horse had eight legs. This number eight is understood by reference to Diagram 8 and will be dealt with later. It is found also in the Vedic tradition in the Eight Vasus or "storm-gods". These are aspects of Vāyu, the God of Air. Their names are variously given in different scriptures, but they always clearly represent the Sun and the Moon and the Five Planets or the Five Elements, with Dhruva, the Pole-Star, as the Eight. The word "Vasu" means "abode, dwelling-place, pervader". Sun and Moon are here, as is often the case, the Dual Divinity of the Moon-Sphere.

The "Pole" is the Centre of the Supernal Sun, the Heart. From the lower point of view, however, the "centre" of life is the Planet Earth, the Earth-Dragon, to whose irregularities in turning round its own "axis" is due the apparent change of the heavenly Pole and the precession of the equinoxes. This question will be dealt with at length in a more suitable context.

The Valkyries, who, as we have seen, take the form of Swans when they accompany "perfected heroes" to Heaven, are martial Maids riding storm-horses when they function in the Battle of Life.

Also Dagur, the God of the Day, that is to say, Manifestation in general, and the Houses ruled on the Day-throne in particular, rides on a Horse, which is called Skinfaxe. The name "Dagur" implies "burning". The word "day" is derived from it. It corresponds to the Sanskrit Vaisvānara, the Fire of Life or Universal Fire.

The aspect of Hermēs as Messenger of the Gods is found in Hermod, a son of Odinn. Hermēs was sent to the Underworld to reclaim Persēphonē or Proserpina, and other souls. Hermod was similarly sent to the Underworld to reclaim Balder from Hel, the Goddess of Helheim. On that occasion he rode on Wodan's Horse Sleipnir. To go into the Underworld of Ignorance and Separation in the form of "this world", in order to reclaim a soul for the Light, can be accomplished only by the full and harmonious co-operation of the Spirit and the Power of Manifestation. Only if the Spirit perfectly controls the Horse of Mind, can it achieve the Resurrection. In Hindu

tradition the Horse is found also in the Avatâra of Vishnu, called Hayagrîva, "the horse-necked one" Hayagrîva is also met with in Northern Buddhism. It has been mentioned already that the Horse represents Mars and is sacred to Jupiter. The God Nirriti, Regent of the Direction of the S W, is sometimes depicted as sitting on a horse. Later we shall see that this God's place is in Scorpio, ruled by Mars. Indra, the Jupiter of Hinduism, is sometimes represented as sitting on a horse, as in the legend of the sage Uttanka, who was told to breathe into the ears of that horse. When he did so, flames immediately issued from the horse's body, enveloping his adversary.

The word "horse". The etymology of the word "horse" (related to the German "Ross") is interesting. The word originally meant "runner". The Horse of Manifestation courses in a circle representing a cycle. The word "course", whence a horse is called a "courser", is related to "horse". Distantly related are also the word "ring", from "hring", the Dutch word "kring", meaning a circle, and the words "circle", "circus", "circuit", "circumambulation", all from Latin, and the Greek "krikos" and "kirkos". The course is the Zodiac. The Ásvins, Gods of the Horse, come to the "succour" of those in need of help on the Path. (A study of words at the hand of an etymological dictionary often reveals connections which are hard to believe from the look of the words themselves. On the other hand, a similarity of words is no indication of their etymological relationship.)

Interesting is also another set of relationships. The descendants of Agni, Fire, are called Angiras. Mars is called Angâra. These words are related to the Greek "aggelos" and "aggaros" (pronounce angelos and angaros) a messenger on horseback. From the former, via the Latin "angelus", came the word "angel".

The Horse of mind. The Horse of Mind and Manifestation should be well controlled by the Solar Hero. The latter has ample opportunity on his long pilgrimage to learn to ride and to develop a loving companionship of master and servant with his horse. Ultimately, sitting on that Horse, he will slay the Dragon of the Ahankara, whether in the form of a hero of ancient Greece, of Syria or Irân, of India, Arabia or any other tradition. Or maybe he will do it as a pilgrim of modern days, who is in no way different from his predecessors, except in as far as he requires a longer time to learn to ride and control his Horse, on account of his "enlightened" mind. The Goddess of Wisdom, Athene or Minerva, virgin-born, lent the winged white horse Pegasus to the Hero Bellerophon, to carry him on his

task of slaying the fire-spitting Chimaera. The Winged White Horse is in a number of traditions the vehicle of the last World-teacher, the Avatāra Kalki of Hindu tradition and the King of Kings of the Revelation of St. John.

The Devil's Steed. But, till the horse of the lower mind has been fully subjected and has grown wings which take the rider wherever the Spirit pleases, he may turn at any time against the pupil on his back, rear on his hind legs, and throw him off. Not only the horse need not yet have learned to obey and follow his rider, but it may also have become lame or sick as a result of the indifference, crudeness or cruelty of the latter. Generally "the Devil's steed" is represented as a horse with three legs, if it is not an ass, an animal with "a will of its own" and not famed for its intelligence. The three legs also represent the three lower planes, in which the horse of the Abankāra rambles along. The horse of the mind-ego is capable of giving vicious kicks, both to others as well as to the artist who has fallen from his back. Such a horse, indeed, should be sacrificed to the Gods. Percival, on his way to the Grail Castle, after he had been thrown down from his own horse, was attacked by a demonic horse.

The demonic horse is known to a great many people in the form of nightmare. The "nightmare" has grown by psychological etymology from several terms, traditionally relating to the same subject. A mare, from older forms mere and marr, is a female horse. It is only of secondary importance. The verb "to mar" originally meant to hinder, to ruin. The "mara" was a blood-red and fiery ghost, vexing and tormenting people. As slayer the Mara is mentioned in the ancient poem Ynglinga-Tal. In Dutch the mistletoe is called "maren-tak", meaning "ghost-branch". The mistletoe was the plant which served to kill Balder, the God of Light of Northern Europe, Baldert the Good and the Beautiful. The nightmare is experienced in the Solar plexus Centre, because the God of Light has been killed in that Region. It is the psychic Centre of Fire, ruled by Mars.

Incubo and succuba. In Latin the Nightmare was called Incubo, from which is derived the word "incubus". "Incubation" implies "the engendering of heat, hatching out". The Latin Succuba, however, belonged to the plane below that of Fire. The Succuba was a female demon coming to have sexual intercourse with sleeping men. Related to the Incubo is the Vampire, the ghost who, according to popular superstition, came in the night to suck the life-blood of sleeping people. All these aspects of humanity are worthy of consideration by the psychology which deals with the unconscious of those who are spirit-

ually asleep The "vamps" of modern pictures and literature also "suck man's life-blood" But they belong to the species Succuba and the Element Water The Vampire belongs to higher realms, as its traditional association with the throat also indicates

The symbolism of food and stomach. Modern science smiles patronizingly about the old superstitions regarding nightmares, and attributes them to overeating, or the taking of unsuitable or poisoned food This view is perfectly correct — as long as it is remembered that "food" implies more than just the food of "this world", and that greed or gluttony — which causes over eating — was the factor that caused the Fall — and causes it ever anew — in league with the karmic appetites for unwholesome food There is over-eating, because there is desire Desire is the root of all evil

Knowing this, Vedic man could pray "Give us the food that is best and most wholesome for us and for all, food that is the one basis of all life activities, for such food, intently do we pray to the Lord of all forces (Rig-veda, Mandala VII)

The stomach symptoms associated with nightmares are but reflections of symptoms on the inner psychical planes The physical phenomena act — as is often the case — as warnings regarding the tendencies in the unconscious Lessons are generally learnt through the reactions of the reflections on the lower planes Man's "Karma" is the cause of and the goad to the development of self-knowledge and wisdom The reactions of Desire, with its hosts of offspring-desires, turn back upon man to teach him his lessons The mass-man is focussed either in his emotions or erotic life or in his lower mind, he lives, to put it crudely, in his abdomen and his stomach, or, to put it in traditional terms, in the Sacral plexus and the Solar plexus Better than the word "plexus", which arouses physical and anatomical associations *we, in conformity with Hindu tradition, the words "wheel" and "lotus",* which are, from the point of view of the physical body, purely symbolical They are also called "centres"

The Solar plexus Centre. Even the terrifyingly realistic experience of a nightmare is easily explained away by physicians who do not see any deeper than the physical body They should take due note of the symbolism of "food", "gastric fire", the necessity of "eating pure food" and of occasional "fasting" The Solar plexus is the Centre which stood out in the Fall, it is also the Centre where the Battle of Life is going on It is presided over by the God of Fire It is the Centre of

the Thunderbolt, Mars. In its Sphere, symbolically called "the Battlefield", the struggle between Jupiter and the Titans, between Thor and the Giants, between Indra and Asura Vritra, is going on. In the battle Thor uses his thunder-hammer, called Mjolner and his girdle or belt of power, called Megingjard, which symbolizes control over that region of "the body".

In that Centre Hindu tradition places the Tejolinga or Fire-Linga. Indra is the traditional "Destroyer of Demons". His name has been derived from a word for "subduing, conquering". He owns a bow, which takes two forms. As an unbent bow it is invisible to mortals. It is the bow in the state of rest, and refers to the Ether, the Sphere which is ruled by him. As a bent bow it is visible to mortals as the rainbow. The bent bow is further a weapon of warfare; it refers to the Element Fire, to which Indra descends for the purpose of fighting the Asuras. The rainbow is, as we shall see later, the "bridge between heaven and earth". The Element Fire lies midway between the Elements Ether and Earth.

Indra is the owner of green horses. He often rides on the white horse Uchchaishravas. Tradition teaches that the performance of a hundred "horse-sacrifices" will elevate a man to the rank of Indra. This means that the perfect "sacrifice" of the Horse of Mind alone — possible, of course, only with the help of Spirit, — can form, or rather, reform, or still better, uniform, a man into a Guru or Son of God.

The Element Fire, the Sphere of the Solar plexus, was that predominating in the Fall of Adam. All real trouble and sorrow originated there, and therefore a mighty task has to be performed by the spiritual aspirant in "pacifying" that part of his nature. He should learn to subject his lower mind so that he may soar to the higher realms of Spirit and Heaven. In Chinese Yoga important injunctions are given to meditate on the Solar plexus. In different periods of traditional history much stress was laid on such teachings and practices. In early centuries in the West there existed a particular kind of meditation practice in which the gaze was directed on the navel. In the 14th century this practice was followed in Mount Athos. The adherents of the cult were called Omphalopsukhoi or Umbilicani, meaning "navel-souls". This form of contemplation was also called Hesychasm, a word derived from the Greek hesikos, meaning quiet. It is, indeed, of the utmost importance to quieten the Solar plexus Centre, which is alternatively called the Navel Centre. The Navel is the central pivot of the Scheme of Manifestation. In the traditional Hindu representation Brahmâ the Creator issues from a lotus, the stalk of which arises out of the Navel of the "Sleeping" Vishnu. The Solar plexus Centre, however, is situated somewhat above the navel.

In the Râja Yogic tradition the Solar plexus Centre is called Manipura. The Manipûra Lotus is conceived with ten petals, which are said to represent in an unpurified personality the qualities of shame, fickleness, jealousy, desire, laziness, sadness, ignorance, aversion, disgust, and fear. These are the ten basic shortcomings of the "ego" in the fiery world of Manifestation. By the "heating-process" of tapas, or austerity and spiritual practices, by moral mind purification, mind-sacrifice and mind-surrender-to-God, the spiritual aspirant may "open up" this lotus, which then qualifies for its names of "Solar plexus" and "Lotus of Happiness", as well as Manipûra, meaning "full of rays" and also "jewel-city". It then "extends upwards", according to tradition. And then "the Yogî can heal the sick" which means that he can exert a beneficial influence on the mind of others, with application also on the material plane. He is further said then "to be able to transmute metals into gold", which Alchemic symbolism signifies that he can transmute the lower elements of his being into the highest, purest and incorruptible element, "he is able to enter into another's body", and "become clairvoyant" which are both ways of expressing, that, after having mastered his own lower mind, he gains knowledge of the troubles caused by that mind, which serves him when he identifies himself with others. It is also well-known that the lower kind of "clairvoyance", a faculty which the possessors share with many animals, is connected with the Solar plexus Centre, which is also the "Animal Centre". These faculties may be attained to a limited extent even before this Lotus fully "opens up", that is, blossoms spiritually.

The weaknesses of Zeus and Indra. The Fall is expressed also in the mythological traditions connected with the Gods. The Gods are represented either in a pure and exalted aspect, as Rulers of their own Spheres or Abodes, and as harmoniously united parts in the Divine Scheme, or they are represented as having descended to Spheres other than their own, where very often they get involved in all kinds of trouble. The Spheres are within the human psyche, and the psyche lives within the Spheres. Greek and Roman mythology is full of stories concerning "the weaknesses of Zeus-Jupiter" and Hindu mythology full of references to "the weaknesses of Indra". After one of his adventures Indra was found out and covered by "a thousand marks of disgrace", as Man is after the Fall. But eventually Indra was forgiven and the thousand marks of disgrace were changed into so many eyes. Experience brings vision and a great sinner can become a great saint. In view of these truths deluded teachers — like Rasputin — have even recommended people "to sin" mightily, for the greater would be the ultimate spiritual benefit. Truths

like this illustrate how the Devil of Ahankâra makes use of anything and everything in order to achieve his purpose. Even truth, wrongly applied, may serve to involve Man in deeper darkness of egoism and separateness, with karmic results of pain and sorrow.

The qualities of the ten petals of the Manipûra Lotus link on to the Ten Plagues of Egypt and the Ten Sins visiting Buddha under the Bodhi Tree. These refer to the negative aspect of the Ten Houses of Manifestation in the Zodiac, from Aries to Capricorn. Ten is the number of Manifestation and Fire is the Element of Manifestation, par excellence. The Centre of this Sphere is the Solar plexus or Manipûra. In order to overcome the ten inner plagues the great Teachers of the various traditions have given ten Rules. Moses gave the Ten Commandments, Buddha the Ten Precepts, Patañjali (II, 30, 32) the Ten Virtues, and Śrī Krishna Ten Great Qualities and also Ten Higher Qualities (Bhagavad Gītā XIII, 8—9 and 9—12). The various correspondences are shown in Diagram 2.

The preliminary stage of healing In the traditions of Raja Yoga, the Ten Yamas and Niyamas, the "Restraints" or "Commandments", should be mastered before the Yoga can lead to spiritual attainment. They form, as it were, the preliminaries of Yoga or Union with the Divine. The moral stage has to be passed by an aspirant, before he may fully enter the blessedness of the spiritual life. Origen referred to this when he wrote (in *Contra Celsum* III, 59 and 62) "We at first invite all men to be healed, and exhort those who are sinners to come to the consideration of the doctrines which teach men not to sin, and those who are devoid of understanding to those who beget wisdom, and those who are children to rise in their thoughts to manhood, and those who are simply unfortunate to good fortune, or — which is the more appropriate term to use — to blessedness. And when those who have been turned towards virtue have made progress, and have shown that they have been purified by the word, and have led as far as they can a better life, then, and not before, do we invite them to participation in our mysteries. 'For we speak wisdom among them that are perfect'." And "God the Word was sent, indeed, as a physician to sinners, but as a teacher of divine mysteries to those who are already pure and who sin no more." Therefore, when the Manipûra Lotus opens up and extends upwards, the Yogi "can heal the sick." Therefore, also, the Gospels are full of references to the healing of the sick by Jesus and his disciples.

The Chariot of the Sun It has been mentioned before that the constellation of the Wain, consisting of seven stars, symbolizes the Moving Universe, "carrying" the Immovable, Supernal Sun, the Pole Star We shall recur to this symbolism later

The Sun of Manifestation, which is one of the Duality Sun-Moon of the Moon-Sphere, also has a Chariot representing the entire psychical Universe Its course involves the symbolism of a Path and a Goal

It is the task of the Sun, as the highest of the Seven Powers, to rule the other six. The chariot of the Sun-God Helios of Greek and of the Sun God Sol of Roman tradition is drawn by four horses These represent the Powers of the Four Elements The chariot of the Sun God Surya of Hindu and the Sun-Goddess Sol of North-European tradition is drawn by seven horses These represent the Powers of the Seven Spheres

In the Rig-veda the seven horses are called the Seven Harits The word means "brilliant, ruddy" The Sun God is addressed thus (VII, 60) If thou, O Sûrya, at thy rising wilt report us truly sinless to Varuna and Mitra we will sing to please the Gods Sûrya is rising, O Varuna and Mitra to pace both worlds, looking down on men, protector of all that travel or stay, beholding right and wrong among men He unharnesses his Seven Harits and hastens dutifully to your throne, ye twain, surveying all beings, as a shepherd his flock Sûrya is the Sun of Manifestation His rising is symbolic of "resurrection" Mitra and Varuna represent as we shall see later, the stages of Capricorn and Aquarius, into which the Sun sets for the Night Varuna represents in some contexts the Supernal Sun of Aquarius

The symbolism of a Car has a general reference to the creative lower mind, the Element Fire While the Sun is generally conceived with a Car the Moon is generally thought to have a Ship This is a *Vessel* In some contexts it becomes an Ark It will be dealt with later

The physical and psychical body of man is the vehicle of the divine man It is the ultimate task of every one who follows the Solar Path of the Tradition to learn to control and drive the seven horses of his being

Driving accidents Driving accidents are due either to the incapacity or the ambition of the driver, who tries to do something beyond his power, or to a defect in the mechanism of the car, arising from long misuse by the driver The higher the "horse-power" of the car, the more serious the accident is likely to be The driver is the subjective and the car the objective element of the microcosm It is interesting to study the driving accidents in myths and fairy tales These

fall into several categories, by far the most prominent of which is that which refers to mental ambition and pride coupled with over-confidence in the self.

The myths serve as lessons and warnings. For great are often the trials which people call down upon themselves, and terrible are the catastrophes which often follow them.

Phaëton was the son of the Sun-God Hélios and a mortal mother. People had disbelieved the story of his divine origin and mocked him and his mother. His pride had been badly hurt, and he wanted to show them who he was. Nowadays we would say, that he suffered from an inferiority complex. Phaëton went to his father's abode to ask him for the boon of driving the Sun-Chariot for a day. Hélios was delighted to see his son and promised him to fulfil any wish he might have. On hearing what Phaëton wanted, however, the Sun-God was filled with alarm. He tried to dissuade his son. But when Phaëton persisted, he had to give his permission, being bound by his promise. The results were catastrophic. Phaëton lost control over the ruddy mares, went off the Solar Path, and burned woods, fields of grain, villages and towns, killing numerous people, by bringing the Fire of the Sun too near the earth. To save the world from being entirely destroyed, he was finally killed by the Thunderbolt of Zeus-Jupiter. He had given a demonstration that he was not yet "one with the Father". First of all he should not have approached the Father out of self-will connected with an ambitious scheme.

It will be seen later, that the Sin of excessive self-confidence and mental ambition and pride has its place in the scheme of the Zodiac in the Signs of Cancer and Leo, at "the Height of Manifestation", in summer. "Phaëton" is etymologically related to the Sanskrit "Bhâs", meaning to shine, to be bright. "Bhâsa" and "Bhâskara" are names of the Sun in Hindu tradition. The root "bhas" means, however, to devour, to consume, to reduce to ashes. The myth is not meant to illustrate the fact that in midsummer the sun tends to burn the crops, but the natural phenomena are used to illustrate the dangers pertaining to a particular stage of the spiritual path.

Woe to him who presumptuously tries to drive the Solar Chariot in the world of Manifestation before he has become qualified to do so, by long practice of self-purification, by extirpation of the (partly symbolic) Seven Sins of Greed, Lust, Wrath, Jealousy, Gluttony, Pride and Sloth. Woe to him and to every one who is connected with him in the remotest way. For worldly ambition is the most dangerous of all powers. Whether a man be a worldly or a spiritual leader, the bringer of a personal creed into the field of politics and nationalism or into that of religion — merging into one

another — he is bound, sooner or later, to cause a conflagration in the world

The modern world has again seen several self-styled teachers and leaders who attempt to teach and lead others before they have become qualified to do so and have become *rightly* guided themselves. They were driven by over-estimation of self, ambition and conceit, and have dragged vast numbers of people with them into the conflagration, some as victims in the spiritual sense and others as victims in the worldly sense. They deluded themselves — and others — into thinking that they were instruments of God or Fate

The further a man advances on the Path of Return to Divine Reality the more care he must take, for the more terrible would be a new Fall. As one tradition has it, "the Path is as sharp as a razor". If a man carries with him a burden of Ahankâric shortcomings he will cut his feet, and the fickleness of the light he carries will make him lose his balance, he will slip and find his doom in the Abyss below, and will then have to begin all anew

In the world of Manifestation the Solar Chariot is particularly connected with the Solar plexus Centre, as we shall see later. Driving accidents in dreams have reference to the unknown life of the lower mind, the *Element Fire*, within the soul

**Spiritual
ambition and
vanity.**

While traditionally *mental* pride and ambitious actions are connected with the stage of Cancer and Leo, in the middle stage of the Path, *spiritual* pride and ambitious striving are associated with the end-stage of the Path especially Sagittarius. While the shortcomings we have considered just now apply to the moral and creative aspects of the lower mind, and therefore particularly of human society also, the shortcomings of spiritual pride and ambition apply to a more subtle and private realm of the psyche, largely unnoticed by other people, and perhaps hardly noticed by the person himself

Ikaros was the son of Daedalos, who was known for his pride. Daedalos was the architect of the Labyrinth of Crete, largely symbolic of the architectural structure of the Moon-Sphere, or Mâyâ, in connection with the Height of the world of Manifestation, in Cancer and Leo. In other words, it represents the Mâyâvic aspect of the world, in which the soul loses its way. Imprisoned in the Labyrinth of their own making, Daedalos made a pair of wings for Ikaros. After having warned his son not to fly too high, he told him to fix the wings and to fly to a land where they would be free and where he would soon follow him. Although warned by his father, Ikaros

flew too high and ventured too near the Sun. The wax with which the feathers of his wings were attached, melted by the heat and he fell into the sea.

Sagittarius is the stage in which spiritual pride has a place. The fall of Ikaros into the sea is the Fall of the soul from the Fire-House of Sagittarius to the Water-House of Scorpio, or, alternatively, in a general sense, from the Air, through Fire, into Water, covering most of the period of Manifestation.

The fate of Ikaros was shared by Etana of Babylonian myth and Nimrod of the Korân legend. Later a number of parallel myths to those of Phæton and Ikaros will be dealt with, each with their own particular implications.

A little bird should not leave its nest too soon. It might fall and not be able to return to the safety of the nest, watched over and fed by its parents. The soul should not use its wings to fly away from the lower planes before the time of the last flight has come. A man should "keep his feet on earth", even when he is shaken by great spiritual experiences. The Four Elements each claim their share of attention in human life. Further, artificial wings are made out of the stuff of the lower Elements. They are not true wings at all. True wings form part of the living spirit. They lift us up to the heavens and bring us down again to the earth. When they are full-grown, they make heaven and earth into one world, for the Air interpenetrates all Spheres and reaches up to the Ether.

Even in modern speech "flying" is indicative of both ambition and escapism. It is significant that "fly" is preferred to "flee" in the sense of *escape*.

17. THE SYMBOLISM OF THE MYTH OF MOSES AND THE TEN PLAGUES OF EGYPT

Jehovah and Moses.	The Ten Rules are given by the Guru or Enlightener, the Lord of the Sphere of Light, the Ether, in his aspect as the Ruler of Pisces. They will be dealt with in the
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20th section.

The Jewish YHVH or Jehovah is none but Jupiter, the Ruler of Pisces. The first letters of the two words are traditionally related. Jupiter is called Jehudiel, named Remunerator and Counsellor, among the Seven Great Angels of the Judaic tradition.

Jupiter's abode is the Mountain-top. The same applies to Jehovah when he is truly "in his element".

Jehovah revealed the Tradition to Moses, who was a Teacher and Son of God, leading the fragments of a disintegrating tradition in the bondage

of the Ahankâra back to the Promised Land, symbol of the Paradise or Ether-Sphere, the "Original State"

**The desert,
the burning
bush, and
thorns.**

The contact of Moses with Jehovah takes place in three main stages. The first refers to the Element Fire and the Solar plexus Centre, the second to the Element Air and the Anâhata Lotus or Heart Centre, and the third to the Element Ether and the Visuddha Lotus or Throat

Centre. In chapter 3 of Exodus we read "Now Moses kept the flock of Jethro his father in law, the priest of Midian, and he led the flock to the backside of the desert, and came to the mountain of God, to Horeb." Moses takes the animals into the desert. Both animals and desert are symbols of the Element Fire, the mental plane. Mount Horeb is a mountain on the Sinai peninsula. The root of Horeb is found in Egyptian, Hebrew and other languages. The Egyptian "hor" meant "heart." The God Horus is 'the Heart' of the World. The Sanskrit "hrî", the Latin "cor", the Greek "ker" and "kardia", all mean "heart", and all these words are related. If written with the letter heth, the Hebrew "hor" means "cavern", and if written with the letter he, it means "mountain." The cavern or heart is the hidden spiritual centre. Symbolically Cave and Mountain form a pair of opposites, often found together. Moses approaches this sacred mountain, representing the Spirit. But before he may know God as the Lord of Air, he must know him as the God of Fire. "And the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush and he looked, and behold, the bush burned with fire, and the bush was not consumed." Note the words "the angel of the Lord." The angel associated with "the flame of Fire" is Mars. His Lord is Jehovah-Jupiter-Guru. The thorn-bush or bramble is a plant which symbolizes egoism and sin. It is mentioned in the parable of the trees recounted in Judges 9, 8-15. The ram which Abraham offered for a burnt offering to the Lord instead of his son, was found "caught in a thicket" (Genesis 22, 13). The "thicket" is a thorny bush, Spinctum Akantheon. Abraham, like every man, had to sacrifice "the animal nature", "caught in the thorns of sin." The Ram, moreover, is connected with Fire and the Fire-House Aries. It is the Vâhana of Agni, the Hindu God of Fire. Thorns are emblems of sin. In Hebrews 6, 8 one reads "That which beareth thorns and briers is rejected, and is nigh unto cursing, whose end is to be burned." Jesus said (St. Luke 6, 43-44) "For a good tree bringeth not forth corrupt fruit; neither doth a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit. For every tree is known by his own fruit. For of thorns men do not gather figs, nor of a bramble bush gather they grapes." In view of the

tradition concerning thorns, the putting of a crown of thorns on the head of Jesus was one of the greatest indignities and insults he had to bear. But his love was, indeed, "as the lily among thorns" (Solomon's Song 2; 2). The Haggadah significantly states that roses had no thorns before the Fall of Man. The Rose, corresponding to the Lotus of Indian tradition, is the flower which symbolizes the Quintessence, Paradise, the Christ.

The third Chapter of Exodus states "that the bush was not consumed". For the Fire is not the fire of this world, it is the Fire of God. Fire is a symbol and not a material actuality. And then "God called unto him out of the midst of the bush, and said, Moses, Moses. And he (Moses) said, Here am I." The "midst" refers to the centre, the Ether, the Sphere of God. God calls Moses by name, which is a form of the "naming" of the mental plane. And God draws Moses's attention to the "I", the Ahankâra. In a subsequent verse (14) God contrasts it with the "I—I" of Divinity, the "I of Being", after Moses, in a question typical of the mental plane, on which he is still focussed, has asked his *name* (13). "And God said unto Moses, I AM THAT I AM: and he said, Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, I AM hath sent me unto you."

The Anâhata or Heart Lotus has traditionally twelve petals, corresponding to all twelve Houses of the Zodiac. Two of these represent Abankâra, "the I-factor", "selfishness", and Mamatâ, the sense of "mineness", also the sense of "mineness in relation to God", a form of devotion.

The Lord promises to take the children of Israel out of Egypt unto the "land flowing with milk and honey". In this Hebrew tradition Egypt, the land of affliction, represents the state of sinfulness, which is ruled by the Ahankâra, symbolized by Pharaoh. In many places Egypt is identified with sin and affliction. It is found last in the Revelation of St. John (11; 8): " . . . the great city, which spiritually is called Sodom and Egypt, where also our Lord was crucified." Crucifixion is a symbol of the affliction of the soul in the bondage of the sinful world of Manifestation. The promised land "of milk and honey" is the Original State, Paradise, the Garden, in the Zodiac centred in Aquarius, the House in which both Milk and Honey, two aspects of the Elixir of Life, are found in a large number of traditional contexts.

Aaron's rod. In the myth under consideration the focus continually shifts to and fro between the Spheres of Fire and Air, between the Solar plexus Centre and the Heart Centre. This is also indicated in the changing of the rod into the snake, and back again into the rod. The rod is an aspect of the "Rod of Mercury" and the snake is a symbol of the

urge of sex This symbolism, to which much more attention will be given in another context, refers to "the transmutation of sex", which has to be learnt in between the Solar plexus Centre and the Heart Centre After this mystery had first been demonstrated to Moses, the rod passes to Aaron and becomes known as "Aaron's rod" The Solar plexus Centre is also known by the name of Kundalî Cakra Kundalinî is the "Fiery Power", or "Serpent Power", which is said to "sleep" in the Mûlâdhâra or "Root-support Centre" It is very much awake in its own Centre, the Solar plexus When a spiritual aspirant begins his upward ascent of the Path, the Fiery Power rises to return to the Source whence it came, there to be harmonized with and united to its Lord

The Struggle between Moses and Pharaoh. In the struggle between Moses and Aaron on the one hand, and Pharaoh, the King of Egypt, and his servants, on the other, is found a form of the struggle between the Gods and the Titans, Light and Darkness, God-Realization and Ahankâra, virtue or righteousness, and sin or separateness Moses and Aaron perform certain miracles before Pharaoh It will be noticed that the priests and magicians in the service of Pharaoh always try to imitate those miracles, but to no avail, for they are always beaten And, indeed, priests, "sorcerers" and ritualists can never prevail over true prophets and mystics, because the latter have direct experience of those matters which the former only know by hearsay The mystic has the living tradition, the traditionalist only its form The mystic has authority direct from God, whilst the traditionalist has it from his predecessors or superiors

Aaron represents one plane below that of Moses He is the intermediary of Moses in dealing with the people as well as in dealing with Pharaoh The Lord says about him (Exodus 4, 15-16) "Thou shalt speak unto him, and put words in his mouth and I will be with thy mouth, and with his mouth, and will teach you what ye shall do And he shall be thy spokesman unto the people and he shall be, even he shall be to thee instead of a mouth, and thou shalt be to him instead of God " Aaron puts the Revelation into words and ritual acts for the people This is the "naming" process The Word is articulated by him The "articulation" is literally "a dividing by joints"

The unveiling and re-veiling of Tradition. Revelation has two aspects It is at one and the same time the unveiling of the Essence of Truth, and the re-veiling of the Truth in the material of past traditions The Truth is visioned anew in its Quintessence and comes down via Air, Fire and Water to Earth It sounds the spiritual note

and call, is expressed in rational terms, is suitably clothed in emotional material and is engraved on stone tables or written on paper. The Birth of the Word takes place in Ether, and subsequently on the lower planes, in a form suitable to the requirements of the age or occasion. In Revelation "Truth" and "practical purposes" become one. The intermediaries are the Gods or Angels. St Dionysius the Areopagite writes (in *Celestial Hierarchies* IV, 2) "The revelation of supernatural secrets to man is done by their intermediary", and "Thus the Angels have brought us the tradition (law), as holy scripture teaches us". The word Angel comes from the Greek *Aggelos*, "messenger". Derived from that is the word "evangelist", literally "a writer of good tidings". Angelic intermediaries assist in the process of Revelation in the soul. Human intermediaries assist in disseminating the Revelation in the world. The latter are generally disciples. Sometimes they are relatives. Aaron was the brother of Moses.

The hardened heart of Pharaoh After Moses had been suitably instructed by the Lord, he began his spiritual struggle with Pharaoh. The Lord sent Plagues to bring Pharaoh "to his reason", but every time "Pharaoh's heart was hardened", and the Lord had to send another Plague to the land. The Ahankara, residing in the Heart Centre, is indeed the hardest thing to overcome. It requires great calamities to soften it. Pharaoh's "heart" is nothing but the spirit of hard-heartedness and hard-headedness of the Ahankâra, hardened and hardbitten — almost as bad as "stiff-necked", a term later to be applied to the Elect, and referring to a more advanced stage. It will be noted that during the Ten Plagues the myth is still focussed in the Sphere of Fire and the Solar plexus Centre. Only after the Exodus from Egypt does the focus shift to the Sphere of Air. When Moses receives the Law and the Commandments on the Top of Mount Sinai, the focus shifts for him to the Sphere of Ether.

The captivity of egotism The Ten Commandments, which will be considered later, are nothing but a teaching to avoid the Plagues. They are meant for those who have ears to hear. Warnings are ever again going forth to the people who are focussed in selfishness, greed and the tendency towards separation. Again at the present time the Lord commands his servants to say, as is written in Ezekiel (3, 10-11) "Son of man, all my words that I shall speak unto thee receive in thine heart, and hear with thine ears. And go, get thee to them of the captivity, unto the children of thy people, and speak unto them, and tell them, Thus saith the Lord God, whether they will bear, or whether they will forbear."

Ever again there is "captivity" in the bondage of the Ahankāra, ever again the Spirit calls upon the people in captivity to receive the words of tradition *in the heart*, hearing them *with the ears*. Indeed, the people are "impudent and hardhearted" (3, 7) and "a rebellious house" (3, 9)

The two groups of Commandments and Plagues. As shown in Diagram 2, the Ten Plagues and the Ten Rules are connected with the Five Elements and range themselves into two groups, following each other in an ascending scale throughout the year-cycle. The first group of five refers to the "Organs of Perception" and the second to the "Organs of Action". This scheme applies to the Return Path to God, for guidance on which the Ten Commandments have been given. On that Return Path the part of the year-cycle which shows an increase of the Power of Manifestation — from Aries to Leo — is particularly recommended as a time of "watching" and "learning to know oneself", and the second part of the year-cycle which shows a decrease of the Power of Manifestation and a return to the Source — from Leo to Capricorn — is particularly recommended as a time for working out spiritually and in practical life the knowledge and experience gained during the first part of the year. The symbolism of the Plagues is undoubtedly based on natural catastrophes.

The first plague of Egypt. The first Plague, sent by the Lord over the Land of Egypt through Moses and Aaron, is described in the seventh Chapter of Exodus. It is the turning of the waters of Egypt into blood, so that all the fish die. The people have no more water to drink. The symbolism refers to the pure Water of Pisces being turned into the blood of Aries, the House of "the Kill", ruled over by Mars. The Water of Life is no more available. There is nothing left but the bloody Sea of Samsāra or worldliness. The *divine potentialities* represented by the fishes, the seeds of Pisces, brought to land by Manu and Matsya of Hindu tradition or Noah of Hebrew tradition, die in the sinful pool of worldliness, in which the Ahankāra holds sway.

Symbolism of the Ark. The tradition of Matsya, Noah and other Guardians of Life will be dealt with at length later. In order to throw light on the beginning of the cycle, a few things must be said here. The Ark, whether in the form of the Ark of the Covenant or in that of the Ark of Noah, represents The Tradition, the vessel of Immortal Life. The Ark of the Covenant contained the tables of the Law — the Hebrew tradition. The disap-

pearance of the Ark from the Great Temple at Jerusalem was symbolic of the degeneration of Hebrew tradition. The Jews believe that it is hidden in a cave in a Mountain and that its hiding place will be revealed by the Messiah. The Ark of Noah represents more particularly the "hidden Ark", bringing the Tradition safely through a sinful period of Manifestation to another epoch. It is visible only to the Elect, those whom, as the Lord said to Noah, "I have seen righteous before me in this generation". Only the Elect are saved from drowning in the Waters of the Deluge, the Sea of Samsâra.

The word "Ark", as a Container of the Treasure of Life and Tradition, comes from the old Teutonic "arika" and the Latin "arca", both meaning a chest. From the last word and "arcanum", meaning hidden, secret or mystery, is derived the English word "arcane". The Ark is, of course, the "esoteric" tradition. This word is also found in the Sanskrit Argha, meaning literally "a vessel", and "value". The word Argha is used also for the Receptacle of the Linga. It denotes the sacred Yoni in which the Linga-Treasure is contained. The related Sanskrit "arch" means to shine, to be brilliant, to honour. "Argh" is to be worth, value, treasure. A Western form of the Sacred Vessel and Container is the Holy Grail, hidden away from the profane, like the Ark of the Covenant.

The "Ark" as a Ship — another form of "vessel" comes from the closely related Latin "arcus", meaning a curve, a bow. It is a form of the Moon-ship, the "Barque of Isis". In southern climes the Crescent Moon symbolizing the beginning of Creation or Manifestation, is horizontal like a ship. We see it in the "Argo" of the Argonauts on their quest to obtain the Golden Fleece, the *skin* of the Sun-Ram of Aries. In the heavens it is found in the constellation "Argo navis", stretching alongside the Zodiacal Sign of Cancer, ruled by the Moon. The "navis" or ship we have also in the "nave" of the church. A church is or should be the holder of sacred tradition, and the ship which carries the pilgrim to his goal. It is the exoteric form of the Ark of the Testimony. In Norse mythology the House of the Ark, Pisces, is called "Noatun", meaning "town of ships".

From the Latin "arcus", meaning bow, comes the "arc-en ciel", the rainbow, the "bow in heaven". The symbolism of bow and rainbow, pertaining to the Element Air or Spirit, will be explained at length later. The rainbow was the "sign" of the Covenant (Genesis 9, 13-14). From the Latin arcus come also the English arc and arch, implying a curve, . This arch we see in the dome of the night-heaven and in the last quarter of the moon in Southern climes. The arches in churches, further represent the vault of heaven.

The bow is found in Sagittarius, this time as a weapon in the hand of

the Guru, to be used in order to destroy the Ahankâra at the end of the cycle. This Sign is also called "the Archer." In it the arch of the Night heaven becomes visible and the Moon shows herself in the arc of Dissolution. This is the case, because in Sagittarius Manifestation draws to its close.

Associated to some extent with the words mentioned above is the other word "arch", found in archangel, archbishop, etc., which is derived from the Greek "Arkê", meaning chief, beginning, first, original, pre eminent government. Pisces is the House to which this applies also, in its implications of first, original and governmental. It is ruled by Jupiter as Law giver for the new cycle to come, and is moreover the House in which the 'archives' are kept, elsewhere called the "Moon-records" or "Astral records." They contain both the Records of Tradition, and the Records of Karma. Pisces is the House of the Crescent Moon.

The Ark of Life and Tradition, the Moon-Vessel with the Sun-Treasure is ever sailing with the Wind of the Spirit in the Ocean of Heaven. Occasionally it becomes visible on Earth. But it is ever invisible to those who are too much engaged in the struggle with the waves of the Sea of Samsâra. From the point of view of "the world", blinded by Ahankâric involvements and forgetful of God-Reality, it is "lost" and "hidden".

The symbolism of the Ark of Noah is also of special significance for the Element Fire and the Solar plexus, sphere of the lower mind. For in it all "animals" lived together in harmony and peace, as in Paradise, of which the Ark is but a special form. The Ark of Noah was One Whole, and the Lord was its One Master. It had no watertight compartments like a modern battleship. All ships with watertight compartments go down sooner or later to the bottom of the Sea of Samsâra, but the Ark is the only vessel that does not sink in the floods of the Deluge. It must come to pass, as prophesied by Isaiah (11, 6), that "the wolf shall dwell with the lamb, and the leopard shall lie down with the kid, and the calf and the young lion and the fawn shall feed together, and a little child shall lead them." The "little child" is the Child of the Divine Birth, the Child of God, who has harmonized the elements of his being. In modern India wild animals are said to do no harm to a saint who passes through a jungle. This is the case because he has tamed and harmonized the wild animals within his own soul. He has himself become an Ark, carrying the fruits of harmony and immortality within his Self, an Ark of testimony of Love, Life and Truth.

Sometimes the Ark as Vessel contains a little Child as the Treasure. In the second Chapter of Exodus we read how the mother of Moses 'took for him an ark of bulrushes, and daubed it with slime and with pitch, and

put the child therein; and she laid it in the flags by the river's brink." The same story has been found on Babylonian tablets with reference to King Sargon of Akkad, who lived long before Moses. Sargon and Moses, as well as Manu, Menes, Minos and others to be dealt with later, are all "Law-givers" and are all connected with Pisces and Aries.

The First Plague of Egypt, the turning of the Waters into Blood and the dying of the "fish", presents a perfect contrast to the symbolism of the Ark explained above.

The second plague of Egypt. The Second Plague is an abundance of frogs that come forth from the river and go into the houses, into the bedchambers and upon the beds, and into the troughs and ovens for making bread. They come upon the people and upon the servants. At the request of Pharaoh, the frogs are removed, but they die and the land stinks. This symbolism applies to the second House, Taurus, an Earth-House ruled by Venus, Goddess of the Element Water. The symbolism of frogs has two aspects, referring to either the Downward or the Return Path. One form of Venus in Egypt was that of the Frog-Goddess Heket, born from the Primordial Slime. She presided over birth as well as over Rebirth. For the frog, an amphibious animal, is a symbol of sex and the sexual functions and organs, and of sensuality, in connection with the Mâyâvic Path of involvement in worldliness. But the frog is also a symbol of Rebirth and Resurrection. All frogs sing with gladness when the water of life fertilizes the earth in spring. In Indian tradition frogs are the myrmidons of Indra, the God of Ether, who sends the Heaven-Water to Earth. In Hindu tradition frogs are said to symbolize inspiration, and in Egyptian tradition the frog formed the hieroglyph for the idea of the Resurrection. In that sense it was also adopted by the early Christians in Egypt. But the frogs in the Plague present the lower aspect of the symbolism. They go "into the beds" and into the places where the bread of life is prepared. And they die and stink. Sensuality and its concomitants are the weaknesses of Taurus. In India frogs are associated with fertility and the getting of children. During sexual embrace frogs may cling tightly to each other for hours, days, or, it is said, even weeks. In a temple of Simhâchalam near Vizagapatam is a "Kappa Sthambam". Kappa means both "frog" and "embracing". Barren women who visit this temple place their offerings before this pillar.

The third plague of Egypt.

The Third Plague is that the dust of the land is smitten so that "it became lice in man and in beast, all the dust of the land became lice throughout all the land of Egypt." It refers to man and beast of the mental plane, the Element Fire. In Gemini, the House to which this Plague refers, Fire is represented as the St. Elmus Fire, and as the Fire of the Hearth, of the Goddess Vesta. In this House Fire should take an exalted form, for it is an Air-House ruled by Mercury. But in the Plague the Wind smites the dust of the land and makes it into a pest. Dust consists of innumerable fragments. Lice affect the skin and cause an unbearable itching. The skin is symbolically connected with both the Elements Air and Earth. The "dust of the Earth", caused by the sins of the mind, is an unbearable plague to the spiritual man.

The fourth plague of Egypt.

The Fourth Plague consists of "a grievous swarm of flies" coming "into the house of Pharaoh, and into his servants houses, and into all the land of Egypt the land was corrupted by reason of the swarm of flies." The flies represent the Element Air. They are the unpleasant counterparts of Birds, and the sound of their buzzing is as irritating as their dirty habits are obnoxious to health. Some give painful stings and poisonous bites. They manifest in the "house of Pharaoh", the Ahankâra, and in "the houses" of the people. This symbolism refers to Cancer, the House ruled by the Moon, the Goddess of architecture and society. On the Return Path the Moon Spirit sends her messenger Mercury in the form of a Dove or other White Bird. On the Downward Path the Adversary of Mercury is represented by black flies. The columns adjoining the Ten Plagues of Egypt in Diagram 2 give clues to the significance of these plagues. They will be discussed further in connection with the Ten Commandments. Flies symbolize before all gossip.

The fifth plague of Egypt.

The Fifth Plague is that the cattle of the Egyptians die "The hand of the Lord is upon the cattle which is in the field, upon the horses, upon the asses, upon the camels, upon the oxen, and upon the sheep there shall be a very grievous murrain." The five Animals represent the Five Elements, in the connection shown in Diagram 2, the horses particularly indicating Leo, the asses Cancer, the camels Gemini, the oxen Taurus and the sheep Aries. As we shall see later two-humped Camels are indeed sometimes connected with Gemini, and asses — mill-grinding animals — with Cancer. The cattle of the Israelites are saved, as, indeed, the Israelites are exempt from all the Plagues. The "Egyptians" represent the people under the rulership of the

Ahankâra. The "Israelites" are the Elect, not in the sense of representing any chosen race or nation, though that interpretation has been given to it by later generations of Jews. The original name of Israel as a man of the world and as a Jew was Jacob. Later, after a great spiritual battle (Genesis 32; 24) his name was changed to Israel, that is to say, "a prince", for as a prince he had power with God and with men, and prevailed (32; 28). The man Jacob, the Jew, had risen above ordinary humanity, and above his own race and nation. He became a spiritual universalist, a spiritual leader instead of a mere tribal leader. The "Israelites" of Sons of Israel are the spiritual aspirants and disciples of all the world: the princelings of God — at least in the light of the original tradition — which was revived from time to time. And "they are not all Israel which are of Israel" (Romans 9; 6).

The animals mentioned as the victims of the Fifth Plague are not wild beasts, but domestic animals. They represent the creative and sustaining capacities of man. Their destruction is one of the greatest catastrophes that can overtake a man, even as the death of his cattle on the physical plane is one of the greatest material calamities for a man. The Plague refers to the Element Ether, the Element from which Adam fell, and in which he "died" with his Fall. In this Element the Ahankâra should die, and not the divine creative faculties of man, symbolized by the domestic animals. Symbolically "death" is connected with the Ether, as will be noted in other contexts. Furthermore Leo is a Fire-House, ruled by the Sun. Fire is the Element of the mind, of the "animals".

The sixth
plague of
Egypt.

With this crisis the first set of Plagues ends. The second set begins again with the Element Earth. The Sixth Plague is that the "ashes of the furnace" are "sprinkled towards heaven", and become "small dust in all the land

of Egypt" and "a boil breaking forth with blains upon man, and upon beast". The "furnace" is that of Leo, the Fire House ruled by the Sun. The "ashes" represent the material left over from the fire. It belongs to Earth, and it is sprinkled towards "heaven". The House of Virgo to which this Plague refers, is an Earth-House ruled by Mercury, the Lord of Air or heaven. It is the House in which, if all goes well, the Spirit comes down from on high to the Earth — on the Ladder, the Rainbow-bridge, or on Wings. But the reverse — that the dust of the Earth goes upwards — should not take place. Boils break forth on the skin. It is a skin-affection much worse than that caused by the lice in the Air-House of Gemini, ruled also by Mercury. After the catastrophe of the previous Plague, sickness and disease are bound to follow on all planes, but pre-eminently on the physical.

The seventh plague of Egypt. In the Seventh Plague calamities follow in regard to the Element Water, the plane of the emotional life. The Lord said "I will stretch out my hand, that I may smite thee and thy people with pestilence, and thou shalt be cut off from the earth", and "Stretch forth thine hand toward heaven, that there may be hail in all the land of Egypt, upon man, and upon beast and upon every herb of the field." The Plague refers to the Air-House of Libra ruled by Venus, the Goddess of the emotional plane. This Plague resembles to some extent the second. Water comes down from heaven — for Libra is an Air-Sign — not in the form of fertilizing rain, but in the form of "hail, and fire mingled with it, very grievous." "The hail smote every herb of the field and brake every tree of the field." The Vegetable kingdom, which here suffers so much, represents the Element Water. "The flax and the barley was smitten for the barley was in the ear, and the flax was balled. But the wheat and the rye were not smitten for they were hidden." At the time of Moses the period of Libra fell during (what is now) the month of September. The cotton harvest falls in Upper Egypt in September and October, and in the Delta in October and November. In September the cotton is "balled." In ancient times the same was the case with flax, the predecessor of cotton. At that time there are no wheat and rye. These are sown only in November or December when the period of the flood of the Nile is over and there is spring in Egypt.

As, after every Plague, Moses interceded with the Lord, at the request of Pharaoh, the Plague came to an end, but "when Pharaoh saw that the rain and the hail and the thunders were ceased, he sinned yet more, and hardened his heart, he and his servants."

The eighth plague of Egypt. The Eighth plague is that of locusts which "cover the eye of the earth, that one cannot see the earth and they shall eat the residue of that which is escaped, which remaineth unto you from the hail, and shall eat every tree which groweth for you out of the field." This Plague refers to the Element Fire, the mental plane. It obscures the mental vision. It refers to the Water-House of Scorpio, ruled by Mars, the Lord of the Element Fire. The horse is the Martian animal. Everyone who has carefully observed a locust, closely related to the grasshopper, will have noted the resemblance especially of the head, to the head of a horse. As the black flies are the shadowy reflections of the Bird of Mercury, the locusts are the shadowy reflections of the Horse of Mars. In Job horse and grasshopper are compared (39, 19-20) "Hast thou given the horse strength? hast thou clothed his neck

with thunder? Canst thou make him afraid as a grasshopper? the glory of his nostrils is terrible." In spite of their negative aspect, however, locusts are winged creatures. For they are sent from on high for the punishment of sins. We read that "the East wind" brought them (Exodus 10; 13). The East is the direction ruled by Jupiter. In this particular case it is the direction of Mount Sinai, where Jehovah will manifest himself. The main characteristic of locusts is greed, the "sin" pertaining to the Element Fire. They "steal" and "eat" the fruits of labour and the fruits of the emotional life in particular: "They did eat every herb of the land, and all the fruit of the trees which the hail had left: and there remained not any green thing in the trees, or in the herbs of the field, through all the land of Egypt." Herbs apply more particularly to the emotional plane, and trees to the mental. Green is the colour of spiritual love. A swarm of locusts is a monstrous and disgusting phenomenon, demonstrating the destructive aspect of Mars. It is finally taken away by "a mighty strong West wind" which "cast them into the Red Sea". Ultimately everything, favourable or unfavourable, lands in the Sea, out of which it originally emerged. The Plagues are approaching their end, and that Sea is coming nearer. The wind refers to the Sign to follow.

The word "locust" comes from the Latin *Locusta*, meaning lobster. "Lobster" comes from *lopustre*, a corruption of the same word. The scorpion, from which the House of Scorpio takes its name, has the claws and the form of a lobster. The lobster, as a water animal, is well placed in Scorpio, a Water-House. The scorpion's poisoned sting refers to Mars, the Ruler of this House. Formerly some devices of war were called "scorpions". In old traditions, as we shall have occasion to note, the "scorpion" of Scorpio was often depicted as a lobster.

The ninth plague of Egypt. The Ninth Plague was that "Moses stretched forth his hand toward heaven; and there was a thick darkness in all the land of Egypt". And "they saw not one another, neither rose any from his place for three days: but all the children of Israel had light in their dwellings." This Plague refers to the spiritual plane and the Fire-House of Sagittarius, ruled by Jupiter as Guru. In this House and at this stage there should be Light, as there is indeed in the dwellings of the Elect. Darkness implies ignorance, sin, and fear, or otherwise inner uncertainty and depression. The Martian Fire should become the Guru's Light, if there is to be Birth in the next House. But here the next House is to be one of death. Pharaoh threatens Moses with death: "Get thee from me, take heed to thyself, see my face no more; for in that

day thou seest my face thou shalt die And Moses said, Thou hast spoken well, I will see thy face no more " (10, 28-29) But "death" in the next House is to turn against Pharaoh instead of aiding him The Intermediary of the Divine and the Ahankâra will meet for the last time Moses will lead his chosen ones out of bondage unto liberation Only those who remain in "Egypt" to see again the face of Pharaoh, the Ahankâra, will spiritually go to greater darkness and gloom Their horses will be more hard-mouthed and they will be more hard-hearted and hard-shelled, till another set of Plagues may bring them to their reason and force them to obey God's Ten Commandments

The "darkness" of the Ninth Plague may be either the "darkness" which culminates in the "ghost-hour" found at the top of Diagram 1b, or it may be the "darkness" of a "depression", sometimes even manifesting at advanced stages of the Path It is a "darkness" out of which ultimately the Light is born This "darkness" is a form of conscience

Some of the symbolical implications of the "darkness" of Sagittarius and the "midnight" of Capricorn which follows on it, will be understood from reference to Diagram 1b The "midnight-hour" of Capricorn is the Hour of the Birth of the Sun, the Divine Child, in the "Cave" In connection with the Tenth Plague, however, there is to be not birth, but death, of the child-element in man

The tenth plague of Egypt. The culmination of the Plagues is reached with the Tenth Plague The Lord instructs Moses to let his chosen people collect jewels of silver and jewels of gold to take with them out of Egypt These represent the Treasure of Capricorn and Aquarius And then "saith the Lord, About midnight will I go out into the midst of Egypt and all the first-born in the land of Egypt shall die, from the first-born of Pharaoh that sitteth upon his throne, even unto the first-born of the maid-servant that is behind the (flour) mill, and all the first-born of beasts " The death of the "first-born" is the greatest calamity that can overtake a man It is far worse than "the death of the cattle" It strikes very deep As the death of the cattle occurs in Leo so the death of the first-born occurs in Capricorn Both Houses refer to the Ether Sphere It has already been noted that in Hindu tradition the eldest son performs the rites for a deceased parent, and a man "must have a son, in order to attain liberation", the son represents the element of spiritual birth within a man himself If all goes well on the Path of Return to God, it is another "first-born" which should die, namely the first germ of separation and delusion, the Ahankâra, which is at the root of all sin and

trouble This aspect of the symbolism is also found to some extent in the death of the first-born of Pharaoh

And the Lord spake unto Moses and Aaron, saying "This month shall be unto you the beginning of months it shall be the first month of the year to you " As will be seen later, it is at the very foundation of Hebrew tradition that Capricorn, or the month that corresponds to it, is the first month of the year The Lord then ordains the rite of the paschal lamb The injunction is "Your lamb (or kid) shall be without blemish, a son of a year ye shall take it out from the sheep, or from the goats " It may be a lamb or a kid (Exodus 12, 3, etc) In fact, goat and ram are intimately related Sometimes they represent the mythical "brothers" and sometimes the Houses of Capricorn and Aries Capricorn is "the goat-horned" It is the last of the Ten Houses of Manifestation Aries, the Ram, is the first of these Houses

Unleavened bread. In the twelfth Chapter of Exodus the Lord gives instructions for the rites to be performed in connection with

the first month of the year One of the main injunctions is "Seven days shall ye eat unleavened bread, even the first day ye shall put away leaven out of your house for whosoever eateth leavened bread from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall be cut off from Israel" (12, 15) The "seven days" refer to the entire cycle of the spiritual path through the Zodiac to come, with the stress on the first and seventh day, which are the Day of Capricorn-Aquarius The "bread" is the Bread of Life of Aquarius, as the "blood", referred to later, is the Blood of Capricorn Leaven is a symbol of the Abhankâric transforming influence St Paul uses it "Your glorying is not good Know ye not that a little leaven leaveneth the whole lump Purge out therefore the old leaven, that ye may be a new lump, as ye are unleavened For Christ our passover is slain for us Therefore let us keep the feast, not with old leaven, neither with the leaven of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth " (I Cor 5, 6-8) Aquarius is the stage in which all transformation ends in rest, the same rest out of which it came forth Capricorn-Aquarius is the stage of Rest and Pralaya Therefore the next verse in Exodus is "And in the first day there shall be an holy convocation, and in the seventh day there shall be an holy convocation to you, no manner of work shall be done in them, save that which every man must eat, that only may be done of you "

The blood on the door-posts. Next the Lord gives instructions regarding the killing of the lamb or kid He directs the Elect to take of the animal's blood and to strike it on the two side-posts

and on the upper door-post of the houses, wherein they shall eat it And none is to go out from the door of his house until the morning The blood will be for a token upon the houses, and the Lord will pass over those houses and the Plague shall not be upon them Blood is a symbol of spiritual life In the present context it also denotes spiritual sacrifice The two side-posts of the door symbolize the Elements Water and Fire and the upper door post the Element Air The threshold represents the Earth It is not to be smeared with blood since it is the Earth plane of Capricorn which is symbolically entered upon from the other three Elements

Capricorn is the House of Initiation and the Door of Initiation is connected with the winter solstice After the Door has been marked with the symbol of *life*, the power of *death* cannot approach it The First Plague was one of Blood Here the Blood of the sacrifice is the counter-element to that Blood of sin With the departure of the people of Moses through the Door of Initiation, the focus in the plane of Fire is left, and the Spiritual Wandering begins The focus shifts from the Solar plexus Centre to the Heart Centre as soon as the "animal nature" is sacrificed and the soul becomes aware of its spiritual heritage and begins to strive to gain it by listening intently to the directions of the Spirit and watching intently for the Light

The first month of the year. Moses was instructed by the Lord to make the month Abib the "first month of the year" (12, 2 and 13 4) From the tradition of the Ten Plagues and from other traditions (some of which are to be dealt with later)

it is evident that Abib, the first month, represents the month corresponding to Capricorn In connection with Genesis it can be proved that Capricorn is the "first month" in the earliest known Jewish tradition, long before the time of Moses (see "The Key to the First Chapter of Genesis") Between the tradition to which the first Chapter of Genesis refers and the tradition of Moses lies almost a full cycle of precession of the equinoxes In the time of Moses the precession had almost returned to its starting point This subject will be dealt with at the end of the second Book

In later Jewish tradition the month Abib became the month Nisan During the first Babylonian exile the Jews apparently forgot some of the names of their months — which are still lost to us After the exile they officially adopted the Babylonian names of the months Probably largely because the name "Abib" implied spring (the ancient Egyptian month Epiphi, still called "Ebib" in modern Egypt, corresponded to the Taurus period which then fell in April) they wrongly identified their old month Abib (corresponding to Capricorn, the beginning of the season of spring in Egypt) with the

Assyrian month Ni-sa-an-nu, corresponding to Aries, the beginning of spring after the spring-equinox. This became the new Jewish name "Nisan".

Much confusion arose from the fact that the *names* of the present Jewish months are *Assyrian*, whereas their *place in the calender*, connected with their original traditional meaning, corresponds to the order of the *Egyptian* months. The present month Abib (Av) corresponds to the Egyptian month Epiphi or Ebib. The *name*, however, came from the Assyrian A-bu, as was the case with the names of the other new Jewish months. In this error we have an example of faulty syncretism. It had curious consequences concerning the connection between the Jewish religion and Christianity, as we shall see later.

The Assyrian calender began with Aries, the Jewish calender — according to Genesis and the injunctions of Moses — with Capricorn.

Pesach, the Passover, is quite legitimately called the "Feast of Spring". Only the spring referred to is the Egyptian one, and not that of Palestine or Syria. In connection with the crops mentioned in the verses relating to the Seventh Plague (9; 31-32) we have already noted that the Egyptian spring begins in December, in the middle of the season of sowing. Pesach is also called in Jewish tradition "the Season of our Freedom". It is traditionally in Capricorn that the liberation of the soul is begun and also attained — quite apart from any historical exodus from Egypt — and this liberation is attained by passing through the Door of Initiation, the Gate of the Sun, the Door which opens by the Virgin-Birth.

The reference to the "first-born" in the Tenth Plague has typical Capricornian implications. The contrast between the *death* of the first-born, applying to the Fall, and the *birth* of the first-born (Christ), referring to the Return, should be noted.

The Civil New Year.	The Egyptian New Year began with the month Tahuti, representing the first month of the inundation of the Nile and corresponding to Cancer. The Jewish New Year begins with the month Tishri — the <i>name</i> of which comes from the Assyrian Tash-ri-tu, but the order of tradition of which corresponds to the Egyptian Tahuti. It does not originally correspond to Libra, but to Cancer. Tishri is the month of the birth of the Patriarchs. It will be shown later that this "birth" is traditionally connected with the summer-solstice in several religions.
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The month of Tishri, called Ethannm in the original Jewish tradition, is the first month of the "civil" year. Its first day opens the Civil Year — connected with the height of involvement in "the world" — while the

first day of Nisan or Abib opens the Spiritual Year. The two New Year's days are connected with the two solstices.

The first of Tishri is the "civil" New Year's day, and the first of the "Ten Solemn Days", which form the season of Divine Judgment and Divine Grace. These Ten Days, like the Ten Commandments and the Ten Plagues, refer to the Ten Houses of Manifestation. Their season in the year falls in the period which represents the Height of Manifestation in the Zodiac. Later this will be explained at greater length. The last of the Ten Solemn Days is the Day of Atonement, Yomkippur, literally the day of the "wiping out" of sins. It represents the Tenth House, Capricorn. Of old the "scapegoat" — the goat of "Capricorn" — was sent out on that day. On the same day the High Priest pronounced the holy four-lettered Name of God YHVH, during a solemn sacrificial service in the Temple. The pronouncing of the Name of God on the physical plane refers to what is also called the "Birth of the Word", which happens in Capricorn, the House of the Divine Birth. It should be noted that Jehovah (YHVH) is the Enlightener, God of the Ether-Sphere. The festival of the Capricornian Birth of the Word is celebrated in the month corresponding to Cancer, the House of the Voice. The Voice of Tradition speaks about the Birth of the Word. Cancer is ruled by the Moon — here in the aspect of Virgin-Mother, giving birth to the Word of God. The Ten Solemn Days recapitulate, as it were, the symbolic mysteries connected with the Ten Houses of Manifestation.

The "wiping out" of sins, connected with Yomkippur, corresponds to the Baptism in the river Jordan, of Christianity. Both mysteries apply to the Water-House of Cancer.

The number ten is encountered also in other contexts, as (in Exodus 12, 2-3) "In the tenth day of this month they shall take to them every man a lamb".

The sacrificial lamb or kid When the real meaning of the original traditions had been lost, later generations began to confuse and misinterpret much of them. The sacrifice of the lamb or the kid belongs to Capricorn. But it is done in order to undo or make amends for the "original" slaying of the Lamb or Shepherd, which caused the Fall. The Goat which killed the Ram must be killed by way of expiation and for atonement. By its death — the death of the Power of Darkness — the Lamb can attain to Resurrection in his own House, Aries, at the time of Spring. In regard to this mystery — which will be dealt with at length on a more suitable occasion — it should be kept in mind that the Paths of

the Fall and of the Return move in opposite directions. The entire mystery is contained in the commemoration of the "passover" between Good Friday and Easter, as will be seen later.

Let us return to the Jewish Passover. The Lord gave the following instructions for the eating of the sacrificial lamb, at the last moment before the departure from the land of Egypt. "And thus shall ye eat it; with your loins girded, your shoes on your feet, and your staff in your hand; and ye shall eat it in haste: it is the Lord's passover." At this juncture on the Path the greatest watchfulness should be observed and the Elect should be completely *ready* — to start on the great pilgrimage of the Spirit, provided with the girdle of self-control and the wand and sandals of Mercury.

The beginning of the spiritual path. After the Tenth Plague Pharaoh at last sent the Israelites out of Egypt, and they departed. They formed a great multitude, accompanied by flocks and herds. The

fragments of a tradition, which had passed the test, had been collected, or re-collected, and left the field ruled by the Ahankâra, to begin the return journey to the Promised Land, the Land of Origin. After they had departed, Pharaoh made yet another effort to recapture them and bring them again under his dominion. But the host of the Egyptians found its death in the Red Sea. It was caused, as Moses and Israel sang unto the Lord, by "the blast of thy nostrils" (15; 8). Aquarius is an Air-House. "Thou didst blow with thy wind, the sea covered them: they sank as lead in the mighty waters." (15; 10). For on the Pilgrimage the Spirit of the Lord protects and guides the people, whether as Wind, or as a "pillar of a cloud" by day and a "pillar of fire to give them light by night. The pillar represents the Spiritual Pole. The "waters" of the Red Sea in which the "Egyptians" found their death are, for them, the waters of the Sea of Samsâra, and for the Elect, the waters of the Ocean of Aquarius. The Israelites passed unhurt through the Waters of Samsâra or worldliness. (Historically, they passed through the Reed sea or Papyrus sea which in antiquity was considered to be part of the Red sea). During the spiritual pilgrimage the Ahankâra appears in more subtle and less despotic forms than in Pharaoh.

When the children of Israel are undergoing all kinds of hardships during their wanderings, they look back many a time to the, "fleshpots of Egypt" And so it is with many an aspirant and pilgrim

The Wilderness. After leaving Egypt, "God led the people about, through the way of the wilderness of the Red Sea." As will be shown later, the beginning-stage of the Path — in Capri-

corn, and secondarily in Aquarius — is traditionally one of "darkness", "wilderness", "chaos" Only at the very end of the Path is the same stage revealed to be Paradise As it is in the myth under consideration, the children of Israel have only just emerged from the "moral stage" and entered the spiritual pilgrimage Aquarius is not yet the promised land They have to go through another cycle before it will become so Aquarius is as yet a desert, for the Water of Life has not yet been found The Israelites had a great thirst, and they could not find any water but "the bitter water" of Marah (15, 23) But they were vouchsafed just a glimpse of the Water of Life, though not in its Undivided Form, but as referring to all Twelve Houses, for "they came to Elim, where were twelve wells of water, and threescore and ten palm trees and they encamped there by the waters" (15, 27) The word "Elim" means "Gods" Aquarius is in many traditions the House of "all the Gods" The numbers 12 and 10×7 imply completeness in time and the space of the Spheres

The Bread of Life.

In the wilderness of Sin the Israelites suffered much from hunger, and the Lord said to Moses "Behold, I will rain bread from heaven for you (Exodus 16, 4)" The bread of life came down from heaven in the form of Manna (16, 15) 'And the children of Israel did eat manna forty years, until they came to a land inhabited, they did eat manna, until they came unto the borders of the land of Canaan' (16, 35) The forty years represent a full cycle of Manifestation (The number 40 is dealt with in the second Book) Before the Manna came down, the children of Israel "looked toward the wilderness and, behold, the glory of the Lord appeared in the cloud" The Manna was found "when the dew that lay was gone" Cloud and dew and bread of life are, as will be seen later, typical symbols of the Air-House of Aquarius These occurrences took place in "the second month after their departing out of the land of Egypt" After that the pilgrimage passed to the House of Pisces, ruled by Jupiter Jupiter's Mountain is represented by Mount Horeb When the people were thirsting for water, Moses produced water by striking the rock of the mountain with his rod (17, 6) Pisces is a Water House, ruled by the Lord of the Ether The rod or wand of Mercury is the intermediary, for upward and downward movements, between the higher and the lower worlds After that the children of Israel were attacked for the first time, by the Amalekites Amalek represents the first form of the Ahankâra to trouble the wanderers on the spiritual Path to the Promised Land Though Pisces is, as yet, a House "pre-natal" to Manifestation, its

negative aspect is great, as will be observed in connection with other myths and traditions

Spiritual support During the fight of the Israelites with the Amalekites Moses stood "on the top of the Hill (Horeb) with the rod of God" in his hand (17, 9) "And it came to pass when Moses held up his hand, that Israel prevailed and when he let down his hand, Amalek prevailed" But his hands were heavy, and had to be supported by Aaron and Hur, "and his hands were steady until the going down of the sun" (17, 11, 12) Victory in a spiritual fight can only be attained if the hands are stretched unto heaven, and if no weariness overtakes the pilgrim In the traditional attitude of prayer the hands were uplifted, If a spiritual task is beyond the power of a man, he may be supported by companions, those "who eat bread with him" The rod of the Spirit, moreover, should point upwards for victory The memorial altar which Moses built in that place he called Jehovah-nissi, that is, "The Lord is my banner" The banner is a symbol of Air

The eagle of Aquarius Next follows a Chapter in which Moses "chose able men out of all Israel, and made them heads over the people, rulers of thousands, rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens" (18, 25) for matters of judgment Pisces is a House in which rulership and matters of law are arranged for the cycle of Manifestation to come With that the scene is set for the Revelation "In the third month" after the departure from Egypt the children of Israel came to the wilderness of Sinai It is the opening of the year of Manifestation corresponding to Aries, the first of the Ten Houses Previously three stages in the contact of Moses with the Lord have been mentioned Now Moses passes from the spiritual stage to the phase of Guru "Moses went up unto God, and the Lord called unto him out of the Mountain saying thus shalt thou tell the children of Israel Yehaveseen what I did unto the Egyptians, and how I bare you on eagle's wings, and brought you unto myself" (19, 3-4) In the last sentence the two previous stages are referred to The 'eagle's wings' relate to the stage of Air or Spirit The Eagle is the Bird that is sacred to Jupiter It is found in the Eagle winged Odinn and in Garuda, the vehicle of Vishnu The Eagle is an Animal form of Mercury as special servant of Jupiter He is the Psukhopompos, the Guide of souls he is the "angel of the Lord, who went before the camp", and brought the children of Israel to Mount Sinai the Mountain of Jupiter Jehovah In

Ezekiel (1, 10) and the Revelation of St John (4 7) the Eagle refers to Aquarius

The communion of Moses with the Lord took place on the Top of Mount Sinai. It is Piscean in nature, since it is connected with law giving and pertains to the visionary and that which is strictly hidden from the people. Jupiter, Lord of the Ether and the Mountain-top, is the Ruler of Pisces. When the Revelation comes down to the people, however, it refers to Anes in that it is articulated and takes a visible form meant to be understood by everyone.

The first among men After the last words quoted above, the Lord says on the Mountain-top to Moses "If ye will obey my voice indeed, and keep my covenant, then ye shall be a peculiar treasure unto me above all people for all the earth is mine and ye shall be unto me a kingdom of priests, and an holy nation" (19, 5 6). These words strongly confirm the observation, made before, that there is here question of universal sacred tradition and spiritual competency and not of racialism or nationalism. The 'kingdom of priests' is that which is found in "all the earth". It is the antithesis of "the kingdom of this world", the realm of greed, lust, anger, jealousy and delusion, ruled by the Ahankāra. In the verse quoted, the Voice is clearly the Tradition.

It has happened very often in the world's history, that at times when true tradition has been forgotten and established tradition has degenerated the tradition of the "Elect" has been explained in the sense of a "Herren volk" instead of in the sense of "servants of God and Man". Actually there is a complete contrast between the two conceptions. The temporal one implies privileges and monopolies, the spiritual one implies hardships and troubles, for "the Lord chastises those he loves". Israel was a "prince among men". This means "first" among men. Originally the rulers of the human race, princes or kings, became rulers by virtue of superior spiritual qualities. They were, above all, "rulers of themselves", as can be understood from the ancient traditions of the world, among which, in this respect those of the Chinese stand out. In this connection the traditional origin of the word "King" is interesting. It is found in the old North European Lay of Rígh, which describes how the God Heimdall, the White, who is a form of Mercury, was the father of the three classes of men: the Thralls, the Carles (in English Churls) and the Iarls (in English Earls). These correspond to the three lower Varnas or "natural classes" of Hindu tradition. The "youngest" of the Iarls was called Konr (in English Kin). He was not at all like the others and had no interest in knightly pursuits. Instead

11	BEST											1	11
12	Undertaking											2	12
13	10 P.											3	13
14												4	14
15												5	15
16												6	16
17	ISSUED SUBJECT TO UNCERTAINTY'S RULES AND REGULATIONS											7	17
18	HOURS											8	18
19	7	8	9	10	11							9	19
20	12	13	14	15	16							10	20
21	17	18	19	20	21							11	21
22	22	CH	SP	SUN	MON							12	22
23	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	STA	DOWN						

, everlasting mysteries, mysteries of life, he knew how to blunt the edges (of swords), and how to still language of the birds, how to quench fire, to stay and to allay sorrows." There is no need to stress the powers. This man was called Konr-ungr or "Kin-e prototype of the "King". Why the "first" should youngest", becomes clear when it is seen that this Return Path to God. Konr-ungr was the youngest ce is in Capricorn, which is also the place of Kronos st of the Twelve Primordial Titans, who was also Etymologically "King" is derived from the Gothic e", and related to the Latin "genus". ie Lord to "his Elect" precedes the Revelation of

d. THE SYMBOLISM OF THE SACRED MOUNTAIN

The sacred Mountain.

The Sacred Mountain is found in traditions all over the world. From the point of view of the pilgrim whose path ascends to its summit, the Mountain symbolizes the Human Universe. The Top of the Mountain is the Realm of Jupiter Guru. It extends into the Ether. Universally known are Mount Olympus ruled by Zeus, and Mount Pelion, ruled by Cheiron as Guru. In Hebrew tradition there are several sacred Mountains. Apart from Horeb or Sinai, there are Zion, Carmel and Gerizim, the sacred Mountain of the Samaritans. In Hindu tradition there are a large number of sacred Mountains, the most important, apart from the purely mythical Meru, being Arunâchala in South-India and Kailâsa in the Himâlayas. Every one of these Mountains has, apart from the universal aspect of its traditions, its special traditions, in connection with particular Elements of existence, in relation to geographical and cultural characteristics. Foremost in Japanese tradition is sacred Fujiyama. In Java is found the Smeru Mountain, derived from the Hindu Su-meru. The latter two mountains are volcanoes Their top is fire-bearing and shining, which is symbolically appropriate for the Ether. The Greek "aitho", from which "ether" has been derived, means "shining". Volcanoes hide the Martian Fire, which, like the Thunderbolt, can be thrown down for the purpose of destruction. The Chinese sacred Mountain, Omei Shan, is "the Hill that reaches Heaven". In European tradition is found Mountsalvat, "the Mountain of Salvation," on which resides the King who guards the Holy Grail. In Crete the Mountain of Zeus was Mount Ida.

The summit of Central Asia has its traditions of a great White Mountain, the Mountain. where the Tradition is carefully guarded from the profane for whom the place is inaccessible — as is the case with Montsalvat The Top of the Sacred Mountain, where the Treasure of the Tradition, the Bread of Life, Self-Realization, is preserved in all eternity, is accessible only to the Elect of the Elect, the Sons of God For others its ascent means death "Take heed to yourselves, that ye go not up into the mount, or touch the border of it whosoever toucheth the mount shall he surely put to death" (Exodus 19, 12) This does not mean that he will be killed by human agency because he has committed sacrilege The meaning is much deeper It has been observed before how "death" is connected with the Ether-Sphere The Ahankâra should be utterly overcome and the Fall undone, before the consciousness of man can see the glory of the Ether-Light. For uninitiated humanity, struggling with the Mâyâ of the world, that Sphere can only be, and actually is, reached, after death, in the literal sense of the world But since during their lifetime "uninitiated" people have not "developed the eyes to see" and their consciousness is in the bondage of the lower planes, they will dwell in the Ether in complete unconsciousness — in a state of death indeed If heaven is not gained here and now, it will never be gained in a "hereafter". The Sons of God, however, live perpetually "on the Mountain-top", in Paradise, the Kingdom of Heaven, whether they happen to be "here" or "there" Muslim tradition knows the White Mountain or Mountain of Qâf, also called the Mountain of the Saints On its summit is said to be a Garden where lives that small part of mankind which has never lost its original sanctity It lives in the Paradise state The envoys who are sent out from there to the outer world are called the Solitary Ones Their head is Al-Khidr, whose meeting with Moses is recited in the Koran in the Sûra of the Cave (64) Al-Khidr has previously been seen to represent the Lord of the Spirit His messengers are the angelic manifestations and incarnations of the Spirit, which have been mentioned before They are intermediaries between the higher and the lower worlds, and aid the man of the Fall to return to the Garden on the Mountain-top, where he can regain communion with God, and communion with Humanity through God in the "community of saints" It is the Great White Lodge

Hyperboreans Greek tradition had the myth of the existence of the
and Hyperboreans, people perpetually living in Golden Age
Uttarakurus. conditions "far in the North", in everlasting "sunshine"
 The North is the direction of the North-pole, symbol of
 the Immovable Centre of the All, the Immortal and Unchanging Reality

beyond the changing realm of Manifestation, turning with the cycles. That happy land was said to be ruled by Saturn; it refers to the House of Aquarius, ruled by Saturn on the Day-throne, or rather to the Immortal Abode to which Aquarius is the Gate. The North-pole forms the symbolic extension of the summit of the sacred Mountain.

That Golden Age Northland is mentioned in Hindu tradition in several forms. The perfect beings who dwell there are called the Northern Kurus. In the Rāmāyana (Kishkindhā-kānda 44; 82) we read: "Go to those illustrious Northern Kurus, who are liberal, prosperous, perpetually happy, and undecaying. In their country there is neither cold nor heat, nor decrepitude, nor disease, nor grief, nor fear, nor rain, nor sun." And also (Kishkindhā-kānda 43; 38): "There are the Northern Kurus and the abodes of those who have performed works of merit". In the Mahābhārata there are several references to it. A Sage who had a marvellous vision, exclaimed (Anusāsanaparva 2811): "I have attained, even in my embodied condition, to the heavenly state: or to the Northern Kurus; or to Amarāvati!" Amarāvati is the City of the Gods, ruled by Indra, Jupiter. Arjuna, arriving at the land of the Northern Kurus, was addressed thus (Mahābhārata, Sabhā-parva 1045): "Thou canst not, son of Pritha, subdue this city. Refrain, fortunate man, for it is completely secure. He who shall enter this city must be certainly more than man . . . Nor is there anything here which thou canst conquer. Here are the Northern Kurus, whom no one attempts to assail. And even if thou shouldst enter, thou couldst behold nothing. For no one can perceive anything here with human senses." On the Mountain-top, the Sphere of Ether, is perfect security from the Ahankāric attacks of the world below, for it is the realm of "sanctuary". The temples and churches of all traditions were not built on mountain-tops just because of the fine view. From them the soul has an "all-round" view of "the world below", dwarfed to insignificance by the height. He enjoys pure Air and lives with the Eagles circling around the summit, taking his delight in the Sun and the Moon and the Stars.

In Sanskrit the Northern Kurus are the Uttarakuru. Ptolemy (VI; 16) was acquainted with this tradition, speaking of a mountain, a people, and an abode called Ottorokorra.

Some references go even deeper than those quoted above, pointing to the Moon-Sphere and Sun-Sphere beyond the Ether-Sphere. In the Rāmāyana (Kishkindhā-kānda 43; 54) we read: "Beyond that chief of Mountains (in the land of the Northern Kurus) is the Northern Ocean. There in its centre is the great golden Soma-giri". Soma-giri means "the Mountain of the Moon". Soma is, moreover, the Lunar Elixir of Life. The text continues: "That region, though sunless, shines by the lustre of that Mountain, and

is recognizable by a sunlike splendour, as if the sun were shining. There the divine Soul of the World, Śambhu, one, but tenfold, Brahmâ, dwells, the God of Gods, attended by the Rishis. You must by no means go beyond the Kurus". Brahmâ, the Creator, is the "tenfold one". In one tradition the Chariot of Soma, the Moon, is drawn by ten horses. Śambhu is Śiva, the Static Aspect of Divinity in the Duality of the Moon-Sphere. A further verse (Kishkindhâ-kânda 44, 117) says "Beyond the Kurus to the North lies the Ocean, and there the vast Soma-Mountain is situated, resembling a mass of gold". And the injunction is given (in the Kishkindhâ-kânda 44, 121-122) "You must not travel to the North of the Kurus. That region is untrodden by the steps of other living beings also. For that Soma-Mountain is difficult of access even to the Gods themselves."

When a spiritual aspirant has passed the lesser Mysteries and approaches the greater Mysteries, he is strongly warned not to strive too high, not to be swayed by spiritual ambition, not to let subtler desires come into the place of the cruder ones he has overcome. The dangers of errors in relation to the Moon-Sphere are terrible, as will be seen elsewhere. The warning given by the Lord on Sinai has already been quoted. It was repeated at a later stage (Exodus 19, 21), when "the Lord said to Moses, Go down, charge the people, lest they break through to gaze unto the Lord, and many of them perish." And the Lord said "Let the priests also, which come near to the Lord, sanctify themselves, lest the Lord break forth upon them." How much more will these warnings apply to the Moon-Sphere!

The Mountains and Lakes of the Moon. In Hebrew tradition Mount Sinai, the Ether Mountain in the Wilderness, ranks lower than the Mountains of the Moon — as they might be called — in the Promised Land, especially Mount Zion, identified with the "Heavenly Jerusalem", the Moon-Sphere Paradise.

The "*Mountains of the Moon*" are found in many traditions. In Africa there are the Mountains of the Moon, where the source of the Nile is found.

There, on the roof of Africa, is the great lake, now called Victoria Nyanza.

The symbolism of the Lake and the River of Life refers to the Water of Life of the Moon-Sphere. In Western Tibet, not far from the boundary of India, is found the sacred Manasarovar Lake, about which a traveller has written "Wonderful, attractive, enchanting lake! Theme of story and legend, playground of storms and changes of colour, apple of the eye of gods and men, goal of weary, yearning pilgrims, holiest of the holiest of all the lakes, art thou, Tsomavang (Soma-vang), lake of all lakes. Navel of old Asia, where four of the most famous rivers of the world, the Brahma-

putra, the Indus, the Sutlej and the Ganges rise among the gigantic peaks, surrounded by a world of mountains, among which is Kailâs, the most famous in the world, for it is sacred in the eyes of hundreds of millions of Hindus, and is the centre of a wreath of mountains where every morning blasts of conches sound out from the roofs over the lake. Axle and hub of the wheel, which is an image of life, and round which the pilgrims wander along the way of salvation towards the land of perfection. That is Manasarovar, the pearl of all the lakes of the world." The Vishnu Purâna (II; Ch. 8) has the following symbolism: "Springing from the Moon on the summit of Mount Meru, the sacred river runs towards the four quarters of the world, purifying them. The Sitâ, the Alakanandâ, the Chakohu and the Bhadria are its four arms."

In Genesis we also read of four rivers which came down from Eden (2; 10-14). The very words "Eden" and "Adam" have been said to be related to the Sanskrit words "adhan", meaning "home", "âdi" and "adim", meaning "first, original". The tradition of the Garden of Eden, however, is focussed geographically in Armenia and Kurdistan, a country divided at the time this is written into four sections, namely a Persian, a Russian, a Turkish and an Iraqi part. The four rivers, namely the Euphrates, the Tigris, the Zab (Pison) and the Araxes spring from the Elburz Mountains near Lake Van. Symbolically the four rivers in the different traditions represent the Four Elements of Manifestation.

The sacred region of the Himâlayas is called "the roof of the world", as the Moon-Sphere is, much more appropriately, the roof of the Heavens. The symbolism of the Himâlayas is so "universal" that it exercises the greatest fascination on the minds of people throughout the world. Hinduism, which has been nourished by it for ages at its very feet, is the most universal and least exclusive tradition in existence. The grandness of the Himâlayan landscape seems to be a powerful counter-influence against religious pettiness and narrow-mindedness. The universality of the glories of the Moon-Sphere and of the Himâlayan Roof of the World is, however, one which pertains rather to the higher and exalted realms of consciousness than to the everyday-forms of consciousness from which these are hidden.

And so it happened that the Blessed Sister Catherine Emmerich, isolated in the midst of early Christian Europe, could have visions in which she was transported to that world. Father Schmaeger, who wrote down what the saint dictated, recites: "In the second week of Advent she was guided . . . on to the highest summit of a mountain which is found in Tibet and which is also completely inaccessible. She saw there, guarded by Elias, the treasures of all the divine traditions communicated to mankind by the angels

and the prophets since the beginning of the world" In the saint's own words he wrote "High on the mountain was a great plain and in that plain a lake, and in the lake a verdant island It seemed to me that that entire part of the world received from there salvation and benediction I had a lively impression of the sanctity of that place It seemed to me that with that water the salvation of several epochs had descended to the valleys and that men themselves had come from those mountains, whence they had descended ever lower and sunk ever deeper I also felt that the heavenly presences were there maintained, guarded, purified, prepared in advance for mankind A little lower I saw a very great river It was the same watercourse which I had seen descending from the great mountain a large number of people of brown complexion, men, women and children were engaged in drinking and bathing on the rocks and the small islands They had come from very far They had something in their manner which reminded me of what I had seen on the banks of the Jordan in the Holy Land It is by virtue of the water which is found on the summit that all things are refreshed and renewed We all know each other, we all hold one to another I am not very good at expressing it, but we are like seed spread out in the entire world I had already seen earlier, how Elias lives perpetually on this mountain, in a garden, before paradise She also saw Elias presenting leaves and books pertaining to revelations of St John She then saw a source, like a great fountain, spring up from a white cloud, "in the form of a ray of crystalline appearance, which at its summit divided itself into innumerable rays and drops, which fell down forming immense waterfalls reaching to the most distant regions of the earth and I saw men illumined by these rays in the houses, in the huts in the towns of different parts of the world"

St John, mentioned by the Blessed Catherine, had seen the wonders of the Moon-Sphere "And he carried me away in the spirit to a great and high mountain, and shewed me that great city, the holy Jerusalem, descending out of heaven from God, having the glory of God and her light was like unto a stone most precious, even like a jasper stone, clear as crystal (Revelation 21 10-11) "And he shewed me a pure river of water of life clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of God and of the Lamb" (22, 1)

Having and being After having had a distant glimpse of the glories of the Moon Sphere, the soul must come down to work out its salvation in the worlds which it inhabits, to which it is habituated, to which it leans by habitude, which form the habit or veil of its essence It is significant that these words, intimately related in meaning, have been

derived from the Latin *habere*, *habit*, meaning "to have", a related word. *Habit* means also dress. It is that "which one has" and refers to the Veils of *Mâyâ*. To pierce the Veils of *Mâyâ* and rise to the glories of the Moon-Sphere, one should renounce "having", whatever form it may take, gross or subtle. Instead of having there should be Being. Instead of being dressed in the habits or Veils of *Mâyâ*, one should go forward naked: utterly possessionless. Even the creeds, theories and beliefs of the world of Manifestation should be discarded.

After a glimpse of Heaven, the habits of life again draw man down to his habitual spheres. The tendencies within his soul, called in Hinduism *vrittis* and *vāsanās*, reassert themselves. But he comes down feeling a new man, with greater faith and strength to take up the Battle of Life: the subjection of the rebellious powers of the lower man.

19. SYMBOLISM CONNECTED WITH THE LOWER MIND

The symbolism of giants. The Mountain, the Summit of which is ruled by Jupiter, is a symbol of the Manifested Universe, and refers particularly to the Element, the symbolic dimension of which is "height": the Element Fire. Mountain symbolism, and all that is connected with it, has particular reference to the Sphere of the Solar plexus. One of the main concomitants of the Mountain is the Giant. Tales of Giants, found in all traditions, are generally connected with Mountains. To give an example, in Norse mythology the Giants are called the *Ioten*. Their "home" was traditionally the *Iotenheimer*, the chain of mountains stretching from the South to the North in Norway. In the Zodiac *Iotenheim* has its place in Leo, as also the chain of the *Himālayas*, as will be observed elsewhere. In Cancer, too, giants are found, but they are of a different nature, pertaining to *Mâyâ*, to the Moon and the Astral Plane, whilst the giants of Leo refer to the Sun of the Moon-Sphere and to the Element Fire. In Roman tradition *Titānius* was the Sun-God.

The field of the Giants is the Sphere of the Solar plexus. We have previously seen that the Siddhi or Achievement of the Solar plexus and the Element Fire is *Mahimā* or "Greatness". It takes greatness to overcome a Giant, a power of magnitude of the lower mind. In the fairy-tales the Giants are represented as "big eaters" — which symbolism leads to the "stomach" and "gluttony" or "greed". They like to "eat a whole ox", and are especially fond of "human flesh", e.g. the *Titans* who consumed *Dionūsos*, the Cyclop *Poluphemos* in the myth of *Odysseus*, the Giant in the story of *Sindbad the Sailor*, the Giant in the tale of *Tom Thumb*, and many others. The

Sphere of Fire, the "mental" plane, is the world of "man" pre-eminently, in the Indian and European traditions. The modern world is full of dangerous, man-eating Ogres, if one has the eyes to see. In the old Norse *Alviss Mal* it is mentioned that the Giants call Fire by the name of *Frakan* or "greedy" and wood by the name of *Elldi* or "firewood."

It is a gigantic task to overcome the monstrous *Tuphoes* or *Tuphon*, raging like a fiery whirlwind — still found to some extent in the "typhoon" — who rebelled against the Gods, and was struck by the Thunderbolt of Zeus-Jupiter, and bound under the *Etna* in Sicily, "in a lake of fire and brimstone." In order to overcome the Giant of immoral greed it is necessary to follow the Ten Commandments. For Ogres and Giants cannot be put down by their own powers and methods, except perhaps on the physical plane. On the Plane of Fire, their own realm, they should be fought only by means of the weapons of the higher planes — those of the Spirit and of the Guru.

Jupiter comes down from his Mountain-peak to battle with the Giants — born from the blooddrops of *Uranus* — and the Titans in the Sphere of the Solar plexus. *Indra* comes down there to battle with his adversary *Asura Vritra*, and *Thor* to fight with the Giants.

Dilaceration and flesh-eating. The "flesh-eating" of the Giants has several implications, as has been mentioned elsewhere. One is, that the inner mental greeds feed on man's flesh on the physical plane, causing sickness and disease. Medical science should again become, as it was in ancient traditions, a sub science of psychology, which in its turn should be a sub-science of sacred tradition. In ancient times the functions of the priest, as pastor and magician, of the astrologer, of the psychologist and dream explainer, and of the physician were generally combined in one person, or, if this was not the case, the various persons discharging these functions worked in close co-operation. In the course of the ages, as a result of the progressive — or rather regressive — "schizophrenia" of humanity, the tendency to "watertight compartment" fragmentation of the soul and of everything, the representatives of these various sciences have drifted further and further away from each other and from the traditional ideal of unity and harmony. A new race of priests, symbologists, astrologers, psychologists and physicians, working in close co-operation with one another, and looking to the Guru for enlightenment, will have to re-collect, reconstruct, heal and resurrect Man, first within themselves, and as a result of that in the world around them. That new race has already been born and has started to work on its gigantic task.

It is at heart the same task as that of vanquishing the Giants and of obeying the Ten Commandments. It has to proceed to its appointed end, if Man is to attain Peace and Bliss, unshakable, indestructible, immutable, eternal, in the Realm whence he once came, the Paradise and the Heavenly City of the Moon-Sphere.

The "eating of human flesh" by the Giants refers in the first place to the Ahankâric cannibalism which is so common in "ordinary" life and which is so largely excused under the motto "struggle for existence". On the physical plane murder is punished promptly enough, after the verdict has been pronounced. Murder or assault on the emotional and mental planes are, however, not generally punished if they do not reach expression on the physical plane. Such deeds are left to the Avengers on the inner planes within the soul. The Furies were born, like the Giants, from the blood-drops of Uranus.

The Battle in the field of the Solar plexus Centre.	But besides "murder" or "assault", there are a number of Adversaries to be overcome in the Sphere of the Solar plexus, the animal mind. They are Greed, Disgust, Fear, Anger, Hate, Pride, Lust for Power, Lust for Revenge, and a host of subtler ones.
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It is in connection with the Battle of Life focussed in the Solar plexus Centre that Mars assumes the aspect of God of War. For a purified and pacified soul he takes the form of the God of Fire in the service of the Spirit, either as the God of Spring, or as Vesta, the Goddess of the Fire of the Hearth, or as Vulcan, the God of Construction and the Divine Artisan of the Gods. These aspects will be dealt with later. They have special reference to the Elements and Houses of the Zodiac.

In several traditions the Solar plexus Centre is described as the "Battle field". In the North-European tradition it is called Vigrid. It is the Field where the Battle of the "Twilight of the Gods" takes place. In Hindu tradition it is the "Kurukshetra" where the Battle took place to which the Bhagavad Gîtâ was the introductory teaching given by the Guru. Kurukshetra means "the field of the Kurus". These Kurus are not the Northern Kurus previously mentioned, but the Southern Kurus, whose task in life it is to fight against unrighteousness and evil. The Southern Kurus, symbolically, are those who originally "had come down from those mountains whence they had descended ever lower and sunk ever deeper". This indicates the Fall of man. Ultimately, after the re-attainment of Peace, they are bound Northwards, to rejoin their brethren, the Northern Kurus,

in their Paradise of Communion In the Zodiac the Battlefield is in particular the Fire-House of Sagittarius, watched over by Jupiter as Guru

The battle with the Giant is one against great odds For the powers which the Giant represents are old and habitual ones They have been allowed to grow almost unchecked, because they are generally so much hidden from perception Unnoticed they develop, till one day the soul discovers that they have assumed vast proportions And the worst of it is that the element in the soul which has to fight them is as yet young and small The spiritual aspirant is "the youngest son" He has only recently been born into his heritage

The little man Though young and small in appearance, however, the of the Spirit. Spirit is well able to look after its own interests and hold its own against the powers of the plane below it For it does not depend, like them, on its own strength, but draws its strength from higher Spheres Its feats are truly surprising and miraculous, from the point of view of the world The deeds of Mercury, immediately after his birth, have been studied before Hercules throttled a couple of Serpents in his cradle Krishna did the same, in fact, he overcame, already in his early youth, several Monsters that came to kill him In this connection one should remember that Mercury is "the Immortal Youth", a Kumâra One has to become a Child to find the Kingdom of Heaven Childhood is the state nearest to the Ether-Sphere, the Origin and the Goal Spiritually advanced souls naturally manifest their greatness already as children In every tradition, especially among Hindus and Buddhists, there are parallels to the story of the boy Jesus, sitting in the midst of the doctors in the Temple and astonishing them by his wisdom (St Luke 2, 42-49)

The newly manifesting Spirit is often symbolized not only as a Baby but as a Dwarf, or rather as a small man Dwarfs and kobolds are human beings in their generally insignificant physical plane aspect The Dwarf of the Spirit is, on the other hand, a truly striking personage In a number of myths, legends and fairy-tales from all parts of the world the Giant of the Mental Plane is overcome by the Little Man of the Spirit In I Samuel Chapter 17 we read how David, the youngest son of Jesse, slew Goliath, after he had said unto him "Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield but I come to thee in the name of the Lord of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou has defied This day will the Lord shut thee up, and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee, and I will give the carcases of the host of the Philistines thus day unto the fowls of the air and to the wild beasts of the earth, that all

the earth may know that there is a God in Israel." Every word refers to a victory of the Spirit over the powers of the lower mind, whose "head" is taken away, and whose body becomes the food of Birds and Beasts.

In European folklore there is the fairy-tale of Tom Thumb or Little Thumb and the Giants. He was also the youngest son. His story is full of interesting symbolism.

The Thumbling is found in all traditions. In Alchemi he was called the Homunculus. He is often referred to in the Upanishads. For instance the Kathopanishad (IV; 12) states: "The Purusha (Man) of the size of a thumb, resides in the middle of the body (âtmani) as the Lord of the past and future, (he who knows him) fears no more." This "Man of the size of a thumb" is also said to reside "in the heart", that is to say, in the Centre of the Spirit.

But, though he resides in the Heart Centre, he represents the Lord of that Heart, the Quintessence of the Spirit, and is, from different points of view, the forerunner, the representative, the reflection, or the pre-natal stage of the Divine Child of the Ether-Sphere. The symbolism of the thumb has been noted before. The four fingers represent the Four Elements and the thumb the Ether. The thumb is, even in popular tradition, a symbol of domination and will. It stands for the domination of Jupiter. Lord of the Ether. It represents the Will of God.

For the purpose of fighting against the lower nature the Little Man of the Spirit descends to the Sphere of the Solar plexus.

The mouse and the rat. Not always, however, does the Dwarf of the Spirit take the form of a man. In certain connections he may take the form of a small animal. The vehicle of the Elephant-headed God Ganapati is the Mouse. It is not the common house-mouse, but the shrew-mouse, which was also sacred to the Son of God in the form of an aspect of Horus. It seems unfair that a little mouse should carry such a vast and weighty body like that of Ganeśa. But it seems equally unfair that a dwarf should fight a giant. Ganapati represents, according to tradition, the Manifested Universe in his body, and the Unmanifest in his head. The Ganapati Atharva of the Atharva-veda proclaims: "Om, I bow to thee, Ganapati, thou only Creator, thou only Protector, thou only Destroyer, thou only unmistakably Brahman". And also: "In a visible form Thou art That", in other words, "Thou art the Cosmos made perceptible". The commentator Sâyanâcharya adds: "It is he who removes the fear inherent in duration and time, and gives immortality". Another Ganapati scripture says: "Below the throat he is one with Mâyâ, and his head . . . represents Brahman." His vâhana is the Mouse. The Sanskrit word for mouse, Mûsha,

to which "mouse" is related, means also "thief" The mouse is "the thief in the night" who comes to steal grain from the winter stores of man, when the latter is asleep, that is to say, spiritually not awakened It is traditionally said to represent the Âtman, the Divine Self, which works in "the unconscious" and interferes with Man's Ahankâric stores and the plane for the future It lives in holes representing the "cave of the heart" It can peep through and go into the smallest places where man cannot follow him These places are all within the human soul The Śrûti explains "The thief is Brahman through whom all names and shapes exist" One Ganapati tradition says "It is Îśvara (God) who enjoys all He lives there like a thief He is said to be a mouse"

But if the little mouse is a symbol of God, who always gets the better of man and who is difficult to "catch", his big black relative, the rat, is a symbol of the Ahankâra Like the Mouse, he is found in the Heart Centre, as the dark shadow of the Mouse Where the mouse can only be gentle, a rat may be a ferocious animal In the Zodiac mouse and rat are found in Aquarius, in which connection they will be met later The Mouse is the Aham, the fundamental Divine "I", and the Rat is the Ahankâra, which tries to "take away from" that "I" The Rat is the thief in the sense in which "stealing" is implied in the Eighth Commandment

The over-coming of Giants

In the Zodiac Giants are found especially at the "height" of Manifestation and particularly in Leo, and Dwarfs are found especially in Aquarius, the House opposite to Leo

The gigantic Powers of the Element Fire have to be overcome with the assistance of the Lord of Fire, in the service of the Spiritual Ideal In the Greek tradition Hephaestos, in the Roman Vulcan, in the Hindu Visvakarman, Gods connected with the Creative Fire, are the Divine Artisans who make the Weapons with which Gods and Heroes overcome the Ahankâric Adversaries The mightiest Weapon is the Thunderbolt By Fire the Titans are vanquished and punished Odysseus overcomes the Cyclops Polyphemos by thrusting a burning stick into his one eye, and Sindbad does the very same to the "one eye, red as fire" of the horrible black man-eating monster, encountered on the third of his seven symbolical journeys

For those who have the eyes to see, the same is enacted in the modern world

The symbolism of stomach and digestion. Even to people who have not awakened in the least to spiritual aspirations, the experiences of the Solar plexus are very real ones. The stomach region is even physically

man's weak spot — as boxers know. Everyone knows that in a state of great fear, tension, suspense or sorrow, he is incapable of eating or may even feel sick. Nature compels him to fast: to take no more food of identification with the world. Nature may even compel him to return what he has taken in excess. If only the latter were as easy on the inner planes of the psyche! Nightmares are not only experiences at night.

The word "digest" is derived from a Latin word for "to carry", with the prefix "dis", meaning "asunder, away, apart or between, one by one, utterly, not, the reverse of, deprivation of, expulsion from". The dictionary gives the following meanings for the word "digest": "Reduce into systematic form, classify; summarize; think over, arrange in the mind; prepare (food) in stomach and bowels for assimilation...; assimilate (conquered territory etc.); brook, endure, be reconciled to, (insult, opinion); get mental nourishment from."

After cogitation on the root-meaning, it is clear that for the sake of health-wholeness-holiness the function of "digestion" should be performed perfectly, in harmonious co-operation with the other functions.

Symbolism of liver and bile. The main organ which provides the means of digestion is the liver, including the gall-bladder. The meaning of "bitter as gall" is too well known to need comment.

It has been observed before how the sense of taste refers to the Element Water, but how bitterness refers to the Element Fire. In a number of myths and traditions the liver is connected with the Fall.

In Genesis (2; 21—23) one reads that God "took one of his (Adam's) ribs, and closed up the flesh instead thereof: And the rib, which the Lord God had taken from man, made he a woman, and brought her unto the man." And that woman was called "Eve" (Havah), meaning "Living". That there was question of more than a rib stands out from Adam's words: "This is now bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh". The rib in the place indicated by tradition covers the liver. In many traditions the liver has been considered to be an organ which is intimately connected with "life". The word "life" implies "body". In English the words "life" and "liver", though perhaps (except very remotely) not from the same root, are intimately associated. In Gothic, Latin, Sanskrit, German and other languages the "v" is replaced by "b". In German there are the words "Leib" (body), "Leben" (life) and "Leber" (liver). Out of the Four Tem-

peraments as described by Galen the Choleric is that in which the functions of the Element Fire predominate This word comes from the Greek "kholê", meaning bile, from which "gall" also is derived A "live coal" is a burning coal The expression "hot liver" is applied to a passionate temperament Interesting is also "liversick", formerly "livor", meaning envy A related word in Latin is "libido", from which comes the "Libido" of psychology "Libido" and "lubido" mean lust, pleasure A related word in Sanskrit is "lubh", meaning to desire The word "love" is related to this Thus the words "life" and "love" are distantly related Even though there is here question of words which are not Hebrew, they throw some light on Eve from the points of view of evolution and the Fall

The symbolism of the liver occurs in the seventh Chapter of the Proverbs of Solomon in which the contrast between the two aspects of the Moon-Sphere is emphasized The Great Goddess, the Virgin, is given the name of Wisdom Her antipode, Mâyâ, the Deluder, is called "the strange woman, the stranger which flattereth with her words" (7, 5) and "a woman with the attire of a harlot, and subtil of heart (7, 10)" It is described how "the goodman is not at home", how he has *fallen*, how "he goeth after her straightway", "till a dart strike through his liver, as a bird hasteth to snare, and knoweth not that it is for his life" (7, 23) "Her house is the way to hell, going down to the chambers of death" (7, 27) But Wisdom is the Path of Eternal Life, as is proclaimed in the eighth and ninth Chapters of the Proverbs

In Greek myth is found the story of Tityos, who had approached Lêto or Latona with dishonourable intentions, and who was punished in the Under-world by two vultures picking his ever-growing liver The drama of the Fall is found in Greek myth in a more complete form in the story of Promêtheus His name, meaning "he who thinks in advance", is significant for the Fall, focussed in the mental plane It is also significant that Promêtheus "formed man of clay" By doing this he was the "first materialist"

Promêtheus and stealing. In the present age Promêtheus is looked upon as a kind of saviour and great hero, to whose good offices it is due that humanity came into the possession of certain blessings, which are, however, not enumerated or defined The myth intends to convey the reverse teaching The misunderstanding is typical of a mentality which stole the Fire from Heaven like Promêtheus and is still continuing to do so It is indeed quite understandable that Promêtheus has become the hero of the modern imagination, for he is the symbol of that of which the modern mentality is the ultimate development, and, in

another sense, a renewed manifestation. Promêtheus, the man who "thought in advance", did not bring blessings. Instead of that he prostituted heavenly blessings for Ahankâric purposes in lower spheres. "Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, of what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on . . . Which of you by taking thought can add one cubit unto his stature?" (St. Matthew 6; 25, 27). This teaching, of course, refers to fundamental and profound truths, connected with advanced stages of the Return Path to God. The average man, ever engaged in doing the opposite, will not be able to understand it and even less will he be able to follow it up. As will be seen later, the teaching has especially reference to the Sign of Capricorn.

It has been observed before that "stealing" refers to the Element Fire, the mental plane. What is stolen, is, however, the Light of the Ether-Sphere. It is the Apple of Paradise which was stolen by Adam and Eve. In the Proverbs of Solomon the Apple occurs as "the apple of thine eye" which is the Law of God (7; 2). The eye is the organ with which the light is seen. The Stealing of the Light is the breaking of the Law. It is the misappropriation of knowledge for the purposes of the Ahankâra, the Separator and Grabber. It is that which brings about the Fall. Zeus-Jupiter, to punish Promêtheus, chained him to a rock. By that he came into the bondage of materialism. Had he not "made man out of clay", that is to say, formed him out of Earth and Water alone, without "breathing into his nostrils the breath of life" and making him into "a living soul", as the Lord did in Genesis (2; 7)? Promêtheus became "crucified on the cross of matter". Every day an Eagle came to pick his liver, which grew again during the night. The Eagle is the Bird of Jupiter. It represents the Spirit in its punitive aspect. Promêtheus remained in this terrible state of bondage till Hêraklês, as Saviour, liberated him and reconciled him with Jupiter. Adam remains in bondage till Christ, the Saviour, comes to liberate him.

Epimêtheus and disobedience.	The Fall is represented further in the continuation of the myth. As soon as Promêtheus had stolen the Fire, Zeus, in order to teach humanity a lesson, sent a female to the brother of Promêtheus, called Epimêtheus or "he who thinks afterwards". She was called Pandora, "gifted by Pan" or "All-gifted". She was taken to her future husband by Hermês, who also brought with him a cask or vessel, with the express injunction that it should not be opened, an injunction as definite as that given in Genesis 2; 17: "Of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, thou shalt not eat of it". By
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disobedience, that is to say, the development of a will distinct from the Will of God the evil fruits of Karma or action will be known

Woman, whether as Eve, Pandora, or under any other name, is always both the trouble-maker and the redeemer in man's life. She is Life itself and has both its aspects. Pandora may be inspired by Pan (who is, as observed before, an aspect of Saturn) as the Satyr-Satan of Capricorn — as is the case at first in the myth — or she may be inspired by Pan as the All-Father, Ruler of Aquarius, in which case she will bring man the Water of Life.

At first the cask which Hermès had brought remained untouched, but after a while Pandora could not restrain her growing curiosity, and she opened the vessel. As soon as it was open, a host of nasty-looking creatures, half insect and half human, escaped from it, representing, according to tradition, all the diseases, troubles and calamities which from that time onwards have plagued humanity, after grievously stinging Pandora and Epimætheus. They are the Plagues, a few of which have been encountered, in the Plagues of Egypt. Pandora quickly closed the lid of the vessel when she realized what she had done. But then it appeared that there was one more creature inside, for she heard a sweet little voice, asking her to be let out. She took pity on it and opened the box for the second time, releasing a beautiful elfin creature, called Hope. It touched the places where she and her husband had been stung by the Plagues, and took away all pain and itch. Hope is often the only thing which keeps up man's spirits in times of overwhelming sorrow, misery and despair. It is only a little winged creature, it represents nevertheless a ray, just a ray, of the Indestructible, Eternal, All-pervading, Immortal Light of God. It is one of Life's greatest blessings, that Woman, the trouble-maker, can open her Box "for the second time" and let out this little angelic representative of Divine Promise, after her heart has been stirred up by pure sentiments. She herself is man's Hope.

In ordinary human relationships of the modern type, however, the Box is rarely opened for the second time. Very often, after the Plagues have come, the partners run elsewhere, with no other result than that they open another Box of Plagues, and maybe another after that, and never come to know the realization of pure Hope.

The myth should not however, be taken as referring exclusively or even pre-eminently to the sexes, for Epimætheus and Pandora, Adam and Eve, Man and Woman, live within every human soul. On the lower planes they form complementary opposites, on the Plane of Spirit they combine in the Hermaphrodite, as symbol of the Higher Man — Hermès combined with

Aphroditë, the Venus of Greek tradition. This word should be dissociated from its present corporeal implications. The spiritual meaning is indicated by the words of Jesus, previously quoted: "When the two become one and the male with the female is neither male nor female". Originally, before the Fall, Adam and Epimêtheus were alone, that is to say, "all-one". Later the double aspect of Man in the Element Air, the Spirit, will be studied repeatedly in the Divine Twin, found above all in Gemini.

In a certain connection Promêtheus, the "Fore-thinker", and Epimêtheus, the "Back-thinker", represent "the future fears and past regrets" of the soul. When life is none too easy, the average person is inclined to spend his mental and nervous energies on dwelling on the episodes of the past and in considering those to come. But the Reality of Life is here and now. The future is changed only by the attitude and deeds of the present. If the present is forgotten in a turmoil of worries and regrets, the past will continue to shape the future. The vicious circle can be broken only by an Awakening out of the Dream of causes-and-effects in time to the everlasting Now. The spiritual aspirant weakens it little by little, till it breaks down finally and completely with the attainment of Self-Realization.

The enquiry into the cause of suffering. In the myths related above the liver is the centre of suffering as a result of the Fall. So it is in the European myth of the Grail for the Grail-King, transfixed by a lance in his side. Amfortas received this wound "under the Sign of Saturn", according to Wolfram von Eschenbach. This again refers to Capricorn, the House of the Fall as well as of the Divine Birth. According to tradition he could be healed only if a knight would ask the cause of his wound. In the various versions of the myth the putting of the question is always followed by joy on the part of the King, and by his healing. Buddhist tradition lays the greatest stress on "enquiry into the cause of suffering", as the first step towards healing of the ills of life. Hindu tradition similarly stresses vicbâra, that is, enquiry into, and cogitation about, truth and suffering. But "the putting of the question" implies also compassion with the suffering of others, identification with all living beings — which is essential for a spiritual aspirant. The Holy Grail keeps the wounded King alive, but cannot heal him. With the Grail King also lives a magnificent old Knight, said to be hundreds of years old. He is lying paralysed on a bed. Him too the Grail keeps alive but cannot heal. The immortal Light of Grace is, indeed, ever-present, but until man enquires into the cause of suffering, that is, in other words, the Fall, it cannot help and heal the suffering and pain of the soul. Before the Door can be opened,

the aspirant must knock. If he knocks with all his soul, the Grace of God may supply him with the key of the Spirit, so that by inspiration and intuition the Door may be opened.

Passion, blood and suffering The lance which transfixed the Grail King was always wet with blood. Blood is a symbol of the spiritual life-force, in the material of the Elements Water and Fire. It is a form of "water", tainted red by "fire". The spilling of blood results from disobeying the Tradition and causes spiritual pain and suffering in the Elements Water and Fire. In the world of the Fall blood is a symbol of passion. Because it is a symbol of passion it is the symbol of the Passion. The Latin word from which "passion" is derived, means suffering. Suffering arises from "hot blood". Therefore, for the redemption of the lower nature, the spiritual hero must spill his life-blood. The Fire which has been stolen in the Fall should be returned to Heaven in the form of Light. The Lotus Centre of Fire must open up and radiate as the Solar plexus Centre.

On the Path of Redemption the Blood becomes Wine, symbolic of the Tradition and the Grace of God. In the Revelation of St. John (19) we read of the Lord on the "white horse", called "Faithful and True, and in righteousness he doth judge and make war. His eyes were as a flame of fire, and he was clothed with a vesture dipped in blood, and he treadeth the winepress of the fierceness and wrath of Almighty God." Every word of this symbolic language refers to the mighty drama taking place in the Solar plexus Centre. "And I saw an angel standing in the sun, and he cried with a loud voice, saying to all the fowls that fly in the midst of heaven, Come and gather yourselves together unto the supper of the great God, That ye may eat the flesh of kings, and the flesh of captains, and the flesh of mighty men, and the flesh of horses." The Angel standing in the Sun calls together the Birds of the Spirit, in order to consume all that which represents aspects of greed, gluttony, power, aggression, "greatness", anger and animality, which have been seen to belong to the Sphere of the Solar plexus.

One of the central theses of the myth of the Holy Grail is that of the blood of the passion which becomes the Blood of Healing. According to one tradition, the Grail was the vessel — already sacred in earlier traditions — in which Joseph of Arimathea gathered the blood of Jesus on the cross. By psychological etymology the word Sangreal, meaning Holy Grail, was said to mean "blood royal".

The wound by the lance through the liver.

The wound of the Grail-King is the same as the wound of Jesus on the cross, with the great difference that Amfortas suffers it during the life, and Jesus after the death of the Ahankāra. The wound is also found in the North European Havamal (2): "I mind me hanging on

the gallows-tree nine whole nights, wounded with the spear, offered to Odinn, myself to myself; on the tree, whose roots no man knoweth."

Belonging to the Vegetable Kingdom, the tree is a symbol pertaining to the Element Water, the emotional plane. But as a *tree* it represents as symbol the Element Fire, the mental plane. The Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil of Genesis, the Gallows-tree of the Havamal, on which Odinn, was offered to himself, the Tree on which Jesus was crucified — for a tree it was: "The God of our fathers raised up Jesus, whom ye slew and hanged on a tree" (Acts 5; 30) — are all aspects of the same Tree — found in many connections in all traditions.

† The lance or spear which transfixes the liver has also been fashioned out of a tree, a young tree. But it is not a tree in its natural state, it is not a club or bludgeon, a weapon belonging to the brute of the Element Fire, it is well prepared and polished. It is the Weapon symbolizing Spirit: it is "one-pointed". In Hinduism it is a symbol of Viveka, "discrimination", implying much the same as Buddhi. It will be dealt with at length on another occasion.

The lance piercing the side of Jesus on the Cross was held by a *soldier*: "One of the soldiers with a spear pierced his side, and forthwith came there out blood and water" (St. John 19; 34). The blood is the blood of passion and of the Passion, which "ran out", and the water is the water of life (see I John 5; 6). But before, when Jesus was still living, the soldiers gave him "gall with vinegar" to drink; as is written in the Gospel according to Peter: *a drink bitter and sour. The bitter taste symbolizes emotional experience in connection with the Element Fire and the acid taste emotional experience in connection with the Element Air. The "vinegar" symbolizes "the acid test" of the moral nature by the Spirit.*

Bread and wine.

We have seen before how the Body of Christ is the Bread of Life. His Blood is the Wine of Life. The Sacrament of the Bread and the Wine is age-old. It is found in Genesis (14; 18) and is still known to the Jews. It was celebrated before the birth of Jesus by the worshippers of Mithras, one of whose main sanctuaries was in the place on which afterwards the church of St. Peter in Rome was built. It was celebrated in many traditions, as for instance was found

to their surprise by the Christian priests who accompanied the Spanish conquerors of the Americas. In their superficiality, narrowness, intolerance and fanaticism they attributed to the work of the Devil whatsoever in the rites of the American Indians resembled their own. The Jesuit Acosta related how the Devil imitated the Ark and the coming of the children of Israel out of Egypt. The truth is the reverse. Such similarities witness to the depth, broadness, greatness and universality of sacred tradition, and superficiality, narrowness, intolerance and fanaticism are due to the work of the Devil, the Ahankâra, collective and individual, on the Planes of Earth, Water, Fire and Air.

Abdomen and infernus. In order that the Blood may become the Wine of Communion with God, the lower or animal man, focussed in the Elements Fire, Water and Earth and in their Centres corresponding to them in the belly and abdomen, must be subjected to a rigorous course of self-discipline. The Ahankâra must be hunted down both in his cruder and subtler forms, and condemned to death. The "lower" regions or "Underworld" are the same as "Hell", as long as the Ahankâra in his various aspects is still at large. The word "abdômen", the lower part of the belly, means literally "away from home". Man's true domicile is or should be the Kingdom of Heaven, where the Dominus or Lord lives. The Latin word "infernus" meant primarily "lower" and was used for "hell" as well as for "the lower parts of the body, the abdomen".

20 THE TEN COMMANDMENTS OF MOZES, JESUS, BUDDHISM AND HINDUISM

The ten commandments. The Ten Rules or Commandments are meant to give guidance and inspiration to man during his period of self-discipline or discipleship. Their exoteric or "moral" aspect refers to the Planes of Earth, Water and Fire, and is intended particularly for the Sphere of the Solar plexus. Their esoteric or spiritual aspect refers to the higher Spheres and is intended particularly for the Heart Centre. The Rules of the various traditions of the world are aspects of the same set of fundamental Rules. They vary in accordance with the psychological exigencies of the time and place of their revelation. These Ten Rules are interpreted by people according to the "level" or plane on which they are focussed. In some religions which have strayed away from true Tradition, the mistaken conception has arisen that there is one standard

of morality and spirituality for one and all. If this is the case, it is an indication that this religion has become entirely exoteric and has lost its deeper contacts as well as its practical grasp of "actual" life. For the Rules or Commandments contain a scale of standards relating to the existing differences of character and behaviour between people. In Hindu tradition, now still remembered in theory, but no longer followed in the social system, there is a fundamental fourfold scale of standards corresponding to the four main types of people, as focussed in the Four Elements.

In considering, appraising, thinking over and meditating upon the Rules or Commandments, and in applying them to action, a ladder of understanding should be climbed, beginning with the literal meaning at the lowest rung and reaching far up into Heaven. They should be known first at the foot of the Mountain and known anew at every stage of the climb to the Summit. And every time they should be "followed". For that is in accordance with the Will of God.

The great Law-givers. We have seen already how the Commandments come down to the world of Manifestation in Aries, after they have been revealed in their essential form in Pisces, the House of Jupiter, as Law-giver. Manu, the Law-giver of Hindu tradition, Menes, the "first King" of Egypt, Minos, the Law-giver of Crete, Numa Pompilius, the second of the seven mythical Kings of Rome, who, according to tradition, instituted public traditional worship — are all intimately related forms of the Son of Man who brought the Light of the Hidden Father of Pisces to the World of Manifestation, for the guidance and use of human beings. The Light of Life and Tradition comes down by the Grace and by the Will of God — to redeem the human mind which has fallen by stealing fragments of it for Ahankâric purposes. In the Fullness, Wholeness and Glory of that Light the scattered sparks can unite, commune and dissolve. It is in this sense that Christ came and comes down "to save the world and redeem sinners".

Zeus spoke through the Oracle at Dodona, in Epirus, in the sacred Oak-wood, to make known his Will to erring man. Strabo describes (476) how King Minos received his code of Laws from his Father Zeus, with whom he communed on sacred Mount Ida in Crete, while his people were assembled round its base, just like the Children of Israel round Mount Sinai. The Holy Mount of Initiation plays an important part in the teaching of Hermes Trismegistus. In the Zend Avesta (Fargard XII; 19) we read how Zarathushtra communed with Ahura Mazda "on the Mountain of the Holy Questions". The Lord of the Ether-Summit of the Mountain,

the Lord of Light, is the Guru, "the dispeller of darkness" Ahura Mazda is called "the Light and the Source of Light"

The Hebrew tradition was an offshoot of the Chaldaean tradition Genesis (11, 31) relates that Abraham's father left Ur of the Chaldees, now called Mukayyar, in Irak, and went to dwell in Haran, now called Harran, on the Nahr Balikh, in Padanaram From there Abraham went to Palestine During the first and second Captivity the Jews lived in the near neighbourhood of Haran, and during the third Captivity they stayed north of Ur, from where Abraham's father had originally come Hence it is not surprising that Hebrew culture contains a large amount of Chaldaean material The district where the Jews lived during the third Captivity borders on Persia At the Tigris the Semitic tradition from the south and the Indo-Aryan tradition from the north met Ur and Susa were only 150 Miles apart, and it is no wonder that the Chaldaean and Persian traditions influenced each other so much, the more so since in both the cult of the Elements, Fire-worship and Astrology played an important part In this connection we can also understand that many traces of the Avestan faith of Persia are encountered in Judaism On account of the close relationship between the Avestan and Vedic traditions, we can furthermore discern points of similarity in Hinduism and Hebrew tradition

The Mountain of Fire. For the Zoroastrians and the modern heirs of this tradition, the Parsees of India, Fire is the main symbol

of Ahura Mazda The Fire is not the ever-changing, flickering Fire of the Creator, Mars, but the Everlasting Eternal Light of the Ether-Sphere That Light is represented in the ever-burning fire in the Parsee temples Yasna XXXVI, 1 has the heading "To the Fire as the symbol of Ahura Mazda who appears in his blazing Flame" In Genesis (19, 18) one reads that "Mount Sinai was altogether in smoke, because the Lord descended upon it in fire" Jehovah manifested himself also in his aspect as Jupiter Tonans "There were thunder and lightnings, and a thick cloud upon the mount" This character is prominent in Hebrew tradition For instance in Isaiah (30, 30) one reads "And the Lord shall cause the glory of his voice to be heard, and shall show the lighting down of his arm, with the indignation of his anger, and with the flame of a devouring fire, with scattering, and tempest, and hailstones" It is, of course, only the Son of God, who communes with his Father on the Mountain-top, who sees and bathes in the essence of the Eternal and Immortal Light, the people at the foot and on the slopes of the Mountain are only aware of "hailstones, thunder and lightning" On the Summit rules ever-

lasting Peace, the Slopes and Plains are swept by Tempests. — So it was in ancient times, and so it is in the days of the present.

Then was heard "the voice of the trumpet exceeding loud; so that all the people in the camp trembled". The Trumpet calls to Recollection and Resurrection. It represents the Moon. It is made of silver and shaped like the moon-crescent and the rams-horn. It brings forth the Sound of the Spirit. "In the day of your gladness, and in your solemn days, and in the beginning of your months, ye shall blow with the trumpets." (Numbers 10; 10).

"And when the voice of the trumpet sounded long, and waxed louder, Moses spake, and God answered him by a voice. And the Lord came down upon Mount Sinai, on the top of the mount; and the Lord called Moses up to the top of the mount; and Moses went up." And when Moses went down again to the people, he conveyed to them the Ten Commandments. Actually there are twelve, the first of which cannot really be called a "commandment". In order to place the Commandments side by side with the Rules of other traditions, and with the corresponding Plagues, the first two will be dealt with separately.

I AM THAT Chapter 20 of Genesis begins with God's statement,
I AM. "I am the Lord thy God, which have brought thee out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage." The first part of this sentence refers to the House of Aquarius, the second part refers to the previous cycle. With the statement "I am the Lord", later often to be repeated, the Lord manifested himself to Moses for the first time, in Exodus Chapter 3. There it is found also in the form of "I AM THAT I AM", one of the few sentences in the Bible which are written with capital letters. In Hebrew it is: "Ehyeh ashar Ehyeh". In the Zend Avesta (Hormuzd Yashta), Ahura Mazda enumerates twenty of his names. The *first* of these is Ahmi, a word related to Ehyeh. Ahmi means "I am". The last of the twenty names is "Ahmi yad ahmi", "I am that I am". In Sanskrit it is "Asmi yad Asmi". The House of Aquarius is the House of Self-Realization, the Realization of the Self or Supernal "I" of God. The Air-House of Aquarius, ruled by Saturn the All-Father, is the House of Âtman, the Self. Etymologically this word means "Self-Breathing". The first part of Âtman is related to the Greek Autos, self. The Sanskrit "an" means to breathe. In the Rig-veda "tman" is also breath. Etymologically unrelated, but deeply related in meaning, is Abam, "I". This word consists of the *first* and the *last* letters, a and h, of the Sanskrit alphabet. The am is a suffix. It is related to the Greek "egô", the Latin

"ego", the Dutch "ik", the English "I" The House of Aquarius is the House of the Divine Self or I Moreover, God is the First and the Last in every sense, and especially also in the House of Aquarius in the Zodiac On the last page of the New Testament, the Messiah who is Christ Returning with Clouds, who, as will be seen later, represents also the House of Aquarius, says "I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end, the first and the last" (Revelation 22, 13) Alpha and Omega are the first and the last letters of the Greek Alphabet, the symbolism of which will be explained later Pisces, ruled by Jupiter, is the House in which the Ahankâra, if it has not been killed at the end of the last cycle, begins its underground work In view of this, the first Commandment, which refers to Pisces, and which is given in the third verse, is "Thou shalt have no other gods before me" In order to reach the Summit, the Kingdom of Heaven, the aspirant should surrender himself to God alone, and not to the separative egoistic tendencies within his soul, aspects and forms of the Ahankâra And there should be nothing valued *before* the I AM which the Lord represents This Commandment soon came to imply that the Gods of "strangers" should not be worshipped — which was quite in order as long as "the Children of Israel" were the spiritual Elect, and "strangers" represented the recreants and apostates from sacred tradition, like the "Egyptians" But when the meaning of the latter tradition had been lost, this Commandment became interpreted in the sense which led to a rigid tribal monotheism But even then something of the original meaning was preserved in that the "rival Gods" of other traditions, like Baal, Moloch and Astarte, in fact, Gods representing the various Elements, became for the Jews symbols of the sins and weaknesses of their Planes The Hebrew tradition was one with more true life than that of the degenerated cultures among which the Jews lived, and in the name of the Gods of these cultures great Ahankâric mischief was perpetuated But even if the Gods of the Four Elements, who continually manifest themselves for the Jews in the form of "Angels", had not been lost sight of and their names misused by the Ahankara, they should never be worshipped *before* Jupiter or Jehovah, who is, as Lord of the Ether, the Ruler of all Five Spheres In short, in every sense, except in the narrow tribal one, there should be no other Gods before Jehovah At the period of the birth of Christianity the same process took place The Ahankâric reflections of the old Gods of the degenerate Greek and Roman civilizations of the time became naturally the demons of the new faith, and the Father in Heaven was again proclaimed to be Unique and "before all" And as Jewish tradition had adopted as its own what was truly sacred and pure in other traditions in the periods

of its rise and growth, so much of what was still sacred and pure in Greek and Roman and other traditions of the time was saved for Christianity in the veneration of the Virgin Mother, Saints and Angels.

The Ten Rules. The following Commandment is to be called the First, since it applies particularly to the First House of Manifestation, Aries. We have seen previously that the Ten Houses fall into two groups of five. The first five are extravert in tendency; hence the spiritual aspirant should cultivate an introvert attitude of mind in regard to them. The set of Rules applying to them is called in Hindu tradition Niyama, meaning "religious observances or rules". In the second set of five Houses of the Zodiac the main tendency is an introvert one. In regard to them the spiritual aspirant should watch particularly his attitude towards the "outer world"; in other words, he should apply to action the insight gained before. In the Hindu tradition this set of Rules is called Yama, meaning "the restraints, the commandments". Yama is the God who closes the Cycles of Manifestation in Capricorn. He will be mentioned later.

Though every stage of the Path, as found in the divisions of the Zodiac, has its particular troubles and its corresponding lessons to be learnt, the Ten Rules apply, of course, to one and all of the stages of the Cycle. The reader may refer to Diagram 2 for a study of the parallels.

The first commandment. The first two Commandments are combined in verse 4. The First is: "Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above." The First House of Manifestation, Aries, is a Fire-House, ruled by Mars. This commandment has especial reference to Earth. The "graven image" refers to manifestation on Earth, as a result of the creative influence of the Mind. The "heavenly things" should be brought down by God alone, and not by a mind deluded by Mâyâ and under the sway of the Ahankâra. It has been seen how Prometheus formed man out of "clay", and how he became fixed to a "rock". God alone should be the Potter, and not the mind of man. In Chapter 31;18 of Exodus one reads how the Lord "gave unto Moses, when he had made an end of communing with him upon mount Sinai, two tables of stone, written with the finger of God."

The finger of God. The word "finger" contains the clue to the Commandment. It is derived from a word which is related to the Latin "fingere", meaning "to make, fashion", and also "to feign". It has thus both the meanings of *creating* and *imagining*, that

are found in the Hindu conception of Mâyâ. The Latin "figmentum" meant "an invention, imagined thing". It is still used in the expression "a figment of the imagination". "Fiction" is a related word, as is also the Latin "figura", meaning "a thing made", from which comes "figure". The figure is the "image" of the Commandment. A related root is found in the Gothic "deigan," meaning "to knead", which is related to the Sanskrit "dih". The symbolism of kneading belongs to that of the Potter and the Bread of life, both of which have their especial place in Aries, the First House of Manifestation.

We have seen that the thumb is a symbol of the Ether and the Will of God, whilst the four fingers symbolize the Elements. They are the instruments of creation on the Four Planes. By themselves they are not of much use: the thumb must co-operate with them and give them support. Writing is done with the "finger of the Spirit", supported below by the middle finger of reason and above by the thumb of God's Will. In between them they hold the pen. The pen is a symbol of the sacred tradition, which it writes down for the benefit of mankind. The symbolism of the Pen or the Supreme Pen has been used in Islâmic tradition, and in more recent days by Baha'u'llah, the Persian prophet.

The evils of literalism and literature. In order to understand this Commandment in a more exoteric way, it might be rendered somewhat as follows: "Thou shalt not identify thyself with the physical body", "Thou shalt not identify thyself with material possessions and worship Mammon", meaning "riches", "Thou shalt not be a materialist, a worshipper of idols, that is to say, an admirer of mere images and figures for their own sakes, by themselves — for they are mere reflections of the Divine, if not productions of the Ahankâra." "Thou shalt not mistake Spirit for matter. Thou shalt not mistake Angels for men." "Thou shalt not be a literalist." Moses knew the tendency of his people towards literalism. Respect for "the letter of the law" at the expense of "the Spirit of the Law" arises in times when cultures degenerate. And finally the Commandment implies "Thou shalt not indulge in fiction." Fiction should here be taken in a somewhat broader sense than that commonly given to it, as implying everything which is not connected with or subservient to sacred tradition. Buddha included "the reading of worthless literature" among the "things which defile a man" (Anigandha Sutta of Sutta Nipata). In modern times countless books are published all over the world which do not help man on his Return Path to Divine Life. They have not been written with "the finger of God", but by the Ahankâra.

Instead of revealing Truth, they hide it more and more. All those forms of study that are versions of the Eating of the Fruit of the Tree of Knowledge are also versions of "fiction" in that they give the wrong kind of food to man's fertile imagination, and lead to the bitterest suffering on Earth — to which this Commandment specially refers — and in the mind, in that they lead away from, instead of back to, Tradition. Other literature, representing "fiction" in the more current sense of the term, has the aim of diverting man's mind, or merely of "killing time." It diverts the mind from the problems and worries of life — which is really an escape — as also from sacred tradition and the heritage of the Spirit and of the Kingdom of Heaven. Humanity should return to such books as are written "by the finger of God", or, if this is asking too much for the majority of men, to its treasure of legends and fairy-tales. For what is needed is "conversion" and not "diversion", meaning "deviation from the path"

Idol-worship. "In ancient times, in the middle ages and even today in many parts of the East, arts and entertainments were subservient and integral to religion and Tradition. Every aspect of life was endowed with ultimate significance. It was "made sacred" or acquired the character of a "sacrifice." In modern times art, if not practised for "its own sake", is seldom acknowledged to subserve anything but the sphere of feeling. By ceasing to have spiritual significance it has ceased to be true Art. In ancient traditions the Divine Artisan of the Gods represented the God of Fire working under the guidance of the God of the Spirit, forging the Weapons to fight the Ahankâra, building the Dwellings and making the Treasures of the Gods. The modern "artisan" and "artificer" is engaged mostly in fabricating Ahankâric weapons of warfare and devices for the comfort of the body and the gratification of the emotions. From these forms of "idol-worship" man should turn away, once and for all, if he does not wish to be involved in further world-catastrophes.

In the First Temptation, referring to this stage on the Path, the Devil wanted Jesus to turn stones into bread. What has been written regarding that Temptation should be considered in connection with the First Commandment of Moses.

The two groups of virtues and evils. The first two Commandments of Moses have a character of their own, and are on the surface not similar to those of the other traditions, given in Diagram 2. As mentioned before, the first five Rules refer to the "senses of perception" and the second five to the "senses of action." The Commandments

were devised to rectify the Evils or Sins. Now it is an indisputable fact that, as Hesiod said, "Vice may be had in abundance without trouble for the way is smooth and her dwelling place is near, but before Virtue the Gods have set toil." The Evils refer primarily to the Path of the Fall, the Virtues to the Path of Return. On the Path of the Fall the two groups of "senses" are inverted. Vice, so to speak, acts first and thinks next, where as Virtue does just the opposite. Hence the Evils or Sins generally begin with Killing, Sensuality and Stealing, referring to the "lower planes", and the subtler ones, referring to the emotions and the mind, come towards the end. Accordingly the first group of Evils applies as much to the first as to the second set of five Houses of the Zodiac.

Because the Rules are primarily teachings meant to remove the Evils, they were sometimes put in an order corresponding to that of the Evils. Patañjali gives his two sets of Rules in the order inverse to that of Moses. His first set corresponds to the second of Moses. Moses had his set of Commandments on two Tables, implying two sets. The Ten Precepts of Buddha (Sûtra of Forty-two Sections 4) begin with Non-killing, like Patañjali. Of the Ten Fetters and Ten Sins visiting Buddha under the Bodhi Tree precious to his Perfect Enlightenment, the Sin of separateness-of-self, the Sin of doubt and scepticism and the Sin of clinging to rituals, are said to be the easiest to overcome, because they refer to bondage in the lower planes. The man who has overcome those three Sins is called Sotâpanna, "One who has entered the Stream." Together with the Sin of hate and anger and the Sin of lust, which also refer to bondage in the lower planes, they are called "the Lower Fetters." It is clear that the grouping has moved away from the Zodiacal order to a grouping which has reference to the planes. Later it will be observed that the Mahâyana tradition is more intimately related to the Zoroastrian-Hebrew-Christian tradition. The Tibetan Work called "The Supreme Path of Discipleship. The Precepts of the Gurus" is largely built up from teachings referring to the Ten Houses of Manifestation. Though based on the Canon of Buddhism this work has reverted to the original traditional division. On account of its size it will be impossible to quote it in full. It enumerates Ten Causes of Regret, Ten Requirements, Ten Things to be done, Ten Things to be avoided, Ten Things not to be avoided, Ten Things one must know, Ten Things to be practised, Ten Things to be persevered in, Ten Incentives, Ten Errors, Ten Resemblances wherein one may err, Ten Things wherein one erreth not, Ten Signs of a Superior Man, Ten Useless Things, Ten Self-imposed Troubles, Ten Things wherein one doeth Good to oneself, Ten Best Things, Ten Grievous Mistakes, Ten Necessary Things, Ten Unnecessary Things,

Ten more Precious Things, Ten Equal Things, Ten Virtues of the Holy Dharma, Ten Figurative Expressions, and Ten Great Joyful Realizations. The teachings given under those headings are partly exoteric, partly both exoteric and esoteric, and partly very advanced, like the Ten Things not to be avoided, the Ten Unnecessary Things, the Ten Equal Things, and the Ten Figurative Expressions. In every case the order will be found to correspond to the time order in the Zodiac, though the correspondence is more obvious in some cases and more hidden in others.

The Ten Pâramitâs or Boundless Virtues of Buddhism were evolved out of a group of six pertaining to the Six Spheres. As regards the Ten Evils, the Arthasâstra (Book I, Ch. VI; 1—2) gives them in the same order as Moses's Commandments. It will be noted that there is a perfect correspondence between the Ten Evils of Buddhism and the Ten Sins of Manu (XII; 5—7). The twenty qualities mentioned in the Bhagavad Gîtâ (XIII; 8—12), given in two groups of ten, separated by the words "and also", have been added to the Diagram, because they fit perfectly into the scheme, as will be seen by comparing them with the Restraints of Patañjali and other parallels. The order within each of the two groups of ten has been slightly adjusted

The sermon on the mount. Before continuing the consideration of the First Commandment, one more set of Rules, given on a Mountain by a great Teacher, may be touched upon. It is the "Sermon on the Mount" given by Jesus (St. Matthew 5, 6 and 7). We read: "There followed him a great multitude of people", "And seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain: and when he was set, his disciples came unto him: And he opened his mouth, and taught them." It is not stated that the multitudes went on to the mountain, but that his disciples came to him and were taught. For the disciples are the intermediaries between the Mountain-top and the Plains. The "plain ones" do not ascend to the Mountain-top. Jesus had a multitude of secondary disciples, however.

The simple words of the Sermon on the Mount make the deepest appeal to the human heart, yet it has not been realized that they were not spoken simply as the fruits of individual reflection, but in most exact accord with the traditional plan. There is much more meaning in them even than appears. The details will receive further treatment in their proper connection. As recorded in chapter 5, verses 3 to 19, Jesus referred not only to the Ten Houses of Manifestation, but to the two "hidden" Houses as well. With this 19th verse, where he expressly refers to "these

Commandments", the series reaches the House of Aries, from which it began.

The rest of the Sermon on the Mount goes over the same ground, dealing with every one of the twelve Houses at greater length.

The precepts referring to Aries. The Precept of Buddhism which refers to Aries, is "Swear not, but speak decently and with dignity" Buddhism further stresses "politeness of speech" The Evil of Buddhism is "abuse", and the Sin of Manu "abusing others" Abuse is a form of "calling names" Aries is the House of the "naming" In Aries the Word comes into Manifestation The Fetter of Buddhism, and the Sin coming to tempt Buddha under the Bodhi Tree is the delusion of a self or soul as something separate or distinct from Reality It is clear that this delusion is the *conditio sine qua non* of the entire Round of Existence, and the first to manifest itself Its opposite is the Higher Quality of Anahankara the absence of Ahankara, of the consciousness of separateness from God-Reality The main quality to be stressed, as it is by Patañjali, in the Gîtâ, and in numerous Hindu teachings, is Purity, of body and mind Strictly speaking, purity is that which is unmixed, exclusive, single, unadulterated, morally undefiled There should not be an Ahankâric "graven image or likeness of anything that is in heaven above" For there should be, if there cannot be Realization of Oneness, at least absence of the manifestation of Duality of God and soul, Good and Evil, etc The Precepts of the Gurus give as First Cause of Regret "Having obtained the difficult-to-obtain, free and endowed human body, it would be a cause of regret to fritter life away" The First Thing One Must Know is "One must know that all visible phenomena, being illusory, are unreal" In Aries phenomena become visible They are, as it were, only "graven images" and "likenesses" of Reality The First Error again stresses the spoken word "Weakness of faith combined with strength of intellect are apt to lead to the error of talkativeness" The First Necessary Thing is contained in "At the very outset one should have so profound an aversion for the continuous succession of deaths and births that one will wish to flee from it even as a stag fleeth from captivity" With the First Great Joyful Realization there is a return to the root-idea "It is a great joy to realize that the mind of all sentient beings is inseparable from the All-Mind" The word for All-Mind is Dharma-Kaya, meaning "Divine Body of Truth, Doctrine, Tradition" Jesus said on the Mount "Blessed are the poor in spirit for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven" Perfect poverty of every Ahankâric thing which separates the soul from the Aham,

God, is possession of the Treasure Later it will be observed that the House of Aries is "Heaven" for those who have entirely submitted themselves to the Will of God, in other words, to the Lord of the Ether-Sphere, the "Lord of the Gods", Jupiter-Jehovah

In Hebrew tradition Jehovah, YHVH, is the "personal God" and representative of Yah, YH The word Jehovah means literally "the Living Yah" This word refers to Divinity in Manifestation Yah has been associated and even identified in Hebrew tradition with the Archangel Michael, who is the Great Angel of the Sun Yah represents the Sun and the Sun-Sphere In Manifestation His Ruler and Will is Jehovah The aspirant should aim at complete surrender to the Will of God, annihilation of every element in his consciousness which separates him from Divinity His blessedness lies in complete poverty or lack of attachments and desires The original Kâma or Desire, the Ahankâric will which separated itself from the Will of God, brought the Fall For the Return to God every trace of Desire, even the subtlest, should be rubbed out, washed off, burned away, blown out, "obliterated" and "effaced" Every moment of his life the prayer "Thy Will be done" should be in his heart, till it becomes his very life itself

The idea of "poverty" has, of course, to be taken in a symbolic and not in a literalistic way, though there is no doubt that, as all traditional teachings aver, great simplicity of life is helpful for the attainment of the spiritual goal However, on most, if not on all, stages of the Path certain minimum needs and comforts of life should be met, if the spiritual benefits of renunciation are to outweigh the disadvantages In the various cases intuition, common sense and wise guidance should decide the mode of life On most stages of the Path the law of moderation holds good

"Blessed are the poor in spirit for theirs is the kingdom of heaven" In the 19th verse begin the further teachings applying to the same House, Aries "Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven but whosoever shall do and teach them, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven For I say unto you, That except your righteousness shall exceed the righteousness of the scribes and the Pharisees, ye shall in no case enter into the kingdom of heaven" Three times the "kingdom of heaven" is referred to The "righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees" is that of literalists The Pharisees were known for their strict observance of the *written* law The Lord refers to the "graven image" of tradition, which should not be "worshipped" to the detriment and negation of the Spirit of Tradition

The Lord continues (5, 21) "Ye have heard that it was said by them of olden time, Thou shalt not kill, and whosoever shall kill, shall be in danger of the judgment But I say unto you, That whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment and whosoever shall say to his brother, Raca (vain fellow), shall be in danger of the council but whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire" Killing is the first Evil of the second set of five Evils, which, as has been observed, also apply to the first set of five Houses The rest of the Lord's injunction refers to what is called in the various columns "abusing others" and "politeness of speech" Whosoever sins by abuse, will not "enter the kingdom of heaven", but suffer from the "hell-fire" of the Fire-House of Aries Before the greater mysteries and glories of the higher life may be obtained, the lesser mysteries of human relations must have been learned, and the "commandments" followed "Therefore if thou bring thy gift to the altar, and thou rememberest that thy brother hath ought against thee, Leave there thy gift before the altar, and go thy way, first be reconciled to thy brother, and then come and offer thy gift" The two following verses are (also) symbolic, the "adversary" being the Ahankâra, the Devil "Agree with thine adversary quickly, whiles thou art in the way with him, lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison Verily I say unto thee, Thou shalt by no means come out thence, till thou hast paid the uttermost farthing" The "prison" is the bondage of "the world", in which the karmic debts have to be paid off to the last farthing Judge and officer represent aspects of conscience and Karma

The second commandment.

The Second Commandment of Moses is "Thou shalt not make unto thee any likeness of any thing that is in the earth beneath or that is in the waters under the earth"

It refers to the Earth-House of Taurus, ruled by Venus on the Night-throne This commandment is an extension of the first, and much of what has been said in connection with that also applies to this, more especially with reference to the plane of feeling, astral desires and sex The commandment has a further implication if considered in relation to the time when it was formulated Apart from implying Thou shalt not identify thyself with thine emotional desires and objects of desire, Thou shalt not worship astral reflections, Thou shalt not be a sentimentalist, this commandment also holds a prohibition of the worship of "stone pillars" like the Śiva Linga of Hinduism, because in such worship in those times the literalistic tendency had overruled the traditional symbolic view.

In its original exalted form the symbol is found worshipped by Jacob in Genesis Chapter 28. It is known that in Syria stone columns were erected to Seth, the third son of Adam. Stone-worship of various kinds was widely prevalent all over Asia Minor, as elsewhere, and many traces of it are found in the Bible. Its tradition finally grew out into that of the Philosopher's Stone. Wherever the tendency arose to see in the stone pillar an emblem of sex instead of that which it symbolized, in other words, wherever and whenever sex-worship replaced the rule of transmutation of sex, a new Revelation of tradition vetoed everything which could lead to misinterpretation. Very much the same veto as that pronounced by Moses was exercised by the early Christians. It was then again necessary as a reaction to the moral corruption of the degenerate traditions of the time. The tendency is also illustrated in the episode, described in Exodus 32, where the people of Israel are found by Moses, when he comes down from Mount Sinai, to be dancing naked around the Golden Calf. This incident is commonly misunderstood. The Golden Calf has not only reference to Mammon, the worship of the vulgar gold of the earth. The Calf is an aspect of Taurus. Its "gold" is a symbol of the glamour of the astral plane, of the "richness" of the desire life. Gold itself forms an object and is a symbol of desire. It is furthermore used for ornaments, that is to say, for the beautification of the personality. The Girdle of Venus is made of Gold. All these forms of symbolism pertain to the Earth-House of Taurus, ruled by Venus on the Night-throne. The very emotional pastimes of gambling, betting and speculation are also weaknesses of Taurus.

It will be noted that sensualism and lust are condemned in the Rules and Commandments for the Air-House of Libra, ruled by Venus on the Day-throne, and not for the Earth-House of Taurus. For in Taurus they serve, within the proper limits, their rightful function within the Scheme.

The precepts referring to Taurus. Buddha's Commandment for Taurus is "Cleanse your heart of malice and cherish no hatred, not even against your enemies, but embrace all living beings with kindness." The Evil of Buddhism is Hatred, the Pious Act and the Perfection are Goodwill, Good-Wishes. The Petal of the Manipûralotus is Sorrow, the emotional karmic resultant to the above weaknesses. In the Precepts of the Gurus much stress is laid on Death for this House. The same applies to other teachings. Later it will be noted that Taurus is the House of the Ancestors, the Lares of Rome and the Pitris of India. The Gîtâ stresses Realization of the Evils of Birth, Sorrow, Disease,

Old-age and Death The Tetter of Buddhism and the Sin which came to tempt Buddha under the Bodhi Tree is Doubt, Scepticism, a weakness which, on close consideration, will be seen to be basically one of feeling. People doubt, not because their *mind* cannot follow or understand, but because something in them does not *want* to know, does not *like* to believe, in addition to the fact that they are focussed too much on Earth. In its First Group the Gita stresses therefore for Taurus Unshakable Faith, and Patañjali, more in connection with the other weaknesses Contentment, Serenity. In the precepts of the Gurus the Second Requirement is "To carry out the commands of a religious preceptor, one requireth confidence and diligence", in other words, "unshakable faith". The Second Error is the following "Strength of faith combined with weakness of intellect are apt to lead to the error of narrow-minded dogmatism." Weakness of intellect is a characteristic of the stage of Taurus, the error to which it leads fits emotionally into Taurus, and intellectually into the next House, Gemini. The Second Resemblance Wherein One May Err runs "Attachment may be mistaken for benevolence and compassion." The Second Thing Wherein One Erreth Not is "In venerating one's spiritual preceptor one doth not err." Incidentally it is to be noted that "venerating" is connected with "Venus", the Goddess of Love. One aspect of Venus was Veneranda, Goddess of Veneration. The Latin "*venia*" meant "pardon", that is to say, the exercise of love or compassion. The related Sanskrit "*van*" means to love, honour, and "*ven*" means "to love, to desire." In the Rig-veda (X, 123) is a hymn dedicated to Vena, "a deity of the middle region", according to Yāska. The name is related to "Venus." The Second Best Thing is "For one of ordinary intellect, the best thing is to recognize, both within and without oneself, the workings of the law of opposites." The opposites can be studied in their most striking form in the lower world in the House of Taurus, in "sex." The Second Necessary Thing is "perseverance so great that one regretteth not the losing of one's life (in the quest for Enlightenment), like that of the husbandman who tilleth his fields and regretteth not the tilling even though he die on the morrow." Though seemingly unconnected, the likeness of the husbandman and his field has also its place in Taurus, as will be dealt with later. The Second Unnecessary Thing goes high "If the unsullable nature of the intellect be realized, no longer is it necessary to seek absolution of one's sins." As William Blake said, "the soul of sweet delight can never be defiled." The Second Great Joyful Realization is "It is a great joy to realize that the Fundamental Reality is qualityless." Jesus, in the Sermon on the Mount, stresses Sorrow and Death, for this House of the fathers and

mothers "Blessed are they that mourn for they shall be comforted" Later on, however, he refers to the second weakness of the second set of five, as before he referred to the first weakness. As before, he contrasts the physical with the "imaginary" "Ye have heard that it was said by them of olden time, Thou shalt not commit adultery. But I say unto you, That whosoever looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart." In fact, one should not have any astral and sensual imaginings. "Thou shalt not make unto thee any likeness of anything that is in the earth beneath of that is in the water under the earth."

The third commandment

The Third Commandment of Moses is "Thou shalt not bow down thyself to them, nor serve them for I the Lord thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me, and showing mercy unto thousands of them that love me, and keep my commandments." The "bowing down" refers to the mental and spiritual faculties. Man should bow down to what is higher than himself. God alone. He should not mentally or spiritually bow to what is lower, and what has been previously dealt with in the first two commandments, referring to lower planes. Assuming for a moment that the translation of "a jealous God" is correct, it is in place to remember that Sufis of old have called God "the jealous lover", because he does not want to share us with any other being. God wants us entirely for himself. Most people are willing to make some concessions to God, by loving and serving him under certain conditions and with certain reservations. And when they think that they have given their due to God, they turn to their Ahankâric loves in the world—the Ten Sins. To express it in Bible terminology "they go awhoring after strange gods." God is never satisfied with the offer of fragments and the surrender of parts of his devotee. He wants complete surrender and whole-hearted devotion. The decision for this can be successfully made up in the mind, the Element Fire, in the Air House of Gemini, ruled by Mercury.

The law of Karma.

The last part of the commandment, as also the "jealousy" of God, has been much criticized by literalists, who have gone as far as accusing the Lord or Moses of cruelty. And yet the meaning of "the visiting of the iniquities of the fathers upon the children" is quite clear, if it is taken in connection with the showing of mercy to those that love God and keep the commandments.

The former sentence applies to those that do *not* keep the commandments. As has been observed elsewhere, in connection with Hindu rites, "fathers and children" signify the causes and effects of actions, or rather, actions and their effects, in short Karma. The "third" and the "fourth" — generations is an added word — refer to cycles of life and manifestation, ages, lifetimes, subperiods, years, months, weeks. The commandment expresses the fact that man must "reap as he sows", and that the "visitations" may come only after long periods have elapsed after the sowing of the seeds. Generally the periods will be longer for unspiritual worldly-minded people, shorter for the spiritual aspirant, and very short in the case of advanced disciples, for whom the karmic reactions to new actions will come almost immediately. The warning of Moses is meant for the masses. It has always been observed, especially by those who have begun to walk the Path, that the very worldly-minded and hardened sinners seem to be allowed to continue their practices over long periods unhindered and unpunished, where as those who strive more sincerely to better themselves, cannot allow themselves any deviations without getting into trouble. The former, however, will have "to pay the uttermost farthing".

Ezekiel (18, 20) corrects the mistaken literalistic interpretation of the Commandment "A son shall not bear the iniquity of the father."

The precepts referring to Gemini. The word which has been translated by 'jealous' indicates rather "zealous". It has been rendered by zealous in the Jewish translation of the Books of Moses.

Both "jealous" and "zealous" are derived from the Greek "zelos". The word implies earnestness, fervour, persistency, whole-hearted endeavour. The very same is implied by the Sanskrit Tapas, the Restraint of Patañjali pertaining to the same House, Gemini. It has been seen before how "tapas" also implies heating, burning. The word "fervour" implies the very same. Zeal, tapas, spiritual fervour are found also in the Buddhist Perfection of Energy, Exertion, and in the Asakti of the Gita, meaning intense and unbroken desire for God and reversion from the world. The corresponding weakness is "laziness", found in other columns in Diagram 2. Moses's Commandment further refers to what Manu calls "adherence to false doctrines", and the Evil of Buddhism "error, clinging to false doctrines". The Fetter and Sin of Buddhism is "clinging to rituals, sorcery". In the Element Fire, to which these Rules and Evils pertain, and in the Air-House of Gemini, the right mental attitude and proper and just views are all-important. Rituals are performed on the physical plane and should not enslave the mind. They should receive esoteric inter-

pretation enabling the different planes of mind and spirit to take support in the ritual at their appropriate level and not be bound under the merely exoteric interpretation. The Precepts of the Gurus contain valuable hints. The Third Requirement is: "To avoid error in choosing a Guru, the disciple requireth knowledge of his own faults and virtues." The Third Error is: "Great zeal without adequate religious instruction is apt to lead into the error of going to erroneous extremes (or following misleading paths)". This instruction combines "zeal" and "doctrine". The Third Resemblance In Which One May Err is: "Cessation of thought-processes may be mistaken for the quiescence of infinite mind, which is the true goal." The Third Thing In Which One Erreth Not is: "In thoroughly studying the Doctrine, hearing discourses thereon, and reflecting and meditating upon it, one doth not err." The Third Best Thing is: "For one of superior intellect, the best thing is to have thorough comprehension of the inseparableness of the knower, the object of knowledge, and the act of knowing." The Third Necessary Thing is "joyfulness of mind like that of a man who hath accomplished a great deed of far-reaching influence." Joyfulness pertains to the Spirit. The Third More Precious Thing is: "One esoteric truth is more precious than innumerable exoteric doctrines." From the spiritual angle, all exoteric doctrines are "false doctrines" and doctrines which lead to "errors". The Third Great Joyful Realization is: "It is a great joy to realize that in the infinite, thought-transcending Knowledge of Reality all samsâric differentiations are non-existent." Several Precepts stress Hypocrisy. Jesus in the Sermon on the Mount stresses meekness: "Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth". In its first group of Qualities, the Gîtâ stresses "unpretentiousness, simplicity, meekness." The corresponding Pious Act of Buddhism is "meekness combined with faith." Jesus says further in the Sermon on the Mount: "If thy right eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell." The eye is a "Jñânendriya" or organ of knowledge. The injunction refers to the errors of knowledge, which are referred to by Moses, by Manu and in the Buddhist teachings quoted in Diagram 2. Identifying himself with Spirit instead of with his reasoning mind, the aspirant should be keen and eager to discard all doctrines which pertain to part and parcel of his being alone, in order that the whole may be saved from sorrow. In the next verse Jesus refers to the typical "Karmendriya", organ of action: "And if thy right hand offend thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee; for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not the whole body should be

cast into hell" When the aspirant has sincerely taken himself in hand, he should indeed carry out self-reforms with determination, as long as he is still able to do so of his own accord and before he will be forced to do so by the fruits of his actions, for the Lord is "a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children"

The symbolism of voice and word. For the understanding of the Fourth Commandment the symbolism of word and voice has to be entered into more deeply. The word is a symbol of creation, because at the hand of it a past world is re-created in the mind

of the speaker and a new world is created in the mind of the listener. Many people talk about nothing but past little incidents in their own life or in the life of others. The talk is on the whole largely concerned with profane matters. The word should, on the contrary, be used in the service of sacred tradition, in accordance with sacred tradition. Instead of being "desire-born" it should be "virgin born". Words meant for purposes of true enlightenment should not be prostituted for the Ahankâric purposes of the profane world. When a spiritual aspirant becomes truly serious in his intention to walk the higher stages of the Path, he should no more re-create the profane aspect of the past — either of himself or of others — by useless and harmful talk. His talk should be concerned only with enlightenment in accordance with sacred tradition, and thus be focussed on the future, only referring to the past for the purpose of shaping the future. If there is no need to talk on subjects of enlightenment and their realization in life, the spiritual aspirant should keep silence. For ultimate Realization is Silence.

The "voice" is either the Voice of Mâyâ, the Deludress, or the Voice of Tradition, the Controller and Enlightener of Mâyâ, Wisdom. The first is the "woman with the attire of a harlot, and subtil of heart" (Proverbs of Solomon 7, 10) with "the strange tongue of a strange woman" (6, 24) and "much fair speech" (7, 21). The second is She of whom it is said (8, 1—2) "Doth not Wisdom cry? and Understanding put forth her voice? She standeth in the top of high places, by the way in the places of the paths." The "top of high places" is the Height of Manifestation of Cancer and Leo. "She crieth at the gates, at the entry of the city, at the coming in at the doors." The "City" is, as will be seen later, the Community of Cancer. The entry to it is by the Solstitial Door of Cancer. "Unto you, O men I call, and my voice is to the sons of man" (8, 3—4). It is the Voice which gives birth to the true Word. "My mouth shall speak truth, and wickedness is an abomination to my lips. All the words of my

mouth are in righteousness; there is nothing froward or perverse in them" (8; 7—8).

Voice and Word find in Manifestation their greatest expression in Cancer and Leo. The first is the House of the Community, the second of Rulership. The Voice is Tradition, the Word its expression or embodiment.

The fourth commandment. The precepts for Cancer.

The Fourth Commandment of Moses is: "Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord in vain; for the Lord will not hold him guiltless that taketh his name in vain." It refers to the Sphere of Spirit, and to the Water-House of Cancer, ruled by the Moon. At this stage of the Path the spiritual life should be taken very seriously indeed.

The higher things should never be taken lightly, or worse, be misused, prostituted for the purpose of the world. The Rule of Buddhism is: "Waste not your time with gossip, but speak to the purpose, or be silent." The Evil of Buddhism is "gossip, or idle talk", Manu condemns "talking idly", the corresponding petal of the Manipûra is "fickleness", and the corresponding Fetter and Sin of Buddhism is Uddhachcha, "restlessness, self-righteousness", which is the root of gossip. The corresponding Virtue is among the Pious Acts of Buddhism "religious discourse" and among the Qualities of Patañjali yoga, meaning the muttering of the Names of God and prayers. In the first column of Qualities the Gîtâ stresses Amânitvam. The root of this word is "man", to think. The main sin of the higher mind is Mâna, pride. These words are derived from the same root as the word "moon". Amânitvam implies the spirit of reverence and humility. The second column of the Gîtâ has "non-identification with wife, home and the rest", all of which things are ruled by the Moon. In Hindu tradition a spiritual aspirant should strive for identification with God alone. As the ruler of form, time and multiplicity the Moon forms the greater obstacle to spiritual progress, till the Veils of her Mâyâ are pierced. It is to this also that the Fourth Cause of Regret of the Precepts of the Gurus refers: "One's own mind being of the nature of the Dharma-Kâya, uncreated, it would be a cause of regret to let it be swallowed up in the morass of the world's illusions." The Fourth Thing One Must Know is "that the body and speech, being compounded of the four Elements, are transitory." The Fourth Thing To Be Practised is: "Having acquired mental discipline by hearing and meditating upon religious teachings, boast not of thine attainment, but apply it to the realization of Truth." It will be noted that Mâna, pride, is the Sin occurring as the fourth of the second group of five Elements and Houses. "By reflecting upon the evils of life in the round of successive

existences, mayest thou be incited to seek Emancipation", is the Fourth Incentive The "Round of Existence" is, of course, presided over by the Moon, the God of Mâyâ The Fourth Error is "Meditation without sufficient preparation through having heard and pondered the Doctrine is apt to lead to the error of losing oneself in the darkness of unconsciousness" It refers to the mental delusions and the state of grave disharmony in the mind which may arise through spiritual ambition and lack of wise guidance It may even lead to various forms of mania and insanity The Pâramitâ referring to this stage is Patience, Tolerance The Fourth Resemblance In Which One May Err is "Sense perceptions (or phenomena) may be mistaken for complete realization "Cancer is the House of phenomenal Mâyâ Therefore "To regulate one's conduct in accordance with the law of cause and effect as carefully as one guardeth the pupils of one's eyes" is the Fourth Sign Of A Superior Man, and the Fourth Thing wherein One Erreth Not is "in nourishing lofty aspirations and a lowly demeanour", for "to be lacking in firmness of mind and yet attempt to act as the head of a monastery produceth self-imposed trouble as doth a feeble old woman who attempteth to herd cattle", which is the Fourth Self-imposed Trouble The "head" while piercing the Veils of Mâyâ, should yet use its faculties for the good of the Whole Body Because Cancer is the House of multiplicity, the Fourth Best Thing is "For one of little intellect, the best meditation is complete concentration of mind upon a single object " And the Fourth Grievous Mistake is "for a religious devotee to preach the Doctrine to the multitude (ere having realized it to be true) instead of meditating upon it (and testing its truth) in solitude" The Fourth Necessary Thing is that "one should comprehend that, as with a man dangerously wounded by an arrow, there is not a moment of time to be wasted" The Fourth More Precious Thing is "One momentary glimpse of Divine Wisdom, born of meditation, is more precious than any amount of knowledge derived from merely listening to and thinking about religious teachings" And finally the Fourth Great Joyful Realization is "It is a great joy to realize that in the state of primordial (or uncreated) mind there existeth no disturbing thought-process" This Joy comes when the riddle of Mâyâ is solved Jesus said in the Mount "Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness for they shall be filled" Instead of Gluttony, condemned in the Fourth Thing To Be Done, and instead of the "Thurst for Existence", called in Buddhist tradition Trishnâ — a word etymologically related to "thirst" — "the mother of desires", there should be hunger for the Bread of Life, and thirst for the Wine of Life, the Soma or Moon-Elixir Jesus further said in the Sermon on the Mount "It hath

been said, Whosoever shall put away his wife, let him give her a writing of divorcement: But I say unto you, That whosoever shall put away his wife, saving for the cause of fornication, causeth her to commit adultery: and whosoever shall marry her that is divorced committeth adultery." The deeper meaning of this injunction lies in the mystic implication of Marriage. It has been noted previously that the marriage on Earth is the reflection of the Mystic Marriage. In a life of spiritual practice — which every life should be — the human marriage leads to the Mystic Marriage. The Moon, Ruler of Cancer, is the presiding deity of marriage. In the Roman tradition Juno was the Patron of marriage. Conjugal faithfulness in marriage and the conjunction of the soul with God through and in faith are traditionally most intimately related, as the identity of the words "faithful" and "faith" denotes.

The remaining teachings have reference to the "Voice" of Cancer. Jesus continues: "Again, ye have heard that it hath been said by them of olden time, Thou shalt not forswear thyself, but shalt perform unto the Lord thine oaths; But I say unto you, Swear not at all; neither by heaven, for it is God's throne; nor by the earth, for it is his footstool; neither by Jerusalem, for it is the city of the great King. Neither shalt thou swear by thy head, because thou canst not make one hair white or black. But let your communication be, Yea, yea; Nay, nay: for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil." This refers to what has been dealt with at the beginning regarding the Fourth Commandment: "Thou shalt not take the name of thy God in vain." Jesus specially refers to four things: The first is Heaven, the "throne" of God. The second is the reflection of Heaven "below" as the "Kingdom of Heaven on Earth": it is the "footstool" of God. The third is the Heavenly Jerusalem, the Moon-Sphere Bride. The fourth is the reflection of that in the Microcosm in the "head". From the point of view of Mâyâ, consciously or unconsciously misused, the spoken word lends itself easily to misconstruction. Swearing, gossip, and idle talk are forms of misuse of the creative word. In communications regarding things of the world words should be used in such a way, that they convey facts and truths and do not serve the purpose of the Ahankâra in hiding or twisting truths. Esoterically, it has to be remembered that the Voice is provided by the Moon-Sphere, and that the Element Air, to which this stage of the Path pertains, is that of Sound. The Creative Word should not be misused. Cancer is the House of the Moon, of Mâyâ and of "magic". Gossip is, from the deeper angle, a form of black magic, religious discourses and prayers are forms of white magic. Patañjali recommends the recitation of mantras, which are partly "Names of God", partly magical invocations,

partly metaphysical insights and partly prayers. Magic, as noted before, is nothing but a science helpful for the control of Mâyâ. It is capable of working miracles — miracles of faith undoing the miracles caused by Mâyâ. From the highest angle of vision, life is nothing but a mirage — but a most wonderful one! The words “miracle” and “mirage” are derived from the Latin “mirari”, meaning “to wonder”. From this word is also derived the word “mirror”. The Mirror of the Moon presents the most enrapturing mirage — a safe one, or a dangerous one, according to whether the Mystic Marriage has been consummated or not. It is a dangerous one if the Marriage Pact is broken — as it has been since the Fall — and if the Head is put away to go and live a life of her own and commit adultery, going “a-whoring after strange gods”

The fifth commandment. The Fifth Commandment of Moses comprises different injunctions. The first is to hallow the sabbath day. This is said in connection with the stage of Leo on the Path of the Zodiac. When studying the Cycle of the Zodiac, it will be noted that Cancer is exactly opposite to Capricorn, and Leo to Aquarius. Leo is the House of the Height of Manifestation, ruled by the Sun of Manifestation. Aquarius is the House of the deepest indrawing and rest of Manifestation. It is the “morning” of the Seventh Day (see “The Key to Genesis”) and the House in which the Supernal Sun is attained, the All-Father. It is meet that at the Height of Manifestation the attention is drawn on the one hand to its transitory nature, and on the other hand to its Source. The Commandment further enjoins “Honour thy father and thy mother: that thy days may be long upon the land which the Lord thy God giveth thee”. The qualifying statement shows that to explain the injunction as referring to the earthly parents alone is seeing only the exoteric aspect of it. Old age is a symbol of Spirit. This Commandment refers also to the Ether, the *Kingdom of Heaven*. *Father and Mother are the Sun, Ruler of Leo, to which this Commandment refers, and the Moon, Ruler of Cancer, the previous House.* They represent the Manifestation-aspects of the Supernal Sun and the Supernal Moon, the All-Father and the All-Mother. At the beginning, of the spiritual Path the father and mother of the aspirant who gave him life in the world in a psychical as well as in a physical sense, are all-important. The Hindu Scriptures proclaim that father and mother are the first Gurus. They should be honoured and served, before all else in the world. It also implies honour and service to the last and final “ancestors”. Among the Niyamas of Patañjali (II, 32) the Rule is rendered as “worship of God, obedience to the Guru, spiritual striving” and the corresponding Rule of the

Gitâ is Âchâryopsanam, literally "sitting near the Teacher and implying receiving his blessings and teachings, and following him, in the deepest sense of that word. The second group of the Gitâ has "constant devotion to the spiritual realization of the Inner Self". The Perfection of Buddhism is Wisdom.

The precepts referring to Leo. Regarding some of the other Virtues and Vices mentioned for this stage it should be remembered that the Ether is the Abode of the Guru not only as Father and Teacher, but also as King and Judge. In ancient times the King was the highest judge in the country. Justice and equity — not so much from the spiritual karmic angle, in which light they will appear at the end of the Zodiac, but in reference to the ethical matters of the world of Manifestation — come forward prominently in the House of Leo, often called the Royal House, or the House of the Ruler. It is the duty of the judge to "see" all and everything in the proper light and in the right colours. In his judgement he should not be influenced by personal motives. He should not be actuated by desires of revenge. He should not try to remedy an ill by adding another ill, in accordance with the tribal law "eye for eye, tooth for tooth", but he should be a peace-maker and exercise a father's mercy. King Solomon is a traditional example of such a Judge: Seer, King, Judge and Peace-maker in one. The Sin which Manu stresses for this stage is "detracting from the merits of others", the Evil of Buddhism is "slandering" and the Rule of Buddhism: "Invent not evil reports, neither do ye repeat them; carp not but look for the good sides of your fellow-beings, so that you may with sincerity defend them against their enemies." It is the traditional kingly duty to look after this — as the weakness of corrupt and degenerate courts is slander and intrigue. Men with kingly and noble natures are bound to follow this Rule of Buddhism by virtue of their very nature, and with all the strength of their character. The word "devil" is derived from the Greek "diabolos", which means slanderer. The Pious Act of Buddhism is "peace-making".

The Fetter of Buddhist philosophy and the Sin tempting Buddha under the Bodhi Tree is Rûparâga. It represents one of the other weaknesses of Leo and the Ether. Rûparâga is interpreted as "form-lust, desire for form and colour, craving for existence in the world of form." In Hindu as well as in Buddhist tradition Rûpa, meaning form and colour, is that which is *seen*, that which delights or repulses the eye. Rûpa is one of the five categories of sense-objects of Hindu philosophy. The other four are Śabda, Sound, pertaining to the Element Air; Gandha, Smell, pertaining

to the Element Fire, Râsa, Taste, pertaining to the Element Water, and Sparsa, Touch, pertaining to the Element Earth

As the Ether is the Mountain-top, so the House of Leo is the Peak of Manifestation After Leo, the Path leads to the Earth, and becomes progressively one of renunciation of substance, form and colour Leo is *all* substance, form and colour It is the strength of Leo, but also its weakness, according to the spiritual character of a person and the context

* The Precepts of the Gurus stress for this stage especially the importance of the Guru, the need for vigilance, and the striving for the good of others instead of striving for self

The Fifth Cause of Regret is "The holy Guru being the guide on the Path, it would be a cause of regret to be separated from him before attaining Enlightenment" The Fifth Requirement is "Unceasing watchfulness and mental alertness, graced with humility, are required to keep the body, speech, and mind unsullied by evil" Watching is alertness in vision The Fifth Thing To Be Done is "Study the teachings of the Great Sages of all sects impartially" The Fifth Incentive, meant for those who have too much of Rûparaga, is "By reflecting upon the miseries which all sentient beings suffer, mayest thou be incited to attain deliverance therefrom by enlightenment of mind" The Fifth Error is "Without practical and adequate understanding of the Doctrine, one is apt to fall into the error of religious self-conceit" In the same context is the following Leonine error The Fifth Resemblance Wherein One May Err is "A mere glimpse of Reality may be mistaken for complete realization" The Fifth Self-imposed Trouble is "To devote oneself wholly to selfish ambitions and not to strive for the good of others produceth self-imposed trouble as doth a blind man who alloweth himself to become lost in a desert" One who is *blind*, that is to say, lacks the Power of vision, is lost in the Desert in which the Lion of Leo roams The Fifth Best Thing — intended for the overcoming of the subtler aspect of Rûparâga — is "For one of ordinary intellect, the best meditation is unbroken concentration of mind upon the two dualistic concepts (of noumena and phenomena, and consciousness and mind)," These pertain to Sun and Moon The Fifth Necessary Thing is "One needeth ability to fix the mind on a single thought even as doth a mother who hath lost her only son" The Fifth More Precious Thing is "The smallest amount of merit dedicated to the good of others is more precious than any amount of merit devoted to one's own good" The Kingly Lion rules over his subjects, the Animals, and looks after their welfare The Lion of the Ahankâra roams about in the Desert for prey Both Lions tend to be lonely, a factor which leads the one to God and

the other towards greater selfishness. The Peak is reached in the Fifth Great Joyful Realization: "It is a great joy to realize that in the Dharma-kāya, wherein mind (the Root-Mind) and matter are inseparable, there existeth neither any holder of theories nor any support of theories." The Dharma-Kāya is the Body or State of Fundamental Truth.

Jesus said at the beginning of the Sermon on the Mountain: "Blessed are the merciful; for they shall obtain mercy". Like his later words, applying to this stage, they refer to the aspect of Leo and the Peak of Ether as that of Judgment, Peace-making and Mercy. "Ye have heard, that it hath been said, An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth: But I say unto you, That ye resist not evil: but whosoever shall smite thee on thy right cheek, turn to him the other also. And if any man will sue thee at the law, and take away thy coat, let him have thy cloke also. And whosoever shall compel thee to go a mile, go with him twain. Give to him that asketh thee, and from him that would borrow of thee turn thou not away." Leo is the House of Power, and the Ether is the Sphere of Ruling Power. This is generally interpreted vulgarly as implying power over the world, and over other man, and indeed, it manifests itself in this way under the thumb of the Ahankāra. Spiritually, however, Power is power over self, over the Ahankāra, a power that develops by the constant practice of self-restraint, by identification with Life instead of with Form, and by living like the sun which shines on the doers of good and evil alike. The greatest power of character, often mistaken for weakness by others who are not so fortunate to possess it, is, under certain circumstances, to give way to others, to let others have their way, and moreover to aid them in achieving their purposes even where their interests are against those of the helper. In connection with these matters, there is also a relationship with the qualities of the Tenth House, in which again the Ether-Sphere is reached, to be studied.

The sixth
command-
ment.

The Sixth Commandment of Moses is "Thou shalt not kill". The Buddhist Rule is "Kill not, but have regard for life". The Sin of Manu is "injuring without the sanction of the law". The Evil of Buddhism is "killing".

The Rule of Patañjali is "non-violence, not hurting", as also the Rule of the first set of the Gītā. In accordance with it the Pious Act of Buddhism is "saving life". At the root of hurting and killing is, of course, hate, anger, aversion, disgust, a Fetter and Sin of Buddhism, a petal of the Manipūra Padma, the fiery centre in the stomach region, and a Weakness mentioned by the Arthaśāstra. The great Quality to be gained at this stage is Equanimity, the Perfection of Buddhist tradition. The Gītā mentions in its

second set "Equal-mindedness in beneficial and non-beneficial happenings "

At the stage of Leo in the Zodiac the Sun begins to go down From the point of view of the Path the set of Jñānendriyas or "organs of knowledge" has reached its peak With the Earth-House of Virgo, ruled on the Nightthrone by Mercury, the set of Karmendriyas or "organs of action" begins with that referring to the Element Earth This gives Virgo relationship with Aries

Virgo is a House of going down to Earth, and also of contact with Heaven The going down may often be in the form of a toppling down, the contact with Heaven on the other hand may be one of great exaltation Later these points will be substantiated in various forms at the hand of traditional material from various parts of the world One of the symbols of Virgo is "blood", the result of the "hurting" or "fall" A related symbol of Virgo is "wine" It may be the Wine of the Moon-Sphere, the Elixir of Life But it may also be a Wine which intoxicates the Ahankāra When people get hurt in a brawl, it is very often due to intoxication by liquor Anagogically it is the intoxicating Wine of Māyā which is often responsible for subtler forms of hurting and killing For these do not apply only to the physical plane It is well known, how a word, a look, a gesture, may cause grievous hurt Thoughts and states of mind can harm more cruelly than a revolvershot Purity of heart and equal mindedness under pleasant and unfavourable circumstances, are the qualities to counterbalance the demons of hate, disgust and anger

The precepts referring to Virgo.	The Precepts of the Gurus stress especially purity of heart and vows The Ruler of Virgo is Mercury, the Lord of Air Vows have especial reference to Earth, where they form the witnesses of Heaven
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The Sixth Cause Of Regret is "Religious faith and vows being the vessel which conveyeth one to Emancipation, it would be a cause of regret were they to be shattered by the force of uncontrolled passions " The Sixth Requirement is "Spiritual armour and strength of intellect are required for the fulfilment of one's heart's vows" It will be seen later that Virgo is the House where the Artificer of the Gods makes the Armour and the Weapons with which the Soul is to slay the Ahankāra at a later stage of the Path Virgo is not only the House of the Artisan, but also that of Science The Fire of Reason is tempered and ruled by the Spirit, for application on Earth In accordance with this the Sixth Thing To Be Done is "Study the beneficent sciences of medicine and astrology, and the profound art of omens " The science of medicine aims at "saving life", astrology aims at "saving life" on a deeper plan, and "the profound art of

omens" aims at "saving life" on the deepest plan. It does not indicate what is normally called prediction of the future, but refers to the higher form of "clairaudience", namely the understanding of living symbols. The First Commandment of Moses refers also to some extent to this first Earth-stage of the second group.

The Sixth Thing Not To Be Avoided is: "Enemies and misfortune, being the means of inclining one to a religious career, are not to be avoided." On the Path the time for action has come. Spiritually the enemy is the Ahankâra-devil. The Sixth Resemblance Wherein One May Err refers to the breaking of spiritual vows: "Those who outwardly profess, but do not practice, religion, may be mistaken for true devotees." The Sixth Sign Of A Superior Man is "to be able to keep alive friendships while one (at the same time) regardeth all beings with impartiality". For this stage of Earth the following is remarked for the Sixth Useless Thing: "Seeing that when death comes one must relinquish even one's own home, it is useless to devote life to the acquisition of worldly things." But "the fact that one experienceth even in the unhappy worlds of existence moments of happiness as a direct outcome of having performed little deeds of mercy while in the human world showeth the virtue of the Holy Dharma." The note of pessimism refers to the worldly side of things, for "It is a great joy to realize that in the self-emanated, compassionate Sambhoga-kâya there existeth no birth, death, transition, or any change", which is the Sixth Great Joyful Realization. The Sambhoga-kâya is the Body of Perfect Endowment, the State wherein there is no change in spiritual blissfulness. "Bhoga" means "enjoyment".

Jesus said on the Mountain: "Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God." And later he said: "Ye have heard that it hath been said, Thou shalt love thy neighbour, and hate thine enemy. But I say unto you, Love your enemies, bless them that curse you, do good to them that hate you, and pray for them which despitefully use you, and persecute you; That ye may be the children of your Father which is in heaven: for he maketh his sun to rise on the evil and on the good, and sendeth rain on the just and on the unjust. For if ye love them which love you, what reward have ye? do not even the publicans the same? And if ye salute your brethren only, what do ye more than others? do not even the publicans so? Be ye therefore perfect, even as your Father which is in heaven is perfect." The words "hate thine enemy" are not found anywhere in the Bible. They do not reflect tradition, but crude public opinion. Jesus stresses impartiality, equanimity and purity of heart, which are none but prerequisites to the manifestation of love on Earth. Virgo is the House in

which the Dove of the Holy Spirit comes down to Earth. The Earth should reflect the perfection of the Father in Heaven. It is noticeable how the stage of Leo merges into that of Virgo.

The seventh commandment. The Seventh Commandment of Moses is "Thou shalt not commit adultery." The Buddhist Rule is "Abstain from impurity and lead a life of chastity." The Restraint of Patañjali is Continence, Chastity. The Pious Act of Buddhist tradition is Chastity. The corresponding Sin of Manu is "holding criminal intercourse with another man's wife." The Evil of Buddhism is "sensuality, yielding to sexual passions." The Fetter of Buddhist philosophy, the Sin visiting Buddha under the Bodhi Tree, the Weakness of the Arthaśāstra, the Petal of the Manipūra, are all the same. Lust. In the Earth-House ruled by Venus on the Night-throne, Taurus, which rules the time of the year of spring, sexuality has its proper place. It is the House "in which the seeds are sown in the furrows made by the plough in the field." The husbandman has to take due care that he wastes no seeds by putting too many, or by sowing them out of season.

Such symbolism does not refer to the Air-House of Libra, ruled by Venus on the Day-throne. At the time of the year when Libra rules, the autumn draws near. It is the time of the harvest. It is a House in which the higher side of human love should manifest itself. The Quality in the first set of the Gītā which refers to this is *kṣāntiḥ*, meaning "forbearance, balance, forgiveness." The very word "Libra" means "balance." In the second set of Gītā is given 'one-pointed and unwavering bhakti', which means "love of God, intense devotion, to God and saintly persons."

The lower forms of love always stand as a barrier between the soul and her spiritual Goal in God, and the higher forms of love are reflections of the Love of God, and lead to Him. All traditions have stressed the necessity of chastity and continence for those who tread the more advanced stages of the Path. Celibacy has ever again been recommended because mystics have experienced that women and families divert the attention of the soul from God. At a certain stage God wants the soul all for Himself.

Modern voices have been heard, voices of physicians and psychologists, proclaiming that continence is unnatural and bound to have bad effects. Unfortunately no voices have been raised to proclaim that the unbridled licence which is going on under the excuse or by the authority of the marriage contract, is far more unnatural and is having a world of bad effects. On the contrary, some religious organizations are even recommending it, because it is said in Genesis (I, 28) that God said unto men,

"Be fruitful and replenish the earth". These words are meant symbolically, however, in connection with the season of fruits. They have very little to do with the subject matter in hand. (See "The Key to Genesis", pp. 72—73).

It is undoubtedly true that for the majority of mankind, and for those on the first stages of the Path, prolonged continence is bound to have undesirable effects. For it should not only apply to the body, but also to the mind, or, to be more exact, the realms of feeling and thought with their creative imagination. Man should not dance around the Golden Calf. "Whosoever looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart." Religious celibacy should not be adopted as a sacred rule of life till a person is able to master his imagination in the astral realm of feeling and desire with a fair amount of success. A vow of celibacy based on "good intentions" alone cannot have the desired spiritual effects. It is clear that few are chosen for a life of perfect all-round continence. It should naturally establish itself from within, and not be forced from without.

There is a sense in which such a perfect continence is found at the beginning of life, in childhood. It is present again at the end of the Spiritual Path, when a person becomes a Child of God. Jesus said on the Mountain: "Blessed are the peace-makers: for they shall be called the children of God". The peace-makers are those who love. Their love embraces men and women, animals and all living things without discrimination.

As long as a man has a family, he has still to discriminate. He loves indifferent ways, according to the nature of the persons in his environment. Between childhood and the Childhood of God there are many stages and for each there is a standard of life and ideals. Each person must ascertain "where he stands", and, having found that out with the assistance of those who are more experienced, should plan his way to the next stage with determination and care. He should not delude himself that any stage of the Path can be skipped, but he may legitimately pray for the Grace of God to endow him one day with wings to fly for a mighty distance. And so he should set himself a certain standard in matters of sex — as in other matters — corresponding to the stage where he stands. Hindu tradition has recommended modified continence or sexual self-control within marriage, and has gone to the extent of advising that certain days, periods of the day and periods of the month and the year are specially unsuited or suited for sexual communion. Every person should aim at establishing regular periods of continence within married life, and study and wonder at the effects of his efforts on his physical, emotional, mental and spiritual life.

His health will improve, he will tend to remain the lover of his wife altogether, the powers of his mind will become more marked, and, what matters most, he will spiritually benefit very greatly

Many of the Rishis or Sages of ancient India, though renowned for their lengthy periods of austerity, were married men. We also learn from the Scriptures that in ancient times brahmacharya did not always imply perfect continence, but rather self-discipline and control of the sexual urge. Akhanda brahmacharya is continence without a break. It has been traditionally more or less identified with God-Realization.

Under the banner of the Spirit transmutation should be practised by one and all who take life a little seriously. It should be practised systematically and in accordance with the stage of development of a person. God watches over the aspirant's endeavours. Nature watches over the body. Such is the experience of ages.

The precepts referring to Libra It will be seen later that the second Karmendriya, referring to Water and the House of Libra, is that of sexual desire. Libra is the first of the Houses in which the great spiritual battle is fought, after the weapons have been made in the House of Virgo, as will be evident from other Diagrams, to be dealt with later. The control of "sex" is indeed a major task. In the Precepts Of The Gurus are found complementary teachings, The Seventh Requirement is "Habitual freedom from desire and attachment is necessary if one would be free from bondage." The Seventh Thing To Be Practised is "Having acquired practical knowledge of spiritual things and having made the Great Renunciation, permit not the body, speech and mind to become unruly, but observe the three vows, of poverty, chastity, and obedience." The Precepts are intended primarily for monks. The Seventh Resemblance Wherein One May Err is "Slaves of passion may be mistaken for masters of Yoga who have liberated themselves from all conventional laws." The Seventh Sign Of A Superior Man is "to look with pity and without anger upon those who live evilly." The Seventh Useless Thing is "Seeing that unfaithfulness to the religious vows will result in one's going to the miserable states of existence, it is useless to have entered the Order if one live not a holy life." The Seventh Best Thing brings in the "balancing" of Libra. "For one of little intellect, the best religious practice is to live in strict conformity with the law of cause and effect." The Seventh More Precious Thing is "To enjoy a single moment of Nirvânic bliss is more precious than to enjoy any amount of sensual bliss", a statement which is well worth pondering over again and again.

Sometimes a life of continence is considered to be one in which something vital is lacking. People who have this idea do not realize that those who have known the Bliss of Divinity say exactly the same about those who lead a life given to "sense". Most of those who know Bliss have also had experience of sensual love and are justified in drawing a comparison. In bare truth the two experiences cannot be compared, being of such an entirely different nature, differing not so much by degrees as by worlds. Yet the experience of mystic Love has ever been expressed in terms of human love — simply because this presents the only possibility of expressing it at all. In this light the symbolism of sex and love belongs to the most exalted symbolism of all. Perhaps one might say that sexual love forms the most exalted mystery of the physical plane, for the pure in heart. But the symbolism of sex and love is that which most easily leads to misunderstanding and abuse. Apart from aspects of abuse which have already been considered, there may be the very different abuses of literalism and of sentimentality. The abuse of literalism exists where all sexual and sensual symbolism is branded as "immoral" without further ado. The abuse of sentimentality exists where people indulge in the kind of sugary and sticky emotionalism which is sometimes mistaken for mysticism, and which serves to create a prejudice in people's minds to the very *word* love as used by others. The experience of mystic Love or Bliss has been expressed in terms of human love the more readily since the highest form of the latter, the Platonic love which is inspired by the Erôs Ouranios, the "Heavenly Erôs", pertains to the realm of the Spirit, which touches the realm of the Ether which is the Sphere of Bliss. Many mystics have found the path which leads from the former to the latter.

The Seventh Virtue Of The Holy Dharma is: "The fact that men after having lived evilly should have renounced the worldly life and become saints worthy of the veneration of the world sheweth the virtue of the Holy Dharma." For every tradition has its Mary Magdalenes. And finally the Seventh Great Joyful Realization is: "It is a great joy to realize that in the self-emanated, diving Nirmâna-Kâya there existeth no feeling of duality". In an Apocryphal Scripture Jesus, when asked by some one when his Kingdom should come, answered: "When the two shall be one, and the outside (that which is without) as the inside (that which is within) and the male with the female neither male nor female." The Nirmâna-Kâya is the "Divine Body of Incarnation", the spiritual state of the Kingdom of Heaven on Earth.

It has been seen before how in the Third Temptation of Jesus, referring to Libra, Scorpio and Sagittarius, Jesus declined the duality of God and

Ahankâra As will be noted, this Temptation refers more particularly to the next two Houses

Jesus said on the Mountain to the multitude of his disciples "Blessed are the peace-makers for they shall be called the children of God" "Take heed that ye do not your righteousness before men, to be seen of them" otherwise ye have no reward with your Father which is in heaven Therefore when thou doest good, do not cause a trumpet to be sounded before thee, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may have glory of men Verily I say unto you, they have their reward But when thou doest alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doeth That thine alms may be in secret, and thy Father which seeth in secret himself shall reward thee openly" Jesus points to a grievous "resemblance wherein one may err" pertaining to Libra True righteousness and true charity are none but manifestations of Divine Love, flowing through man They are inspired by the Spirit, and do not originate in the lower man They belong entirely to God and none but God may be praised for it The lower man should not take any credit for it It is well known that the Ahankâra delights in "good deeds" in the form of charity, because they form a useful material for burying the inner spiritual voice, the voice of conscience, a little deeper The managing authorities of religious institutions well know the mentality of those people who are desirous of buying off their sinfulness by a substantial material present to the institution, whether it be a church, a temple, a monastery, or a place devoted to the public good The need for publicity often accompanies the other psychological characteristics True religious or spiritual life, of which "righteousness" to humanity is an emanation, is an entirely private matter between the soul and God "Deeds and rewards", to speak in terms of the world, are in the secret life of Divine Communion intimately related Every deed carries its own reward And in the deepest realm of all every deed is its own reward The Kingdom comes "when the two shall be one, and the outside as the inside" The symbolism of the right and the left hand, to which Jesus refers, is ancient and universal Primarily the right side of the body is that of the Sun, God-Father, and the left side that of the Moon, God-Mother, the Creatrix The hand is an organ of action The right hand remaining what it is, the left becomes that of the Ahankâra, or else, the right hand is symbolically that of "doing good" and the left that of "doing evil" The Father "which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly" because though the Divine Communion is entirely hidden from the profane and the Ahankâra, its glory is bound to shine through the outer veils of a personality and enlighten the lower worlds,

visible even to some extent to those who ordinarily have not "the eyes to see".

The eighth commandment.

The Eighth Commandment of Moses is: "Thou shalt not steal". The Buddhist Rule is: "Steal not, but help everybody to the fruits of his labour." The Restraint of

Patañjali is *asteya*, meaning "non-stealing, temperance, abstinence of theft in mind and act". The Sin of Manu is "taking what has not been given". The Evil of Buddhism is "theft". The Weakness of the *Artbaśāstra* is "greed". It is that which is at the back of stealing. The Quality recommended by the *Gītā* is "self-control". The Pious Act of Buddhism is "benevolence", and the Perfection of Buddhism is "renunciation". The esoteric implications of "stealing" have been dealt with at length elsewhere: Thou shalt not steal the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge, Thou shalt not steal the Fire from Heaven! Its symbolism refers particularly to the Element Fire and its "*karmendriya*" or "sense of action", and to the Water-House of Scorpio, ruled by Mars, the Lord of the Element Fire, on the Night-throne. In this connection the Fetter of Buddhist tradition and the Sin visiting Buddha under the Bodhi Tree, may be understood. It is *Arûparāga*, the lust for name and fame, the craving for existence in the subtle world of the mind. In the Zodiac Mars appears at this stage not in the forms he takes as Ruler of Aries, as God of Spring for those on the Path of Return or as God of War in connection with the "killing" done in Aries, but as the Hero battling with the *Ahankāra*, selfishness. The great Drama in the Zodiac is drawing to its end. The Weapons forged in Virgo are used. These will be dealt with at length on other occasions.

Apart from the stealing of articles of Earth and the stealing of Fire there is also a stealing of Water, a theft of love.

The lust for name and fame is intimately connected with the stealing of Fire. The desire for "great deeds", the desire to be a hero is in its place at this stage. Scorpio is a Water-House, which explains much of it. The true Hero and the true Knight, however, is not he who fights for his own cause, identifying himself with the *Ahankāra*, and he who fights for a worldly cause, but he who is prepared to give his life for a noble cause of Humanity and Tradition. It will be seen later that Scorpio is the House in which man attains Manhood. In the deepest sense the Solar Hero or Knight of the Spirit is he who is willing to lose everything he has — and not only his life — in the Battle with the Dragon who brought about the Fall. He hunts up the Enemy within his own soul, an Enemy far more

formidable than the cruellest adversary in the world, and far more difficult to slay. The hero of the battlefield of war, who gives his life for his country and its traditions of humanity and decency, is the symbol of the Solar Hero who fights the Dragon in the intermediate psychic realm. And, who knows, in the days when he is engaged in bitter struggle on the physical field of Hell, he may be simultaneously engaged in conflict with the Enemy within himself. And, who knows, at the moment when he loses his life he may win the Victory of Liberation from the Dragon of Bondage, the Victory which is reflected in the title of Jina, "Conqueror", given to Buddhas and Jain Tirthankaras. But even if it be not the case, the battlefields of the world, whether the word is taken in a literal or an anagogical sense, are the reflections of the Battlefield within, and the Truth is gained by way of its reflections on the lower planes. On the path of pilgrimage and struggle the soul gains experience little by little, and no experience is ever lost.

For the Solar Hero it is knowledge which overcomes ignorance, and it is renunciation which overcomes greed and the theft which follows it.

The precepts referring to Scorpio. For this stage, the Precepts Of The Gurus stress insight into the nature of action and its various aspects. Scorpio and the Element Fire are the centre. The Precepts further stress the distinction between selfish and unselfish action and refer specially to misfortunes and persecutions.

The Eighth Requirement is "To acquire the Twofold Merit, born of right motives, right actions, and the altruistic dedication of their results, there is need of unceasing effort." The Eighth Thing To Be Practised is "Having resolved to attain the Highest Goal, abandon selfishness and devote thyself to the service of others." The Eighth Resemblance Wherein One May Err is "Actions performed in the interest of self may be mistakenly regarded as being altruistic." The Eighth Thing Not To Be Avoided is "Reason, being in every action the best friend." It refers especially to this stage. The Eighth Thing One Must Know is "that misfortune, being a means of leading one to the Doctrine, is also a Guru" or teacher of wisdom. The Eighth Thing To Be Persevered In is "Should various misfortunes assail thee, persevere in patience of body, speech and mind." The Eighth Incentive is "By reflecting upon the predominance of evil propensities in this Age of Darkness, mayest thou be incited to seek their antidote." The Eighth Error is "Unless all worldly ambitions be eradicated, one is apt to fall into the error of allowing oneself to be dominated by worldly motives." The Eighth Sign Of A Superior Man is "to allow

unto others the victory, taking unto oneself the defeat " That forms a major victory The Eighth Best Thing is "For one of ordinary intellect, the best religious practice is to regard all objective things as though they were images seen in a dream or produced by magic " The Eighth Grievous Mistake is "for a religious devotee to try to reform others instead of reforming himself " It is one of the prominent grievous mistakes of the modern world The Eighth Necessary Thing is "One needeth to be as confident of one's mental ability as doth a strong man of his physical ability to hold fast to a precious gem which he has found " The physical-plane-hero is the prototype of the Solar Hero In the Epistle of the Gallican Churches, written about the persecution of Christians at Lyons and Vienna, Christ is called "the great and resistless Athlete" The Eighth Unnecessary Thing is "If sorrow and misfortune be recognized as blessings, no need is there to seek happiness " And the Eighth Equal Thing "For him who understandeth thoroughly the teachings which he hath received, it is the same whether he meet with good fortune or with bad fortune " The Eighth Virtue Of The Holy Dharma is "The fact that men whose heavy evil Karma (actions) would have condemned them to almost endless suffering after death should have turned to the religious life and attained Nirvâna showeth the virtue of the Holy Dharma " The Eighth More Precious Thing deals with action and Ahankara "The smallest good deed done unselfishly is more precious than innumerable good deeds done selfishly " The Eighth Thing To Be Done is "Adopt such devotional practices as will conduce to thy spiritual development " It refers to prayer and the science of prayer The Eighth Great Joyful Realization is "It is a great joy to realize that in the Dharma Chakra there existeth no support for the soul-doctrine " The Dharma-Chakra or "Wheel of Truth" was set in motion by Buddha when he preached for the first time in the Deer Park It is the Wheel which forms the antidote to the Wheel of Samsara or "world-involvement", the "wheel of Ixion" The Wheel of the Tradition is also the Solar Wheel In Buddha's Doctrine there is no support for the idea that a separate soul or self, distinct from the One Soul, has any reality The "Atta" or "self" of Buddhism is for all practical purposes synonymous with the Ahankâra of Hindu philosophy We have seen that the Ahankara comes forward prominently in this House One of the outcomes of a belief in a separate soul or self is that of belief in personal immortality The Ahankâra holds fearfully on to its own existence physically, emotionally rationally and even spiritually True Immortality, however, can only come by its very death and dissolution The Sin of Attavâda was the first of the series, in Aries, the House ruled by Mars on the Day-throne

It serves no purpose to waste time, which should be spent with "practice", in philosophical or theological arguments about "atta", "ahankâra" and similar conceptions. The Great Teachers of all traditions are agreed on the fundamental issues, because they have overcome the lower self. If their followers are at variance, it merely shows that they have not been able to follow their teachers, either in understanding or in practice.

Jesus, in the Sermon on the Mountain, said "Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake for theirs is the kingdom of heaven." These words, comprising in one sentence much of what is said in the Precepts of the Gurus, refer to the after-effects of the "poverty of spirit", pertaining to Arics.

Prayer. Persecution and prayer are intimately interrelated. Scorpio and Sagittarius are particularly the Houses in which prayer is learnt, as will be noted later in many connections. Scorpio is the stage of "mantra-initiation" and the technical side of prayer, and Sagittarius, the House ruled by the Guru, represents the stage of mystical prayer.

Jesus said on the Mountain "When thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret, and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly." The injunction stresses that prayer is at heart not a communal affair, but one which should be done privately. When a crowd is gathered, it will obtrude itself to some extent between the soul of the individual worshippers and God. Communal prayer is of very great use to those people who do not pray at all if left to themselves. It has various good aspects. But it cannot take the place of lonely prayer. Communal prayer also tends to fall into "vain repetitions", condemned by Jesus in his next words. Lonely prayer is also likely to be more spontaneous than prayer according to a programme. Nârada, in his Bhakti Sûtra, or "Guide to Love", sings "Practise it alone, practise it alone!" Jesus recommends the same. The Gîtâ recommends "resorting to secluded places." Esoterically the "entering into the closet" implies the retirement into the chamber of the heart. After entering in, the door admitting to the outer world of sense should be shut. The Father lives in the secret Abode of the Ether, in the hidden shrine of the Heart. From this angle of vision the necessity of lonely prayer stands out even stronger. How to shut the door to the outer world when one is in the midst of a big crowd? It is possible only to those who pray habitually and not only at fixed times. To the latter alone belongs the "open reward."

Jesus continues "When ye pray, use not vain repetitions, as the heathen

do: for they think that they shall be heard for their much speaking". Jesus makes a plea for spontaneity and against "parrot-like repetitions". In certain traditions it has been customary for people to go on repeating certain formula. In some Hindu sects the "chanting of the name of the Lord" is practised to this day. It is of course much better that people should chant the names of God than that they should spend their time in vain. Such recitation creates a good atmosphere, a suitable background for a religious life. If it is done with faith and attention, it may surely lead to deeper stages of prayer and meditation. But it is superstition and idolatry if power and value are ascribed to the actual sound of formula and invocations, with no reference to emotional, rational and spiritual actions and reactions. Magic should be a means of overcoming Mâyâ and must not serve the purposes of Mâyâ.

But Jesus means more, as is clear from the following sentence: "Be not ye therefore like unto them: for your Father knoweth what things ye have need of, before ye ask him." As greed is at the root of theft, so it is at the root of begging. Much of what passes for "prayer" is really no better than begging. God knows what the soul needs; He knows it as a Judge as well as a loving Father. It should be left to Him what He giveth or taketh in life. Prayer is intended for leading the soul to His feet, and not for becoming an instrument in the hands of the Ahankâra for taking the soul further away from God. It is in this light that the "Our Father", which Jesus introduces with the words "After this manner therefore pray ye", has to be understood. The esoteric meaning of this prayer belongs to the next House, Sagittarius, the House ruled by Jupiter as Guru, Teacher of Wisdom.

The ninth
command-
ment.

The Ninth Commandment of Moses is: "Thou shalt not bear false witness against thy neighbour." The Rule of Buddhism is: "Lie not, but be truthful; speak the truth with discretion, fearlessness and in a loving way."

Patañjali's Restraint, the Quality of the Gîtâ, the Pâramitâ of Buddhism, the Pious Act of Buddhism are all "truthfulness". Manu's Sin is "speaking untruth", the Evil of Buddhism is "lying". The deeper meaning of "truthfulness" is that at this stage of the Path, one focussed in the Element Air, and applying to the Fire-House of Sagittarius ruled by the Guru on the Day-throne, truth must be faced, acknowledged and spoken out. That is to say, of course, the truth of oneself. We read in the Dhammapâda: "A man winnows his neighbour's faults like chaff, but his own faults he hides, as a cheat hides the false die from the gambler." People are always

ready to come out with "truths" about others, or what their Ahankāra suggests to them of "truths" about others, wherefore Moses's version of the Commandment But who but a true Hero will speak out truth about himself? Pride and fear — two of the weaknesses of this stage — will hold him back. Pride, the Fetter of Buddhism, the Sin tempting Buddha under the Bodhi Tree and the Weakness of the Arthasāstra, is ever again at the root of untruth about self, which is so closely related to hypocrisy.

And who but a true Hero will *face* Truth, the truth which shatters all his previous ideas and beliefs, and which gets the most intimate part of his being by the throat. To face Truth he must conquer Fear. Fear has been called "the Dweller on the Threshold", and "the Terror on the Threshold". The House of Sagittarius is the threshold to Capricorn, and it is the great Battle-ground on which the Hero kills the Ahankāra Monster — if the time has come for it.

It is fear which is at the back of sectarianism, narrow-minded fanaticism and rationalism. Fear of Truth, the great dissolver of all things which are not of Spirit, is the Dweller on the Threshold of Truth. To find relief from that fear, people crowd together in sects, and hide themselves behind a shelter of theological dogmas and a creed which afford some little amount of protection, at least for a while. Atheism is just one of them. The truth of the microcosm is no less terrifying than that of the macrocosm, for it requires a great amount of courage for a man to face his lower nature and look the various aspects of his Ahankāra in the eye, not just casually and rationally, but in full realization. Is is the descent into Hell. To find Truth and *be* Truth, fear must be conquered first of all. Fearlessly the Hero must approach the Dragon guarding the Treasure, before he will be able to slay him and claim the Treasure for his own. The Plague of Egypt in this House is Darkness. Darkness and Silence are the great unknown. For the mystic who has found God-Reality they are aspects of God-Reality. "And the people stood afar off, and Moses drew near unto the thick darkness where God is" (Exodus 20, 21). But for those who are only dimly aspiring to a life of truth, darkness and silence represent all the terrors of the unknown. The soul senses the Ahankāric demons in the dark, but cannot see them, it knows them and yet does not know them. Like an unknown disease, an unknown foe is hard to fight.

Sagittarius corresponds to the time of the day of 10 p.m. to 12 midnight, as is shown in Diagram 1b. On the Path the Darkness of Sagittarius comes before the Birth of the Light in Capricorn.

A soul which is suffering from depression, is also one in darkness. Spiritual vanity represents another form of darkness. Instead of fear in

that case the opposite weakness manifests itself, namely self-assurance, a quality which by its "selfness" betrays the Ahankāra. Self-assurance is the father of pride, which puts the soul on a lofty pedestal at the foot of which the rest of humanity is deemed to crawl like so many ants. Spiritual pride is the Sagittarian aspect of the Third Temptation of Jesus.

In worldly dealings fear, in one of its numerous forms, is always at the back of lying or non-truthfulness. Everyone knows how easy it is for people to see the failings of others, and how difficult for them to see their own shortcomings, straightforwardly, without hypocrisy, self-righteousness and vanity.

The precepts referring to Sagittarius. The Ninth Error of the Precepts Of The Gurus is: "By permitting credulous and vulgar admirers to congregate about thee, there is liability of falling into the error of becoming puffed up with worldly pride." One form of "air in bondage" is "inflation". And yet, the Ninth Sign Of A Superior Man is "to differ from the multitude in every thought and action". The Ninth Grievous Mistake is "for a religious devotee to strive after worldly powers instead of cultivating his own innate spiritual powers." For this stage is that of Spirit, and Sagittarius is ruled by the Guru. The Ninth Useless Thing is "to have lived, even for a very long time, with a spiritual preceptor if one be lacking in humility and devotion and thus be unable to develop spirituality." Pride and lack of devotion to the, or a, Guru are the greatest handicaps at the later stages of the Path. The Ninth Necessary Thing is: "One must expose the fallacy of dualism as one doth the falsity of a liar." Ultimately duality is not Truth. After the Dragon has been killed, God alone is seen to be Reality. Until that time, however, duality remains too much a part of experience to be dispensed with. Moreover, as is taught in both Hinduism and Buddhism, a certain duality should continue to subsist in the relation between disciple and Guru. Even Advaita Vedānta, the Non-dualism of Hinduism, is explicit on the point. For otherwise lack of humility and devotion will form an insurmountable obstacle to reaching the Goal. For a teacher counts the Ninth Thing To Be Done: "Retain such disciples as are firm in faith, meek in spirit, and who appear to be favoured by Karma in their quest for Divine Wisdom." The Ninth Thing Wherein One Erreth Not is "in being able to pass one's whole life in solitude". In the second set of Qualities of the Gītā this is expressed as "distaste for the society of the unenlightened". The misfortunes and persecutions of Scorpio are even intensified in Sagittarius or manifested in more subtle ways. The Ninth Incentive is:

By reflecting upon the multiplicity of misfortunes in this Age of Darkness, mayest thou be incited to perseverance (in the quest for Emancipation) For ultimately, "it is a great joy to realize that in the Divine, Boundless Compassion (of the Bodhisattvas) there existeth neither any shortcoming nor any showing of partiality", which is the Ninth Great Joyful Realization. The Precepts further contain injunctions to practise mystical prayer. The Ninth Thing To Be Practised is "Having entered upon the mystic Mantrayānic Pathway, permit not the body, the speech and the mind to remain unsanctified, but practise the threefold Mandala." The Mantrayānic Pathway is a science of Mantras, or mystic formula, and their practice, which has been expounded, according to tradition, by the Mahāyāna Buddhist Deity Buddha Vajra-Dhāra, "The Holder of the Thunderbolt", who is an aspect of Guru, Ruler of Sagittarius. A Mandala is a symbol for meditation. The "threefold Mandala" refers to what has been called elsewhere "the three worlds", which are referred to in terms of the senses as those of the body, speech and mind.

Jesus said on the Mountain "Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake. Rejoice, and be exceedingly glad, for great is your reward in heaven, for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you." In the first sentence Jesus refers to a kind of "bearing of false witness against the neighbour", to the extent of persecution, and in the second sentence he points out that persecution falls within the traditional scheme of things at this stage, and that if it comes, it is a spiritual blessing in disguise. The Ahankāra is the most dangerous when it is nearest to its end. And near the end the inner and the outer reveal themselves to be more intimately related than at any earlier stage.

The "Our Father". Later on Jesus gives the "Our Father", after pointing out that begging and insistence and repetition are to be avoided, 'because God knows what is wanted. The "Our Father" is built up on the Path through the Zodiac, and recapitulates the various stages in a nutshell. The invocation is to "Our Father which art in heaven" which refers to the All-Father of Aquarius. "Hallowed be thy name" refers to the Guru of Pisces. "Thy kingdom come" refers to Aries. "Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven" refers to the Earth-House of Taurus. It has been noted before how "will" is very often synonymous with "desire". The Buddhist Perfection for Taurus is "goodwill, right resolution, and the Pious Act "good wishes". Manu says that one should think in one's heart what is desirable. "Give us this day our daily

„bread” refers to Gemini, the House of Spirit, and to the Element Fire, which bakes and digests the Bread of Life. It is baked in the Hearth of Gemini, which will be referred to later. That the “bread” mentioned in the prayer is not the “bread of this world” becomes clear from the answer of Jesus when he was tempted by Satan to turn stones into bread: “Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God”. (St. Matthew 4; 4). The First Temptation of Jesus refers to the Houses of Aries, Taurus and Gemini. It is only for those who are blind that the “bread” may be the food of an Age of Darkness.

The Baptism in the Jordan. “Forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors” refers to the House of Cancer, the House of creative “Karma”, as regards the “debts”, and to the Element Air as regards the “forgiveness”. Cancer is ruled by the Moon. The Moon-Sphere is that of the “Astral Records”, the “Book of Life”, which contains the Tradition as well as the accounts concerning obedience and apostasy of the soul. The records of debt of the soul are wiped out by the Baptism. The symbolism of the Baptism of Jesus has been dealt with before. It took place in the sacred river Jordan. The Jordan represents the Water of the House of Cancer, ruled by the Moon, Queen of the Heavenly Ocean. According to one tradition the Baptism took place at the confluence of two rivers. These are the Heavenly Water of the Moon, the Elixir of Life, and the Water of the World. They are found in Islâmic tradition in “the Sweet Sea of the Heavens” and the “Salt Sea”. The “Reunion of the Two Seas is written about in the Korân (Sûra The Cave 59). They are “the Waters below and above the Firmament” of Genesis (1; 7). In the Baptism “the Two Seas” are reunited.

Originally baptism was an important initiation for which a Christian often prepared himself for years and which he passed in the best years of his life. According to the traditional scheme shown in Diagram 1h the stage of Cancer in life is that between majority and 28 years.

In a later period of development child-baptism came in vogue. In this connection there is a tradition associating the baptism with the time of February, i.e. the stage of Aquarius, in which the Water of Life also takes an important place. In accordance with this tradition the baptismal font — which may be taken to represent the Vessel of the Waterman — is called the “uterus ecclesiae” or “womb of the Church”. It will be shown later that the stage of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces is symbolically “the pre-natal” or “womb” stage (see Diagram 1h). The baptismal font was ritually fertilized in the night of the Seventh Day, representing the periods of Capricorn and Aquarius (see “The Key to Genesis”).

It is clear that there are two *different kinds* of "baptism", referring to two distinct stages of the Spiritual Path and both extremely ancient. The Baptism of Jesus was not the child-baptism of February, but the adult-baptism of the Cancer period. The child-baptism is no doubt connected with the presentation of Jesus in the Temple (St. Luke 2, 22). This occurred after the purification of Mary, which is celebrated in February 2nd, exactly in the middle of the Aquarius-period.

The temptation Immediately after the Baptism Jesus went into the **in the** desert, where he was tempted by Satan. We have seen **wilderness.** before that Leo is symbolically often represented as "a wilderness" or "a desert". The House is ruled by the Sun and it is a Fire-House. "Lead us not into temptation" refers particularly to Leo, the House of the Peak of Manifestation and an Ether-stage at that. One reads several times in the Gospels, "Watch and pray, lest ye enter into temptation." Watching is a form of "seeing", referring to Ether. In the Zodiac it occurs particularly in Leo, the Peak of Manifestation, and in Capricorn, the last House of Manifestation, which is also a stage of Ether (see Diagrams 2 and 5). When temptation is present, the soul should not be day-dreaming (Leo) or sleeping (Capricorn), but watch with wide-awake eyes. Insight should be applied without a break to every field of life, in order that temptation may be overcome.

And therefore following on "Lead us not into temptation" — referring to Leo — is "But deliver us from evil." These words refer to Virgo, the House of the Heavenly Virgin, in which great preparations are made for the Battle with the Ahankâra. It is also the House in which the Path leads down, after the Peak of Leo. As will be seen later, the downward movement may be so quick that grievous hurt is suffered, or even death. In the Second Temptation the devil took Jesus to "a pinnacle of the temple", representing Leo, and told him to cast himself down, saying that angels would surely bear him up, lest at any time he should hurt himself. Virgo is also the House of "non-harming" and "thou shalt not kill." People with a religious temperament are tempted to rely on Divine intervention even in the things they should do themselves. But for all matters which relate to the Fall and the resultant hurt and death — to self as well as to others and the world at large — people have to use their own initiative. The will of the Ahankâra and the Will of God are both within their soul. They cannot expect God to lend aid to the Devil. And yet they are much inclined to expect it and by so doing "they tempt the Lord their God."

Without the guidance of a living tradition the soul is helpless, for a

literalistic interpretation of scriptures, bigotry or religiosity, reason or philosophy, and blind faith in a misunderstood theology, do not lead anywhere but deeper into the Labyrinth of Mâyâ.

The "Our Father". "For thine is the kingdom" refers to the Water-stage of the Air-House of Libra, ruled by Love. With Libra the field of the Third Temptation is entered. In it Satan asked Jesus to worship him. Worship is the spiritual form of love or adoration. "The power" refers to the Fire-stage of Scorpio, ruled by Mars, and "the glory" to the Air-stage of the Fire-House of Sagittarius, ruled by Jupiter, the Guru. In the Third Temptation, Satan offered Jesus even his reflection of "the power" and "the glory" (St. Luke 4; 6). "For ever" refers to the Divine Birth in Capricorn, which brings Immortality, and "Amen" is the Word which is born. With that Word the "Our Father" concludes, fulfilling also the cycle from Aquarius to Capricorn, from the Father to the Son.

Vanity and hypocrisy. This interpretation of the "Our Father" does not exclude others. The deeper aspect of the "Our Father" refers to the stage of Sagittarius, ruled by the Guru. The verses which follow in the Sermon on the Mount apply to the same stage. First Jesus stresses the importance of forgiveness, the high quality belonging to this stage of Air or Spirit, mentioned first in the "Our Father" in connection with the stage of Air in the first group of five. Next Jesus says: "When ye fast, be not, as the hypocrites, of a sad countenance: for they disfigure their faces, that they may appear unto men to fast. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward. But thou, when thou fastest, anoint thine head, and wash thy face: That thou appear not unto men to fast, but unto thy Father which is in secret: and thy Father, which seeth in secret, shall reward thee openly" (St. Matthew 6; 16—18). Jesus' words refer to the trait of spiritual vanity which refers especially to this stage. In Diagram 2 it is given in the corresponding Fetter of Buddhism, Sin tempting Buddha under the Bodhi-tree, and Weakness of the Arthaśāstra. It was further seen in the Precepts of the Gurus, and in the Third Temptation of Jesus.

Spiritual vanity exists in a number of forms. In one of its cruder forms it manifests itself in people who think that *looking* holy is the same as, or might be profitably mistaken for, *being* holy. In this form it was very prominent in the society where Jesus lived and taught. It is still prominent in the world, as for instance in India, where often saintliness is imitated

by the help of religious paraphernalia. One sometimes meets religious beggars who have made themselves up with all the possible attributes of Rishis of old which they can think of, to impress the people. In its subtler forms spiritual vanity is one of the most serious obstacles in the higher stages of the Path. Even saintly people are found to have fallen a prey to it. And it is the more serious where those people are not aware of the fact. With this temptation the Ahankāra wins the victory even over the very saintly Śrī Rāmakṛṣṇa said "The vanities of other people fall away little by little, but the vanity of a religious of his own saintliness verily dies with difficulty."

The rest of the Sermon on the Mount, with the exception of the last few verses, is devoted to Capricorn, the House of the Birth of Christ as well as the House of the Fall.

The tenth commandment Coveting and jealousy. The Tenth Commandment of Moses is "Thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's house, thou shalt not covet thy neighbour's wife, nor his servant, nor his ox, nor his ass, nor anything that is thy neighbour's." The

Buddhist Rule is "Covet not, nor envy, but rejoice at the fortune of other people." The Restraint of Patañjali is "non-coveting." The Evil of Buddhism is "covetousness, or envy." The Sin of Manu is "coveting the property of others." The Precepts teach to "avoid such attachments as are inspired by avarice." The Petal of the Lotus of the Solar Plexus is "jealousy." It has been seen before how "coveting" is the manifestation of the Primal Desire which led to the "stealing" of the Fall. It is found in Scorpio in its cruder, more active form, as "greed", the root of "theft." It is clear that "coveting" is intimately connected with "envy or jealousy." Coveting leads to jealousy if the coveted article is not available, because it is in the hands of others. From the spiritual angle the greatest Sin, because it is the primal one, is coveting. But from the ethical angle the greatest Sin is jealousy. If the dealings of humanity are studied dispassionately and with discrimination it will be seen that there is no human weakness which has caused more trouble and suffering in the world than jealousy. Satan covets everything which is God's. He is the very Demon of Jealousy. He tempts even saintly people, who are often jealous of the saintliness of others. And by means of jealousy he persecutes the saintly. In the Epistle of Clement of Rome to the Corinthians (CC, V—VI), referring to the persecutions of Christians in A.D. 64, by Nero, he writes "It was for jealousy and envy that the greatest and most righteous pillars (of the Church) were persecuted, and fought even to the death. Let us

set before our eyes the good Apostles: Peter, who for unrighteous jealousy submitted to not one, nor two, but many labours, and who having thus borne witness, passed to the appointed place of glory; Paul, who by reason of jealousy and envy was able to point by his example to the prize of patience. Seven times he was thrown into prison; he was driven into exile, he was stoned; then when he had preached in the East and the West, he attained the noble renown which his faith won for him, teaching righteousness to the whole world, and coming to the furthest limits of the West. Lastly, he bore witness before rulers, and thus passed from this world, and went to the holy place, after proving himself a marvellous pattern of patience. To these men of holy conversation we must add a goodly company of elect souls who gathered around them, and who, when by reason of jealousy they were subjected to countless indignities and tortures, stood forth as a noble example among us. It was by reason of jealousy that women were persecuted, and were subjected, under the guise of Danaids and Dirces, to dreadful and unholy violence, until they won the goal for which their faith had struggled, and they received, despite their feebleness, a noble prize."

If the causes of war, and especially of the last world-war, and the persecutions which distinguished it, are analysed, it will be seen that jealousy and envy stand out foremost among them, with their fellow of coveting.

One of the symbols of Satan is the snake. The snake is also popularly a symbol of jealousy. Capricorn is the House in which the snake appears in many aspects and forms. They will be considered at length later. In its "lowest" form the snake is symbol of the male organ and its "cupidity"; in its "highest" form it is the Serpent of Dragon of Wisdom. The Sanskrit word Śishna meant both snake and penis. The Rīg-veda enjoins that those "whose God is the Śishna" should not approach the sacred rites, implying that the Mysteries are only for the "pure in heart". The Śishna or Ahi, the Serpent, were the traditional enemies of Indra, the Lord of the Ether, the Jupiter of Hinduism. For the achievement of Masterhood or Sonship the overcoming of desire is essential.

The precepts referring to Capricorn.

The counter-quality to coveting and envy is given in the first set of the Gītā as Vairāgyam, meaning a spirit of dispassion and renunciation. Among the Buddhist Perfections and Pious Acts it is given as "charity,

giving". Capricorn is an Earth-House, ruled by Saturn, Lord of the Element Earth, hence the giving of things in charity, and the renunciation

of things is in its place, considering that the stage on the Path is an Ether one The Fetter of Buddhism and the Sin tempting Buddha under the Bodhi Tree, is *Avijjâ*, the same as the Sanskrit *Avidya*, meaning non-seeing of Truth, ignorance, delusion *Vidyâ*, the etymological relationships of which have been noted elsewhere, means "insight", "wisdom" It relates to the Ether-Sphere The second set of the *Gîtâ* concludes with "realization of the essence of Truth and Reality" The negative quality which corresponds to it in the *Arthasâstra* is *mada*, meaning delusion The word is distantly related to the word "madness" It refers to consciousness and the Moon-Sphere

Charity and the Treasure. The word "charity" comes from Greek and Latin words meaning love, Divine Grace They apply specially to Christ's own sphere, the Ether, and on Earth they manifest as "giving" To this stage of Christ's Birth-House apply the words of Jesus to the rich young man — who was keeping all the commandments, applying to the previous stages — "If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven and come and follow me" (St Matthew 19, 21) In the Sermon on the Mountain (6, 19—21) Jesus says "Lay not up for yourselves treasures upon earth, where moth and rust doth corrupt, and where thieves break through and steal But lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust doth corrupt, and where thieves do not break through nor steal, For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also" The corrupter and thief, in the deeper sense, is, of course the *Ahankâra* Satan, working within the soul The "treasure in heaven" is the Treasure of Capricorn and Aquarius, found in the myths and legends of all the world It is guarded by the Serpent or Dragon Or it is buried deep in a cave of the Earth, guarded by Gnomes, the Earth-spirits in the service of the Lord of Wealth The "heart" is also the Cave of Capricorn in which Christ is born Rust, moth and thief are forms of the Adversary in the Elements Earth, Water, Air and Fire

Coveting is the basic "sin" or cause of separation from God Desire is the first thing to arise, and it is the last thing to go Hence all traditions stress the necessity of desirelessness and the spirit of renunciation Desirelessness is not a negative quality, a pessimistic denial of life, an acceptance of nihilism It is, on the other hand, the most positive quality of all, opening the Door of Initiation into Bliss, the True Life of the Ether-Sphere, Paradise, "the most real state of all", and, in fact, unchanging Reality

The two move-ments in inverse direction. It may cause some surprise that the basic Sin comes last, and that the Sins encountered on the Path become ever subtler instead of cruder, as one would expect. This is on account of the fact that the Path of the

Return leads in the direction inverse to that of the Path of the Fall. The Path of the Return, as conceived in the traditions connected with the Zodiac, is represented within the year-cycle. The Path of the Fall as conceived in the mythological traditions connected with the Zodiac, is represented within the cycle of the precession of the equinoxes. It is secondarily and only in a few contexts reflected in the day-cycle, because the day-Zodiac moves in the direction opposite to that of the year-Zodiac. The year-Zodiac shows the Path of "this world" around the Light of God, the Sun. The movement of the day-Zodiac, however, is due to the revolution of "this world" around *itself*. The earth turns daily around its own axis and the moon turns around the earth. The movement of the earth on its own axis is symbolically connected with the "self-evolutions" of the Earth-And-Moon-Dragon, the Ahankāra "Earth" and "moon", in this connection, should not be confused with the Element Earth, the physical plane, and the Sphere of the Moon, the Great Creatrix. Their relationship will be discussed later. The Earth-And-Moon-Demon is also called the Great Dragon and the Eclipse Demon. He consists of two parts, which are known in Hindu tradition as Rāhu and Ketu, and in the West as the Dragon's Head and the Dragon's Tail. The Fall is traditionally considered as taking place backwards from Capricorn down to Virgo, and from Leo down to Pisces, which House is called "the Abyss" and "the Pit" in various mythological contexts. The Fall leads, of course, from the Ether by way of Air, Fire, Water to Earth and down into Earth. This will be seen to throw additional light on the first two Commandments of Moses. In other traditional contexts, as, for instance, in connection with the World Ages, the Fall proceeds in measured steps on the scale of the Four Elements as found in the twelve divisions of the entire Zodiac. These matters will be dealt with later in the proper contexts. Because the Path of Return goes in an inverse direction to that of the Fall, "conversion" is necessary for the Fallen Man. In ancient times people lived entirely in accordance with the Sun's course through the Zodiac, i.e. in accordance with the symbolism of the spiritual Path. All religious festivals were based upon it. Some traditions still preserve its heritage, though the meaning of that Path and its stages has been almost entirely forgotten.

The etymology of Râhu. Râhu, the Dragon's Head, will be considered at length in other contexts. For the moment only the etymology of the name will be dealt with. The word comes from the root "rabh" and means "to seize". Related to this root are the Sanskrit roots "grdh" and "grah", meaning "to be greedy" and "to occupy". Related to "rabh" is the English "to grab", and related to "grdh" is the English "greed". Related to the root "rabh" is further the Latin "rapere", meaning primarily "to seize" and secondarily "to rob, to plunder". From this word are derived the English "rapine", "rapacious", "ravish" and "rape".

In Astrology Râhu and Ketu, the two halves of the Dragon, are said to be favourable only to two Houses in the Zodiac, Taurus and Scorpio. These are the two houses in which "greed, grabbing, rapine, ravishing, and rape" are encountered in particular.

Desire as Erôs and Kâma. The words "coveting" as well as "cupidity" are derived from the Latin "cupidus", desirous. Cupido was the Roman name of the Greek Erôs and the Hindu Kâma.

The God Kâma is represented with a banner on which the Makara is shown. The Makara is a form of the Dragon and is the name of Capricorn, the Sign of "coveting". Capricorn is the House in which the Divine, the Titanic and the Ahankâric elements are curiously linked. As explained elsewhere, it is the last and the first House.

The God Erôs, Cupid or Kâma is not primarily the playful godling who incites men and women to the passion of human love, or to "coveting". That godling is the son of Aphrodîtê or Venus, the Goddess of Love, aspect of the Ruler of the Element Water. In Hinduism he is the son of Brahmâ and Lakshmi. The God Erôs or Kâma in his higher and primal nature is the First Parent and highest of all the Gods. All beings in the Universe have to bend to his rule, for they owe their existence to him and to him alone, and in him they will finally find their refuge. He is the Father of all. Everyone on the course of the Ages is bound on the Wheel of Time and grows old. But he is the Father of Time, who is the Lord of Capricorn, and he is ever young. He is represented in all traditions as a youth or as a child. His reflection in the emotional imaginings of men indeed burns to ashes after Śiva has opened his Third Eye. Then the lower form of "love" gets burned up and merged in the Ocean of Grace. We have seen before that Capricorn is the House of "Charity" or Divine Grace as well as of "coveting" and that it is the House of the Birth of Christ as well as that of the Devil. Śiva represents in some of his aspects

Saturn and in others Uranus. Saturn is the Ruler and Uranus the Father of the stage of Capricorn and Aquarius. Śiva is called Kāmeśvara, the God of Kāma. But he is more than only the Master of Desire, for he represents the Supernal Aspect of Kāma as Desire introverted into its very essence. As such he is Lord of the mystics. Saturn is Lord of Time and Death, Śiva is Lord of Dissolution and Death. Uranus is Lord of Heaven-realization and Life. So is Śiva. The opening of the Third Eye of Śiva is the same as the Resurrection of the Light. God-realization dissolves all lower forms of love and attraction, leading to the sins of Manifestation.

Death and Immortality. Capricorn is the House of Death as well as of Birth, and Saturn is God both of Death and Life. The Hindu aspect of the God of Death is Yama, the Lord ruling over the Yamas and Niyamas, the Restraints. Yama is the great Restrainer of the Fallen Man. In the Roman tradition he was called Mors. The Hindu Death is also called Mrityu. The words are etymologically related. The Roman God of Love was also called Amor. This word has been preserved in "amour". Its root-meaning is very profound. It means literally and is etymologically related to the word "immortality". A-mor is "not-death". The same combination is found in the Hindu Amrita, the Elixir of Immortality, and the Greek Ambrosia, the Food of the Gods.

The Lord of Light who "existed before the world", the First-born Son of God, is the Primal Amor, the Lord of Immortal Grace. As a result of the Fall his Ahankāric reflection is better known to humanity! In Buddhist tradition Satan is called Māra, which means "the killer", "he who brings mortality". The word is also related to Mors, Mrityu, etc. Māra is often represented as a kingly figure — for he is the Lord of "this world" — with a jewel of great lustre in his crown. This jewel is the Satanic and Mâyâvic reflection of the Capricornian Light and of the Forehead-Eye of Śiva and Ganapati. It is the Mâyâvic counterpart of the jewel which Lucifer, the "Lightbearer", lost from his forehead or crown by his Fall. The True Treasure and its Mâyâvic reflection, which is treasured by Ahankāra, are both found in Capricorn. There both the Divine and the Devil are born. There is an ancient saying: "Daemon est Deus inversus", "the Devil is God inverted". Capricorn is also the House of the Two Paths, leading in inverse direction. The one is the Path of the Ancestors, leading to greater world-involvement and suffering, the other is the Path of the Gods, leading to Liberation and Immortality.

In the Christ-myth the House of Capricorn is represented by Lazarus, whom the Lord loved, and Judas Iscariot, who betrayed the Lord "by

a kiss" In St John (13, 27) it is written that "Satan entered into him"

The arrows of light and the honey-wisdom. The exalted nature of the Higher Amor, Erôs or Kâma, the God of Love, is also evident from his symbols. The "bow and arrows" with which he is represented in both Western and Hindu traditions are a most significant set of symbols. The arrows are the Rays of the Light of the Sun. With them he wounds the "heart" of men and women. In the worldly sense the "heart" may represent the emotional function of man. In sacred Tradition the Heart is the Centre of Spirit, and in a still higher sense, the Root-Centre of the Supreme Spirit, the Supernal Sun. The Sun-Arrow — to be referred to later — kills the subtlest trace of duality and confers Immortality or At-Onement. The Bow, to be considered later, symbolizes the Spirit, subservient to Jupiter-Jehovah, the Guru. The bow of the Purânic Kama is made of a sugar-cane and its string is formed by humming bees. These bring forth the Sound of the Element Air. The bee, the collector of honey, has been a symbol of spiritual striving in many traditions. In Hinduism a special tradition has grown up around bees and honey, which is called the *Madhuvidyâ* or "honey-wisdom". In Tantric tradition there is a well-known verse "As the bee goes from flower to flower, so go thou from teacher to teacher, gathering wisdom." In the Buddhist "*Dhammapâda*" we read "As the bee goes from flower to flower drawing the nectar and leaving unimpaired the colour and the fragrance, so the sage goes about the village." This is universal symbolism. Clement of Alexandria, writing about a brother in the spirit, says (Strom I, 1, § 11) "He, the true, the Sicilian bee, gathering the soil of the flowers of the prophetic and apostolic meadow, engendered in the souls of his hearers a deathless element of knowledge." The bee, going from flower to flower, stores its honey-treasure in six sided cells, representing the six-fold Microcosm. Bees are not troubled by sex, their Queen alone being responsible for the birth of offspring. In the *Brihadâranyaka Upanishad* (2, 5) it is written how the *Âśvins*, the Divine Twins, obtained the "honey-wisdom" with great trouble. We read "This Self is honey for all beings and all beings are honey for this Self. This shining deathless Man who is this Self, who is indeed this Self, he is just this Self. This is the Deathless, the Reality, the All." The bees are "the fragments" centred in harmony and obedience around the Queen Bee, the Divinity of Manifestation.

The honey clover was sacred to *Osiris*. Honey was used by the Greeks in their rituals and represented the *Ambrosia*. The Lord Jehovah, when he manifested himself for the first time to Moses (Exodus 3, 6) promised

him to take his people "unto a land flowing with milk and honey." This symbolism refers to the spiritual nourishment of the truly Elect in and beyond Manifestation. The Milk is the Moon-Elixir, the Motherly nourishment. It is found in the "Milk Ocean" of Hinduism and in the "Milky Way" of all the world. It is the milk of the Heavenly Cow Kâmadhenu, the "Satisfier of Desire". The Golden Honey is the Sun-Elixir, which gives Liberation from the Round of Bondage altogether, and Salvation in the bosom of the Supernal Father. In a Greek myth is told how Jupiter dethroned his father Saturn when the latter was intoxicated with honey. This myth refers to the succession of the House of Pisces, in which the next cycle is prepared, to Aquarius, the House of God-Intoxication.

The string of Kâma's bow is made of bees. Humming bees have all the good qualities, but woe betide him whose indiscretions anger the swarm!

The arrows and the Sakti of Kâma. The arrows which the Purânic Kâma uses on his bow are made of the shafts of five different Indian flowers — representing the Five Elements. They are Champaka, Amer, Nagkeser, Kitticum and Bela. Happy is that mortal who is struck by the shaft of the flower of Ether! In connection with these "five shafts", Kâma is also called by the name of Pañchabâna. Bâna is also a symbolic expression connected with the number 5.

The root of Kâma is "kam", meaning "delight, affirmation". Love is indeed the positive element in the universe.

Kâma enjoys everlasting youth and is said to be the most beautiful of the Gods. His Sakti or Consort, that is to say, his "dynamic aspect", is Rati, the spirit of affection and love-passion. Kâma's Vâhana or Vehicle is the Parrot, the particular form of the Bird of Mercury which has the Martian characteristics of "talking" or "naming" and bright and fiery colours, all in the service of love.

Greek tradition sometimes made a distinction between Eros, Love and Himeros, Desire. The Greek Erôs is generally said to be a son of Aphrodîtê, the Goddess of Love, Greek correspondent to Venus. But in another tradition he is said to be a son of Penia, the Goddess of Poverty and Need. This symbolism also refers to Capricorn. There is one kind of "poverty" which leads to coveting and cupidity, but there is another kind of "poverty", called by Jesus the poverty of spirit, which leads to the Kingdom of Heaven. And besides those antecedents of Erôs Greek tradition knew others. Above and before them all was the Primal Erôs, the First Parent. The Prophetess Diotima taught Socrates that Erôs is "the intermediate Being between

mortals and immortals, a great Daemon, dear Socrates, for everything daemonic is just the intermediate link between God and Man " In those days a "Daemon" was a God, a Guardian Angel and Inspirer It is, however, not surprising that later the word came to mean also, and eventually exclusively, a demon, for the word daemon applied primarily to the Capricornian Love, and Capricorn is the House of the last Titan and of the first God, the House of the great Extremes, the House of the Devil — identified with the older traditions — and of the Christ who had come to the new world For the ancients Erôs had the task — not unsimilar to that of Christ — "of being interpreter and messenger from men to the Gods and from Gods to men, from the former for their prayers and sacrifices, from the latter for their commands and for their compensations for the sacrifices, and thus filling up the gap between both, so that through his meditation the whole is bound together with itself" In these words of Diotima stand forth the great linking and uniting functions of love, in the world among men, and in man of the fragments of his soul This linking and uniting function, which belongs to the Spirit, is found in the symbolism of Kâma's Bow

The nature of We have seen before, that Kâma holds a banner, flying
the Mâkara in the Wind, on which is represented the Makara, the
 curious mythical animal which demonstrates in its body and
 limbs the strange composite nature of the Dragon and of the House of
 Capricorn to which it gave its name It is generally represented with the
 head of a crocodile on which are found the horns of a goat — the horns
 of the "Capricornian" Pan, of Satyrs and of Satan It has the body of an
 antelope or deer, and a curled tail like a snake with the tail-end of a fish
 It has feet like a panther or a dog Some such hybrid monster has been
 drawn by prehistoric men in the Lascaux cave in France It has a head
 like nothing on earth, with two horns on its forehead, while its sides and
 bloated belly are covered with leopard spots The Makara is born in
 Capricorn, or, in other words, there it appears for the first time in the
 New Cycle In so far as it belongs in the Element Earth it is like a creeping
 snake In so far as it belongs in the Element Water, it is fish-like In so
 far as it belongs in the Element Fire, it is panther-like, or has a vast size
 In so far as it belongs in the Element Air, it is like a deer or mountain-
 goat The nature of the Makara is composite, because the influence of the
 Dragon extends to the Four Elements of Manifestation Therefore the
 Makara is the Vehicle of Varuna, the Heavenly Father and Supernal
 Spiritual Ruler of the All Varuna alone has perfectly subjected the Dragon

of Evil. That Kâma has the Makara in his Banner may have two meanings, according to the application of the symbolism alternatively to the Desire which works its ways in the World of Samsâra in connection with the Fall, or to the Desire which urges the soul to choose and walk the Path of Return to God-Reality. The Ahankâric aspect of desire or love includes "coveting", "cupidity", "rapaciousness", "rape", and so forth. The divine aspect of desire or love is embodied in the Grace of the Lord of Love, which comes to those whose Desire is introverted from the World to its Divine Essence.

Relatives of the Mākara. Egyptian parallels to the Makara are the Monster Âmit, "the Devourer of the wicked", with the head and forequarters of a crocodile, the body of a lioness and the hindquarters of a hippopotamus, and further the Crocodile-Monster, an embodiment of Set, which was slain by Horus, the Son of God; and a Greek parallel is the Puthôn, the Monster which was slain by the Sun-God Apollo. The Makara further corresponds to the Fish-Monster Kar, the name of which is etymologically related. It guards the Tree of Life in the Primordial Ocean, in the Zoroastrian tradition, as is told in the Bundahish (XVIII; Yasna XLII). It also corresponds to the Sumerian "Goat-Fish". The Monster of the Deep is found in Babylonian tradition, and in Isaiah (51; 9) we read: "Awake, awake, put on strength, O arm of the Lord; awake, as in the ancient days, in the generations of old. Art thou not it that cut Rahab, and wounded the Dragon". Symbolically identified with "Pharaoh" and "Egypt" (Psalms 87; 4 and 89; 10), Rahab, the Dragon, is one with Râhu, the Dragon of Hindu tradition, who was cut into two by Vishnu in a myth which will be referred to later. It will also be shown later, that the Dragon cuts and is himself cut in Scorpio.

The Monster is found in the form of the Leviathan of the Book of Job (Ch. 41), which is none but an aspect of the Great Deluder and Tempter, Mâra or Satan, the Demon of Mâyâ, the Ruler of the Ocean of Samsâra. Another of its forms is the Whale of the prophet Jonah. Every verse of the 41st Chapter of Job and of the 2nd Chapter of Jonah is pregnant with meaning. The Dragon will be further referred to in a number of other contexts and forms.

The nature of desire or love. In the highest of his aspects Amor, Erôs or Kâma is the highest of the Gods, Father of All. In the Śiva Purâna (Dharma Samhitâ VIII) we read: "The Trinity of Gods is only a form of Kâma. All is born out of and merges back into

Kâma It is present in the sleeping as well as in the waking condition. It is all the transformations of the divine and immortal Bliss which we call Brahman (Reality) and Paramâtmâ (Supreme Self). It is the triple Śakti (Dynamic power) of the Supreme. It is Sankalpa (will and imagination, volitional ideation) which creates the worlds and without which the slightest vibration is impossible." And in the Mahâbhârata we read "The wise-acre who thinks to slay me by fixing his desire on Liberation — I laugh at him, says Kama. The *desire* for Liberation is still a form of myself!" (Asvamedha Parva XIII). This verse derides the knowledge which is founded on theological or philosophical maxims and which ignores mystical traditions. In the Symposium of Plato is said "God mingles not with man, but through Love all the intercourse and converse of God with man, whether awake or asleep, is carried on. The wisdom which understands this is spiritual, all other wisdom, such as that of arts and handicrafts, is mean and vulgar."

The symbolism The Bow of Kâma is a deeply significant symbol. It is of bow and arrow. a symbol in the hand of Indra-Jehovah, and represents the Spirit. It is the bow in the hand of the Centaur or Marksman of Sagittarius, called in Hindu tradition Dhana or "Bowman". This House is ruled by Jupiter, the Guru. The Centaur Cheiron, living in a cave on Mount Pelion, taught his Greek disciples the shooting with the bow.

The arrow is the Sagitta of the Sign Sagittarius. From the root "sag", meaning "perception", comes the Latin sâgîre, "to perceive". Derived are the verbs "to seek" and "beseech", and related is the word "sage".

In Hindu tradition the Bow is held by Śrî Râma in his most common representation. In the Gita Arjuna is addressed as Partha, "the bowman". His bow is the renowned Gândiva, which originally belonged to Soma, the Moon. Budha, the Planet Mercury, is worshipped in the form of a golden bow. In the Mundaka Upanishad (II, 3—4) the Bow is referred to as follows: "Having taken as a bow the great weapon of the Secret Teachings, one should fix in it the arrow sharpened by constant meditation. Drawing it with a mind filled with That, penetrate, O good-looking youth, that Impenishable as the Mark. The Pranava (the Word) is the Bow, the arrow is the self, Brahman is said to be the mark. With headfulness is it to be penetrated, one should become one with It as the arrow in the Mark." In Greek tradition Apollo, the Sun-God, was the God of Archery. He is often represented with quiver and arrow.

The Rainbow-bridge. One of the weapons of Indra, the Hindu Jupiter, is the Bow. This Bow is said to exist in two forms. As unbent bow it is invisible to mortals, as bent bow it is visible in the form of the Rainbow. In Genesis (9; 13) God said to Noah: "I do set my bow in the cloud, and it shall be for a token of a covenant between me and the earth." The Rainbow-Bridge connecting Heaven and Earth is the Spirit. In the Revelation (10; 1) we read: "And I saw another mighty angel come down from heaven, clothed with a cloud: and a rainbow was upon his head, and his face was as it were the sun, and his feet as pillars of fire."

When the Ten Commandments are "obeyed" by the aspirant for God-Realization, and when the lessons of the Ten Houses of Manifestation have been learnt, the Ether-Lord, Jupiter-Jehovah, manifests the Rainbow with his Grace, giving the disciple the power to ascend the Rainbow-Bridge to Heaven. But it is the "razor-sharp Middle Path", and "few there be that find it". Woe to him if one attempts to ascend it before the call comes from Heaven!

It is the Rainbow-Bridge of the Nordic tradition, leading from Earth to the Realm of the Gods. It is called the Bilrost-Bridge. According to tradition the Giants were too heavy to ascend this subtle structure. We have seen before that the Giants and the qualities of "greatness" and "heaviness" refer to the Element Fire. The Guardian of the Rainbow-Bridge is the God Heimdall, an aspect of Mercury. This noble and wise God warns the Gods if intruders are venturing near the Bridge to ascend it, with his magic horn, called the Giallar-horn, the sound of which can be heard at the farthest end of the earth. It is the Sound of the Element Air. Heimdall is also said to hear the subtlest sounds in the world. He sounds his horn when Heroes ride over the Bridge to Heaven and he warns the God when anyone approaches with the intent, in the words of another tradition, to steal the Fire from Heaven.

In Greek tradition the Rainbow was called Iris. Iris was the Messenger of the Gods, and especially of the Goddess Juno, representing the Moon-Sphere. She was known for her quickness. She is an aspect of the Spirit. Light is thrown on the "iris" of the eye in connection with these traditions.

The Rainbow-Bridge is the Pathway of the Solar Hero. In it the Seven Colours of the Seven Spheres are united in beauty and harmony, the Sun on one side, and the Clouds of Heaven on the other. On this bridge Man ventures higher than the Four Elements to Realms of Glory. In the Mundaka Upanishad (II; 2, 5) it is called "the Bridge of Immortality". In the Katha Upanishad, the Scripture which deals with Death, is written (III; 2):

"May we be able to learn that Nachiketas fire-sacrifice, which is the bridge for those who perform sacrifice, which leads to the imperishable Brahman those who desire to cross over to the other shore which is beyond fear" In the Chhândogya Upanishad (VIII, 4, 3) it is said that neither day nor night, death nor sorrow, virtue nor vice, can pass it, but such as are established in Brahmacharya can pass to and fro at will Brahmacharya is continence and chastity It is the Quality which has been seen to refer to Libra It implies the overcoming of the lower form of Kâma, Desire But in a broader, higher and deeper sense it implies the overcoming of the "coveting" of Capricorn, and the realization of the very nature of Kâma, in all its aspects The more mystical aspect of Brahmacharya — which opens up only after the achievement of Brahmacharya on lower planes — is fully manifest in the etymology of the word It means simply "the following of Truth", or "the practice of Reality" The root char means "to move, to act"

The Bridge is found in all traditions It is the "Bridge of the Cliff" by which the Irish Hero Cuchullain passes over from the bright world to the misty world of Scathach, where he learns wisdom It is the mystic bridge which plays such an important part in Japanese tradition, especially in Zen Buddhism, and which is reflected in the bridge found in Japanese gardens

The door of initiation One may pass this Bridge to Heaven only after entering the Door of Initiation of Capricorn And that Door can be entered only after choosing the Right one of the Two Paths, presided over by Janus-Ganapati Jesus said in the Sermon on the Mount with reference to this stage "Enter ye in at the strait gate for wide is the gate, and broad is the way, that leadeth to destruction, and many there be which go thereat Because strait is the gate, and narrow is the way, which leadeth unto life, and few there be that find it" (St Matthew 7, 13—14) To the aspirant the difficulties on the Path may seem to be insurmountable The first time he senses Divinity and makes up his mind for the betterment of himself, he passes the Gate of Initiation But later he sees, that it was not yet the final Gate In fact, he has to pass the Capricornian Gate many times, and every time he passes it, the experience is truer and more lasting Finally he passes the Gate of Truth, of which the previous ones were only the images, and he will obtain the Key, for good Every year a little of the Christ-Light is born in his heart, till finally Christ is born in full glory In spite of the Dweller on the Threshold and the terrible temptations and obstacles in the way of the aspirant, he should

remember with faith that Others have done before him what he is aspiring to do. The Tenth Great Joyful Realization of the Precepts Of The Gurus is: "It is a great joy to realize that the Path to Freedom which all the Buddhas have trodden is ever-existent, ever-unchanged, and ever open to those who are ready to enter upon it." The "readiness" includes the "watchfulness" needed for seeing the glories of the Ether-Light, and faith in the Guru, the Son of God. The Tenth Thing To Be Done is "constantly maintaining alertness of consciousness in walking, in sitting, in eating, and in sleeping"; which is meant literally as well as anagogically; in the Elements Water, Earth, Fire and Air. And as regards faith in God we read that Jesus said (7; 7—11), referring to that Gate: "Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find it; knock, and it shall be opened unto you. For everyone that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened. Or what man is there of you, whom if his son ask bread, will give him a stone? Or if he ask a fish, will he give him a serpent?" Jesus here touches on the use of Desire, and the way of directing Desire. Love is the aim, the means and the end. Instead of the stone of materialism, one should give to those one loves the Bread of Life: instead of the Snake of Capricorn one should give the Fish which is the Seed of Divinity. The Higher Love and Grace surpasses all one can fancy as regards the lower love: "If ye then, being evil, know how to give good gifts unto your children, how much more shall your Father which is in heaven give good things to them that ask him?" And then Jesus gives the fundamental traditional rule concerning Love: "Therefore all things whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them: for this is the law and the prophets." The practical manifestation of this "law" is service, stressed in several of the Precepts for the Tenth Stage. "Unselfish service" implies spontaneous service, flowing forth from the Love of God, and not from any worldly considerations or considerations of receiving anything in return as a reward, and also not rendered because others say that it is a duty, or rendered out of fear.

It is only when a man has crossed the Bridge between Earth and Heaven and has attained the power to cross it at will, that he has the full qualification and authority to point the way to others and to help them to qualify for crossing it in their turn. Then only he will have become a true "pontifex" or "bridge-builder", which word was used for the highest priestly representatives of sacred tradition in ancient Rome. The High-Priest was called the Pontifex Maximus, or "Greatest Bridge-BUILDER", which title is still applied to the Pope of Rome, the Holy Father of Roman Christianity.

By the Bridge the victorious Heroes in the Battle of Life ascend to

Heaven And by the same Bridge the Gods or Angels descend to lower spheres to fight the Giants The latter represents an earlier stage on the Path

"I" and "thou". The Ahankâra, the first Sin, is also the last Sin which holds the soul back from passing the Door to cross the Bridge to Heaven and attain to the bosom of the Father The last failing which tends to hold the soul back at the last moment and seems to form an insurmountable obstacle, is the idea of a personal triumph "I attain" "My Liberation", "I experience" The element of "I and mine" often appears on the Spiritual Path as a blinding factor, representing the basis of the "darkness which comprehendeth not the Light" In Islâmîc Sûfi tradition is the story of the lover knocking at the door of his beloved, asking admittance From within enquires the voice of the beloved who it is that desires to enter The lover replies "It is I"! Then the voice from within responds with the words "Go thy way, for here there is no room for two" The lover retires sorrowfully But after he has learnt a little more he returns and knocks again Again the voice from within enquires "Who is there?" And now the lover replies "It is Thou" And then the door is opened to admit the lover — So, indeed, it is at the end

The true Lover and Beloved is the Lord of Life His reflection, destined ultimately to merge into Him, is Man Therefore, "whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them", for this is the essence of Tradition

Light and darkness. The two masters Man cannot serve God and the Devil Jesus rejected this in the Third Temptation In the Sermon on the Mount he says "The light of the body is the eye if therefore thine eye be single, thy whole body shall be full of light But if thine eye be evil, thy whole body shall be full of darkness If therefore the light that is in thee be darkness, how great that darkness!" Jesus' words reflect the same which he had spoken at the beginning of the Sermon, regarding the stage of Capricorn and Aquarius "Ye are the salt of the earth but if the salt have lost its savour, wherewith shall it be salted? it is thenceforth good for nothing, but to be cast out, and to be trodden under foot of men Ye are the light of the world A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid Neither do men light a candle and put it under a bushel, but they put it on a candlestick, and it giveth light unto all that are in the house Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in

heaven." Salt is a symbol of the Earth-Element. Its savour is in traditional conceptions the Divine Essence of the Earth. "Ye are the light of the world" refers to the Christ-Light in the deepest heart of Man, the Light of the Supernal Sun, the Father. It should not be hid, but light up the entire "bouse", the Temple of God.

"Seek ye first the Kingdom". At the end of the Sermon on the Mount Jesus said: "No man can serve two masters; for either he will hate the one, and love the other; or else he will hold to the one and despise the other. Ye cannot serve God and Mammon". Mammon is the Demon of Coveting, which directs desire Earthward instead of Heavenward. "Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on. Is not the life more than meat, and the body than raiment?" The mystical meaning of these words refers to the "eating" of the Element Fire, the "drinking" of the Element Water, and the "clothing" of the Element Earth. And in the next verse Jesus refers to the Birds of the Air: "Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?" The sowing and reaping and harvesting, to which Jesus refers, is that of selfish deeds, as also the "toiling" and "spinning" which follow in a subsequent sentence. And Man, whose Origin and Heritage is Paradise and who as Son of God harmonises in himself all the Elements, is greater than the Bird. The same ideas are woven out a little more in the verses to follow, and the concluding words are: "Your heavenly Father knoweth that ye have need of all these things. But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you." These words imply that the things of the Spirit, the things concerning the Sacred Path of Tradition, are to be attended to *first*. Jesus did not say *alone*. He implied that the first and foremost attention should be given to the matters of the Spirit, the seeking of the Kingdom, the pursuit of the right action, and that "all the rest" would shape itself of its own accord. This teaching is found prominently in the books of the great Chinese sages Lao-Tze and Chuang-Tze. They said that if only men would devote themselves to the pursuit and practice of Tao, and "do nothing", the problems of the world right themselves of their own accord, as a natural outcome. Lao-Tze, writing a little later than 600 B.C., said: "Perfect Virtue acquires nothing; therefore it obtains everything. Perfect Virtue does nothing, yet there is nothing which it does not effect." And he writes: The wearing of gay embroidered robes, the carrying of sharp

swords, fastidiousness of food and drink, superabundance of property and wealth this I call flaunting robbery, most assuredly it is not Tao" And further on in his Tao-The-King he says "Tao is eternally, inactive, and yet it leaves nothing undone If kings and rulers could but hold fast to this principle, all things would work out their own reformation" Chuang-Tze has very much to say on this matter, along the line of "Rest in inaction, and the world will be good of itself" (Ch XI) The complicated laws and rules which aim at solving the problems and tangles of modern life would have filled him with the greatest disgust and contempt, much as he felt already of these for the far less complicated measures for "reforming the world" of his own time, which he styled "ways of meddling with the universe" But literalists should not read into such ideas a defence of laziness or idleness Jesus said "*Seek ye first the kingdom of God*" "Seeking" is desiring and striving for The kingdom of God should come first of all Jesus might have said with the Philosopher of old (Chuang-Tze, Ch XI) "Nowadays, all living things from the dust spring, and to dust return But I will lead you through the portals of Eternity into the domain of Infinity My light is the light of the Sun and Moon My life is the life of heaven and earth I know not who comes nor who goes Men may all die, but I endure forever" So it was at the time of Chuang-Tze, so it was in the time of Jesus, so it is now, and so it will be in the future

Mechanics and Modern men who are proud of the mechanical achievements of the age of applied science, sub-cycle of the

Dark Age, should understand that in long past ages science was very much more developed as regards the sub-sciences of great human utility — like astronomy, medicine and surgery — than is now commonly accepted As regards the mechanical sciences, these were on the whole not so developed, not because the ancient forefathers had not the intellectual capacities for them, but because their interests were focussed on things more essential to human nature Mechanics were realized to be what they always tend to become, instruments of "coveting" and great Ahankâric temptations In the scheme of things they could be used safely only by the Sages — if these were not intent upon setting an example In the Book of Chuang-Tze (Ch XII) is recounted, that Tze Kung, a disciple of Confucius, once saw a gardener taking water from a well with the help of a bucket, and pouring it into a ditch to water his garden He said "If you had a machine here, in a day you could irrigate a hundred times your present area" The gardener flushed up and said "I have heard from my Teacher that those who have cunning implements are

cunning in their dealings, and that those who are cunning in their dealings have cunning in their hearts, and that those who have cunning in their hearts cannot be pure and incorrupt, and that those who are not pure and incorrupt are restless in spirit, and that those who are restless in spirit are not fit for vehicles for Tao. It is not that I do not know of these things. I should be ashamed to use them . . . Begone! Do not interrupt my work." Tze Kung changed colour and slunk away. Afterwards, when talking to a disciple, he compared the gardener with his Master, Confucius: "I used to think there was only one man in all the world, I did not know there was also this man." The modern attitude is inclined to ridicule such a story and talk cheaply about "putting the clock back". But every man who takes his life seriously, and who aims at walking the ancient yet ever-new Path of universal Tradition, will have to recognize the element of truth in it. And it should be remembered that not science or mechanics are to be blamed for anything that might be evil in the world, but only what is mistakenly called "human nature", or, in other words, the Ahankâra, the Devil. In Justin's Dialogue with Trypho a saying of Jesus has been recorded: "In whatsoever things I find you, in the same will I judge you." As regards the clock, it ever moves forwards and the times it indicates ever recur.

"Thought for the morrow". Jesus continues his "sermon" with: "Take therefore no thought for the morrow: for the morrow shall take thought for the things of itself. Sufficient unto the day is the evil thereof." The long-view of economics is responsible for much evil in the life of individuals and nations. For imaginary future benefits, based on coveting, the entire world was plunged into the second world-war, in the East and in the West. Individually and collectively, men are inclined to look backwards and to look forwards, like Epimetheus and Prometheus. But who has the courage to live in the present and to tackle the evil which is ever present and which can be tackled only in the form it takes from moment to moment, as coveting and envy and jealousy and stealing of the Fire from Heaven? That evil is always present within the very soul itself, and there is no excuse for people that they cannot deal with it. If they ignore it, it is due to weakness, cowardice, ignorance or laziness. All these together or individually form the "blindness" and "darkness" which symbolize the end of the Path in the year-cycle of Manifestation for those who cannot as yet see light.

Literalists should not interpret these ideas in the sense that everybody should stop planning and organizing! Tradition never aims at revolution-

izing the outer form of life, it aims at bringing about a change of heart. It works from within to without, unlike modern methods, which try to work from without to within. When the Spirit takes over charge from the Ahankâra, "the world will come right of its own accord"

The sin of idleness. The opposite of the Virtue of "Inaction" is the Sin of Idleness or Sloth, the greatest and subtlest of the Seven Sins, as will be seen later. It implies "laissez aller" in worldly living with the utter lack of striving for spiritual realization. It is spiritual laziness, and forms the particular Sin of the stage of the Zodiac under consideration. It will be seen later, that it is particularly the Sin of the present Age.

Judging others. These teachings refer particularly to the Tenth Stage and the House of Capricorn, the House admitting to the Eternal Now of Aquarius. Before That may be experienced the moment of now in time must be learned to be made full use of. The best use is that of self-reform. But self-reform is very difficult, whereaa the reform of others is very tempting. In the next sentence (Ch. 7) Jesus says "Judge not, that ye be not judged. For with what judgment ye judge, ye shall be judged: and with what measure ye mete, it shall be measured to you again." In connection with Leo it has been noted that "judgment" refers to the Ether-Sphere. It is an attribute of Jupiter, King and Guru. Jesus has been called the Sun of Justice. The Ahankâra is always ready to take the seat of judgment upon other Ahankâras — which are none but reflections of himself. His judgment, however, is based on unconscious Ahankâric failings, as, for instance, self-righteousness or jealousy, or on revengeful feelings. The words of Jesus further imply that spiritually a man is judged by his own standard. "In whatsoever things I find you, in the same will I judge you", also applies here. The world is everywhere — in individuals, groups, sects and nations — engaged in doing what Jesus condemns next. "And why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but considerest not the beam that is in thine own eye? Or how wilt thou say to thy brother, Let me pull out the mote out of thine eye, and behold, a beam is in thine own eye? Thou hypocrite, first cast out the beam out of thine own eye, and then shalt thou see clearly to cast out the mote out of thy brother's eye." The "eye" is typically Capricornian.

"Pearls before the swine". Next Jesus says "Give not that which is holy unto the dogs, neither cast ye pearls before swine, lest they trample them under their feet, and turn again and rend you." The dog referred to here is not man's faithful friend and guardian, but the Dog of Hell. He is the guardian not at the Door which leads to Heaven, but at the other of the Two Doors, leading to Hell. Capricorn is the House of Hell for those who pass the Door of the Fall, and are under the sway of Satan. The Dog at the Threshold is the terrible Cerberus of Greek and Roman tradition, called Garmir in Norse tradition, and known by other names in Egypt and elsewhere. The "swine" which Jesus refers to, is a Capricornian animal which, like the dog, will again be referred to at greater length. It has been mentioned already in connection with Jesus' exorcism of devils, in the Chapter which follows the last Chapter of the Sermon on the Mount. The "pearls" constitute that part of the Treasure which has already been obtained with toil and tears. It should be safeguarded from the Ahankâra, in oneself as well as in others. Everyone knows what "a pig" and "a swine" is.

The false. The following part of Jesus' Sermon on the Mount has already been mentioned with reference to previous Capricornian connections. After that Jesus says "Beware of false prophets, which come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly are ravening wolves." Though accidental, the "ravening" echoes what has been said before about Ahankâric grabbing, rapaciousness, ravishing, and so on. The wolf is nothing but the wild dog, which is the enemy of man, stealing his milch-cattle. It figures prominently in European tradition as the "werewolf" and as the terrible Fenris-wolf, to be dealt with later. The Teoth Resemblance In Which One May Err, in the Precepts of the Gurus, is "Charlatans may be mistaken for sages." Jesus says "Ye shall know them by their fruits. Do men gather grapes of thorns, or figs of thistles?" The grape comes from the Vine, and the thorn is a symbol of sin in Hebrew tradition. "Even so every good tree bringeth forth good fruit, but a corrupt tree bringeth forth evil fruit." The "fruits" are the "fruits of action" which figure so prominently in Hindu teachings. They are Karma. "A good tree cannot bring forth evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit." There is a profound ancient Chinese parallel to these words, found in the Book of the Elixir. "When the right man (the white magician) makes use of the wrong means, the wrong means work in the right way. But if the wrong man uses the right means, the right means work in the wrong way." These sayings should be meditated upon by those who want

to improve the world by "Maszregeln" The only way of improving the world is by means of holiness In politics character counts vastly more than doctrines and methods "Every tree that bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire Wherefore by their fruits ye shall know them" Next come the closing words of Jesus on the Mountain, in which he rejects those of the Christians who only are Christians in name, and proclaims that all those who do the will of the Father enter into the Kingdom of Heaven With these words Christian sectarianism and exclusiveness stand condemned, and the Universal, truly "Catholic" Church at the heart of all the traditions of the world stands glorified "Not everyone that saith unto me, Lord, Lord, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven, but he that doeth the will of my Father which is in heaven Many will say in that day, Lord, Lord, have we not prophesied in thy name? and in thy name have cast out devils? and in thy name have done wonderful works? And then I will profess unto them, I never knew you depart from me, ye that work iniquity" In the next Chapter (8, 12) Jesus said, referring to the faith of a Roman soldier "Many shall come from the East and the West, and shall sit down with Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, in the kingdom of heaven But the children of the kingdom shall be cast out into outer darkness there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth" Those who are Christians merely in name, instead of passing the Gate of Light, go down through the Gate of Darkness The mere confession of Christ's name is no sure means of Salvation and may lead many into great delusion On the other hand people belonging to other traditions will win the kingdom of heaven if they follow the ancient, yet ever new, Commandments of the Tradition The Light of the World is born in the hearts of people belonging to all traditions and living in all parts of the world

The rock and the sand. "Therefore whosoever heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them, I will liken him unto a wise man, which built his house upon a rock And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house, and it fell not, for it was founded upon a rock And everyone that heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them not, shall be likened unto a foolish man, which built his house upon the sand and the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house, and it fell and great was the fall thereof" In these final words Jesus refers to the Houses of Aquarius and Pisces, in which man obtains either the Water of Life or Elixir of Immortality, of gets its opposite in the form of a Deluge

If "death prevails", man will fall into the Ocean of Samsâra, the Sea of Worldliness, and have to start all over again in the next Cycle of Manifestation. The rock to which Jesus refers, is the Immovable Rock of Tradition, the Immovable Pole of Spirit (see Diagram 1a) and the sand is the Sand of Time and the unreliable quicksand of Mâyâ, consisting of innumerable fragments.

Finally St. Matthew records: "And it came to pass, when Jesus had ended these sayings, the people were astonished at his doctrine: For he taught them as one having authority, and not as the scribes."

The very beginning of the Sermon on the Mountain reveals its mystic and symbolic nature. Instead of beginning with "thou shalt", the teachings referring to the first nine stages on the Path begin with "Blessed!", and those for the last stage, which is one of "becoming what one IS", begin with "Ye are".

The fulfilment of tradition. Two sentences of Jesus at the beginning (5; 17—18) still remain to be considered. They refer to the stage of Pisces, the House in which the Tradition is revealed by the Guru for the benefit of the Cycle to come. He says: "Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil. For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled."

Whenever Tradition is revealed anew by one who has "heard and seen" and been given authority, the people, who are generally of a conservative nature — because it is safe to hold to the old — and accustomed, as they are, to "reformers" who attack human institutions, are taken by a fear that their heritage may be destroyed. Therefore Jesus, as other great Revealers and Teachers, affirms that he lives to fulfil the Tradition of old. And more than that: he firmly asserts and prophesies that the Tradition will always guide the destiny of the human race, till the end of time. "Fulfilment" implies also perfection. The entire "law", that is to say, the whole of sacred tradition, leads to that fulfilment and perfection, the perfection of Man, „even as your father which is in heaven is perfect" (5; 48). In this verse the dualistic and non-dualistic principles are very cleverly and satisfactorily balanced. The "one jot or one tittle" also implies more than is evident from the surface. We have seen that the jot is the Greek iôta and the Hebrew yôd; and we have noted some of their correspondents and relatives. The sacred letter is found in "Jupiter", in "Jehovah", in "Zeus", in "Zyaus-pita", and even in "God". It is also found in "Jesus"

and in "John" "John" meant originally "Yah grants his grace" (See further "Evolution, Paradise and the Fall, Chapter 8)

The Ten or Twelve Commandments or Rules or Restraints contain, in their esoteric and mystical aspects, the entire teaching needed for a disciple on the Path. The disciple's task is to *see* the Guru, to *hear* the tradition, and to *live* in accordance. All teachings embodied in sacred myths and legends and in popular fairy-tales and stories which have been based upon them, are connected with the Rules and Restraints. The Holy War between the Angels of Light and the Powers of Darkness rages on the field covered by the Rules and Restraints within the human soul. That Battlefield has its focal centre in the Solar plexus, though it extends over the whole man. It is presided over by Jupiter-Jehovah, the Ruler and Guru, with the Thunderbolt in one hand, and the other hand held up in blessing.

21 THE THREE FORMS OF AHANKĀRA OR EGO-ACTIVITY

Sāttvic Ahankāra. During the consideration of the Ten Stages of the Path through Manifestation, we have seen that the Ahankāra, the Devil of separateness, coveting and the other Sins of the Fall, is prominent in the first and last Houses of Manifestation. The word "Ahankāra", literally "I-factor", has so far been used in a very wide sense. According to Hindu tradition there are three forms or manifestations of Ahankāra, according to the Three Qualities of the Dynamic Universe.

The first form of Ahankāra is Sāttvic, or pure and harmonious. It is more than "human" and refers to Consciousness. It includes the most exalted consciousness-states in which there is a subtle distinction between Divinity and a self, however much attuned and communing.

Tāmasic Ahankāra. This Sāttvic Ahankāra is the opposite of Tāmasic Ahankāra. The word Tamas, dealt with elsewhere, means "inertia, darkness, materiality, gloom, ignorance".

The traditional function of Tamas is that of veiling consciousness. Out of Tāmasic Ahankāra evolve the Tanmātras, or subtle, causal Elements, and out of these originate the Mahābhūtas, the Great Elements. Earth, Water, Fire, Air, and Ether. The Sāttvic Ahankāra represents the life-aspect of the Universe, the Tāmasic Ahankāra the form-aspect. The former is Divine, the latter Titanic. The former concerns consciousness and the

latter form, — form on all planes, from Earth, the most material, to the Moon-Ether, the least material.

Elsewhere the scheme of correspondence of "the senses" and the Elements has been dealt with. It is the scheme on which the psychological traditions are founded. For completeness' sake the scheme of Tāmasic Ahankāra may be here mentioned. At a first glance it reveals its Material nature. It belongs to the Sāṅkhya School (and is found, for instance, in the Mahābhārata II; 233; 4—7, Manu I; 75—78, and the Bhāgavata Purāna Dialogue between Śrī Krishna and Uddhava).

According to it the Tanmātra or "cause, subtle quality, characteristic" of the Element Earth is "odour"; that of the Element Water is "taste"; that of the Element Tejo, "Fire, Light" is Rūpa, "form and colour"; that of the Element Air is "space, sensitiveness, touch"; and that of the Element Ether is "sound", namely the A of the Om (AUM). The dissolution of the Material Universe is taught by Krishna to Uddhava to take place in the following order: Earth — Odour — Water — Essence — Fire — Form and Colour — Air — Touch — Ether — Sound — Tāmasic Ahankāra.

Krishna teaches: "Out of Tāmasic Ahankāra the Five Elements came forth, out of Rājasic Ahankāra the Senses, and out of Sāttvika Ahankāra the Eleven Devas and Pure Reason."

The Eleven Devas and Pure Reason represent Divinity as manifesting itself in the Twelve Houses of Time. Tāmasic Ahankāra will not be encountered much in these pages. In accordance with this tradition, "touch" (or "feeling") is sometimes associated with Air, also in deeper symbolical contexts.

Rājasic Ahankāra. Remains the third form of Ahankāra, which stands, as it were, midway between the other two. It is Rājasic Ahankāra. Sometimes it is also called Aindriya Ahankāra, or "Ahankāra pertaining to the Senses". It is that form of Ahankāra which will be dealt with almost exclusively in these pages. The Guna or "Quality" of Rajas is that of "motion, activity, passion, etc." The function of Rajas sets the Universe in motion. It associates with Sattva in order to reveal Consciousness, and with Tamas in order to veil Consciousness. It is clear that this is the form of Ahankāra which is pre-eminently "human". Tradition holds that it works in the Buddhi, the function of spiritual discrimination, in the Indriyas or "senses or organs of perception and action", and in the Prānas or "vital airs". It is also called Tajasic Ahankāra. Tajasic has been considered before. It is the "middle state" of consciousness, "whose region is dream"

as the Māndūkya-Upanishad says It concerns the Elements Water and Fire

The function of Rajas or Activity sets the Universe in motion It is clear that the combination of Rajas and Ahankāra is the source of all "evil", from the human point of view

Veiled and revealed Consciousness, in their numerous aspects, are the source of the many forms of the Divine Play of God But when the Ahankāra connected with the creative forces begins to use the implements of Play for its separative and monopolizing purposes, the Playground is turned into a Battlefield The Titans, as Lords of Form, though by origin pure, become the servants in the might of the Devil In many myths and scriptures they become identified with Evil

The "inaction" and 'doing nothing", advised by Lao-Tze and Chuang-Tze, and by so many of the Sages of India and other traditions, causes the destruction of the Rajasic Ahankāra, by the shining forth of Pure Consciousness Evil should not be countered by evil If this is done, the original evil may be checked on the surface, but it will grow underground and some day it will come to a worse outbreak than before Buddha said in the Dhammapāda "Let a man overcome anger by love, let him overcome evil by good, let him overcome the greedy by liberality, the liar by truth For hatred does not cease by hatred at any time, hatred ceases by love, this is an old rule"

Egotism and deliverance. Concerning the Ahankara, Buddha said "Self is a fever, self is transient vision, a dream, but truth is wholesome, truth is sublime, truth is everlasting There is no immortality except in truth For truth abideth forever" These words were spoken in Buddha's first sermon, in the Deer-park at Benares There he also said "Happy is he who has overcome all selfishness, happy is he who has attained peace, happy is he who has found the truth The truth is noble and sweet, the truth can deliver you from evil There is no saviour in the world except the truth"

It may seem to be a stupendous task to the aspirant to achieve "the overcoming of all selfishness", and to do what various teachings have described as purifying oneself, surrendering oneself, conquering oneself, forgetting oneself and annihilating oneself But it is always a consolation and encouragement to him to know that others have gone the Path before him, and achieved the Goal, and to be told, either by word of mouth by a Guru, or by the recorded word of a Guru of a former age, that, though he may think the struggle for the achievement of the Goal a tremendous one, after its achievement he will laugh at his former fears and efforts Then

he will realize that the Goal only exists from the point of view of the Fallen Man. The True Man has never lost the Paradise — which therefore cannot be regained. When the Fallen Man loses his Ahankāra — “a fever, a transient vision, a dream” — he realizes at the same time his perfect identity with the True Man, ever pure and immortal, ever blissful and peaceful. The Medicine of Truth has healed him from his fever, steady Vision of God replaces transient visions, when he awakes from the dream of worldly entanglements to a truer Waking State. From that angle of Vision, “everything is Mâyâ”, indeed! In reality there is only what Hindu tradition calls Sat-Chit-Ânanda, meaning “Being-Consciousness-Bliss”, a Trinity of Reality corresponding to Father — Mother — Son, the same as Father — Holy Spirit — Son, and also corresponding to Supernal Sun — Supernal Moon — Emanated Light. From the angle of Perfection there never was, is, nor can be anything else but Perfection, God-head, Reality, Divinity. From that angle Titanic Creation, ever shifting and changing, is not Reality. From that angle Ahankāric coveting, stealing and misuse, and the Fall, are not Reality.

This angle of vision, however, should not be appropriated by an unpurified mind. It can only be one of realization. Reason cannot and should not try to *grasp* it. Reason should, in accordance with “common sense”, which pertains to it, accept the relative reality of the Mâyâvic world, as the objects of experience in the Spiritual Path. Such is sacred teaching.

The necessity of a Guru. In order to walk that Path, the great traditions have laid stress on the necessity of following holy men, prophets and guides. It is necessary, as Hindu tradition expresses it, “to sit at the Feet of a Guru”. For different stages on the Path it is necessary for different reasons. It is necessary for a strengthening of faith, for the development of humility, for the purification of feelings and thoughts, for the overcoming of fear, for suitable doctrinal guidance, for the development of a spirit of dispassion and renunciation, and — first, foremost and last — for that inexpressible mysterious quintessential element which characterises only the great Guru for what he is to his disciples, apart from and beyond all feelings of devotion, mental admiration and spiritual inspiration.

The traditional necessity to sit at the Feet of a Master has, for obvious reasons, been lost in those religions and sects where true Gurus ceased to be available. For equally obvious reasons it is restored in the time of the birth of a new religion. Christianity would never have become a great religion, if the twelve disciples of Jesus, and so many others, had not sat

at the Feet of their Lord In times of decay there has always been a background of spiritual authority taking the form of a religious hierarchy and thus has served the purpose to some extent, but on the whole it serves only for the lower steps in spiritual advancement A religion or religious organization should be adhered to and by no means abandoned, unless such action be the outcome of an unmistakable call of the Spirit The spiritual aspirant should always be ready to revolutionize his own inner life, broadening and freeing it, while at the same time accepting the limitations of the world If he frees himself from bonds in the outer world — including those of religious institutions — before the proper time of inner freedom has arrived, he will forge for himself new limitations within his soul "Escapes" will never do, where they are forms of Ahankâric escapades The only legitimate escape is that from the clutches of the Ahankâra

22 KARMA, AND THE SYMBOLISM OF ANCESTORS

The purpose of rituals. While accepting the limitations of the world, it should be remembered that those very limitations are aids in the achievement of the spiritual Goal Tradition has furthermore at all times used the limitations of the world for its purposes of purification and enlightenment The rituals of all religions form the examples of such adaptation to the limitations of the lower planes, and especially the physical The purpose of rituals is to purify the emotions and the mind and concentrate the attention on divine things They consist in action-patterns for the guidance of a person on the Path from lower to higher Spheres, and back again, after the notion of at-onement has been symbolically conveyed Their purpose is the synthesis of the fragmented personality and the consecutive liberation of the Fallen Man from the bonds which bind him in the Six Spheres They focus the soul in spiritual rather than worldly karmas

The Intelligence of Karma. We have already seen that Ganapati, the Elephant-headed God of Hindu tradition, is the Lord of the Two Paths and the God of Obstacles The "obstacles" over which he presides are the karmas, or actions and their results In Sanskritic terms they are the "prârabdha karma" (i.e. the karma "already taken hold of") Obstacles on the spiritual Path are chiefly the results of Ahankâric or "evil" actions, but the results of "good" actions may also become obstacles It often happens that if the life of a man takes too good

a turn, and if the troubles of life in the form of sickness, poverty, family worries and so on, keep away from him, that he tends to fall spiritually asleep. Some saints, well aware of the deadening influence of "good luck" are known to have prayed to God to send them troubles and calamities rather than favourable circumstances and occurrences. Some traditions have advised people to renounce not only evil, but also merit, starting from the premises that "good karmas" may form a source of bondage as well as "bad karmas". The attractive heavens with fair damsels in gardens with beautiful flowers in which fountains of wine spring up, which by the simple-minded of some traditions are conceived in a literal instead of symbolic way and looked upon as an enticement to "be good", do not form lesser obstacles on the Path of one who aims at more than just "being good", than the terrible "bells" which the traditions describe in order to put the fear of God into the "wicked". As Lord of Obstacles Ganapati is called Vighneśvara. As Guide and Initiator he is called Vinâyaka. He is also given the title of Jagatkârana, "Ultimate Cause of the Universe".

Ganapati. Ganapati, the Lord of the Two Paths, is like Janus also the Lord of Initiation, that is to say, initiation from a more exoteric into a more esoteric Path, or initiation into The Path. The two festivals of Ganapati are celebrated in Hinduism in Capricorn and in Leo, the two stages where the Path touches the Ether-summit of the Mountain of Manifestation. Ganapati's Jayanthi or Birthday is celebrated in Capricorn, the House of Birth. His other festival is celebrated in the period of Leo. It is characterised by a ceremony, of much beauty, very popular with the younger generation, in which a clay image of Ganapati is worshipped and garlanded with flowers in the house, and afterwards taken, generally by children, to a river or tank, or, if none is near, to a pool or well and immersed.

The propitiation of the Lord of Obstacles signifies the renunciation of those actions and tendencies which are bondage-making for the worshipper and the invocation of divine blessings for the walking on the Path of Liberation. Images of Ganapati are found at cross-roads.

Ganapati is mythologically only "elephant-headed", but is generally represented with an immense elephant-like body as well. The great qualities of the elephant are well-known. His great body is a symbol of the vastness of the Universe. His strength is a symbol of the Almightyness of God. Ganapati presides over the Gate of Birth, the Entrance to the Return Path, in yet another way. The lowest of the seven sacred centres of Yogic tradition "within the body" is presided over by him. It is the centre

of the Element Earth, situated at the bottom of the spine, and called the Mûlâdhâra or "Root-support" The Path of spiritual transmutation begins from the base, and on the physical plane

Behemoth

In various traditions the symbol of the elephant refers especially to Capricorn and invariably represents the counter-principle of the goat-serpent-crocodile leviathan The main Vehicle of Indra, the Jupiter of Hinduism, is the Elephant Airâvata, who will be considered later The vast Universe-Animal of propitious nature is also referred to in Job (40, 15—24), where he is contrasted with the Leviathan "Behold now Behemoth, which I made with thee, he eateth grass like an ox" This shows his harmless, vegetarian nature "Lo now, his strength is in his loins, and his force is in the navel of his body" This symbolism is typically Martian in nature in every detail The "navel" is the Solar plexus or navel centre His vast Martian strength is nourished not by "animal", but by vegetarian food "He moveth his tail like a cedar the sinews of his stones are wrapped together His bones are as strong pieces of brass, his bones are like bars of iron" These symbols may refer to the Elements in the order, resp., of Air, Water and Fire or Earth The next verse refers to Rulership "He is the chief of the Ways of God he that made him can make his sword to approach unto him Surely the mountains bring him forth food, where all the beasts of the field play He lieth under the shady trees, in the covert of the reed, and fens The shady trees cover him with their shadow, the willows of the brook compass him about" The second sentence means that he is fully subservient to God Mountains, beasts and trees refer to the Element Fire, the predominating Element of Manifestation But since the mountains bring food, and the beasts play, and the trees protect with their shade, the symbolism is paradise like, referring to the Ether "Behold, he drinketh up a river, and hasteth not he trusteth that he can draw up Jordan into his mouth" He is able to "oppress", as the Hebrew indicates, the great oppressor of life, the River of Worldliness, and drink it up He is also able to take in his mouth the sacred river Jordan, the Heavenly River, appearing in different contexts, in Cancer as the River of Baptism and in Aquarius as the Water of Life "He taketh it with his eyes his nose pierceth through snares" These final words again refer to the mental plane in full harmony and subservience to the Lord of the Ether, Heaven The sense of smell is that which refers to the mental plane In an elephant the nose is a powerful organ of action as well In various senses it pierces through the snares of Mâyâ

Verses to
Ganapati.

Ganapati, too, is "the chief of the ways of God". His name means "Lord of divine hosts" or "Lord of quantities, groups, aspects". Various Ganapati-verses run: "He who presides over the assemblage of the transcendental and perceptible elements is Ganapati"; "The ruler of all quantities is Ganapati"; "He who rules over all the aspects of Brahman, whether manifested, or unmanifested, is Ganapati." Ganapati's strength is also "in his loins and his force in the navel". One verse says: "Innumerable universes were born from his belly, of this there is no doubt." In the Rig-veda he is called "wealthiest (in food and fame), king of elders", and "Master of the Principle of Principles". He "guards the treasure of treasures" in the Yajur-veda, which is Capricornian symbolism in particular. A prayer in the Yajur-veda is: "May I establish thee in my heart as thou art established in the womb of Nature." The worshipper of Ganapati who is advanced enough to understand the meaning of the following prayer, prays: "O Inner Master of All, thou who takest care of the assemblies of Gods, because thou art their Support and their Seer, thou who takest care of what is loved because thou art the beloved, thou who takest care of the objects of worldly love because thou art the unworldly supreme bliss, which means that thou bringest them all to the fulfilment of their ends because they are parts of thyself; it is thee whom I call as my Master. Take care of me also and give me that joy which is the fruit of the contemplation of thy true nature. Be kind unto me that my heart be pure, and I may understand the nature of this Sun of Consciousness who, to create the world, incarnated himself in the womb of Nature (Prakriti) as reflected Consciousness. This is my request."

Every conception and sentiment in this last prayer to the Capricornian Elephant-God of India could refer also to the Capricornian Christ, the Word who created the world, the Sun of Consciousness, incarnated in the womb of Nature or Matter, the Inner Master of All, who leads all to the fulfilment of their ends because they are fragments of himself, the Support, and the Seer, he who loves and feeds his sheep, because he is the Lord of Love.

The symbo-
lism of
ancestors.

To return to the "Karmas" or results of actions, in connection with their forming obstacles on the Path to God-Reality, these are also referred to in the highly significant Hindu Śrāddha rite, a ceremony the meaning of which has been forgotten with respect to its esoteric implications. It has already been referred to when dealing with the Pitris and Pitaras,

the "forefathers" and "ancestors". Traditionally a man's ancestors are the symbols of his actions in the past, which are his antecedents. The parents on the physical plane are the result or karmic outcome of these antecedents, they form the reflection on Earth of his karmic "ancestors". A man who has evolved a noble character in the past tends to be born in a family with noble traditions — not necessarily "aristocratic", for there are also a nobility of service, a nobility of intellect and a nobility of spirituality. A man who has squandered his nobility in the past tends to be born in a degenerate family. A man who in the course of the Ages has reached the peak of "nobility" — a word evolved from the same root as "knowledge" and "Jñānam" — tends to be born in the noblest of families. Tradition confirmed that Jesus was born in the line of the Patriarch Abraham and King David. Buddha was Prince Siddhārtha of the Śākya clan.

The Primal Ancestor. Man has — in the deeper sense — two kinds of "ancestors" the Primal Ancestor, Eternal, Pure, Unde-filed, and the Fallen Man. In the Semitic traditions it is said that "all descend from Adam and Eve". Adam is both, originally he was the Son of God, later he was the Fallen Man. Because both roles could actually not be filled satisfactorily by one mythological or theological personage, the Prime Ancestor representing the Higher Man became referred to under other names or titles. Ultimately this higher Man was called the Christ, the "first-born" Son of God, who was from the "beginning", and who was the Creator of all. Because there is only One Primal Ancestor, of course, he was the Only Son of God.

In the Bhagavad Gītā Krishna similarly reveals himself as the basis of existence, the originator of sacred tradition, and the teacher of the Patriarchs of the human race (IV, 1—9). The transcendent Krishna, the transcendent Christos and the Ādi-Buddha or Primal Buddha of Buddhism are three traditional forms of the One Primal Ancestor.

The Progenitors. The Ancestor in the form of Adam who lost the Paradise-Consciousness and became the Man who had "fallen", though fallen only a little way of first stage, is found in the Patriarchs or Progenitors of the various traditions. They represent a high spiritual stage, a Golden or Silver Age, since the Fall had in them only begun.

Hindu Brāhmins belong to many clans which trace their descent from certain Vedic Rishis or Sages. Hindu tradition as a whole traces the descent of the human race from the Ten Prajāpatis* that is to say, Patriarchs or

Progenitors. The Sanskrit "prajā" and the Latin "progen" are etymologically related. The word "patriarch" comes from the Greek "pater", father, related to the Sanskrit Pitara and Pitri, and the Greek "arkhês", previously dealt with in connection with the Ark. Hindu tradition knows Ten Prajâpatis or "Lords of Progeniture". We shall see later that these find each their place in one of the Ten Houses of Manifestation. In the Brahmânda Purâna is found the tradition that the first nine of these Progenitors were condemned by their Father, Brahmâ the Creator, the Prime Prajâpati, to go to the Earth to lead the life of ordinary men and spend their time in spiritual practices, because they had given proof of a certain amount of spiritual blindness and resultant faulty judgment. The Tenth Prajâpati showed them the way to redemption. He is Nârada Rishi, whose House is Capricorn. Capricorn, the House of the Fall, is also always the House of the Saviour or Redeemer. In Greek tradition the Tenth of Primordial Titans — another form of the Ten Prajâpatis — Kronos or Saturn becomes the Saviour of his nine brothers and sisters. He represents Capricorn, the House of Christ, the Saviour. The first nine Primordial Titans were "buried in the Earth" by their Father. In the Brahmânda Purâna the Nine Prajâpatis were condemned with a "curse" to leave Heaven and go to the Earth. At the end of the Path through the Zodiac the *seeing* and the *speaking* of Truth is essential. If Truth cannot be seen and thought, and expressed in word and deed, the Fall will ensue. It is significant that the word "Fall" comes from the Latin "fallere", meaning "to deceive". From this same word have been derived the words "fallacy", "false", "fault" and "fail". Non-seeing of Truth is self-deception or falling into the snare of the Betrayer. Non-speaking, that is to say, non-acting, of Truth, is its outcome; it is deception of others and acting in the bondage of the Betrayer.

The meaning of ancestor-rites. The true descent of Man, from whatever angle it is looked upon, is from nothing but his own actions, which are the resultant of his "vision" — or rather, on the whole, lack of vision, "faulty" insight. The ancestors are the past tendencies, desires, thoughts, motives and actions. It is those "ancestors", the true ones, which determine the father and mother and grandparents which a soul obtains for its birth on Earth. Ancient forms of "ancestor-worship", misunderstood by later generations which had lost "vision", were based on this traditional conception of old. Modern man has not only lost this insight, but he has forgotten the practice of the rites of the Ancestors, so he misses an important aid in his own liberation from bondage and sorrow. His vision "fails", he is spiritually

unable to hear a "false" note, his conceptions are "fallacious", his feelings "false" and his actions betray the Fallen Man. In short, his life is based on deception.

The prime object of religious rites is the purification and liberation of "the elements of the soul." The "visiting of the iniquities of the fathers upon the children" should be prevented. Some religious rites are in correspondence with the time-scheme of the Spiritual Path through the Zodiac. Others are based on the sevenfold division of the Spheres apart from time.

The Jewish Prayers for the Dead, which are read on Friday nights and Saturdays in all services, consist exclusively in the praise of God, who awakens the Dead to eternal Life.

The Śrāddha The Hindu Śrāddha or Ancestor-rite is one of the few rite. major traditional rites of a private nature which are still faithfully observed by the traditional-minded among the Hindu higher castes. Its significance, if no more understood, is still intuitively felt. It is celebrated with the help of some priests in the centre or main part of the house, near the ever-burning lamp, if one is kept in the house. Near that is a small representation of the ever-present Ganapati, usually in the form of a little mound. The Śrāddha rite is performed for the immediate ancestors that have died during a person's lifetime and for which no Śrāddha has yet been done. The maximum number is six, comprising the four grandparents and the two parents, plus the "primal ancestor" or founder of the clan, as the seventh.

For this Śrāddha rite, there is made near the everburning lamp on the floor, with the symbol of Ganapati at its side, a symbolic representation of the Seven Rivers, consisting mostly of flowers. The Seven Rivers represent the Seven Gods on the Plane of Water, which is, as has been noted previously, especially that of the "ancestors" or "forefathers." Every person has noticed that when death occurs in a family and a loved relative has passed away from the physical plane, the focus of consciousness in the house shifts from the physical to the emotional plane. It is a matter of common experience, that after a person has died on Earth, he manifests himself to those who love him as overwhelmingly alive in the next Element, Water, the plane of feeling, desire and emotional imagination. Separation may have occurred on the physical plane, but on the emotional plane the bond of attachment is accentuated with the greatest reality. After a while, when the deceased passes from the Element Water to higher spheres, the link between the living and the deceased becomes focussed in the more

subtle and lasting spiritual spheres, at the same time losing its acute emotional pain and sorrow. This is the case for those who are spiritually advanced on the Return Path to Divinity. For those who have no spiritual inclinations, death is death indeed, and never reveals itself as liberation in nobler and more lasting realms.

The symbol of the River comprises the flowing of the element of feeling and desireful imagination through the sands of Time in the Zodiac. According to whether the river-symbol is connected with the Return Path to God-Reality or with the Fall, it is respectively the Heavenly River of Life or the River of Death, flowing through the Underworld. The River is generally represented in the traditions as having ten branches or as consisting of ten rivers, corresponding to the ten Houses of Manifestation. The Source of the River is in Aquarius and Pisces.

"Open Sesame"! The representation of the Seven Rivers is made by the help of flowers, another symbol of the emotional plane.

On the right of it is made a symbolic representation of Mount Meru together with the whole Hindu Pantheon. The mountain consists, according to custom, of five kinds of grain mixed together. These are sesame, called in India gingily, wheat, two kinds of pulse, called in India dhall, and rice. These represent, of course, the Pañchabhūtas or Five Elements, out of which the "Mountain" of the Manifest Universe is composed. Sesame or gingily is an interesting symbol. It is well-known from the tale of "Ali Baba and the forty thieves". The forty thieves represent the ten times four Elements of the Manifested Cycle, also found in other groups of forty, referred to elsewhere. They guard their "treasure" which is hidden in a "cave" in the rock. We have seen before that this symbolism is typically Capricornian and Aquarian. The Treasure is guarded in many myths by a Dragon which is not to be trifled with. The magic word which opens unto the treasure of the forty thieves is "Open Sesame!" When the disciple on the Spiritual Path learns the mystic secrets of the Elements, of which those of the Element Earth are hardest to learn, because it is the crudest Element, he can find the Treasure of God-Reality. The Thief of the Ahankāra anxiously watches that the Treasure does not fall into the hands of the soul, for if this happens it results in his unmasking and death. But the soul must take great care that it does not obtain the mystic secret which admits into the Treasure-Cave by "stealth", and before it has been sufficiently purified and prepared for passing that great Gate of Initiation. Woe unto the intruder if he ventures near the Treasure before he has obtained the necessary qualifications; if he, like

the unfortunate brother of Alı Baba, after admitting himself to the Treasure forgets the magic word, and tries to escape by calling out the names of other grains, referring to other Planes of Existence! These keys do not fit this lock, and he is trapped and caught by the returning forty thieves, who cut him into six parts, illustrating the dilaceration of the Fall

According to Menander cakes of sesame had a fertilizing quality. In his time they were therefore not lacking at Greek weddings. The connection with the above mentioned traditions is evident.

Offerings in the Śrāddha. On the top of Mount Meru, symbolized by the mixture of the Five Grains, is put a silver pot with a big bunch of flowers in it. These are said to represent all the Gods. The pot, made of silver, represents the Kumbha of the Moon-Sphere, with the Water of Life of the Moon-Sphere.

During the rite, the details of which need not be given here, offerings of food are placed before the seats intended for the deceased parents and grandparents for which the rite is performed. The offerings placed before each seat consist of six heaps of grains of different varieties around a central seventh bigger heap of rice. Afterwards vegetables are also added. In the rite as performed in the Brāhman community the meals are cooked and afterwards eaten by Brāhman priests and guests. In the Śaiva Siddhānta community the offerings are uncooked and afterwards taken away by the officiating priests. After the making of these offerings the Homa or sacrificial fire is made up of sticks of wood in a central place, and lighted. It is further fed by liquid butter and incense of different varieties is offered in it. The Homa-offerings consist of nine different kinds of grain: sesame or gingily, wheat, two varieties of white pulse or dhal, senna seeds, two varieties of white gram, mustard seed, and ordinary dhal. The nine grains represent the seeds of the first nine Houses of Manifestation of the Zodiacal Path. It will be noted that it is almost entirely a rite dealing with products of the vegetable kingdom, which is the kingdom which symbolizes the Element Water or plane of feeling and emotion. Seeds represent the Karmas of that plane, and occur whenever there is question of new generation and fertility. They are symbols of latent life, of unborn life, of life to come in the next cycle. Therefore they occur in family rites, comprising those of marriage and birth as well as those of death. Seeds symbolize hidden tendencies and desires, for it is from these that the life of the new cycle will spring forth.

In addition to the nine kinds of grain there is a tenth offering of flowers and fruits. These symbolize the flowering and fruition of the spiritual

striving of the soul in the Tenth House, Capricorn. Fruits are a superior kind of seeds. Custom demands that the offered fruits are cut open. The meaning is, that they should be prevented from sprouting in the next Cycle. The object of the Śrāddha rite, in contradistinction to that of the rites of family-continuance, is Liberation, and Enjoyment of the Sweetness of Perfection. Coco-nuts, according to Hindu custom, have to be cracked when offered. Their hard outer shell is said to represent the Ahankāra or the Earth-Element, the fruit-flesh the "antariksha" or mid-region of the soul, the sweet water the Jñānavāri or Water of the Spirit, and the empty space the Ākāśa or Ether. Coco-nuts, however, are not essential for the Śrāddha rite.

The Six Parents represent a person's past Karma, his creative impulses and tendencies which shape his future in the Six Spheres and on the path as conceived in terms of the Zodiac. They are the Powers which brought about his very existence, and it is those Powers which have to be liberated from all traces of Ahankāric bondage, in order that they may attain Immortality and Bliss. The six parents, who form the reflection of those Powers on the physical plane, get the full benefit from the Śrāddha rite, one which may be expected to be performed with great depth of feeling and devotion. The exoteric and the esoteric, the ritualistic and the mystical, the actual — a word implying action — and the anagogical, are intimately related.

The consummation of the rite is the offering to the "primal ancestor". It is symbolic of final synthesis and harmonization, and dissolution in the Central Heart of All, the Seventh Sphere, the Supernal Sun and Father.

To the "primal ancestor" are offered seven balls, which, according to custom, should be of the size of either an egg or a coco-nut. These balls each consist of a mixture of seven things: sesame, wheat, ginger, dhall, jaggery or brown country-sugar, honey, and liquid butter mixed with rice flour. Significant is also that at the conclusion of the rite these seven balls should not be eaten by human beings, but should be either given to crows or thrown into a river. The crow is a form of the Bird of Spirit which has a traditional link with the ancestors because it is almost domestic in its habits. The River represents the Water from which everything on earth springs and to which it returns. The Heavenly River or Ocean is Aquarius, the House which is the Source and the Ultimate Abode. The symbolism of the immersing in water is found in many Hindu traditions. Where it is not a purification ceremony, it is one of the "merging and dissolving" of Karmas. The latter is, duly considered, in fact the ultimate and supreme purification. The immersing of an image of Ganapati has already been mentioned, as also the immersing of a "burnt brick", also

representing a deceased person Custom demands that, when the seven balls and the burnt brick are carried to the river and immersed, one should keep silence This is understandable, for Silence symbolizes the Ultimate State of God-Reality or Self-Realization, and the Word implies Creation The object of this rite is liberation from Ahankâric rebirths in the World of Manifestation Talk would spoil the magic of the rite, connected, as it is, with the creative processes on the Four Planes of Manifestation It is significant that in some Indian languages the word for "talk" is derived from "Samsâra" Samsâra is "the round of birth and death", life in world-involvement

Love and death. The performer of the rite and the persons for whom the rite is performed are or were related on the physical plane by family relationship, on the plane of feeling by love and other emotions, on the mental plane by psychical karma, on the spiritual plane by spiritual karma, and on the higher planes by more mystical and lasting links In accordance with the relative degree of grossness of the materia of the various planes, separation is the most evident on the physical plane On the plane of emotional love separation becomes less marked and strong On every subsequent plane separation becomes less and unity more marked On the higher plane of love, that of the Spirit, unity predominates far over separation In the ultimate State, the Seventh, there is only pure and undivided Oneness But even in the Ether-Sphere that Oneness is visioned, and in the light of that Sphere ultimately every son of Man will see and proclaim "I and my Father are one" When he attains that realization, he has liberated his Primal Ancestor, Adam, from the bondage of the Fall, and attained unto the Heavenly Primal Ancestor, the Supernal Father, the "Seventh" On reaching that realization, death cannot hold any more sorrow by separating those who love, whether it be parent and child, lover and beloved, friend and friend, Guru and disciple It is in this high sense that "love conquers death" not the love of the plane of feeling, not even the love of the spirit, but the Charis or Grace of God That is the true A-mor, the "Immortal", the "Amrita" — Love and the Love-Draught in one, as Medicine of Life the antidote to the Poison of Death

23. THE MYTH OF ERÔS AND PSUKHÊ. THE GREAT LONGING

Erôs and Psukhê.

The Higher Love or Grace of God, in which there is perfect Oneness, and the lower forms of love, which bring separation and constant sorrow, are contrasted in

the myth of Erôs and Psukhê. This myth holds all the important distinctives of the Fall and of the Return and Reunion of the soul with the Divine. The Greek "psukhê" means the soul. Derived is "psychology", the science of the soul. The word "soul" is generally used in a wide sense — as it is also in these pages — as denoting everything in between the physical body and the Basic Divine Reality. The etymology of "psukhê" we have considered elsewhere in more detail. Like the related Arabic word "nafs", it implies the soul as inclined towards the world of the flesh. Psukhikos meant "animal, carnal, carnally inclined". Its opposite was "pneumatikos", implying a soul inclined towards the heights. The "psukhikos" is, as it were, the "out-breathing soul", and the "pneumatikos" the "in-breathing soul", for both words imply air and breath.

Psukhê was the daughter of a queen of the island of Crete. She was so beautiful that she was worshipped by the people as the Goddess of Love, Aphrodîtê or Venus, herself. This mistaking of the reflection in form and matter for the divinity itself naturally "displeased the Goddess". Aphrodîtê sent her son, Erôs, the most beautiful of the Gods, to make Psukhê fall in love with the ugliest man available. But fate willed that Erôs fell in love with her himself. He had her transported by the Zephyrs, the Southern Winds, his servants, to his heavenly abode. There Psukhê learned to know heavenly bliss in the arms of the God of Love himself. Erôs, however, visited her only in complete darkness, and forbade her ever to try and find out who he was. This prohibition occurs in many myths and fairy-tales. We have come across it before in the legend of Elsa of Brabant who was forbidden by her saviour and husband, Lohengrin, to ask who he was or whence he came. This prohibition is a form of the prohibition to eat the Fruit of the Tree of Knowledge, which forbids the opening of a particular door. Each form of prohibition has reference to another aspect or level of the same problem.

After a while Psukhê was tempted to find out who her Lover was; she lit an oil-lamp and looked at him in his sleep. When she beheld the most beautiful of all Beings she was much startled and her hand which held the lamp shook. By accident a drop of hot oil fell from the lamp on the shoulder of Erôs, who woke up and immediately left her. In this myth the Fall is

again prompted by curiosity and Fire is again the means by which it is brought about. The sacred olive-oil, connected with the Moon-Sphere, should also not be spilled. The mystery of the Grace and Being of God should not be enquired into by the lower mind. No personal possessive attitude should enter into the communion with the Divine. Love requires perfect surrender in perfect darkness and in perfect innocence. True faith "asks no questions" and does not need to know separate details. It knocks at the Door, and when the voice from within asks "Who is there?" it replies "It is Thou!"

Psukhê was inconsolable and wandered around, passing through many trials. Finally she arrived in the realm of the Goddess Aphrodîtê and entered her service. She was treated by Aphrodîtê like a slave. If Erôs had not helped her invisibly, she would have succumbed under the burden of her trials. Ultimately, at the request of Eros, the God-Father Zeus intervened on her behalf, the Goddess Aphrodîtê was pacified, and Psukhê was brought to Mount Olympus, where she obtained Immortality and where her Marriage with the God of Love was celebrated by all the Gods.

Psukhê lives within every man and woman, and everyone has to go and find his way through the "Labyrinth of Crete", the world of Mâyâ, till at the end of the Path of Pilgrimage the Mystic Marriage is celebrated.

The great
longing.

In Hindu tradition the withdrawal of Erôs from Psukhê finds its parallel in the withdrawal of Krishna, the Supreme Lover, from Râdhâ and other Gopis, who are so many aspects of Psukhê, the human soul. In Solomon's Song (5, 6) we read "I opened to my beloved, but my beloved had withdrawn himself, and was gone. my soul failed when he spake. I sought him, but I could not find him. I called him, but he gave me no answer." And the trials follow. "The watchmen that went about the city found me, they smote me, they wounded me, the keepers of the walls took away my veil from me."

A time comes to every soul, that it cries out, as St John of the Cross cried out

"Where hast Thou hidden Thyself,
And abandoned me in groaning, O my Beloved?
Thou has fled like the hart,
Having wounded me
I ran after Thee, crying, but Thou wert gone."

"Why, after wounding
This heart, hast Thou not healed it?
And why, after stealing it,
Hast Thou thus abandoned it,
And not carried away the stolen prey?"

"Quench Thou my troubles,
For no one else can soothe them;
And let mine eyes behold Thee,
For Thou art their light,
And I will keep them for Thee alone."

"Reveal Thy presence,
And let the vision of Thy beauty kill me.
Behold the malady
Of love is incurable
Except in Thy presence and before Thy face."

The great Muslim mystic Kabîr, who had a Hindu Guru, sang:

"My body and my mind are grieved for the want of Thee;
O my beloved! come to my house.
When people say I am Thy bride, I am ashamed; for I have not
touched Thy heart with my heart.
Then what is this love of mine? I have no taste for food, I have
no sleep; my heart is ever restless within doors and without.
As water is to the thirsty, so is the lover to the bride Who is there
that will carry my news to my beloved?
Kabîr is restless: he is dying for sight of Him."

And Nârada Risbi, the Prajâpati of Capricorn, the Lord of Love-ecstasy, sings: "Love is immortal. Obtaining which a man becomes perfect, becomes immortal, becomes satisfied. And obtaining which he desires nothing, grieves not, hates not, does not delight in sensuous objects, makes no effort for selfish ends. Knowing which he becomes intoxicated with joy, transfixed, and rejoices in the Self. Love cannot be made to fulfil desires, for its nature is renunciation. Renunciation is the giving up of ritual and worldly affairs; exclusive devotion to Love and indifference to everything opposed to it." In these words of Nârada, found at the beginning of the Nârada Bhakti Sûtra, is found a recapitulation of what has been said previously in connection with the traditional teachings referring to Capricorn.

24 THE RITES OF FINAL SANCTIFICATION

The rite of anointing. After the Ten Senses or Organs, referring to the Ten Houses of Manifestation, have been dealt with, the question may arise as to whether Aquarius and Pisces are not represented by these or other ones. These two Houses — in some contexts together with Capricorn — represent the stage of Rest. Aquarius is no more within the scheme of the ordinary Senses, and Pisces is not yet within that scheme. Aquarius represents the stage of harmonization and atonement of the Senses or Organs. This is expressed in the Rite of Anointing or Chrismation. It has been shown elsewhere, that Aquarius is the 'House of the Cream' or Chrism of the Milk-Ocean. In this connection we can understand how the anointing of the head is connected with Aquarius.

In the rite of Confirmation or the Mystery of the St. Myron's Anointing according to the Holy Catholic Apostolic Church of Orthodox rite, or "Eastern Church", the priest begins with pronouncing the following words: "Blessed art thou, O Lord God Almighty, Source of all good things, Sun of Righteousness, who sheddest forth upon them that are in darkness the light of salvation, through the manifestation of thine Only-begotten Son and our God, and who hast given unto us, unworthy though we be, blessed purification through hallowed water, and divine sanctification through lifegiving Unction, who now also hast been graciously pleased to regenerate thy servant that hath newly received Illumination, by water and the Spirit, and grantest unto him remission of sins, whether voluntary or involuntary. Do thou, the same Master, compassionate King of kings, grant also unto him the seal of the gift of thy holy and almighty and adorable Spirit." Read with discrimination, one sees that every detail refers to the stage of Aquarius, the Source, in which the Light of the Supernal Sun shines in the Darkness of the minds of those who are regenerated by its Illumination — every detail, except that referring to the Baptism with water, which refers to the rite of the opposite stage of the Zodiac, in the Water-House of Cancer. The "divine sanctification" by Unction is the Illumination by the Spirit, the Holy Spirit of the Highest Sphere. The end of this prayer is "Deliver him from the Evil One and from all the machinations of the same. And preserve his soul in purity and uprightness, through the saving fear of thee, that he may please thee in every deed and word, and may be a child and heir of thy heavenly kingdom." In "every deed and word" the Karmendriyas and Jñānendriyas are hinted at. These stand out clearly during the actual rite. For the priest anoints the

person with the holy Chrism, making the sign of the cross on the brow, on the eyes, on the nostrils, on the lips and on both ears, and further on the breast, on the hands and on the feet, saying each time: "The seal of the gift of the Holy Spirit. Amen."

The sanctification of the ten organs by the seal of God. Eyes, nostrils and ears need no further comment, relating, as usual, to the Elements Ether, Fire and Air. The lips relate to the touching of the Element Earth, as an expression of Charity. The brow relates to the experience of the Water of the Moon. The five "Organs of Action" are represented by the breast and the two hands and feet. Besides representing the various Elements, the feet are specially connected with the Spirit or Mercury, as we saw before, wherefore they are symbols of "walking the Path"; and the hands are specially connected with Jupiter, the Ruler and Ordainer, and the Shaper of the Spiritual Man. Therefore, when the priest anoints the feet, he adds to the words quoted above, "That you may walk before God", and when he anoints the hands, he adds: "Thy hands have made me and fashioned me."

In this symbolical division of Organs of Action, the two hands represent the instruments of Jupiter and Mars, the two feet the instruments of Mercury and Venus (for on the spiritual Path man is a "Hermaphrodite") and the physical body the instrument of Saturn, the Lord of the Earth. The synthetical nature of the rite for the "lowest" plane stands out by the additional words which are pronounced by the priest when he anoints the breast: "Unto the healing of soul and body". Furthermore the ears are also anointed with some additional words: "Unto the hearing of faith". (See Diagram 1 and the diagram on p. 211.)

In the various Catholic Churches, rites of Anointing are performed at the Baptism, at the Confirmation, at the entering of the priesthood, at the crowning of a king and at the Extreme Unction. As the word "Chrism" indicates, rites of Unction with Chrism are anticipatory and expressive of the very last Initiation on the Path, that of "Christhood", forming in the Christian tradition the "crowning" glory of Illumination, followed, accompanied or preceded — according as one considers it from the point of view of Grace or "works" — by purification and atonement.

In connection with the description of the rite of the Mystery of St. Myron's Anointing it is interesting that the Greek "Muron" means "unguent" and "muriros", "a thousand" and "countless" (compare the word "myriad" from Greek "murioti", meaning ten thousand). In Yoga

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the psychic Lotus on the top of the head is the Sahasrâra or "thousand petalled"

The Extreme Unction. The Sacrament of Extreme Unction is administered when physical death is expected. It is, however, not only a rite to facilitate liberation of the soul from the body and ensure "salvation" Symbolically "death" signifies the passing of the Ahankâra, "the Evil One and the machinations of the same" In this connection, too, we can understand that the Church does not perform the Rite of Extreme Unction for anyone during his lifetime. For it represents final sanctification and Christhood

The Unction. The rite of Extreme Unction is really an Unction of the extreme. the extreme end of the body at the extreme end of life. In Hindu tradition Anointing is done in the rite of pouring oil on the head of the Linga, representing the Spiritual Pole, in Aquarius Jacob set up his "pillar, and poured oil upon the top of it" The oil "upon the top" has an intention and meaning which is opposed to that of the oil applied "below" To ascribe a "phallic" significance to these rites — as modern scholars have done — would entail having to ascribe a similar significance to the rite of Holy Anointing Hinduism also has many rites of pouring oil upon the heads of sacred images and persons

25 THE PSYCHICAL CENTRES OF YOGA

The Sahasrâra and crown of glory. The chakras or "wheels" or the padmas or "lotuses" of Yoga are the centres of the Seven Spheres. We have noted before that the highest is called the Sahasrâra or Lotus "of a thousand petals" It is said to be situated above the crown of the head and to have the radiance of a thousand suns. It is the Centre of full Enlightenment in those who have attained Sonship. It is reflected in the halo around the head of saints, pictured by Buddhist, Christian and other traditions, and furthermore in symbolical head-coverings like a royal crown. For in ancient tradition the King represented "rulership by the Grace of God", since he was (or was supposed to be) the most spiritually advanced noble of the nation or tradition concerned. At the root of social tradition and at the heart of human society is the King who is a perfected man, truly anointed with the Chrism of the Aquarian stage — a man who is not a dictator or tyrant, but a loving fa-

ther of the people. Lao-Tze has described the general trend or Fall of Kingship during the Four Ages in the Tao Teh King: "In the highest antiquity, the people did not know that they had rulers. In the next age they loved and praised them. In the next, they feared them. In the next, they despised them." The general trend in the present age is still to despise kings, as a class or breed, though particular kings, by virtue of their superior character, are loved and praised. The meaning of the word "king" may be extended to include any kind of ruler. It would lie within the destiny of the age to see an increasing influence on the life of the people from the side of a new class of "unknown kings", in whom the Light has been born, and who hold with the King of this Age who said: "My Kingdom is not of this world!" For the true King does not rule the realm of Darkness, he represents the Light.

The Sahasrâra or "thousand-petalled" Lotus over the head radiates the crowning glory of the Unity of the soul with the Father. In the Proverbs of Solomon there is much reference to Wisdom — who is none but the Great Mother, the Holy Spirit of the Moon-Sphere. One reads (4; 9): "She shall give to thine head an ornament of grace: she shall compass thee with a crown of glory." It is said in the Yogic tradition that in the Sahasrâra, the Lotus over the head of the perfected Yogî, the Goddess Kundalinî and her Lord, Śiva, are united. She is called Chit, Consciousness, and He is called Sat, Reality. They unite in a place within the Sahasrâra called the Chandra-loka or "Moon-World". It is the abode of Paramâ-nanda, "Supreme Bliss". The name Chandra-loka gives a clue to the nature of the Sahasrâra. It is the Sun-aspect of the Moon-Sphere. The true Centre of the Supernal Sun is the Hridaya or Heart-Centre, in the right side of the chest. The Hridaya is the Centre of Unmanifest Divinity and the Sahasrâra that of Manifest Divinity. Traditionally the Sahasrâra corresponds to the "seventh heaven", the Satya-loka or "Abode of Truth". According to tradition there are twelve central petals in it. These represent the Twelve Houses of the Sun-Zodiac. This Centre is called the Anubhâva Chakra or "pure experience wheel", in contradistinction to the other six Chakras or Centres, which are called Sâdhanâ Chakras. Sâdhanâ is the practical spiritual Path to Sâdhya and Siddhi, which allied words may be rendered by Fullness, Satisfaction, and Achievement, Power. The root "sâdh" means "to exert". Sâdhanâ is spiritual striving. The six lower Chakras are the rungs of the ladder on which the Sâdhaka or "striver" exerts himself. Regarding the seventh and highest, the Anubhâva Chakra the "anu" is the subtle central point, the "atomic centre" of the All, and "bhâva" is "realization, experience, mood". After other teachings have

been dealt with, it will be realized that the "anu" is the Spiritual Pole in Aquarius. The lowest Chakra, the Mûlâdhâra, is in the Zodiac in the stage of Capricorn and Aquarius. The highest Chakra, the Sahasrâra, is in the same stage. The intermediary Chakras are found in the other part of the Zodiac. The fact that Duality occurs in the traditions describing the Sahasrâra shows that it is inferior to the Heart, which is traditionally connected only with Oneness and has no divisions or petals at all. The full glory of harmony, communion, wholeness, holiness and unification is manifest in the Sahasrâra, the blossoming of which follows on the blossoming of the Âjñâ Padma, the Centre below it, which is one of outright Duality. According to tradition the Six Padmas or Lotuses exist in all men, either in bud or in blossom, and the Sahasrâra opens up in full blossom only in perfected men. It derives its glory both from the Heart and from the perfected Lotuses of the Six Spheres.

The, "anu" may be found in the point at the top of the frontispiece, which is generally called "bindu", and the mooncrescent below it represents, among other, the Âjñâ

The Âjñâ or Forehead Centre.

The Chakra or Centre of the Moon is the Âjñâ, traditionally connected with the forehead. It is "the brow", where the Soma or Elixir of Life is experienced. It is said to have two petals, which symbolize Sun and Moon, and is the Centre of Duality. It is said that in this Centre the vital forces of a Yogî assemble before he finally leaves the world and enters the Purâna Purusha, the "Ancient Man", who is the "Primal Ancestor" representing the Seventh Sphere, beyond the Six Spheres of Creation. The Six lower Centres are symbolically joined together in the figure of two crossed triangles forming a six-pointed star and surrounded by a circle, which is called Śrî Chakra. It is found in Jewish tradition without the circle in the Star of David and with the circle in the Seal of Solomon. In the Christian tradition it is a symbol of the Father. This is entirely in accord with the other traditions, for the House of the Father is Aquarius, and the Chakra of Vishnu, representing Manifestation, is also found as symbol in Aquarius as will be shown later. It is clear that the symbol, besides representing the Six Powers, Spheres and Centres, with the Seventh in its centre, also serves to represent the Zodiac (see Diagram 13). According to one tradition the Sahasrâra itself is formed like Śrî Chakra. This points again to Aquarius (see Diagram 3).

The Sanskrit word "Soma" for the Moon also means the Lunar Elixir of Life, which represents Pure Spirit and Pure Consciousness. The word

is used for the Moon in the Vedas and in Astrology. Besides representing Consciousness, the Moon also represents on the one hand, Mâyâ, the Power that veils Consciousness, and, on the other, the Tradition, the Power that reveals Consciousness. Hence the Moon is Creator of Form and Body, in the wider sense of these words, including all that has extension and substance on all the Planes.

The Throat The Viśuddha or Centre of "Purity", situated in the
Centre and the throat, is the Centre of the Element Ether. In and from
forbidden fruit. this Sphere the Fall of Man takes place and therefore
 the traditions of the Fall are connected with the Throat
 Centre. From this Centre the Word is also born.

In connection with the Fall the throat features in traditions of the eating of forbidden fruits and potions. We have seen before that the "apple of Eve" is present in the pomum Adami or Adam's apple, and that it is related to the pomegranate or "seed-apple" eaten by Proserpinâ in the "Underworld" — which is none but the world of the Fall. In the symbolism of seed and fruit lies an element which refers the cause of the Fall to a previous round or cycle of time. It combines in itself the conceptions of a "beginning" and of a "beginninglessness": a "world which was, and is, and ever shall be." For seeds and fruits are those of past lives of worlds, traditions and individuals. Though the fruits of the past ever again fall at the feet of man, he has freedom to choose whether to eat them or to cut them open and offer them at the Feet of the Primal Ancestor, God.

The poisoned Apple of the Fall is not *really* digestible and gets stuck in the throat, like the pomum Adami and the apple of the Witch-Queen given to Snow-white. When in Hindu myth the Milk Ocean is churned (to be dealt with later), the World-Poison arises before the Fourteen Precious Things. It was swallowed by Śiva, but remained fixed in his throat, for which reason Śiva bears the name of Nila-kantha or "blue-throated one". The Viśuddha or Throat Centre of Yoga is said to have sixteen petals. These consist of two groups of seven petals plus two more. The eighth petal is said to be the Poison of Mortality, and the sixteenth the Amrita or Elixir of Immortality. The former is a symbol of the Fall, and the latter of the Return or Divine Birth.

Drinking the The symbolism of Śiva drinking the World-Poison has
Cup of the been explained, like the symbolism of Christ drinking
Poison. the Cup of the Passion, as meaning that he took upon
 himself the sins of the world. This explanation is quite

correct as long as it is realized that the process at which the symbolism hunts takes place within every human soul, and that every soul must at one time accomplish it. But unfortunately the symbolism is generally externalized, extraverted and projected onto a separate, distinct, person, forming an idol of Christ. The general trend in the Fallen Man is to find another individual to do the dirty work for him of cleaning the Augeas-stable (within his own soul) or to perform the labour of bearing his burden. But unfortunately for him his delusion does not serve him in the end, and he will have to do the work himself. If some historical Śiva or Christ or Saviour had been truly able to take upon himself the sins of all Fallen Men, and store the Poison, the Seeds of Sin, within his throat, "this world" would have become a paradise instead of being the hell which it is for so many people.

Śiva, Christ, or any other traditional forms of Fatherhood or Sonship, do not exist in some external separate place or region, but dwell as fundamental aspects of Reality within the being of every man and woman. In reality they are not "there", and to be seen in a "here-after", but they are "here" and may be seen "now".

The Son of God is the Door, the Way, and the Guide on the Way. But if the spiritual aspirant does not knock at the Door and pray to be shown the Way, and follow that Way, the Return cannot be achieved. A Saviour from bondage and sin cannot save a soul, if the soul does not wish to be saved with all its heart and strive to be saved with all its might.

At the end of the spiritual path the Element Earth provides the ultimate spiritual temptations or tests. From Ethereal heights the soul comes down to take on the life of "ordinary humanity", in order to redeem that humanity, in self and others, deeply and intimately interrelated.

In this connection there is personal sacrifice in the drinking of the World-Poison and the bearing of the Cross. The conception of "sacrifice", previously dealt with, must be considered from the point of view of the Spirit as well as from "below". The great sacrifice takes many forms in life and therefore in mythology. One of these is the sacrifice of one of his hands by the God Tyr. It will be treated later. When the soul "descends into Hell" it fully shares the sufferings of Hell and bears the Burden of the World.

What the World-Poison further symbolizes will be shown later.

**Throat-
symbolism.**

In connection with the Fall, Jupiter-Jehovah, the Ruler of the Ether and the Throat Centre, shows himself in his aspect as "Angry God". The word "anger" is related

to an old Norse word "anгр" and to the Latin "angor" meaning "a strangling", "anguish". These two words are both derived from the same root. The Latin "angere" meant to choke. Derived is "angina", quinsy, meaning literally "a choking". The words "strangling" and "string", derived from Latin and Greek words, are also related. In former days "fallen people", that is to say, evil-doers, were "hanged". This should not be substituted by "hung", for "hung" comes from another verb meaning "to suspend". Or they were "strangled", by means of a "string". In ancient Norse tradition there was reference to a "goat-hair rope", a string made from the Capricornian animal. In Norse tradition the World-Tree of Death was termed among others the "Gallows-tree". By the Fall the soul is hanged on that Tree — related to the Tree of the Cross of Christ — and strangled, choking. The choking is the same as that of Snow-white when she ate the poisoned apple.

The golden necklace. Symbolism which forms the opposite to that of the strangling, anger, anguish and hanging of the Fall, is that of the Golden Necklace. The Golden Necklace is worn by the Perfect and by strivers for Perfection, whereas the rope of bondage and slavery to "the world" is worn by the Fallen. Solomon recommends (in the Proverbs 3; 3): "Let not mercy and truth forsake thee: bind them about thy neck; write them upon the table of thine heart". And he says (6; 20—21): "My son, keep thy father's commandment, and forsake not the law of thy mother: Bind them continually upon thy heart and tie them about thy neck. Egyptian tradition knew the Usekh necklace of gold, which was placed on the neck of the deceased to give him power to free himself from his mummy bandages, symbols of bondage in "death".

The string of bondage. The Necklace of Tradition and the Covenant finds its counter symbol in the string of bondage to lawlessness and sin. One form of it is the string of the gallows. In Dutch it is called "strop". It is the halter to hang a person. It is related to "strik". Also related is the Dutch "strot" which is related to the English "throat", again related to "throttle", implying both the wind-pipe and to choke. Further related, and derived from the Latin "torquere", to twist, are "tortuous, torque, torsion, torment, torture, thwart and twist". With the Fall life gets, as it were, a twist, and when heaven is turned into hell, the soul becomes tormented and tortured.

The necklace of the Tradition. This list of words could be continued with ever more remotely related words, in an attempt at illustrating in the etymological field the sacred tradition that all words of human speech, symbols of states of consciousness and materiality, belong to seven main groups, corresponding to the Seven Spheres and their Intelligences, and to their Centres within the human "body" Fragments of the science of word-sounds have been preserved in the Hindu and Cabalistic traditions According to the Hindu tradition concerned, all "Creation", which issues from the Primal Word OM or AUM, or, in another context, from Veda, is contained in the combinations of the letters of the Alphabet These are found in symbolical form in the "Garland of Letters" or Rosary of the Goddess Kâli The rosary used by devotees forms the reflection of this grand symbol of Creative Tradition, except for the fact that it is based on the symbolism of the spiritual number 108 (to be dealt with later) and not on the number 50 The Rosary of Kâli is worn by her as a *necklace* It is represented as consisting of fifty childrens' heads which provide so many ever-young mouths from which the Voice issues with ever-new creative powers The Rosary of the Goddess is called Varnamâlâ or "Rosary of Letters" We shall encounter it again further on It is significant that the Varnas of the Rosary are called "Mâtrikâ" or "Little Mothers" Both the Consciousness and the Dynamism which are in Speech pertain to the Moon-Sphere In another context the fifty beads of the Rosary represent the seven times seven Spheres plus their Origin and Goal, the One

The Chassids, a Jewish sect which originated in Eastern Europe, possess the Tradition of the letters forming the elements of the World According to them each letter contains World, Soul and Deity These combine and unite with each other Similarly the letters combine and unite, and the Word is created .

Words indicating the third Centre. A few more groups of words which are traditionally connected with the Third Centre, that of the Ether, situated in the "throat", may be mentioned in passing

These groups of words are not etymologically related in the ordinary sense First of all "three, triple, thurd, treble, triangle, triad, Trinity" Further "tree", "Druid" and the Anglo Saxon "dry", meaning a magician, which are all etymologically related to the Greek "drus", an oak, and the Sanskrit "daru", a kind of pine-tree The oak was sacred to Jupiter, the Lord of the Ether, in Dodona and elsewhere Further "try", "trial"; "true", "trow" We have already considered words which reach

out towards the Fifth Centre, the Solar plexus Centre, as "drum, trumpet, trump, thunder, tornado, Thor and Thrym", the name of the Thunder-Giant of Norse tradition. Next the prefixes "tra" and "trans".

The "transcendent" Ether-Sphere is attained when the soul has "climbed beyond" the Elements of Manifestation. On the other hand, when there is a "choking" in the Throat Centre, and the Breath of Life cannot flow freely, the soul "falls", like Snow-white, into a "trance". The word "trance" is derived from "trans-ire", meaning "to go over". In some traditional contexts the Fall is symbolized as a trance-like sleep, in others as a form of spiritual death. Sometimes, however, the "going over" is meant in the opposite direction, and in that case the word "trance" is used to denote the rapture of the Ether-Sphere.

Vampires. A number of unpleasant experiences, relating to the "throat", are recorded in myths and fairy-tales. In his fifth journey, Sindbad the Sailor falls into the hands of "the Old Man of the Sea", a terrible old man who clasps himself with spiderlike legs around his neck, all but strangling him to death, while kicking him with his feet in the region of the stomach. This experience refers to the Ether and Fire Spheres, to Throat and Solar plexus Centres. The horrible old man represents the shadow of the Guru, Ruler of the Ether Sphere. The Vampires of many traditions, who at night, when there is no light and when man is asleep, are said to suck his life-blood from his throat, belong to the same field. These Vampires are said to be persons who are dead and yet preserve some kind of life in the grave by their unholy practices. These traditional data are symbolic of the Fallen Man in his worst animal aspects. It is perhaps a merit of the Age of rational enlightenment to have set bounds to the superstitions which have sprung from such traditions. But it has not set bounds to that which the *symbolism* refers to. On the contrary.

The Heart Centre. The Element of the Heart Centre is Air. This Centre is called in Hinduism the Anâhata Padma or "Lotus of unstruck Sound". Its presiding Deity is Îśa. It is the fourth of the seven Centres, whether reckoned from the highest or the lowest. The number four is encountered in many traditions connected with the Heart and the Element Air: in the Four Winds, the Four Chambers of the Heart, the Four Directions and other symbolism in which the Four Elements are considered from the spiritual angle. The symbolism of the lungs and of breath is based upon Air or Spirit

The Solar plexus Centre. The Element of the Solar plexus Centre is Fire. This Centre is called the *Manipûra* in the terminology of Yoga. It is also called the Navel Centre and its presiding Deity is Rudra, the "Crier" or "Howler" — a title appropriate to Mars as God of Manifestation and Conflict. The crying of Mars before the gates of Troy was notorious. The Element Fire, the Sphere of the Solar plexus Centre, is an important and vast world. We have noted before, that the dimension of height is symbolically associated with it, with the concomitant symbolism of bigness or vastness, as encountered especially in Giants. Fire is the Element which creates and maintains the World of Manifestation and gives it a vastness which is even more impressive than that of the material universe. The Indian "*Brihat*", meaning "big, vast", refers specially to the Element Fire and its Power. Jupiter (Guru) is called *Brihaspati* or "Lord of the *Brihat*", for Jupiter is the Master of Mars, the creative Power.

The Sacral Centre. The Element of the sixth Centre from above or the second from below is Water. The presiding Deity of this Centre is Vishnu, the Preserver and Power of Love, who in this context is identical with Venus. The Centre is the *Svâdhîsthana*, situated in the pelvic region. It is also called the "Sacral" Centre. This highly significant name is derived from the sacrum, a composite triangular bone which played a part in Roman tradition as the "*os sacrum*" or "sacred bone". The inverted triangle ∇ is a symbol of the Goddess in many traditions. It constitutes the counterpart to the triangle of the God-Father, suggesting the Mountain-top Δ . The word "pelvis" means "basin". The Basin is the Vessel of the Water. In the physical body this "basin" contains the kidneys or water-forming organs and the bladder. It also contains the womb. We read in the Korân (Al Furkan 56) "And He it is who hath created man of water, then made him capable of the ties of kindred and affinity". The Venusian part of the body contains further triangles. The important functions of the body do not only serve as material for tradition for its symbolical teaching purposes, but are also the reflection on the physical plane of life-functions in subtler but less transient states of existence on higher planes. While accepting this traditional teaching and making due use of it for purposes of self-guidance and self-improvement, it should not lead to certain mistakes of outlook. One is the attachment of greater importance to form than to meaning, and the search for form-parallels when there should be a looking for parallels in meaning. As is ever the case in matters which pertain to the traditional teachings

of old, it is the spiritual-intuitive function which should give the lead and not reason or feeling. Another mistake of outlook is found in the efforts of recent investigators who have taken pains to *identify* the symbols of Yoga with the physiological organs of the body, with the conscious or unconscious motive of showing what great physiologists and anatomists the ancient yogis were. They may indeed have been, but they will surely not have been too proud of it, since they considered the physical sciences to be only sub-sciences of the psychological and spiritual sciences of sacred tradition.

The Root-Support Centre. The lowest Centre in the body is the Mûlâdhâra or "Root-Support" at the base of the body which is the Centre of the Element Earth. It is also called the Pelvic plexus Centre. Its presiding Deity is alternatively given as Brahmâ, the Creator, or Ganapati, the Elephant-headed Son of Śiva. Sometimes both are mentioned in connection with it. In Yogic tradition it is held that the Creative Power, Kundalinî, "sleeps" in this Centre. For here creation comes to a full stop. There is nothing more material than the physical plane, symbolized by the Earth-Element. In it the Creator "rests".

From the moral point of view referring to the Fall, the symbolism of the sleeping of the Creative Power refers to the negative state at the end of the Fall which is the opposite of the blissful "resting of God", described with reference to the Seventh Day of Genesis (2; 2). The Path of Return begins in the negative state of complete spiritual inaction. The mortal sin which symbolizes it is "Sloth".

In this connection it is significant that Yogic tradition teaches that the Mûlâdhâra is ruled by Ganapati, who is the Deity presiding over the *beginning* of the Path of Return, or by Brahmâ, who is "the Creator", which means the Creator of the Spiritual Man. Brahmâ, who holds the Vedas in his hand, is the Lord of the Tradition. In this connection it is significant that the Kundalinî-Power, when it rises from its coiled-up, sleeping state in the Mûlâdhâra, first passes through the Brahmâdvâra or "Door of Brahmâ" before it rises upwards. The Creative Tradition is needed right from the beginning of the Path of Return.

At the end of the Fall the "resting" or "sleeping" of the Creative Power takes place in the lowest of the Seven Centres, which is of the Element Earth. This is the negative form of "rest" which has reference to the psychical state described in the symbols pertaining to the First Day of Genesis. At the end of the Path of Return, when Divine Reality is attained (or re-attained), the positive form of "rest" takes place in the highest

Centre This is described in the symbolic picture given for the Seventh Day of Genesis. According to the Yogic tradition, the union of the Dynamic and Static Divine Powers, or Mother and Father, Śakti and Śiva, takes place in the Sahasrâra or Sun-Centre. This tradition affirms that the supreme experience unites in one the "this" and the "That", Earth and Heaven. The dual Powers unite in bliss, according to the Yogic tradition, in the Sahasrâra or Crown of Glory, and cease to be distinct, according to the tradition of the Jñânis, in the Hridaya or Heart which is the fundamental (and only true) "Centre". For the average person, the Yogic tradition, on account of its rich symbolism, appealing both to the inspiration and the rational function, is much more fascinating and interesting than the more "profound" and "deeper" tradition of the Jñânis or "gnostics".

26 GENESIS AND THE DAYS OF THE WEEK

Genesis. The first three Chapters of Genesis, containing teachings referring to the Path through the heavenly mansions, constitute the basis of the teachings contained in the Ten or Twelve Rules and Commandments. Genesis 1 describes in symbolic terms the stages of the Spiritual Path from the very first, which has been referred to at the end of the previous Chapter with application to Yoga, to the very last, the realization of the Divine.

Since the teachings of Genesis 1, dealing with the Return, and the tradition of Genesis 2, describing the evolution of mankind and of the individual during one life, and of Genesis 3, dealing with the Fall, have been given at some length in "The Key to Genesis" and "Evolution, Paradise and the Fall", they can be omitted in this place (see Diagrams 1a and 1b).

The first six Days of Creation refer to the Twelve Signs of the Zodiac, one Day comprising two Signs. The Seventh Day deals with the same stage as the First, but refers to a higher level.

The Wilderness. The "Wilderness" which is the opposite of "Paradise", is encountered in the scheme of the Zodiac especially in connection with Leo and Aquarius, the Signs of the Poles of Manifestation and the Spirit. In Leo it is the Wilderness in which there is too much Fire and in Aquarius one in which there is too little. This symbolism is connected with the heat of midsummer and the cold of midwinter (see Diagram 1b). The cold Wilderness is, for instance, the icy

waste-land of the Three Grey Sisters and the Niffhel or "Fog hell" of Norse tradition (see Diagram 11) "Hot hell" is a conception which has been derived from tropical or sub-tropical surroundings

In one context, connected with the increase of the Fiery Power on the one hand, and its decrease on the other, the Fall is conceived as taking place in two stages, i.e. from Aquarius to Leo and from Leo to Aquarius. In the Fall the soul is ever on its way from the Fiery to the Icy and from the Icy to the Fiery Wilderness. From the point of view of evolution and the life of an individual, the same applies, but then in the inverse direction, which is also followed in the Return to Divinity.

In this connection it is well to note that in human life (in myths, fairy-tales and, of course, actually) three movements should always be watched and their interrelation studied: (1) the Fall, going backwards through the Zodiac (Genesis 3), (2) the Return, going forwards through the Zodiac (Genesis 1), and (3) the evolutionary movement in the world from birth to middle age, old age and death, also going forwards through the Zodiac (Genesis 2).

Hinduism calls the Wilderness either — in mythology — by the name of a particular jungle, or — in general — the world of "Samsâra", in which the soul "errs" in the Labyrinth of "Error". In Jewish tradition it is called the "Olam ha-Tohu", which signifies "the world of confusion, turmoil, chaos". In the Bible it is called "the Deep" and described in expressive terms by the Prophets and Apocalypics.

Culture.

The Wilderness is changed into a Garden by means of culture. Agriculture and horticulture serve for symbolizing the cultivation of spiritual life in the spheres of the emotions and the lower mind, according to the rules of the Tradition. The modern conception of "culture" has been cut off from its roots. Consequently "culture", in the modern sense of the word, is merely a culture of flowers in vases or little plants in pots. It is not a cultivation of the Tree of Life in the midst of the Garden. The Tree of Knowledge with the forbidden fruit alone is well attended to at the present time.

Vegetable astrology forms an introduction to human astrology. It refers, of course, not particularly to plants, but to the emotional life of humanity. Before beginning to deal with the rational and spiritual life of man, it is necessary to study his emotional life. Varaha Mihira, the great Hindu Astrologer, who lived in the sixth Century A.D., dealt with vegetable astrology before taking up the astrology which deals with man in his higher aspects (Brihad Devata Ch. III). Vegetable astrology deals with

Though the Lokas in popular Hinduism have come to be regarded as heaven-states, older tradition considered them as being "below heaven" and as being "iha", that is "this" or, in other words, as belonging to "this world". The word "laukika", which is derived from "loka", means "worldly". "This world" is also the "Sukritasya Loka" or "world of good deeds". Both Śaṅkarāchārya and Madhvāchārya have pointed out that "Loka" has reference to the human form, obtained as the result of the Karmas of previous Cycles.

The days of the week. There is undoubtedly a connection between the Days of Genesis and the days of the week, but it appears that the order of the days of the week could be inverted in accordance with its application to either the Path of the Fall or the Path of Return.

Saturday is called Śanivāra in Sanskrit. Śani is the name of the Son in Hindu astrology. Saturday is the day of Saturn in all traditions.

It is significant that in Hinduism the days of the week are called by the *astrological* names of the Gods, and not by the mythological names corresponding to the ones used in the European traditions.

Sunday is called Ravivāra in Sanskrit. Ravi is the name of the Sun in Hindu astrology. This day is the day of the Sun in every tradition.

Monday is called Somavāra in Sanskrit. Soma is a name of the Moon and also means the Lunar Elixir. Monday is the Moon-day everywhere.

"Tuesday" is derived from the Anglo-Saxon "Tīwesdaeg". Tīw was the Anglo-Saxon Jupiter. In old High German the day was called "Ziestac", "the day of Ziu". The God was known in other European traditions as Teiwa, Dize, Dio, Tyr, Tys and Twisco. These words are allied to the Latin "deus", meaning "God", and "Iu-piter", meaning "Iu-father", the Greek "Zeus" and the Sanskrit "deva-s" and "dyaus". All these words are derived from a common root.

In the late and degenerate forms of some traditions there has been some confusion between Jupiter, the God who presides over the Battle of Life, and Mars, the God who is actively engaged on the Battlefield and who is the instrument and subordinate of Jupiter.

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the emotional reactions of "plants", with their competition for food, with their marriage and the begetting of children, and with their provision for their offspring

This is the science of "culture" It is necessary in the stage of the Third Day of Genesis, referring to the spring-time of the soul, when the process of culture begins

Evenings and Mornings. In accordance with the tradition of the succession of "evenings" and "mornings", meant in a symbolical sense and applied in a literalistic manner, the Jewish day even now is considered to begin at sunset on the previous day

In various Western traditions of Astrology the Signs of the Zodiac are alternatively ruled by the sacred Planets or planetary Gods "on the Night-throne" and "on the Day-throne" The first are the "evenings" and the second the "mornings" of Genesis The Signs ruled on the Night-throne will on closer observation of Diagrams 1b and 3 reveal themselves to be all the Earth and Water-Signs and those ruled on the Day-throne all the Fire and Air-Signs In the Syrian tradition, as voiced by Saint Ephrem, the beings of the subtle and higher worlds were said to have a body of Fire and Air, and those of the lower and grosser worlds a body of Earth and Water (see Diagram 3)

Lokas and Talas. It will be shown later that the Signs ruled on the Day-throne or Mornings of Genesis correspond to the Lokas of Hinduism, and the Signs ruled on the Night-throne or Evenings of Genesis to the Talas "Lokas" is generally rendered by "heavens" and "Talas" by "underworlds" This is correct in so far there is not imagined in them a contrast of heaven and hell, as is often done in modern Hindu conception or popular belief, in which traditional meaning has been forgotten It is expressed in scriptures that all experiences, including the highest and the lowest, can be had, for instance, in Bhûrloka, corresponding to Aquarius The Talas are not places of punishment any more than the Lokas are particularly places of reward The Hindu "hell" is called "Naraka" and the Talas are not "hells" but "underworlds" The word "Tala" comes from a root meaning "surface, level, lower part, base, bottom" The Lokas are "lokyante", meaning "what are seen" For they are the worlds ruled on the Day-throne, the "mornings" of Genesis Etymologically related words are "to look", the Latin "locus" or "place", from which "local" is derived, and other more remotely related words from which "light" is derived

Though the Lokas in popular Hinduism have come to be regarded as heaven-states, older tradition considered them as being "below heaven" and as being "iha", that is "this" or, in other words, as belonging to "this world". The word "laukika", which is derived from "loka", means "worldly". "This world" is also the "Sukritasya Loka" or "world of good deeds". Both Śankarāchārya and Madhvāchārya have pointed out that "Loka" has reference to the human form, obtained as the result of the Karmas of previous Cycles.

The days of the week. There is undoubtedly a connection between the Days of Genesis and the days of the week, but it appears that the order of the days of the week could be inverted in accordance with its application to either the Path of the Fall or the Path of Return.

Saturday is called Śanivāra in Sanskrit. Śani is the name of the Son in Hindu astrology. Saturday is the day of Saturn in all traditions.

It is significant that in Hinduism the days of the week are called by the *astrological* names of the Gods, and not by the mythological names corresponding to the ones used in the European traditions.

Sunday is called Ravivāra in Sanskrit. Ravi is the name of the Sun in Hindu astrology. This day is the day of the Sun in every tradition.

Monday is called Somavāra in Sanskrit. Soma is a name of the Moon and also means the Lunar Elixir. Monday is the Moon-day everywhere.

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Mars brings blessings as God of Resurrection and Spring — the blessings being those of Jupiter, his Lord

The North- and West-European traditions did not have a week of seven days, but one of five. When, as a result of the association with Romans, a seven-day week was instituted, Tyr or Tiw was apparently wrongly identified with Mars, and Thor with Jupiter. And thus the day of Mars came to be called "Tuesday" and the day of Jupiter "Thursday". There cannot be any doubt, however, that Thor corresponds to Mars and that Tyr or Tiw represents an aspect of Jupiter. The nature of Thor stands out from his fire-red beard, his Fire-Hammer, his goats, his belt of strength and other symbolism (dealt with in the Book of Stars), and from the fact that he is a slayer of Giants and Animal Monsters. Tiw or Tyr is an aspect of the Lord of the Ether-Sphere, the Guru. In the Hymis-Kvída he is the counsellor and guide of Thor in obtaining the "mighty cauldron a mile deep" from the dangerous old Giant called Hymi. This refers to the mighty work of subduing the Solar plexus Centre, ruled by Mars. The Rune or mystic symbol of Tyr or Tiw is like an upturned arrow, a tree or a mountain-top. † Tyr or Tiw is the Lord of the Victory in the Battle of Life. In the Old Play of the Wolsungs, Sigdrifa spoke to Sigfred "Runes of Victory thou must know, if thou wilt have victory, and thou shalt grave them on thy sword-hilt, some on the rims, some on the carnage-brands, and twice name Tyr." The sword is an emblem of Mars, the rune of victory, however, is a symbol of Jupiter.

In Dutch, Tuesday is "dinsdag", derived from "dingsdag", the day of "rechtsgedingen", that is, of lawsuits and judgments. These belong to the domain of Mars, but are presided over by the Lord of the function of faith and insight, Jupiter-Jehovah-Guru. The word "dings" is derived from the same root as the name of the God Tiw, Tyr or Dio. The Dutch word for Thursday, "donderdag", comes from the name "Donar" or "Thunderer", belonging to Thor or Mars.

Wednesday or "the day of Wodan" is called Budhavāra in Sanskrit. The etymological relation between the names is dealt with elsewhere. Wednesday is the day of Mercury in all traditions.

"Friday" is the day of Venus. Yet the word is derived from the Anglo-Saxon "Frīge-daeg". Frīg was the wife of Odinn or Wodan. As we shall see later, it stands out from her traditions that she represents the Goddess of the Moon-Sphere. Here we have thus discovered an indication of another exchange.

For Friday is in Dutch "vrijdag" and in German "Freitag". These words indicated "the day of Frīja or Frēya", and thus meant "the day of

Venus", for whereas Frigg represented the Goddess of the Moon-Sphere, Freya was Venus "Frigg" and "Freya" or "Frya" are from a common root, which also created the words "friend" and "free". It is related to the Sanskrit root "pri" from which came "pri", to love, and "priyâ", meaning wife, loved one. *Prīti* is a term in *Bhakti* Yoga, the Way of Union with God through Love, and means "love of and intense pleasure in God"

The Moon and Venus. Traditionally the Moon first becomes visible as the Crescent, indicating her function as *Creatrix*, in Pisces. She begins Manifestation as "half-moon" in Aries. In Cancer, the House ruled by the Moon, she manifests as the Full Moon of Manifestation. In Libra she enters her "last quarter". And in Capricorn, after the Moon-sickle (in the hand of Saturn) has cut off the Cycle, she is the New Moon. From the Virgin Darkness of Capricorn the Solar Light is born. The two Goddesses who represent the Spheres of the Moon and Water, namely the Virgin Aphrodite Ouranos and Aphrodite Pandemos, the daughter of Zeus and Dionê, the Goddess of the Ether, are intimately connected and hence often confused. The first is the Goddess of the Water above the Firmament, and the second the Goddess of the Water below the Firmament. In various traditions Venus is represented with the moon as one of her symbols, and the Moon with a vessel with water. It is well known what a great influence the moon has on the inner — especially the emotional — life of men, and of plants and animals. The material moon exerts a pull on the water of the physical plane. The Astral Plane of the Moon is reflected below in the astral plane of modern terminology. On her side the planet Venus is seen on the earth in crescent and half shapes, and as "full", like the moon.

Genesis and the days of the week We shall see later, that occasionally a tradition is encountered, in which the Seven Days of Genesis are identified with the seven stages of the week as found in the names of the days. Thus identification may be one of association rather than of original intention, since the two teachings, though covering the same ground, are focussed on different aspects of the life-scheme. Therefore the two schemes have not been connected with each other in these Books, unless a particular tradition has been built upon it and requires it for its understanding.

It appears that the order of the days of the week could be inverted according to its reference to either the Path of the Fall or the Path of Return. It is interesting to observe that whether the days of the week are

taken in one direction or in the other, the days of Saturn and the Sun — which pertain to one stage — and of Mercury remain the same. These are the first and seventh, and the fourth or middle, days of the week. It is clear that if the second and sixth, and also the third and fifth days are exchanged, the entire order is inverted. And of both these exchanges we have found indications. It should be noted that the Second and Sixth Days are ruled by Jupiter and Mars on the inverse Day and Night-thrones, and the Third and Fifth Days by Venus and Mercury on the inverse Day and Night-thrones. There is method in the seeming madness (see Diagram 1a)!

The two Poles of Existence are in Aquarius and Leo, the "mornings" of the First or Seventh, and Fourth Days, which remain when the order of the days of the week is inverted. The Pole of Reality or Spiritual Pole is in Aquarius and the Pole of Manifestation in Leo. The pivot of Manifestation is the Fourth Day of Cancer and Leo. In the human being the Heart is the pivot. In the week, it is Wednesday. The intimate friendship between Mercury and the Sun-God has been already stressed in other contexts. In the North and West-European traditions Odinn or Wodan, that is, the God of Spirit, takes on the function of Head and Father of the Gods, which is often held by Jupiter. In those traditions Jupiter is found in subtler, more esoteric forms, as in Vidar, Tyr and Niord. They are dealt with in the Book of Stars.

27 FURTHER ZODIACAL SYMBOLISM IN JEWISH TRADITION

Zodiacal symbolism in Jewish tradition. In Jewish tradition the Zodiac is called Mazzaroth (see Job 38:32). The word means literally "to encircle" or "to surround". Jewish tradition before the Captivity shows many traces of the symbolism of the Path through the Zodiac. The original Jewish year was a lunar one, which was adapted to the solar, as is shown from the references to yearly harvests. The ancient names of the months are no more in use, since after the Captivity the months were given new (Assyrian) names which are still being used. In Genesis (7, 11) we read that in the second month, on the seventeenth day, the Deluge began. "The same day were all the fountains of the great deep broken up, and the windows of heaven were opened." This refers to the second Sign of the Zodiac, Aquarius. "And the rain was upon the earth forty days and forty nights." In one context this refers to the latter half of the Sign of Aquarius, and to the Water-Sign of Pisces. In another context it refers

to a full Cycle of Manifestation. And in the next Chapter (8; 4) we read: "The ark rested in the seventh month, on the seventeenth day of the month, upon the mountains of Ararat." The seventh month was called Ethanim (I Kings 8; 2). In the Book of the Kings (I: 6; 37) is mentioned that the foundation of the Great Temple, "the house of the Lord", was laid in the second month, the month Zif. The Foundation is Aquarius. Solomon "was seven years in building it" (I: 6; 38). "In the month Bul, which is the eighth month, was the house finished throughout all the parts thereof, and according to the fashion of it." The eighth month Bul corresponds to the Sign of Leo. The Great Temple symbolizes the perfection of Manifestation. Leo represents the height of Manifestation. In the eighth Chapter is described the dedication of the Temple (2): "And all the men of Israel assembled themselves unto King Solomon at the feast in the month Ethanim, which is the seventh month." This month corresponds to the seventh Sign, Cancer. We saw before, that in that month the Ark of Noah rested on Mount Ararat. Cancer and Leo are the "Heights of Manifestation". In Hindu tradition they are the Himâlayas and in Norse tradition the Iotenheimer. Here they are Mount Ararat. In that same seventh month, corresponding to Cancer, "all the elders of Israel came, and the priests took up the ark. And they brought up the ark of the Lord, and the tabernacle of the congregation, and all the holy vessels in the tabernacle, . . . And the priests brought the ark of the covenant of the Lord unto his place, into the oracle of the house, to the most holy place." (I Kings 8; 3, 4, 6). The Ark, as we saw before, is the Ark of the Moon. The Sign of Cancer is ruled by the Moon, and it is a Water-Sign. The "tabernacle" and the "vessels" form elaborating symbolism connected with the "Ark". The "oracle" is that of the Voice. During the dedication ceremony of the Temple, Solomon expresses the idea that there is a greater thing than Manifestation (I; 8; 27): "But will God indeed dwell on the earth? Behold, the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain thee; how much less this house that I have builded?" The Temple is the World of Manifestation. It is also the "body", that is to say, the complex of "sheaths", of Man's Manifestation. The Temple of Solomon contained, literally and anagogically, a world of symbolism, as many other traditions connected with this great King. The following has more than economic significance: "And Solomon had twelve officers over all Israel, which provided victuals for the king and his household: each man his month in a year made provision."

The entering of the Ark of the Covenant into the Temple takes place through the Door of the Summer Solstice. In later Jewish tradition the

seventh month became that of Tishri. The first of Tishri is now the Jewish New Year's day. The Height of Manifestation is celebrated in Jewish tradition with the Ten Solemn Days and other festivals in the month of Tishri. It marks the beginning of the "civil year", whereas the month of Nisan, corresponding to the month of Abib of Moses, marks the beginning of the "spiritual year". The Signs to which they correspond respectively Cancer and Capricorn, exactly opposite to each other in the Zodiac, are those of the two solstitial Doors. Other Zodiacal symbolism in early Jewish tradition will be dealt with later in other contexts.

Easter and Pentecost. It has already been pointed out that the Jewish Pesach celebrated the mystery of Capricorn, and not that of the Easter Festival. The Christian Easter, though concurring with the Jewish Pesach in the time of Jesus, symbolically does not correspond to that, but to the Jewish Pentecost. The Jewish Pentecost, Shovvoth, is called "the Season of the Giving of our Law". It falls seven weeks, or 49 days, after Pesach. The word "Pentecost" means the "fiftieth" day. The symbolism of 49 and 50 will be dealt with later. Apart from referring to a World of seven times seven Spheres plus One, and to a full Cycle, the number 50 has a special meaning in connection with the particular time on the Path through the Zodiac to which it refers. We have seen that Moses received the Law on Mount Sinai in Pisces and gave it to the World of Manifestation in Aries. Between the leaving of "Egypt" in Capricorn and the giving of the Law 49 days pass.

The first-fruits. Pentecost, the Feast of Weeks, is also called the Day of First-fruits (Exodus 34, 22, Numbers 28, 26). These "first-fruits" are first of all the first-fruits of domestic animals, as is clear from many references to them. They are, above all, the lambs of Aries. Secondly they are the first-fruits of the wheat-harvest (Exodus 34, 22). When we dealt with the Seventh Plague some crops were mentioned (Exodus 9, 31—32). Corn or wheat was mentioned only as being absent. This is the case because it is sown in Egypt only in November, that is after the Seventh Plague, which in the time of Moses fell in the month of September. The very first wheat ears in the new Cycle of Manifestation represent the Resurrection. In many traditions, among which is the Egyptian, the wheat-ear forms a symbol of Resurrection. Pentecost, the Feast of Weeks, is the Festival of the Resurrection. In Aries the Tradition arises out of the Darkness to the Light of Day for the guidance of humanity. And along with it Man rises out of the Tomb. At Pentecost

are read even now in the synagogues words of Resurrection: "Let God arise" — "Let the righteous rejoice" — "He is the God that maketh men to be of one mind in an house, and bringeth the prisoners out of captivity." St. Paul, Christian initiate into the Mysteries of the Tradition, connected the Resurrection with the symbolism of "first fruits" (I Corinthians 15; 20): "Now is Christ risen from the dead, and become the first-fruits of them that slept".

The spiritual harvest. The precession of the⁷ equinoxes caused in early times confusion in established traditions. The sowing and

harvesting times, upon which the symbolism of the Spiritual Path is so largely based, gradually shifted with respect to their Zodiacal basis. Therefore the Lord instructed Moses to make the month Abib (again) the first month of the year (Genesis 12; 2 and 13; 4) and thus to revert to the original tradition of Genesis 1. This was justified for the period which Moses inaugurated. But the wanderings of the Jews and the consequent disorganization of their traditional life created new difficulties and misunderstandings. Sometimes adjustments were made to suit the needs of place and time, as for instance regarding the celebration of the Feast of Ingathering. It is now celebrated in the seventh month, which is the first month of the civil year, though Scripture enjoins that it should be celebrated at the end of the spiritual year (Exodus 34; 22 and 23; 16). It is clear that this injunction has symbolical meaning. We read (Exodus 34; 21): "Six days shalt thou work, but on the seventh day thou shalt rest: in earing time and in harvest thou shalt rest." In the Zodiac the "spiritual harvest" falls on the Sixth Day, the Day of the attainment of Manhood, consisting of Scorpio and Sagittarius. It is a very active time indeed. After that follows the Seventh Day, forming the stage of Rest or Inaction. It consists of Capricorn and Aquarius. In addition to the difficulties mentioned above came the difficulties of the calendar. The original Jewish year was solar as well as lunar. The later Jewish year became lunar only.

The leaven of sin. "Seven days shall ye eat unleavened bread; the first day ye shall put away leaven out of your houses: for whosoever cateth leavened bread from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall be cut off from Israel. And in the first day there shall be an holy convocation, and in the seventh day there shall be an holy convocation to you; no manner of work shall be done in them." (Exodus 12; 15—16). This injunction of Moses to his Elect

after the last Plague and before leaving the land of Egypt refers to the entire Spiritual Path, beginning and coming to an end in the stage of Capricorn and Aquarius, which is that of the First Day and the Seventh Day. During the entire Pilgrimage the soul should avoid the leaven of sin.

Whitsuntide. The Christian Whitsuntide, confused with the Jewish Pentecost because it concurred with it in the time of Jesus, has no symbolical connection with the giving of the Law or Tradition or with "first-fruits." It falls again fifty days later, counting from Easter and refers to the mystery of the Air-House of Gemini, ruled by the Spirit, the Lord of the Element Air. For Whitsuntide is the Festival of the Holy Spirit (Acts 2, 2-4). The "sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind" (2, 2) is that of the Lord of Spirit, ruling his Air-House Gemini on the Day-Throne. The "cloven tongues" are those of Gemini, the Twins (2, 3). They are said to be "like as of fire." This is the Fire under the rulership of the Spirit. It is dealt with elsewhere as the Fire of Vesta, the Dioscures Castor and Pollux, St. Elmus, and in other forms, all referring to Gemini. It is also found in Diagram 2.

28 THE SYMBOLISM OF THE PERIODS OF LIFE

The span of human life. In order to understand the symbolism of "birth", the deeper implications of the traditional periods of the life-cycle should be meditated upon. These are shown in Diagram 1b.

In accordance with the Indian tradition that human life in the Kali Yuga extends to a period of a hundred years, the periods of life are often taken to cover each twenty-five years. In that case the traditional ages for changing the Āśrama or mode of life are 25, 50 and 75. Another Hindu tradition takes the span of life as 108 years and a third as 120 years. The sacred number 108 is arrived at (in one way) by four times 27, the number of the Houses of the Moon-Zodiac. Its deeper implications will be dealt with later. The number 120 is arrived at by twelve times ten. Side by side with these traditions another tradition is found in East and West which serves better for practical purposes. It is the tradition, in which life is conceived in periods of seven years referring to each of the Twelve Houses of the Zodiac, which is shown in Diagram 1b. It is far more important than the others.

The spiritual birth. The Birth of Light takes place in some symbolical contexts at the entering of the Path, as is the case, for instance, in Genesis. In other symbolical contexts the Birth of Light comes at the end of the Path. For the sake of comparing the two, we may say, that the first Birth is — like every birth — a beginning and the first dim perception below of the manifestation of Light in its own Ether-Sphere, while the second Birth is that of the full blaze of Light. In the spiritual life "the birth of Christ" begins in the one way and ends ultimately in the other way. The first column of the three which refer to the Four Stages, in Diagram 1b, is the one to which the "first" and "second" Birth of Light apply. It is the column which starts from the winter-solstice — symbolically connected with that Birth — and which is concerned with the private religious or spiritual life of a person. In nature the "birth" of the sun is practically unnoticed, at the end of December. It is noticeable only to those persons who watch for it very carefully. In the same way, the spiritual Birth in a person can only be perceived by those persons in his environment who watch for it with great interest and love.

At the top of the column with the heading "Traditional periods in the day-cycle" we see that the first Birth takes place at the "ghost-hour", corresponding to the "darkness" and "wasteness" of Genesis, and the Chaos, Hell and Tartaros of other traditions. The Fallen Man is a mere ghost, from the point of view of the Spirit, and his psychical life consists of ghosts alone.

The birth of manifestation. From the point of view of life in the world the stage of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces is the stage of the embryo. Incarnation or conception begins with the winter-solstice. The three Houses are those of "Mother Earth" and of "the Womb". From the outer point of view, that of the World, man is born out of the Earth-Darkness at the vernal equinox, at the beginning of Aries. It is the time when "the Sun rises". Aries is the House of the Resurrection. This form of "birth" refers to the outer life in the world. It applies to the second of the three columns concerned, that of the "Division with reference to the Four Elements of Manifestation referring to the outer life in the world (beginning from the vernal equinox)". When comparing the first and the second columns it is interesting to observe that the private spiritual life of a person is always focussed one Element higher than, or is always one stage in advance of, his outer life in the world, including his relationships with other people. This is ultimately

the reason why the individual redeems the world On the Path of the Fall, on which the outer worldly life predominates over the inner spiritual life, the redeeming principle is exchanged for one which drags down

The four stages of life There are two traditions regarding the Four Varnas or "natural classes" of Hinduism These are represented in the two columns concerned One tradition knows the Four Varnas to be connected with the Four Elements the Śūdra with Earth, the Vaiśya with Water, the Kshatriya with Fire, and the Brāhmana with Air The other tradition holds that the end of life of the Vaiśya is Artha or material prosperity (referring to Earth), that the end of life of the Kshatriya is Kāma or emotional satisfaction (referring to Water), and that the end of life of the Brāhmana is Dharma (referring to Fire), — the end of life of the Śūdra being service of persons of the other Varnas, and the fourth end of life, Moksha or Liberation, being beyond the four categories

The third column is based on and starts from the Spiritual Pole The first Āśrama and the first stage as shown in this column do not correspond (as has been assumed in the Diagram for the sake of simplicity) The Four Āśramas can perhaps be understood more easily from the two previous columns

Conception. In Capricorn occurs *either* conception, a going down into incarnation, leading to the birth of Manifestation in Aries, or the Immaculate Conception, leading almost immediately to the Virgin Birth of the Light In Catholic tradition the Immaculate Conception of Our Lady is commemorated on December 8th, and the Birth of Christ on December 25th The Immaculate Conception is presided over by the Guru in the House of Sagittarius

Symbolically the "conception" and "incarnation" have both reference to Capricorn, because they are connected with the downward leading Door of Capricorn According to the scheme which connects with every Sign a period of seven years (see Diagram 1b, "Traditional periods of the life-cycle"), the after-death or pre-natal period of Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces takes 21 years It is clear that though it may very well take twenty-one years for a soul to come down to a new incarnation, previous to birth, the period between physical conception and birth is neither 21 years nor three months Symbolically "conception" belongs to Capricorn, because it is the crucial House of Desire and Coveting If we reckon the period backwards along the Path of the Fall, the time between the first

point of Capricorn and the first point of Aries is exactly nine months.

On the Path of Return the absence of Desire or Coveting in Capricorn brings the Virgin Birth.

Forms of symbolic birth. Manu (II; 169) refers to three kinds of "births". The first is that from the mother, the second comes when the "sacred thread" is given, and the third comes with the Initiation to a Yajña of major Sacrifice. The first "birth" is that of Manifestation, from the Womb of Mother Earth, in Aries. The third is that of Capricorn. The second, as has been dealt with elsewhere, is connected with Scorpio, the House where self-control is attained by means of prayer, and where the powers of the world are fought with the weapons of the Spirit.

In the Gospel of St. John (3; 3—6) three births are also referred to. Apart from the birth from the mother, spoken about by Nicodemus, Jesus refers to two kinds of symbolical birth, "of water and the Spirit". The "birth of water" is the Baptism of the Fourth Day, that of the Height of Manifestation, in the River of Life. It corresponds to the birth of the Patriarchs, in the Jewish religion, and to the birth of Yomkippur. The "birth of the Spirit" is that of the Seventh Day, comprising the Capricornian Birth and the Aquarian Anointing with the Cream of Life. These two forms of Birth are the two antipodal and complementary Initiations through the two Solstitial Doors. They are the two great "conversions" in a person's life, literally "turnings about". At the two solstices the sun seems to turn about on its course.

The "year" of one human lifetime is marked by "solstices" and "equinoxes".

Periods of life. In the outer life in Manifestation the period of physical growth extending from birth to majority is presided over by the emotional inner man. It covers Aries, Taurus and Gemini. Puberty occurs in Taurus. At the age of majority — twenty-one — falls the Initiation through the Door of Cancer into "the greater life", that of society. The period of emotional development in the world is presided over by the rational inner man. It covers Cancer, Leo and Virgo, and forms the period of "the Height of Manifestation". The age of 42 is marked by the autumnal equinox and the Evening Star. Psychologists are aware of the "crisis" which occurs in the psychical life of a person at about that age. The second or emotional period closes and the strength of a person begins to wane. People do not want it to close and rebel against

the waning, hence the crisis occurs. The third or moral period — that between 42 and 63 — covers *Libra*, *Scorpio* and *Sagittarius*. In it the attention is introverted and the Battle with the powers of the *Ahankâra* is fought under the guidance of the Spirit. If the Battle is won and *Ahankâra* dies, the last, the spiritual period, is entered upon. This entering, implying full renunciation, is done by the Inner Ruler, the Guru, the Light of the World. The entering upon the Spiritual Heritage of the Son is the "Birth of the Spirit", referred to by Jesus (St. John 3; 5). It is evident, that the true *Sannyâsi* is not he who performs a *rite* of cremating his lower self and puts on a yellow robe, but a Son of God alone, a perfected Saint and Sage, in whom all separateness, duality and sin have truly burned up, and who can say from experience: "I and the Father are One".

The climacterics. — The ages of 21, 42 and 63 are the climacterics or critical periods of life. The 63rd year has been called "the grand climacteric". The conception has been derived from Greek tradition. The Greek "*klimakter*" means "rung of ladder". The top of the Ladder reaches the Ether-Sphere.

The crises which occur at the climacterics may be alleviated and even prevented by a closer living according to the sacred traditions of life. One who learns to understand the Signs upon the horizons and within himself and to act in accordance will often have occasion to say from the depth of his heart — with the initiates of the Mysteries of *Dionûsos* — "bad have I escaped, and better I have found!"

PEACE!

PEACE!

PEACE!

To be followed by Volume II,
 "The Book of Battles".

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 „ 16. The symbolism of the myths dealing with world-periods.

In Volume II the following Diagrams will be dealt with: 3, 4a, 4b, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9a, 9b, 9c and 10.